THE TATTVAYOGABINDU OF RĀMACANDRA

A Critical Edition and Annotated Translation of an Early Modern Text on Rājayoga, with a Comparative Analysis of the Complex Yoga Taxonomies from the Same Period

by Nils Jacob Liersch



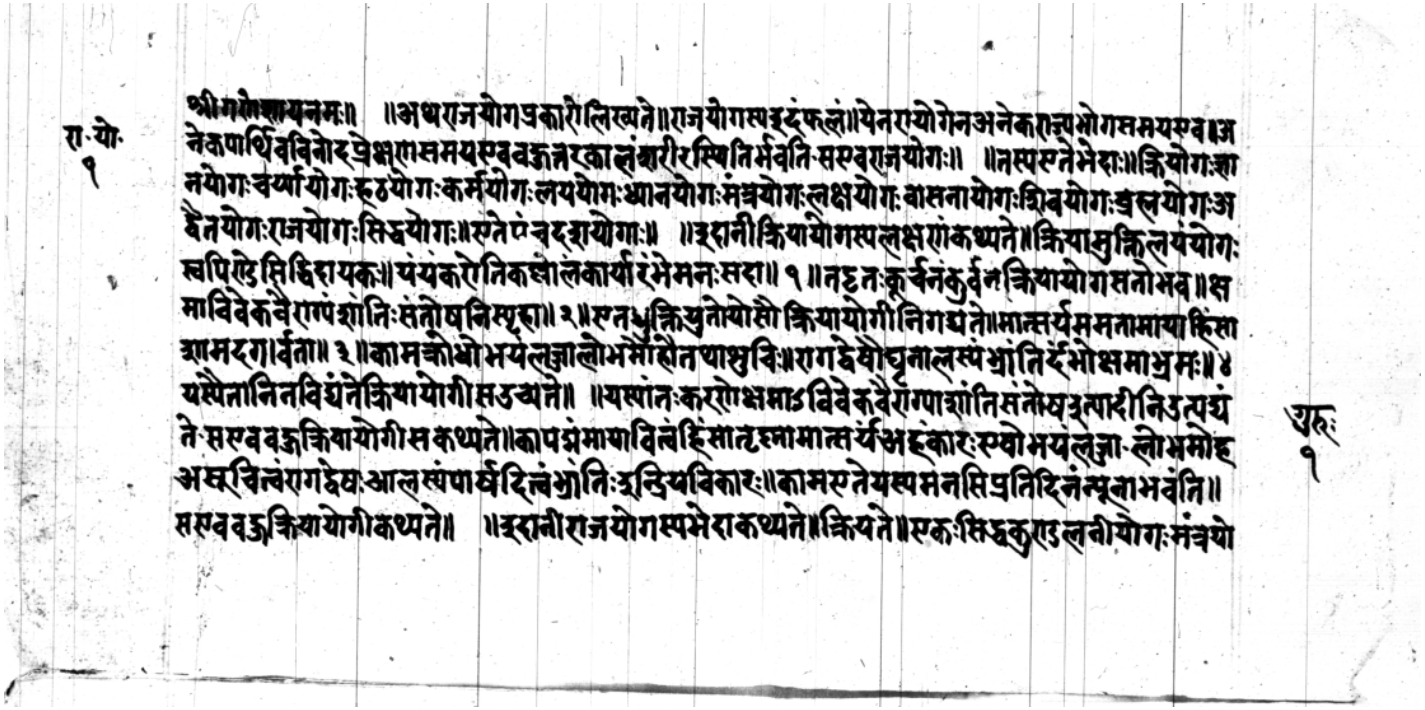


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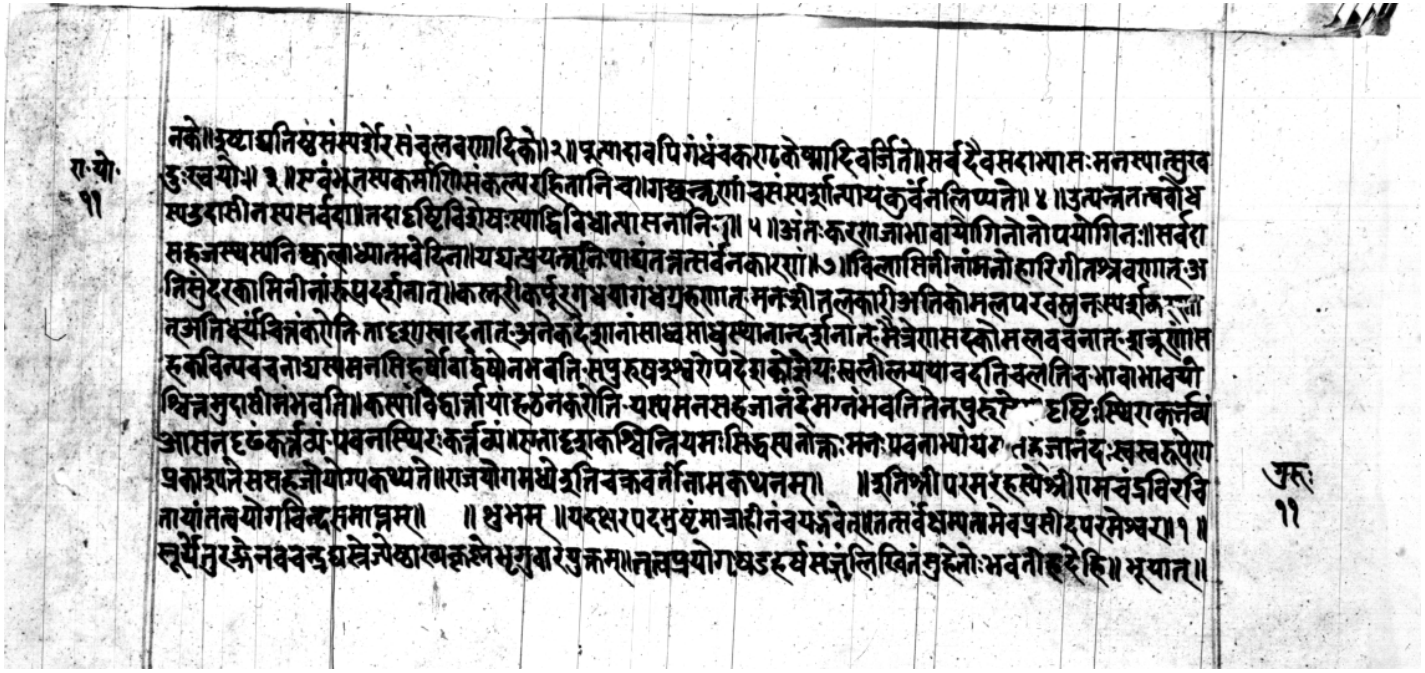


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[1] For more information about the ERC-funded *Haṭha Yoga Project* (2015–2020), see http://hyp.soas.ac.uk/ (alternatively: https://web.archive.org/web/20240516171430/http://hyp.soas.ac.uk/; archived on 04.10.2023).

my master's thesis, the results of which I presented at the 2018 World Sanskrit Conference in Vancouver, Canada, I also met James Mallinson. Soon afterwards, I found myself on the island of Procida in southern Italy, fortunate enough to have been invited to the HYP's two-week *Amṛtasiddhi* workshop. In Procida, Jason Birch encouraged me to work on the *Tattvayogabindu* and provided me with the first manuscripts of the text that he had collected. The investigation of the broader theme of complex yoga taxonomies, introduced at the very beginning of the text, appeared particularly promising for advancing research on the history of yoga. At another HYP workshop in spring 2019, devoted to the *Yogabīja* and held at the University of Marburg, I met Jürgen Hanneder, who readily agreed to supervise my dissertation on the *Tattvayogabindu*. I am deeply grateful for his continuous support, philological expertise, and encyclopaedic knowledge.

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Chapter 1

Introduction

1.1 General remarks

The *Tattvayogabindu* of Rāmacandra[2] is an early modern Sanskrit text on Rājayoga that was written in the first half of the sixteenth century[3] in northern India.[4] The most salient feature of the work that makes it historically significant is its highly differentiated taxonomy of yoga types. In the *Tattvayogabindu*'s introduction, most manuscripts name fifteen types of yoga, presented as methods of Rājayoga. These are 1. Kriyāyoga, 2. Jñānayoga, 3. Caryāyoga, 4. Haṭhayoga, 5. Karmayoga, 6. Layayoga, 7. Dhyānayoga, 8. Mantrayoga, 9. Lakṣyayoga, 10. Vāsanāyoga, 11. Śivayoga, 12. Brahmayoga, 13. Advaitayoga, 14. Siddhayoga, and 15. Rājayoga itself.[5] The text is a yogic compendium written mainly in prose, incorporating 47 verses, and organised into thematically defined sections of varying length, many of which are introduced by recurring formulaic expressions. The sections deal with the methods of Rājayoga and their effects, while others also cover topics such as yogic physiology, the Avadhūta, the importance of the guru, cosmogony, and a *yogaśāstrarahasya*.

The *Tattvayogabindu* has not been discussed comprehensively in the secondary literature on yoga. The only exception is Birch (2014: 415–416), who briefly described its list of fifteen yogas in the context of the "fifteen medieval yogas" and noted that a similar taxonomy occurs in Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (17th century), a commentary on the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* that integrates fifteen medieval yogas within its *aṣṭāṅga* format. An incomplete account of the fifteen yogas is found within the Sanskrit yoga text *Yogasvarodaya*, which is known only through quotations in the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*, the *Yogakarṇikā* and the *Śabdakalpadruma*. The *Yogasvarodaya* announces a total of fifteen yogas but names only eight of them in its introductory *śloka*s. It is the primary source and template for the compilation of the *Tattvayogabindu*. In addition to borrowing several passages, Rāmacandra often follows its con-

[2] For a discussion of the author Rāmacandra, see p. 21.

[3] The dating of the text is discussed on p. 6.

[4] The detailed discussion of the place of origin is found on p. 227, n. 382.

[5] This is a remarkable increase in the number of declared yogas compared to the standard medieval tetrad of Mantra, Laya, Haṭha and Rājayoga.

tent and structure, rewriting the *Yogasvarodaya*'s *śloka*s into prose or quoting them directly without attribution. Due to the incomplete transmission of the *Yogasvarodaya*, Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu* provides a natural and valuable starting point for the first in-depth study of the complex yoga taxonomies of the early modern period, a phenomenon that, as I will show, can be situated with considerable precision in both time and place. The other source text that Rāmacandra used is the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, whose content he draws on, particularly in the second half of his composition. Another text that includes a somewhat similar taxonomy of twelve yogas divided into three tetrads[6] is Sundardās's *Brajbhāṣā* yoga text named *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* (17th century), which not only shares most of these types of yoga but also offers a different and valuable perspective on their classification and interpretation.[7]

These complex taxonomies that emerged during the 16th and 17th centuries crossed sectarian divides and were adapted to the specific needs of different authors and traditions. The *Tattvayogabindu* thus documents a substantial part of the diversity of yoga types and teachings that emerged after the *Haṭhapradīpikā* (15th century) and were adopted and practised across a broad range of religious traditions and social strata in India. In the particular case of the *Tattvayogabindu*, there are various statements throughout the text that reveal a strategy to detach yoga from its ascetic and renunciate connotations and to stylise Rājayoga as a practice that can bring the desired soteriological benefits even to practitioners who enjoy worldly pleasures and luxurious lifestyles. Textual evidence suggests that the *Tattvayogabindu* is an important example of a text that provides an early modern adaptation of Rājayoga for *kṣatriya*s in a courtly environment. In fact, the *Tattvayogabindu* is currently the earliest known work to address its teachings on Rājayoga to rulers, ranging from kings (*rājan*) to the idealised universal ruler (*cakravartin*). This strongly suggests that the term *rājayoga* is conceived here as a "yoga for kings."

[6] See p. 315 for a detailed discussion of the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*.

[7] For a comparative table of the complex early modern yoga taxonomies see table 2 on p. 305.

One printed edition of the *Tattvayogabindu*, accompanied by a Hindi translation, was published in 1905 on the basis of one or more unidentified manuscripts.[8] This publication bears the title "*Binduyoga*", confirmed by the printed text's final rubric.[9] However, as I will discuss in the introduction, the text was originally known as *Tattvayogabindu*. The manuscripts consulted display significant discrepancies, structural differences, and variant readings both among themselves and in comparison with the printed edition.[10] Furthermore, the manuscripts are scattered across the northern half of the Indian subcontinent and Nepal, which suggests that the text was widely transmitted at some point. Lengthy passages of the *Tattvayogabindu* are quoted without attribution in a text called the *Yogasaṃgraha* and Sundaradeva's *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā*.

The first chapter of this study contains a general introduction to Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu*. The chapter gives a brief overview of the content of the text and discusses its origin, the author and the author's intended audience. Subsequently, the textual witnesses, source texts and testimonies of the *Tattvayogabindu* are described. A stemmatic analysis of the text is then presented, based on manual philological methods and computer-assisted stemmatics, resulting in a *stemma codicum*. The chapter concludes with a presentation of the editorial policies, which form the basis for the second chapter of this thesis. The second chapter, the core of this study, is a critical edition and annotated translation of the *Tattvayogabindu*. The critical edition establishes a significantly improved text and sheds new light on its historical significance. The third chapter contains a comparative analysis of the complex early modern yoga taxonomies based on hermeneutics of difference.[11] Using the new critical edition of the *Tattvayogabindu* and the texts mentioned

[8] Miśra, 1905.

[9] To avoid terminological confusion, I consistently follow Camillo Formigatti's usage in distinguishing between the final rubric—the string of words marking the end of a textual unit, often including an assertion of authorship and title—and the colophon proper of a manuscript, that is, the statement providing information on the date, place, agency, or purpose of the manuscript's production. See Formigatti, 2022: 48–49.

[10] For example, the printed edition does not contain the complex yoga taxonomy presented in the manuscripts of the *Tattvayogabindu*.

[11] The concept of hermeneutics of difference is discussed on p. 306, n. 478.

above, *Yogasvarodaya*, *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* and *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, the complex yogic taxonomies of the four texts are compared in detail. Based on this comparative analysis, a differentiated hypothesis concerning the emergence of the complex yoga taxonomies is developed, and the complex yoga taxonomies are situated and explained in the broader context of the historical development of the yoga traditions. The comparison includes a nuanced description of each yoga category used by the authors of the texts with complex yoga taxonomies. While the authors of the four texts often use identical terms for the individual yoga categories, they interpret these categories in accordance with their respective religious backgrounds and agendas, producing significant differences in meaning and emphasis. Contrasting the comparanda, i.e., the authors, the texts, the yoga taxonomies, and the yoga categories, therefore, provides deep insight into the discursive negotiation processes of the Indian yoga traditions during the 16th and 17th centuries.

1.2 Dating the *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya*

The oldest dated extant manuscript of the *Tattvayogabindu*, N_2, was written in the running year Nepal Saṃvat 712, that is, in 1591 CE.[12] The second-oldest surviving dated manuscript V was written in Vikram Saṃvat 1751, that is, in 1693 CE.[13] The third-oldest preserved manuscript N_1[14] was written in Nepal Saṃvat 837, i.e. in 1716 CE.

Both Nepalese manuscripts N_1 and N_2 exhibit a substantial *lacuna* amounting to approximately 23.50% of the total text. Since N_2 is dated earlier than N_1, it must be assumed that either N_1 is a direct copy of N_2 or both derive from the same exemplar. A comparison of the distribution of errors, shared readings, and divergences suggests that the latter scenario is more likely. The presence of such a large *lacuna* in both manuscripts points to either the loss or deterioration of the corresponding folios of the exemplar. Furthermore, both manuscripts contain various corruptions. In light of these observations,

[12] For a detailed description of manuscript N_2 and a discussion of its dating, see p. 36.
[13] For a description of the manuscript V see p. 45.
[14] For a description of the manuscript N_1 see p. 35.

it appears that the textual transmission had already undergone substantial degradation by the end of the sixteenth century. Consequently, the work was most likely composed several decades before the oldest dated extant manuscript N_2 was copied, that is, sometime in the sixteenth century, probably in its second half.

The latter assumption is corroborated by witness V, the second-oldest available dated witness, which is one of the poorest in the tradition. It contains no significant variants, and the sheer number of scribal errors and editorial interventions compelled me to exclude it from the collation.

The earliest quotations from the *Tattvayogabindu* occur in Sundaradeva's *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā*. Sundaradeva quotes from the *Tattvayogabindu* without attribution. The two lengthy passages quoted from the *Tattvayogabindu* include the teachings on the sixteen *ādhāra*s[15] as well as those on Lakṣyayoga and its subtypes.[16]

The dating of the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* has only recently been revised due to the discovery that certain first-hand annotations surrounding the main text of the Ujjain *Yogacintāmaṇi* were, in all likelihood, borrowed from Sundaradeva's work, which currently provides the text's *terminus ante quem*.[17] Birch (2018) dated the Ujjain *Yogacintāmaṇi* to 1659 CE.[18] Thus, the citations within the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* represent the second-oldest transmitted textual evidence of the *Tattvayogabindu*.

In the case of the *Tattvayogabindu*, the colophon of N_2 establishes a current *terminus ante quem* of 1591 CE. The same *terminus ante quem* applies to its hitherto undated source text, the *Yogasvarodaya*, and, as will be discussed later in more detail, to the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*.

We may therefore safely assume that the *Tattvayogabindu* was composed in the second half of the sixteenth century or earlier. Consequently, Rāmacandra's source texts, the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, must have been composed earlier still.

[15] *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 95r l. 3 to f. 96r l. 4).
[16] *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 124r l. 7 to f. 125r l. 3).
[17] Birch, 2024: 52–54.
[18] Birch, 2018: 50, n. 111.

1.3 Synopsis of the *Tattvayogabindu*'s contents

Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu* can be divided into 59 sections. Many of these sections are brief, consisting of only a few sentences or lists of specific topics or concepts the author wishes to convey. However, some sections are significantly longer. Almost every section is introduced with clearly identifiable section markers. In these cases, a section begins with recognisable phrases such as *atha*, *idānīm* or *idam*. Sometimes, sections begin without section markers. Nevertheless, the thematic shifts were so significant that I, as the editor, felt obliged to mark these passages as separate sections.[19] The wording of the text remains entirely unchanged.

By far the largest part of the text is devoted to explaining various yogas. Of the fifteen yogas presented in the introduction as methods of Rājayoga[20], Rāmacandra explains only eight in the course of the text. These are Rājayoga, Kriyāyoga, Siddha[kuṇḍalinī]yoga, Mantrayoga, Lakṣyayoga, Haṭhayoga, and Jñānayoga. Surprisingly, there are also three additional yogas not listed among the fifteen initially mentioned: Aṣṭāṅgayoga, Satyayoga, and Sahajayoga. The individual yogas, both those explicitly described and those merely mentioned in the taxonomy, are discussed in detail from p. 303 onwards. This chapter analyses and compares them with the three other texts containing complex yoga taxonomies, particularly in order to determine the significance of these taxonomies in the history of yoga.

Another major subject is (yogic) reality (*tattva*) in all its dimensions, from the yogic body and cosmogenesis to the role of the *guru*. In sections XXV–XXVI, Rāmacandra names and describes the functions of the ten physical channels (*nāḍī*s) and the ten vital winds (*vāyu*s). In sections XXXII–XLI, he postulates the identity of the universe (*brahmāṇḍa*) and the body (*piṇḍa*). Following this, Rāmacandra lists numerous macrocosmic elements within the body: the worlds (*loka*s), rulers of the worlds (*lokasvāmin*s), seven islands (*dvīpa*s), seven oceans (*samudra*s), nine regions (*khaṇḍa*s), eight major mountains (*parvata*s), nine rivers (*nāḍī*s), twenty-seven constellations (*nakṣatra*s),

[19] This specifically pertains to sections VI, VII, XIV, XVII, and XLI.

[20] See p. 106.

and so on. Structurally, Rāmacandra simply names the macrocosmic element and then locates it in the body. Finally, in sections LV–LVII, Rāmacandra lists the digits (*kalā*s) of the moon (*candra*), sun (*sūrya*), and fire (*agni*). Another significant component of the *Tattvayogabindu* is a variant of a set of teachings that can be traced back to an ancient Śaiva paradigm.[21] This set consists of teachings on *cakras*,[22] *ādhāra*s,[23] *lakṣya*s,[24] and *vyoma*s or *ākāśa*s.[25]

Other topics include a description of the tamed Avadhūta,[26] and a description of the division of the heart lotus (*hṛdayakamala*), whose reception history can be traced back to the teachings of the Śaiva exegetes of Kashmir.[27] Other sections discuss a pentadic cosmogony or the importance of the teacher (*guru*) for yoga practice.[28] The work concludes with a lengthy section titled the "esoteric yoga doctrine in all of the scriptures" (*yogaśāstrarahasyaṃ samagraśāstramadhye*), which primarily concerns the ultimate yoga teaching for those called *cakravartin*, namely Sahajayoga. This yoga enables the practitioner to enjoy all the benefits of yoga without the need to practise it. Table 1 provides an overview of all contents of the *Tattvayogabindu*, arranged by sections:

[21] *Tattvayogabindu* XXVIII.1: *navacakraṃ kalādhāraṃ trilakṣyaṃ vyomapaṃcakaṃ | svadehe yo na jānāti sa yogī nāmadhārakaḥ* || Variants of this verse are found in numerous yoga texts with a Śaiva orientation and older Śaiva Tantras. I discuss this paradigm on p. 393.

[22] A total of nine *cakra*s, along with meditation instructions on these, are described in detail in sections IV–XII. In section XXIX, nine *cakra*s are listed again, but only with names and locations.

[23] The sixteen containers (*ādhāra*s) are described in section XXX. These include specific locations suitable for meditation, *mudrā* and *bandha* techniques.

[24] The *Tattvayogabindu* includes five meditative foci (*lakṣya*s), which are collectively referred to as the Rājayoga method called Lakṣyayoga. The sections on the subtypes are found in sections XIII–XV and XXIII–XXIV.

[25] These are five meditative spaces that the yogi can traverse, described in section XXVIII.

[26] The original archetype of the antinomian ascetic is tamed in XLIV.

[27] See sections XLV–XLVII.

[28] See sections XLIII and LVIII.

Table 1: Topics of the *Tattvayogabindu*

Section	Topic in Sanskrit	Translation
I	*rājayogaprakāraḥ*	Method of Rājayoga
II	*kriyāyogasya lakṣaṇam*	Characteristics of Kriyāyoga
III	*rājayogasya bhedāḥ*	Varieties of Rājayoga
IV	*mūlacakram*	Mūlacakra
V	*svādhiṣṭhānacakram*	Svādhiṣṭānacakra
VI	*nābhisthāne padmam*	Lotus within the place of the navel
VII	*hṛdayamadhye kamalam*	Lotus within the heart
VIII	*kaṇṭhasthāne kamalam*	Lotus within the location of the throat
IX	*ājñācakram*	Ājñācakra
X	*cakraṃ tālumadhye*	Cakra within the palate
XI	*aṣṭamacakraṃ brahmarandhrasthāne*	Eighth cakra at the aperture of brahman
XII	*mahāśūnyacakram*	Cakra of the great void
XIII	*lakṣyayogaḥ*	Lakṣyayoga
XIV	*ūrdhvalakṣyam*	The upper focus
XV	*adholakṣyaḥ*	The lower focus
XVI	*rājayogayuktasya puruṣasya yac charīracihnam*	The physical sign of a person who is engaged in Rājayoga
XVII	*anyad rājayogasya cihnam*	Another sign of Rājayoga
XVIII	*caryāyogaḥ*	Caryāyoga
XIX	*haṭhayogaḥ*	Haṭhayoga
XX	*haṭhayogasya dvitīyo bhedaḥ*	Second type of Haṭhayoga
XXI	*jñānayogasya lakṣaṇam*	The characteristics of Jñānayoga
XXII	*svabhāvabhedam*	Distinction of the nature
XXIII	*bāhyalakṣyam*	The outer focus
XXIV	*antaralakṣyam*	The inner focus
XXV	*nāḍīnāṃ bhedāḥ*	Division of the channels
XXVI	*śarīramadhye vāyavaḥ*	The vital winds within the body

Table 1: Topics of the *Tattvayogabindu* (continued)

Section	Topic in Sanskrit	Translation
XXVII	*madhyalakṣyam*	Central focus
XXVIII	*ākāśabhedāḥ*	Divisions of space
XXIX	*cakrāṇām anukramaḥ*	Sequence of *cakra*s
XXX	*ādhāracakrasya bhedāḥ*	Divisions of the wheels of support
XXXI	*aṣṭāṅgayogasya vicāraḥ*	Reflection of Aṣṭāṅgayoga
XXXII	*piṇḍabrahmāṇḍayor aikyam*	Identity of the universe and the body
XXXIII	*piṇḍamadhye lokatrayam*	Triad of worlds
XXXIV	*uparitanaṃ lokacatuṣkam*	Upper tetrad of worlds
XXXV	*catvāro lokasvāminaḥ*	Lords of the world
XXXVI	*saptadvīpāni piṇḍamadhye*	Seven continents within the body
XXXVII	*piṇḍamadhye saptasamudrāḥ*	Seven oceans within the body
XXXVIII	*navadvāramadhye navakhaṇḍāni*	Nine regions within the nine doors
XXXIX	*piṇḍamadhye 'ṣṭakulaparvatāḥ*	Eight major mountains within the body
XL	*śarīre navanāḍyaḥ*	Nine rivers within the body
XLI	*saptaviṃśatinakṣatrāṇi …*	Twenty-seven constellations …
XLII	*rājayogāc charīre cihnāni*	Signs in the body as a result of Rājayoga
XLIII	*gurubhakteḥ phalam*	Result of devotion towards the teacher
XLIV	*avadhūtapuruṣasya lakṣaṇam*	Characteristics of an Avadhūta person
XLV	*kamalānāṃ saṃketam adbhutam*	The wonderful esoteric teaching of the lotus flowers
XLVI	*ādhārakamalam*	Lotus of support
XLVII	*hṛdayakamalasya bhedaḥ*	Division of the heart Lotus
XLVIII	*yogasiddher anantaraṃ jñānam*	Knowledge after the success in yoga
XLIX	*piṇḍotpattiḥ*	Origin of the body
L	*śarīramadhye pañca mahābhūtāni*	Five great elements within the body

Table 1: Topics of the *Tattvayogabindu* (continued)

Section	Topic in Sanskrit	Translation
LI	*pañcaprakārā antaḥkaraṇasya*	Five modes of the internal organ
LII	*kulapañcakasya bhedāḥ*	Divisions of the pentad of the *kula*
LIII	*ekaṃ jñānam*	Unique knowledge
LIV	*karma kāmaḥ candraḥ sūryaḥ agniḥ*	Action, desire, moon, sun and fire
LV	*candrasya ṣoḍaśakalāḥ*	Sixteen digits of the moon
LVI	*sūryasya dvādaśakalāḥ*	Twelve digits of the sun
LVII	*agnisaṃbandhinyo daśakalāḥ*	Ten digits related to fire
LVIII	*yogasya māhātmyam*	Majesty of yoga
LIX	*yogaśāstrarahasyam*	Secret teaching of the scriptures of yoga

1.4 Rāmacandra and the audience of his text

The article by Jason Birch titled "Rājayoga: Reincarnations of the King of All Yogas" (2014) re-evaluates the reception history of the term *rājayoga*, significantly enhancing our understanding, coloured by modern interpretations, with a far more nuanced perspective. As the title of Birch's article directly suggests, the term Rājayoga has been used by different traditions at various times with highly diverse understandings and interpretations of this compound. A significant insight for this study is that in the extant Sanskrit literature on Yoga, the interpretation of Rājayoga as "Yoga for kings" is comparatively rare. Birch (2014: 412) notes:

> In fact, my research has revealed only two texts which contain the gloss of Rājayoga as "the Yoga fit for kings". Both are

> eighteenth-century Vedāntic works, namely, the *Rājayogabhāṣya* and Divākara's commentary to the *Bodhasāra*.

Divākara's commentary is particularly interesting. Here, Rājayoga is described as the Yoga of kings—"rulers could accomplish it even when they remain in their position as kings."[29] The following pages demonstrate that Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu* likely falls into this category. Textual evidence suggests that the *Tattvayogabindu* is one of the rare examples of a Rājayoga text composed for the warrior aristocracy, taught to members of a royal court, and perhaps even to the king himself. Rāmacandra begins his treatise on Rājayoga with the following definition. In *Tattvayogabindu* section I, ll. 1–2 he writes:

> *atha rājayogaprakāro likhyate ‖ rājayogasyedaṃ phalaṃ | yena rājayogenānekarājyabhogasamaya eva | anekapārthivavinodaprekṣaṇasamaya eva | bahutarakālaṃ śarīrasthitir bhavati |*
>
> Now, the method of Rājayoga is laid down. This is the fruit of Rājayoga: Through Rājayoga, the long-term durability of the body arises even when there is the manifold enjoyment of political power [and] even when there is manifold royal entertainment and spectacle.

The core message is unequivocal. Rājayoga enables the practitioner to achieve lasting health and physical stability while enjoying political power, entertainment, and spectacle. Consequently, the Rājayoga described in the text is unlikely to be intended for ascetics who pursue soteriological goals with minimal material possessions, but explicitly for individuals accustomed to an affluent lifestyle. The adjectives °*rājya*° and °*pārthiva*° used in the definition suggest a more specific courtly context. The effect of *śarīrasthiti* promoted by Rājayoga can also be seen as an indicator of a courtly audience, as the qualities of strength, discipline, and resilience were essential for fulfilling the primary duty of the *kṣatriya* caste, namely the protection and defence of

[29] Birch, 2014: 430.

the population. The motif of physical and mental strengthening through yoga in a courtly context is exemplified by the famous yoga tradition of the Mysore Palace. Tirumalai Krishnamacharya was employed as a yoga teacher by Maharaja Krishnaraja Wodiyar IV (1884–1940) within the court's educational program at the Mysore Palace from the 1930s until the early 1950s, primarily to cultivate the physical robustness and mental agility of the royal family.[30]

In his book containing a new edition of the *Dattātreyayogaśāstra* (2024: 21–22), Mallinson argues convincingly that the status and name of Rājayoga in the early texts of Haṭhayoga reflect developments within the monastic traditions of the time. Mallinson dates the *Dattātreyayogaśāstra* to 1200 CE, three centuries before the composition of the *Tattvayogabindu*. Many monastic institutions had gained significant power and autonomy, distancing themselves from royal patronage. The heads of these monasteries, known as *maṭhādhipati*s, began to function similarly to kings (*rāja*s) and were sometimes even referred to by such titles. Mallinson refers to Sanderson's observation that Śaiva *maṭhādhipati*s from Bengal to Karnataka ruled like kings, engaging in activities such as founding monasteries, bestowing land grants on brahmins, rewarding poets, founding temples and settlements, and providing means of irrigation. These *maṭhādhipati*s were often given royal or imperial titles. Furthermore, Mallinson demonstrates that the heads of monasteries in which *haṭha* yoga texts were likely composed were also conceived of as kings. Could it be that the *Tattvayogabindu* is a text from one of the *maṭha*s described by Mallinson, even though the *Tattvayogabindu* was written approximately three centuries later? This can be ruled out for two reasons, even though powerful *maṭha*s existed in Rāmacandra's time. Firstly, there are no indications of specific ascetic affiliations in the *Tattvayogabindu*; on the contrary, Rāmacandra strives to give his text a religiously neutral character and is careful to obscure the Śaiva roots of the source texts he uses. Secondly, the text explicitly speaks out against celibate ascetics, a stance that would hardly be expected from a text belonging to and intended for the audience of a *maṭha*.

Rāmacandra writes in *Tattvayogabindu* LVIII.6:

[30] See Singleton, 2010: 177–178 and Sjoman, 1996: 52–53.

> *ajñānākulaśīlānāṃ yatīnāṃ brahmacāriṇām |*
> *upadeśaṃ na gṛhṇīyād anyathā narakaṃ dhruvam ||*
>
> One should not accept the teaching of celibate ascetics whose nature is confused by ignorance; otherwise, hell is inevitable.

Ascetics can thus be excluded as a potential audience at this point.[31] Certainly, the development of the *maṭha*s described by Mallinson (2024: 21–23), where *maṭhādhipati*s gained immense power and influence and promoted practices known as Rājayoga, did not go unnoticed by other rulers. It is possible that these circumstances inspired other rulers to include Rājayoga in their courtly training programs.

Beyond the introduction, further indications of the text's intended audience are scattered throughout the *Tattvayogabindu*. For instance, Rāmacandra points out that certain yogic practices can enhance one's attractiveness and cultivate popularity among young women,[32] or even subject women to one's will.[33] One result of meditation on the ninth *cakra* is that the practitioner, even while enjoying royal pleasures, amusing himself among women, and watching musical performances, finds that his vitality increases daily like the waxing moon.[34] As a result of practising *antaralakṣya*, a meditation on a red light between the eyebrows, he becomes beloved among all royal people.[35] Furthermore, one of the outcomes of Rājayoga is that every desire for worldly pleasures is fulfilled without attachment to those pleasures. As

[31] There are literary accounts of kings renouncing their kingdom to become ascetic yogins, such as the *jogī khaṇḍa* of the *Padmāvat*. Mallinson (2021: 75) cites the respective passage and provides a translation. In the *Tattvayogabindu*, Rājayoga is reinterpreted so that the king can remain in his position as the "enjoyer of the earth" while simultaneously achieving all soteriological goals without the inconveniences of an ascetic lifestyle.

[32] *Tattvayogabindu* V ll. 6–7: *tanmadhye 'tiraktavarṇaṃ tejo vartate | tasya dhyānakaraṇāt sādhako 'tisundaro bhavati | yuvatīnām ativallabho bhavati |*

[33] *Tattvayogabindu* VII ll. 4–6: *asyā mūrter dhyānakāraṇāt svargapātālākāśamanuṣyagandharvakinnaraguhyakavidyādharalokasaṃbandhinyāḥ strīyaḥ sādhakasya puruṣasya vaśyā bhavanti |*

[34] *Tattvayogabindu* XII ll. 1–3: *rājyasukhabhogavṛtaḥ | strīmadhye vilāsavataḥ saṃgītavinodaprekṣyāvataḥ eva puruṣasya pratidinaṃ śuklapakṣe candrakalāvat kalā vardhate |*

[35] *Tattvayogabindu* XXIV ll. 2–3: *atha vā bhruvor madhye 'tiraktavarṇasyātisthūlasya tejaso dhyānakaraṇāt sakalānāṃ pārthivapuruṣāṇāṃ vallabho bhavati |*

examples, Rāmacandra mentions excellent fruits and women.[36] Another result of Rājayoga, according to Rāmacandra, is that even if one were to obtain an entire kingdom, the feeling of having gained something does not arise.[37] Furthermore, the omission of non-violence (*ahiṃsā*) in the context of the presentation of Aṣṭāṅgayoga's *yama*s and *niyama*s points to a *kṣatriya* audience. The duties of a ruler sometimes involve "cruel" actions, such as enforcing laws, possibly through war. For this reason, a ruler cannot adhere to *ahiṃsā*.[38]

An important example[39] that strengthens the above interpretation of a particular wealthy setting is the mention of the eight enjoyments (*aṣṭau bhogāḥ*). I have not yet been able to locate the direct source of the *aṣṭau bhogāḥ*. However, in the *Mānasollāsa* of King Someśvara, one finds a list of twenty royal *upabhoga*s, which include all eight mentioned here in much greater detail.[40] The eight enjoyments might be a simplified form of the twenty royal enjoyments from King Someśvara's *Mānasollāsa*. Thus, this enumeration of pleasures likely originated in a courtly context. The eight enjoyments are introduced as the result of the innate nature of the self. Rāmacandra's depiction suggests that his audience was familiar with these enjoyments. In *Tattvayogabindu* XXII p. 172 ll. 1–4, Rāmacandra states:

> *paṭṭasūtramayāni vastrāṇi* 1 ‖ *pañca vā sapta vā śālikāyuktāni harmyāṇi* 2 ‖ *ativipulā mṛdūttarachadavatī śayyā* 3 ‖ *padminī tāruṇyavatī manoharā guṇavatī tatropaviṣṭā kāntā* 4 ‖ *sādhvāsanam* 5 ‖ *atimūlyo 'śvaś ca* 6 ‖ *manoramam annam* 7 ‖ *tathāvidhaṃ pānam* 8 ‖ *ete 'ṣṭau bhogāḥ kathitāḥ | ete duḥkhaṃ bhajante | bhikṣāṃ yācante ca |*

[36] *Tattvayogabindu* XVI ll. 6–7: *atha ca phalacandanakāminyāderyasya yasyeccha bhavati | taṃ taṃ bhogaṃ prāpnoti | atha vāsya mana eva sthāne 'nurāgaṃ na prāpnoti ‖*

[37] *Tattvayogabindu* XVII l. 1: *yasya rājyādhilābhe 'pi phalalābho na bhavati |*

[38] Cf. *Tattvayogabindu* XXXI.

[39] This passage has no parallel to the *Yogasvarodaya*.

[40] Shrigondekar, 1939: 5.

1. Clothes made from silk thread;[41]
2. Mansions endowed with five or seven rooms;[42]
3. A very large bed with a soft and lovely blanket;[43]
4. [on which] there is seated a sweetheart belonging to the Padminī-class of women—youthful, beautiful, and virtuous;[44]
5. An excellent seat;[45]
6. An exceptionally valuable horse;[46]
7. Appetising food;[47]
8. Similar drinks.[48]

These are the eight enjoyments. They bring about suffering. And [they] require begging.

The final sentence of the passage, "And [they] require begging." (*bhikṣāṃ yācante ca* |), is initially puzzling, but the textual tradition is unequivocal. The preceding pronoun *ete* most naturally refers back to the *aṣṭau bhogāḥ*, and the translation deliberately preserves this awkwardness. Semantically, however, the statement clearly concerns the practitioner, since the act of begging can only be performed by an animate agent. The question, therefore, is who

[41] In the twenty *upabhoga*s of the *Mānasollāsa* we find the topic of *Vastropabhoga* or the "enjoyment of garments". Particularly in summer, the king is asked to wear silk or cotton clothes, which are thin and charming. Cf. Shrigondekar, 1939: 14.

[42] The first *adhyāya* of the third *viṃśati* of the *Mānasollāsa* discusses astrology for finding out auspicious moments while building new houses for princes. Here, houses with one to four *śālā*s are described. Cf. Shrigondekar, 1939: 6–7.

[43] This is found as *Śayyābhoga* within the *Mānasollāsa*. In this section, seven kinds of beds and eight kinds of bedsteads are described. Cf. Shrigondekar, 1939: 14.

[44] This is resembled as *yoṣidupabhoga* within the *Mānasollāsa*. In this chapter, King Someśvara describes the qualifications of women whom a king should marry. The two most important qualities he gives are beauty and full youth. Out of the four kinds of women, a) Padminī, b) Citriṇī, c) Śaṅkhinī, and d) Hastinī, he suggests that the latter two kinds are not worth enjoying. Cf. Shrigondekar, 1939: 21.

[45] The *āsanopabhoga* or "the enjoyment of seats" within the *Mānasollāsa* describes various kinds of royal seats. Cf. Shrigondekar, 1939: 15.

[46] This is resembled as *yānopabhoga* within the *Mānasollāsa*. In this chapter, King Someśvara lists nine kinds of vehicles, including horses. Cf. Shrigondekar, 1939: 24.

[47] This is resembled as *annabhoga* within the *Mānasollāsa*. In this section, King Someśvara describes the names of various kinds of great food and instructions for preparing various dishes. Cf. Shrigondekar, 1939: 21.

[48] This is resembled as *pānīyabhoga* within the *Mānasollāsa*. In this chapter, everything related to drinking and drinks is described. Cf. Shrigondekar, 1939: 23.

could plausibly be envisaged as requesting the eight pleasures listed above. A travelling ascetic or mendicant might beg for food and drink, but hardly for silk garments, women, expensive horses, and similar luxuries. An ordinary householder might aspire to such possessions, yet the notion of begging for them still seems inappropriate. The passage therefore appears to presuppose a courtly milieu in which such costly goods could actually be requested and granted, most plausibly from wealthy patrons or members of a royal court.

In the last section of the *Tattvayogabindu* (LIX), Rāmacandra presents his *yogaśāstrarahasyasamagraśāstramadhye*, "esoteric yoga doctrine in all of the scriptures". This section explicitly states that this esoteric yoga doctrine should be revealed in the presence of a king with certain qualities.

> *yasya rājño manomadhye kapaṭaṃ nāsti | yasmin dṛṣṭe deśakasya trāso na bhavati | tasya manaḥ śuddhaṃ bhavati | yasya pṛthivyāṃ kīrtir bhavati | yasya manomadhye satpuruṣavacanaviśvāso bhavati | yo rājā sadānandapūrṇo bhavati | yasya pārśve pratyakṣam anekaṃ manohārivastūni bhavanti | etādṛśasya rājño 'gre yogarahasyaṃ kathanīyam |*
>
> The king in whose mind there is no deceit and, when he is seen [by his subjects] there is no fear of a ruler, [he is one who] has a purified mind. [The king] who has fame on earth; in whose mind there is trust in the speech of good people; who is a king always filled with bliss; at whose side there is an abundance of enchanting objects visible [to all], in the presence of such a king the secret of yoga shall be explained.

Next, Rāmacandra presents Sahajayoga as the ideal yoga for a *kṣatriya* or monarch:

> *vilāsinīnāṃ manohārigītaśravaṇāt ‖ atisundarakāminīnāṃ rūpadarśanāt ‖ kastūrīkarpūragandhayo grahaṇāt ‖ manaḥśītalakāryatikomalaparavastunaḥ sparśakāraṇāt ‖ atimādhuryaṃ citte karoti | tādṛśaḥ svādanāt ‖ anekadeśānāṃ sādhvasādhusthānadarśanāt ‖ maitreṇa saha komalavacanāt ‖ śatruṇā saha kāṭhinyavacanāt ‖ yasya manasi harṣo vā dveṣo na bhavati | sa puruṣa īśvaropadeśako jñeyaḥ ‖*

svalīlayā vadati calati ca bhāvābhāvayoś cittam udāsīnaṃ bhavati ‖ kasyāṃcid vārttāyāṃ haṭhaṃ na karoti | yasya manaḥ sahajānande magnaṃ bhavati ‖ tena puruṣeṇa dṛṣṭiḥ sthirā kartavyā | āsanaṃ dṛḍhaṃ kartavyaṃ | pavanaḥ sthiraḥ kartavyaḥ | etādṛśaḥ kaścin niyamaḥ siddhasya noktaḥ | manaḥpavanābhyāṃ yadā sahajānandaḥ svasvarūpeṇa prakāśyate | sa sahajayogaḥ kathyate rājayogamadhye | iti cakravartināmakathanam |

Because of listening to the lovely songs of charming women, looking at the beauty of very lovely women, smelling the fragrance of camphor and musk, touching objects that make the mind relax and that are extremely soft and superb, [because of all these things] he experiences exquisite beauty in the mind.

Despite enjoying such things, seeing good and bad places of many countries, speaking sweetly with friends, and speaking harshly to enemies, joyful excitement and hatred do not arise in his mind. This person is known as a teacher who conveys the instruction of the Lord (*īśvara*). For his own amusement, he speaks and moves. The mind is equanimous in both existence and non-existence. He, whose mind is immersed in inherent bliss, does not commit violence in any business.[49] By that person, the gaze shall be stabilised. The posture shall be stabilised. The breath shall be stabilised. No such discipline is prescribed for the accomplished [person]. When by means of mind and breath, the natural bliss appears through one's own true nature; it is called Sahajayoga ("natural yoga") [in this system] of Rajayoga. This is the explanation for those named *cakravartin* ("Universal Ruler").

[49]The literal translation of *kasyāṃcid vārttāyāṃ haṭhaṃ na karoti*—"he does not commit violence in any business"—is both appealing and contextually plausible. At the same time, in view of the contrast with the forceful yogic practice prescribed for the non-*siddha* practitioner, which involves the stabilisation of posture, breath, and gaze, an allusion to Haṭhayoga may also resonate here. On such a reading, *haṭha* would carry not only its ordinary sense of acting forcefully or harshly, but would also evoke a deliberately forceful or effortful mode of yogic practice, in contrast to Sahajayoga, which arises naturally and without force.

A passage from the *Mokṣopāya* (2.11.3–18) sheds further light on the religious aspirations of the warrior aristocracy. In a dialogue between Rāma and Vāsiṣṭha, a brief account of the "descent of knowledge" (*jñānāvatāra*) is given to explain to Rāma the reason why he, as a prince, is entitled to receive salvific knowledge. Jürgen Hanneder summarises and explains these passages as follows:

> At the end of the *kṛtayuga*, when the system of ritual action (*kriyākrama*) was being lost, "protectors of the earth" (i.e. kings) were created for establishing and maintaining ritual and rules (2.11.10–11). Furthermore *smṛti*-works and ritual works were taught on earth for attaining success in the three aims of life *dharma*, *kāma* and *artha* (12). But with the passage of time the situation declined: when the people were only intent on their daily food, the kings quarrelled over lands, thus all beings became guilty and had to be punished (13–14). Then the kings could no longer protect the earth by peaceful means and became dejected together with their subjects. In order to remove their dejection, it is said, the doctrines of knowledge (*jñānadṛṣṭi*) were taught by the sages (16): First, the *adhyātmavidyā* was taught to the kings and later on spread to the people, wherefore it was called *rājavidyā* (17). Through this "secret of the kings" (*rājaguhyam*) the rulers attained a state free from suffering. There is at least one more occurrence of the term *rājavidyā* in the *Mokṣopaya*:
>
> *prabhutvaṃ samadṛṣṭitvaṃ tac ca syād rājavidyayā |*
> *tām eva yo na jānāti nāsau mantrī na so 'dhipaḥ ||* (3.78.39)
>
> Rulership and the condition of having equal vision—that occurs through *rājavidyā*.
> Who does not know it is neither a minister nor a king.
>
> The background of the issue of how *kṣatriya*s can obtain the salvific knowledge or become liberated is that their caste duties enjoin "cruel" actions, like law enforcement and the protection

> of subjects, in the worst case, through war. Naturally, the accumulation of such bad *karma*s was seen as an impediment to the attainment of the religious aim, while their active life, and perhaps even the concept of the king as the "enjoyer of the earth" was difficult to align with the wide-spread notions of a religiously accomplished way of life that involved some kind of restraint.[50]

Although originating centuries before the composition of the *Tattvayogabindu*, these insights into the *kṣatradharma* remained valid for *kṣatriya*s in Rāmacandra's period. The depiction of the *yogaśāstrarahasya* presented in *Tattvayogabindu* LIX describes a lifestyle characterised by wealth and royal pleasures. Rāmacandra emphasises the dissolution of bad *karma* resulting from violence. His Sahajayoga is characterised by the fact that it can be maintained without deprivation and continuous practice, making it the ideal yoga for a ruler. The king is explicitly addressed with the word *rājan* and finally with the word *cakravartin*. For this reason, the *Tattvayogabindu* is an important example of a Rājayoga text written for the warrior aristocracy and members of a royal court. The following scenario, therefore, seems most likely: Rāmacandra was a locally distinguished yogin hired by an unknown king in northern India[51] in order to teach yoga to the members of the royal court and perhaps to the king himself.[52] Yoga was fashionable then and, therefore, could not be omitted from the educational program of a 16th-century Hindu

[50] Hanneder, 2006: 121.

[51] See n. 382 on p. 227 for a discussion of the place of composition of the *Tattvayogabindu*.

[52] The *Tattvayogabindu* XXVIII.1 presents a variant of a widely circulated verse, whose origins can be traced back to the *Netratantra* 7.1–2, composed between 700–850 CE, see Sanderson, 2004: 243. This verse presents a specific set of yogic teachings, an ancient Śaiva paradigm found in various texts. This consists of six to nine *cakra*s, sixteen *ādhāra*s, three to five *lakṣya*s, and five *vyoma*s, *ākāśa*s, or *kha*s. For an overview, see p. 192. It is interesting to note that Rāmacandra gives these teachings such a central place in his *Tattvayogabindu*, as the *Netratantra*'s association with kingship has been illustrated by Alexis Sanderson, particularly its use at the courts of Śaiva officiants in the capacity of royal priests or *rājapurohita*s. From the ninth to the eleventh century, it is well documented that Śaiva and Mahāyāna gurus conducted "apotropaic, restorative, and aggressive mantra rituals" to safeguard the king and the kingdom in the realms of South and Southeast Asia. The *Netratantra* is one such text employed by Śaiva gurus in the service of royalty. The same set of yogic teachings is also found in the *Śivayogapradīpikā*. Seth Powell (2024: 146) notes in his dissertation that the *Śivatattvaratnākara*, an extensive compendium attributed to a king named Keḷadi Basavabhūpāla (also known as Basavarāja, Basavāppa Nāyaka I), who reigned from 1696–1714 in Ikkeri, Karnataka, quotes a

royal court.[53] The *Tattvayogabindu* was commissioned by the king as a written legitimisation of the yoga teachings tailored to the royal court. Rāmacandra did not need to reinvent the wheel for this but instead used two texts that were likely important to his original religious group, the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, and rewrote them so that the teachings presented now directly addressed his courtly audience. This text could have served as a source for the courtiers' self-study, or perhaps Rāmacandra used it as a textual basis for his teaching at the royal court. His courtly audience likely included young courtiers such as the king's descendants. In section XXXI of the *Tattvayogabindu*, Rāmacandra explains the limbs of Aṣṭāṅgayoga. Here, he states explicitly that *sukumāra*s ("young children" or "young princes") should not practise *prāṇāyāma*, and it is, therefore, only mentioned by name.[54] It is indeed very striking that Rāmacandra, although the *Yogasvarodaya* teaches many *kumbhaka*s and *mudrā*s, did not adopt these.[55] These circumstances would also plausibly explain the relatively low register of Sanskrit.

There is no doubt that yoga was practised at royal courts in northern India during early modern times. Hargreaves[56] presents three paintings dating to the seventeenth and eighteenth centuries that depict royal yogins.

The first painting (Figure 3), created circa 1740–1750 CE, depicts a prince wearing royal gear, including a crown and silk scarf, and richly adorned with jewellery, his body containing depictions of Śiva at the forehead, Brahmā at the heart, and Viṣṇu at the navel. While seated in a cross-legged yogic posture, he is practising breath control (*prāṇāyāma*). The painting is currently held in the Bhuri Singh Museum, Chamba in Himachal Pradesh.

large portion of the *Śivayogapradīpikā* in its seventh chapter, a section providing instructions on yoga for the king. Thus, this is yet another example of a text that provides an intriguing early modern instance of the adaptation of yoga in a non-ascetic and courtly environment.

[53] For a discussion of the increase in yoga's popularity at the time, see p. 480 et seqq.

[54] *Tattvayogabindu* XXXI p. 210 ll. 1–2: *prāṇāyāmas tu sukumāreṇa sādhituṃ na śakyate | atas tasya nāmamātraṃ kathyate* | I consider it very likely that Rāmacandra refrained from providing a description of the eighth limb *samādhi* at this point. *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*, quoted with reference to *Yogasvarodaya* (Ed. p. 841), defines *samādhi* as: *samādhir niścalā buddhiḥ śvāsocchvāsādivarjitaḥ* | "*Samādhi* is the immovable intellect, devoid of inhalation, exhalation, and so forth." As a precaution, that is something that one would avoid teaching to very young yoga practitioners.

[55] See p. 59, p. 60, p. 61, and p. 311.

[56] See Hargreaves, 2020.



Figure 3: A prince in royal gear practising breath-control (*prāṇāyāma*).

The second painting (Figure 4) dating to 1690–1700 CE depicts a crowned prince named Mandhāta seated in a yogic position and, as Hargreaves suggests, probably practising *prāṇāyāma*. This painting contains the same three deities, but in a different order. Here, the lower two are reversed, with Viṣṇu at the heart and Brahmā at the navel. The painting was acquired Nurpur, in the Pahari region of India, and is currently held in the Cleveland Museum of Art.



Figure 4: The crowned prince Mandhāta seated in a yogic posture.

The third painting (Figure 5) is a miniature dating to around the 19th century held in the Wellcome Collection. The painting illustrates a person called Appu Sahib Patumkar performing the yogic posture *dhanurāsana*, the "bow-posture" on an antelope's skin. According to Hargreaves, the practitioner's name suggests that he belonged to a noble family.

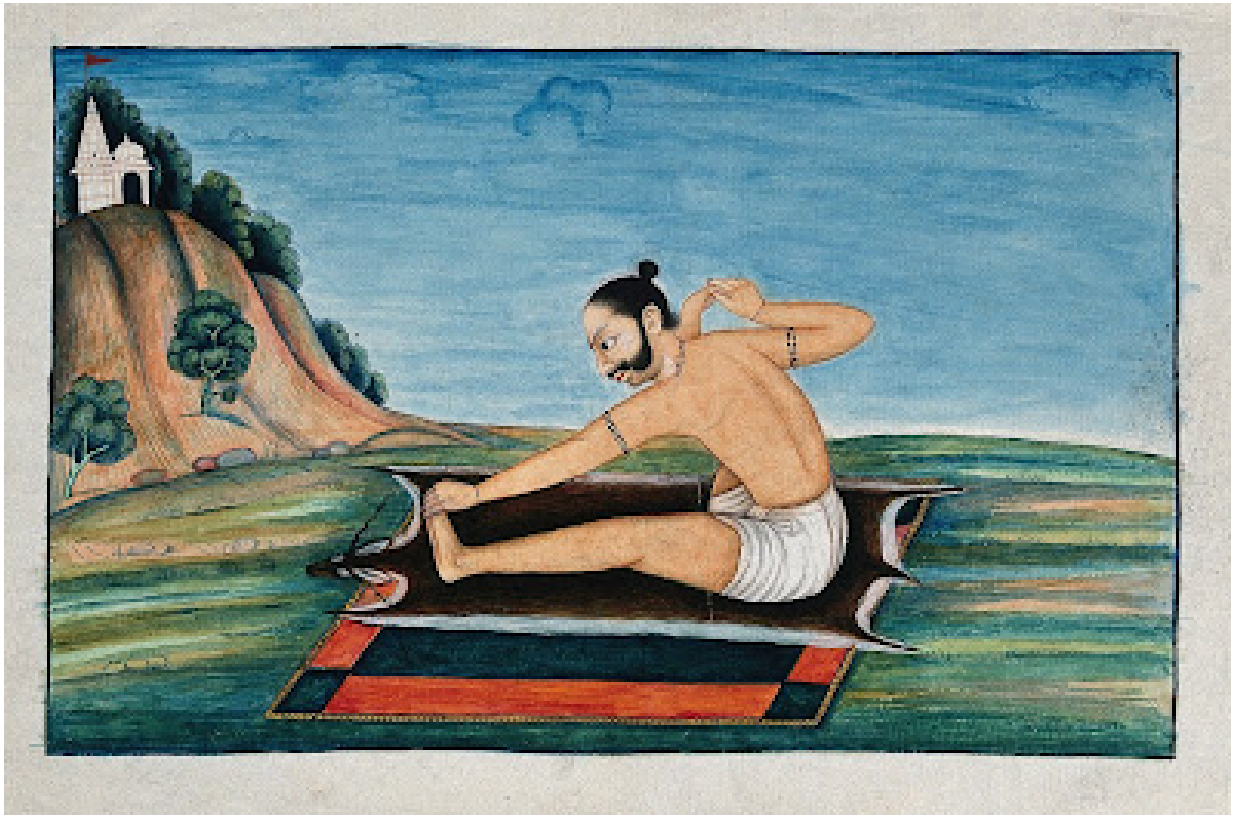


Figure 5: Appu Sahib Patumkar performing *jogh* [*āsana*].

In summary, the *Tattvayogabindu*, composed before 1591 CE, appears to be the earliest known work to address Rājayoga teachings explicitly to monarchs, ranging from kings (*rājan*) to the idealised universal ruler (*cakravartin*). This strongly suggests that the term *rājayoga* is understood here as a "yoga for kings."

1.5 Editorial matters

The following section covers essential text-critical formalities. Following a description of the consulted and unconsulted witnesses, the title is discussed. This is particularly relevant in the case of Rāmacandra's text, where an unusual situation arises: the text is known by at least eleven different titles according to the final rubrics,[57] colophons, title pages, library cards, the printed edition, and citations. Thus, this phenomenon requires further discussion. Subsequently, the source texts, testimonia and parallels are briefly described and contextualised. Next, I will present a stemmatic analysis, discuss the text's stylistic peculiarities, and outline the conventions used in the critical edition.

1.5.1 Description of the consulted witnesses

The official start of the funded period of the dissertation project from which this book emerged, on 15 March 2021, coincided with the extensive lockdowns and travel restrictions imposed in response to the COVID-19 pandemic. As a result, during the phase of the dissertation in which I might otherwise have consulted additional manuscripts, I was largely confined to desk-based work at home.

At the time of submission, I had been able to consult the following witnesses: B, D, E, L, N_1, N_2, P, U_1, and U_2. Approximately two weeks after suc-

[57] Once more I would like to stress that in order to avoid terminological confusion, I consistently follow Camillo Formigatti's usage in distinguishing between the final rubric—the string of words marking the end of a textual unit, often including an assertion of authorship and title—and the colophon proper of a manuscript, that is, the statement providing information on the date, place, agency, or purpose of the manuscript's production. See Formigatti, 2022: 48–49.

cessfully defending the dissertation, I took up a position on the ERC-funded project "Saving the Kashmirian Sanskrit Heritage" (Ka-Sa-Ha-Rakṣā) at the Philipps-Universität Marburg. For this project, I undertook a research trip through northern India in early 2025, during which I acquired not only a substantial number of digital scans and photographs of Kashmiri Śāradā manuscripts but also additional witnesses to the text edited in this dissertation. During this trip, I was able to obtain eight further witnesses: C, J, K_1, K_2, K_3, P_2, S, and V. As the edition had already reached an advanced stage, I decided to collate only those new witnesses likely to be of real significance. I therefore transcribed each of them, applied various methods of computer-assisted stemmatic analysis, integrated the witnesses into the stemma, and carefully re-examined crucial passages of the text where additional manuscript evidence might prove helpful. In the end, only two manuscripts—J and K_1—provided material of genuine value: they confirmed readings previously attested only once and, in several places, rendered a number of earlier emendations unnecessary. The remaining witnesses did not justify the considerable effort required for full collation, as they supplied no useful variants and merely added further scribal errors.

Siglum: B

Collection: Oxford Bodleian Library (OBL), Sanskrit Manuscripts of Candra Shum Shere (CSS), see Gharote and Bedekar, 2005: 102–103.

Title: The title folio reads: *Tatvabiṃduyogaḥ*

Ms. No.: d. 458 (7)

Extent: 15 folios

Material: Paper

Language: Sanskrit

Script: Devanāgarī

Date: Unavailable

Condition: Incomplete

Remarks: The first and last folio are missing. The extant text of B begins at section IX. The manuscript was donated to OBL by Shum Shere, Chandra Mahārāja Chandra Shamsher Jang Bahadur Rana in 1909.

Incipit: Unavailable

Final Rubric and Colophon: Unavailable

Siglum: C

Collection: Nagpur University Library (NUL), see *Descriptive Catalogue of Yoga Manuscripts (Updated)* (2005: 102).

Title: *Tattvabinduyoga*

Ms. No.: 5760

Dimensions and extent: 28 cm x 16,5 cm; 12 folios

Material: Paper

Language: Sanskrit

Script: Devanāgarī

Date: Unavailable

Condition: Incomplete (last folio is missing), otherwise very good

Remarks: The text of C is textually corrupt, with numerous scribal errors such as omitted *visarga*s and *anusvāra*s, lost punctuation, incorrect case endings, and confusion between long and short vowels. Moreover, the manuscript contains many omissions of words and entire sentences, as well as conflations of separate sentences due to eyeskips, haplographies, dittographies, and similar errors. A detailed examination of the witness showed that it contains no variants of value that would improve the established edition. In order to avoid unnecessarily inflating the apparatus, I refrained from collating this manuscript.

Incipit: *śrī gaṇeśāya namaḥ || śrīsarasvatyai namaḥ || śrīgurave namaḥ || athas tattvabiṃduyogapraraṃbha ||*

Final Rubric and Colophon: Unavailable

Siglum: D

Collection: Saraswati Bhawan Library, Sampūrṇānanda Saṃskṛta Viśvavidyālaya, Varanasi. See Gharote and Bedekar, 2005: 104–105.

Title: *Tattvayogabindu*

Ms. No.: 30019

Dimensions and extent: 21 cm x 10,3 cm; 16 folios

Material: Paper

Language: Sanskrit

Script: Devanāgarī

Date: Vikram Saṃvat 1841 = 1784 CE

Condition: Incomplete

Remarks: Folios 15 & 16 are missing. The *lacuna* in D extends from verse XLIV.9 to section L. The scan also indicates that folio 19 is missing. However, the text is complete on folio 18.

Incipit: *śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ || śrīsarasvatyai namaḥ || śrīnirañjanāya namaḥ || atha rājayogaprakāro likhyate ||*

Final Rubric and Colophon: *iti paramahaṃsyāṃ śrīrāmacaṃdraviracitāyāṃ tatvayogabiṃdu samāptaḥ || śubham astu | saṃvat 1841 || bhādau śudha 15 lī 0 ve sarva śake rā rāma rāma cha*

Siglum: E

Title: *Binduyogaḥ with Bhāṣaṭīkā*

Collection: Kaivalyadhama Library, Lonavla

No.: 6387

Editor: Jvālāprasāda Miśra, son of the revered scholar Sukhānanda Miśra

Material: Paper

Language: Sanskrit and Hindi

Script: Devanāgarī

Date: 1905 CE

Condition: Contains several *lacunae*. A large section of the text is transposed.

Remarks: This is the only printed edition, published in Mumbai, together with a Hindi translation and a *Bhāṣaṭīkā* commentary. Problematic passages in the unknown exemplar were emended or conjecturally restored by the Pandit.

Incipit: *śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ | rājayogāntargataḥ || binduyogaḥ*

Final Rubric and Colophon: *iti rājayoge candraparamahaṃsaparipūrṇapīṭhamāhātmyaprākāśakaḥ binduyogaḥ samāptaḥ || śubham astu || iti śrīsarvaguṇasampannapaṃḍitasukhānandamiśrasūrisūnupaṇḍitajvālāprasādamiśrakṛtabhāṣāṭīkāsahito rājayoge binduyogaḥ samāptaḥ || śubham astu || śrīr astu ||*

Siglum: J

Collection: Jawaharlal Nehru University Library, New Delhi

Title: *Tattvayogabinduḥ*

Ms. No.: 55769

Extent: 17 folios

Material: Paper

Language: Sanskrit

Script: Devanāgarī

Date: Vikram Saṃvat 1865, Śaka Saṃvat 1730 = 1808–1809 CE

Condition: Complete; in good condition

Remarks: A very important manuscript that occasionally provides key readings. The manuscript has been digitised and is freely available online at:
https://www.pandulipipatala.nic.in/manus/search-view?id=MzAzMjg3OA%3D%3D

Incipit: *|| śrī gaṇeśāya namaḥ || śrī gurubhyo namaḥ || oṃ namaḥ śrīvāsudevāya || oṃ niraṃjanāya ||*

Final Rubric and Colophon: *iti śrīpāramahaṃsyāṃ śrīrāmacaṃdraviracitāyāṃ tatvayogabiṃduḥ saṃpūrṇaṃ || || śubhaṃ bhavatu || saṃvat 1865 pramāthīnāmasaṃvatsare vai śākhavadya 10 sthiravārī narmadā tirītichamāṃḍe śvaṃ saṃnnidhā | nilikhitaṃ svarthaṃ paropakārārthaṃ ca hastākṣaraśivarāmaśaṃkarabaḍavopanāmakamāhadevakarena likhitaṃ śake 1730 caitravadyasaptamī 7 sthiravārīsaṃpūrṇaṃ || śrī kachārpaṇam astu || śrī || cha ||*

Siglum: K_I

Collection: Asiatic Society of Bengal, Kolkata

Title: *Tattvayogabindu*

Ms. No.: G 11019

Dimensions: 25,8 cm x 11,5 cm; 28 folios

Material: Handmade paper **Language:** Sanskrit **Script:** Devanāgarī

Date: Vikram Saṃvat 1818 = 1761 CE

Condition: Complete; the paper is brittle

Remarks: K_1 is one of the few complete witnesses belonging to the stemmatically most important group of manuscripts.

Incipit: *śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ ‖ śrī sarasvatyai namaḥ ‖ śrī niraṃjanāya namaḥ ‖ atha rājayogaprakāro likhyate ‖*

Final Rubric and Colophon: *iti paramahaṃsyāṃ srīrāmacaṃdraviracitāyāṃ tatvayogabiṃdasamāptāḥ śubham astu ‖ saṃvat 1818 samayavaisāṣavadi tṛtīyābudhavāsare ‖ liṣitaṃ śrīdikṣitakalānāth tat putreṇa caṃdramani śubhaṃ bhūyāt ‖ sthitijayatapuranagre līṣitaṃ śubham astu ‖ śrī rādhe kṛṣṇa sahāi ‖ śrī gaṃgāju sahāi ‖ śrī rāmarāmarāma śrī bhavanyainamaḥ ‖ śrī ‖ rāmaśrīsarasvati namaḥ śrīrāmacaṃdrasahāi ‖ śrī ‖*

Siglum: K_2

Collection: Asiatic Society of Bengal, Kolkata

Title: *Tattvabinduyoga*

Ms. No.: IM 5441

Dimensions and extent: 25,5 cm x 10,5 cm; 17 folios

Material: Paper

Language: Sanskrit

Script: Devanāgarī

Date: Vikram Saṃvat 1811 = 1754–1755 CE

Condition: Incomplete (the first folio is missing); otherwise in good condition

Remarks: K_2 transmits the text with many scribal errors and does not contain any useful variants that would improve the edition. Thus, I refrained from a full collation.

Incipit: Unavailable

Final Rubric and Colophon: *iti śrīrāmacaṃdraparamahaṃsavirācitas tatvabinduyogaḥ samāptaḥ ‖ ‖ 1 ‖ śubhaṃ ‖ saṃvat ‖ 1811 ‖ ++ ‖ cha |*

Siglum: K_3

Collection: Asiatic Society of Bengal, Kolkata

Title: *Tattvayogabindu*

Ms. No.: G 5538A

Dimensions and extent: 25,1 cm x 15 cm; 25 folios

Material: Handmade paper

Language: Sanskrit

Script: Bengali

Date: Unavailable

Condition: Complete; in very good condition

Remarks: I located manuscript K_3 during my research trip through northern India in the spring of 2025. Although I was able to ascertain that the manuscript belongs to the β-tradition (see the stemmatic analysis), I was unable to examine it in full for two reasons. First, the Asiatic Society of Bengal in Kolkata provides digital reproductions of only about thirty per cent of any given manuscript. Second, during my four-day stay in Kolkata I was able to transcribe only two of the three available witnesses—K_1 and K_2—in their entirety. Owing to time constraints,

the prioritisation of other material, and my limited confidence in reading the Bengali script, I could not examine or transcribe K_3 with the same degree of precision. A member of staff kindly transcribed the first two folios for me, allowing me at least to form an initial impression of the manuscript's quality. Manuscript K_3 proved to be a typical β-witness, transmitting the characteristic β-readings and already exhibiting several of its typical errors. A complete examination, inclusion in the stemmatic analysis, and, if appropriate, collation therefore remain desiderata.

Incipit: *śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ | śrīsarasvatai namaḥ | śrīnirañjanāya namaḥ | atha rājayogaprakāra likhyate |*

Final Rubric and Colophon: Unavailable

Siglum: L

Collection: Lalchand Research Library Ancient Indian Manuscript Collection, Chandigarh; *Lal Chand Research Indological Research Center Manuscript Catalog - DAV College Chandigarh* (2017: 251) = Hoshiarpur Vishveshvarananda Vedic Research Institute's (HVVRI) Ms. No. 5876 "*Tattvabindūyogaḥ* by Rāmacandra", see *Descriptive Catalogue of Yoga Manuscripts (Updated)* of the Kaivalyadhama S.M.Y.M. Samiti (2005: 102–103). All Manuscripts of HVVRI have been transferred to Chandigarh.

Title: *Tattvabinduyoga*

Ms. No.: 5876

Dimensions: 43 folios

Material: Paper

Language: Sanskrit

Script: Devanāgarī

Date: Unavailable

Condition: Complete

Remarks: The manuscript is digitised and freely available online under: https://dav.splrarebooks.com/collection/view/tattvabinduyogah

Incipit: *śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ | atha tattvabiṃduyogaprāraṃbhaḥ*

Final Rubric and Colophon: *iti rājamacaṃdraparahaṃsaviracites tatvabiṃduyogasamāptaṃ || śrīkṛṣṇārpaṇam astu || cha ||*

Siglum: N_I

Collection: National Archives, Kathmandu; microfilmed by the Nepalese German Manuscript Preservation Project (NGMPP) and catalogued by the Nepalese German Manuscript Cataloguing Project (NGMCP).

Title: *Tattvayogabindu*

Ms. No.: B 38/31

Acc No.: NAK 5/2724

Dimensions and extent: 26.5 cm x 8.5 cm; 13 folios

Material: Paper

Language: Sanskrit

Script: Pracalita (Nepālākṣara)

Date: Nepal Saṃvat 837 = 1716 CE

Condition: Incomplete (four folios are missing)

Remarks: N_I is among the oldest dated extant witnesses to Rāmacandra's text and often provides important readings. After section XXXIV, there is a *lacuna* extending to section XLVIII; approximately 23.50% of the entire text is missing. In light of the shared lacuna and its later date, N_I must either depend directly on N_2 or derive from a common exemplar.

Incipit: *śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ ‖ śrīgurave namaḥ ‖ atha rājayogaprakāro likhyate ‖*

Final Rubric and Colophon: *iti śrīparamarahasyāṃ śrīrāmacaṃdraviracitāyāṃ tatvayogabiṃdu samāptaḥ ‖ ‖ śrīsvasti ‖ ‖ saṃvat 837 ‖ vinā guru na siddhati ‖*

[A second hand adds the following in a mixture of Nepālī and Newārī:]

eka vacana sosyā sālikaseṃ caudha bhuvana kā mola ‖
kahane soka haḍiyā avakyā vajāye ṃe ḍhola ‖ 1 ‖

popoṣṭakaṃmā 10 | 11 | 12 | 13 ja(m)mā 4 patra aghaḍiṣī ṭaṭāye ++ ho

Siglum: N_2

Collection: National Archives, Kathmandu; microfilmed by the Nepalese German Manuscript Preservation Project (NGMPP) and catalogued by the Nepalese German Manuscript Cataloguing Project (NGMCP).

Title: *Tattvayogavinda* (= *Tattvayogabindu*; the title folio reads: *srī rājayogabinduprārambhaḥ*. The library card reads *Rājayogatattvabindu*.)

Ms. No.: B 38/35 = A 1327-14

Acc No.: NAK 3/750

Dimensions and extent: 33 cm x 16 cm (B 38/35) and 32 cm x 16 cm (A 1327-14); 11 folios

Material: Paper **Language:** Sanskrit **Script:** Devanāgarī

Date: Nepal Saṃvat 712 = 1591 or 1592 CE. Most likely, 21 June 1591.[58]

[58] I would like to express my sincere gratitude to Stanislav Jager, Dragomir Dimitrov, Martin Gansten, and, in particular, Anupam Suman for sharing their thoughts on deciphering this intricate *bhūtasāṃkhyā*-date. According to all the mentioned scholars (personal communication, in person and by email in December 2025), the colophon verse *sūrye turaṅge*

Condition: Incomplete

navacandraghasre jyeṣṭhākhyakṛṣṇe bhṛguvārayuktam encodes a calendrical date in the Nepal Saṃvat era using the *bhūtasāṃkhyā* system along with standard lunar terminology. The *bhūta* numerals *sūrye* (=12, corresponding to the twelve Ādityas or solar months) and *turaṅge* (=7, corresponding to the seven horses of the solar chariot) together yield the year 712, which is to be read in reverse order according to established *bhūtasāṃkhyā* convention. The remainder of the verse specifies the lunar day and month (*navacandraghasre* = *amāvāsyā* or new-moon day; *jyeṣṭhākhyakṛṣṇe* = month of Jyeṣṭha, Kṛṣṇa pakṣa) and fixes the weekday (*bhṛguvārayuktam* = Friday).

A critical chronological question raised by Suman and Gansten is whether the year "712" should be interpreted as an elapsed (completed) year, as is often assumed in Indian chronological studies, or as the ongoing (running) year. Suman notes that the verse employs the locative case throughout (*sūrye turaṅge*...), situating the act of writing "in the year 712" without any explicit qualifiers such as *gate* (past), *atīte* (gone), or *samāpte* (completed) that would unambiguously indicate a completed year. This usage aligns with other Nepal Saṃvat colophons in which the locative is used to specify the current year at the time of composition.

Astronomical testing confirms the necessity of reading NS 712 as a running year. If treated as elapsed (≈1592 CE), no occurrence of Jyeṣṭha Kṛṣṇa Amāvāsyā falling on a Friday can be identified. Interpreted as a running year, however, the lunar and weekday data correspond precisely to 21 June 1591 CE, which is demonstrably Jyeṣṭha Kṛṣṇa Amāvāsyā and a Friday. This agreement is decisive, leaving little doubt that the author intended a running-year reckoning. Moreover, Suman emphasises that the date reflects the *amānta* lunar system (in which a month begins immediately after the new moon), as is standard in Nepal Saṃvat, rather than the *pūrṇimānta* system typical in North India.

Suman's interpretation is further supported by parallels in other Nepalese manuscripts catalogued in the Nepal-German Manuscript Preservation Project (NGMPP), where locative constructions with full lunar details consistently yield coherent dates only when the year is understood as running. Historical precedent also supports this approach: Bendall, 1883 in the introduction and passim of his 19th-century Cambridge catalogue, stressed that Nepalese manuscript dates cannot be mechanically inferred from the year number alone, noting instances in which the *tithi* and weekday would be inconsistent with an elapsed-year reading. Similarly, Petech, 1984 in his chapters on chronology and dating practices has shown that Nepal Saṃvat dates in inscriptions and manuscripts must be tested both astronomically and historically, warning against assuming uniform elapsed-year reckoning and demonstrating that a current-year framework is sometimes required when detailed calendrical elements are supplied.

Taken together, locative grammar, manuscript parallels, and astronomical evidence establish the methodological principle that Nepal Saṃvat dates expressed in the locative must be interpreted in conjunction with internal calendrical details. Accordingly, the colophon year "712" must be understood as a running year. The corresponding historical date is therefore: Nepal Saṃvat 712 (running year), Jyeṣṭha Kṛṣṇa Amāvāsyā, Friday = 21 June 1591 CE. Suman also rules out the possibility of Śaka Saṃvat both philologically and astronomically. Furthermore, Suman argues that the precision of the date may reflect the author's deliberate choice, as 21 June 1591 falls on a new-moon day governed by the *ārdrā nakṣatra*, which is particularly auspicious for yogic and Śaiva matters.

Remarks: Manuscript N_2 has a *lacuna* extending from after section XXXIV to section XLVIII. Approximately 23.50% of the entire text is missing. The *lacuna* is indicated on f. 8r l. 1. It stops at the same place where manuscript N_1 has missing folios. Thus, we have to assume that manuscript N_1 is either a direct copy of manuscript N_2 or both descend from the same exemplar. The latter is more likely, since N_2 preserves several different and occasionally better readings.

For the critical reader, it should be noted that the palaeographical features of the manuscript—an almost modern-looking Devanāgarī hand on paper—leave open the question of whether the date recorded in N_2 refers to the manuscript itself or whether, as initially seemed quite possible, the scribe merely copied the colophon from the exemplar without indicating the precise date of the present copy. This possibility, however, can now be ruled out. As already observed by Bendall, 1883: xxi, the dated Nepalese manuscripts of the sixteenth century available to him share several characteristic features: paper had by then become the dominant writing material; the horizontal headline is almost continuous, while the vertical strokes frequently project slightly above it; and the overall ductus appears regular, square, and distinctly Devanāgarī in character. All of the general features identified by Bendall are present in N_2, making it plausible that, in this case, the colophon genuinely belongs to the manuscript itself.

Furthermore, following a suggestion by Dragomir Dimitrov, I compared the orthographical features of the manuscript with scans of all dated Nepalese Nāgarī manuscripts from the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries that were available for purchase online at the time from the Staatsbibliothek zu Berlin. I examined the following manuscripts: *Kālītattva* (NGMPP Reel No. A 207-4), *Mādhavanidāna* (A 224-11), *Mṛtyuharalāṅgalaṣaḍakṣaramantravidhi* (A 246-19), *Skandapurāṇa* (A 259-5), *Skandapurāṇa* (A 292-9), *Skandapurāṇa* (A 300-2), *Vṛttaratnākara* (A 356-7), *Saṃjñāvivekavivṛti* (A 414-28(2)), *Ratnadīpa* (A 423-42), *Raudriyameghamālā* (A 424-16), *Siddhāntaśiromaṇi* (A 432-12), *Sañjñātantra* (A 433-9), *Apāmārjanastotra* (A 468-41), *(Śivaprokta) Īśvarasahas-*

ranāmastotra (A 471-31), *Prāyaścittaprakaraṇa* (A 521-3), *Vaiyākaraṇabhūṣaṇa* (A 570-3), *Gotrapravaranirṇaya* (B 407-13), *Kātantravṛttipañjikā* (B 458-17), *Kakṣapuṭa* (C 25-5). The great majority of these manuscripts display palaeographical features highly similar to the almost modern-looking Devanāgarī hand of N_2, strongly confirming that N_2 is an original sixteenth-century manuscript rather than a more recent copy of an older exemplar.

NGMCP catalogues another scan of the same manuscript under NGMPP Reel No. A 1327-14. The dimensions differ in the catalogue, but this appears to be a cataloguing error, since it is definitely the same manuscript. However, the latter scan is poor.

Incipit: [59]*śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ* ‖ *atha rājayogaprakāro likhyate* ‖

Final Rubric and Colophon: [60]*iti śrīparamarahasye śrīrāmacaṃdraviracitāyāṃ tatvayogavinda samāptam* ‖

‖ *śubham* ‖

yad akṣarapadabhraṣṭaṃ mātrāhīnaṃ ca yad bhavet ‖
tat sarvaṃ kṣamya tām eva prasīda parameśvara ‖1‖

sūrye turaṅge navacandraghasre
jyeṣṭhākhyakṛṣṇe bhṛguvārayuktam ‖
tattvaprayogaḥ ṣaḍaharṣasaṃjñaṃ
likhitaṃ suhetoḥ bhavatīha dehi ‖ *bhūyāt* ‖[61]

[59] See p. iii for the facsimile of the first folio of N_2.

[60] See p. iv for the facsimile of the final folio of N_2.

[61] The final two *pāda*s are grammatically highly problematic and contain a metrical error that clearly indicates textual corruption. Moreover, the terminology renders a convincing interpretation particularly difficult. Nevertheless, I would like to propose the following partial restoration of the final two *pāda*s together with a tentative translation of the final verse of N_2:

Siglum: P

Collection: Bhandarkar Oriental Research Institute (BORI), Pune; see Gharote and Bedekar, 2005: 394–395, here catalogued under the title *Rājayoga*.

Title: *Tattvabinduyoga* (the library card reads *Rājayoga* (*Tattvabinduyoga*)).

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tattvaprayogaṃ ṣaḍakṣarasaṃjñaṃ
likhitaṃ suhetoḥ bhavanīyaṃ dehin ‖ bhūyāt ‖

On Friday, on the new-moon day of the dark fortnight of [the month called] Jyeṣṭhā, in the [Nepal Saṃvat] year 712 [understood as the current year; corresponding to 21 June 1591 CE], [this] application of [supreme] reality, bearing a six-syllabled designation (*Ta-ttva-yo-ga-bi-ndu*), was written for a good purpose. [It is] to be contemplated, O embodied one. May it endure!

The main problem of the verse lies in its transmitted reading *ṣaḍaharṣa°*, which is semantically unintelligible. The context suggests it as a possible alternative title for the work. However, judging from the contents of the *Tattvayogabindu ṣaḍa-harṣa°* understood as "six non-joys" seems extremely unlikely. Not much better is to ignore the "a" or to explain it as having been secondarily appended to *ṣaḍ°* in order to satisfy metrical constraints or to suspect influences of local linguistic usage in order to take it as "six joys," perhaps referring to the six faculties (the five senses plus *manas*; cf. the *yamas* in *TYB* XXXI). Neither interpretation is convincing. The word must therefore be regarded as corrupt.

Furthermore, the verse is grammatically incongruent: *likhitaṃ* as well as *bhavati* are syntactically redundant, thereby producing a semantically unstable sequence. The word *dehi* is likewise problematic. It may be corrupt, and no fully satisfactory emendation readily suggests itself. Regarding the latter issue, two interpretations seem conceivable: either as a second-person singular imperative, which is contextually weak, or as a vocative singular in the non-standard form *dehi* (instead of the expected *dehin*), the omission of the final nasal being attributable to a minor scribal error.

Accordingly, I emend to *dehin*. Furthermore, I emend to *°prayogaṃ* in order to establish grammatical congruence and to imply an elided *idaṃ* as the nominative singular subject of the sentence. As discussed above, since *ṣaḍaharṣa* is not a plausible candidate for an alternative title of the work, whereas *°saṃjñaṃ*, as the final member of a Bahuvrīhi compound, is congruent with *°prayogaṃ* and refers to the title that was written (*likhitaṃ*), would be expected, the best conjecture I can offer is *ṣaḍakṣara°*, alluding to the six-syllabled title of the text given previously in the final rubric of the colophon. I have considered alternative conjectures at length; however, among other possibilities I explored—such as *śrīrahasya°*, *sapraharṣa°*, or *ṣaḍahaṇi* in combination with *saṃsthaṃ* in place of *saṃjñaṃ*—*ṣaḍakṣara°* currently appears to me the most plausible solution. Additionally, I propose to emend the odd, redundant, and suspicious formulation *bhavatīha* in the light of *tattvaprayogaṃ* to the almost obvious gerundive form *bhavanīyaṃ*.

Finally, a metrical irregularity remains, which I am presently unable to resolve. Ultimately, this reconstruction represents only my current best conjecture and does not entirely resolve this perhaps irrecoverably corrupt verse.

Ms. No.: 644

Dimensions and extent: 25 cm x 11,2 cm; 29 folios

Material: Paper

Language: Sanskrit

Script: Devanāgarī

Date: Vikram Saṃvat 1867 = 1810 CE

Condition: Complete

Incipit: *śrīṇe ya maḥ | atha rājayoga liṣyate*

Final Rubric and Colophon: *iti śrīrāmacaṃdraparamahaṃsaviracitas tatvabinduyogasamāptaḥ saṃvat 1867 pauṣakṛṣṇaḥ 12 ravau śubham bhuyāt || cha ||*

Siglum: P_2

Collection: Anandashrama Sanstha, Pune

Title: *Rājayogamāhātmya*

Ms. No.: 81/359

Extent: 22 folios

Material: Paper **Language:** Sanskrit **Script:** Devanāgarī

Date: Unavailable

Condition: Incomplete; in very good condition

Remarks: The cover folio reads: *rājayoga māhātmya*. The final folios are lost. The penultimate chapter on folio 22 is introduced with: *idānīṃ yogasya māhātmyaṃ kathyate*—hence the title given on the cover folio. Since the colophon is missing but the manuscript belongs to the γ-group, I expect *Tattvabinduyoga* to be the title of the manuscript. A thorough

examination of the manuscript and its readings led me to refrain from collating it, as it contains no variants that would improve the edition. The manuscript is digitised and freely available online at: https://www.pandulipipatala.nic.in/manus/search-view?id=MzUwMjA5MA%3D%3D

Incipit: ‖ *śrī gaṇeśāya namaḥ* ‖ *gurubhyo namaḥ* ‖ *kuladaivyai namaḥ* ‖ *śrī ā+in-āthāya nam+*

Final Rubric and Colophon: Unavailable

Siglum: S

Collection: M. T. R. College Manuscript Library, Surat

Title: The library card reads *Rājayoga*. The original title is lost owing to the loss of the final folio.

Ms. No.: 601

Dimensions and extent: 33 cm x 16 cm; 11 folios

Material: Paper **Language:** Sanskrit **Script:** Devanāgarī

Date: Unavailable

Condition: Incomplete; the final folios are missing, and the first folio is damaged in the upper right corner.

Remarks: The library card suggests that the text includes a commentary.[62] However, this appears to be a misunderstanding on the part of the cataloguer. This is most probably due to the fact that the manuscript begins with a couple of *śloka*s and then switches to prose. Furthermore, the manuscript completely dispenses with punctuation. There is no *daṇḍa* or comparable punctuation mark. Specific variants indicate that this manuscript may be the direct exemplar of the printed edition, or

[62] The library card gives the title: "Rājayoga with commentary".

that both this manuscript and the printed edition derive from the same exemplar. The textual witness is characterised above all by numerous scribal errors, incorrect case endings, and omitted *anusvāra*s. A detailed examination of the witness showed that it contains no variants of value that would improve the established edition. In order to avoid unnecessarily inflating the apparatus, I refrained from collating this manuscript.

Incipit: || *śrī gaṇeśāya namaḥ* || *gurubhyo namaḥ* || *kuladaivyai namaḥ* || *śrī ā+ināthāya nam+*

Final Rubric and Colophon: Unavailable

Siglum: U_I

Collection: Scindia Oriental Research Institute (SORI), Vikram University, Ujjain, see Gharote and Bedekar, 2005: 104–105, 246–247.

Title: *Tattvayogaviduḥ* (the title folio reads: *atha yogataprāraṃbhaḥ.*)

Ms. No.: 1574

Dimensions and extent: 20 cm x 13 cm; 45 folios

Material: Paper

Language: Sanskrit

Script: Devanāgarī

Date: Unavailable

Condition: Incomplete

Remarks: Manuscript U_1 contains a *lacuna* within section LVII. This comparatively large and important section is almost entirely absent in this manuscript. The readings of this manuscript are particularly important for the constitution of the text in the section corresponding to the large *lacuna* in N_1 and N_2.

Incipit: *śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ* || *atha rājayoga likhyate* ||

Final Rubric and Colophon: *iti śrīpāramahaṃsyāṃ śrīrāmacaṃdraviracitāyāṃ tatvayogaviduḥ samāptaḥ śubhaṃ bhūyāt* ||

Siglum: U_2

Collection: Scindia Oriental Research Institute (SORI), Vikram University, Ujjain, see Gharote and Bedekar, 2005: 394–395, here catalogued under the title *Rājayoga*.

Title: *Tattvabinduyoga* (the title folio reads: *atha śrīrājayogaprāraṃbhaḥ* || *śrīrāmavaracitena* ||)

Ms. No.: 6082

Dimensions and extent: 21 cm x 11 cm; 37 folios

Material: Paper **Language:** Sanskrit **Script:** Devanāgarī

Scribe: Bābājī Rājadherakara

Date: Śaka Saṃvat 1805, Vikram Saṃvat 1940 = 1883 CE

Condition: Complete

Remarks: This manuscript contains lengthy additions concerning the ninefold *cakra* system in sections IV–XII.

Incipit: *śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ* || *śrīgurave namaḥ* || *atha rājayogaprakāro likhyate* ||

Final Rubric and Colophon: *iti śrīrāmacaṃdraparamahaṃsaviracitas tatvabiṃduyogasamāptaḥ* ||

śrīśubhaṃ bhavatu || *śrīsītārāmārpaṇam astuḥ* || *idaṃ pustakaṃ* || *śake 1805* || *vikramārka saṃmat* || *1940* || *jayanāmasaṃvatsare* || *udagayaṇe* || *griṣmaṛtau* || *vaiśākhe māse* || *kṛṣṇapakṣe* || *tithau 23* || *bhānuvāsare* || *prathamayāmye* || *śrīkṣetra avaṃtikāyāṃ* || *śrīmahārudramahākālasaṃnidhānena saṃpūrṇaṃ* ||

lekhanaṃ ānaṃt? suta? bābājī rājadherakareṇa likhyate ‖

yādṛśaṃ pustakaṃ dṛṣṭvā tādṛsaṃ likhitaṃ mayā ‖
yadi śuddhaṃ aśuddho vā mama doṣo na dīyate ‖1‖

śrīrāma ‖ *cha* ‖

Siglum: V

Collection: Baroda Oriental Institute, Central Library, Vadodara. See *An Alphabetical List of Manuscripts in the Oriental Institute Baroda, Vol. II* (1950: 1238).

Title: *Tattvayogavicāraḥ*

Ms. No.: 10558

Dimensions and extent: 26 folios

Material: Paper

Language: Sanskrit

Script: Devanāgarī

Date: Vikram Saṃvat 1751 = 1694 CE

Condition: Complete; in good condition

Remarks: Apart from the fact that V is the second-oldest extant dated manuscript of the *Tattvayogabindu*, the manuscript displays numerous attempts at abbreviating the text (e.g., using *ādi* instead of complete enumerations, or omitting entire sentences deemed redundant or insignificant). At the same time, essential syntactic elements appear to have been inadvertently omitted, making deliberate and accidental abridgements difficult to distinguish. The redactor frequently replaces

the expected °*madhye* with a locative, and repeatedly attempts to optimise verbal constructions, often with questionable results. Apart from its early date and its interesting variant of the final colophon, the manuscript contains no important variants but an overwhelming number of minor ones. Furthermore, the manuscript also exhibits numerous omissions, duplications, and conflations of syntactically similar sentences, which are characteristic of the transmission of this text. Including it in the collation would have made the critical apparatus unmanageable. Therefore, I decided to exclude the witness from the collation. The only feature worth mentioning is an additional verse inserted between verses XLIV.1 and XLIV.2: *āvadhūta aiśvaryaś ca samagraś ca dharmaś ca yanāśaḥ śriyaḥ jñānavairāgyasaṃyuktaḥ ṣaṇāṃ bhaga++tīraṇā* (V, fol. 27v, ll. 3–4).

Incipit: ‖ *śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ* ‖ ‖ *atha rājayogaprakārāḥ likhyaṃte* ‖

Final Rubric and Colophon: *iti paramahaṃsasaṃhitāyāṃ haṃsyāṃ srīrāmacaṃdraviracitāyāṃ tatvayogavicāraḥ* ‖ ‖ *saṃ 1751 mārgaśīrṣa śudi pa somo likhitaṃ* ‖

1.5.2 Manuscripts not consulted

1.5.2.1 Important

- Kolkata (former Calcutta) Sanskrit Library. NCC: CS. III. 65. = *A Descriptive Catalogue of Sanskrit Manuscripts of The Calcutta Sanskrit College, Vol. 3*, 1900: 37. Title: *Tattvayogabinduḥ*. Author: Paramahaṃsa Rāmacandra. Material: country-made white paper. Dimensions and extent: 9 x 3 inches; 22 folios. Date: Vikram Saṃvat 1847 (1790 CE). Condition: old, slightly worm-eaten, generally accurate, and complete. This manuscript is the most important among the unconsulted ones. The title suggests that it belongs to the β-group. During my research trip through India in early 2025, I visited the Kolkata Sanskrit Library. Unfortunately, a change of staff happened to coincide with my visit, so I was unable to order a digital copy of the

manuscript. Since then, I have made several attempts to place the order, but unfortunately without success so far.

- Sanskrit Vidyāpeetham, near Yamuna Kinare, Etawah (U.P.). Title: *Tattvabindūyogaḥ*. Author: Rāmacandraḥ. Script: Devanāgarī. Condition: incomplete. Ms. No.: ESV 7 (P20), see Gharote and Bedekar, 2005: 102–103. The title of the manuscript indicates that it likely belongs to the γ-group.

1.5.2.2 Damaged

- Lucknow Sanskrit Parishad. *A Catalogue Of Manuscripts In Akhil Bharatiya Sanskrit Parishad*, 2021: 224. Title: *Rājayoga Prakāraḥ?*. Author: Rāmacandra. Serial No.: 74. Accession No.: 1266. Condition: incomplete. Only two folios survive. Age: recent.

1.5.2.3 Probably unobtainable

- NCC: Darbhanga Raj 2146 (inc.). Probably: Descriptive Catalogue of Raj Manuscripts Preserved in Kameshwar Singh Sanskrit University, Darbhanga. Title: *Rājayogaprakāra*. https://lnmu.ac.in. Unfortunately, I have not been able to access the catalogue.
- CPB. (Ms. No.: 4579-80. *Catalogue of Sanskrit and Prakrit Manuscripts in the Central Provinces and Berar*, 1926: 408. Title: *Rājayoga*. Author: Rāmacandra Paramahaṃsa. Subject: Yoga. Owner. (4579) Nārāyaṃ Purānī of Hardā (Hoshangābād district). (4580) Viśvambharnāth of Ratanpur (Bilāspur district). Comment: According to information provided by colleagues, these manuscripts may be difficult to locate. It is possible that one of these is manuscript C, held at Nagpur University Library (NUL).

1.5.3 Discussion of the text's original title

It is striking that the witnesses to Rāmacandra's text disagree over its title. The variants are: *Tattvabinduyoga*, *Tattvayogabindu*, (*Tattvayogaviduḥ*,) *Tattvayogavicāraḥ*, *Rājayogatattvabindu*, *Binduyoga*, *Rājayoga*, *Rājayogaprakāra*, *Rājayogavicāra*, *Rājayogamāhātmya* and *Tattvajñānapradīpikā*.

Five of the γ-group manuscripts[63] consulted for this critical edition—B, K_2, L, P and U_2—bear the title *Tattvabinduyoga* according to their final rubrics. The printed edition E is titled *Binduyogaḥ*. From a stemmatological perspective, the printed edition E must descend from a γ-group manuscript.

It is challenging to derive a convincing meaning from the title *Tattvabinduyoga* and even *Binduyoga*, especially considering the actual content of the work. The term *bindu* does not appear even once in the entire text. Various possible interpretations and translations of this compound, such as "Yoga of the points/essence of reality," are unsatisfactory. If an interpretation of such a title were correct, one would expect an explanation of *bindu* in the text. Although various yoga practices involving concentration on specific bodily points are mentioned frequently, these are never referred to as *bindu*s.

It is not apparent why Jvālāprasāda Miśra, the editor of the 1905 printed edition, most likely made the editorial decision to discard the title of his exemplar[64] and rename the text *Binduyoga*, since this does not enhance the title's relevance to the work. The term *binduyoga*, which appears, for example, in the *Amṛtasiddhi* (7.14), where *binduyoga* designates its core yoga practice[65] is not applicable here, as Rāmacandra neither teaches *mudrā*s nor practices involving sexual fluids.[66] Nor does the term *bindu* in Rāmacandra's text function as an ultimate *tattva* within a system of *tattva*s, as it does, for example, in *tattva* systems of Śaivism.[67] In fact, Rāmacandra's text teaches a tenfold *tattva* system that does not require *bindu* as the ultimate *tattva*.[68] The only simple and plausible explanation is that Jvālāprasāda Miśra must have un-

[63] See p.72 for the stemmatic analysis of the manuscripts.

[64] The exemplar of the printed edition is unknown. However, since it must be a manuscript of the γ-group, all of which refer to the text as *Tattvabinduyoga*, and the printed edition contains only two (*bindu* and *yoga*) of the three elements of the title-giving compound (with *tattva* missing), it is highly likely that an editorial decision was made to deviate from the original title in the final rubric of the exemplar.

[65] *Amṛtasiddhi* 7.14: *binduyogaṃ parityajya yo mohād anyam icchati | sa śākhoṭakavṛkṣeṣu mūḍho jāgarti niṣphalam ||*

[66] On the contrary, Rāmacandra discredits the practice of *mudrā*s in section LVIII.

[67] See Gengnagel, 1996: 177 for the 36 *tattva*s of Śaivasiddhānta. Additionally, see Goodall, 2016: 77 et seqq. for a discussion on the genesis of the Śaiva *tattva* systems.

[68] *Tattvayogabindu* XXII l. 4 mentions earth (*pṛthvī*), water (*āp*), fire (*tejas*), wind (*vāyu*), space (*ākāśa*), mind (*manas*), intellect (*buddhi*), illusion (*māyā*), transformations (*vikāra*), and form (*rūpa*).

derstood *Binduyoga* as "Yoga of the points [for concentration]," given that substantial portions of the text teach *cakra*s, *lakṣya*s, and *ādhāra*s for meditation. For these reasons, and notably because the term *bindu* does not appear in the work, it is highly unlikely that Rāmacandra's text was originally titled *Tattvabinduyoga*.

Instead, the title of the γ-group manuscripts likely originated from the same archetype as the β-group manuscripts, namely J, K_1, D, N_1, N_2, and U_1, all of which bear the title *Tattvayogabindu* in their final rubrics. Given that the β-group not only contains the oldest extant dated manuscripts of the text but also frequently offers superior readings, it can be asserted with high confidence that the γ-group title resulted from a metathesis of the two compound elements *bindu* and *yoga*.

Considering the aforementioned issues with the term *bindu*, which appears only in the title and not within the text, this title makes better sense. The term *°bindu* is a common final element in titles of various Sanskrit texts.[69] The use of the term "*°bindu*" in the titles of these texts emphasises the idea of expressing essential, seminal points in a condensed way to make complex topics more accessible and intelligible. As such, the term suggests that each work strives to distil the essence of its subject into basic doctrines or principles. In the case of Rāmacandra's text, *°bindu* is entirely plausible when understood in this way.

Based on the textual evidence of the manuscripts alone, it is highly probable that the final rubrics of the γ-group result from a metathesis of the final two elements of the title compound. The β-group therefore most likely preserves a form of the title that is closer to the original than that transmitted by the remaining manuscripts. The only outlier is the second oldest extant dated manuscript, V, which is distinguished above all by its conspicuous editorial interventions and its frequently unsuccessful attempts to optimise or simplify the Sanskrit. These efforts often involve the omission of clauses or the pecu-

[69] See, for example, *Siddhāntatattvabindu* NGMPP, Ms. No. MA 905-3 and NGMPP, Ms. No. E 1189-13 ("Drops of the [supreme] reality of Siddhānta"); *Nyāyabindu* ("Drops of reasoning"), NCC Vol 10. (2007: 252); *Nirṇayabindu* ("Drops of verdict"), NCC Vol 10. (2007: 146); *Bhaktibindu* ("Drops of devotion"), NCC Vol 15. (2007: 148); *Dharmabindu* ("Drops of law"), NCC Vol. 9 (2007: 257), etc.

liar conflation of two or more sentences. In its final rubric, this manuscript presents the title *Tattvayogavicāraḥ*. I understand the final member of the compound *°vicāraḥ* as yet another editorial "improvement," intended to convey the sense of 'investigation' or 'reflection'. The sequence *Tattvayoga°* is thereby preserved, and it is reasonable to assume that, in cases of metathesis within longer compounds, it is generally the later elements rather than the initial member that are affected. Without exception, all manuscripts that preserve a final rubric read *Tattva°* as the first word of the title. The manuscript evidence therefore strongly suggests that the most probable original title was *Tattvayogabindu*.

How, then, did the other titles come into being? Sundaradeva's *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā*, which cites extensively from Rāmacandra's text[70] without attribution—an unusual omission, as he typically cites his other sources—suggests that he either did not accept the title as it appeared in his exemplar, or that it had simply been lost. Another testimonium, titled *Yogasaṃgraha*, quotes approximately 20% of Rāmacandra's entire text.[71] In this case, the author, when quoting the text, renames the work *Tattvajñānapradīpikā* for reasons unknown. Further titles also circulate, found both on manuscript cover pages and in catalogue entries. These titles—such as *Rājayoga*, *Rājayogaprakāra*, *Rājayogavicāra*, or *Rājayogamāhātmya*—either result from librarians working with exemplars that, owing to folio loss, lacked a final rubric and colophon, or were adopted because the titles available in the final rubrics appeared misleading, given that, in most cases, such variants occur in witnesses belonging to the γ-group of manuscripts.

Another title, however, attested only on the library card of N_2, is *Rājayogatattvabindu*. The final rubric of N_2, however, clearly reads *Tattvayogavinda* (obviously a corruption of *Tattvayogabindu*). At first sight, *Rājayogatattvabindu* or *Yogatattvabindu* appears to be a plausible and meaningful title for the work when understood as "Drops of the [supreme] reality of yoga." This inevitably raises the question: Is it possible that even the title preserved in the β-group has succumbed to textual corruption? Could the title of the β-group itself be

[70] For references see p. 68.
[71] For references see p. 67.

the result of metathesis, with the three components of the compound having been confused by scribes at an early stage of transmission? The following text-immanent observation could support the possibility that no surviving manuscript preserves the title in its original form. In section LVIII, ll. 1–8, Rāmacandra's text reads:

> *idānīṃ yogasya māhātmyaṃ kathyate* | *guror anugrahāt* | *śāstrasya paṭhanāt* | *ācārakaraṇāt* | *vedāntarahasyaśravaṇāt* | *dhyānakaraṇāt* | *layasādhanāt* | *upavāsakaraṇāt* | *caturaśītyāsanasādhanāt* | *vairāgyasyotpatteḥ* | *vairāgyakaraṇāt* | *haṭhayogasya karaṇāt* | *iḍāpiṅgalayoḥ pavanadhāraṇāt* | *mahāmudrādidaśamudrāsādhanāt* | *maunakaraṇāt* | *vanavāsāt* | *bahutarakleśakaraṇāt* | *bahutarakālaṃ yantramantrādisādhanāt* | *tapaḥkaraṇāt* | *bahutarārthadānāt* | *tīrthasevākaraṇāt* | *āśramācārapālanāt* | *saṃnyāsagrahaṇāt* | *ṣaḍdarśanagrahaṇāt* | *śiromuṇḍanāt* | *anyopāyakaraṇāt* | ***yogatattvaṃ*** *na prāpyate* | *sa tu yogo gurusevayā prāpyate* |
>
> Now, the majesty of yoga is taught.
> As a result of the grace of the teacher, studying the teaching, execution of good conduct, hearing the secret of Vedānta, meditation, dissolution, fasting, practising 84 postures, generating indifference, cultivating indifference, doing Haṭhayoga, holding the breath of the Iḍā- and Piṅgalā-channels, practising the ten seals beginning with the great seal, observing silence, dwelling in the forest, causing excessive distress, practising Mantra and Yantra, etc. for a long time, doing austerities, giving many donations, frequenting places of pilgrimage, observing the conduct [proper] to the stages of life, adhering to renunciation, grasping the six philosophies, shaving the head, doing other methods, the **reality of yoga** is not attained. But this [reality of] yoga is truly attained by serving the teacher.

The negation of these practices, associated with yoga and even those previously taught by Rāmacandra himself, clearly indicates that this passage

constitutes a central doctrinal statement of the entire work. The compound *tattvayoga* never occurs elsewhere in the text, whereas *yogatattva* appears only at this single location. Given the centrality of this passage and the inconsistencies noted above in the titles transmitted by the β- and γ-groups, it appears conceivable that the original title of the work may have been *Yogatattvabindu*.

This hypothesis—while not entirely implausible and therefore not to be categorically dismissed—ultimately lacks persuasive force, since it is supported not by manuscript evidence, as argued above, but solely by the library card of N_2. It must nevertheless be noted that, in addition to the library card of manuscript N_2, which reads *Rājayogatattvabindu*, the first folio of manuscript U_1 introduces the text with *atha yogata[ttva?]prāraṃbhaḥ*. A plausible explanation for the appearance of the compound *°yogatattva°* on the library card may lie in the frequency of this word combination within the broader Yoga literature. A search through the commonly used e-text corpora circulating among scholars of Yoga and Tantra yielded the following results: the combination *tattvayoga* produced only 19 occurrences, whereas *yogatattva* appeared 109 times. The latter compound is also frequently attested in the titles of Yoga works.[72] Thus, this may be regarded as an understandable error made by a librarian when labelling the library card.

The existence of so many variants of the title in the final rubrics, manuscript cover pages, and catalogue entries can most plausibly be attributed to an early scribal error in the transmission of the text—a metathesis involving entire words, which at an early stage transformed the compound of the work's title from *tattvayogabindu* into *tattvabinduyoga*. Subsequent scribes or editors then either introduced further metatheses, attempted to correct what they perceived as an inappropriate title, replaced it altogether, or omitted it entirely.

[72] For example, *Yogatattva*, see NCC Vol. 22 (2007: 70); *Yogatattvasamāsasūtra*, see NCC Vol. 22 (2007: 70) ; *Yogatattvaupaniṣad*, see *Yogatattvopaniṣad* (ed. pp. 363–388); *Yogatattvadīpikā*, see *Descriptive Catalogue of Yoga Manuscripts (Updated)* (2005: 232); *Yogatattvopaniṣaddīpikā*, see *Descriptive Catalogue of Yoga Manuscripts (Updated)* (2005: 232), etc. Moreover, the position of *°tattva°* is also supported by its occurrence in Sundaradeva's title *Haṭhatattvakaumudī*.

Taking the text as a whole, the title *Tattvayogabindu* makes perfect sense when understood as a *tatpuruṣa* in combination with a simple *dvandva*: "The Essence of Yoga and [Supreme] Reality." This is appropriate, for the work's first half (I–XXXI) is concerned primarily with the individual practices of Rājayoga, while the second half, with a few exceptions, deals chiefly with cosmogony and the yogic body (XXXII–LVIII). The compound may also be understood more generally as a combination of two *tatpuruṣa*s—a genitive *tatpuruṣa* and an instrumental *tatpuruṣa*—and rendered in English as "The Essence of Union with [Supreme] Reality." *Tattvayogabindu* is thus the most plausible title for Rāmacandra's work.

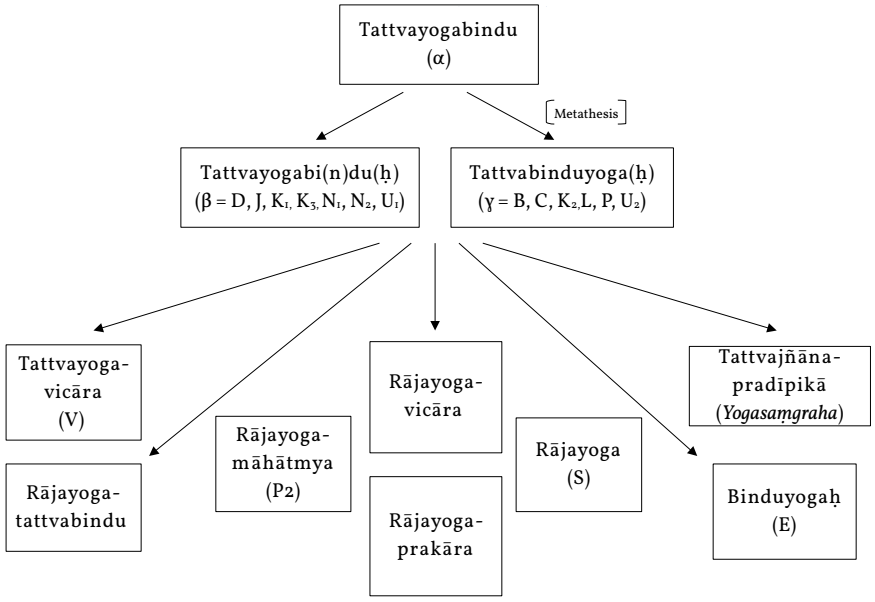


Figure 6: Hypothesis concerning the transmission of the title *Tattvayogabindu*.

1.5.4 Reconstruction of the archetypal final rubric

The final rubric of the text in the manuscripts falls into two groups corresponding to the β- and γ-groups identified in the stemmatic analysis (p. 72). A close examination of the final rubrics reveals a gradual progression of corruptions in the transmission from β to γ. Figure 7 provides a synoptic representation of the final rubrics, clearly illustrating the split between the two groups.

```
beta-witnesses:

iti    paramarahaṃsyāṃ                śrīrāmacaṃdrviracitāyāṃ tatvayogabiṃdu  samāptaḥ   || \D
iti śrīpāramahaṃsyāṃ                  śrīrāmacaṃdrviracitāyāṃ tatvayogabiṃduḥ saṃpūrṇaṃ  || \J
iti    paramahaṃsyāṃ                  śrīrāmacaṃdrviracitāyāṃ tatvayodabiṃda  samāptāḥ   || \K1
iti śrīparamarahaṃsyāṃ                śrīrāmacaṃdrviracitāyāṃ tatvayogabiṃdu  samāptaḥ   || \N1
iti śrīparamarahasye                  śrīrāmacaṃdrviracitāyāṃ tatvayogabindu  samāptam   || \N2
iti śrīparamahaṃsyāṃ                  śrīrāmacaṃdrviracitāyāṃ tatvayogaviduḥ  samāptaḥ   || \U1
iti    paramahaṃsasaṃhitāyāṃ haṃsyāṃ  śrīrāmacaṃdrviracitāyāṃ tattvayogavicāraḥ          || \V

gamma-witnesses:

iti śrīrāmacaṃdraparamahaṃsaviracitas tatvabiṃduyogasamāptaḥ  || \U2
iti śrīrāmacaṃdraparamahaṃsaviracitas tatvabinduyogasamāptaḥ  || \P
iti    rājamacaṃdraparahaṃsaviracites tatvabiṃduyogasamāptaṃ  || \L
iti śrīrāmacandraparamahaṃsaviracitas tatvabinduyogasamāptaḥ  || \K2
iti śrīsārvaguṇasaṃpannapaṃḍitasukhānandamiśrasūrisūnupaṇḍitajvālāprasādamiśrakṛtabhāṣāṭīkāsahito rājayoge binduyogaḥ samāptaḥ || \E
```

Figure 7: Synoptic transcription of the manuscripts' final rubrics.

At the same time, a widespread misconception comes to light: the spiritual title *paramahaṃsa* appears to be a later attribution to Rāmacandra resulting from a corruption in the final rubrics—an error which, to complicate matters, already appears in one of the oldest dated surviving manuscripts (V). Yet V is not a trustworthy witness: its readings diverge so markedly from the rest of the transmission, without contributing anything of value to the reconstruction of the text, that I was compelled to exclude it from the collation. The scribe introduced numerous redactional changes, consciously omitted sentences, and almost every folio contains numerous (often unsuccessful) attempts to "improve" Rāmacandra's admittedly less elegant Sanskrit. One such failed attempt is preserved in the final rubric of V, which reads: *iti paramahaṃsasaṃhitāyāṃ haṃsyāṃ śrīrāmacaṃdraviracitāyāṃ tattvayogavicāraḥ* ‖ The feminine endings in this final rubric create the impression that Rāmacandra's text formed part of another, perhaps larger, work entitled *Paramahaṃsasaṃhitā*—a title that does exist, though it bears no relation to Rāmacandra's text. The readings of the final rubrics in the other manuscripts of the β-group reveal that this final rubric is yet another failed attempt by the redactor to improve upon his exemplar. The other manuscripts of the β-group (for example, the third-oldest extant dated witness N_1, one of the best representatives of the β-group) present the final rubric along the following lines: *iti śrīparamarahasyāṃ śrīrāmacaṃdraviracitāyāṃ tatvayogabiṃdu samāptaḥ* ‖ At first glance this final rubric appears contradictory. On the one hand, the title of the text is clearly given as *Tattvayogabindu*; on the other, the feminine endings evoke the constructions typical of chapter-final rubrics, which use the locative to indicate the overarching work and the final nominatives to provide the name of the concluding chapter. Taking the other witnesses of the β-group into account, it becomes evident that all members of the β-group continue to transmit the same grammatical irregularities and preserve the feminine endings. At a superficial level, the final rubrics of the γ-group do not appear to be of much help in resolving these issues. They all read approximately like U_2: *iti śrīrāmacaṃdraparamahaṃsaviracitas tatvabiṃduyogasamāptaḥ* ‖ One might therefore conclude that the readings of the γ-group are preferable, since their final rubrics are grammatically correct.

However, as I demonstrated in the introduction (see p. 47), we may safely assume that the original title was *Tattvayogabindu* and not *Tattvabinduyoga*. Moreover, when reflecting on the discrepancies between the readings of the two manuscript groups and taking into account the stemmatic conclusions—particularly the fact that the β-group preserves a version that on average must be closer to the original text than that of the γ-group—it becomes apparent that the final rubrics of the γ-group are likely the result of redactional intervention. They represent, in other words, an attempt to emend an already corrupt final rubric (presumably in a form similar to the final rubrics of the β-group).

This is evident, first, in the alteration of the title from the original *Tattvayogabindu* to *Tattvabinduyoga* in the γ-group; secondly, in the change from the β-reading *paramarahasya* to *paramahaṃsa*; and thirdly, in what appears to be a concomitant disregard for the feminine endings of the hyparchetype of the β-group, on the basis of which the redactional changes in the γ-transmission appear to have been undertaken.

Any remaining doubts the reader may entertain regarding the plausibility of these hypothetical reconstructions can be dispelled by an important observation. The final section of the *Tattvayogabindu*, namely LIX, which constitutes the undisputed culmination of the work, opens with the phrase *idaṃ yogaśāstra**rahasyam** samagraśāstramadhye*, after which the ideal form of yoga intended for Rāmacandra's audience is introduced. This makes it reasonable to assume that the occurrence of the forms derived from *°rahasya* in the final colophon ultimately originates here. I consider it probable that an originally section-concluding rubric once preceded the work-concluding final rubric. This provides the crucial clue to how the corrupt forms of the β- and γ-final rubrics arose:

The most likely archetypal final rubric, *iti śrīparamarahasyam | iti śrīrāmacandravirācito 'yaṃ tattvayogabinduḥ samāptaḥ ||*, was corrupted through simple and typical scribal errors: the omission of *iti* and the introduction of a feminine locative ending through a minor inaccuracy (*°virācito 'yaṃ* → *°viracitāyām*), followed by what was likely an automatic adjustment of *°rahasyam* to *°rahasyām*. This produced the reading *iti śrīparamarahasyāṃ śrīrāmacaṃdraviracitāyāṃ tat-*

vayogabiṃdu samāptaḥ ‖, from which the subsequent corruptions took their course. Later witnesses of the β-group, such as D and U_1, copied the final rubric from their exemplars, introducing further errors so that *śrīparamarahasyāṃ* becomes *śrīpāramahaṃsyāṃ*. Due to the loss of the feminine referent and the aforementioned copying error, scribes of the γ-group were led to a further emendation. From the intermediate stage *iti śrīpāramahaṃsyāṃ śrīrāmacaṃdraviracitāyāṃ*, a scribe apparently felt compelled to introduce a plausible correction and altered the reading of his exemplar to *iti śrīrāmacaṃdraparamahaṃsaviracitas*. Thus, Rāmacandra was erroneously assigned the spiritual title *paramahaṃsa* and consequently presumed to have undergone initiation into the Daśanāmī Saṃnyāsī order.[73,74] Thus, when confronted with these somewhat confusing transmissions of the final rubric, one might expect one *iti* to mark the end of a chapter and the second to close the work as a whole. Yet one has to bear in mind that the text offers no clear system of chapters; instead, it is divided into numerous sections introduced by *idānīṃ* or, more rarely, *atha* and similar markers. These sections—aside from this single exception—never conclude with a chapter-final rubric or chapter colophon. It is therefore unlikely that the *iti*s before the final rubric should be interpreted as marking a chapter-final rubric. Rather, I propose understanding it as an emphatic concluding formula that marks the climactic end of the text.

1.5.5 Description of the sources

In the critical edition of the *Tattvayogabindu*, the author's sources are indicated in the first register of the critical apparatus, corresponding to the passage in question. Overall, two texts form the basis of Rāmacandra's work: the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*. However, Rāmacandra never explicitly identifies these sources. On the one hand, there are some direct quotations, often in the form of verses. More commonly, however, Rā-

[73] See Clark, 2006: 42–45 for a discussion of the term *paramahaṃsa* in the Daśanāmī Saṃnyāsī order.

[74] I wish to thank Jason Birch for sharing his thoughts regarding the reconstruction of the final rubric, which provided the decisive impetus for arriving at a satisfactory solution.

macandra uses his sources as a textual basis, either transforming them into prose, paraphrasing them and introducing editorial changes, or blending the contents of both sources. Nevertheless, the passages can be identified, as the corresponding passages are often very similar. They are sometimes so similar that consulting the source texts significantly helped me to make sound editorial decisions and to correct corrupt passages appropriately.

1.5.5.1 Yogasvarodaya

The *Yogasvarodaya* (YSv) is the main source text for Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu*. Rāmacandra draws most of his material from this text and even follows its structure to a considerable extent. The majority of sections in the *Tattvayogabindu* consist of Rāmacandra's rewriting of the *śloka*s of the *Yogasvarodaya* into prose, incorporating specific editorial changes to align with his agenda. Thus, this text is crucial for the reconstruction of uncertain passages in the *Tattvayogabindu*.[75] So far, the *Yogasvarodaya* is known only from quotations preserved in the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* and *Yogakarṇikā*, which will be described below. No manuscript has yet been identified, and locating one remains a desideratum.[76]

[75] For a detailed description of the *Yogasvarodaya*, see p. 311.

[76] One of the few glimmers of hope in the search for a manuscript of this text arose from a result in the current National Mission for Manuscripts search engine (https://www.pandulipipatala.nic.in/). This was a manuscript in the Dogra Art Museum in Jammu, Ms. No. 288. The manuscript, titled *Yogasvarodaya* and classified by the search engine as belonging to the Tantra genre, therefore appeared to be a promising candidate. During a visit to the museum in February 2025, after four days of negotiations, I was able to examine the manuscript. Unfortunately, it turned out to be a different text. The Jammu manuscript concerns *svarodaya* for yogis. The text includes a highly detailed account of the localisation and functioning of the yogic channels (*nāḍīs*), the *ṣaṭkarma*s, the *haṃsamantra*, and the *aṣṭasiddhi*s. Thematically, the manuscript is structured as follows:

1. *atha nāḍībhedaḥ*; 2. *atha tattvanirśāyaḥ*, 3. *atha tattvadhyānaḥ*; 4. *atha yuddhajayaprakāraṇam*; 5. *atha svasvaprakāraṇam*; 6. *atha garmaprakāraṇam*; 7. *atha samvatsanaprakāraṇam*, 8. *atha rogaprakāraṇam*; 9. *atha kālajñānam*. The final rubric reads: *iti śrīśivāśivasaṃvāde yogasvarodaye muktiprakāraṇaṃ ‖ saṃpūrṇam.*

1.5.5.2 Prāṇatoṣiṇī

The *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* (PT) by Rāmatoṣaṇa[77] is a Tantra compendium (*nibandha*) from the 19th century, compiled by the author in Bengal.[78] This extensive compendium addresses creation, the four *puruṣārtha*s, and devotion. The *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* is divided into six major *kāṇḍa*s ("sections"): 1. *sargakāṇḍa* (subject: cosmogony), 2. *dharmakhaṇḍa* (subject: rituals and the Dharma of the twice-born), 3. *arthakāṇḍa* (subject: daily routine, deity worship, purification practices, rites, offerings, etc.), 4. *kāmyakāṇḍa* (subject: wish-fulfilment practices, protective mantras, etc.), 5. *bhaktikāṇḍa* (subject: performance of devotional deity worship), and 6. *jñānakāṇḍa* (subject: *mokṣa*, yoga, etc.). The author draws from a multitude of texts circulating in this region during the 19th century.

Additional topics treated in the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* range from *mantras*, *yantras*, and their meanings[79] to meditations, religious stories, legends, and deity worship,[80] the six acts of magic, tantric rituals including sexual rites, and various areas of tantric philosophy.[81]

The *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* incorporates a total of 304 verses from the *Yogasvarodaya* in its *jñānakāṇḍa*.[82] It is therefore currently the most extensive testimonium to the *Yogasvarodaya*. All these verses are cited with the reference *yogasvarodaye*. These verses are quoted in a largely coherent sequence, giving the reader the impression that the complete text has been transmitted. However, this is not the case. Many additional verses of the *Yogasvarodaya* are preserved in the *Yogakarṇikā* described below. There are numerous overlaps between the

[77] Although the printed editions identify Rāmatoṣaṇa as the author of this work, sometimes bearing the titles Vidyālaṃkāra or Bhaṭṭācārya, Shāstri (1905: 2) mentions another name: "Babu Prāṇakṛṣṇa Visvās of Khaṛhadaha, within ten miles of Calcutta, collected in the beginning of the nineteenth century a large number of Tantra, Purāṇa and Smṛti MSS., for the purpose of compiling Prāṇatoṣiṇī, Prāṇakṛṣṇā Kriyāmbudhi and other encyclopaedic works on Hindu ritual and worship."

Since the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* is frequently cited in recent secondary literature on tantric studies but lacks detailed studies, critical editions, or complete translations into Western languages, this discrepancy remains unresolved.

[78] Vidyāsāgara, 1898.

[79] See Slouber, 2010: 69–70.

[80] See Kinsley, 1997: 149–150.

[81] See Urban, 2010: 100.

[82] Vidyāsāgara, 1898: 831–848.

quotations. The main difference lies in the fact that, unlike the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*, the *Yogakarṇikā* primarily includes practical instructions from the *Yogasvarodaya*, such as instructions on *prāṇāyāma*, *kumbhaka*, or *mudrā* techniques.

1.5.5.3 Yogakarṇikā

The *Yogakarṇikā* (YK) of Nāth Aghorānanda is another significant testimonium to the *Yogasvarodaya*.[83] The *Yogakarṇikā* is an extensive anthology on yoga, comprising 1253 verses divided into 15 *pāda*s. The text draws its verses from a wide array of sources, often, though not always, citing them with references. Besides various Purāṇas (*Mārkaṇḍeyapurāṇa*, *Narasiṃhapurāṇa*, etc.) and Tantras (*Kūbjikāmatatantra*, *Grahayāmala*, *Rudrayāmala*, etc.), Nāth Aghorānanda also cites texts from the Haṭha and Rājayoga traditions (*Yogasvarodaya*, *Haṭhapradīpikā*, *Dattātreyayogaśāstra*, *Gheraṇḍasaṃhitā*, *Yogayājñavalkya*, various works attributed to Gorakṣa, etc.). Based on the established dating of the *Yogasvarodaya*, which must have been written before 1591 CE,[84] and Mallinson's dating of the *Gheraṇḍasaṃhitā* to circa 1700 CE,[85] we can confidently assume that the *Yogakarṇikā* was composed no earlier than the eighteenth century. The fifteen *pāda*s are thematically structured as follows:

1. *dinacaryā* ("daily routine"); 280 verses
2. *lakṣādiyogaḥ* ("Yoga of foci, etc."); 123 verses
3. *prāṇāyāmaḥ* ("breath control"); 108 verses
4. *yogasaṅketaḥ* ("preliminaries"); 80 verses
5. *sādhanasaṅketaḥ* ("consensus of methods"); 36 verses
6. *pratyāhāraḥ* ("withdrawal of the senses"); 34 verses
7. *kumbhakavidhiḥ* ("precepts for breath-retention"); 78 verses
8. *mudrāsādhanam* ("discipline of [haṭhayogic] seals"); 214 verses
9. *dhāraṇā* ("concentration"); 31 verses

[83] Nath Sharma, 2004.
[84] See p. 6.
[85] Mallinson, 2004: xiv.

10. *dhyānam* ("meditation"); 50 verses
11. *samādhiḥ* ("meditative absorption"); 34 verses
12. *layayogaḥ* ("Yoga of absorption"); 26 verses
13. *āsanāni* ("postures"); 57 verses
14. *ghaṭaśodhanam* ("purification of the pot [the body]"); 56 verses
15. *tyājyagrāhyavidhānam* ("injunctions and prohibitions"); 36 verses[86]

The *Yogakarṇikā* cites a total of 134 verses with references (*yogasvarodaye* or *svarodaye*) and at least four, if not eight or more, additional verses without references:[87]

- 1.210–213 [probably 1.209–216]: Kriyāyoga; 4–8 or more verses quoted without reference
- 1.244–280: main *nāḍī*s and nine *cakras*; 36 ślokas quoted with reference
- 2.1–41: five *lakṣya*s, sixteen *ādhāra*s, five *ākāśa*s; 41 ślokas quoted with reference
- 4.40–49: *ṣaṭkarma*s; 9 verses quoted with reference
- 4.53–54: *trāṭaka*; 2 verses quoted with reference
- 4.67–80: various *kumbhaka*s (*vyutkrama, bhāstrikā, bhrāmarī, kapālabhāti, antardhauti, vārisāra, nāḍikṣālanam, mūlaśodhanam*; 13 verses quoted with reference
- 5.29–33: Aṣṭāṅgayoga; 4 verses quoted with reference
- 6.23–34: *pratyāhāra*; 2 verses quoted with reference
- 7.2–10: various *kumbhaka*s (*śītkāra, sūryabheda, ujjāyī, śītalī, bhāstrikā, bhrāmarī, mūrcchā, kevala*); 8 verses quoted with reference
- 7.23–28: *sūryabheda*; 6 verses quoted with reference
- 7.68–72: *ṣaṇmukhikaraṇa*, also called *dantodara*; 4 verses quoted with reference

[86] There are two additional introductory verses and eight final verses that are not included in the chapter counts.

[87] See p. 311 n.493.

- 8.136–141: *khecarīmudrā*; 5 verses quoted with reference
- 12.2: a general statement on *laya*; 1 verse quoted with reference
- 12.23–25: Haṭhayoga practice involving colour visualisation; 3 verses quoted with reference

It is noteworthy that all practical instructions on *ṣaṭkarma*s, *kumbhaka*s, and *mudrā*s from the *Yogasvarodaya* were not incorporated by Rāmacandra into his *Tattvayogabindu*.

A particularly distinctive feature of the *Yogakarṇikā* is its first chapter, which is also by far the most extensive.[88] No other Sanskrit yoga text known to me describes the daily routine of a yogin in such detail, including ritual ablutions, mantra recitation, dressing, the application of sectarian markers (*tilaka*), including tying the hair into a knot, offerings, and the devotional performance of prostrations before one's own *iṣṭadevatā*, etc.[89]

1.5.5.4 Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati

The *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* (SSP), one of the authoritative Sanskrit works of the modern Nātha Sampradāya and often attributed to Gorakṣanātha, appears to have served as another major source for the *Tattvayogabindu*.[90] More broadly, the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* exhibit substantial similarities in both content and structure. These correspondences are sufficiently extensive to suggest a close textual relationship between the two works, whether through direct dependence or through shared textual materials.

In secondary literature, at least three attempts have been made to date the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*. While White (2003: 224) accepts the historical Gorakṣanātha as the author of the text, placing its origin in the 12th century, Bouy (1994: 19) dates the text much later, to the period between 1600–1650 CE. This dating is based on Bouy's dating of the *Gorakṣasiddhāntasaṃgraha* to

[88] It is also the only chapter in which almost no sources are given. Either all these verses are by Nāth Aghorānanda himself, or—more likely, in my opinion—the source references are missing from the printed copy. I suspect further verses were taken from the *Yogasvarodaya*.

[89] For further details on the first chapter of the *Yogakarṇikā*, see p. 351.

[90] All quotations from the SSP are from Gharote and Pai, 2016.

the first half of the seventeenth century, and the fact that this text quotes the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*. Mallinson[91] dates the composition of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* to around 1700 CE. His estimate is based on the period in which the Nātha Sampradāya was institutionalised. Mallinson hypothesises that this text was composed to meet the need for a systematic religious scripture, which would serve as the authoritative textual foundation for the newly institutionalised Nātha Sampradāya. The present examination of the *Tattvayogabindu* allows the timeframe of its composition to be narrowed further.

The research underlying the critical edition of the *Tattvayogabindu* establishes a *terminus ante quem* of 1591 CE for Rāmacandra's text. If, as the textual evidence strongly suggests, Rāmacandra drew directly on the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* as one of the principal sources for compiling the *Tattvayogabindu*, then the same *terminus ante quem* would also apply to the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*. On this basis, the latter was most likely composed in the second half of the sixteenth century or earlier. This timeframe may be further narrowed in light of its parallels with the *Amaraughaśāsana*, whose oldest extant manuscript is dated to 1525 CE and which, according to Mallinson (2011: 16), may have served as a source for the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*.[92] If the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* did indeed borrow this material from the *Amaraughaśāsana*, 1525 CE may be taken as a possible *terminus a quo*. Taken together, these considerations suggest that the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* was most likely composed between 1525 and 1591 CE, assuming the proposed direction of textual dependence.

The *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* is an exceptionally systematic exposition of the philosophical teachings associated with the Nātha Sampradāya. Like the *Tattvayogabindu*, this text is a blend of prose and verse, presenting complex teachings in relatively simple Sanskrit, aside from some *termini technici*. The

[91] See Mallinson 2013.

[92] I identified the following five parallels based on the printed edition of the *Amaraughaśāsana*: 1. *Amaraughaśāsana* 12 ≈SSP 1.37; 2. *Amaraughaśāsana* 13 ≈SSP 1.38; 3. *Amaraughaśāsana* 14 ≈SSP 1.39; 4. *Amaraughaśāsana* 15 ≈SSP 1.40; and 5. *Amaraughaśāsana* 16 ≈SSP 1.41. It is likely that further parallels between the *Amaraughaśāsana* and the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* will emerge upon a careful examination of the *Amaraughaśāsana* manuscripts.

text comprises six *upadeśas*: 1. *piṇḍotpatti* ("genesis of the body"), 2. *piṇḍavicāra* ("investigation of the body"), 3. *piṇḍasaṃvitti* ("insight into the body"), 4. *piṇḍādhāraḥ* ("substratum of the body"), 5. *piṇḍapadayoḥ samarasakaraṇam* ("effecting a uniform taste of the [supreme] place and the body"), 6. *avadhūtayogilakṣaṇam* ("characteristics of an *avadhūtayogin*").[93]

Rāmacandra appears to have made extensive use of material also found in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*. While the first half of the *Tattvayogabindu* (I–XXVIII) can be traced primarily to the *Yogasvarodaya*, with occasional formulations and concepts closely paralleling the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, correspondences with the latter become considerably more frequent from section XXIX onwards. These parallels consist not so much of verbatim quotations as of distinctive formulations, concepts, rephrasings, and paraphrases, which Rāmacandra integrates, with varying degrees of success, into material otherwise closely related to the *Yogasvarodaya*.[94] Particularly significant are a number of unattributed verses in the *Tattvayogabindu* that correspond closely to verses of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*. With one exception, Rāmacandra does not reproduce these verses verbatim but modifies them to varying degrees.[95] The direction of dependence is difficult to establish with absolute certainty, since Rāmacandra never identifies the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* as his source and the possibility of an otherwise unknown intermediary source cannot be excluded. Nevertheless, the cumulative evidence strongly suggests that Rāmacandra was drawing on the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, or on a source very closely related to it, rather than the reverse. This is indicated not only by the number and density of the correspondences, but also by their sequence and structural coherence, particularly in the cosmological sections, where passages of the *Tattvayogabindu* follow the order of material

[93] A summary of the chapter contents can be found in Gharote and Pai, 2016: xvii–xxiii.

[94] Rāmacandra appears to have drawn on material corresponding to *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 1.4, 1.17–20, 1.22–26, 1.30–34, 1.37–67, 2.1–26, 2.28–34, 2.36, 2.38, 2.45, 3.1–14, 4.9, 5.55–60, 5.60, 5.79, 6.10–11, 6.32, 6.60, and 6.64–67.

[95] I have identified fifteen such verses: TYB 28.1 ≈SSP 2.31; TYB 41.1 ≈SSP 5.79; TYB 44.1 ≈SSP 6.10; TYB 44.2 ≈SSP 6.11; TYB 44.5 ≈SSP 6.32; TYB 44.7 ≈SSP 6.64; TYB 44.8 ≈SSP 6.65; TYB 44.9 ≈SSP 6.66; TYB 44.10 ≈SSP 6.67; TYB 48.1 = SSP 1.4; TYB 58.1 ≈SSP 5.60–61ab; TYB 58.2 ≈SSP 5.61cd–62ab; TYB 58.3 ≈SSP 5.64; TYB 58.4 ≈SSP 5.64cd–5.65ab; and TYB 58.5 ≈SSP 5.65cd–5.66cd.

found in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*. The comparatively uneven quality of Rāmacandra's adaptations likewise makes it unlikely that the corresponding verses originated with him. Since the *Tattvayogabindu* was certainly composed before 1591, these parallels may also provide evidence for the dating of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, although they are not conclusive on their own.[96]

1.5.5.5 Amanaska

The *Amanaska*[97] is another source text for Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu*. According to Birch (2013), the *Amanaska* is one of the most significant and influential texts on Rājayoga. It had a profound influence on numerous subsequent yoga texts, including the *Haṭhapradīpikā*, *Amaraughaprabodha*, *Śivayogapradīpikā*, and *Yogatārāvalī*, as well as later works such as Yugaladāsa's *Yogamārgaprakāśikā* and Brahmānanda's *Jyotsnā*. Additionally, the *Amanaska* is frequently cited in compendia such as *Yogacintāmaṇi*, *Haṭhatattvakaumudī*, and *Gorakṣasiddhāntasaṃgraha*. It also influenced the twelfth chapter of Hemacandra's *Yogaśāstra* and was incorporated into two late Yoga Upaniṣads. Birch dates the first chapter of the *Amanaska* to between the 15th and 16th centuries CE, while the second chapter is dated to the 11th or 12th centuries CE. This second chapter contains some of the earliest teachings on Rājayoga. The text is structured as a dialogue between the supreme god (*īśvara*) and the sage Vāmadeva. Vāmadeva initiates the discussion by asking how one attains liberation in life (*jīvanmukti*). Īśvara responds by teaching the practice of *amanaska* (the no-mind state), synonymous with *samādhi* and Rājayoga. To attain the *amanaska* state, the dissolution of mind and breath is required, primarily through the practice of *śāmbhavīmudrā*. This yoga practice leads to the perception of the non-dual state (*advaitapada*), the highest reality (*paratattva*). According to Birch, the second chapter reflects Śaiva origins but avoids specific tantric sect affiliations. *Amanaska* 2.3–4 describes Rājayoga as both the king (*rāja*) of all yogas and a means for the yogin to attain the supreme Self, described as the illustrious king.

[96] For a discussion of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* in relation to the *Śivayogapradīpikā*, see Powell, 2023: 147–152.

[97] For a detailed discussion of the *Amanaska*, see Birch, 2013: 1–16.

A significant aspect of the *Amanaska* is its rejection of most Haṭhayoga techniques. Instead, it advocates an effortless path to liberation through the practice of *amanaska*. Birch notes that the text eschews complex metaphysics and philosophical elaborations.

The *Tattvayogabindu* shares the equivalent of two and a half verses with the *Amanaska* in *Tattvayogabindu* LIX: TYB LIX.2cd ≈*Amanaska* 1.12ab, TYB LIX.6 ≈*Amanaska* 2.36, and TYB LIX.7 ≈*Amanaska* 2.37. Editorially modified forms of these verses also appear in the *Yogasvarodaya*. However, in certain hemistiches, the readings in the *Tattvayogabindu* correspond more closely to those of the *Amanaska* than to the *Yogasvarodaya*. It remains uncertain whether Rāmacandra derived these verses via the *Yogasvarodaya* or directly from the *Amanaska*.

1.5.6 Description of the testimonia

To date, I have been able to identify two testimonia of the *Tattvayogabindu*, namely the *Yogasaṃgraha* and the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā*. Both texts reproduce conspicuously long passages from the *Tattvayogabindu*. These sections serve as crucial additional evidence for reconstructing the *Tattvayogabindu*. They are included in the second register of the critical apparatus where available for the passage in question.

1.5.6.1 Yogasaṃgraha

The *Yogasaṃgraha* is a compendium of excerpts from various Yoga texts, currently known from a single manuscript.[98] Although written in Devanāgarī script, the manuscript is exceedingly difficult to read. The scribe's handwriting is often imprecise and carelessly executed. The manuscript consists of only eight folios in total. Folio 1 and folio 2 recto are missing. The text commences on folio 2 verso in the midst of an extensive quotation from the *Tattvayogabindu*. It is precisely above the first line of folio 2 verso that a second hand inscribed the title *Yogasaṃgraha*.

[98] *Yogasaṃgraha*; Ms. No.: 30020; Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts (IGNCA). The paper manuscript is incomplete and in very poor condition overall.

The *Yogasaṃgraha* quotes sections II–XII of the *Tattvayogabindu* in sequence,[99] initially giving the impression that this manuscript is another, albeit incomplete, textual witness of the *Tattvayogabindu*. However, closer examination reveals various minor editorial alterations to the quoted text. The quotation from the *Tattvayogabindu* in the *Yogasaṃgraha* concludes after section XII with "*cha | tad uktaṃ tattvajñānapradīpikāyāṃ ||*". Beyond this point, there are no further citations of the *Tattvayogabindu* in the *Yogasaṃgraha*. Subsequently, the manuscript contains what appears to be an unsystematic collection of various yogic topics and practices. The manuscript lacks a final rubric and colophon. This absence and the nature of the handwriting likely explain the title assigned to this manuscript by the IGNCA. I propose that the *Yogasaṃgraha* represents a compilation produced by a Yoga practitioner, likely a householder, who recorded personally relevant content.

Besides the *Tattvayogabindu*, so far, I have been able to identify only the *Uttaragītā* as another source. Additional topics covered in this manuscript include the *nāḍī*s, *prāṇāyāma*, *kuṇḍalinī*, the *haṃsamantra*, and various descriptions of *mudrā*s, such as *khecarīmudrā*, *haṃsamudrā*, *bhūcarīmudrā*, and, towards the end of the manuscript, *unmanīmudrā*.

1.5.6.2 Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā

The *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* is an unpublished seventeenth-century Sanskrit yoga text,[100] authored by Sundaradeva.

Sundaradeva, a Brahmin of the Kāśyapa Gotra, was the son of Govindadeva and the grandson of Viśvanāthadeva. He resided in Benares during the 17th century, where he was likely active not only as an author but also as a physician (*vaidya*). Sundaradeva did not originate from Benares but, like many scholars of his time, probably moved there from the southern regions

[99] *Yogasaṃgraha* IGNCA 30020, f. 2v. l. 1 to f. 4r. l. 4 ≈*Tattvayogabindu* II–XII.

[100] The dating of the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* has recently been revised due to the discovery that some first-hand notes surrounding the main text of the Ujjain *Yogacintāmaṇi* were likely borrowed from Sundaradeva's *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā*. See Birch, 2024: 52–54. Birch (2018) dated the Ujjain *Yogacintāmaṇi* to 1659 CE.

of India, facilitated by the conditions of the "Pax Mughalia".[101] Sundaradeva authored not only the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* but also another extensive yoga text, the *Haṭhatattvakaumudī*,[102] as well as various works on Ayurveda.[103]

The *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* is an exceedingly comprehensive compendium[104] on yoga, written in a mixture of verse and prose. Its topics and sources are remarkably diverse and have yet to be examined systematically. A critical edition of the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* remains a desideratum. The text comprises a compilation of various teachings on Haṭha and Rājayoga,[105] which are interconnected with diverse teachings from the Upaniṣads, the epics, Pātañjalayoga, various Tantras, the *Yogavāsiṣṭha*, and various Purāṇas. Mallinson[106] also identified striking parallels with the *Bahr al-Hayāt*, such as breathing techniques (*prāṇāyāma*s) in non-seated positions.[107] The eclectic mix and sheer number of yoga techniques taught in this text surpass those found in most other Sanskrit yoga texts.

Some of the descriptions of these techniques in the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* were taken without attribution from the *Tattvayogabindu*.[108]

The passages quoted include the teachings on the sixteen *ādhāra*s[109] and the teachings on Lakṣyayoga and its subtypes.[110] These passages are repro-

[101] The ancestry, location, and profession of Sundaradeva are derived from the colophon of the Jodhpur manuscript of the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 145v). See Birch, 2018: 123.

[102] Birch (2013: 162–165) discusses the *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* in relation to the *Amanaska*. For an edition of the *Haṭhatattvakaumudī*, see Gharote, Devnath, and Jha, 2007.

[103] These include *Bhūpālavallabha* (or *Bhūpacaryā*), the *Cikitsāsundara*, the *Līlāvatī*, and the *Yogoktivivekacandra* and *Yogoktyupadeśāṃrta*. For references and a discussion on the entanglement of yoga and Ayurveda in Sundaradeva's works, see Birch, 2018: 58–62.

[104] In terms of *śloka*s, the text likely exceeds 3000 verses.

[105] The text includes, for instance, an extended description of *āsana*s, some of which are not found in other yoga texts. See *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* MMPP 2244, f. 16r l. 4 to f. 22v l. 6.

[106] See Birch, 2018: 131 n. 121 and pp. 123 et seqq.

[107] See Ernst (2013: 59–69) for a translation of the fourth chapter of the *Bahr al-Hayāt*. Additionally, see Ernst, 2003.

[108] In an entry by Theodor Aufrecht in the *Catalogus Catalogorum* for the title *Tattvayogabindu*, currently listed in Raghavan, Narang, and Bhattacharya, 2007: 60 (Vol. 8), it states: "Q. by Sundaradeva in his C. Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā." This not only attests to Theodor Aufrecht's incredible erudition in Sanskrit literature but also indicates that he read the texts he catalogued with remarkable attention, as the *Tattvayogabindu* is cited without reference in roughly the second third of the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā*.

[109] *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 95r l. 3 to f. 96r l. 4).

[110] *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 124r l. 7 to f. 125r l. 3).

duced predominantly verbatim by Sundaradeva, though some may have undergone slight editorial changes. One passage, in particular, stands out. Within the description of the *adholakṣya*, there is a passage describing two additional techniques absent from the manuscript tradition of the *Tattvayogabindu*.[111] The first technique describes a specific form of gazing. After positioning the eyes in a particular manner and staring at a lamp for a set period, the yogin can subsequently see in the dark, perceive the luminous form of God, experience a sense of bliss, and lose bodily awareness. The second technique involves rubbing the eyes in specific spots to induce further light phenomena. The origin of these techniques is uncertain. Most likely, these additions originated with Sundaradeva himself. However, it is not entirely impossible that these techniques originally belonged to the *Tattvayogabindu*, with the manuscript tradition failing to preserve them. This possibility cannot be entirely excluded because the manuscript tradition of the *Tattvayogabindu* is prone to haplography and eyeskips owing to frequent structural similarities and identical beginnings of certain sentences.[112]

1.5.7 Notes on the parallels

In the third register of the critical apparatus, I list relevant parallel passages from other texts that do not fall under the categories of source texts or testimonia but should still be included in the critical apparatus because of their significance for editorial decisions or their broader relevance.

- The additional material found in manuscript U_2 in the context of the presentation of the nine *cakra*s (IV–XII) turned out to correspond—often verbatim—to passages I later encountered, quite by chance, in several manuscripts and scrolls belonging to a Kashmiri [art] tradition. These manuscripts bear the title *Nāḍīcakra*,[113] and are in most cases sumptuously

[111] *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* I based on ORI B 220 (f. 239 r l. 8 to f. 240r l. 13), GOML R 3239 (f. 258 l. 14 to f. 259 l. 10) and MMPP 2244 (f. 124r ll. 5–9 to f. 125r ll. 1–2).

[112] I have edited the additional material on p. 398.

[113] Various manuscripts bearing the title *Nāḍīcakra* are catalogued at *Catalogue of Sanskrit Manuscripts at the Oriental Research Library, Srinagar*, 2021: 182. The manuscript numbers are: 722, 869, 890.3, 1334, 1388, 1490, 2150. Another manuscript of the same text lies in the Śāradā

illustrated. They depict the yogic cosmos in descending order. Following a brief cosmogony, they present a description of the nine *cakra*s. Below this is a representation of the yogic micro–macrocosm which, in large part, corresponds to the elements of the yogic micro–macrocosm described in the *Tattvayogabindu* (from XXXII onwards): the *saptadvīpa*s, *pātāla*s, *tattva*s, *tanmātra*s, *mahābhūta*s, *vāyu*s, *śakti*s, the *agni* groups, *liṅga* types, stages of *vāk*, *loka*s, and so forth. For the third register of the critical apparatus, I chose manuscript 1334, which not only contains the most beautiful illustrations but also appears to be comparatively carefully written, although its text still contains numerous grammatical and other scribal errors. I obtained copies of all the manuscripts; however, due to time constraints, I had to select one without examining all of them in equal detail.

- In the context of the eight *cakra*s of *Tattvayogabindu* XI, manuscript U_2 presents additional material. The text includes a widely known verse that describes the mechanism of the so-called *haṃsamantra*, also known as *ajapāgāyatrī*.[114] The source of the verse in U_2 is difficult to identify. In order to elucidate the possible sources, it was useful to list the texts that transmit parallel versions of the verse. These include: ≈*Vivekamārtaṇḍa* 29, ≈*Yogabīja* 106, ≈*Yogacintāmani* (PULL, f. 6r), ≈*Haṭhatattvakaumudī* 22.27, and ≈*Yogaśikhopaniṣad* 1.130cd–131ab (Ed. p. 416).
- *Tattvayogabindu* XXVIII.1 presents a variant of a widely circulated verse whose origins can be traced back to the *Netratantra*. Rāmacandra adopts this variant from the *Yogasvarodaya*. Further investigations into the variants of this verse revealed insights into an extensive intertextual network spanning several centuries. This verse provides an intriguing starting point for further studies on the genesis of the corpus of Haṭha- and Rājayoga texts from the eleventh century CE onwards, precisely at the intersection where ascetic and tantric traditions converged and produced new literature. This verse also appears later in the *Haṭhapradīpikā*, where

manuscripts of the Janert collection, housed at the Staatsbibliothek Berlin. The Ms. No. is Hs or 12446 SBB-PK, see *Indische Handschriften, Teil 18: Die Śāradā-Handschriften der Sammlung Janert der Staatsbibliothek zu Berlin – Preussischer Kulturbesitz*, 2012: 134.

[114] *Tattvayogabindu* XI.1: *sakāreṇa bahir yāti hakāreṇa viśet punaḥ | haṃsaḥ so 'haṃ tato mantraṃ jīvo japeti sarvadā ||*

it forms the first verse of a tetrad of verses, which, for reasons yet to be clarified, is called *saubhadra*.[115] I have identified the following parallels to TYB XXVIII.1: ≈*Netratantra with Netroddyota* 7.1cd–2, ≈*Tantrāloka (b)* 19.15, ≈*Ūrmikaulārṇavatantra* 2.184, ≈*Vivekamārtaṇḍa* 6.3, ≈*Yogataraṅgiṇī* quoted with reference *Nityanāthapaddhati* (Ed. p. 72), ≈*Gorakṣaśataka (Nowotny)* 13, ≈*Haṭhapradīpikā* 4.58, ≈*Yogacūḍāmaṇyupaniṣad* 3cd–4ab, ≈*Maṇḍalabrāhmaṇopaniṣat* 3.4.5, ≈*Haṭhatattvakaumudī* 24.1, ≈*Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.31 (Ed. p. 43), ≈*Prāṇatoṣiṇī* (Ed. p. 172).

- In *Tattvayogabindu* L, Rāmacandra presents the five great elements within the body (*śarīramadhye pañca mahābhūtāni*). Rāmacandra drew these descriptions from the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* and the *Yogasvarodaya*. Notably, this description is found in almost identical form in *Amaraughaśāsana* 11–16. I noticed the following parallels: TYB L l. 1–5 ≈*Amaraughaśāsana* 11–16 ≈SSP 1.37–41 ≈YSv (PT, p. 846). Although this contributes little to the constitution of the edited text, this insight is nevertheless relevant from the perspective of yoga research, as the sources of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* have not yet been systematically explored. My observations suggest that both the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Amaraughaśāsana* are important candidates as sources for the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*.
- In *Tattvayogabindu* section XLI.1, the γ-group witnesses transmit a verse on the *navanidhi*s which is a variant of *Amarakośa* 1.1.165–1.1.166.

1.6 Stemmatic analysis

The stemmatic analysis of the *Tattvayogabindu*, undertaken to construct a *stemma codicum* representing the relationships between the collated textual witnesses, is based on the classical Lachmannian method, supplemented by trees generated with contemporary phylogenetic software to provide empirical support for the manual philological analysis.[116] The following

[115] Before *Haṭhapradīpikā* verse 4.58, it is stated: *tathā hi saubhadraṃ nāma ślokacatuṣṭayam* |

[116] Certainly, in the case of the *Tattvayogabindu*, reconstructing the *stemma codicum* would have been feasible by manual methods alone, given the relatively manageable textual tradition, without yielding fundamentally different results. However, precisely in light of the

subsections explain how the *stemma codicum* is constructed. The first subsection presents my philological observations concerning both the macro- and microstructure of the transmission of the *Tattvayogabindu*. Each observation is substantiated by concrete textual examples. The second subsection introduces a selection of computer-generated trees representing the manuscript transmission of the *Tattvayogabindu*, produced using different phylogenetic algorithms. These models are critically evaluated with regard to their respective advantages and limitations, assessed in detail in light of the philological observations. In the final subsection, the two approaches converge in the proposed *stemma codicum* of the *Tattvayogabindu*.

1.6.1 Philological observations

1.6.1.1 Macrostructural observations during collation

Before collating the manuscripts, I transcribed every available witness of the *Tattvayogabindu* and arranged the transcriptions synoptically. This approach proved helpful for the preparation of the critical edition of the *Tattvayogabindu*. The text comprises a mixture of prose and verse. Many prose passages are structurally very similar, with identical beginnings and sentence endings. As a result, virtually every manuscript omits words, sentences, or entire sections through eyeskips caused by the repetitive structure of the text. Additionally, there are also frequent instances in which words, phrases, or even entire passages are transposed. Several manuscripts have substantial *lacunae*. A synoptic comparison of the transcriptions was crucial for maintaining an overview in such cases and for reconstructing a text as close as possible to the original. The synoptic arrangement makes these structural differences immediately apparent. See the following example:

This is one of many examples (Figure 8) of sentences illustrating recurrent structural differences among the witnesses. During the transcription of the

text's well-preserved and uncontaminated transmission, readily comprehensible through traditional philological analysis, the stemmatic analysis of the *Tattvayogabindu*'s textual witnesses conducted here can, in my view, serve as a useful case study. It demonstrates both the utility and the limitations of computer-assisted stemmatics and provides data that may benefit future applications of these methods.

```
puruṣo yad icchati  tad bhavati          \D
puruṣo yad icchati  tad bhavati//  cha // \J
puruṣo yad icchati  tad bhavati//        \K1
puruṣo yad icchati  tad bhavati          \N1
puruṣo yad icchati  tad bhavati          \N2
puruṣo yad icchati  tad bhavati    vā    \U1
puruṣo yad icchati//                     \U2
puruṣo yad icchati                 cha   \P
puruṣo yad icchati/                      \B
puruṣo yad icchati/                      \L
puruṣo yad icchati/                      \E
```

Figure 8: Example from section XII: Synoptic transcription of the *Tattvayogabindu*'s witnesses.

textual witnesses, it became apparent that the transmission of the Urtext or archetype (α)—the hypothetically reconstructed state of the text, based on all extant witnesses, which approximates the original more closely than any surviving manuscript—divides into two main branches, each traceable to a hyparchetype.[117] The two hyparchetypes differ structurally and are also distinguished by characteristic readings and key errors.

I refer to the first hyparchetype as β (D, J, K_1, K_3, N_1, N_2, U_1, and V) for two main reasons: this group contains the two oldest extant dated witnesses and, in all likelihood, preserves a structural arrangement that is closer to the original than the γ-group, which contains additional material in some places and often preserves clearly more degenerate variants. Although the β-group frequently contains errors, in many cases there is at least one manuscript whose reading is entirely convincing. The oldest extant dated manuscript N_2 is from 1591 CE. The second-oldest extant dated witness is V, which was written in 1694 CE.

I collated all manuscripts of the β-hyparchetype except for V and K_3. During the transcription of V, it quickly became clear that despite its age, it contains numerous errors and conflations of sentences, as well as extensive redactional intervention in the text of its exemplar. Crucial passages for the constitution of the text were checked against V, but V did not provide readings

[117] Paolo Trovato and others explain the very high rate of lost archetypes and two-branched stemmata by "the high (90%) rate of extinction of individual copies". See Trovato, 2017: 86.

```
          ūrdhvalakṣam  āha       ākāśe dṛṣṭiḥ karttavyā  \V
prathamaṃ urdhvalakṣaḥ  kathyate/ ākāśamadhye    dṛṣṭiḥ/  \D
prathamaṃ urdhvalakṣaḥ  kathyaṃte/ākāśamadhye    dṛṣṭiḥ// \J
prathamaṃ urdhvalakṣaḥ  kathyate/ ākāśamadhye    dṛṣṭiḥ/  \K1
prathamaṃ urdhvalakṣaḥ  kathyate/ ākāśamadhye    dṛṣṭiḥ/  \N1
prathamaṃ urdhvalakṣaḥ  kathyate/ ākāśamadhye    dṛṣṭiḥ/  \N2
prathamaṃ urdhvalakṣya/ kathyate/ ākāśamadhye    dṛṣṭiḥ/  \U1
prathamaṃ urdhvalakṣaṃ  kathyate/ ākāśamadhye    dṛṣṭiḥ   \U2
prathamam ūrdhvalakṣyaḥ kathyate/                          \P
athama    urdhalakṣaṃ           //ākāśamadhye    dṛṣṭi    \B
atha      ūrdhvalakṣaṃ          //ākāśamadhye    dṛṣṭiḥ/  \L
prathamam ūrdhvalakṣyaṃ kathyate/ ākāśamadhye    dṛṣṭiḥ/  \E

athavā//  mana  ūrdhvaṃ      kūryāt/                       \V
athavā    mana  ūrdhaṃ       kṛtvā   sthāpyate             \D
athavā    mana  ūrdhvaṃ      kṛtvā   sthāpyate//           \J
athavā//  mana  ūrdhaṃ       kṛtvā// sthāpyate            \K1
atha ca// mana  urdhvaṃ      kṛtvā   sthāpyate/           \N1
atha ca   mana  ūrdhvaṃ      kṛtvā   sthāpyate/           \N2
atha ca   manerddhvaṃ        kṛtvā   sthāpyate            \U1
atha      mana  urdhvaṃ      kṛtvā   sthāpyate//           \U2
atha ca   mana  ūrdhvaṃ      kṛtvā   sthāpyate/           \P
athavā          ūrdhvamana   kṛtvā   sthāpyate            \B
athavā          ūrdhvaṃ mana kṛtvā   sthāpyate            \L
kadā ca   mana  ūrdhvaṃ      kṛtvā   sthāpayati/          \E
```

Figure 9: A typical example of sentences in section XIV that shows how the redactor of V tried to improve upon his exemplar.

that would improve upon the reconstructed text. A collation of manuscript V would have pushed the size of the critical apparatus to unbearable extremes and was thus eliminated from the collation.

K_3, a manuscript kept in Kolkata in the Asiatic Society, would have been of interest to collate, but I was able to obtain copies of only the first 6 of its 25 folios due to a restrictive policy. Those folios contained no useful or otherwise noteworthy new variants.

I refer to the second hyparchetype as γ (B, C, E, K_2, L, P, P_2, S and U_2). This hyparchetype is more distant from the archetype but is nevertheless significant because its witnesses preserve almost the entire text with fewer *lacunae*.

The manuscripts descending from the γ-hyparchetype proved important for the reconstruction of the text, particularly in those instances in which all β-manuscripts are clearly corrupt.

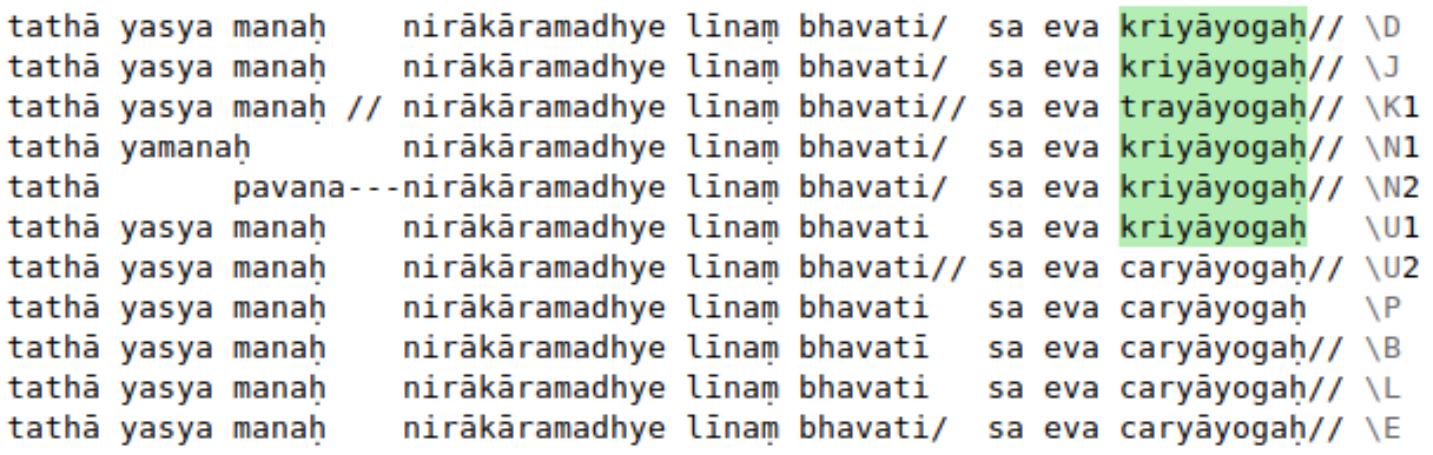


Figure 10: The image shows the end of section XVIII on Caryāyoga. The β-transmission clearly contains an early binding error and reads *kriyāyogaḥ* or *trayāyogaḥ*. The γ-transmission provides the correct reading *caryāyogaḥ*.

I eliminated C, P_2, K_2, and S, which I discovered only after submitting the dissertation. After transcribing them and thoroughly checking their variants, I found that they yielded no useful new variants for reconstructing the archetype. Although these four manuscripts occasionally offered better readings than the rest of the γ-witnesses, in each of these rare cases the same readings were already attested in the β-group. Furthermore, the critical apparatus would have grown even larger without any real benefit.

There is no detectable contamination between the β and γ-hyparchetypes, which simplifies editorial practice and makes the use of computerised stemmatics more reliable. Additional material found in γ is never present in β.

Although both groups contain numerous errors and are equally indispensable for reconstructing the archetype, the β-hyparchetype is closer to the archetype than its γ-counterpart, even once γ-interpolations are excluded. In practice, while β-readings are more often preferable, readings of one group frequently illuminate and correct corruptions in the other, and convincing emendation is often possible only by contrasting both hyparchetypes.

1.6.1.2 Microstructural observations during collation

Thus, the α-archetype splits into the β and γ-hyparchetypes. The following observations provide further details regarding the microstructure of the stemma.

β-hyparchetype: Witness N_2 is either the exemplar of N_1 or both manuscripts descend from the same exemplar because they share the same substantial *lacuna*, amounting to approximately 23.5% of the entire text. The latter scenario is more likely, as N_2 contains two sentences that are missing in N_1. I decided to collate both manuscripts, as there are occasional minor discrepancies—some of which proved helpful. Although both manuscripts still contain numerous minor errors, the process of textual reconstruction made it clear that, at least in the approximately 76.5% of the text that they preserve, they transmit, on average, the best readings; N_1 and N_2 therefore stand closest to the archetype (α) among all surviving witnesses.

```
\om                                                    \D
yadyat prayatnaniḥpādya    tattaḥ svadharmakāraṇaṃ/    \J
yadyat aprayatna niḥpādyaṃ tattat sarvam  akāraṇāṃ//   \K1
yadyat prayatnaniṣpādyaṃ   tattat sarvam  akāraṇaṃ/    \N1
yadyat prayatnaniṣpādyaṃ   tattat sarvam  na kāraṇaṃ//7//\N2
yadyat aprayatra niṣyayiṃ  tat    sarvam  akāraṇāṃ     \U1
yadyat prayatnaniḥpādyaṃ   tat    sarvaṃ  kāraṇa//     \U2
yadyat prayatnaniḥpārdhaṃ  tattat sarvam  akāraṇam     \P
yadyat prayatnaniḥpādya    tat    sarvam  akāraṇāt/    \B
yadyat prayatnaniḥpādya    tat    sarvem  ikāraṇāt//2// \L
yadyat prayatnaniḥpāyaṃ    tattat sarvam  akāraṇam//6// \E
```

Figure 11: The image shows a synoptic transcription of verse LIX.9cd. One of several instances in which N_1 and N_2 provide the best variants. Additionally, the last part shows the nature of discrepancies between the two Nepalese witnesses.

There are only three β-witnesses that transmit the text in its entirety: K_1, J, and U_1. The latter two appear to form a separate branch, and it is likely that either both derive from the same exemplar or that U_1 directly descends from J, since they share the same distinctive readings in the majority of cases, although U_1 introduces a greater number of minor scribal errors. Within this branch of the β-group, J should therefore be placed closer to the archetype than U_1. Moreover, J ranks among the best witnesses available, together with N_1, N_2, and K_1. However, in terms of its stemmatic distance from the archetype, J is somewhat more distant from the archetype than these three witnesses, though still closer than D and U_1.

Furthermore, there is considerable evidence that D and K_1 also belong to a sub-branch of β. However, a direct copying relationship can be ruled out, as D contains several specific *lacunae* that are absent in K_1. One must therefore posit at least one common exemplar from which both witnesses descend. Overall, K_1 appears to stand relatively close to the archetype, as its readings are frequently among the intrinsically strongest readings.

```
asthimadhye śākadvīpaḥ      śiromadhye   śālmalidvīpaḥ//   \D
asthimadhye śaktidvīpaḥ//   śiromadhye   śālmalidvīpaḥ//   \J
asthimadhye śākadvīpaḥ      śiromadhye   śālmalidvīpaḥ//   \K1
\om                                                        \N1
\om                                                        \N2
astimadhye  śāktidvīpaḥ     śīromadhye   śālmalidvīpaḥ     \U1
asthimadhye śākadvīpaḥ      śirāmadhye   śālmalidvīpaḥ/    \E
asthīmadhye śākadvīpaḥ      śirāmadhye   śālmalidvīpaḥ     \P
astimadhye  śākaladvīpaḥ//  śirāmadhye   śākaladvīpaḥ//   \B
astimadhye  śākaladvīpaḥ    śarīramadhye śākadvīpaḥ       \L
astimadhye  śākadvīpaḥ//    śīromadhye   śālmalīdvīpaḥ//  \U2
```

Figure 12: The image shows a synoptic transcription of a sentence in section XXXVI. One can clearly see that J and U_1 share the same variants, with U_1 producing further corruptions.

```
śarīmadhye   karmasthāne  nenekatīrthavallī vasaṃti// \D
śarīramadhye marmasthāne  naikatīrthavallī  vasaṃti// \J
śarīmadhye   karmasthāne  nenekatīrthavallī vasaṃti// \K1
\om                                                   \N1
\om                                                   \N2
śarīramadhye marmasthāne  naikatīrthavallī  vasaṃtī   \U1
śarīramadhye             'nekatīrthāvalī    vasatī//  \U2
    madhye                nekatīrthāvalī    vasaṃti/  \P
śarīramadhye              anekatīrthāvalī   vasaṃtī// \B
śarīramadhye              anekatīrthāvalī   vasaṃtī// \L
śarīramadhye              anekatīrthāni     vasaṃti/  \E
```

Figure 13: The image shows a synoptic transcription of a sentence in section XLI. One can clearly see that D and K_1 belong to the same branch.

γ-hyparchetype: Among the nine available witnesses of the γ-group is the printed edition E, which is based on a hitherto unknown manuscript.[118] The pandit editor attempted to correct poorly transmitted passages by means of *divinatio*. Unfortunately, apart from some grammatical emendations, he often failed in this endeavour.

U_2 contains a considerable amount of additional material on the nine *cakra*s. Initially, I underestimated U_2 owing to its extensive additions in sections IV–XII. When these are excluded, U_2 stands remarkably close to the

[118] After submitting the dissertation, I obtained S, which is either the exemplar of E or shares a common exemplar with it.

β-hyparchetype. On average, U_2 is the representative of the γ-hyparchetype whose readings correspond more often than all the others to those of the β-hyparchetype. The best representative of the γ-group is P, whose readings closely resemble those of K_2. However, K_2 begins only towards the end of section II, while P preserves the full text. Thus, it is unlikely that a direct genealogical relationship exists between the two manuscripts. Both can therefore be assigned to the same branch, but at least one common intermediary exemplar must be posited above them.

```
sarvāsāṃ \om                                      \D
sarvāsāṃ nijavṛttīnāṃ vismṛtiṃ bhajate tu yaḥ//  \J
sarvāsāṃ nijavṛtīnāṃ  vismṛtiṃ bhajate tu yaḥ// \K1
\om                                               \N1
\om                                               \N2
sarvāsāṃ nijavṛtīnāṃ  vismṛtiṃ bhajate tu yaḥ    \U1
sarvāsāṃ nijavṛttīnāṃ vismṛtiṃ bhajate tu yaḥ//  \U2
sarvāsāṃ nijavṛtīnāṃ  vismṛtī  bhajate tu yaḥ    \P
sarvāsāṃ bījavṛtīnāṃ  vismṛtī  bhajate tu yaḥ    \B
sarvāsāṃ bījavṛtīnāṃ  vismṛtīṃ bhajate tu yaḥ//  \L
sarvāsāṃ nijavṛttīnāṃ vismṛtīr bhajate ttu yaḥ/  \E
```

Figure 14: The image shows a synoptic transcription of verse XLIV.9ab. That is one among many instances in which U_2 is closer to the β-hyparchetype than any other witness among the γ-witnesses.

A further branch within the γ-group comprises B and L. These witnesses preserve by far the most corrupt transmission of the text. Surprisingly, in some rare cases, they provided the decisive and only convincing reading, which made their inclusion in the collation laborious but indispensable.

Overall, the γ-group is characterised by additional material in some passages, usually verse insertions that elaborate on a specific term. These were critically edited with the available witnesses and included in the grayscale, as they provide important insights into the reception history of the text. Overall, P, at only a minimal stemmatic distance from U_2 (excluding the supplementary material), appears to be the most reliable witness of the γ-group.

In light of the characteristics of both groups, and given the necessity of drawing on each of them for the reconstruction of the α-archetype, it is reasonable to assume that the root of the stemma should be placed be-

```
 \om                                              \D
anekakārabhedotthaṃ kaṃ   svarūpātmakaṃ malaṃ//7// \J
anekakārabhedochaṃ  kaṃ   svarūpātmakaṃ malaṃ////  \K1
 \om                                              \N1
 \om                                              \N2
anekakārabhedotthaṃ sva   svarūpātmakaṃ malaṃ      \U1
anekākārabhedotthaṃ kaḥ// svarūpātmakaṃ paraṃ//    \U2
anekākārabhedocchaṃ kaṃ   svarūpātmakaṃ malaṃ 7    \P
anekakārabhedochaṃ  kiṃ   svarūpātmakaṃ malaṃ//7// \B
anekakārabhedāttthaṃ kiṃ   svarūpātmakaṃ malaṃ//7// \L
anekākārabhedotthaṃ kaṃ   svarūpātmakaṃ malam/     \E
```

Figure 15: The image shows a synoptic transcription of verse XLV.1cd. That is one among rare instances in which B and L read better than the rest of the entire transmission.

tween these two groups, although its exact position was probably somewhat closer to the β-hyparchetype. In order to verify my micro- and macrostructural philological observations and to obtain measurable, statistically robust results capable of depicting the precise distances between the individual manuscripts more accurately than the human mind, the trees generated with phylogenetic software—presented in the following section—were incorporated into the analysis.

1.6.2 Computer Stemmatics applied to the *Tattvayogabindu*

For the constitution of the *stemma codicum*, all complete transcriptions of the *Tattvayogabindu* were additionally analysed using commonly employed algorithms implemented in phylogenetic software. The dataset was stored in the Nexus format. The numerous gaps in the transmission were coded as non-significant sites in the dataset to prevent the results from being distorted by the large *lacunae* or the interpolations of the γ-group, particularly manuscript U_2. The results were compared with my philological observations, and the findings of both approaches were combined to arrive at a final reconstruction. Here, I present the most useful phylogenetic trees that support and complement my philological considerations. Discrepancies between philological methods and computer-assisted stemmatics are examined and explained in detail.

This work may serve as an example of how such computer-assisted methods can be applied to stemmatic analysis in a comparatively uncomplicated transmission such as that of the *Tattvayogabindu*, in constructing a *stemma codicum* based on empirical data, combining the empirical basis of phylogenetic analysis with the expertise of the philologist.[119,120]

1.6.2.1 Tree 1 and 2: Maximum Parsimony

The phylogenetic method based on the *Maximum Parsimony* algorithm is one of the most widely used approaches for stemmatic analysis in philology.[121]

The first resulting tree (Figure 16) has a very good CI (Consistency Index) of ≈0.79. This indicates that the proposed tree structure accounts for roughly 79% of the character-state changes represented in the phylogeny. My earlier observation that the manuscripts divide into two principal groups

[119] See Guillaumin (2020: 339–356) for an overview of the criticism digital methods have faced since their inception.

[120] The main reason why the *Tattvayogabindu* constitutes a particularly suitable case for combining computer-assisted stemmatics with traditional methods of stemma construction is the absence of contamination between the β- and γ-groups. This significantly reduces the susceptibility of phylogenetic algorithms to methodological errors when applied to this tradition. As Maas (2009) has shown with regard to cladistic analysis using Maximum Parsimony, such problems typically arise from the strictly bifurcating structure of computer-generated trees. In these models, each extant textual witness is connected by exactly one branch to a single inferred ancestor, a structure that cannot adequately represent contamination within a textual tradition. Moreover, strict bifurcation fails to account for cases in which a manuscript was copied more than once and several of its descendants have survived. In cladistic trees, every extant manuscript is therefore modelled as a copy of an inferred witness, which is often inaccurate, since many textual traditions include surviving manuscripts that are direct copies of other surviving witnesses. See Maas, 2009: 80. If the editor is aware of these structural limitations, has a thorough understanding of the transmission of the text, and is familiar with the assumptions and mechanics of the applied algorithms, spurious bifurcations or contamination effects in computer-generated models can be identified. Under these conditions, phylogenetic analyses can meaningfully inform and refine the editor's philological judgement, supporting the manual construction of a plausible and empirically grounded *stemma codicum* that reflects the underlying transmission of the text as accurately as possible. In the case of the *Tattvayogabindu*, however, the aforementioned problems—particularly those related to contamination—do not play a role.

[121] *Maximum Parsimony* calculates all possible bifurcating trees and searches for the most parsimonious tree (the one requiring the fewest changes). It groups manuscripts according to their shared derived characters. Only parsimony-informative sites are considered: a site is informative if it contains more than one variant and at least two variants occur at least twice. All other sites are excluded; see Windram, Shaw, Robinson, and Howe (2008: 445–446).

served as an explicit criterion for placing the root precisely between these two branches—a division also affirmed by the *Maximum Parsimony* algorithm.

The first tree (Figure 16), however, has three weaknesses.

First, even if N_1 were a direct copy of N_2, the algorithm would be unable to detect this. This inability is due to the algorithm's strictly bifurcating assumptions, noted above.

The second weakness is reflected in the relatively low bootstrap value[122] of only 53 at the node where U_2 is positioned. In my view this arises because the character states resulting from the editorial interventions of the scribe responsible for the additional material cannot be readily accommodated by the algorithm when viewed against the remaining γ-transmission. Consequently, the position of U_2 requires careful philological consideration.

The third weakness of the tree—visible only when the display option "Branches proportional to length" is enabled—is the seemingly very short branches leading to V and U_2. This stands in striking contrast to the philological evidence. While it is indeed intriguing that the tree confirms the early divergence of the branches leading to both manuscripts, the stemmatic distance from the root must, in reality, be far greater. How is this to be explained?

It is crucial to understand that branch length here indicates only the number of character-state changes uniquely attributable to that node or taxon. It does *not* indicate, as one might initially assume, how "close" a text stands to the archetype. Rather, it reflects the number of diagnostic (synapomorphic) changes assigned to that branch. If a manuscript such as V or U_2 exhibits many idiosyncratic, unshared variants—often editorial in nature—that are exclusive to itself, i.e. *autapomorphies*, then two consequences follow. First, the

[122] Bootstrapping measures the statistical support for parts of a phylogenetic tree; see Felsenstein (1985). The method assesses whether the entire dataset supports the reconstructed tree or whether the proposed tree is merely one among several nearly equivalent alternatives. This is achieved by repeatedly resampling the dataset, constructing trees from these random subsamples, and calculating how frequently the various clades reappear. Bootstrap support is assigned according to the frequency with which a given manuscript group is recovered. A clade appearing in every subsample receives 100% support; if it appears in half of them, support is 50%. Values of 70% or higher generally indicate reliable groupings; see Baldauf (2003: 250).

Maximum Parsimony algorithm ignores autapomorphies when constructing the topology; they play no role in determining the manuscript's position within the tree. Parsimony evaluates only shared innovations. Thus, if V and U_2 represent early splits but share almost no variants with any other witness, the algorithm may place them close to the root. Second, the displayed branch lengths may remain short when most of the manuscript's changes are autapomorphic. For example, the branch of V therefore appears short, even though the text is in fact heavily altered. For this reason, in such cases it is advisable to disable the option "Branches proportional to length" (Figure 17).

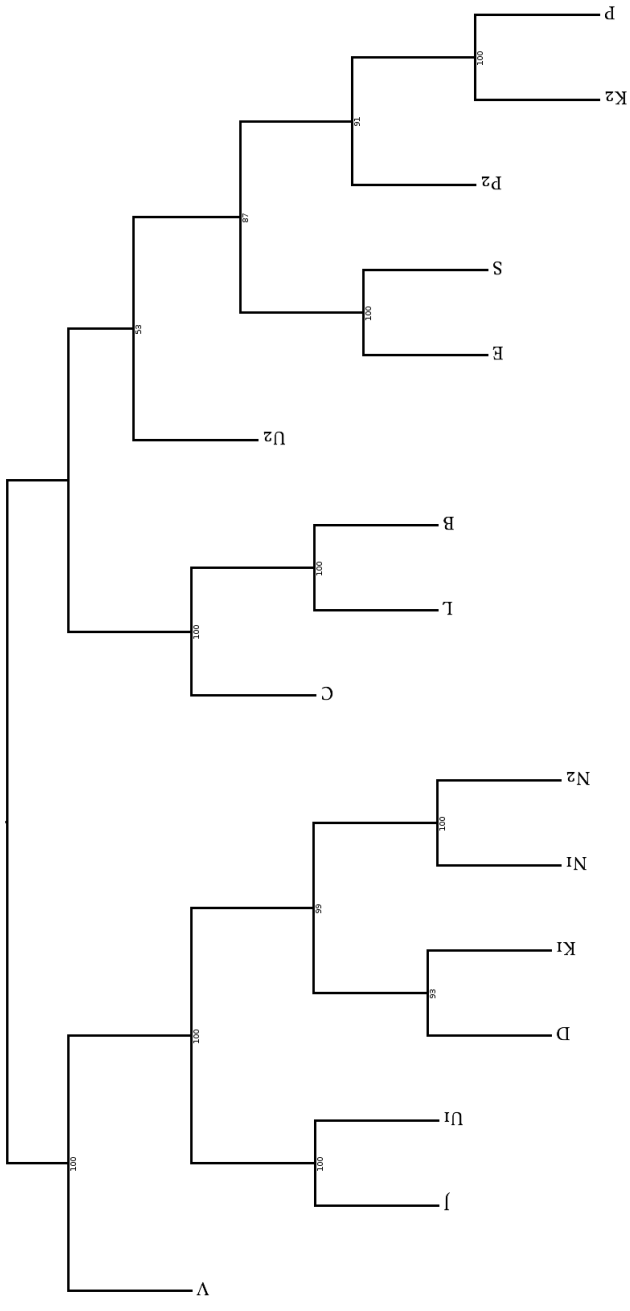


Figure 16: Generated with Mesquite Version 3.81 (build 955). **Algorithm**: *Parsimony Tree Analysis* with PAUP 4.a168. **Dataset**: Full collation of the *Tattvayogabindu*.

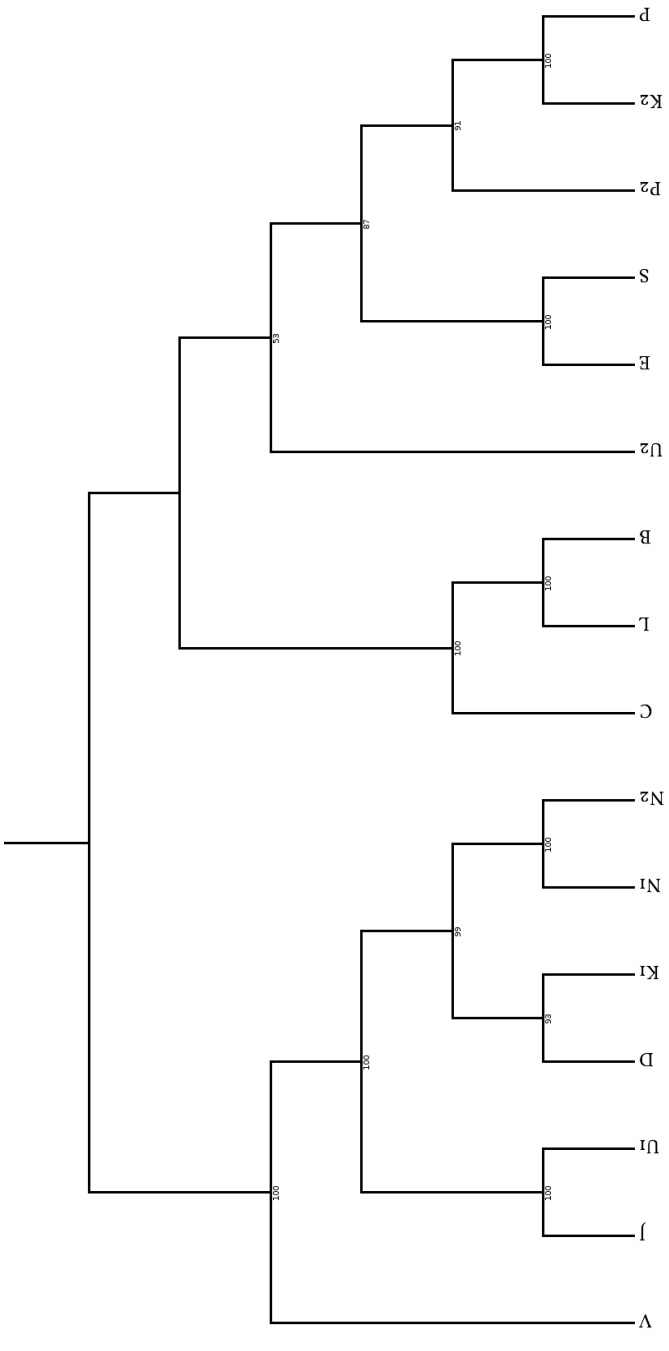


Figure 17: Generated with Mesquite Version 3.81 (build 955). **Algorithm**: *Parsimony Tree Analysis* with PAUP 4.a168. **Dataset**: Full collation of the *Tattvayogabindu*.

Apart from the weaknesses noted above, all further philological microstructural observations can be confirmed.

1.6.2.2 Tree 3, 4 and 5: Neighbour-joining

This section presents three *neighbor-joining* trees (Figure 18, 19 and 20).[123] The three trees are based on the same dataset. All spelling variations were normalised to reduce *noise*. Any gaps in the transmission were encoded as non-significant. All three trees use the p-distance, a simple measure of sequence divergence.[124] The results differ only slightly, but in my assessment, all three trees correspond to key philological observations. The first tree (Figure 18) is unrooted. The second tree (Figure 19) is rooted by the calcu-

[123] *Neighbor-joining* is a particular approach to phylogenetic analysis that SplitsTree can execute. The primary mechanism underlying this method is a hierarchical clustering technique; see Saitou and Nei, 1987. A concise explanation by the authors is as follows: "The principle of this method is to find pairs of operational taxonomic units (OTUs [= neighbours]) that minimise the total branch length at each level of clustering of OTUs starting from a star-shaped tree. The branch lengths and topology of a parsimonious tree can be quickly determined using this method." In this case, it can be visualised as follows: The algorithm is supplied with a diverse set of texts in the form of manuscript transcripts, which act as operational taxonomic units. *Neighbor-joining* divides them into smaller groups with shared features. First, the algorithm measures the distance of each possible pair of manuscripts. This distance indicates how similar or dissimilar they are with regard to specific features. Then, the algorithm finds the two manuscripts with the smallest distance between them. These are the "closest neighbours" in terms of similarity. These two individual manuscripts are then joined together to form a node. This node represents an assumed common ancestor. The algorithm then recalculates the distances between this newly created node and all other manuscripts. These distances reflect each manuscript's overall similarity or dissimilarity to the new node. The process is repeated: the algorithm identifies the next pair of nearest manuscripts or groups of manuscripts, creates the next node, and adjusts the distances. In this way, a phylogenetic tree is created. The function repeats these steps until all manuscripts and groups of manuscripts are connected in an undirected tree-like structure in which the length of the branches and the distance between the nodes represent the relationships of the manuscripts based on their similarities. Branch lengths correspond to estimated evolutionary distances. The resulting trees can vary considerably depending on how the data are coded and how gaps are treated. The application of *neighbor-joining* to support philological work is discussed by Hoenen, Manafzadeh, Stadler, Roos, Hoenen, and Guillaumin (2020: 319).

[124] The "Uncorrected P" or p-distance calculates the proportion of nucleotide or amino acid sites at which two sequences differ. The calculation of Uncorrected P is simple. The number of differing sites is divided by the total number of sites compared; see Huson and Bryant, 2022: 46.

lated midpoint.[125] The three trees correspond very closely to the macro- and microstructural philological observations. In contrast to the *Maximum Parsimony* analysis (see above), the pronounced divergence of V within the β-group and of U_2 in the γ-group is clearly corroborated. While the unrooted tree leaves open whether the β or γ-hyparchetype lies closer to the root, i.e., the archetype, the midpoint-rooted tree is consistent with my observation that the β-hyparchetype is overall closer to the archetype than γ. The first tree (Figure 18) additionally displays its bootstrap scores, which provide strong statistical support for the depicted structure. The final tree (Figure 20) depicts the unrooted *neighbor-joining* tree in a display mode that more closely resembles a traditional *stemma codicum*.

[125] Midpoint rooting is a computational method used to assign a root to an unrooted phylogenetic tree or network by identifying the pair of taxa separated by the greatest patristic distance (i.e., the longest distance across the tree when branch lengths are considered). The algorithm then places the root at the midpoint of the longest path, effectively splitting it into two halves. This procedure does not rely on external outgroup information but instead assumes that evolutionary rates are approximately clock-like across the tree; under this assumption, the longest path is taken to represent the deepest divergence, and its midpoint provides a plausible estimate of the root. SplitsTree implements this procedure by first computing all pairwise distances among taxa, locating the pair with the maximal separation, and then inserting the root at the exact point along their connecting path where the distances to each side are equal.

Figure 18: Generated with SplitsTree App version 6.3.12. **Algorithm**: *Neighbor-joining* (unrooted). **Distance**: Uncorrected P. **Dataset**: Full collation of the *Tattvayogabindu*.

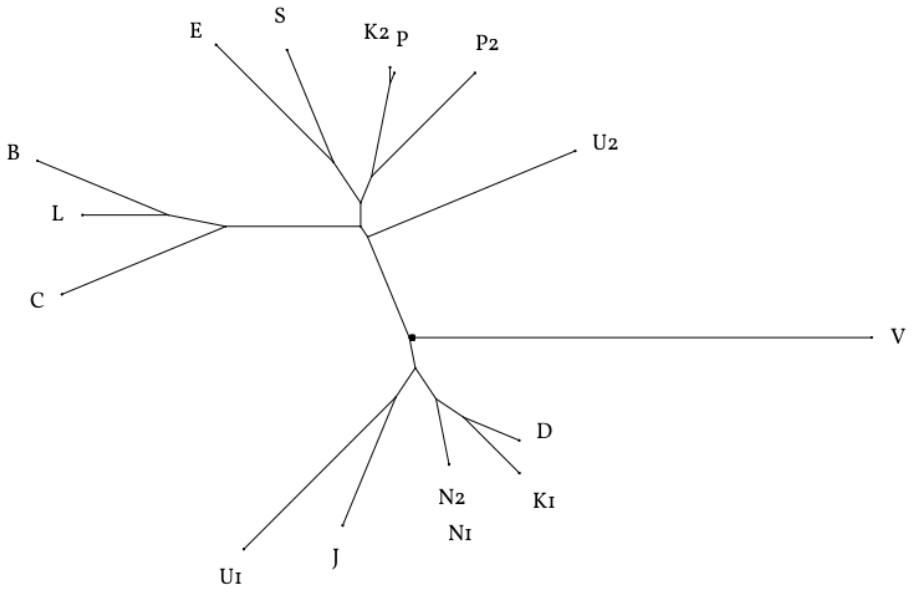


Figure 19: Generated with SplitsTree App version 6.3.12. **Algorithm**: *Neighbor-joining* (root by MidPoint, the little dot at the central line marks the root). **Distance**: Uncorrected P. **Dataset**: Full collation of the *Tattvayogabindu*.

Figure 20: Generated with SplitsTree App version 6.3.12. **Algorithm**: *Neighbor-joining* (root by MidPoint, the little dot at the central line marks the root). **Distance**: Uncorrected P. **Dataset**: Full collation of the *Tattvayogabindu*. Bootstrapping with 1000 replicates.

1.6.2.3 Tree 3: Minimum Spanning Tree

Another vital aspect is illustrated by the *Minimum Spanning Tree* (Figure 21).[126] Interestingly, the *Minimum Spanning Tree* may be useful for identifying particularly central manuscripts because of its algorithmic properties. In our case, it highlights the central manuscripts of the two groups, namely N_2 for the β-group and P for the γ-group, which accords closely with my philological observations. The *Minimum Spanning Tree* algorithm has only rarely been used in philology. Further experiments with different textual traditions whose stemmata are independently known would be necessary to determine whether comparable results can be obtained consistently.

[126]The algorithm underlying the *Minimum Spanning Tree* calculates an undirected and unrooted tree-shaped graph representing the simplest way to connect all the manuscripts by minimising the total weight of the edges based on their pairwise distances; see e.g. Hoenen, Manafzadeh, Stadler, Roos, Hoenen, and Guillaumin (2020: 317). Also see Cormen, Leierson, Rivest, and Stein (2009). Furthermore, see Huson and Bryant (2022: 43). The goal of the *Minimum Spanning Tree* is to connect all manuscripts in such a way that the total length of the connections is minimised. The *Minimum Spanning Tree* thus, in our use case, represents the simplest way to connect a set of manuscripts while minimising the total distance of the connections based on their textual differences. The resulting tree should not be understood as a stemma and does not include hypothetical ancestral nodes at branching points; every branching point shown corresponds to an extant manuscript.

Figure 21: Generated with SplitsTree App 6.3.12. Algorithm: *Minimum Spanning Tree*. Distance: Uncorrected P. **Dataset**: Full collation of the *Tattvayogabindu*.

1.6.2.4 Stemma codicum

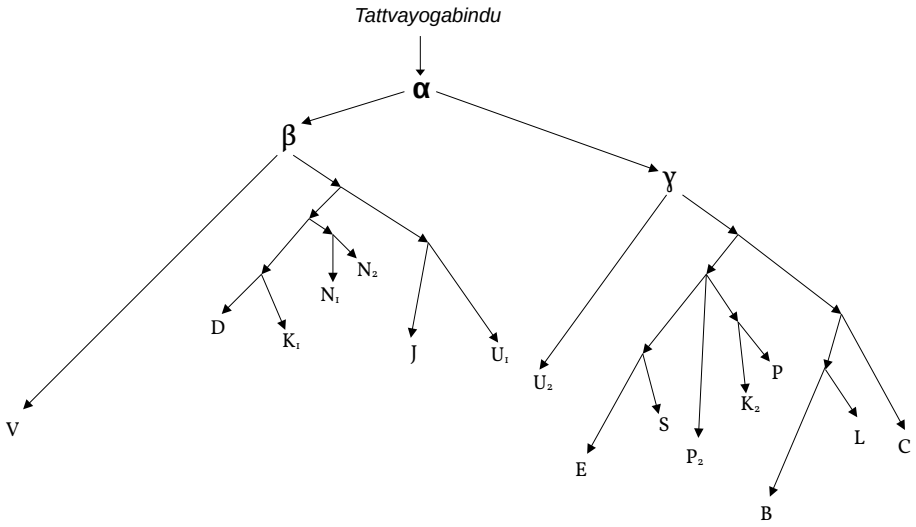


Figure 22: Stemmatic hypothesis of the *Tattvayogabindu*.

The cumulative evidence from the phylogenetic algorithms, combined with the philological analysis, leads to the following *stemma codicum* (Figure 22) of the *Tattvayogabindu*. This graph represents a plausible hypothesis of the relationships between the textual witnesses based on the current state of knowledge. This reconstruction forms the foundation upon which the critical edition presented in this study was prepared.

1.7 Conventions for the critical edition

To facilitate consultation, the critical edition with its apparatus and the translation with annotations are presented on facing pages. This arrangement eliminates the need for constant page-turning when consulting the edition, translation, and annotations. While this format offers a significant advantage, it also presents a challenge: the length of the critical

edition, including the multi-register critical apparatus on the verso page, does not always match the length of the translation and annotations on the recto page. Despite efforts to minimise this discrepancy, for example by shortening annotations, leaving empty space on one or both pages was often unavoidable.[127]

The constituted text of the critical edition has been set in modern Devanāgarī, reflecting the vast majority of manuscripts and presumably also the script of the original text of the *Tattvayogabindu*. I introduced the headings and section numbering in large Roman numerals within square brackets to organise the text, mark the beginning of new topics clearly, and facilitate citation. These headings correspond to the sections introduced in the text by recognisable phrases such as *atha*, *idānīṃ*, and the like. Rāmacandra did not distinguish between chapters, subchapters, sections, and subsections but instead linked themes by means of these phrases. The headings in square brackets follow this convention. Verse numbering is organised by section, with the verses numbered consecutively within each section.

The verses have been organised and structured in accordance with the conventions of modern printed editions of metrical Sanskrit texts. Beyond the introduction of section headings, however, I have refrained from subdividing the prose passages into indented paragraphs, as such divisions would constitute an additional interpretative intervention not attested in the sources. This decision aims to preserve the original textual continuity and

[127] This undertaking was laborious, and due to the complexity of the critical apparatus and the evolving technology used in this work, each page had to be manually typeset. This manual process could not achieve the precision that fully automated typesetting would provide. I decided to typeset the critical edition with the LuaLaTeXpackage "ekdosis," see https://ctan.org/pkg/ekdosis. Ekdosis allows the creation of multilingual critical editions with a multi-level critical apparatus and a printable PDF document. The primary reason for this choice is that the entire edition is also output as a TEI-compliant XML file. This file can then be converted automatically into an HTML file, i.e., a digital edition (which I hope to publish soon for the *Tattvayogabindu*), using a script and an XSLT processor, facilitating computer-aided stemmatic analysis, data mining, and similar tasks. I would like to thank Robert Alessi for his invaluable support. I hope that ekdosis, which holds great potential for philologists seeking to leverage digital humanities, will continue to be developed and enable automatic page breaks for a complex multi-layered critical apparatus in an alignment environment with facing pages containing the translation and annotations. I hope some readers will appreciate the effort made to provide the convenience of not having to flip between the edition, translation, and annotations in my edition.

character of the work. Moreover, the prose sections are often so brief that further paragraphisation would in many cases serve little practical purpose.

Among the text's witnesses, the application of *sandhi* varies considerably and inconsistently. For the edited text, I have standardised *sandhi* and, when necessary, supplied *avagraha*s to produce a readable text conforming to contemporary Sanskrit editorial conventions. Variant readings concerning *sandhi* are consistently recorded in the apparatus criticus. This is necessary because of various text-critical problems[128] arising from the inconsistent use of punctuation, which results in the application or non-application of *sandhi* depending on whether the respective witness has a *daṇḍa* at the relevant point. This is particularly the case in lists, which occur frequently in the work. The individual items were most likely originally separated by double *daṇḍa*s.

These lists are a frequent feature of the *Tattvayogabindu*. The text opens with a list of 15 Yogas, and many further lists occur throughout the work. In order to produce a consistent and easily readable edition, lists have been normalised to the nominative singular or plural of the respective item, or, in the case of explanatory lists, to the ablative singular or plural. The items in the lists are always separated by a double *daṇḍa* (‖).

The critical edition follows, whenever possible, standard conventions of punctuation. In verse poetry, a *daṇḍa* (|) marks the end of half a stanza, i.e., two quarters of a *śloka*, and a double *daṇḍa* (‖) marks the end of a verse. In prose, a single *daṇḍa* indicates either the boundary of a subordinate clause or the end of a sentence, while a double *daṇḍa* marks the end of a section. Thus, in most cases, the *daṇḍa* in prose corresponds functionally to either a comma or a full stop.

The reader will observe that the critically established text employs *daṇḍa*s with comparatively high frequency. Since, however, these punctuation

[128] The inconsistent use of punctuation marks in the available witnesses necessitates standardisation. Upon close examination, it appears that punctuation has frequently been dropped or added during the transmission of the text. The copyists' neglect or inconsistent handling of punctuation has resulted in different versions of lists with and without punctuation. In many instances, missing punctuation has led to changes in case endings, alterations to the text, and the combination of list items into compound formations that were not present in the original text.

marks are attested with similarly high frequency in virtually all manuscripts representing both hyparchetypes, their prevalence can hardly be regarded as a secondary feature confined to a particular branch of the transmission. Rather, the agreement of the two branches strongly suggests that this usage can already be assigned to the archetype reconstructed in the present edition. Accordingly, the *daṇḍa*s have been retained in the constituted text, insofar as the aim of the edition is to reconstruct a textual form that stands closer to the lost original than any single surviving witness.

Furthermore, I have standardised the gemination and degemination of consonants after semivowels. Due to the inconsistent use of class nasals among the witnesses, *anusvāra*s have been replaced with the corresponding class nasals throughout the edition.

1.7.1 Grammatical particularities

Grammatical constructions in this text occasionally depart from the norms of Classical Sanskrit. In most cases, however, their frequency suggests that they should not be regarded as errors but rather as features of contemporary or regional usage. In a number of passages, the genitive is employed in place of other cases.[129] Several relative constructions begin with *yasya*, which is to be understood as *yasmin*, since the corresponding correlative pronoun would otherwise be lacking. In such relative constructions, a *daṇḍa* must also frequently be interpreted as functioning as a comma.

1.7.2 Guide to the apparatus

The critical apparatus consists of five registers, not all of which are filled on each page. These registers contain sources, testimonia, parallels, the critical apparatus with readings of the witnesses, and notes. To help the reader distinguish between sources, testimonia, and parallels, these are identified as such on each page on which they occur. Sources, testimonia, and parallel passages are cited diplomatically. Orthographical, grammatical, and scribal

[129] Whitney 1879: 87, 294.

irregularities have not been emended, as they may be relevant for assessing textual transmission and manuscript affiliation.

The numbering of all registers of the apparatus and their lemmata follows the line numbering of the text. This applies to both prose passages and verses. Every line is counted, and every fifth line of the text is numbered on the far left margin. The numbering is bold and blue to aid the reader's navigation in the apparatus. When present, the first register of the apparatus displays the source texts. It should be noted that Rāmacandra does not adopt the sources verbatim but often converts verses into prose and occasionally adds or omits information according to his agenda. When Rāmacandra incorporates verses, he usually makes editorial changes. According to the schema, variants in the source texts are indicated in round brackets following the affected word.

In the second register, if available, testimonia are recorded. In the third register, if available, parallel passages that are helpful or informative for the reconstruction of the text are noted. All texts used in these first three registers are consistently cited. If these texts are only available in manuscript form, the entry begins with the title, followed by an abbreviation of the holding institution and the manuscript number in round brackets (e.g., MMPP 2244, f. 99r l. 1–2). When a passage from a source, testimonium, or parallel is identical to the edited text, it is preceded by the equal sign (=). The approximate sign (≈) is used instead when the passage corresponds only approximately.

The fourth register contains the critical apparatus. The critical apparatus is positive. Each lemma begins with the corresponding line number, followed by the selected reading. The selected reading is followed by one or more sigla of witnesses that attest this reading. The closing square bracket separates this from the rejected variants. These are presented with the reading followed by the relevant siglum or sigla. The selected reading is always highlighted in bold. The abbreviation "cett." has been introduced to keep the critical apparatus concise. It stands for the Latin *ceteri*, literally meaning "the others," and refers to all other witnesses except those named for each lemma. This entry can appear only once per lemma. Here is an example:

indriyavikāraḥ cett.] iṃdriyaṃ vīkāraḥ P iti vikāraḥ L

When the selected reading results from an emendation (em.) or a conjecture (conj.), the corresponding abbreviation appears instead of a witness, a group of witnesses (β or γ), or the *ceteri* (cett.) abbreviation before the square bracket. If the emendation or conjecture is attributed to a colleague, the colleague's surname is printed before the abbreviation. If the reasoning behind the conjecture is not self-explanatory, it is explained in the annotations. The plus sign (+) represents illegible or missing letters due to manuscript damage. Given the manageable number of textual witnesses, I recorded all variants in the critical apparatus, except for those stemming purely from scribal conventions (e.g., substitution of class nasals by *anusvāra*, gemination/degemination of consonants). Thus, if one manuscript reads °tatva° and another °tattva°, only the latter (standard) spelling is reported for both, since this does not constitute a meaningful variant.

If words or sentences are omitted (om.), this is always noted in the corresponding entry before the respective siglum. However, in cases of larger *lacunae*, such as the *lacunae* in N_1 and N_2, which encompass 23.50% of the total text, I have opted not to record each omission in the apparatus for the sake of a more concise critical apparatus. I have documented these cases in the final register of the apparatus, which indicates the beginning and end of larger gaps in the respective witness and notes that the extensive *lacunae* in the relevant section are not recorded individually in the critical apparatus. In addition to information concerning omissions, the final register also contains information about transpositions of passages and other such details. According to the conventions of recent publications of critical editions of Yoga texts[130], the lemmata in the critical apparatus, as well as all sources, testimonia, and parallels, are set in Roman transliteration.

The selected reading is given first, followed by the rejected variants. These are arranged in accordance with the stemma. Where several witnesses attest the same reading, their sigla are arranged according to their stemmatic affiliation and fixed order within the respective group.

[130] See, for example, Mallinson and Szántó, 2021; Powell, 2023; or Birch, 2024.

1.7.3 Guide to the translation and annotations

The translation is presented parallel to the critical edition on the recto side of the book. In the translations, I have endeavoured to reflect the style of the Sanskrit text. Thus, I have sought to strike a balance between literal and idiomatic translation. Verse insertions have been numbered according to the numbering of the sections and clearly marked as such. When the translation of a particular word depends on a secondary or tertiary meaning, and the significance is not immediately apparent, the Sanskrit term is given in round brackets. Sanskrit technical terms or proper names have not been translated into English. Technical terms with various possible translations, whose meaning can only be discerned in the context of the entire text, are printed in Sanskrit but accompanied by a translation in round brackets. English words added to facilitate the translation or provide contextual information that was not immediately evident are integrated into the translation in square brackets. The footnotes discuss textual issues, provide additional information, explain technical terms, or highlight important or interesting parallels to other texts.

In the translation I occasionally introduce paragraph breaks that are not marked as such in the Sanskrit text. This is intentional. Sanskrit manuscripts and traditional editions generally do not employ paragraphing in the same way as modern European texts. Introducing paragraphs in the translation serves to clarify the structure and argument for the reader and to make the text more accessible. Since the translation is an interpretative act, it may diverge in its layout from the edited Sanskrit text.

1.7.4 Abbreviations and signs

+ one illegible character; ++ indicates one illegible *akṣara*

† marks the beginning and end of a corrupted and hitherto unreconstructable passage

= passage or verse is identical

≈ passage or verse is similar

AS Asiatic Society Kolkata (former RASB = Royal Asiatic Society of Bengal)

BORI Bhandakar Oriental Research Institute (Pune)
conj. conjecture
CSS Sanskrit Manuscripts of Candra Shum Shere
Ed. Edition
em. emendation
et seqq. et sequentia ("and those following")
f. folio
ff. folios
GOML Government Oriental Manuscript Library (Chennai)
HVVRI Hoshiarpur Vishveshvarananda Vedic Research Institute
IFP French Institute of Pondicherry
IGNCA Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts (Delhi)
illeg. illegible
JNUL Jawaharlal Nehru University Library
l. line
ll. lines
Ms. Manuscript
Mss. Manuscripts
Ms. No. Manuscript number
MMPP Maharaja Man Singh Pustak Prakash Research Centre
NCC New Catalogus Catalogorum
NGMCP Nepalese German Manuscript Cataloguing Project
NGMPP Nepalese German Manuscript Preservation Projecti
NWS Nachtragswörterbuch des Sanskrit
NUL Nagpur University Library
OBL Oxford Bodleian Library
OI MSU Oriental Institute, The Maharaja Sayajirao University of Baroda (Vadodara)
ORI Oriental Research Institute (Mysore)

ORIS	Oriental Research Institute (Srinagar)
pc	post correctionem
PULL	Panjab University Library Lahore
r.	recto
ŚKD	*Śabdakalpadruma*
SSP	*Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*
SORI	Scindia Oriental Research Institute Vikram University (Ujjain)
unm.	unmetrical
vol.	volume
vols.	volumes
v.	verso
YK	*Yogakarṇikā*
TYB	*Tattvayogabindu*
YSv	*Yogasvarodaya*

1.7.5 Sigla in the critical apparatus

- β: D, J, K_1, N_1, N_2, U_1
- γ: B, E, L, P, U_2
- B : Bodleian Oxford D 4587
- G : *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* GOML Ms. No. R 3239
- G_{pc} : *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* GOML Ms. No. R 3239
- cett.: ceteri (all manuscripts except the ones mentioned in the lemma)
- D_1: IGNCA 30019
- E : Printed Edition
- J : JNUL Ms. No. 55769
- Jo : *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* MMPP MS. No. 2244
- K_1: AS G 11019
- L : Lalchand Research Library LRL5876
- M : *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* ORIM Ms. No. B 220

- N_2: NGMPP B 38-35 / A 1327-14
- N_1: NGMPP B 38-31
- P : Pune BORI 664
- PT : *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*
- U_1: SORI 1574
- U_2: SORI 6082
- V : OI MSU 10558
- YK : *Yogakarṇikā*
- YSv : *Yogasvarodaya*

Chapter 2

The *Tattvayogabindu* of Rāmacandra

Critical Edition and Annotated Translation

[I. **rājayogaprakāraḥ**]

श्रीगणेशाय नमः ॥
अथ राजयोगप्रकारो लिख्यते।
राजयोगस्येदं फलं येन राजयोगेनानेकराज्यभोगसमय एव। अनेकपार्थिवविनोद–
प्रेक्षणसमय एव। बहुतरकालं शरीरस्थितिर्भवति। स एव राजयोगः।
तस्यैते भेदाः।

क्रियायोगः १॥ ज्ञानयोगः २॥ चर्यायोगः ३॥ हठयोगः ४॥ कर्मयोगः ५॥ ल–
ययोगः ६॥ ध्यानयोगः ७॥ मन्त्रयोगः ८॥ लक्ष्ययोगः ९॥ वासनायोगः १०॥
शिवयोगः ११॥ ब्रह्मयोगः १२॥ अद्वैतयोगः १३॥ सिद्धयोगः १४॥ राजयोगः
१५॥ एते पञ्चदशयोगाः॥

Sources: 2–6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 831): atha rājayogaḥ ‖ yogasvarodaye | īśvara uvāca | rājayogaṃ pravakṣyāmi śṛṇu sarvatra siddhidam | guhyād guhyataraṃ devi nānādharmaṃ parāt param rājayogena deveśi nṛpapūjyo bhaven naraḥ | rājayogī cirāyuś ca aṣṭaiśvaryamayo bhavet ‖ 8–11 cf. YSv (PT, p. 831): pañcadaśaprakāro 'yaṃ rājayogaḥ ‖ kriyāyogo jñānayogaḥ karmayogo haṭhas tathā | dhyānayogo mantrayoga urayogaś ca vāsanā | rājaty etad brahmavaśīva ebhiś ca pañcadaśadhā | idānīṃ lakṣaṇañ caiṣāṃ kathayāmi śṛṇu priye |

Parallels: 8–11 cf. *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 2): nididhyāsanañ caikatānatādirūpo rājayogāparaparyāyaḥ samādhiḥ | tatsādhanaṃ tu kriyāyogaḥ, caryāyogaḥ, karmayogo, haṭhayogo, mantrayogo, jñānayogaḥ, advaitayogo, lakṣyayogo, brahmayogaḥ, śivayogaḥ, siddhiyogo, vāsanāyogo, layayogo, dhyānayogaḥ, premabhaktiyogaś ca |

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2 **śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ** cett.] śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ ‖ śrīgurave namaḥ ‖ N_1, śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ ‖ śrīsarasvatyai namaḥ ‖ śrīnirañjanāya namaḥ ‖ DK_1, śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ ‖ śrīgurubhyo namaḥ ‖ oṃ namaḥ śrīvāsudevāya ‖ oṃ niraṃjanāya ‖ J, śrīgaṇeśāya namaḥ ‖ oṃ śrīniraṃjanāya ‖ U_1, śrīṇeyamaḥ P 3 **atha rājayogaprakāro likhyate** $N_2N_1DK_1J$] atha rājayogaprakāra likhyate U_1, atha rājayoga liṣyate P, atha rājayoga likhyate U_2, rājayogāntargataḥ ‖ binduyogaḥ E, atha tattvabiṃduyogaprāraṃbhaḥ L 4 **rājayogasyedaṃ phalaṃ** PU_2] rājayogasya idaṃ phalaṃ $N_2N_1DK_1J$, *om.* EL °**yogenāneka°** N_1P] °yogena aneka° $N_2DK_1JU_1U_2$ 5 °**prekṣaṇasamaya** cett.] °prekṣyaṇasamaya U_2 **eva** cett.] evaṃ U_2 **rājayogaḥ** cett.] rājayogas U_2 6 **tasyaite** PU_2] tasya ete cett. 8 **caryāyogaḥ** cett.] tvaryāyogaḥ U_1 8–9 **layayogaḥ** cett.] nayayogaḥ U_2 9 **lakṣyayogaḥ** cett.] lakṣayogaḥ JU_1 10 **siddhayogaḥ** PU_2] rājayogaḥ β **rājayogaḥ** PU_2] siddhayogaḥ cett. 11 **ete pañcadaśayogāḥ** cett.] evaṃ paṃcadaśāyogā bhavaṃti U_2

[I. **Method of Rājayoga**]

Homage to the glorious Gaṇeśa.

Now, the method of Rājayoga is laid down.

This is the fruit of Rājayoga: Through Rājayoga, the long-term durability of the body arises even when there is the manifold enjoyment of political power [and] even when there is manifold royal entertainment and spectacle.[131] That alone is Rājayoga.
These are the varieties [of Rājayoga]:

1. Kriyāyoga ("Yoga of [mental] action"); **2.** Jñānayoga ("Yoga of gnosis"); **3.** Caryāyoga ("Yoga of conduct");[132] **4.** Haṭhayoga ("Yoga of force"); **5.** Karmayoga ("Yoga of deeds"); **6.** Layayoga ("Yoga of absorption"); **7.** Dhyānayoga ("Yoga of meditation"); **8.** Mantrayoga ("Yoga of mantra"); **9.** Lakṣyayoga ("Yoga of foci"); **10.** Vāsanāyoga ("Yoga of mental residues"); **11.** Śivayoga ("Yoga of Śiva"); **12.** Brahmayoga ("Yoga of Brahman"); **13.** Advaitayoga ("Yoga of non-duality"); **14.** Siddhayoga ("Yoga of the Siddhas"); **15.** Rājayoga ("Yoga for kings").[133] These are the fifteen yogas.[134]

[131] This unique definition of Rājayoga hints at an exceptionally wealthy lifestyle of Rāmacandra's audience.

[132] The first three yogas invite comparison with the familiar Śaiva categories of *kriyā*, *caryā*, *jñāna*, and *yoga*; cf. Goodall, Sanderson, and Isaacson, 2015: 77.

[133] For this meaning of Rājayoga, see Birch, 2014: 12.

[134] The definitive source of the list of the fifteen yogas presented at the beginning of the text is uncertain. Rāmacandra's text is largely based on the content and structure of the *Yogasvarodaya* (YSv) as quoted in *Prāṇatoṣinī* (Ed. pp. 831–858). In this text, however, the list is incomplete. YSv mentions a total of fifteen yogas but names only eight subcategories of Rājayoga. Rāmacandra may therefore have felt the need to complete the list. The other source he used for compiling his text is *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* (SSP), which does not present such a list. Nārāyaṇatīrtha presents an almost identical list in his *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*. A comparable list of twelve yogas occurs in Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*. A detailed investigation of the fifteen yogas is presented from p. 303 onwards.

[II. **kriyāyogasya lakṣaṇam**]

इदानीं क्रियायोगस्य लक्षणं कथ्यते।

क्रियामुक्तिरयं योगः स्वपिण्डे सिद्धिदायकः।
यं यं करोति कल्लोलं कार्यारंभे मनः सदा।
तत्तदाकुञ्चनं कुर्वन्क्रियायोगस्ततो भवेत्॥ II.1॥

क्षमाविवेकवैराग्यं शान्तिसन्तोषनिस्पृहाः।
एतद्युक्तियुतो योऽसौ क्रियायोगी निगद्यते॥ II.2॥

मात्सर्यं ममता माया हिंसाशा मदगर्वता।
कामक्रोधौ भयं लज्जा लोभमोहौ तथाशुचिः॥ II.3॥

रागद्वेषौ घृणालस्यं भ्रान्तिर्दंभोऽक्षमा भ्रमः।
यस्यैतानि न विद्यन्ते क्रियायोगी स उच्यते॥ II.4॥

Sources: 3–4 ≈YSv (PT, p. 831): kriyāmuktimayo (*kriyāmuktir ayaṃ* YK 1.209) yogaḥ sapiṇḍisiddhidāyakaḥ (*sapiṇḍe* YK 1.210) | yat kāromīti (*karomīti* YK 1.210) saṅkalpaṃ kāryārambhe manaḥ sadā ‖ 5 ≈YSv (PT, p. 831): tatsāṅgācaraṇaṃ (*°saṅgā°* YK 1.210) kurvan kriyāyogarato bhavet | 6–7 = YSv (PT, p. 831): kṣamāvivekavairāgyaśāntisantoṣanispṛhāḥ | etan muktiyuto yo 'sau (*muktiyutaś cāsau* YK 1.211) kriyāyogo nigadyate | 8–9 = YSv (PT, p. 831): mātsaryaṃ mamatā māyā hiṃsā ca madagarvitā | kāmaḥ krodho bhayaṃ lajjā lobho mohas tathā 'śuciḥ (*°śuciḥ* YK 1.212) ‖ 10–11 = YSv (PT, p. 831): rāgadveṣau ghṛṇālasyaśrāntidambhakṣamābhramāḥ (*ghṛṇālasyaṃ bhrāntir dambho 'kṣamā bhramaḥ* YK 1.213) | yasyai tāni na vidyante kriyāyogī sa ucyate ‖

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2 **idānīṃ** cett.] idānī N_2, atha U_2 **kriyāyogasya** cett.] kriyāyogas U_2 **kathyate** cett.] kathayate D, *om.* U_2 3 **kriyāmuktir** cett.] kriyāmukti N_2, kriyāmuktiḥ ‖ U_2 **ayaṃ** cett.] layaṃ N_2 **siddhidāyakaḥ** cett.] siddhidāyakaṃ U_2 5 **tat tad** Mallinson em.] tattataḥ $N_2N_1DK_1P$, taṃ kataṃ J, taṃ kṛtaṃ U_1, tatas tataḥ U_2 **ākuñcanaṃ** Mallinson em.] kūrcanaṃ N_2, kuñcanaṃ $N_1DK_1JU_1PU_2$ **tato bhavet** PU_2] ato bhava N_2N_1DJ, ato ++va U_1 6 **°viveka°** cett.] vivekaṃ U_2E **vairāgyaṃ** cett.] vairāgya° JU_1 **°nispṛhāḥ** PU_2] °nispṛhā N_2N_1E, °nispṛhaḥ D, °niḥpṛhī J, °niṣpṛhī U_1 7 **etad** JU_1PE] etat $N_2N_1DK_1U_2$ **yuktiyuto** cett.] muktiyuto U_2 **yo 'sau** $N_2K_1JU_1$] yogī N_1DPU_2E 8 **mātsaryaṃ** U_1U_2E] mātsarya N_1DK_1JP **hiṃsāśā** cett.] hiṃsāḥ ‖ *unm.* N_1, hiṃsā ca E 9 **°krodhau** U_1U_2] °krodho N_2DJ, °krodha° N_1PE **śuciḥ** $N_2K_1U_2E$] 'śuciḥ N_1DJU_1P 10 **rāgadveṣau** cett.] rāgadoṣau U_1, atha dveṣo L **ghṛṇā°** cett.] ghṛṇā° N_2 **bhraṃtir daṃbho** cett.] bhrāṃtir debho D, bhrāṃtir dabho K_1, bhrāṃtir daṃbhā J, bhrāṃti daṃbha° U_1, bhrāntitvaṃ E **'kṣamā bhramaḥ** cett.] kṣamā bhrasaḥ K_1, kṣamī bhramaḥ JU_1, mokṣam ābhramaḥ E 11 **yasyaitāni** cett.] yathaitāni J **na** cett.] ca E

Notes: 6 **kṣamā°**: E begins here. **rāga°**: L starts here.

[II. **Characteristics of Kriyāyoga**]

Now, the characteristic of Kriyāyoga is described.[135,136]

II.1 This yoga is liberation through [mental] action. It bestows success (*siddhi*) in one's own body. Whatever wave the mind creates at the commencement of an action, through constantly restraining that very [wave] Kriyāyoga arises.

II.2 Patience, discrimination, equanimity, peace, modesty, desirelessness: the one endowed with these means is said to be a Kriyāyogī.

II.3 Envy, selfishness, cheating, violence, expectation, intoxication and pride, lust, anger, fear, laziness, greed, error, and impurity, …

II.4 … attachment and aversion, disgust and laziness, error, deceit, envy and confusion: Whoever does not experience these is called a Kriyāyogī.

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[135] For a comparative analysis of the various forms of Kriyāyoga in texts containing complex yoga taxonomies, see p. 318 et seqq.

[136] The most famous mention of the term *kriyāyoga* appears in *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* or *Yogasūtra* 2.1 where it is defined as: *tapaḥsvādhyāyeśvarapraṇidhānāni kriyāyogaḥ* ‖ 2.1 ‖ See Mukerji, 1983: 113. According to the introduction of this *sūtra* in the *Vyāsabhāṣya*, Kriyāyoga is presented as a means by which someone with a distracted mind can attain yoga (*vyutthitacitto 'pi yogayuktaḥ*). Yoga, which for Patañjali is *samādhi*, shall be achieved by the three elements of Kriyāyoga, namely mental, moral, and physical austerity (*tapas*), repetition of *mantra*s or study of sacred literature (*svadhyāya*) and surrender to god (*īśvarapraṇidhāna*). This trinity of means is supposed to destroy the impurities (*kleśa*s) of *citta*. These are given in *Pātanjalayogaśāstra* 2.3 as ignorance (*avidyā*), egoism (*asmitā*), attachment (*rāga*), aversion (*dveṣa*) and the urge to live (*abhiniveśa*), see Mukerji, 1983: 116. The three major terms of Patañjali's Kriyāyoga are absent in the *Tattvayogabindu*. Nevertheless, the individual elements of the *kleśa*s, along with the aim to reduce these in the yogi's mind, can also be found in the *Tattvayogabindu*. In his commentary on the *Pātanjalayogaśāstra*, titled *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Nārāyaṇatīrtha, who, like Rāmacandra, uses a very similar list of fifteen yogas, presents Kriyāyoga as the first item on his list and explains its purpose as the generation of *samādhi* and the reduction of *kleśas*, cf. Vimala, 2000: 71.

यस्यान्तःकरणे क्षमाविवेकवैराग्यशान्तिसंतोष इत्यादीनि निरंतरमुत्पाद्यन्ते स एव बहुक्रियायोगी कथ्यते। कापट्यं मायावित्वं हिंसा तृष्णा मात्सर्यं अहंकारः रोषो भयं लज्जा लोभो मोहा अशुचित्वं रागो द्वेष आलस्यं पाषण्डित्वं भ्रान्तिरिन्द्रिय–विकारः कामः। एते यस्य मनसि प्रतिदिनं न्यूना भवन्ति स एव बहुक्रियायोगी कथ्यते॥

[III. **rājayogasya bhedāḥ**]

इदानीं राजयोगस्य भेदाः कथ्यन्ते। के ते। एकः सिद्धकुण्डलिनीयोगः मन्त्रयोगः।

Sources: 7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 831): jñānayogaṃ pravakṣyāmi tajjñānī śivatāṃ vrajet |

Testimonia: 3–5 ≈*Yogasaṃgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 2v. ll. 1–2): lobhamohau aśucitvaṃ rāgadveṣau ālasyaṃ pāṣaṃḍitvaṃ bhrāṃtiḥ iṃdriyavikāraḥ kāmaḥ ete yasya pratidinaṃ nyunā bhavaṃti | sa eva kriyāyogī kathyate | 7 ≈*Yogasaṃgraha* (IGNCA 30020 f. 2v. ll. 2–3): atha rājayogasya bhedau kathyete || siddhakuṃḍaliyogaḥ mantrayogaś ceti |

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1 **yasyāntaḥkaraṇe** cett.] va yasyāṃtaḥkaraṇe J **kṣamā°** cett.] kṣamā N_2D, kṣamāḥ N_1 **vivekavairāgyaśānti°** cett.] 'vivekavairāgyāśānti° N_2, vivekavairāgya || śāṃti° N_1DK_1 **°saṃtoṣa ityādīni niraṃtaram** J] °saṃtoṣa ityādīni $N_2N_1DK_1$, °santoṣa ity ādīna niraṃtaram U_1, °santoṣa ityādīny P, °santoṣa ity ādayo niraṃtaraṃ U_2, °santoṣādīny E, °santoṣa ity ādīno° L **utpādyante** cett.] utyaṃte U_1, utpadyante E, °tpādyaṃte L 2 **bahukriyāyogī** cett.] bahukriyāyogā D **kathyate** cett.] sa kathyate N_2DJ, tkacyate U_2 **kāpaṭyaṃ** cett.] yasyāntaḥkaraṇe kapatyaṃ N_1, kāpachaṃ U_1, kāpayaṃ L **māyāvitvaṃ** N_2N_1] māyavitvaṃ DK_1, māyavitaṃ J, yāyavitvaṃ U_1, vittaṃ PE, pāpātitaṃ U_2, vitaṃ L **mātsaryaṃ** cett.] mātsarya DK_1U_1, māścaryaṃ J, mātsaryam E **roṣo** N_1DK_1PLB] eṣo N_2, roṣaḥ JU_1E 3 **bhayaṃ** cett.] kṣayaṃ E **lajjā** cett.] lajā U_1 **lobho** em.] lobha° cett., lobhaḥ PL, *om.* U_2 **mohā** cett.] moha N_2JL, mohaḥ P **aśucitvaṃ** cett.] aśūcitvaṃ N_2, asucitvaṃ K_1J **rāgo** em.] rāga° βU_2, rāgaḥ P, *om.* E, rāja° L **dveṣa** L] dveṣaḥ βPU_2, *om.* E **ālasyaṃ** cett.] *om.* E **pāṣaṇḍitvaṃ** N_1DK_1J] pārṣaḍitvaṃ N_2, pākhaṃḍitvaṃ U_1U_2L, pākhaṃḍatvaṃ E **bhrāntir** em.] bhrāntiḥ cett. 3–4 **indriyavikāraḥ** cett.] iṃdriyaṃ vīkāraḥ P, iti vikāraḥ L 4 **kāmaḥ** cett.] kāma N_2, *om.* U_2 **ete** cett.] rāte U_1, etate U_2, eta L **nyūnā** em.] nyunā cett., vyunā E **bhavanti** cett.] bhavīti N_1 5 **kathyate** cett.] kathyate || cha || K_1, kathyaṃte U_1U_2 7 **idānīṃ rājayogasya** cett.] *om.* U_1 **bhedāḥ** cett.] bhedā N_2, *om.* U_1 **kathyante** cett.] kathyate N_2, *om.* U_1L **ke te** $N_1DK_1JU_1$] kriyate N_2, te ke PU_2EL **siddhakuṇḍalinī°** N_1E] siddhakuṃḍalanī° N_2DK_1, siddhakuṃḍanī° J, siddhakuṇḍalinī° U_1, siddhakuṃḍaṃliṃ P, siddhakuṇḍalinī° U_2, siddhakuṇḍalanī° L **°yogaḥ** cett.] yogaḥ | JE, yoga | U_2L **mantrayogaḥ** cett.] *om.* L

Notes: 3 **lobha°**: IGNCA 30020 begins here.

In whose mind "patience, discrimination, equanimity, peace, contentment", etc., are cultivated without interruption, he alone is called a Yogī of many actions (*bahukriyāyogī*).[137] Fraud, the state of being deceptive, violence, craving, envy, ego, anger, fear, shame, greed, delusion, impurity, attachment, aversion, laziness, heterodoxy, error, agitation of the senses, sexual desire: He in whose inner organ[138] these diminish from day to day, he alone is called a Yogī of many actions (*bahukriyāyogī*).

[III. **Varieties of Rājayoga**]

Now, varieties of Rājayoga are described. What are they? One is Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga [and one is] Mantrayoga.[139]

[137] The term *bahukriyāyogī* ("yogī of many actions") occurs solely in the *Tattvayogabindu*. Both the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Yogasaṃgraha* use only *kriyāyogī* in their discussions of Kriyāyoga. To my knowledge, *bahukriyāyogī* is otherwise unattested and thus likely a neologism coined by Rāmacandra to emphasise the multitude of negative mental fluctuations to be restrained and positive ones to be cultivated by the *kriyāyogī*.

[138] In *Tattvayogabindu* LI (Ed. p. 268), Rāmacandra's inner organ (*antaḥkaraṇa*) consists of mind (*manas*), intellect (*buddhi*), ego (*ahaṃkāra*), mental faculty (*citta*) and consciousness (*caitanya*).

[139] The use of the term *siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga* instead of *siddhayoga* as listed initially is striking. Furthermore, this type of yoga, presented as the second-last item in the initial yoga taxonomy (TYB I, p. 106), is introduced as the second type right after Kriyāyoga, the first item in both the initial list and the subsequent text. That raises further questions as the term *kuṇḍaliṇī* is not mentioned in the subsequent description. However, in choosing this formulation, Rāmacandra probably had in mind the ascent of the Kuṇḍalinī through the nine *cakra*s he presented (see p. 442, n. 887). The relation between Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga and Mantrayoga appears mysterious since only witness U_2 describes a specific type of Mantrayoga. The additional passages of witness U_2, marked in greyscale, instruct the "recitation of the non-recitation" (*ajapājapa*) of the *haṃsamantra*, also called *ajapāgāyatrī*, during meditation for almost every (seven out of nine) *cakra*. All witnesses except L (L omits *mantrayoga*) preserve this reading, and the sentence following supports the reading of *mantrayoga* by dual forms. The *Tattvayogabindu* closely follows the structure of the *Yogasvarodaya*, as quoted in *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* and *Yogakarṇikā*. However, the yoga introduced there is *jñānayoga* and neither *siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga* nor *mantrayoga* are mentioned. The *Śāradātilakatantra* 25.37ab, however, provides a possible and plausible explanation: *bibharti kuṇḍalī śaktir ātmānaṃ haṃsaṃ āśritā* | "The *kuṇḍalī* Śakti abides in the *haṃsaḥ* [and] supports the [individual] Self." See Bühnemann, 2011: 218, 228.

अमू राजयोगौ कथ्येते। मूलकन्दस्थान एका तेजोरूपा महानाडी वर्तते। इयमेका नाडीडापिङ्गलासुषुम्णाः॥ एतान् भेदान् प्राप्नोति। वामभागे चन्द्ररूपेडानाडी वर्तते। दक्षिणभागे सूर्यरूपा पिङ्गलानाडी वर्तते। मध्यमार्गेऽतिसूक्ष्मा पद्मिनीतन्तुसमाकारा कोटिविद्युत्समप्रभा भुक्तिमुक्तिदा शिवरूपिणी सुषुम्णा नाडी प्रवर्तते। अस्या ज्ञानोत्पत्तौ सत्यां पुरुषः सर्वज्ञो भवति॥

[IV. **mūlacakram**]

इदानीं सुषुम्णाया ज्ञानोत्पत्तावुपायाः कथ्यन्ते। आदौ चतुर्दलं मूलचक्रं वर्तते।

Sources: 1–7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 831): paṭhanāt smaraṇād vyānān maṇḍanāt brahmasādhakaḥ | tad bhedasyaikasandhānam aṣṭaiśvaryamayo bhavet | tritīrthaṃ yatra nāḍī ca tripuṇyaṃ parameśvari | …eṣo 'sya viśvarūpasya rājayogo mato budhaiḥ | viśeṣaṃ kathayiṣyāmi śṛṇu caikamanāḥ sati | mūlakande sthale caikā nāḍī tejasvatī parā (*tejasvitāparā* YK 1.246) | gudorddhe (*gudordhve* YK 1.247) sā tribhāgābhūd iḍā (*tridhā bhūyād iḍā vāme* YK 1.247) nāma śaśiprabhā | śaktirūpā mahānāḍī dhyānāt sarvārthadāyinī | dakṣiṇe 'pi kulākhyeti (*dakṣiṇe piṅgalākhyeti* YK 1.248) puṃrūpā sūryavigrahā | madhyabhāge suṣumnākhyā brahmaviṣṇuśivātmikā | śuddhacittena sā vijñā vidyutkoṭisamaprabhā | bhuktimuktipradā dhyānād aṇimādiguṇapradā | suṣumnāntaḥ samāśritya navacakraṃ yathā śṛṇu | mūlādhāraṃ catuṣpatraṃ gudorddhe (*gudordhve* YK 1.250) varttate mahat 1–7 cf. SSP 2.26 (Ed. p. 38): mūlakandād daṇḍalagnāṃ brahmanāḍīṃ śvetavarṇāṃ brahmarandhraparyantaṃ gatāṃ saṃsmaret | tanmadhye kamalatantunibhāṃ vidyutkoṭiprabhām ūrdhvagāminīṃ tāṃ mūrtiṃ manasā lakṣayet | sarvasiddhipradā bhavati | piṇḍe navacakrāṇi | ādhāre brahmacakraṃ tridhāvartaṃ bhagamaṇḍalākāram | tatra mūlakandaḥ |

Testimonia: 1–7 ≈*Yogasaṃgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 2v. ll. 3–7): mūlakandasthāne ekā tejomayā mahānāḍī vartate | iyaṃ iḍāpiṅgalasuṣumnā bhedā tridhā | vāmabhāge candrarūpā iḍā | dakṣiṇabhāge sūryarūpā piṅgalā | madhyamārge atisūkṣmā visataṃtusamākārā koṭividyutprabhā bhuktimuktipradā suṣumnā nāḍī vartate | yasyāḥ jñāne puruṣaḥ sarvajño bhavati | atas taj jñānotpattāv upāyā ucyaṃte | gudamūlacakraṃ caturdalaṃ |

1 **amū** cett.] astu E **°yogau** cett.] °yogaḥ E **kathyete** P] kathyate βEL, kathyaṃte U_2 **°kandasthāna** em.] °kandasthāne cett., °ṃ kaṃdasthāne P **ekā** cett.] eka N_2N_1, ekāṃ J **vartate** cett.] pravartate U_2 **iyam** E] iyaṃ cett., trayaṃ L **ekā** cett.] eka P, eka | E, kā L 2 **°piṅgalā°** cett.] °piṅgala° DK_1J **°suṣumṇān** em.] °suṣumnān $N_2N_1DK_1$, °suṣumnā JU_1L, °suṣumṇā PU_2E **etān** $JU_1\gamma$] ete $N_2N_1DK_1$ **°rūpeḍā°** em.] °rupā iḍā° cett., °rupā U_2 2–3 **vartate** cett.] pravarttate U_2 3 **dakṣiṇa°** cett.] dakṣiṇe JU_1 **vartate** cett.] pravarttate U_2 **°mārge** cett.] °rge D **'ti°** γ] ati° $N_2N_1DK_1U_1$, *om.* J **padminī°** cett.] padmanī° N_2N_1PL, pa++nyanī° K_1 4 **°kārā** cett.] °kāra° P **°prabhā** cett.] °prabhaḥ U_1 **°dā** PU_2] °do° β, °pradā EL **śivarūpiṇī suṣumṇā nāḍī pravartate** U_2] *om.* cett. 5 **asyā** PU_2L] *om.* β, 'syā E **jñānotpattau** γ] °tpanne β **satyāṃ** PU_2L] sati β, satyaṃ E 7 **suṣumṇāyā** PU_2] suṣumṇāyāḥ $N_2N_1DK_1J$, suṣumnāya° U_1, suṣumṇāyāṃ E, suṣumnā° L **°pattāv upāyāḥ** E] °panno upāyāḥ N_2, °panno 'pāyāḥ N_1, °pattau upāyāḥ DK_1JU_1PL, °pattau upāyā U_2 **kathyante** cett.] kathyate L **caturdalaṃ mūla°** $N_1DK_1JU_2$] prathamacaturdalamūla° N_2, caturdalaṃ mūlaṃ U_1PE, caturdalamūla° L **vartate** cett.] pravartate U_2

These two Rājayogas are described [in the following].[140] In the location of the root-bulb[141] exists one major channel in the form of light. This one channel splits up into Iḍā, Piṅgalā and Suṣumnā. On the left side is the lunar Iḍā-channel. On the right side exists the solar Piṅgalā-channel. Within the middle path, having the very subtle form equal to the fibre of a lotus stalk [and] shining like a thousand lightnings, bestowing enjoyment and liberation, [and] having the form of benevolence,[142] the central channel occurs.[143] When the knowledge of her has arisen, the person becomes omniscient.

[IV. **Mūlacakra**]

Now, the means for the genesis of gnosis of the central channel are described. At the beginning [of the central channel] exists the four-petalled root-*cakra*.

[140] See p. 436 et seqq. for Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga and p. 384 et seqq. for Mantrayoga.

[141] The *kanda* ("bulb") in yogic literature is usually below the navel or near the perineum. It seems that Rāmacandra's concept of the *kanda* is close to the one found in *Vivekamārtaṇḍa* 16: *ūrdhvaṃ meḍhrād adho nābheḥ kandayoniḥ khagāṇḍavat | tatra nāḍyaḥ samutpannāḥ sahasrāṇi dvisaptatiḥ* ‖ "Above the penis and below the navel is the home of the *kanda*, which is [formed] like the egg of a bird. There, the 72000 channels originate."

[142] The expression *śivarūpiṇī suṣumṇānāḍī* derives from the source passage *suṣumnākhyā brahmaviṣṇuśivātmikā* in the *Yogasvarodaya*, where *suṣumṇā* is described as having "the nature of Brahmā, Viṣṇu, and Śiva". Rāmacandra omits the first two and instead attributes to the *suṣumṇānāḍī* a specifically "Śiva-form", associated with benevolence and auspiciousness, the precise meaning of which remains open to interpretation.

[143] The decision to adopt the reading *śivarūpiṇī suṣumṇānāḍī pravartate*, attested only in U_2, is not without problems, yet preferable for several reasons. Without it, the sentence remains syntactically incomplete and semantically opaque, and the referent of *asyā* in the following sentence is unclear — especially since *iḍā* and *piṅgalā* have already been introduced, so the omission of *suṣumṇā*, the most important of the three, would be unexpected. Although U_2 elsewhere contains additional material on the nine *cakra*s — likely secondary — this case appears different, as it preserves a sentence seemingly lost very early in the rest of the tradition. This is supported by the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Yogasaṃgraha* (*bhuktimuktipradā suṣumnā nāḍī vartate*). Stemmatic considerations likewise favour this choice, since the redactor or scribe of U_2 likely had access to an exemplar close to the γ-archetype.

प्रथममाधारचक्रम्। गुदा स्थानम्॥ रक्तवर्णम्॥ गणेशं दैवतम्॥ सिद्धिबुद्धिशक्तिम्॥ मुषको वाहनम्॥ कुर्मऋषिः॥ आकुञ्चनमुद्रा॥ अपानवायुः॥ ऊर्मी कला॥ ओजस्विनी धारणा॥ चतुर्दलेषु रजःसत्त्वतमोमनांसि॥ वं शं षं सं॥ मध्यत्रिकोणे त्रिशिखा॥ **तन्मध्ये त्रिकोणाकारं कामपीठं वर्तते। तत्पीठमध्येऽग्निशिखाकारैका मूर्तिर्वर्तते। तस्याः मूर्तेर्ध्यानकरणात् सकलशास्त्रकाव्यनाटकादिसकलवाङ्मयं विनाभ्यासेन पुरुषस्य मनोमध्ये स्फुरति।** अस्य बहिरानन्दः॥ योगानन्दः॥ वीरानन्दः॥ उपरमानन्दः॥ अजपाजपशत्॥ ६००॥ घटि १ पलानि ४०॥

Sources: 4–6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 832): tanmadhye svarṇapīṭhe tu trikoṇaṃ maṇḍalaṃ (*trikoṇamaṇḍalaṃ* YK 1.251) param | tatra vahniśikhākārā mūrttiḥ sarvatra siddhidā | asyā dhyānaṃ manomadhye vinā pīṭhena (*pāṭhena* YK 1.252) vāṅmayam | sarvaśāstrāṇi saṅkarṣaṃ (*saṃkarṣa* YK 1.252) sadā sphurati yogavit | 4–6 cf. SSP 2.1 (Ed. p. 29): tatra śaktiṃ pāvakākārāṃ dhyāyet | tatraiva kāmarūpapīṭhaṃ sarvakāmaphalapradaṃ bhavati |

Testimonia: 4–6 ≈*Yogasaṃgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 2v. ll. 7–9): tanmadhye trikoṇākāraṃ kāmapiṭhaṃ | tatpīṭhamadhye agniśikhākārā gaṇeśamūrttir varttate | tasyā mūrter dhyānakaraṇāt sakalakāvyanāṭakādisakalavāṅmayaṃ vinābhyāsena puruṣasya manomadhye sphurati |

Parallels: 1–7 ≈*Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334 (S), ll. 180–188): oṃ prathamam ādhāracakraṃ guhyasthānaṃ raktavarṇaṃ gaṇeśadevatā siddhibuddhiśaktiḥ kūrmarṣiḥ mūṣakavāhanaṃ apānavāyu unmakala akocanamudrā mūlabandhaḥ caturdala 4 caturmātrā 4 vaṃ śaṃ ṣaṃ saṃ antarmātrā 4 bahirmātrā 4 ānanda 1 yogānanda 2 virānanda 3 śrīparamānanda 4 ajapājapya ṣaṭśatāni 600 palaṃ 40 akṣara 40 pūjamānasikā sohaṃ bhāvena pūjayet atra gandhādi samarpayāmi namaḥ

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1 **prathamamādhāracakram** em.] *om.* β, prathamaṃ ādhāracakram PU_2L, prathamamādhāracakraṃ vartate E **gudā sthānam** PU_2EL] *om.* β **raktavarṇam** PU_2EL] *om.* β **gaṇeśaṃ daivatam** em.] *om.* β, gaṇeśāṃ daivataṃ P, gaṇeśadaivataṃ U_2EL 1–2 **°śaktim || muṣako vāhanaṃ** em.] *om.* β, °śaktir mukhako vāhanam P, °śaktiḥ muṣako vāhanaṃ U_2, °śaktimuṣakavāhanam E, °śaktimuṣako vāhanaṃ L 2 **kurmaṛṣiḥ** PU_2EL] *om.* β **ākuñcanamudrā** PU_2L] *om.* β, ākuṃcamudrā E **apānavāyuḥ** EL] *om.* β, apānavāyuś P, apānavāyu U_2 **ūrmī** em.] *om.* β, urmī U_2 **kalā** PU_2EL] *om.* β 3 **ojasvinī dhāraṇā** PU_2EL] *om.* β **caturdaleṣu rajaḥsattvatamomanāṃsi** PU_2EL] *om.* β **vaṃ śaṃ ṣaṃ saṃ** PU_2EL] *om.* β 3–4 **madhyatrikoṇe** PU_2EL] *om.* β 4 **triśikhā** PL] *om.* β, trirekhā U_2, triśikhāt E **tanmadhye** cett.] tanmadhya N_1L **°pīṭhaṃ** γ] °piṭhaṃ β 4–5 **'gniśikhākāraikā** E] agniśikhākārā ekā βU_2, magniśikhākārā ekā P, jñiśikhākarāṇakā L 5 **vartate** cett.] vartante K_1, asmi U_2 **tasyāḥ** N_1DK_1E] tasyā $N_2U_1PU_2L$, tasyāṃ J **mūrter** cett.] mūrtair U_1, *om.* U_2, mūrtir EL **°nāṭakādi°** cett.] °nāṭakādi || L **°sakala°** cett.] °saka° N_2, *om.* L 6 **°vāṅmayaṃ** PU_2EL] °vāgmayaṃ $N_2N_1DK_1U_1$, °vāmayaṃ J **sphurati** cett.] sphuraṃti L **bahirānandaḥ** em.] bahir mānandā U_2 6–7 **yogānandaḥ** em.] yogānandā U_2 7 **vīrānandaḥ** em.] virānandā U_2 **uparamānandaḥ** em.] uparamānandā U_2

The first is the *ādhāracakra*.[144] The location is the anus. The color is red. The deity is Gaṇeśa. The power is success and intelligence. The mount is a rat. The Ṛṣi is Kūrma. The seal is contraction. The vital wind is Apāna. The digit is Ūrmi. The concentration is Ojasvinī. In the four petals [exist] *rajas*, *sattva*, *tamas* and the mind-faculties; [as well as] *vaṃ śaṃ ṣaṃ* and *saṃ*. A trident is [situated] in the internal triangle. In its middle is ***kāmapīṭha***[145] in the shape of a triangle. In the middle of this seat (*pīṭha*) exists a single manifestation in the shape of a flame of fire. As a result of meditation on this manifestation, all literature, [such as] *śāstra*s, poetry, drama, etc., appears in the person's mind without learning. From this [arises] external bliss, yogic bliss, heroic bliss [and] the bliss of coming to rest.[146] A hundredfold recitation of the non-recitation: 600. 1 *ghaṭi* [and] 40 *pala*s.[147]

[144] This term already occurs in the tenfold *cakra*-system of the 13th c. *Saṃgītaratnākara* 2.120ab.

[145] This refers to one of the four *pīṭha*s of tantric Buddhism and the Kaula Yoginī-Tantra named Kāmarūpa, specifically the present-day Kāmākhyā Temple in Assam, which is identified with different parts of the yogic body in various traditions. For detailed discussions, see Liersch, 2026: 48–58, 129, Rosati, 2020: *et passim*, and Mallinson and Szántó, 2021: 119, n. 144. The *Śārṅgadharapaddhati*, *Śivayogapradīpikā*, and *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* (all teaching a ninefold *cakra*-system) place Kāmarūpa at the *brahmacakra*.

[146] The 11th-century *Amanaska*, the earliest text on Rājayoga, already mentions various blisses such as *ānanda*, *paramānanda*, *sahajānanda*, and *cinmātrānanda* (Birch, 2013: *et passim*). A similar group (*paramānanda*, *sahajānanda*, *vīrānanda*, *yogānanda*) is associated with the first *cakra* in the 13th-century *Saṃgītaratnākara* (2.120cd–2.121ab). Earlier references to the "four blisses" appear in Vajrayāna sexual yoga (see Isaacson and Sferra, 2014: 99; Sferra, 2000: 31–33), and the *Hevajratantra* (1.1.28 *et passim*) lists *ānanda*, *paramānanda*, *sahajānanda*, and *viramānanda*, the latter referring to male pleasure at ejaculation. These concepts were adopted in the *Amṛtasiddhi*, which, however, contrasts sexual ritual with a celibate yoga. It states that semen (*bindu*) is the source of "the blisses whose last is Virama" (7.4) and that accomplished yogins experience three blisses without ejaculation (34.3), reflecting its ascetic orientation (Mallinson and Szántó, 2021: 17). Later texts, including the *Amaraughaprabodha*, which cite the *Amṛtasiddhi*, modified or removed such Buddhist sexual-yogic terminology (Birch, 2019: 21).

[147] See p. 388 n. 731 for an explanation of the units of measurement.

[V. **svādhiṣṭhānacakram**]

इदानीं द्वितीयं स्वाधिष्ठानचक्रं षट्दलमुड्डीयाणपीठसंज्ञकं भवति। लिङ्गस्थानम्॥ पीतवर्णम्॥ पीतप्रभा॥ रजो गुणः॥ ब्रह्मा देवता॥ वैखरी वाचा॥ सावित्री शक्तिः॥ हंसवाहनम्॥ वरुण ऋषिः॥ कामाग्निप्रभा॥ स्थूलदेहः॥ जाग्रदवस्था॥ ऋग्वेदः॥ आचार्यलिङ्गम्॥ ब्रह्मसलोकता मोक्षः॥ शुद्धभूमिका तत्त्वम्॥ गन्धो विषयः॥ अपानवायुः॥ अन्तर्मातृकाः॥ वं भं मं यं रं लं॥ बहिर्मातृकाः॥ कामा॥ कामाख्या॥ तेजस्विनी॥ चेष्टिका॥ अलसा॥ मिथुना॥ अजपाजपः सहस्रः॥ ६००० ॥ घ। १६ प। ४०॥ **तन्मध्येऽतिरक्तवर्णं तेजो वर्तते। तस्य ध्यानात्साधकोऽतिसुन्दरो भवति। युवतीनामतिवल्लभो भवति। प्रतिदिनमायुर्वर्धते॥**

Sources: 2–9 cf. YSv (PT, p. 832): liṅgamūle tu pīṭhābhaṃ (*raktābhaṃ* YK 1.253) svādhiṣṭhānan tu ṣaḍdalam | tanmadhye bālasūryābhaṃ mahajjyotiḥ susiddhidam | dhyānāc ca varddhate āyuḥ kandarpasamatāṃ vrajet | 2–9 cf. SSP 2.2 (Ed. p. 28): dvitīyaṃ svādhiṣṭhānacakram | tanmadhye paścimābhimukhaṃ liṅgaṃ pravālāṅkurasadṛśaṃ dhyāyet | tatraivoḍyānapīṭhaṃ jagadākarṣaṇaṃ bhavati |

Testimonia: 2–9 ≈*Yogasaṃgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 2v. ll. 9–11): liṃgo dvitīyaṃ ṣaṭdalaṃ svādhiṣṭānasaṃjñakaṃ kamalaṃ udyānapīṭhasaṃjñakaṃ vartate | tatra atiraktaṃ yahbhā saṃjñakaṃ tejaḥ | tasyā nāt sādhakaḥ atisuṃdarāṃgasan yuvatīnām ativallabhaḥ san pratidinam āyuṣyābhivṛddhimān bhavati | cha |

Parallels: 2–8 ≈*Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334, ll. 164–179): oṃ dvitīyaṃ svādhiṣṭhānacakraṃ liṅgasthāne pītavarṇe rajoguṇa ākāśabrahmadevatā sāvitre śaktiḥ varuṇa ṛṣiḥ kāmāgniḥ ujāṇeyadhāraṇāṃ sthūladeha jāgrātāvasthā vaikharī vācā ṛgveda ācāryaliṅga gatā bhūmikā sāyujyatā mokṣa hamsa vāhanaṣaṇmatrā 6 vaṃ bhaṃ maṃ yaṃ raṃ laṃ 6 antarmātrā 6 bahirmātrā 6 kāma 1 kāmakṣa 2 tejasi 3 ullāsa 4 ceṣṭhitā 5 miṭhunadevatā 10 ajapājapya ṣaṭsahasraṃ 60000 ghaṭikā 16 palaṃ 30 akṣarā 40 pūjamānasikī proktā mohaṃ bhāvena pūjayet atra gandhādibhis samarpayet 4, 10, 4, 57, 0, 10, 11

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2 **idānīṃ** cett.] idānī N_2 **dvitīyaṃ** cett.] dvitīye U_2 **svādhiṣṭhānacakraṃ** K_1U_1] svādhinacakraṃ N_2, svādhiṣṭānacakraṃ $N_1DJ\gamma$ **ṣaṭdalam** em.] ṣaḍḍalaṃ N_2, ṣaṭdalaṃ $N_1DK_1JU_1PU_2LB$, ṣaḍdalaṃ E **uḍḍīyāṇapīṭha°** U_2] uḍyānapīṭha° N_2N_1, uḍyāṇāpīṭha° DK_1J, uḍāganapīṭa° U_1, upāyanapīṭha° E, uḍḍīyān pīṭhaṃ L 3 **guṇaḥ** em.] guṇa U_2 4 **sthūladehaḥ** em.] sthūladehā U_2 5 **ṛgvedaḥ** em.] ṛg veda U_2 **śuddhabhūmikā** em.] śuddhabhumikā U_2 6 **antarmātṛkāḥ resp=mallinsonem**] antarmātṛkā U_2 **bahirmātṛkāḥ** Mallinson em.] bahirmātrā U_2 7 **tejasvinī** em.] tejasī U_2 **sahasraḥ** em.] sahasra U_2 8 **'tiraktavarṇaṃ** PU_2] atiraktavarṇa° N_2U_1, atiraktavarṇaṃ N_1DK_1JE **tasya dhyānāt** cett.] dhyānāt tasya dhyānāt J 8–9 **sādhako** PU_2EL] sādhakaḥ cett. 9 **'ti°** γ] ati° β **yuvatīnām ativallabho** em.] yuvatīnāṃ ativallabho N_2K_1J, *om.* cett. **bhavati** N_2K_1J] *om.* cett. **pratidinam** γ] dinadinaṃ prati N_2K_1, dinaṃ dinaṃ prati N_1JU_1, dinaṃ prati D

[V. **Svādhiṣṭānacakra**]

Now, the second is the six-petalled Svādhiṣṭhānacakra known as the seat of *Uḍḍīyāṇa*[148] The location is the penis. The colour is yellow. The shine is yellow. The quality is Rajas. The deity is Brahmā. The speech is Vaikharī. The power is Sāvitrī. The mount is the goose. The Ṛṣi is Varuṇa. The light is the fire of passion. The body is gross. The state is waking. The Veda is Ṛg. The object of veneration (*liṅga*) is the teacher. The liberation is Brahmasalokatā.[149] The principle is the pure state. The sense object is smell. The vital wind is Apāna. The internal syllables [are]:[150] *vaṃ bhaṃ maṃ yaṃ raṃ laṃ*. The external mother goddesses [are]: Kāmā, Kāmākhyā, Tejasvinī, Ceṣṭikā, Alasā [and] Mithunā.[151] A thousandfold recitation of the non-recitation; 6000; 16 *ghaṭi*s [and] 40 *pala*s. In its middle exists an extremely red light. The adept becomes very handsome as a result of meditation on it. He becomes one whom young women desire. His lifespan increases every day.

[148] The term *uḍḍīyāṇa* originally refers to one of the four *pīṭha*s of tantric Buddhism and the Kaula Yoginī-Tantra, see White, 1996: 260. According to Dyczkowski (1988), Sanderson (2007) and Urban (2010), Uḍḍiyāna is probably situated in the Swat Valley in modern Pakistan. See Sanderson, 2007: 265–269 for a detailed term discussion. Throughout the text corpus of Haṭhayoga, the *pīṭha*s are repeatedly located differently in the yogic body.

[149] The term *brahmasalokatā* might be translated as "residing in the world of Brahmā."

[150] In all instances where U_2 provides the inner (*antar°*) syllables and outer (*bahir°*) mother goddesses, I have corrected and standardised all occurrences of *°mātrā* or *°mātrāḥ* to the appropriate word and form, which is *°mātṛkāḥ*. Thanks to James Mallinson for this suggestion. The emended form, *°mātṛkāḥ*, on the one hand, conveys a clearer meaning when applied to *syllables* placed on the *cakra*s, while also signifying "mothers" or "mother goddesses," precisely as presented in all cases where U_2 provides *bahirmātṛkā*. In any case, U_2 yields a list of goddesses in the nominative singular feminine. Furthermore, this decision is reinforced by evidence from other texts. See for example Agastyamuni's *Rājayoga* (f. 8–9) which contains nearly identical syllable combinations that are placed on the petals of the *cakra*s within its sixfold *cakra* system.

[151] The worship of mothers is originally a central element of the Śākta tradition known as Kaula-Śaivism. It belongs to the Mantramārga and developed from the former Kāpālika cult. See Oberlies, 2012: 92.

[VI. **nābhisthāne padmam**]

तृतीयं नाभिस्थाने दशदलं पद्मं वर्तते। कपिलवर्णम्॥ विष्णुदेवता॥ लक्ष्मी श–
क्तिः॥ †आयु†ऋषिः॥ समानवायुः॥ गरुडवाहनम्॥ सूक्ष्मलिङ्गं देहः॥ स्वप्ना–
वस्था॥ मध्यमा वाक्॥ यजुर्वेदः॥ दक्षिणोऽग्निः॥ समीपता मोक्षः॥ गुरुलिङ्ग–
5 विष्णुः॥ आपस्तत्त्वम्॥ रसो विषयः॥ दशदलानि॥ दशमातृका अन्तर्मातृकाः–
॥ डं ढं णं तं थं दं धं नं पं फं॥ बहिर्मातृकाः॥ शान्तिः॥ क्षमा॥ मेधा॥ तनया॥
मेधाविनी॥ पुष्करा॥ हंसगमना॥ लक्ष्या॥ तन्मया॥ अमृता॥ अजपाजपः सह–
स्रः॥ ६०००॥ घ। १६ प। ४०॥ **तन्मध्ये पञ्चकोणं चक्रं वर्तते। तन्मध्ये एका मूर्तिर्वर्तते। तस्यास्तेजो जिह्वया कथयितुं न शक्यते।**

Sources: 2–9 cf. YSv (PT, p. 832): tṛtīyaṃ nābhideśe tu digdalaṃ paramādbhutam | mahāmeghaprabhaṃ tat tu koṭividyutsamanvitam | kalpāntāgnisamaṃ (*kalpānto 'gni*° YK 1.255) jyotis tanmadhye saṃsthitaṃ svayam | 2–9 cf. SSP 2.3 (Ed. p. 30): tṛtīyaṃ nābhicakraṃ pañcāvartaṃ sarpavat kuṇḍalākāram | tanmadhye kuṇḍalinīṃ śaktiṃ bālārkakoṭisannibhāṃ dhyāyet | sā madhyā śaktiḥ sarvasiddhidā bhavati |

Testimonia: 2–9 *Yogasaṃgraha* IGNCA 30020, f. 2v. ll. 11 to f. 3r. ll. 1–2: nābhisthāne daśadalaṃ cakraṃ | tanmadhye paṃcakoṇaṃ pīṭhe lakṣmī++parvatī saṃjñakaṃ guṇā sahitā śiva saṃjñakā rāmaṇaṃ rūpā yasyās tejo jihvayā kathituṃ na śakyate

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Parallels: 2–8 ≈*Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334, ll. 142–154): oṃ caturthaṃ maṇipūrakacakraṃ nābhisthānaṃ nīlavarṇaṃ ukāra sattvo guṇa viṣṇo devatāḥ lakṣmī śaktiḥ garuḍo vāhana vāyu ṛṣiḥ samānavāyuḥ liṅgadeha suṣumṇāvasthā madhyamā vācā caturveda dakṣināgniḥ āgatābhūmikāḥ surūpatāmokṣa daśadala daśamātrā 10 ḍaṃ ḍhaṃ ṇaṃ taṃ thaṃ daṃ dhaṃ naṃ paṃ phaṃ antarmātrā 10 balirmātrā 10 kṣamā 1 medhā 2 trīvratā 3 nāyā 4 medhā 5 yaścharā 6 haṃsagamanī 7 tanmayā 8 lakṣmyā 9 devatā amṛtā 10 ajapājapya ṣatsahasraṃ 6000 ghaṭikā 16 palaṃ 40 pūjamānasikaḥ sohaṃ bhāvena pūjayet atra gandhādi samarpayāmi namaḥ

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2 **tṛtīyaṃ** cett.] tṛtīyacakraṃ N_2, atha tṛtīyaṃ maṇipūracakraṃ U_2, tṛtīye E **daśadalaṃ** cett.] daśadalakaṃ U_1, *om.* U_2, daśadala° L **padmaṃ** JU_1PE] padma $N_2N_1DK_1$, *om.* U_2, °padme L **vartate** cett.] *om.* U_2 3 **āyu** em.] vayu U_2 **°liṅgaṃ dehaḥ** em.] °liṅgadevatāha U_2 4 **dakṣiṇo'gniḥ** em.] dakṣināgniḥ U_2 **samīpatā** em.] samipatā U_2 5 **raso** em.] rajo U_2 **daśamātṛkā** em.] daśamātrāḥ U_2 **antarmātṛkāḥ** em.] antarmātrā U_2 6 **bahirmātṛkāḥ** em.] bahirmātrā U_2 7 **haṃsagamanā** em.] ahaṃsagamanā U_2 7–8 **sahasraḥ** em.] sahasra U_2 8 **tanmadhye pañca°** cett.] *om.* L **°koṇaṃ** cett.] °koṇakaṃ J, *om.* L **vartate** cett.] *om.* L **tanmadhye** cett.] *om.* L **ekā** cett.] *om.* L 9 **mūrtir** cett.] *om.* L **vartate** cett.] asmi U_2 **tasyās** $JU_1\gamma$] tasyā $N_2N_1DK_1$ **kathayituṃ** cett.] kathatuṃ U_1, vaktuṃ U_2, kathyituṃ L

[VI. **Lotus within the place of the navel**]

The third lotus exists at the location of the navel[152] [and] has ten petals. The color is reddish. The deity is Viṣṇu. The power is Lakṣmī. The Ṛṣi is †Āyu†.[153] The vital wind is Samāna. The mount is Garuḍa. The body is the subtle body.[154] The state is sleep. The speech is Madhyamā. The Veda is Yajur[veda]. The fire is the southern [fire]. The liberation is Samīpatā. The *guruliṅga*[155] is Viṣṇu. The principle is water. The sense object is taste.[156] There are ten petals [and] ten *mātṛkā*s. [The] internal syllables [are]: *ḍaṃ ṭaṃ ṇaṃ taṃ thaṃ daṃ dhaṃ naṃ paṃ phaṃ*. The external mother goddesses [are]: Śānti, Kṣamā, Medhā, Tanayā, Medhāvinī, Puṣkarā, Haṃsagamanā, Lakṣyā, Tanmayā and Amṛtā.[157] A thousandfold recitation of the non-recitation; 6000; 16 *ghaṭi*s [and] 40 *pala*s.[158][159] In its middle exists a *cakra* with five angles. In the middle of it is a single manifestation. It is not possible to describe the splendour of it with speech.

[152] The important mention of *kuṇḍalinī* in SSP 2.3 (Ed. p. 30) and a parallel passage in *Nāḍīcakra* scroll (ORIS 1334, ll. 155–163) are discussed on p. 442.

[153] The name *vayu* for a *ṛṣi* as attested in manuscript U_2 is probably a mistake. Since immediately afterwards, the associated *vāyu* is given, this should be an eyeskip. My best guess is *āyu*, the name of a sage mentioned in *Ṛgveda* 2.14.7 and Geldner, 1907: 24.

[154] I corrected *devatāha* to *dehaḥ* since a deity has already been mentioned before, *sūkṣmaliṅgaṃ* most likely refers to a *deha* and, as in the second *cakra* the *deha* is followed by an *avasthā*.

[155] For the phallus of Śiva, considered as one's teacher or guide, cf. *Śivapurāṇa* 1.18.31.

[156] I emended *rajo* to *raso* since the association of water with taste is well known.

[157] I was unable to locate parallel lists of *bahirmātṛkāḥ* for the navel *cakra* in other sources, and a comprehensive search of my electronic text library yielded no occurrences. The association of deities with *cakra* petals or syllable series is, however, well attested—for instance in the *Rudrayāmala Uttaratantra*—with antecedents traceable to the *Kubjikāmatatantra*, albeit with differing enumerations. The pairing of *antarmātṛkānyāsa* and *bahirmātṛkānyāsa*, denoting the implantation of syllables within the *cakra*s and their reinforcement on the outer body, is widespread and further elaborated in works such as the *Dīpikā* on the *Nityāṣoḍaśikārṇava* and the *Śāradātilaka*. I am grateful to Shaman Hatley for discussing this topic with me.

[158] Thus, the prescribed duration for meditation on this *cakra* is six hours and forty minutes.

[159] Unlike the preceding *svādhiṣṭhānacakraṃ* this *cakra* at the navel is not associated with a *guṇa*, a *dhāraṇā*, a *prabhā* and a *mudrā*.

तस्याः मूर्तेर्ध्यानकरणात्पुरुषस्य शरीरं स्थिरं भवति॥

[VII. **hṛdayamadhye kamalam**]

चतुर्थं हृदयमध्ये द्वादशदलं कमलं वर्तते। अनाहतचक्रं हृदयस्थानम्॥ श्वेतवर्णम्॥ तमो गुणः॥ रुद्रो देवता॥ उमा शक्तिः॥ हिरण्यगर्भ ऋषिः॥ नन्दी वाहनम्॥ प्राणवायुः॥ ज्योतिष्कलाकारणं देहम्॥ सुषुप्तिरवस्था॥ पश्यन्ती वाचा॥ सामवेदः॥ गार्हपत्योऽग्निः॥ शिवलिङ्गम्॥ प्राप्तिभूमिका॥ सरूपता मुक्तिः॥ द्वादशदलानि॥ द्वादशमातृकाः॥ कं खं गं घं ङं चं छं जं झं ञं टं ठं॥ बहिर्मातृकाः॥ रुद्राणी॥ तेजसा॥ तापिनी॥ सुखदा॥ चैतन्या॥ शिवदा॥ शान्तिः॥ उमा॥ गौरी॥ मातरा॥ ज्वाला॥ प्रज्वालिनी॥ अजपाजपः सहस्रः॥ ६०००॥ घ। १६ प। ४०॥

Sources: 1–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 832): tasya (*asya* YK 1.256) dhyānāc cirāyuḥ syād arogo (*arogī* YK 1.256) jagatāṃ varaḥ (*jagatāmvaraḥ* YK 1.256) | sarvapāpavinirmukto jagatkṣobhakaro (*jaganmokṣakaro* YK 1.256) mahān | anāhatam aṣṭapīṭhaṃ (*mahāpīṭhaṃ* YK 1.257) caturthakamalaṃ hṛdi | 1–3 cf. SSP 2.4 (Ed. p. 30): caturthaṃ hṛdayacakram aṣṭadalakamalam adhomukhaṃ tanmadhye karṇikāyāṃ liṅgākārāṃ jyotīrūpām dhyāyet | saiva haṃsakalā sarvendriyavaśyā bhavati |

Testimonia: 1–3 ≈*Yogasaṃgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 3r. ll. 1–2): tasā dhyānakaraṇāt sādhakasya śarīraṃ sthiraṃ bhavati | cha | hṛdayamadhye dvadaśadalaṃ …

Parallels: 3–10 ≈*Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334, ll. 97–113): oṃ aṣṭamam anāhatacakraṃ hṛdayasthānaṃ śvetavarṇaṃ tamoguṇa makāra gurudevatāḥ umā śaktiḥ hiraṇyagarbha ṛṣiḥ nandī vāhana prāṇavāyu jyotikalākāraṇa deha suśuptiḥ athavasthā paśyanti vācā sāmaveda gārhapatyāgni śivaliṅga prāpti bhūmikā sāyujyātā mokṣa dvādaśadala 12 dvādaśamātrā 12 kaṃ khaṃ gaṃ ghaṃ ṇaṃ caṃ chaṃ jaṃ jhaṃ ñaṃ ṭaṃ ṭhaṃ bahirmātrā 12 rudrāyaṇī 1 tejasā 2 tāpinī 3 sukhadā 4 caitanyā 5 śivā 6 śānti 7 umā 8 gaurī 9 mātarā 10 jvālā 11 prajvālinīdevatāḥ 12 ajapājapa ṣaḍsāhasraṃ 6000 ghaṭikā 16 palaṃ 44 akṣaro 40 pūjāmānasikā sohaṃ bhāvena pūjāyet atra gandhādi samarpayāmi namaḥ

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1 **tasyāḥ** $\beta U_2 E$] tasyā PL **mūrter** cett.] *om.* U_2, mūrtir L **puruṣasya** cett.] *om.* P **śarīraṃ** cett.] *om.* P **sthiraṃ** cett.] *om.* P **bhavati** cett.] bhavati vā U_1, *om.* P 3 **caturthaṃ** cett.] caturthacakrakamalaṃ N_2, caturthaṃ kamalaṃ K_1 **kamalaṃ** cett.] *om.* N_2K_1 **vartate** cett.] bhavati N_2, ‖ vartate K_1, asti U_2 4 **nandī** em.] nandi U_2 5 **jyotiṣkalākāraṇaṃ** em.] jyotiḥ kalākāraṇaṃ U_2 **deham** em.] dehe U_2 **paśyantī** em.] paśyaṃti U_2 6 **gārhapatyo'gniḥ** em.] gārhasyatyo gniḥ U_2 7 **dvādaśamātṛkāḥ** em.] dvādaśamātrā U_2 **ñaṃ** em.] yaṃ U_2 7–8 **bahirmātṛkāḥ** em.] bahir mātrā U_2 8 **śāntiḥ** em.] śānti U_2 9 **mātarā** em.] mātara U_2 **ajapājapaḥ** em.] ajapājapa° U_2 **sahasraḥ** em.] °sahasra U_2

As a result of meditation on this manifestation, the body of the person becomes durable.[160]

[VII. **Lotus within the heart**]

The fourth lotus is twelve-petalled [and] exists within the heart. The place of the Anāhatacakra[161] is at the heart. The colour is white. The quality is Tamas. The deity is Rudra. The power is Umā. The Ṛṣi is Hiraṇyagarbha. The mount is Nandī. The vital wind is Prāṇa. The body is the instrument of the digit of light. The state is deep sleep. The speech is Paśyantī. The Veda is Samā[veda]. The fire is the fire of the householder. The *liṅga* is Śiva. The level is attaining.[162] The liberation is taking the same form [as the deity]. [There are] twelve petals. [The] twelve [internal] syllables [are]: *kaṃ khaṃ gaṃ ghaṃ ṇaṃ caṃ chaṃ jaṃ jhaṃ ñaṃ ṭaṃ ṭhaṃ*. The external mother goddesses [are]: Rudrāṇī, Tejasā, Tāpinī, Sukhadā, Caitanyā, Śivadā, Śānti, Umā, Gaurī, Mātarā, Jvalā [and] Prajvālinī. A thousandfold recitation of the non-recitation; 6000; 16 *ghaṭi*s [and] 40 *pala*s.

[160] The source text specifies this bodily durability as a long lifespan (*cirāyuḥ*) and freedom from diseases (*arogatā*).

[161] The designation *aṣṭamam anāhatacakraṃ* in the *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334, l. 97) for the *cakra* located in the heart — here referred to as *anāhatacakra* — is the result of a chain of scribal errors, confusions and conceptual extension. While the first two *cakra*s in the *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334) largely correspond to witness U_2, the *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334) refers to the third *cakra* as *kuṇḍalinīsthānam* without specifying its precise location, which is, however, indicated towards the end (l. 163) by the term *garbhapuṭaṃ* which is the womb below the navel. The fourth *cakra* in the *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334) is the *Maṇipūracakra* at the navel (ll. 142–154), corresponding to the third *cakra* in U_2. The fifth *cakra* in the *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334) is the *Manacakra*, the description of which appears in U_2 within the account of the heart *cakra*. Subsequently, the *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334) identifies the heart *cakra* as the eighth (*aṣṭamam*), which, however, must be a scribal error for the original *ṣaṣṭham*, since the *Viśuddhicakra*, which follows (l. 79), is recorded as the seventh (*saptamam*), and yet another eighth *cakra* (ll. 68–69) is then listed at the site of the nose (*nāsikāsthānam*). Thereafter, three further *cakra*s follow, which again correspond almost verbatim to the supplementary material preserved in U_2.

[162] Cf. *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* 3.45: *prāptir aṅgulyagreṇāpi spṛśati candramasam* | "Attaining is that by which one can touch the moon with the fingertips."

अतितेजोमयत्वाद्दृष्टिगोचरं न भवति। तन्मध्येऽष्टदलमधोमुखं कमलं वर्तते। मनश्चक्रे॥ मनो देवता॥ बहिश्शक्तिः॥ आत्मा ऋषिः॥ हृदयमध्ये स्थितं पद्मं नालं तस्य दशाङ्गुलम्। कोमलं तस्य तन्नालम्। निर्मलं चाप्यधोमुखम्। कदलीपुष्पसंकाशं तन्मध्ये च प्रतिष्ठितम्। मनउन्नतिः संकल्पं विकल्पात्मकमेव च। पूर्वदले श्वेतवर्णे यदा विश्रमते मनः धर्मकीर्तिविद्यादिसद्बुद्धिर्भवति। अग्निकोण आरक्तवर्णे निद्रालस्यमायामन्दमतिर्भवति। दक्षिणे कृष्णवर्णेति तदा क्रोधोत्पत्तिर्भवति। नैर्ऋत्ये नीलवर्णे ममतामतिर्भवति। पश्चिमे कपिलवर्णे क्रीडाहासोत्सवोत्साहमतिर्भवति। वायव्ये श्यामवर्णे चिन्तोद्वेगमतिर्भवति। उत्तरे पीतवर्णे भोगशृङ्गारमहोदयमतिर्भवति। ज्ञानसंधानमतिर्भवति।

Sources: 2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 832): sūryapatraṃ mahājyotir mahāsūkṣman tu cākṣuṣam | sūryapatraṃ dvādaśadalam (sentence *om.* in YK) | tanmadhye 'ṣṭadalaṃ padmam ūrddhavaktraṃ mahāprabham |

Testimonia: 2 ≈*Yogasaṃgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 3r. ll. 2–3): …tejomayatvāt | dṛṣṭigocaraṃ na bhavaty etādṛśaṃ vartate | tanmadhye 'ṣṭadalaṃ adhomukhaṃ kamalaṃ ‖

Parallels: 3–10 ≈*Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334, ll. 114–141): oṃ pañcamaṃ manacakraṃ manadevatā buddhiśaktiḥ ātmāṛṣiḥ nābhimadhye sthitaṃ padmaṃ nālaṃ tasya daśāṅgulām komalaṃ tasya tat nālaṃ nirmalā cāpy adhomukham kadale puṣpasaṅkāśaṃ tanmadhye ca pratiṣṭhatiṃ pūrvadale śvetavarṇaṃ yadā maśrāmate manaḥ tadā dharmakīrtir matir bhavet 1 agnidale raktavarṇaṃ yadā maśramate manaḥ tadā krodhamātmanamatir bhavet 2 dakṣiṇadale kṛṣṇavarṇaṃ yadā viśrāmate manaḥ yadā viśrāmate manaḥ tadakridham ātmanamatir bhavet 3 nainṛti dale nīlavarṇa yadā viśrāmate manaḥ tadā samatā matir bhavet 4 paścimadale kapilavarṇaṃ yadā viśrāmate manaḥ tadā ānandotmahamatir bhavet 5 vāyavyadale śyāmavarṇaṃ yadā viśrāmate manāḥ tadā taś cāṭanamatir bhavet 6 uttaradale pītavarṇaṃ yadā viśrāmate manāḥ tadā kāmahāsya matir bhavet 7 īśādale gauravarṇaṃ yadā viśrāmate manāḥ tadā kamākriyā++nabuddhi++sya ra bhavati ta sandhiḥ sandhiḥ tribdau bātapirtau dayaḥ atra gandhādi samarpayāmi namaḥ

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2 **°gocaraṃ** cett.] °gocaratāṃ U_2 **na** cett.] *om.* J **bhavati** cett.] yāti U_2 **'ṣṭadalam** U_2E] aṣṭadalaṃ β, 'ṣṭadale P, ṣṭadalaṃ L **adhomukhaṃ kamalaṃ** cett.] mukhaṃ kamalaṃ P, adhomukhakamalaṃ L **vartate** cett.] asti U_2 3 **bahiśśaktiḥ** conj.] bahiśaktiḥ U_2 **ātmā** em.] ātma° U_2 **hṛdayamadhye** conj.] nābhimadhye U_2 4 **daśāṅgulam** em.] daśāgulaṃ U_2 5 **unnatiḥ** em.] unnaty U_2 **asaṃkalpaṃ** em.] asaṃkalpa U_2 6 **śveta°** em.] sveta° U_2 **viśramate** em.] viśrāmate U_2 **agnikoṇa** em.] agnikoṇe U_2 7 **nidrālasya°** em.] nidrā ālasya° U_2 7–8 **nairṛtye** em.] naiṛtye U_2 9 **śyāma°** em.] śāma° U_2 10 **jñānasaṃdhāna°** em.] jñānasaṃdhāne U_2

Because of being made of [such an] intense light, [the fourth lotus] is not in the range of sight. In its middle exists an eight-petalled lotus facing downwards.[163] The mind resides in the *cakra*. The deity is Manas. The power is Bahiś.[164] The Ṛṣi is the self. In the middle of the heart[165] is a lotus whose stalk is ten fingers long. Its stalk is soft. [The lotus] is pure [and] facing downwards. There is [something] resembling a banana flower established within it. The mind wants advancement, but its essence is indecision. While the mind rests on the eastern petal, which is white, a clear intellect endowed with the fame of *dharma*, knowledge, etc., arises. While in the southeast, which is reddish, a mind endowed with weakness, illusion, sleepiness, and laziness arises. While in the right south, being black, the production of anger arises. While in the southwest, which is blue, a mind of selfishness arises. While in the west, which is brown, a mind [focussed on] play, laughter, and excitement arise. While in the northwest, which is dark in colour, a mind endowed with worry and anxiety arises. While in the north, which is yellow, a mind occupied with enjoyment, sexual passion, and prosperity arises. While in the northeast, which is whitish, a mind united with gnosis arises.

[163] For a discussion of the eight-petalled lotus within the twelve-petalled lotus in the heart, see p. 253.

[164] *Bahiśśaktiḥ* is the external energy that permeates the external space. The conjecture is based on *Kriyakramadyotikavyākhyā* (Ed. p. 96) and *Sakalāgamasārasaṅgraha* quoted with reference *siddhāntaśekhare* (Ed. p. 80): *caraṇāṅguṣṭhayor yugmāt sañcintya suṣirāntanau | suṣirāntabahiśśaktiṃ vyāpinīṃ cintayet tataḥ* ‖ The reading attested in the parallel *Nāḍīcakra*, which developed within the same textual tradition, is *buddhiśakti*. While this cannot be entirely ruled out, given the poor quality of the transmission in the scroll, I strongly doubt that this reading is original.

[165] I conjectured *nābhi°* to *hṛdaya°* since the context is an eight-petalled within the twelve-petalled lotus whose eight petals are discussed in U_2, cf. *Tattvayogabindu* XLVII.

तन्मध्ये प्राणवायोः स्थानमष्टदलकमलमध्ये लिङ्गाकारा कर्णिका कथ्यते। तस्याः कलिकेति संज्ञा। तत्कलिकामध्ये पद्मरागरत्नसमानवर्णाङ्गुष्ठप्रमाणैका पुत्तलिका वर्तते। तस्या जीवेति संज्ञा। तस्या बलं अथ च स्वरूपं कोटिजिह्वाभि र्वक्तुं न शक्यते। अस्या मूर्तेर्ध्यानकारणात्स्वर्गपातालाकाशमनुष्यगन्धर्वकिन्नरगुह्यकविद्याधरलोकसंबन्धिन्याः स्त्रियः साधकस्य पुरुषस्य वश्या भवन्ति। इत्यत्र किं कथ्यते॥

Sources: 1–6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 832): prāṇavāyoḥ sthalañcāsya liṅgākāran tu karṇikā | kālikākhyā karṇikeyaṃ asyā madhye tu kuṇḍalī | padmavatyāḥ (*padmāvatyāḥ* YK 1.259) prabhāṅguṣṭhapramāṇā (°*prāmāṇa*° YK 1.259) ratnasannibhā | tasyā saṅgī (*tasya saṅgī* YK 1.260) jīva iti ananto balarūpataḥ | asya dhyānaṃ (*dhyānād* YK 1.260) jagadvaśyaṃ khecarīsarvago bhavet | bhavanti vaśyā devādyāś cintākarttur na (*citta*° YK 1.260) cānyathā | iṣṭāniṣṭo (*iṣṭāniṣṭa* YK 1.261) bhaved vaśyaḥ (*vaśyaṃ* YK 1.261) satyaṃ satyaṃ na saṃśayaḥ | iṣṭasiddhir bhavet tasya sarvajñādiguṇodayaḥ |

Testimonia: 1–6 = *Yogasaṃgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 3r. ll. 3–7): ta ca prāṇavāyoḥ sthānam | aṣṭadalakamalamadhye liṃgākārā karṇikā kaliketi saṃjñikāsti tanmadhye padmarāgaratnasamānavarṇā aṃguṣṭhapramāṇā ekā puttalikā jīveti saṃjñikāsti | tasyāḥ balaṃ svarūpaṃ ca koṭijihvābhir vaktuṃ na śakyaṃ || asyā mūrtter dhyānakaraṇāt sādhakasya svargapātāla ākāśagaṃdharvakiṃnaraguhyakavidyādharastrīyo vaśā bhavati | pṛthvī loke manuṣyādi striṇāṃ kākathā cha |

1 °**vāyoḥ** cett.] °vāyo U_1U_2 **liṅgākārā** cett.] *om.* J **karṇikā** cett.] karṇi D, *om.* J **kathyate** cett.] *om.* J **tasyāḥ** cett.] *om.* J 2 **kaliketi** cett.] *om.* J, karṇiketi E, kalikeli L **saṃjñā** cett.] *om.* J, *om.* L **tatkalikāmadhye** cett.] tataḥ kalikāmadhye N_2, *om.* J, madhye L °**rāgaratnasamānavarṇāṅguṣṭhapramāṇaikā** em.] °rāgaratnasamānavarṇa aṃguṣṭhapramāṇā ekā N_2, °rāgaratnasamānavarṇāṃ || aṃguṣṭhapramāṇā || ekā N_1P, °rāgaratnasamānavarṇā aṃguṣṭhapramāṇāt ekā DJU_1, °rāgaratnasamānavarṇā aṃguṣṭhapramāṇā ekā K_1, °rāgasamānavarṇāṃguṣṭhapramāṇaikā E, °ratnasamānavarṇā aṃguṣṭhapramāṇā ekā L **puttalikā** cett.] putalīṃ J 3 **tasyā** PE] tasyāḥ β, tasya U_2L **jīveti saṃjñā** U_1] jīveti saṃjñaḥ N_2, jīveti saṃjñāḥ N_1, jīveti saṃjña DK_1J, jīvasaṃjñā PU_2E, *om.* L **tasyā** N_2PE] tasyāḥ $N_1DK_1JU_1$, tasya U_2 **balaṃ atha ca svarūpaṃ** cett.] balam atha svarūpaṃ P, balaṃ tasya atha svarūpaṃ U_2, balamadhyasvarūpaṃ E, bala sappa svarūpaṃ L **koṭijihvābhir** cett.] koṭijihvāyābhi K_1L **vaktuṃ** cett.] ktuṃ K_1 **na** cett.] naiva PE 4 **asyā** cett.] asyāḥ $N_1DK_1JU_1$, tasyāḥ U_2 **mūrter** cett.] mūrtir N_2L **dhyānakāraṇāt** cett.] dhyānaṃ karaṇāt || U_2, dhyānāt L °**pātālākāśa**° γ] °pātāla ākāśa° β 5 °**saṃbandhinyāḥ** em.] °saṃbandhinyaḥ βPEL, °saṃdadhinya U_2 **striyaḥ sādhakasya puruṣasya** β] striyo 'pi PU_2EL **vaśyā bhavanti** cett.] vaśyo bhavati N_2, vaśyā bhavaṃti pṛtthilokasaṃbadhinyonipi striyaḥ vaśyā bhavaṃti J **atra** cett.] yaṃtra DK_1 **kiṃ** β] *om.* γ 5–6 **kathyate** cett.] kathyate || cha || J, kathyate vā U_1

It is said that in its middle is the place of the *prāṇa*-vital wind [and] in the middle [of] the eight-petalled lotus is a central receptacle (*karṇikā*)[166] in the form of a *liṅga*. The technical designation of it is bud (*kalikā*).[167] In the middle of this bud exists a single thumb-sized [divine] figurine (*puttalikā*)[168] being similar to a ruby-gem in color. Her technical designation is Jīva.[169] Not even with ten million tongues is it possible to talk about her nature and her power. As a result of meditation on this form, the women of the inhabitants of the world [which are] Humans, Gandharvas, Kinnaras, Guhyakas, Vidyādharas, in the heavenly world, underworld, and open space become obedient to the will of the practising person. What [more] is here to say about this?

[166] Regarding the translation of *karṇikā* as "central receptacle" instead of the widespread translation "pericarp", see Reigle, 2012:442.

[167] A similar concept, including the usage of the term *kalikā*, is found in the chapter on creation (*sargakāṇḍa*) of the *Prāṇatoṣinī*, 1898: 54. In a quotation attributed to a text called *Śāktānanda*, the *jīva* is described as having the shape of a bud of light (*pradīpakalikākāro jīvo*) and always resides in the heart: *ādau sañjāyate bījaṃ brahmāṇḍaṃ sahasāṅkuraḥ | tasya madhye sumeruś ca kaṅkāladaṇḍarūpadhṛk | carācarāṇāṃ sarveṣāṃ devādināṃ viśeṣataḥ | ālayaḥ savabhūtānāṃ meror abhyantare 'pi ca | pradīpakalikākāro jīvo hṛdi sadā sthitaḥ |*

[168] The concept of a *puttalikā* in the heart can be traced back to the Kaula Tantras, e.g., the *Śāradātilakatantra* 22.126–128: *puttalikāyā hṛdayaṃ spṛśan prāṇā iha prāṇā jīva iha sthita iti indriyāṇi spṛśan sarvendriyāṇi vāṅmanaścakṣuḥśrotraghrāṇeti sarvāṅgaṃ spṛśan prāṇā ihāyāntu sukhaṃ ciraṃ tiṣṭhan tu iti śiraḥ spṛśan svāheti japet | mantranyāsam iti |*

[169] The idea of the thumb-sized soul residing in the heart is already present in the oldest strata of yogic literature. See *Kathopaniṣad* 6.17: *aṅguṣṭhamātraḥ puruṣo 'ntarātmā sadā janānāṃ hṛdaye saṃniviṣṭaḥ | taṃ svāc charīrāt pravṛhen muñjād iveṣīkāṃ dhairyeṇa | taṃ vidyāc chukram amṛtaṃ taṃ vidyāc chukram amṛtam iti* ‖ Also cf. *Śvetāśvataropaniṣad* 3.13: *aṅguṣṭhamātraḥ puruṣo 'ntarātmā sadā janānāṃ hṛdaye sanniviṣṭaḥ | hṛdā manīṣā manasābhikḷpto ya etad vidur amṛtās te bhavanti* ‖

[VIII. **kaṇṭhasthāne kamalam**]

इदानीं पञ्चमं कमलं षोदशदलं कण्ठस्थाने वर्तते। धूम्रवर्णम्॥ जीवो देवता॥ अविद्या शक्तिः॥ विराट ऋषिः॥ वायुर्वाहनम्॥ उदानवायुः॥ ज्वाला कला॥ जालन्धरो बन्धः॥ महाकारणदेहः॥ तूर्यावस्था॥ परा वाचा॥ अथर्वणवेदः॥ जङ्गमलिङ्गम्॥ जीवप्राप्ता भूमिका॥ सायुज्यता मोक्षः॥ षोडशदलानि॥ षोडशमातृकाः अन्तर्मातृकाः॥ अं आं इं ईं उं ऊं ऋं ॠं ऌं ॡं एं ऐं ॐ औं अं अंः॥ बहिर्मातृकाः॥ विद्या॥ अविद्या॥ इच्छा॥ शक्तिः॥ ज्ञानशक्तिः॥ शतला॥ महाविद्या॥ महामाया॥ बुद्धिः॥ तामसी॥ मैत्रा॥ कुमारी॥ मैत्रायणी॥ रुद्रा॥ पुष्टा॥ सिंहनी॥ अजपाजपः सहस्रः॥ १०००॥ घ। २ प। ४६ अक्षर ४०॥ **तन्मध्ये कोटिचन्द्रसमप्रभ एकः पुरुषो वर्तते। तस्य पुरुषस्य ध्यानकरणादसाध्यरोगा नश्यन्ति। एकसहस्रवर्षपर्यन्तं पुरुषो जीवति॥**

Sources: 3–12 cf. YSv (PT, p. 832) = YK: kalāpatraṃ pañcaman tu viśuddhaṃ kaṇṭhadeśataḥ | asya madhye pumān ekaḥ koṭicandrasamaprabhaḥ | naśyantya sādhyarogā hi sahasrāyuś ca cintanāt | 3–12 cf. SSP 2.5 (Ed. pp. 30–31): pañcamaṃ kaṇṭhacakraṃ caturaṅgulam | tatra vāma iḍā candranāḍī | dakṣiṇe piṅgalā sūryanāḍī | tanmadhye suṣumnāṃ dhyāyet | saiva anāhatakalā anāhatasiddhidā bhavati |

Testimonia: 3–12 ≈*Yogasaṃgraha* (IGNCA 30020 f. 3r. ll. 7–8): kaṃṭhasthāne paṃcamaṃ ṣodaśadalaṃ viśudhhasaṃjñakaṃ cakraṃ varttate ‖ tatra koṭicaṃdraprabha ekaḥ puruṣo sti tasya puruṣasya dhyānakaraṇād asādhyarogā naśyaṃti ‖ sahasravarṣaṃ jīvati |

Parallels: 3–10 ≈*Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334, ll. 79–96): oṃ saptamaṃ viśuddhicakraṃ kaṇṭhasthānaṃ dhūmravarṇaṃ jīvo devatā avidyā śaktiḥ virāṭ ṛṣi vāyu vāhana udāna vāyuḥ jvalā kalā jālāgni ++ vedā mahākāraṇadeha turyāvasthā parāvācā atharvanaveda jāṅgamaliṅga samatā bhūmikā salokatāmokṣa ṣoḍaśadala 16 ṣoḍaśamātrā aṃ āṃ iṃ īṃ uṃ ūṃ ṛṃ ṝṃ ḷṃ ḹṃ eṃ aiṃ oṃ auṃ aṃ aḥ antarāmātrā 16 bahirmātrā 16 vidyā 1 avidyā 2 icchā 3 kriyā 4 jñānaśaktiḥ 5 sitalā 6 mahāvidyā 7 mahāmāyā 8 buddhiḥ 9 tāmasa 10 maitra 11 maitrāyaṇī 12 kumārī 13 raudrā 14 pūrṇā 15 siṃhini 16 ajāpājāpya sahastaṃ 1000 ghaṭikā 2 palaṃ 46 akṣarā 40 pūjāmānasikā sohaṃ bhāvena pūjayet atragandhyādi samarpayāmi namaḥ

3 **idānīṃ** β] *om.* γ **kamalaṃ ṣodaśadalaṃ kaṇṭhasthāne** $N_1DK_1JU_1$] kamalaṣodaśadalaṃ kaṇṭhasthāne N_2, kaṇṭhasthāne ṣoḍaśadalaṃ kamalaṃ PEL, viśuddhacakraṃ kaṃṭhastāne U_2 **°varṇam** em.] °varṇe U_2 5 **°dehaḥ** em.] °deha U_2 6–7 **°mātṛkāḥ** em.] °mātrāḥ U_2 7 **°mātṛkāḥ** em.] °mātrār carāḥ U_2 **uṃ** em.] u U_2 8 **°mātṛkāḥ** em.] °mātrā U_2 **śaktiḥ** em.] śakti U_2 9 **tāmasī** em.] tamasī U_2 **puṣṭā** em.] puṣṭa° U_2 10 **°japaḥ sahasraḥ** em.] °japasahasra U_2 11 **°samaprabha** em.] °samaprabhaḥ $N_2N_1K_1JU_1P$, °samaprabhā DL, °samaprabhaḥ ‖ U_2, °sūryasamāna E **ekaḥ puruṣo** cett.] ekapuruṣo D, eka pumān U_2 **puruṣasya** cett.] puṃsaḥ U_2 **°kāraṇād** PEL] °karaṇāt cett. 12 **°paryantaṃ** cett.] *om.* L **puruṣo** cett.] sa puruṣo PE **jīvati** cett.] jīvatīdānīṃ E

[VIII. **Lotus within the location of the throat**]

Now, the fifth sixteen-petalled lotus exists at the location of the throat. The color is grey. The deity is Jīva. The power is ignorance. The Ṛṣi is Virāṭa. The mount is the vital wind. The vital wind is Udāna. The digit is the flame. The lock is Jālandhara. The body is the primordial cause (*mahākāraṇa*). The state is the fourth state (*tūrya*). The speech is Parā. The Veda is Atharvaṇa[veda]. The object of veneration is the movable. The level is Jīvaprāptā. The liberation is the union with the deity (*sāyujyatā*). [Associated with it are] sixteen petals [and] sixteen mother goddesses (*mātṛka*s). The internal syllables [are]: aṃ āṃ iṃ īṃ uṃ ūṃ ṛṃ ṝṃ ḷṃ ḹṃ eṃ aiṃ oṃ auṃ aṃ aṃḥ. The external mother goddesses [are]: Vidyā, Avidyā, Icchā, Śakti, Jñānaśakti, Śatalā, Mahāvidyā, Mahāmayā, Buddhi, Tāmasī, Maitrā, Kumārī, Maitrāyaṇī, Rudrā, Puṣṭā, Siṃhanī. A thousandfold recitation of the non-recitation; 1000; 2 *ghaṭi*s, 46 *pala*s. 40 *akṣara*s. In its middle exists the one consciousness[170] shining like a thousand moons. As a result of meditation on this consciousness, incurable diseases vanish. The person lives up to 1001 years.

[170] The term *puruṣa* appears in the last three sentences of this section. Judging by the context, *puruṣa* in the first two sentences must be understood as "consciousness", perhaps with the same connotations as in the Sāṃkhya-Yoga traditions. In contrast, the sentence concluding the section must refer to the person practising meditation.

[IX. **ājñācakram**]

इदानीं षष्ठचक्रं आज्ञानामकं वर्तते। अग्निर्देवता॥ सुषुम्णा शक्तिः॥ हंस ऋषिः॥ चैतन्यवाहनम्॥ ज्ञानदेहः॥ विज्ञानावस्था॥ अनुपमवाचा॥ सामवेदः॥ प्रमा–दलिङ्गम्॥†अर्धमात्रा॥† आकाशतत्त्वम्॥ जीवो हंसः॥ चैतन्यलीला आरंभः॥ द्वे मातृके॥ हं क्षं॥ अन्तर्मातृके॥ बहिर्मातृके॥ स्थितिः॥ प्रभा॥ अजपाज–पः सहस्रः॥ १०००॥ घ। २ प। ४६ अक्षर ४०॥ **तच्चक्रं भ्रुवोर्मध्ये द्विदलकं स्थि–तम्। तन्मध्येऽग्निज्वालाकारमकलं किंचिद्वस्तु वर्तते। न स्त्री न पुमान्। तस्य ध्यानकरणात्पुरुषस्य शरीरमजरामरं भवति॥**

Sources: 2–8 cf. YSv (PT, p. 832): ājñākhyaṃ ṣaṣṭhakaṃ (*ṣaṭkaṃ* YK 1.264) cakraṃ bhruvor madhye dvipatrakam | agnijvālānibhaṃ jyotiḥ puṃsaḥ strīto (*pūṃsastrīto* YK 1.264) vivarjitam | dhyānāc cāsya sarvasiddhirajarāmaratāṃ vrajet | 2–8 cf. SSP 2.7 (Ed. p. 31): saptamaṃ bhrūcakraṃ madhyamāṅguṣṭhamatram | tatra jñānanetraṃ dīpaśikhākāraṃ dhyāyet | tatra vāksiddhir bhavati |

Testimonia: 2–8 *Yogasaṃgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 3r. ll. 8–10): bhrūvor madhye dvidalaṃ ājñācakraṃ ṣaṣṭhaṃ | agnijvālākāraṃ paramātmasaṃjñakaṃ vastv āsti | tac ca na strīpumān | tasya dhyānakaraṇād ajarāmaraḥ sādhako bhavati |cha|

Parallels: 2–6 ≈*Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334, ll. 58–67): oṃ navamī ājñācakraṃ bhrūvorsthānaṃ pītavarṇaṃ agnir devatāḥ susumṇā śaktiḥ haṃsa ṛṣiḥ caitanyavāhana jñānadehī vijñānavasthā anupamā vācā suṣumṇā deva caitanyā śūnya nirārambha dvidala 2 antarmātrā haṃ caṃ bahirmātrā 2 sthiti 1 prabhāmi 2 ajapājapya ekasahasraṃ 1000 ghaṭi 9 palaṃ 46 akaṣarā 40 pramādā liṃgaṃ dve mātre ākāśatatva jīva haṃsa 4 pūjāmānasi kāmahaṃ bhāvena pūjāyet atra gandhādi samarpayāmi namaḥ

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2 **ṣaṣṭhacakraṃ** *β*] ṣaṣṭhaṃ bhrūmadhye PE, ṣaṣṭa bhrūmadhye U_2, ṣaṣṭhaḥ bhrūmadhye L **ājñā** cett.] ajñā N_2N_1D **nāmakaṃ** $N_1DK_1JU_1$] nāmaka N_2, cakraṃ PEL, cakraṃ raktavarṇaṃ U_2 **vartate** cett.] *om.* U_2 **agnir** em.] āgnir U_2 3 **jñānadehaḥ** em.] jñānadehī U_2 4 **akāśa°** em.] ākāśā° U_2 **jīvo haṃsaḥ** em.] jīvahiṃsa U_2 **°līlā āraṃbhaḥ** em.] °līlāraṃbhaḥ U_2 5 **mātṛke** em.] mātrā U_2 **antar mātṛke** em.] antar mātrā U_2 **bahir mātṛke** em.] bahirmātrā U_2 **sthitiḥ** em.] sthiti U_2 5–6 **ajapājapaḥ sahasraḥ** em.] ajapājapasahasra U_2 6–7 **tac cakraṃ bhruvor madhye dvidalakaṃ sthitam** *β*] dvidalaṃ PEL, *om.* U_2 7 **'gnijvālā°** E] agnijvālā° cett. **°kāram akalaṃ** em.] °kāraṃ akalaṃ $N_2N_1DK_1J$, °kāraṃ akala U_1, °kārakamalaṃ *γ* **kiṃcid vastu** cett.] kiṃcit vastu U_1 **na strī na pumān** cett.] na strī pumān ELB 8 **°karaṇāt** cett.] °karaṇāt | U_2 **śarīram ajarāmaraṃ** U_2] śarīraṃ ajarāmaraṃ *β*E, śarīraṃ ajarāmaro PLB **bhavati** cett.] bhavati ‖cha‖ J, bhavati vā U_2

Notes: 7 **agnijvālākāra°**: Witness B starts here.

[IX. **Ājñācakra**]

Now, a sixth[171] *cakra* named Ājñā exists.[172] The deity is fire. The power is the central channel. The Ṛṣi is Haṃsa. The mount is consciousness. The body is knowledge. The state is insight. The speech is the incomparable. The Veda is Samā[veda]. The object of veneration is intoxication. †[It is consisting of] half a measure.†[173] The principle is space. The gander is the living soul. The origin is the activity of consciousness. There are two *māṭṛka*s. The inner syllables [are]: haṃ [and] kṣam. The external mother goddesses [are]: Sthiti [and] Prabhā. A thousandfold recitation of the non-recitation; 1000; 2 *ghaṭi*s, 46 *pala*s, and 40 *akṣara*s. This two-petalled *cakra* is in the middle of the eyebrows. In its middle exists a certain object in the form of a blazing fire without parts. [It is] not female, [it is] not male. As a result of meditation on it, the body of the person becomes non-ageing and immortal.

[171] Interestingly, the scroll entitled *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334, ll. 68–77), which is situated in the same textual tradition as the supplementary material preserved in witness U_2, inserts—immediately prior to the *Ājñācakra* located between the eyebrows—an additional, eighth *cakra* positioned at the nose: *oṃ aṣṭamaṃ balavāñ cakraṃ nāsikāsthānaṃ oṃkāro devatā svaṣamnā śaktiḥ virāṭ ṛṣiḥ trivarṇata tridala 3 trimātrā 3 akāra ukāra makāra satvoguṇa rajoguṇa tamoguṇa brahmaviṣṇurudraḥ pṛthvī āpaḥ tejo vāyuḥ ākāśaḥ 5 prāṇa 'pāna vyāna dāna samāna 5 śabda sparśa rūpa rasa gandhaḥ 5 nāga kūrma kṛkala deva datta dhanañjaya 5 mano buddhi cittā antākaraṇa ahaṅkaraḥ 5 iḍā piṅgalā suṣuṃṇā.*

[172] *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.7 declares this *cakra* to be thumb-sized and calls it the eye of wisdom (*jñānanetram*) on which the practitioner is to meditate as a flame of a lamp thereby attaining perfection of speech: *saptamaṃ bhrūcakraṃ madhyamāṅguṣṭhamātram | tatra jñānanetraṃ dīpaśikhākāraṃ dhyāyet | tatra vāksiddhir bhavati |*

[173] It is difficult to make sense of *ardhamātrā*. My best guess is that an *ardha* divides something into two. It may be a synonymous expression referring to the two *mātṛka*s that follow.

[X. **cakraṃ tālumadhye**]

इदानीं सप्तमं चक्रं चतुःषष्टिदलं तालुमध्येऽमृतपूर्णं वर्तते। ललाटमण्डलम्॥ च–
न्द्रो देवता॥ अमृता शक्तिः॥ परमात्मा ऋषिः॥ अमृतवासिनीकला सप्तदशी॥
अमृतकल्लोलनदी॥ महाकाशा॥ अंबिका॥ लंबिका॥ घण्टिका॥ तालिका॥ अ–
5 जपागायत्री देहस्वरूपम्॥ काकमुखी॥ नरनेत्रा॥ गोश्रृङ्गा ललाटा॥ ब्रह्मपठा॥
हयग्रीवा॥ मयूरमुखा॥ हंसवदज्ञानि॥ अजपागायत्रीस्वरूपम्॥

Sources: 2 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 832–833): catuḥṣaṣṭidalaṃ tālumadhye cakran tu madhyamam | cf. SSP 2.6 (Ed. p. 31): ṣaṣṭhaṃ tālucakram | tatrāmṛtadhārāpravāhaḥ |

Testimonia: 2 ≈*Yogasaṃgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 3r. l. 10): tālumadhye catuḥṣaṣṭhidalaṃ amṛtapūrṇaṃ

Parallels: 2–6 ≈*Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334, ll. 49–52): oṃ daśame pūrṇagiripīṭhe lalāṭamaṇḍale candro devatā amṛtā śaktiḥ paramātmā ṛṣiḥ dvāviṃśaddalāni amṛtavāsinikalā 4 ambikā 1 lambikā 2 ghaṃṭkā 3 tālikā 4 dehasvarūpaṃ kākamukhaṃ 1 naranetraṃ 2 gośṛṅgaṃ 3 lalāṭabrahmapara 4 hayagrīvā 5 mayūramuśchaṃ 6 haṃsacārītani 7 sthāna

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2 **saptamaṃ** cett.] saptama° J **cakraṃ catuḥṣaṣṭhidalaṃ tālumadhye** β] tālumadhye catuḥṣaṣṭidalaṃ PU_2E, tāludeśe madhye catuḥṣaṣṭhidala LB **'mṛtapūrṇaṃ** em.] amṛtapūrṇaṃ cett., amṛtapūrṇa N_2 4 **mahākāśā** em.] mahākāśa U_2 5 **lalāṭā** em.] lalāṭa U_2 6 **°svarūpam** em.] °svarūpaṃ U_2

[X. **Cakra within the palate**]

Now, the seventh *cakra*, having sixty-four petals [and] being full of nectar, exists in the middle of the palate.[174] The Maṇḍala is the forehead.[175] The deity is the moon. The power is the nectar of immortality. The Ṛṣi is the supreme self. The seventeenth digit is the residence of the nectar of immortality. [It is] the river that has waves consisting of nectar of immortality. [It is] the great space. [It is] the "little mum"[176] [It is] the uvula. [It is] the Tālikā[177]. [It is] the "little bell". The unspeakable Gāyatrī is the own form of [its] body.[178] Crow-beaked, human-eyed[179], cow-horned forehead, reciting the Brahman,[180] horse-necked, peacock-faced [and] swan-limbed is the own form of the unspeakable Gayatrī.[181]

[174] The *tālucakra* follows the *ājñācakra* between the eyebrows, deviating from the usual ascending sequence. Rāmacandra adopts this order from the *Yogasvarodaya* (cf. table 19 in Powell, 2023: 214) but revises it in his second ninefold system in *Tattvayogabindu* XXIX (p. 194), following the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, which places the *tālucakra* before the *ājñācakra*.

[175] The scribe of U_2 likely altered the sentence to fit Rāmacandra's *cakra* system. The reading *lalāṭamaṇḍale* in the *Nāḍīcakra* scroll (ORIS 1334) is preferable, as the *cakra* is located at the forehead rather than the palate. Rāmacandra's deviation from the expected ascending sequence may thus reflect a conflation of different interpretive traditions.

[176] The terms *aṃbikā*, *laṃbikā*, *ghaṇṭikā*, and *tālikā* may refer to the uvula. In the *Jogpradīpyakā*, the haṭhayogic practice called *manthana* has two variations, see Mallinson, 2010: 207, n. 250. The second type (vv. 643–653) instructs the yogin to use a metal peg (*kīla dhātamaya*) to churn, purify, and produce *amī* (= *amṛta*) at four locations: *ambikā* (frenum), *lambikā* (tongue), *tālu* (palate), and *ghaṇṭikā* (uvula). These places correspond to the teats of Kāmadhenu, the "wish-fulfilling cow" (v. 651). The *Vairāṭapurāṇa* locates an *amṛtacakra* at the forehead emitting "nectar". That is the dwelling place of the *gāyatrī*, known as Kāmadhenu, with four teats: Ambikā, Lambikā, Ghaṇṭikā, and Tālikā, see Kavirāj, 1987: 50.

[177] The precise meaning of *tālikā* is unclear. In a private correspondence (November 2023), Mallinson suggested it might originate from *tālu*.

[178] Tantric *mantra*s are often associated with a deity and their bodies, see Haas, 2022: 20.

[179] The concept of "human eyes" probably emphasises the contrast with the traditional notion of crows possessing only a single eye. Thanks to Dr. Dominic A. Haas for this hint.

[180] Possibly the Veda or any sacred word, like i.e. the sacred syllable *oṃ* or speculatively even the *ajapāgāyatrī* itself. However, whether the *haṃsa mantra* is considered a Vedic Brahman is unclear. I am grateful for Dr. Dominic A. Haas suggestions regarding this passage.

[181] The bird-like body of the *ajapāgāyatrī* refers to the body of a particular *haṃsa* ("swan"), …

अधिकतरशोभायुक्तम्॥ अतिश्वेतम्॥ तन्मध्ये रक्तवर्णं घण्टिकासंज्ञा एका क–
र्णिका वर्तते। तन्मध्ये भूमिः। तन्मध्येऽप्रकटचन्द्रकला अमृतधारास्रवन्ती वर्तते।
तस्याः कलाया ध्यानकरणात् तस्य समीपे मरणं नायाति। निरन्तरध्यानकरणा–
दमृतधारा स्रवति। तदा क्षयरोगपित्तज्वरहृदयदाहशिरोरोगजिह्वाजडभावा नश्य–
5 न्ति। भक्षितं विषमपि न बाध्यते। यद्यत्र मनः स्थिरं भवति॥

Sources: 1–5 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 832–833): pīyūṣapūrṇaṃ (*pīyūṣapūrṇa°* YK 1.266) koṭīndusannibhaṃ (*°sannibha°* YK 1.266) cāmṛtasthalī | tanmadhye ghaṭikāsaṃjñā karṇikā raktasannibhā | saha cendukalā tatrāmṛtadhārāṃ (*tāndrā°* YK 1.267) sravaty asau | etad dhyātvāmṛtaiḥ snātvā sadā yogāt pramucyate | unmādajvarapittādidāhaśūlādivedanāḥ (*°śūnyā°* YK 1.268) | naśyanti ca śiroduḥkhaṃ jāḍyabhāvo 'pi naśyati | sadyodhyānādbhuktaviśvaṃ jihvājāḍyañ ca naśyati (last hemistich *om.* in YK) 1–5 cf. SSP 2.6 (Ed. p. 31): ghaṃṭikāliṅgaṃ mūlarandhraṃ rājadantaṃ śaṃkhinīvivaraṃ daśamadvāram | tatra śūnyaṃ dhyāyet | cittalayo bhavati ||

Testimonia: 1–5 ≈*Yogasaṃgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 3r. l. 11 to 3v. ll. 1–2): adhikataraśobhayuktaṃ atiśvetaṃ cakraṃ | tanmadhye raktavarṇaghaṃṭikāsaṃjñā varttate | tanmadhye prakaṭacandrakalā amṛtādhārāsravaṃtī varttate | tasyāḥ kalāyā nirantaraṃ dhyānakartum maraṇaṃ kṣayarogaḥ pettajvarahṛdayadāhaśiro++++jihvāyājaḍyaṃ ca naśyati

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1 **°kataraśobhāyuktam** N_2K_1] °kataraśobhayuktaṃ N_1DJU_1PLB, °kataraprabhāmuktaṃ U_2, °kaśobhāyuktam E **atiśvetam** em.] atiśvetaṃ cett. **raktavarṇaṃ** cett.] raktavarṇa° N_2K_1 **ghaṇṭikā°** cett.] ghaṭikā° P, ghāṃṭikā° E, ghaṇikā° L **ekā** cett.] ekā ekā LB 2 **bhūmiḥ** cett.] bhūmis JU_1, bhūmi U_2 **'prakaṭa°** cett.] pragaṭa° U_1, °ṃdrakaṭaṃ U_2 **amṛtadhārāsravantī** cett.] 'mṛtādhārā sravati PU_2, 'mṛtādhārā bhavati E, 'mṛtādhārā sravaṃti LB **vartate** β] *om.* γ 3 **kalāyā** cett.] kalāyāḥ $N_2N_1K_1JU_1$, karṇikāyā LB **nāyāti** cett.] na yāti U_2LB **nirantara°** cett.] nirantaraṃ K_1 3–4 **°dhyānakaraṇād** cett.] °dhyānād PE 4 **amṛtadhārā** cett.] amṛtadhārā plāvanaṃ P, amṛtadhārā plavanaṃ U_2, amṛtadhārāyāḥ sajīvo E **sravati** U_1LB] sravaṃti $N_2N_1DK_1$, sravanaṃ bhavati J, bhavati PU_2E **tadā** γ] *om.* β **kṣayarogapittajvarahṛdayadāhaśirorogajihvājaḍabhāvā** em.] kṣayarogaṃ pittajvarahṛdayadāhaśirorogajihvāyājaḍabhāvātā N_2, kṣayarogaṃ pittajvarahṛdayadāhaśirorogajihvāyājaḍabhāvā N_1, kṣayaṃ rogaṃ pittajvarahṛdayadāhaśirorogajihvāyājaḍabhāvā DK_1, kṣayarogapittajvarahṛdayadāhaśirorogajihvāyājaḍabhāvā JU_1, kṣayarogapittajvarahṛdayadāhaśirorogajihvājaḍabhāvān P, kṣayarogoptatti || jvara hṛdayadāha || śiroroga || jihvājaḍatā || dayo U_2, yakṣamarogapittajvarahṛdayadāhaśirorogajihvājaḍabhāvā E, kṣayarogapittajvarahṛdayadāharogajihvāyājaḍabhāvān L, kṣayarogapittajvarahṛdayadāharogajihvāyājaḍavān B 5 **bhakṣitaṃ** N_2U_1] bhakṣitam N_1, bhakṣitāṃ DK_1J, bhakṣitam api PU_2EL, bhākṣitamār pi B **viṣam api** β] viṃṣa P, viṣaṃ U_2LB, viṣan E **bādhyate** cett.] bādhate N_2PE **yady atra** cett.] yadyan na N_2DK_1J, yady atram api LB **manaḥ sthiraṃ** JPE] manasthiraṃ cett.

[It is] endowed with superabundant beauty. [It is] very bright. In its middle exists a unique central receptacle named "the little bell" (*ghāṇṭikā*)[182] being red in colour. In its centre is a site. In the middle of that exists the hidden digit of the moon, which is oozing a stream of nectar. As a result of meditation on this digit, death does not go near him. As a result of uninterrupted meditation, the stream of nectar flows. Then, the states of wasting[-disease] (*kṣayaroga*),[183] bilious fever (*pittajvara*),[184] burning sensation of the heart (*hṛdayadāha*),[185] head-disease (*śiroroga*),[186] and tongue insensibility (*jihvājāḍya*)[187] vanish. Even ingested venom does not trouble if the mind is fixed on it.

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since the *ajapāgayatrī* contains the unrecited [*a*]*haṃ sa* "I am that" expression. The *haṃsa* is a common metaphor for the soul wandering in the wheel of Brahman or Saṃsāra, cf. *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* 1.6 and 3.18. The animal parts may symbolise the various physical embodiments which the *jīva* undergoes as it passes through the *brahmacakra*. The manuscript *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334) contains an illustration of the *dehasvarūpa* of *ajapāgāyatrī*. The text surrounding the illustration is almost identical to the description of U_2 found here. See p. 489 for the facsimile with the illustration. Furthermore, Haas, 2022: 191–192 notes that while the association between the Vedic Gāyatrī and birds was once prominent in Vedic literature, it seems to have diminished. Here, however, it has survived in the context of the *ajapāgāyatrī*. Furthermore, in the *Nāḍīcakra* scroll (ORIS 1334), between the description of the ninth *Ājñā-cakra* (ll. 58–67) and that of the subsequent tenth *cakra* (ll. 49–52), there appears an additional passage describing the Suṣumṇā (ll. 53–57): *oṃ tejomayī nāḍī suṣumnā madhyagāmṛtā yasyā mitaṃ idaṃ viśvaṃ proktaṃ ca puṭataṇḍavayogibhis tat praya 'nena jñeyā sā dehavarttinī tāṃ na jānanti ye mūḍhāḥ vṛthā te bhāravāhakāḥ tasyādidaṃ cakraṃ dhyeyaṃ jñeyaṃ ca vijñātamaiḥ.*

[182] The term *ghaṇṭikā*, meaning "little bell," commonly denotes the uvula, see Mallinson, 2010: 24, 207 n. 250, 210 n. 260 and Padoux, 1994: 126f. Within the sixfold *cakra*-system of *Kubjikāmatatantra* 7.85, the uvula serves as a pathway for the ascent of breath, *mantra*, and self between the fifth and the sixth *cakra*: *lalanāghaṇṭike yojya pañcamaṃ sthānam ākramet | ākramed guhyacakraṃ tu karaṇaṃ cordhvamūlakam ||*

[183] A fever that causes bodily depletion, cf. *Āyurvedīya Mahākośa (Āyurvedīya Śabdakośa) Sanskrit-Sanskrit [Dictionary]*, Jośī, 1968: 441–442.

[184] A fever due to disordered bile, cf. ibid. Jośī, 1968: 618.

[185] The burning sensation in the heart caused by heart disease resulting from disordered bile, cf. ibid. Jośī, 1968: 1721.

[186] The term refers to disorders of the head. When blood, fat, phlegm, or vata decreases, severe pain results; cf. ibid. Jośī, 1968: 1452.

[187] Stiffness or numbness of the tongue, cf. ibid. Jośī, 1968: 1452.

[XI. **aṣṭamacakraṃ brahmarandhrasthāne**]

इदानीं अष्टमचक्रं ब्रह्मरन्ध्रस्थाने शतदलं वर्तते। गुरुदेवता॥ चैतन्यशक्तिः॥ विराट ऋषिः॥ सर्वोत्कृष्टसाक्षिः॥ भूततुर्यातीतचैतन्यात्मकम्॥ सर्ववर्णाः॥ सर्वमात्राः॥ सर्वदलानि॥ विराट देहः॥ स्थितावस्था॥ प्रज्ञा वाचा॥ सोहं वेदः॥ अनुपमस्थानं॥ अजपाजपः सहस्रः॥ १००० घटि २ पला ४६ अक्षर ४०॥ सर्वजपः संख्या॥ २१६००॥ एकविंशतिसहस्राणि षड्शतानि॥ तथैव च निशाहे वहते॥ प्राणं यो जानाति स पण्डितः॥

सकारेण बहिर्याति हकारेण विशेत् पुनः।
हंसः सोऽहं ततो मन्त्रं जीवो जपति सर्वदा॥ XI.1॥

Sources: 2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 833): brahmarandhre 'ṣṭamaṃ cakraṃ śatapatraṃ mahāprabham | cf. SSP 2.8 (Ed. pp. 31–32): aṣṭamaṃ brahmarandhraṃ nirvāṇacakraṃ sūcikāgrabhedyam |

Parallels: 2–9 ≈*Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334, ll. 25–48): oṃ ekādaśaṃ sahasradalacakraṃ mūrvnisthānaṃ guru dīptiḥ caitanyaśaktiḥ virāṭ ṛṣiḥ sarvotkṛṣṭasampattiḥ tayoḥ tīta caitanyātmakā sarvavarṇaṃ sarvamātrā sarvadā virāṭ daha sthitnyavasthā prajāvācā so haṃ veda anupame sthāna ajapā ekasahasra 1000 ghaṭikāḥ 2 śaṃ 4 a 9, 40 so haṃsa saṃkhya 21600 ekaviṃśati sahasrāṇi ṣaṭśatāni tataiva ca śaśahe vahate prāṇā sa ca kālaṃ vinaśyati sakāreṇa bahir yāti hakāreṇa viśet punaḥ haṃ so haṃ so tato mantraṃ jīve japati sarvadā 8–9 ≈*Vijñānabhairava* 156: sakāreṇa bahir yāti hakāreṇa viśet punaḥ | haṃsa haṃsety amuṃ mantraṃ jīvo japati nityaśaḥ || 8–9 ≈*Vivekamārtaṇḍa* 29: hakāreṇa bahir yāti sakāreṇa viśaty adhaḥ | haṃsa haṃsety amuṃ mantraṃ jīvo japati sarvadā || 8–9 ≈*Yogabīja* 106: hakāreṇa bahir yāti sakāreṇa viśen marut | haṃsa haṃseti mantro 'yaṃ sarvajīvā japanti vai || 8–9 quoted with reference (*yogabīje*) ≈*Yogacintāmani* (f. 6r): sakāreṇa bahir yāti hakāreṇa viśen marut | haṃsa haṃseti amum mantraṃ jīvo japanti sarvadā || 8–9 quoted with reference (*yogabīje*) ≈*Haṭhatattvakaumudī* 22.27: hakāreṇa bahir yāti sakāreṇa viśet punaḥ | haṃsa haṃseti mantro'yaṃ sarve jīvā japanti vai || 8–9 ≈*Yogaśikhopaniṣad* 1.130cd–131ab (Ed. p. 416): hakāreṇa bahir yāti sakāreṇa viśet punaḥ | haṃsa haṃseti mantro 'yaṃ sarvair jīvaiś ca japyate ||

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2 **aṣṭamacakraṃ brahmarandhrasthāne śatadalaṃ** $N_2N_1DK_1J$] aṣṭamaṃ cakraṃ brahmaraṃdhrasthāne śatadalaṃ U_1, brahmarandhrasthāne 'ṣṭamaṃ śatadalaṃ cakraṃ PU_2E, brahmaraṃdhrasthāne aṣṭamaṃ śatadalaṃ cakraṃ LB 4 **dehaḥ** em.] deha U_2 **vedaḥ** em.] veda U_2 5 **ajapājapaḥ sahasraḥ** em.] ajapājapasahasra U_2 5–6 **sarvajapaḥ** em.] sarvajapa° U_2 7 **prāṇaṃ** em.] prāṇaḥ U_2

[XI. **Eighth cakra at the aperture of brahman**]

Now, [there] exists the eighth *cakra* having one hundred petals at the location of the aperture of Brahman.[188] The deity is the teacher. The power is consciousness. The Ṛṣi is Virāṭa.[189] [It is] the witness above everything. The nature of consciousness is the state beyond the fourth state. [It has] all colours. [It has] all *mātrā*s.[190] [It has] all petals. The body is Virāṭa.[191] The state is steady.[192] The speech is wisdom. The Veda is the "I am that"-[expression] (*so'haṃ*). The place is unsurpassed. A thousandfold recitation of the non-recitation; 1000; 2 *ghaṭi*s, 46 *pala*s, 40 *akṣara*s. The count of all mutterings [per day] is 21600. In this way, it carries on day and night. He who knows the breath is a learned person.

XI.1 With the sound "sa", he exhales. With the sound "ha", he inhales again: "I am he, he is I". Because of that, the embodied soul constantly utters the Mantra.[193,194]

[188] The *brahmarandhra*, often termed the "aperture of Brahman," is a tiny opening at the crown near the fontanelle. Its name originates from ancient Upaniṣadic beliefs, portraying it as a portal for the individual soul (*ātman*) to surpass bodily limitations and merge with the absolute (*brahman*).

[189] The Ṛṣi Virāṭa was previously assigned to the fifth *cakra*.

[190] This could refer either to syllables or to mother goddesses, or to both.

[191] Due to the previously mentioned assignment of *virāṭa* to the Ṛṣi of the *cakra*, this could be an eyeskip, so that the originally intended assignment of the *deha* of the eighth *cakra* would be lost.

[192] Possibly in the sense of cessation.

[193] The exact source of this verse is unclear. Considering the possibilities presented in the parallels, it appears evident that this verse represents a mixed variant. It is likely that this verse was widespread in the yoga traditions of the time and was transmitted from text to text and orally from teacher to student, which may have led to the continual emergence of new variants.

[194] The supplementary material in U_2 on this *cakra* terminates at this point, whereas the Nāḍīcakra scroll (ORIS 1334) transmits a slightly longer passage. Immediately following the verse, it reads (diplomatically transcribed): *ādhare liṅganabhau hṛdaya sarasi je tālamūle lalāṭe dvīpatre śoḍaśāre dvidaśadaśadale dvādaśāre catuṣkayāsānte bālamadhye ḍapha kaṭa sahite kaṇṭhadeśe svarāṇāṃ haṃ kam tatvārthayuktaṃ sakaladalayutaṃ varṇarūpaṃ namāmi.* This passage …

तस्य कमलस्य जालन्धरपीठ इति संज्ञा। सिद्धपुरुषस्य स्थानं। तन्मध्येऽग्निधूमाकारा रेखा यादृशी। तादृश्येका पुरुषस्य मूर्तिर्ववर्तते। तस्या नादिर्नान्तोऽस्ति। तस्या मूर्ते र्ध्यानकरणात्प्रत्यक्षं निरन्तरं पुरुषस्याकाशे गमागमौ भवतः। पृथ्वीमध्ये स्थितस्यापि पृथ्वीबाधो न भवति। सकलं प्रत्यक्षं निरन्तरं पश्यति पृथग्भवति। अतिशयेनायुर्वर्धते॥

Sources: 1–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 833): jālandharaṃ nāma pīṭhaṃ etat tu parikīrttitam | siddhapuṃsaḥ (°*puṃsa*° YK 1.270) sthalaṃ jñātvā agnidhūmanibhā śikhā | ādimadhyāntahīnā strīpuṃmūrtti (°*mūrtir* YK 1.270) varttate parā | antajñānī (*antaryāmī* YK 1.271) bhaved dhyānād ākāśe 'pi samāgamaḥ | nirantaraṃ sarvavettā ity ūccāno mahān bhavet | jaganmadhye sthito jantur jagadbādhāvivarjitaḥ | 1–5 cf. SSP 2.8 (Ed. pp. 31–32): tatra dhūmaśikhākāraṃ dhyāyet | tatra jālandharapīṭhaṃ mokṣapradaṃ bhavati |

Testimonia: 1–5 ≈*Yogasaṃgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 3v. ll. 2–5): brahmaraṃdhre śatadalaṃ jālaṃdharapīṭhasaṃjñakaṃ siddhapuruṣasyānacakraṃ tanmadhye gnidhūmrāreṣākārā ādimadhyaṃtarahitā puruṣasya mūrttir asti | tasyāḥ dhyānakartuḥ pṛthivyāṃ sthitāv api pṛthvī kṛtabādho na bhavati | trikālikajñānaṃ pratyakṣaṃ bhavati | āyurvṛddiḥ liṃgaśarīreṇa sarvatra pratyakṣaṃ gamāgamo bhavati |

1 **kamalasya** cett.] kamala° E **jālandharapīṭha** cett.] jātyadharaṇīpīṭha E, jālandharapīṭha° B **iti** cett.] *om.* B **saṃjñā** cett.] °saṃjñā B **°puruṣasya sthānam** cett.] sthānam mūrti vartate LB 1–2 **'gnidhūmākārā rekhā** LB] agnidhūmrākārarekhā N_2, 'gnidhūmākārā reṣā N_1, agnidhūmākārā reṣā DK_1, agnidhūmākārārekhā J, agnidhūmrākārā rekhā U_1, 'gnidhūmākārarekhā PE, 'gnidhūmrākārā rekhāyāḥ U_2 2 **yādṛśī** cett.] etādṛśī U_2, yādṛśy° E **tādṛśy** βPLB] *om.* U_2, ādṛsy E **vartate** cett.] vartaṃte K_1 **tasyā** γ] tasyāḥ β **nādir nānto'sti** cett.] nāsty aṃtaḥ ādir api nāsti $N_2N_1DK_1U_1$, aṃta ādir api nāsti J, nādināṃ 'to sti P 3 **tasyā** PELB] tasyāḥ cett. **mūrter** U_1PU_2E] mūrtir N_2N_1DJLB, mūrti° K_1 **dhyānakaraṇāt pratyakṣaṃ nirantaraṃ** EB] dhyānakaraṇāt pratyakṣanirantaraṃ cett. **puruṣasyākāśe** cett.] puruṣa ākāśe N_2, puruṣasya ākāśe N_1DK_1J, puruṣasya ākāśi U_1, puruṣasyākāśa° U_2 **°gamau** cett.] °game N_2K_1, °gamo JU_1 **bhavataḥ** cett.] bhavati J, bhavata U_2 3–4 **pṛthvīmadhye** cett.] pṛtivīmadhye U_2B 4 **sthitasyāpi** γ] sthitāv api β **pṛthvībādho** EL] pṛthvīkṣato bādho β, pṛthaka P, pṛthvībādho ko U_2, pṛtvībādho B **na bhavati** cett.] bhavati P **sakalaṃ pratyakṣaṃ nirantaraṃ** em.] sakalāpratyakṣaṃ nirantaraṃ β, *om.* PU_2, sakalān pratyakṣaṃ niraṃtaraṃ E, sakalāḥ pratyakṣaṃ niraṃtara LB **paśyati** cett.] *om.* PU_2, paśyatī LB 4–5 **pṛthagbhavati** E] ca pṛthak ca bhavati $N_2N_1K_1JU_1$, ca pṛthak pṛthak bhavati D, *om.* PU_2, ca pṛthak bhavati LB 5 **atiśayenāyur** PE] atiśayena āyur β, *om.* U_2, atīśayanāyur LB **vardhate** cett.] vardhayate LB

"The seat of Jālandhara" is the name of its lotus.[195] [It is] the place of the accomplished person. In the middle of it, there is a streak that looks like the manifestation of smoke and fire, and in such a way, the unique manifestation of consciousness exists. It has no end nor a beginning. As a result of meditation on the manifestation, direct perception of both the coming and going of the soul in space arises. Affliction from the earth-element does not arise [anymore] even if one is within the earth.[196] One constantly sees everything directly [and] one becomes separate.[197] The span of life increases significantly.

constitutes a highly corrupt and partially difficult-to-reconstruct doxographical enumeration of localisations, presented in ascending order and occasionally accompanied by iconographic features such as the number of petals or phonetic elements.

[195] For a similar concept of Jālandhara see the description of the eighth *cakra* in *Saubhāgyalakṣmyupaniṣad* and *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.8.

[196] The meditation effect described here is probably an allusion to a yogic practice usually referred to in Hindi as *bhūmigat samādhi*. Through a trance-like state of *samādhi*, certain yogis enable themselves to be buried underground for an extended period of time without suffering any lasting damage. See Mallinson, 2010: 233 n. 45 and Mallinson and Singleton, 2017: 327, 342–345 for more details on the practice and historical accounts. Biological studies have even been conducted to better understand the mechanisms of the human body that underlie this practice. See Heller, Elsner, and Nageswara, 1987.

[197] Probably "separate from the rest of matter" in the Sāṃkhya-Yoga sense.

[XII. **mahāśūnyacakram**]

इदानीं नवमचक्रस्य भेदाः कथ्यन्ते। तस्य महाशून्यचक्रमिति संज्ञा। तदुपर्यपरं किमपि नास्ति। तदेव महासिद्धचक्रं कथ्यते। तस्य पूर्णगिरिपीठमित्येतादृशं नाम। तस्य महाशून्यचक्रस्य मध्य ऊर्ध्वमुखमतिरक्तवर्णं सकलशोभास्पदमने–
5 ककल्याणपूर्णं सहस्रदलं एकं कमलं वर्तते यस्य परिमलो मनसो वचसो चागोचरः तस्य कमलस्य मध्ये त्रिकोणरूपैका कर्णिका वर्तते।

Sources: 2–6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 833): navaman tu mahāśūnyaṃ cakran tu tatparāt param | tad upari paraṃ kiñcin nāsti kiñcin mahāparam | mahācakraṃ siddhacakraṃ pūrṇagauryādisaṃjñakam | tanmadhye varttate padmaṃ sahasradalam adbhutam | ūrddhvavakraṃ mahāvaktre (*mahāvaktraṃ* YK 1.274) varṇaśobhāpadaṃ mahat | sarvakalyāṇasampūrṇamasya tulyaṃ na vidyate | parimāṇaṃ vaktam (*vaktum* YK 1.275) asya manasā vacasā na hi | trikoṇakarṇikā tatra (°*tantraṃ* YK 1.276) varttate jagad īśvari | 2–6 cf. SSP 2.9 (Ed. pp. 32): navamam ākāśacakraṃ soḍaśadalakamalam ūrdhvamukham | tanmadhye karṇikāyāṃ trikūṭākārāṃ tad ūrdhvaśaktiṃ tāṃ paramaśunyāṃ dhyāyet | tatraiva pūrṇagiripīṭhaṃ sarveṣṭasiddhipradaṃ bhavati |

Testimonia: 2–6 ≈*Yogasaṃgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 3v. ll. 6–9): brahmaraṃdhre eva śatadalacakropari mahāśūnyacakraṃ mahāsiddhacakraṃ pūrṇagiricakraṃ iti saṃjñakaṃ sahasradalaṃ cakraṃ asti | tad upari kiṃcin nāsti | tac cakraṃ atiraktaṃ ūrdhvamukhaṃ sakalaśobhāspadaṃ anekakalyāṇapūrṇaṃ mano vācām agocara parimalo petaṃ | tat kamalamadhye trikoṇākarṇikā |

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2 **navama°** cett.] navamaś U_1, navamaṃ B **bhedāḥ** cett.] bheda N_2 **kathyante** cett.] kathyate N_2U_2LB **mahāśūnya°** cett.] mahāśūnye N_1LB, *om.* U_2 **°cakram iti** PELB] cakreti β, *om.* U_2 **saṃjñā** cett.] *om.* U_2 **tad upary** PEB] tad upari βL, *om.* U_2 **aparaṃ** cett.] *om.* U_2LB 3 **kim api** cett.] kiṃ api β, *om.* U_2 **tasya** cett.] tasya cakrasya β, madhye tasya U_2 **pūrṇagiri** cett.] pūrṇagire JU_1 **°pīṭham** PU_2LB] °pīṭha E, *om.* cett. **ity** em.] *om.* βE, iti PU_2, iti saṃjñā LB **etādṛśaṃ** cett.] ekādaśaṃ U_2, etadṛśaṃ E 4 **nāma** cett.] nāmaḥ U_1 **°cakrasya madhye** em.] °cakramadhye β, cakrasya madhye PELB, °cakrasya U_2 **ūrdhvamukham** β] ūrdhmukham PEL, urdhvamukham U_2, ūrdhvamukhem B **atiraktavarṇaṃ** β] iti raktavarṇa° P, ativarṇaṃ U_2, iti raktavarṇaṃ ELB **°śobhāspadam** cett.] °śobhanāsyadaṃ U_2, °śobhāspadam E 5 **°pūrṇaṃ** cett.] °pūrṇa° N_2B **sahasradalaṃ** cett.] sahasradala K_1 **ekaṃ** cett.] eka° D, *om.* U_1 **vartate** cett.] vartato B **yasya** cett.] yasya kamalasya U_2 **manaso vacaso** E] manasā vacasā $N_2N_1DK_1PLB$, manasā vācā U_2 **cāgocaraḥ** conj.] na gocara N_2U_2, na gocaraḥ $N_1DK_1JU_1PEB$, gocaraḥ L 6 **kamalasya** cett.] kamala° P **trikoṇarūpaikā** E] trikoṇārūpā ekā cett., trikoṇārūpā eka N_2N_1

[XII. **Cakra of the great void**]

Now, the divisions of the ninth *cakra* are explained.[198,199] The designation of it is "the *cakra* of the great void". Above that, there is no other. Therefore, it is declared the "the great accomplished *cakra*". [Another] such name is "[divine] seat of Pūrṇagiri". In the middle of that *mahāśūnyacakra* exists a single upward-facing extremely red thousand-petalled lotus—an abode of absolute splendour— full of countless blessings, whose fragrance is not in range of mind [and] speech, [and] in the centre of this lotus exists one central receptacle in the shape of a triangle.

[198] Other texts incorporate systems of nine places. For example *Kumbhakapaddhati* 91–92, which presents a technique of *kumbhaka* for *pratyāhāra*: *navasthānāni vijñāya pratyāhāraḥ sa vedhasaḥ | pādatalaguhyanābhihṛdayoraḥkaṇṭhaganṭikāḥ kramataḥ* ‖ 91 ‖ *bhrūmadhyaṃ ca lalāṭaṃ brahmasthānaṃ navaitāni | yogasiddhiḥ sarvaroganāśaḥ pratyāhṛtau bhavet* ‖ 92 ‖ "Having realised the nine places, this [following description] is the withdrawal of the senses according to the creator. Holding [the breath] in the sequence of [the following places] brings about success in yoga and destruction of all diseases: soles of the feet, generative organ, navel, heart, throat, uvula, middle of the eyebrows, forehead and the crown of the head". In the *Gorakṣapaddhati* 2.75–76 one finds nine places as *dhyānasthāna*s, "places for meditation": *gudaṃ meḍhraṃ ca nābhiś ca hṛtpadmaṃ ca tad ūrdhvataḥ | ghaṇṭikā laṃbikāsthāna bhrūmadhye ca nabhobilam* ‖ 75 ‖ *kathitāni navaitāni dhyānasthānāni yogibhiḥ |upādhitatvamuktāni kurvanty aṣṭaguṇodayam* ‖ 76 ‖ "Anus and generative organ and navel, heart and [the place] above [the heart], uvula, tongue, middle of eyebrows and crown of the head. These are the nine places of meditation [taught] by the yogis, freeing one from the material world's limitations and bestowing the eight supernatural powers."

[199] Similar ninefold *cakra* systems can be identified in the *Yogasvarodaya*, the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, and the *Yogakarṇikā*. Yet another text that presents a similar system and most likely quoted the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* without reference but with several redactions is the *Saubhāgyalakṣmyupaniṣad*.

तत्कर्णिकामध्ये सप्तदशी एका निरञ्जनरूपा कला वर्त्तते। कोटिसूर्यसमप्रभं कलायास्तेजो वर्तते। परमुष्णभावो नास्ति। कोटिचन्द्रसमप्रभं शीतलं परं शीतभावो नास्ति। अस्याः कलाया ध्यानकरणात्साधकस्य दुःखं मनसि न भवति। अत्र स्थानेऽहं देवता ॥ सोऽहं शक्तिः ॥ आत्मा ऋषिः ॥ मोक्षमार्गः ॥ हं ब्रह्मोर्ध्वम् ॥ हं चक्र इति ॥ अग्निचक्रे सकारो भवति ॥ प्राणी रूढो भवेज्जीव आरोहत्यवरोहति ॥ भवगुहा स्थानम् ॥ पीतवर्णम् ॥ कोटिसूर्यप्रतिकाशं तेजः ॥ सदोदितप्रभा ॥ शिवो देवता ॥ मूलमाया शक्तिः ॥ हर आत्मालयावस्था ध्वनिस्थिरा नादात्मकोऽखण्डध्वनिः ॥ अघोरा मुद्रा ॥ †मूलमाया ॥† ॥ प्रकृतिदेहः ॥ वाङ्मनोऽगोचरः ॥ निःप्रपञ्चः ॥ निःसंशयः ॥ †निस्तरङ्गनिर्लेपलक्षं लयध्यानसमाधि ॥†

Sources: 1–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 833): nirañjanakalā sā tu koṭisūryasamaprabhā | koṭicandraprabhā caiva śītoṣṇādivivarjitā | asya dhyānāt sādhakasya manoduḥkhaṃ bhaven na hi | asya dhyānāt sādhakasya manoduḥkhaṃ bhaven na hi |

Testimonia: 1–3 ≈*Yogasaṃgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 3v. ll. 10–11): tasyāṃ karṇikāyāṃ saptadaśī niraṃjanarūpā koṭisūryaprabhā satī uṣṇabhava hīnā koṭicandrasamasītalaikākalāsti | tasyāṃ anaṃtaparamānaṃtaparamānaṃdānāṃ sthānaṃ tasyāḥ kalāyā dhyānakaraṇāt sādhako yadyādiśati tatra bhavati |

Parallels: 3–9 ≈*Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334, ll. 9–24): oṃ namaḥ paramātmane pūrvapakṣam idaṃ proktaṃ paramānandagiro kṛtaṃ anubhāvāt kathitaṃ śāstraṃ navacakraṃ prakīrtitaḥ oṃ dvādaśāra brahmarandhrasthānaṃ pītavarṇaṃ śirasthānaṃ sūryakoṭipratikāśaṃ tejasvinīdīptaprabhā śivo devatā mūlamāyā śaktiḥ paramātmārṣiḥ layāvasthā dhunīsthitiḥ nādātmakaṃ śūnyamudrā mūlamāyā prakṛtiḥ deha vāṅmano 'gocaraḥ niṣprapañca nissaṃśaya nistaraṅga nirlepa 1 laya 2 lakṣa 3 samādhi 4 parambrahmasthānaṃ mahāmantraṃ japet ‖ brahmerandhe dehasuṣumṇāmārgasuṣumṇā avasthār ūrdhvaprayogātma ‖ oṃ brahmarandhradehasusumṇāmārga suṣumṇā avasthār ūrdhvaprayogātmāhaṃ brahmarandheti agnicakre sakāro bhavati ‖

1 **saptadaśī** cett.] saptadaśireṇa LB **ekā** cett.] *om.* E **°samaprabhaṃ** cett.] °sadṛṣaprabhaṃ U_1, °samaprabha P, °samaprabhā U_2LB 2 **param** U_2E] para N_2, paraṃ U_1, parim cett. **uṣṇabhāvo** cett.] auṣṇabhāvo D, uṣṇabhavo PLB, udbhavo E **°samaprabhaṃ** N_2N_1D] °samaṃ prabhaṃ U_1, °samaprabhā PU_2EB, *om.* L **śītalaṃ paraṃ** U_1PU_2EB] śītalapara N_2, śītalaparaṃ N_1D, *om.* L **śītabhāvo** PEB] bhāvo $N_2N_1DU_1$, śītalabhāvo U_2, *om.* L 3 **asyāḥ** cett.] asyā N_2U_2 **kalāyā** N_2U_1] kalāyāḥ N_1D, *om.* P, kalāyāḥ U_2, kalāyā ELB **°karaṇāt** β] °yogāt γ **sādhakasya** cett.] sādhaka° N_2 **na** cett.] *om.* LB 4 **sthāne** em.] stāne U_2 **brahmorvdham** em.] brahmordhaṃ U_2 5 **sakāro** em.] sakaro U_2 **bhavati** em.] bhavatī U_2 6 **śivo** em.] śīvo U_2 7–8 **'khaṇḍadhvaniḥ** em.] khaṃḍadhvani U_2

In the middle of that central receptacle exists the seventeenth digit in an untainted form. The splendour of the digit is shining like ten million suns, but there is no occurrence of heat. Its coolness is that of ten million moons, and yet there is no occurrence of cold. As a result of meditation upon the digit, suffering does not arise in the practitioner's mind. Here, at this location the deity is "I"(*aham*). The power is the "he is I" (*so'ham*). The Ṛṣi is the self. The path is the liberation. Above Brahma[randhra?][200] is *haṃ*.[201] *Haṃ* is in the *cakra*.[202] In the *cakra* of fire[203] is the letter "*sa*". The breathing becomes developed [and] the soul ascends and descends. The place is the hiding place of existence. The colour is yellow. The splendour is the shine of ten million suns. The shine always arises. The deity is Śiva. The power is primordial illusion. The state is the dissolution of the self into Hara[204] which is the unbroken sound that is not subject to sonic change having the nature of subtle sonic matter.[205] The seal is Aghorā. †Primordial illusion.†[206] The body is original matter. [It is] not within the range of mind and speech. [It is] without manifestation. [It is] without doubt. †Absorption into meditation and dissolution is the goal without waves [and] without tarnish.†[207]

[200] It is unclear whether this *brahmordhvam* signifies Brahman, Brahmā or even the *brahmarandhra cakra*. Since the syllable "*sa*" is situated in the *agnicakra* this location here could point at the upper part of the body, the point up to which the *haṃ*-part of the breath ascends on inhalation.

[201] The syllable "*haṃ*" in this context refers to the first syllable of the word *haṃsa*.

[202] This particular *cakra* must refer to the current *cakra* which is described here, which appears to be the exact topmost point to which the breath ascends.

[203] Since the bodily fire in most texts of yoga is situated in the navel area, the *agnicakra* perhaps refers to the lowest point in the body to which the breath descends.

[204] Epiphet of Śiva, cf. for example *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* 25.6.

[205] The term *nāda* in Śaiva contexts can be taken as "subtle sonic matter", cf. *Tāntrikābhidhānakośa* 3, 2013: 277.

[206] Possibly a dittography of the mention of *mūlamāyā* a few lines above. The point of mentioning it here is not clear to me.

[207] The meaning of the cruxed passage could not be reconstructed and translated with certainty. The translation is provisional. The compound *layadhyānasamādhi* seems to be a *dvandva*-compound of the collective unit of the three related terms. The compound could, however, also be dissolved as a *tatpuruṣa* and translated as "absorption into meditation and dissolution", which seems to provide a better sense.

तदुपर्यनन्तपरमानन्दस्य स्थानम्। तत्रोर्ध्वशक्तिः। एतादृशी संज्ञा एका कला वर्तते। अस्याः कलाया ध्यानकारणात् पुरुषो यदिच्छति तद्भवति। राज्यसुखभोगवतः स्त्रीमध्ये विलासवतः संगीतविनोदप्रेक्ष्यावतः एव पुरुषस्य प्रतिदिनं शुक्लपक्षे चन्द्रकलावत् कला वर्धते। पुण्यपापेऽस्य शरीरस्य न स्पृशतः। निरन्तरध्यानकरणान्निजस्वरूपप्रकाशसामर्थ्यं भवति। दूरस्थमप्यर्थं समीप इव पश्यति॥

Sources: 1–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 833): anantaparamānandasthānaṃ jñeyaṃ tadūrddhvataḥ (*tadarddhataḥ* YK 1.278) | ūrddhvagatakalā tatra tasya dhyānād bhaved iti | iti siddhirājayogaṃ strīṇāṃ bhogaṃ mahāsukham | gītavādyavinodādi saśivaṃ varddhate kṣitau | dhyānaṃ nirantarañ cāsya puṇyapāpe sthire (*sthirau* YK 1.280) na hi | nijarūpasya dṛṣṭiḥ syād dūrasyārthañ ca paśyati | 1–5 cf. SSP 2.9 (Ed p. 32): navamam ākāśacakraṃ ṣodaśadalakamalam ūrdhvamukham | tanmadhye karṇikāyāṃ trikūṭākārāṃ tadūrdhvaśaktiṃ tāṃ paramaśūnyāṃ dhyāyet | tatraiva pūrṇagiripīṭhaṃ sarveṣṭasiddhipradaṃ bhavati |

Testimonia: 2–5 ≈*Yogasaṃgraha* (IGNCA 30020, f. 4r. ll. 1–4): rājyasukhabhogavataḥ strī vilāsavataḥ saṃgītavinodaprekṣāvato pi sādhakasya śuklapakṣacaṃdravat pratidinaṃ tejaso vapuṣaś ca vṛddiḥ puṇyapāpasya śārbhāvaḥ nijasva rūpaprakāśasāmarthaṃ dūrasthapy arthasya samīpastham iva darśanaṃ ca bhavati | cha | tad uktaṃ tattvajñānapradīpikāyāṃ ‖

Parallels: 1–5 cf. *Saubhāgyalakṣmyupaniṣad*: navamamākāśacakram | tatra ṣoḍaśadalapadmam ūrdhvamukhaṃ tanmadhyakarṇikātrikūṭākāram | tanmadhye ūrdhvaśaktiḥ | tāṃ paśyan dhyāyet | tatraiva pūrṇagiripīṭhaṃ sarvecchāsiddhisādhanaṃ bhavati |

1 **tadupary** em.] tadupari cett. **ananta°** cett.] alakṣa° JU_1 **sthānam** cett.] stānaṃ DU_2, sthānam vartate LB **tatrordhvaśaktiḥ** $N_1K_1U_2E$] tatra ūrdhva śakti N_2, tatra ūrdhva śaktiḥ D, tata ūrdhva śaktir J, urdhvaśaktir U_1, tatordhvaśaktiḥ P, rdhaśakti ardhaśakti LB **etādṛśī** cett.] etādṛsaṃ D, etādṛsa J, ekādaśā PLB, etādṛśā U_2 **saṃjñā** cett.] saṃjñakā JU_1 2 **asyāḥ** cett.] tasyāḥ N_2K_1, asyā U_1 **kalāyā** cett.] kalāyāḥ $N_2K_1U_2$ **dhyānakāraṇāt** cett.] dhyānakāraṇā D **tad bhavati** $N_2N_1DK_1$] tad bhavati ‖cha‖ J, tad bhavati vā U_1, *om.* γ 2–3 **rājyasukhabhogavataḥ** $N_2N_1JU_1$] rājyasukhabhogavṛtaḥ DK_1, tasya sukhabhogavataḥ PU_2E, tasya sukhaṃ bhogavaṃtaṃ L, tasya khaṃ bhogavataṃ B 3 **strīmadhye** cett.] śrī strīmadhye N_2 **vilāsavataḥ** cett.] vilāsavata° U_2, vilāsavaṃtaṃ LB **°vinodaprekṣyāvataḥ** $N_1DK_1JU_1$] °vinodaprekṣāvataḥ N_2P, °vinodaprekṣāvata U_2, °vilāsavataḥ vinodaprekṣāvataḥ E, °ṃ prekṣāvatāḥ L, °ṃ vinodavaṃtaṃ prekṣāvaṃtāḥ B **eva** PB] evaṃ cett., eka U_1 4 **°vat kalā** γ] vṛddhi vaṃto N_2, vṛddhivato N_1DJ, vṛddhivata K_1, vṛddhir U_1 **vardhate** N_1DU_1PE] vartate cett. **puṇyapāpe** cett.] puṇyapāpau U_1, *om.* P **'sya** E] *om.* P, asya cett. **śarīrasya** LB] śarīrena β, *om.* P, śarīraṃ U_2E **na** U_2ELB] *om.* βP **spṛśataḥ** cett.] spṛśāt U_1 4–5 **nirantaradhyānakaraṇān** em.] nirantaradhyānakaraṇāt βE, *om.* P, evaṃ puruṣasya pratidinaṃ niraṃtaraṃ dhyānakaraṇāt U_2, niraṃtaraṃ dhyānakaraṇāt LB 5 **°prakāśa°** cett.] °ṃ prakāśana° U_2E **°stham apy arthaṃ** DK_1JU_1] °stham api N_2N_1, °stham api padārthaṃ PB, °stham api bhavati ‖ dūrastham api padārthaṃ U_2, °sthopi ca dūrasthavastu E, °stham api parārthaṃ L **samīpa** cett.] samīpaṃ N_2, samīpam N_1JU_1 **iva** cett.] eva JU_1

Above that is the place of infinite supreme bliss. In that [place], there exists the upper power (*ūrdhvaśakti*)[208] as a unique digit which has such a designation. As a result of meditation on this digit, whatever the person wants arises. Even though [one is] enjoying royal pleasures, amusing oneself amongst women and watching musical performances, the person's digit grows daily like the digit of the moon in the bright half of the month. His body is not affected by merit and sin. As a result of uninterrupted meditation [onto this digit], the ability to illuminate one's own nature arises. He sees even remote objects as if they were near.[209]

[208] Examining the primary source for the composition of Rāmacandra's account of the ninth *cakra*, found in the *Yogasvarodaya* (cf. sources), one might infer that the term *ūrdhvaśakti* is a corruption of the term *tadūrddhvataḥ*. However, the term and concept are validated by its occurrence in *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.9 (cf. sources), which Rāmacandra must have consulted as well. The association of *ūrdhvaśakti* with a *kalā* is likely an innovation by Rāmacandra, as the *ūrdhvaśakti* of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* is not explicitly identified as a *kalā*. Moreover, the *kalā* mentioned in the YSv is not designated as a *śakti*. Rāmacandra, therefore, amalgamates assertions from both sources in his interpretation.

[209] The final testimony from *Yogasaṃgraha* IGNCA 30020 references its source as *Tattvajñānapradīpikā* (cf. testimonia). After that, the manuscript paraphrases and quotes other yoga texts such as the *Uttaragītā*.

[XIII. **lakṣyayogaḥ**]

इदानीं सुखसाध्यो लक्ष्ययोगः कथ्यते। अस्य लक्ष्ययोगस्य पञ्चभेदा भवन्ति। १ ऊर्ध्वलक्ष्यम्। २ अधोलक्ष्यम्। ३ बाह्यलक्ष्यम्। ४ मध्यलक्ष्यम्। ५ अन्तरलक्ष्य–म्॥

Sources: 2–4 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 833): sukhasādhyaṃ lakṣayogam idānīṃ śṛṇu pārvati | pañcadhā lakṣayogaś ca ūrddhalakṣādibhedataḥ (*ūrdhva* YK 2.1) ‖ ūrddhalakṣam (*ūrdhva* YK 2.2) adholakṣo (*°lakṣaṃ* YK 2.2) bāhyalakṣaṃ (*vāhya°* YK 2.2) tathaiva ca | madhyalakṣas (*°lakṣaṃ* YK 2.2) tathā jñeyam antarlakṣas (*°lakṣaṃ* YK 2.2) tathaiva ca |

Testimonia: 2–4 cf. *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f.124r ll. 7–9): atha rājayogāṃgasukhasādhyo lakṣyayogaḥ kathyate ‖ lakṣayogasya paṃcabhedāṃ bhavati | parā ūrdhvalakṣyāṃ bāhyalakṣyaṃ madhyalakṣyam antaralakṣyaṃ ceti |

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2 **°sādhyo** cett.] °sādhya N_2, °sādhyopa° U_1, °sādho PB, °sādhe L **lakṣyayogaḥ** cett.] lakṣanayogaḥ N_2, °lakṣayogaḥ U_1, lakṣayogaḥ LB **asya** γ] *om.* β **lakṣya°** cett.] lakṣana° N_2, alakṣa° JU_1, lakṣa° U_2LB **pañcabhedā** cett.] paṃcabhedāḥ L, paṃce bhedāḥ B **bhavanti** cett.] bhavati N_2U_1, bhaṃvaṃti K_1, bhavaṃtī B 3 **ūrdhvalakṣyam** PE] urdhvalakṣa N_2U_1, urdhvalakṣya N_1DK_1J, ūrdhvalakṣam U_2LB **°lakṣyam** PE] °lakṣa N_2, °lakṣya N_1DK_1J, *om.* U_1, °lakṣam U_2LB **bāhyalakṣyam** U_2] bāhyalakṣa N_2, bāhyalakṣya N_1DK_1J, bāhyalakya U_1, madhyalakṣyam P, lakṣyam E, madhyalakṣam L, bāhyakṣam B **madhyalakṣyam** em.] madhyalakṣa N_2U_1, madhyalakṣya N_1DK_1J, bāhyalakṣyam PE, madhyalakṣaṃ U_2, bāhyakṣam L, *om.* B 3–4 **antaralakṣyam** PE] antaralakṣa N_2, antaralakṣya $N_1DK_1JU_1$, sarvalakṣyam U_2, aṃtaralakṣam LB

[XIII. **Lakṣyayoga**]

Now, Lakṣyayoga ("Yoga of foci"),[210] which is easily accomplished,[211] is explained. There are five subdivisions of this Lakṣyayoga: 1. The upper focus (*ūrdhvalakṣya*), 2. The lower focus (*adholakṣya*), 3. The outer focus (*bāhyalakṣya*), 4. The middle focus (*madhyalakṣya*), 5. The inner focus (*antaralakṣya*).[212,213,214]

[210] The original reading of the yoga is likely *lakṣyayoga* since it is attested across both the β- and γ-groups. This reading is supported by the usage in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.26–32 and *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 2). However, *Prāṇatoṣinī* (Ed. pp. 833–834) and *Yogakarṇikā* (Ed. pp. 23–24) as well as *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* (Ed. pp. 104–105) use the term *lakṣayoga*, indicating that both designations were common. See p. 393 for a detailed discussion of Lakṣyayoga.

[211] The emphasis on the ease of Lakṣ(y)ayoga is not just shared with the *Yogasvarodaya* but also with Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.25a: *lakṣayoga hai sugam upāī* |

[212] In most other texts it is called *antarlakṣya*, but the *Tattvayogabindu* reads *antaralakṣya* throughout its manuscript tradition. This is confirmed by the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* (cf. sources).

[213] The practices of Lakṣ(y)ayoga in Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.35–36 (Ed. pp. 104–105) are essentially identical, except presented in a different order and subsumed under the category of Haṭhayoga. The *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, one of Rāmacandra's central sources, particularly for the second half of his text, describes three almost identical *lakṣya*s in 2.26–31: *antarlakṣya*, *bahirlakṣya* and *madhyamaṃ lakṣyaṃ*.

[214] Nārāyaṇatīrtha, in his *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, does not mention any of the five categories within his descriptions of Lakṣyayoga. Here, Lakṣyayoga is connected to *Yogasūtra* 1.35. Lakṣyayoga directs the mind onto a specific focus, like the tip of the nose, etc., to stop the mind's activity, cf. *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Ed. p. 54.

[XIV. **ūrdhvalakṣyam**]

प्रथममूर्ध्वलक्ष्यं कथ्यते। आकाशमध्ये दृष्टिः। अथ च मन ऊर्ध्वं कृत्वा स्थाप्यते। एतस्य लक्ष्यस्य दृढीकरणात्परमेश्वरस्य तेजसा सह दृष्टेरैक्यं भवति। अथ चाकाशमध्ये यः कश्चिददृष्टः पदार्थो भवति। स साधकस्य दृष्टिगोचरे भवति। अयमेवोर्ध्वलक्षयः॥

Sources: 2–5 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 834): lakṣaṇaṃ śrṛṇu caiṣāṃ hi phalaṃ jñātvā maheśvari | ākāśe dṛṣṭim āsthāya mana ūrddhan tu kārayet | ūrdhalakṣaṃ (*ūrdhva°* YK 2.4) bhaved eṣā parameśasya caikatā |

Testimonia: 2–5 cf. *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f.124r l. 9 to f. 124v l. 2): tatra prathamam ūrdhvalakṣyaṃ nirūpyate ākāśamadhye dṛṣṭiḥ athavā mana ūrdhvaṃ kṛtvā sthāpyate tasya lakṣyadṛḍhīkaraṇāt prathamaṃ tamo jyotir nakṣatreṃdrādīnāṃ darśanaṃ tato 'bhyāsad ārḍhye manasthairye krameṇa parameśvarasya tejasā sahadṛṣṭher aikyaṃ bhavati ākāśamadhye yaḥ kaścid dṛṣṭhaḥ padārtho bhavati sa sādhkasya dṛṣṭhigocaro bhavati ‖ ayaṃ ūrdhvalakṣyayogaprakāraḥ

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2 **prathamam** PE] prathamaṃ βU_2, atha L, athama B **ūrdhvalakṣyaṃ** E] urdhvalakṣaḥ $N_2N_1DK_1J$, urdhvalakṣya U_1, ūrdhvalakṣyaḥ P, urdhvalakṣaṃ U_2, ūrdhvalakṣaṃ L, urdhalakṣaṃ B **kathyate** cett.] *om.* LB **ākāśamadhye** cett.] *om.* P **dṛṣṭiḥ** cett.] *om.* P, dṛṣṭi B **atha ca** $N_2N_1U_1P$] atha vā DK_1JLB, atha U_2, kadā ca E **mana ūrdhvaṃ** N_2JPE] mana urdhvaṃ N_1U_2, mana ūrdhaṃ DK_1, manerddhvaṃ U_1, ūrdhvaṃ mana L, ūrdhvamana B **sthāpyate** cett.] sthāpayati E 3 **lakṣyasya** N_1PE] lakṣasya cett., lakṣaṇasya N_2 **dṛḍhīkaraṇāt** cett.] dṛḍhakaraṇāt PE, dṛḍhīkṛtvā LB **tejasā** cett.] tenasā U_2, teja° LB **dṛṣṭer aikyaṃ** JU_1PU_2E] dṛṣṭeḥ ekaṃ N_2, dṛṣṭeḥ aikyaṃ N_1DK_1, dṛṣṭair aikā LB **atha** cett.] athā B 3–4 **cākāśa°** PU_2EB] ākāśa° N_2, ca ākāśa° $N_1DK_1JU_1$, vākāśa° L 4 **kaścid adṛṣṭaḥ** N_1U_1PE] kaścita adṛṣṭaḥ N_2, kaścit adṛṣṭaḥ DK_1J, kaścid dṛṣṭa° U_2, kaccit dṛṣṭaḥ B **padārtho** cett.] padārtha N_2, padārthe N_1K_1 **sa** cett.] *om.* N_2U_2LB **dṛṣṭigocare** $N_1DK_1U_2$] dṛṣṭigocaro cett., dṛṣṭigocarā N_2 **bhavati** cett.] bhavatī B **ayam** cett.] atham J 4–5 **evordhvalakṣyaḥ** DU_1PE] eva vodhalakṣaṇam N_2, evordhvalakṣya N_1U_2, evordhvalakṣaḥ L, evordhalakṣaḥ B

[XIV. **The upper focus**]

At first, the upper focus is explained. The gaze is on the centre of the sky.[215] And then, having directed the mind upwards, it is fixed [there]. As a result of stabilising this focus, unity of the gaze with the splendour of the highest lord arises. And then, some object that has not been seen before arises in the centre of the sky. That [object] arises in the range of sight of the practitioner. This alone is the upper focus.[216,217]

[215] This could be the zenith; see *Sanskrit Wörterbuch*, 1858: 179.

[216] Sundardās presents a comparable understanding of *ūrdhvalakṣ(y)a*, namely the practice of fixing the gaze on the sky, in his *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.27: *ūrddha lakṣa karai ihīṃ bhāṃtī | duṣtyākāśa rahai dina rātī | bibidha prakāra hoi ujiyārā | gopi padāratha dīsahiṃ sārā ||*

[217] A similar practice is presented in *Vijñānabhairava* 84: *ākāśaṃ vimalam paśyan kṛtvā dṛṣṭiṃ nirantarām | stabdhātmā tatkṣaṇād devi bhairavaṃ vapur āpnuyāt ||* Although the term *lakṣya* is not used, the central elements of the practice are found here: the gaze is constantly fixed on the sky, establishing a connection with the divine. See also *Śivasaṃhitā* 5.30–31.

[XV. **adholakṣyaḥ**]

अथाधोलक्ष्यः। नासिकाया उपरि द्वादशाङ्गुलपर्यंतं दृष्टिः स्थिरा कर्त्तव्या। अथवा नासिकाया अग्रे दृष्टिः स्थिरा कर्त्तव्या। लक्ष्यद्वयस्य दृढीकरणाद्दृष्टिः स्थिरा भवति। पवनः स्थिरो भवति। आयुर्वर्धते॥ एतद्वयमेव बाह्यलक्ष्यमपि कथ्यते। बाह्याभ्य–
5 न्तरमाकाशवत् शून्यलक्ष्यः कर्त्तव्यः। जाग्रद्दशायां चलनदशायां भोजनदशायां स्थितिकाले सर्वस्थाने शून्यस्य ध्यानकारणात् मरणत्रासो न भवति॥

Sources: 2–6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 834): nāsikopari deveśi dvādaśāṅgulamānataḥ | dṛṣṭiḥ sthirā (*dṛṣṭisthiran* YK 2.5) tu karttavyā (*karttavyam* YK 2.5) adholakṣam idaṃ bhaja (*bhajet* YK 2.5) | athavā (*tathā ca* YK 2.5) nāsikāgre tu sthirā dṛṣṭir iyaṃ bhavet (*śṛṇu* YK 2.5) | sthirā dṛṣṭiś cirāyuḥ syāt tathāsau (*yasya bhavet sthirā dṛṣṭiś cirāyuḥ* YK 2.6) sthiradṛṣṭimān | : bāhyalakṣaṃ svayaṃ jñeyaṃ yāti tattvanivāsinām (*°nirāsinām* YK 2.6) | kāmināṃ tu bahir dṛṣṭiś cintādiṣu susiddhidā | etad bāhyamadhyalakṣaṃ iṣṭacintā nirākulam (*dṛṣṭicintānirākulaḥ* YK 2.7) | antarlakṣaṃ śṛṇu śukradigvidigādivarjitam (*subhru°* YK 2.8) | (*bāhyabhyantara ākāśaṃ vādhāmantraṃ paraṃ mataṃ* YK 2.8cd) | calaj jāgratsuṣupteṣu bhojaneṣu ca sarvadā | sarvāvasthāsu deveśi cittaṃ śūnye niyojayet | karttā kārayitā śunyaḥ (*śūnyaṃ* YK 2.10) mūrttimān śūnya īśvaraḥ | harṣaśokaghaṭastho 'yaṃ janmamṛtyū labhet svayam |

Testimonia: 2–6 ≈*Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 124v ll. 2–4): atha adholakṣyayogaḥ nāsikāyā upari dvādaśāṃgulaparyaṃta dṛṣṭiḥ sthirā kartavyā athavā nāsikāyā agre dṛṭhṭiḥ sthirākartavyā lakṣyadvayasya dṛḍhīkaraṇad dṛṣṭiḥ sthirā bhavati pavano pi sthiro bhavati jito bhuvati pavanasthairya mano pi sthiraṃ śāṃtaṃ bhavati lakṣadvayadṛḍhīkaraṇād āyurvṛddhir bhavati | satyam ūrdhvalakṣyavad vāhyalakṣam api kathyate bāhyo abhyaṃtare ākāśavat chonyalakṣaḥ kartavyaḥ jāgrad daśāyāṃ calanadaśāyāṃ ca bhojadaśāyāṃ sthitikāle sarvasthāne śūnyadhyānakaraṇān maraṇā trāso na bhavati |

2 athādholakṣyaḥ em.] atha adholakṣanaḥ N_2, atha adholakṣyaḥ N_1, atha adholakṣaḥ DK_1, atha adholakṣa JU_1, athādholakṣaḥ PL, *om.* U_2E, athādholakṣa B **nāsikāyā** cett.] nāsikāyāḥ U_2E **upari** cett.] upariṣṭāt U_2 **dvādaśāṅgula°** cett.] daśāṃgula° U_2, dvādaśāṃgulamūla° E **dṛṣṭiḥ** cett.] dṛṣṭi° JU_1 **athavā** cett.] *om.* LB **3 nāsikāyā** cett.] nāsika N_2, nāsikāyāḥ JU_1 **agre** cett.] °gre K_1, *om.* LB **dṛṣṭiḥ** cett.] dṛṣṭi° N_2K_1 **sthirā** cett.] *om.* LB **karttavyā** cett.] *om.* LB **lakṣyadvayasya** J] lakṣadvayasya cett., lakṣadūyasya E **dṛḍhīkaraṇād** N_2] dṛḍhīkaraṇāt $N_1DU_1U_2$EL, dṛṣṭīkaraṇāt P, dṛḍhīkaraṇān B **dṛṣṭiḥ** cett.] dṛṣṭi° N_2U_2L **sthirā** cett.] °sthiro L, sthiro B **bhavati** cett.] bhavatī B **4 pavanaḥ** N_1DK_1PE] pavana° $N_2JU_1U_2$, *om.* LB **sthiro bhavati** cett.] *om.* LB **etad dvayam** N_2JPL] etat advayam DK_1, etat dvayam U_1U_2, etad dūyam E, etad dvayadvaya B **eva** β] api γ **°lakṣyam** U_1PU_2E] °lakṣam cett. **api** β] eva γ **kathyate** β] bhavati PU_2EL, bhavatī B **4–5 bāhyābhyantaram** N_2] bāhyo bhyaṃtaraṃ N_1DK_1, bāhyābhyaṃtare JU_1PU_2LB, bāhyāṃtara E **5 ākāśavat** β] ākāśe cet PU_2, ākāśe E, ākāśa cen L, ākāśacvat B **°lakṣyaḥ** $N_1DK_1JU_1$] °lakṣaḥ N_2, °lakṣyaṃ PU_2E, °ṃ lakṣaṃ LB **karttavyaḥ** cett.] karttavyā LB **jāgraddaśāyāṃ** cett.] jāyadaśāyāṃ N_2, jāgṛaddaśāyāṃ U_2, jāgradādidaśāyāṃ LB **calana°** cett.] cakaba° N_1 **bhojanadaśāyāṃ** cett.] *om.* JU_1, bhojanaṃ daśāyāṃ P **6 °sthāne** cett.] °sthāneṣu LB **°trāso** N_1DK_1J] °trāśo N_2, °sautrāṃ U_1, *om.* γ **na** cett.] *om.* γ **bhavati** N_2N_1] bhavati ‖ śūnya D, bhavati ‖ cha‖ J, bhavati vā U_1, *om.* γ

[XV. **The lower focus**]

Now, the lower focus. One should stabilize the gaze up to twelve finger breadths above the nose. Alternatively, one should stabilize the gaze onto the tip of the nose. The gaze becomes still due to the stabilising of the two foci. The breath becomes stable. Lifespan increases.[218,219] This pair is also taught as an external focus.[220] [Then] the focus of emptiness, which is like space, should be executed internally and externally.[221] The fear of death does not arise due to meditation on the void in all states—while eating, moving, waking [and] at the time of rest.[222,223]

[218] In Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 2.26 (Ed. p. 104), one finds the following verse with a similar concept. He shares the technique of fixing the gaze onto the nose and the notion of the breath becoming stabilised: *prathamahīṃ adho lakṣa kauṃ jānaiṃ | nāśā agra dṛṣṭi sthira ānaiṃ | yātoṃ mana pavanā thira hoī | adho lakṣa jo sādhai koī ||*

[219] In his *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā*, Sundaradeva adds further techniques to the category of *adholakṣya* at this point of the text. For the reconstructed passage (based on ORI B220, GOML R3239, and MMPP 2244) and its translation, see p. 398.

[220] This statement associates the two practices of *adholakṣya* with *bāhyalakṣya*, which is described later in the text. Indeed, these later descriptions instruct the practitioner to focus on one of the five elements at various distances in front of the nose or above the head (cf. p. 174).

[221] The description undoubtedly derives from the *Yogasvarodaya* as quoted in the *Prāṇatoṣinī* (Ed. p. 834), where it is declared a practice of *antaralakṣ(y)a*. Rāmacandra extracts this passage from his source text and locates this practice within the *adholakṣya* category.

[222] The translation of *sthitikāle* as "time of rest" is confirmed by the four states mentioned in the YSv (cf. sources). The formulation *sthitikāle* is Rāmacandra's rendering of *suṣupteṣu*.

[223] The concept of five *lakṣ(y)a*s appears only in the lost *Yogasvarodaya* and from there made its way into *Prāṇatoṣinī*, *Yogakarṇikā* and *Tattvayogabindu*. Other texts that include it are *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* and *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*. In those texts, it is treated as a distinct type of yoga: Lakṣ(y)oga. If one encounters the concept of three *lakṣ(y)a* as found in *Netratantra with Netroddyota* (cf. 7.1), *Śivayogapradīpikā* (cf. 4.36–50), *Maṇḍalabrāhmaṇopaniṣat* (cf. 2.6–2.14) or *Advayatārakopaniṣad* (Ed. pp. 3–5) etc. it is never presented as a distinct type of yoga.

[XVI. **rājayogayuktasya puruṣasya yac charīracihnam**]

इदानीं राजयोगयुक्तस्य पुरुषस्य यच्छरीरचिह्नं तत् कथ्यते। सर्वत्र पूर्णो भवति। पृथिव्याः दूरे तिष्ठति। पृथ्वीं व्याप्य तिष्ठति। यस्य जन्ममरणे न स्तः। सुखं न भवति। दुःखं न भवति। कुलं न भवति। शीलं न भवति। स्थानं न भवति। अस्य सिद्धस्य मनोमध्ये ईश्वरसंबन्धी प्रकाशो निरन्तरं प्रत्यक्षो भवति। स च प्रकाशो न शीतो न चोष्णो न श्वेतो न पीतो भवति। तस्य न जातिर्न किञ्चिच्चिह्नम्। अयं च निष्कलो निरञ्जनः। अलक्ष्यश्च भवति। अथ च फलचन्दनकामिन्यादेर्यस्य यस्येच्छा भवति। तं तं भोगं प्राप्नोति। अथवास्य मन एव स्थानेऽनुरागं न प्राप्नोति॥

Sources: 2–8 cf. YSv (PT, p. 834): idānīṃ kathayiṣyāmi rājayogasya lakṣaṇam | rājayoge kṛte puṃbhiḥ siddhicihnaṃ bhaved iti | paripūrṇaṃ bhavec cittaṃ jagatstho 'pi jagadbahiḥ | na kṣobho janma mṛtyuś ca na duḥkhaṃ na sukhaṃ tathā | bhedābhedau manaḥsthau na jñānaṃ śīlaṃ kulaṃ tathā | prakāśakuśasambandhiprasaṅgo 'yaṃ nirantaram | sarvaprakāśako 'sau tu naṣṭabhedādir eva ca | asya citte nānurāgo virāgo na bhaved iti | asya jāter na cihnañ ca niṣkalo 'yaṃ nirañjanaḥ | ananto 'yaṃ mahājyotir vāñchāṃ bhogaṃ dadāti ca |

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2 **puruṣasya** cett.] *om.* E **yac charīracihnaṃ** N_1DP] yac charīracihūṃ N_2, yaccharīracihnaṃ K_1, ya charīre cihnaṃ J, yac charīre cinhaṃ U_1, yat śarīracinhaṃ U_2, śarīre yac cihnaṃ E, cinhnaṃ LB **tat** $N_2N_1DK_1$JE] tata U_1, *om.* PU_2LB **sarvatra°** β] tatsarvatra° γ **°pūrṇo** cett.] pūrṇā N_2P 3 **pṛthivyāḥ** cett.] pṛthivyā U_2, *om.* LB **dūre** N_1DK_1JE] dūra N_2, ddūre U_1, dūraṃ U_2, *om.* LB **tiṣṭhati** cett.] *om.* LB **pṛthvīṃ** N_2DK_1] pṛthvāṃ N_1, *om.* JU_1LB, pṛthi° P, pṛthivyā U_2, pṛthivyāṃ E **vyāpya** $N_2N_1DK_1$PE] *om.* JU_1LB, vyāti U_2 **tiṣṭhati** cett.] *om.* JU_1LB **yasya janmamaraṇe na staḥ** cett.] *om.* JU_1LB 3–4 **sukhaṃ na bhavati** cett.] *om.* JU_1LB 4 **duḥkhaṃ na bhavati** cett.] *om.* $JU_1\gamma$ **kulaṃ** K_1U_2B] kūlaṃ N_2N_1DP, *om.* JU_1E, kalaṃ L **na bhavati** cett.] *om.* JU_1E **śīlaṃ** cett.] śītalaṃ P, *om.* ELB **na bhavati** cett.] *om.* ELB **sthānaṃ na bhavati** cett.] *om.* ELB 5 **siddhasya** cett.] siddhasya pṛthivivyāpyaṃ tiṣṭhati ‖ yasya janmamaraṇe na staḥ sukhaṃ na bhavati ‖ duḥkhaṃ na bhavati ‖ kulaṃ na bhavati ‖ śīlaṃ na bhavati ‖ JU_1, *om.* E **manomadhye** cett.] *om.* E **īśvarasaṃbandhī** cett.] *om.* E, īśvaraṃ saṃbaṃdhī B **prakāśo** cett.] prakāśaḥ β, *om.* E **nirantaraṃ** cett.] nirattaraṃ U_2, *om.* E **pratyakṣo** cett.] prakyakṣa N_1, *om.* E **bhavati** cett.] *om.* E 6 **coṣṇo** cett.] +++o U_1 **śveto** cett.] kheto N_2U_1 **na pīto** cett.] pīto na U_2 **jātir** cett.] jāti N_2DK_1, jānāti U_2 **kiñcic cihnam** cett.] kiñcic cihūṃ $N_2N_1DK_1$, kiṃcit ‖ cihūṃ J, kiṃcit khecha cihnaṃ U_1, na kiṃcit cihnaṃ U_2, kiñcic cihnam E **ayaṃ** cett.] arya J, vyayaṃ LB 7 **niṣ°** cett.] niḥ° JU_1, nīṣ° U_2B **alakṣyaś** cett.] alakṣaś N_2N_1LB, alakṣyaḥ U_1U_2 **ca** cett.] *om.* U_1U_2 **phala°** cett.] phalaṃ N_2JU_1B **°candana°** $DK_1JU_1PU_2$] caṃdra° N_2, °caṃdrana° N_1, °dvande E, °vaṃdana° L, jaṃdana° B **āder** cett.] āde DK_1, ādir L, ādar B 7–8 **yasya yasyeccha** em.] yasya yasyeccha N_2N_1, yasya yasyechā DK_1J, yasya yaṃ U_1, yasyochā P, yasye chā U_2, yasyecchā E, yasya L, yasye B 8 **bhavati** cett.] bhavaṃti J, na bhavati PELB **taṃ taṃ** $N_2N_1DK_1$J] tataṃ U_1, *om.* γ **bhogaṃ prāpnoti** cett.] *om.* γ **°vāsya** N_2N_1] °vā yasya DK_1J, °vāsvā U_1, *om.* γ **mana** β] *om.* γ **eva** $N_2N_1DK_1$] etat J, etata U_1, *om.* γ **sthāne 'nurāgaṃ na prāpnoti** β] *om.* γ

[XVI. **The physical sign of a person who is engaged in Rājayoga**]

Now, the physical sign of a person who is engaged in Rājayoga is taught.[224] He is rich at all times.[225] He exists detached from the world [yet] having permeated the world.[226] For whom neither birth nor death exists; happiness does not exist; suffering does not exist;[227] lineage does not exist; moral conduct does not exist;[228] [and] abode does not exist in the mind of this accomplished [person], a light that is connected to God becomes perceptible. And, the light is not cold, not hot, neither white nor yellow.[229] Neither does he have a caste, nor does he have any sign. Furthermore, he is without parts, immaculate and uncharacterised. And then, whatever wish for the most excellent fruit, affectionate woman, etc. arises,[230] he obtains that very enjoyment.[231] However, his very mind does not experience attachment in this situation.[232]

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[224] The shift from Lakṣyayoga to the physical sign of Rājayoga seems abrupt, but Rāmacandra follows the *Yogasvarodaya*'s structure, treating the remaining Lakṣyayogas later.

[225] In light of Rāmacandra's understanding of Rājayoga as the "yoga for kings," this translation for *pūrṇa* seems appropriate.

[226] Cf. *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.22: *icchā parai tahāṃ so jāī | tīni loka mahiṃ aṭaka na kāī | svarga jāī devani mahiṃ baiṭhai | nāgaloka pātāla su paiṭhai ‖* 22 ‖

[227] Equanimity towards opposites in the state of Rājayoga is common among texts that teach Rājayoga, cf. e.g. *Amanaska* 1.26ab: *sukhaṃ duḥkhaṃ na jānāti śītoṣṇaṃ ca na vindati |*; *Haṭhapradīpikā* 4.111 ≈ *Nādabindūpaniṣad* 53ab–54cd: *na vijānāti śītoṣṇaṃ na duḥkhaṃ na sukhaṃ tathā | na mānaṃ nopamānaṃ ca yogī yuktaḥ samādhinā ‖*; also cf. *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.18cd: *jākaiṃ dukha aru sukha nahiṃ hoī | harṣa śoka vyāpai nahiṃ koī |*

[228] Cf. *Dattātreyayogaśāstra* 186.

[229] Cf. *Amanaska* 1.51: *vāsarārdhalayenāpi svātmajyotiḥ prakāśate | sūryo gobhir ivoddīpto yogī viśvaṃ prakāśate |*; also cf. *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.13cd: *rājayoga saba ūpara chājai | jo sādhai so adhika birājai ‖*; and 3.23cd: *hṛdai prakāśa rahai dina rātī | deśai jyoti tela bina vātī ‖*

[230] This statement is unusual as it contradicts standard renunciatory principles. For this reason, *bhavati* was changed to *na bhavati* in the transmission of the γ-group. The passage is supported by the *Yogasvarodaya*: *…mahājyotir vāñchāṃ bhogaṃ dadāti ca |* cf. sources.

[231] For constructions similar to "*yasya yasyecchā …taṃ taṃ bhogaṃ …*" cf. *Ānandakanda* 1,15.312 and *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* 5.39.

[232] Nearly all manuscripts omit (some even repeat) sentences in this section, likely due to eye-skipping caused by structural similarity and brevity of the sentences.

[XVII. **anyad rājayogasya cihnam**]

अन्यद्राजयोगस्य चिह्नं कथ्यते। यस्य राज्यादिलाभेऽपि फललाभो न भवति। हानावपि मनोमध्ये दुःखं न भवति। अथ च तृष्णा न भवति। अथ च कस्मिन्नपि पदार्थे प्राप्ते कस्यापि पदार्थस्योपर्यनिच्छा न भवति। अस्मिन्नपि पदार्थे मनसोऽनुरागोओ न भवति। अयमपि राजयोगः कथ्यते। अथ च यस्य मनः श्रुतिविद्वत् पुरुषे मित्रे शत्रौ च समं भवति। दृष्टिश्च समा भवति। सकलपृथ्वीमध्ये गमनवतः सुखभोगवतः यस्य मनसि कर्तृत्वाभिमानो नास्ति। अनुचरलोकमध्ये कर्तृत्वं न ज्ञापयति। सोऽपि राजयोगः कथ्यते।

Sources: 2–8 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 834–835): rājye (em. *rājya* YSv) prāpte 'pi no harṣo hānau duḥkhaṃ bhaven na hi | kvacid vastuni deśasya niḥsvane keṣu kutracit | vidyāvidyāmitraśatrau samā dṛṣṭiś ca sarvaśaḥ | bhogāsaktādikarttṛtvena mano no bhavet khavat | lokamadhye bhavet karttā manomadhye 'pi niṣkriyaḥ | eṣo 'pi rājayogīti sukhe duḥkhe samas tathā |

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2 **anyad** N_2E] anyat $N_1DK_1JU_1$, *om.* P, anyata LB **rājayogasya** cett.] rājayoga° JU_1, *om.* P **cihnaṃ** JE] ciṃhuṃ N_2, cinhaṃ N_1U_2LB, cihuṃ DK_1, *om.* P **kathyate** cett.] *om.* P **yasya** cett.] *om.* P **rājyādi°** cett.] rājyāpi° J, rājādi° LB **°lābhe** N_1DK_1E] °lobhe N_2, *om.* JP, °lābe U_1, °lābho U_2, lābhety LB **'pi** N_1DK_1E] 'pi ca N_2U_1, ca J, *om.* PU_2, ty LB **phala°** N_2N_1DE] palā° J, pala° U_1, *om.* PU_2, aphala° LB **lābho** cett.] *om.* P **na bhavati** cett.] ba bhavati N_1, *om.* P, na bhavatī LB 3 **hānāv** cett.] *om.* P, hānād U_2, hananād LB **api** cett.] pi N_2LB, *om.* P **manomadhye duḥkhaṃ na** cett.] *om.* P **bhavati** cett.] *om.* P, bhavatī LB **atha ca tṛṣṇā na** cett.] *om.* P **bhavati** cett.] *om.* P, bhavatī B **atha ca** cett.] *om.* P **kasmin** cett.] *om.* P **api** DU_1] pi N_2N_1, *om.* PE, adhi U_2, na LB 4 **padārthe** cett.] *om.* PE, padārtha° U_2, padārtho L, padārthau B **prāpte** cett.] prāpta N_1, *om.* PE **kasyāpi** cett.] *om.* PE, kābhyādi U_2 **padārthasyopary** E] padārthasya upari β, *om.* P, padārthopari U_2, padārthasyopari LB **anicchā** E] anisthā N_2, anusthā N_1, anichā DK_1J, aniṣṭā U_1, *om.* P, anicha U_2, ānīcha L, ānīchā B **na** cett.] *om.* DK_1P, ni B **bhavati** cett.] bhavaṃti N_1DJ, *om.* P **asminn** cett.] kasmin U_2E **api** cett.] *om.* ELB **manaso** PELB] manasaḥ $N_2N_1DK_1$, manasaś J, manasa U_1, *om.* U_2 4–5 **'nurāgo** PELB] cānurāgo J, anurāgo cett. 5 **na bhavati** K_1E] bhavati $N_2N_1DJU_1$, na bhavati ayam api padārthe manasonurāgo na bhavati P, na bhavati ‖ ayam api padārthe anurāgo na bhavati U_2, na bhavatī LB **ayam** cett.] atham P, atha L **api** cett.] sama L **rājayogaḥ** cett.] rājayoga N_2U_2 **ca** cett.] caḥ E **yasya** cett.] ya D **śrutividvat** em.] śrutividyut $N_2N_1DK_1$, śubhividyut J, śrunividvat U_1B, śunividvat P, śuciviśuddha° U_2, munividvat E, bhunividvat L 5–6 **puruṣe** cett.] puruṣeṣu E 6 **mitre** cett.] maitre PELB **śatrau** cett.] *om.* E, śatro B **dṛṣṭiś ca** cett.] *om.* LB **samā** cett.] namnā P, *om.* LB **bhavati** cett.] *om.* LB **sakalapṛthvīmadhye** cett.] °pṛtvī° L **gamanavataḥ** N_1JU_1E] gamavataḥ N_2, gamanaṃ vataḥ D, gamanataḥ K_1, gamanāgamanavataḥ P, gamanāgamanavat U_2, gamanāgamanataḥ LB 7 **sukhabhogavataḥ** cett.] sukho bhogavataḥ U_1, sukhabhogavat U_2, sukhabogho bhavataḥ LB **yasya** cett.] tasya K_1 **kartṛtvābhimāno** JU_1PU_2E] kartṛtvādyabhimāno $N_2N_1DK_1$, kartutvābhimano LB **anucara°** LB] anuca° βPU_2, atha ca E **°madhye** cett.] °madhya LB **kartṛtvaṃ na** cett.] kartṛtvaṃ N_1U_1, kartṛtvābhimano LB 8 **jñāpayati** cett.] jñātva payati DK_1JU_1, nāsti LB **rājayogaḥ** N_1PE] rājayoga cett.

[XVII. **Another sign of Rājayoga**]

Another sign of Rājayoga is described. For whom,[233] even if a kingdom has been attained, there is no gaining of a [karmic] result;[234] [and] even in loss, suffering does not arise within the mind; and neither does desire arise. And then, if a certain object has been attained, no aversion[235] arises towards [this] certain object, and also no affection of the mind arises towards this very object—this is said to be Rājayoga. Moreover, whose mind is impartial towards a person who has expertise in sacred scriptures, a friend [or] an enemy; and [whose] view becomes indifferent; in whose mind no sense of being the agent prevails [while] moving in the whole world and enjoying pleasures; in whose mind the pride of the ability [to do these things] does not arise; [and] who does not present himself as the agent among his attendants—this is also said to be Rājayoga.

[233] Grammatical constructions in this text may deviate from classical Sanskrit. In most cases, however, these should not be regarded as errors due to their frequency but as features of contemporary or regional usage. Some constructions in this section and other passages of the text use the genitive as a substitute for other cases, such as the dative, instrumental or locative; see Whitney, 1879: 87, 294. In particular, this can be observed in this and other places of the text in relative clause constructions beginning with *yasya*, which must, for example, be read as *yasmin*, as otherwise, the corresponding correlative pronoun seems to be missing. The genitive, for example, in connection with the following word *manasi* or *manaḥ* (see edition text) would make the yogin the implicit subject of the sentence and the actual correlative pronoun of the construction referring to *yasya*, in this section *ayam* or *saḥ*, would appear incongruous. At the same time, the *daṇḍa*s in these constructions should be understood as commas or semicolons.

[234] Mallinson suggested considering an emendation of *phalalābhaḥ* to *phalalobhaḥ*, which would indeed make good sense. However, in light of the unequivocal consistency of the manuscripts across the stemma, I have adhered to the transmitted reading.

[235] The most common meaning of the word *aniccha* is indifference. However, even with considerable semantic latitude, this cannot be the intended meaning in this context. For this reason, I propose the meaning of "aversion" as attested in *Sanskrit Wörterbuch*, 1858: 47. The meaning "aversion" can be easily derived by taking *an-icchā* as a *nañ-samāsa* compound that expresses the direct opposite of "desire". The mention of the word *tṛṣṇā* in the previous sentence supports this conclusion.

नवीनानि पट्टसूत्रमयानि धृतानि वस्त्राणि। अथवा जीर्णानि सच्छिद्राणि धृतानि कस्तुरिका चन्दनलेपो वा कर्दमलेपो वा। यस्य मनसि हर्षशोकौ न स्थौ स एव राजयोगः। नगरमध्येऽथच वनमध्ये उद्वसग्राममध्ये लोकपूर्णग्राममध्ये वा यस्य मन ऊनं न पूर्णं वा न भवति। सोऽपि राजयोगः॥

[XVIII. **caryāyogaḥ**]

इदानीं चर्यायोगः कथ्यते। निराकारो नित्योऽचलोऽभेद्यः स एतादृश आत्मा। एतादृशे आत्मनि मनो यस्य निश्चलं तिष्ठति तस्यात्मनः पुण्यपापस्पर्शौ न भवति। उदकमध्ये स्थितस्य पद्मिनीपत्रस्य यथोदकस्पर्शो न भवति तथैवात्मनि। यथाकाशमध्ये पवनः स्वेछया भ्रमति तथा यस्य मनः निराकारमध्ये लीनं भवति स एव चर्यायोगः॥

Sources: 1–10 Cf. YSv (PT, p. 835): harṣaśokau na jātv eṣāṃ nodvego lokasaṅgame | nityollāse nirākāre nirāsane nirātmani | manasā niścalo bhūtvā sadā tiṣṭhet samo 'pi ca | yathākāśe bhraman vāyur ākāśaṃ vrajate svayam | tathākāśe mano līnaṃ rājayogakriyā matā | jagatsaṃsarganirlepaṃ padmapatrajalaṃ yathā |

1 **navīnāni** cett.] navīnīniś pī L, navinīnīr api B **paṭṭa°** ELB] paṭa° cett., pada° U_1 **°mayāni** cett.] °maya E **dhṛtāni** cett.] tāni JU_1 **vastrāṇi** cett.] *om.* U_2 **sacchidrāṇi** cett.] sachadrāṇi P, sachidrāṇi U_2, chidrāṇi E, svachidrāṇi LB **dhṛtāni** cett.] dhūtāni P, dhvātāni U_2 1–2 **kasturikā** β] kastūrī PU_2EB, kasturī L 2 **°lepo** cett.] °lepair E **vā** cett.] cā L **°lepo** cett.] °lepena E **vā** cett.] *om.* E **°śokau** cett.] °śoka N_2, °śoko N_1DJU_2, °śo K_1 **sthau** em.] sthaḥ cett., sthā N_2U_1, ko staḥ K_1, sta U_2 **eva** cett.] evātra E 2–3 **rājayogaḥ** cett.] rājayogaḥ ‖ cha ‖ J, rājayoga U_2, tiṣṭhati | yasya janmamaraṇe na staḥ sukhaṃ na bhavati | kulaṃ na bhavati śīlaṃ na bhavati | sthānaṃ na bhavati | E, rājayogaḥ ‖ idānīṃ ‖ LB 3 **nagara°** cett.] ṣagara° D, vā nagara° U_1, rājayogaḥ nagara° E **'tha** PU_2LB] atha cett. **udvasa°** U_2] udvesū° N_2N_1D, udvaṃsū K_1, udvaṃsa J, udassaṃ° U_1, utasaṃ° P, yuddhe saṃ° E, udvasta° LB **grāma°** cett.] grāmaṃ B **loka°** K_1JU_1] sveta° N_2D, ++++° N_1, *om.* γ **mana** PU_2] manaḥ cett. 4 **ūnaṃ** N_1JPU_2] ūnan N_2DK_1, unaṃ U_1LB, bhaya° E **na** $N_2N_1DK_1$] *om.* cett. **vā** cett.] *om.* U_1, vāṃ PU_2 **'pi** em.] pi cett. **rājayogaḥ** cett.] rājayogaḥ kathyate E 6 **caryāyogaḥ** cett.] tvaryāyogaḥ U_1, yogaḥ E **nirākāro** cett.] nirākālo N_2N_1DJ, nirvikāro U_2 **nityo** β] 'calo PU_2, *om.* E, calo LB **'calo** β] nityo γ **'bhedyaḥ** $N_2N_1DK_1E$] abhedhyaḥ JU_1, bhedhyaḥ PLB, 'bhedyha U_2 **etādṛśa** JPLB] etādṛśaḥ $N_2N_1DK_1U_1E$, etādṛśā U_2 **ātmā** cett.] ātmani U_2E 7 **etādṛśe** N_1DK_1J] etādṛśa N_2, etādṛśo U_1P, *om.* U_2E, sa etādṛśe L, sa etādṛśye B **ātmani** cett.] *om.* U_2E **mano** U_1PU_2E] manaḥ $N_2N_1DK_1J$, *om.* LB **yasya** cett.] *om.* LB **niścalaṃ** cett.] niścala N_2PL **tiṣṭhati** cett.] bhavati U_1 **tasyātmanaḥ** cett.] tasya ātmanaḥ JU_1U_2 **°pāpasparśo** cett.] °pāpaṃ sparśo J, °pāsya sparśo U_1U_2 8 **padminīpatrasya** cett.] padmanīpatrasya PLB, padmapatre E **yathodakasparśo** U_2] yathā udakasparśo β, yathodakasya sparśo PEL, yathodakasya sparśā B **bhavati** cett.] bhavatī B 9 **°kāśa°** PE] 'kāśa° U_2, ākāśa° cett. **pavanaḥ sve°** cett.] pavanasva° $N_2N_1DK_1J$ **bhramati** cett.] brahmayati JU_1 **yasya manaḥ** cett.] pavana° N_2, yamanaḥ D **bhavati** cett.] bhavatī B 10 **caryā°** γ] trayā° K_1, kriyā° cett.

Whether one is wearing new clothes made of silk, or old, worn [clothes] with holes, whether [one is] smeared with sandalwood and musk, or smeared with mud—when delight and grief do not reside within the mind, it is that which is Rājayoga. When the mind is neither [in a state of] lack nor [in a state of] abundance, whether one is situated in a city, a forest, an uninhabited village or a village full of people, this too is Rājayoga.

[XVIII. **Caryāyoga**]

Now, Caryāyoga is explained.[236] Formless, permanent, immovable [and] unsplittable—such is the self. For one whose mind remains steady in such a self, his self does not come into contact with sin and merit. Just as contact with water does not arise for the lotus leaf situated in water, likewise in the [case of the] self. When the mind is absorbed into the formless, in the same way as the wind wanders according to its own will in space, only that is Caryāyoga.[237]

[236] Caryāyoga is absent in the YSv (PT and YK). Rāmacandra uses a passage from the YSv's section on Rājayoga to construct this subtype of yoga (cf. PT, p. 835: *nityollāse … samo 'pi ca* |). Its brevity suggests an attempt to match the initial list of yogas . The passage does not clarify why he employs the term *caryā°*. Its inclusion among the fifteen yogas reflects the four *pāda*s of the Śaiva Āgamas (*kriyā-*, *jñāna-*, *caryā-*, and *yogapāda*). However, there is no connection to ritual conduct/discipline of Śaiva practices. Perhaps, in this context, the concept of *caryā°* = √*car* + *kṛt*-suffix *-yā* f. might express the action, which refers to the meaning "wandering, roaming" of the verbal root √*car*, which Rāmacandra brings up in his description.

[237] Parallels to Rāmacandra's innovative Caryāyoga can be identified in the texts with similar taxonomies. In *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. pp. 2, 52–53, 100–101, 150) Nārāyaṇatīrtha presents Caryāyoga in the context of *Yogasūtra* 1.33. According to Nārāyaṇatīrtha's commentary, its practice involves the cultivation of specific mental attitudes, such as *maitrī* ("loving-kindness"), *karuṇā* ("compassion"), *muditā* ("compassionate joy") and *upekṣā* ("equanimity"), towards circumstances characterised by happiness, suffering, virtue and vice. Sundardās, in his *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* (2.40–51, Ed. pp. 96–98), describes the similar-sounding Cārcāyoga as a type of *bhaktiyoga* that is *bhakti* towards the unmanifest consciousness (*avyakta puruṣa*) in rapturous devotion. According to Sundardās, the unmanifest consciousness (*avyakta puruṣa*) is formless, eternal, etc. (40). However, in Sanskrit and *brājbhāṣā* the term means "discussion". Thus Caryāyoga and Carcāyoga are unrelated. For an analysis of Caryāyoga, p. 350.

[XIX. **haṭhayogaḥ**]

इदानीं हठयोगः कथ्यते। रेचकपूरककुंभक इत्यादिप्रकारेण पवनस्य साधनं कर्तव्यम्। अथ च धौत्यादिषड्कर्मकारणात् शरीरस्य शुद्धिर्भवति। सूर्यनाडीमध्ये पवनः पूर्णो यदा तिष्ठति तदा मनो निश्चलं भवति। मनसो निश्चलत्वे आनन्दस्वरूपं प्रत्यक्षं भासते। हठयोगकरणात् मनः शून्यमध्ये लीनं भवति। कालः समीपे नागच्छति॥

Sources: 2–6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 835): idānīṃ haṭhayogas tu kathyate haṭhasiddhidaḥ | kṛtvāsanaṃ pavanāśaṃ śarīre rogahārakam | pūrakaṃ kumbhakañ caiva recakaṃ vāyunā bhajet | itthaṃ kramotkramaṃ jñātvā pavanaṃ sādhayet sadā | dhauty ādikarmaṣaṭkañ ca prakuryād (*saṃskuryād* ŚKD p. 501) haṭhasādhakaḥ | etan nāḍyān tu deveśi vāyupūrṇaṃ pratiṣṭhitam | tato mano niścalaṃ syāt tata ānand eva hi | haṭhayogān na kālaḥ syān manonāśo (*manaḥ śūnye* ŚKD p. 501) bhaved yadi |

2 **haṭhayogaḥ** cett.] haṭhayoga U_2, grahayogaḥ E, haṭayoga B **ity ādi°** cett.] ity ādhi° N_2 **pavanasya sādhanaṃ** cett.] pavanasādhanaṃ PE 2–3 **kartavyam** ELB] kartavyaṃ cett. 3 **ca** cett.] *om.* U_1 **dhautyādi°** cett.] vidhotyādi° U_1, dhotyādi° B **sūryanāḍīmadhye** cett.] sarvasūryanāḍīmadhye B **pavanaḥ** cett.] pavana° LB 4 **pūrṇo** cett.] *om.* J **yadā tiṣṭhati** cett.] yadāti LB **mano** γ] manaḥ β **niścalaṃ** cett.] niścalo PLB **manaso** γ] manasaḥ β **niścalatve** cett.] niścalatvena E **ānandasvarūpaṃ** cett.] ānandaṃ svarūpa° P, ānandarūpaṃ E, ānaṃdaṃ svarūpaṃ LB 5 **bhāsate** cett.] bhāṣate N_2U_1 **haṭha°** cett.] haṭa° B **yoga°** cett.] yogā° B **karaṇāt** cett.] kāraṇāt PELB **manaḥ** cett.] mana N_2 **līnaṃ** cett.] sthānaṃ U_2 **kālaḥ** cett.] kāla° N_2U_1, kālaṃ J, kāsaḥ U_2, kālā° B 5–6 **nāgacchati** cett.] nāgachaṃti D, pi nāgachati J, ti nāgachati U_1, nāma gacchati B

[XIX. **Haṭhayoga**]

Now, Haṭhayoga is explained.[238,239] Breath is to be controlled by means of practices such as exhalation, inhalation [and] retention, etc.[240] And then due to the six actions (*ṣaṭkarma*), like *dhauti* etc.,[241] the purification of the body arises. When the breath fills the inside of the sun channel,[242] then the mind is immovable. When the mind is motionless, then the nature of bliss manifests. As a result of Haṭhayoga, the mind becomes absorbed into emptiness. Time [as death] does not approach.

[238] See p. 357 for a detailed discussion of Haṭhayoga within the complex early modern yoga taxonomies.

[239] The *Yogasvarodaya*'s description of the two types of Haṭhayoga is quoted in *Śabdakalpadruma* (ŚKD), Ed. p. 501. I recorded the variants in the sources of the edition of this passage. I would like to thank Franz Veit for drawing my attention to this reference.

[240] The *Yogasvarodaya* suggests that the term *ādi* should refer to the other common practices of Haṭhayoga such as *āsana*, *mudrā*, and perhaps even *nādānusandhāna*, cf. *Haṭhapradīpikā* 1.56.

[241] See *Haṭhapradīpikā* 2.22–37.

[242] Usually the *sūryanāḍī* is the *piṅgalā*-channel, beginning at the right nostril, as previously declared in the *Tattvayogabindu* III l. 3. Here, it appears more likely that *sūryanaḍī* refers to the central channel, the *suṣūmnā*. However, the manuscript's tradition is clear. Nonetheless, the term might very well be corrupted. The context instead suggests conjecturing the reading *śūnyanāḍī*. In *Jyotsnā* 4.10, Brahmānanda understands "the void" (*śūnya*) as the central channel. In *Haṭhapradīpikā* 3.4, *śūnyapadavī* is a synonym of *suṣumnā*. Both words *sūrya°* and *śūnya°* begin with a sibilant, which is often confused, followed by a long *ū* in both manuscripts. Although both words end with orthographically quite distinct ligatures र्य (*rya*) or न्य (*nya*), an illegible manuscript at an early stage of transmission could easily have caused this error.

[XX. **haṭhayogasya dvitīyo bhedaḥ**]

इदानीं हठयोगस्य द्वितीयो भेदः कथ्यते। पादादारभ्य शिरःपर्यन्तं स्वशरीरे कोटि–सूर्यतेजःसमानं श्वेतं पीतं नीलं रक्तं किंचिद्रूपं चिन्त्यते। तद्ध्यानकारणात् सकलाङ्गं रोगज्वलनं भवति। आयुर्वृद्धिर्भवति॥

Sources: 2–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 835): idānīṃ haṭhayogasya dvitīyaṃ bhedaṃ acchṛṇu (*bhedavat śṛṇu* ŚKD p. 501) | ākāśe nāsikāgre tu sūryakoṭisamaṃ smaret | śvetaṃ raktaṃ tathā pītaṃ kṛṣṇam ity ādirūpataḥ | evaṃ dhyātvā cirāyus syād aṅgājananavarjitam (°*varjitaḥ* YK 12.25) | śivatulyo mahātmāsau haṭhayogaprasādataḥ (°*prasaṅgataḥ* YK 12.25) | haṭhāj jyotir (*haṭha*° YK 12.26) mayo bhūtvā hy antareṇa śivo (*śiva* ŚKD p. 501) bhavet | ato 'yaṃ haṭhayogaḥ syāt siddhidaḥ siddhasevitaḥ |

Testimonia: 2–4 cf. ≈*Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244 f. 125 ll. 4–5): pādād ārabhya śiraḥ-paryaṃtasya śarīre koṭisūryatejaḥsadṛśaṃś cetaṃ pītaṃ raktaṃ vā kiṃcidrūpaṃ viciṃtya tasya dhyānakaraṇāt sarvāṃge rogajvalanaṃ bhavati ‖

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2 **haṭhayogasya** cett.] haṭayogasya U_1B, haṭhayoga° P **dvitīyo** cett.] dvitīya° DPL, dvitīyaṃ B **bhedaḥ** cett.] bhedāḥ LB **kathyate** cett.] kathyante LB **pādād ārabhya** cett.] pādādārabhyā N_1D **śiraḥ** cett.] śiro U_2, śira° LB **paryantaṃ** cett.] paryentaṃ N_1, pariyataṃ U_1 **svaśarīre** cett.] svaśarīraṃ JU_1 2–3 **koṭisūryatejaḥ** cett.] koṭisūryye tejaḥ U_2 3 **samānaṃ** cett.] samāna° LB **śvetaṃ** cett.] śveta° B **pītaṃ** cett.] *om.* LB **nīlaṃ** cett.] nīla° J **raktaṃ** cett.] laktaṃ N_1 **kiṃcidrūpaṃ** $N_1DK_1JU_2$] ciṃrūpaṃ U_1, kiṃdrupaṃ PB, kiṃcidvarṇaṃ E, tiṃdrupaṃ L **cintyate** cett.] cityate P, ciṃtate LB **tad** N_2PEL] na N_1, ta DK_1U_1, *om.* J, tat U_2B **dhyānakāraṇāt** γ] dhyānaṃ karaṇāt $N_2N_1DU_1$, dhyānakaraṇāt K_1, dhyānakāraṇā J **sakalāṅge** βPU_2] sakalaṃ E, sakalaṃge LB 4 **rogajvalanaṃ** Dγ] roga N_2N_1, roga kṣataṃ U_1 **bhavati** JU_2E] na bhavati | jvaranaṃ na bhavati N_2, na bhavati | jvalanaṃ na bhavati N_1, na bhavati DK_1U_1PLB **āyur** cett.] āyu° N_2, *om.* DK_1 **vṛddhir** cett.] *om.* DK_1EL **bhavati** cett.] *om.* DK_1, vardhate EL, bhavatī B

[XX. **Second type of Haṭhayoga**]

Now, the second type[243] of Haṭhayoga is explained.[244] Some kind of form being white, yellow, blue [and] red, equal to the shine of ten million suns shall be contemplated in one's own body from the feet to the top of the head. As a result of meditation on that, the burning of diseases in the entire body arises. The lifespan increases.[245]

[243] The division of Haṭhayoga into two subcategories is unique in yoga literature and originates from the *Yogasvarodaya*.

[244] At this point *Yogasvarodaya* as quoted with reference in *Yogakarṇikā* 12.23, adds a verse not found in the *Prāṇatoṣinī*: *susthāsanaṃ samāsīno nīrajāyatalocanaḥ | cintayet paramātmānaṃ yo vadet sa bhaviṣyati |*

[245] Cf. *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 835) as presented in the sources for XX. p. 156: "Now, listen to the second variation of Haṭhayoga. Contemplate the space at the tip of the nose as being equal to the radiance of ten million suns in colours such as white, red, yellow, black, and other colours of that nature. By meditating in this way, one can achieve a long life because one is freed from the process of ageing (*aṅgajaraṇavarjitaḥ* em.] *aṅgājananavarjitaṃ* PT). Through the devoted practice of Haṭhayoga, one whose self is great becomes like Śiva. Having become like the light, one truly becomes one with Śiva inside. Therefore, the path of Haṭhayoga will bring forth supernatural abilities and is followed by the Siddhas." Rāmacandra's adaptation omits various details, but both descriptions are reminiscent of Bāhyalakṣya, see section XXIII on p. 174. Another light-based technique of Haṭhayoga, classified as a technique of *dhyāna*, can be found in *Gorakṣayogaśāstra* 33–50. It involves visualising equally intense light at the navel, heart and head, igniting this light in all six *cakra*s, and ultimately attaining liberation from the fetters of birth (*mucyante janmabandhanāt*). Another similarity appears in *Amanaska* 2.7–8: *cittaṃ buddhir ahaṅkāra ṛtvijaḥ somapaṃ manaḥ | indriyāṇi daśa prāṇāñ juhoti jyotimaṇḍale ‖* 7 *‖ āmūlād bilaparyantaṃ vibhāti jyotimaṇḍalam | yogibhiḥ satataṃ dhyeyam aṇimādyaṣṭasiddhidam ‖* These verses precede or introduce *śāmbhavī mudrā*. Here, thought, intellect and ego are taught to be the officiants, whereas the mind is the sacrificer who sacrifices the senses and the ten vital breaths into the orb of light (2.7). The orb of light (*jyotimaṇḍala*) shines from the root (one immediately thinks of the root of the body or spine, but Birch, 2013: 286 suggests the palate) to the aperture at the top of the head. Yoga practitioners should constantly meditate on it to achieve *siddhi*s (2.8).

[XXI. **jñānayogasya lakṣaṇam**]

इदानीं ज्ञानयोगस्य लक्षणं कथ्यते।

एकमेव जगत्पश्येद्विश्वात्मासुविभास्वरम्।
अविकल्पतया युक्त्या ज्ञानयोगं समाचरेत्॥ XXI.1 ॥

यत्र तत्र स्थितो वापि सर्वज्ञानमयं जगत्।
य एवं वेत्ति बोधेन सोऽपि ज्ञानाधिकारवान्॥ XXI.2 ॥

प्राप्नोति शाम्भवीं सत्तां सदाद्वैतपरायणः।
यथा न्यग्रोधबीजं हि क्षितावुप्तं द्रुमायते॥ XXI.3 ॥

एकान्तं नैकधा स्वेन दृश्यते दशधा कृता।
मूलाङ्कुरस्य चोद्दण्डाः शाखाकुसुमपल्लवाः॥ XXI.4 ॥

Sources: 2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 835): idānīṃ jñānayogasya lakṣaṇaṃ kathyate śive | yaj jñātvā jñānasampūrṇaḥ śivaḥ syān na punarbhavaḥ | 3–4 ≈YSv (PT, p. 835): ekam eva jagat paśyed viśvātmā viśvabhāvanaḥ | iti kṛtvā tu vai yukto jñānayogaṃ samācaret | 5–6 ≈YSv (PT, p. 835): yatra tatra sthito vāpi sarvajñānamayaṃ jagat | ya evam asti bodhena so'pi jñānādhikāravān | 7–8 ≈YSv (PT, p. 835): prāpnoti śāmbhavīmantrān sadā nityaparāyaṇaḥ | yathā nyagrodhavījaṃ hi kṣitau vaptur drumāyate | 9–10 ≈YSv (PT, p. 835): ādāv ekas tato 'nekaḥ svabhāvāc chādanādibhiḥ | varddhate 'harniśaṃ vṛkṣaḥ patrapallavavistṛtaḥ |

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2 **idānīṃ** cett.] idānī U_1 **kathyate** $N_2K_1JU_1PU_2E$] *om.* N_1DLB 3 **eva** cett.] evā LB **jagat** cett.] cayat P **paśyed** cett.] paśyad B **viśvātmā°** cett.] viśvāva° E 4 **avikalpatayā** cett.] āvikalpatayā U_1U_2 **yuktyā** cett.] yuktā LB 5 **tatra** JB] yatra cett. **vāpi** cett.] hiṃsa° U_2 6 **ya evaṃ** cett.] evaṃ *unm.* JU_1U_2 **vetti** cett.] vette na U_1, ve *unm.* B **jñānādhikāravān** cett.] jñānādhikāraṇāt E 7 **prāpnoti** cett.] *om.* E **śāmbhavīṃ sattāṃ** PB] sāṃbhavīsattā N_2K_1J, sāṃbhavīṃ satta N_1, sāṃbhavīsattāṃ DU_1U_2, *om.* E, śāmbhavīṃ sattān L **sadādvaita°** cett.] sadāṃdvaita° U_1, *om.* E 8 **yathā** cett.] *om.* E **nyagrodhabījaṃ** cett.] nyagrodhavījaṃ N_2N_1D, *om.* E, nyagrodhavīja L **hi** cett.] *om.* E **kṣitāv** cett.] kṣitvāṃ J, kṣitāptā *unm.* U_1, *om.* E, kṣitī B **uptaṃ drumāyate** cett.] ukta drumāyate U_1, uptaṃ drumāyate likāṃ pa++vāḥ *unm.* P, *om.* E, utpadyate yathā L, utpadyate B 9 **ekāntaṃ** cett.] yekāṃtaṃ U_1, *om.* P, ekānte LB **naikadhā** cett.] ++naikadhā *unm.* J, *om.* P, naikadā E, nekadhā LB **svena** cett.] śvetana N_2DJ, śveta N_1, *om.* P **dṛśyate** cett.] dṛśyet N_2, *om.* P, dṛśyaṃte LB **daśadhā** N_1JE] śadhā *unm.* N_2U_1, *om.* P, daśadhāt LB **kṛtā** β] *om.* P, kṛtiḥ U_2, kṛtaḥ EL, kṛ+tā B 10 **mūlāṅkurasya** E] mūlāṃkurutva cett., *om.* P **coddaṇḍāḥ** N_1U_2E] codarāṭaḥ N_2D, codarāḍa J, *om.* P, kudaṃḍa L, kudaṃjaḥ B **śākhākusumapallavāḥ** U_2] śākhākumbhalapallavā N_2, śāvārakumbhalapallavaḥ N_1U_1, śālavākumapadṛtravā D, śākhāku++lapallavā J, *om.* P, śākhākuṇḍalapallavāḥ E, śākhākilekālapallavā LB

[XXI. **The characteristics of Jñānayoga**]

Now, the characteristic of Jñānayoga is explained.

XXI.1 He shall see the world as only one, illumined by the supreme self. By the method of non-dualistic thinking, he may accomplish Jñānayoga.

XXI.2 Alternatively, wherever one dwells, the world is made of all knowledge. He who knows thus by realisation is also qualified for gnosis.

XXI.3 The one who is devoted to non-duality always attains the reality of Śaṃbhu,[246] just as the seed of the banyan tree scattered onto the ground [always] becomes a tree.[247]

XXI.4 By nature [the reality of Śaṃbhu] is not only seen as one [but] has been fabricated tenfold. [Just as] the branches, buds and twigs are [held] up by the stem of the roots and shoots. […]

[246] Rāmacandra uses the term *śāṃbhavīṃ sattāṃ* as a designation of the ultimate state to be attained by practising Jñānayoga, which he presents as the realization of absolute unity. In medieval yoga texts, particularly in the Rājayoga genre, the feminine noun *śāmbhavī* most often appears in the context of a non-physical *mudrā*, the so-called *śāṃbhavī mudrā*. For a detailed discussion of *śāṃbhavī mudrā*, its influence and all references, see Birch, 2013: 71–79. The usage of the feminine noun *śāmbhavī* to qualify a state is less common. More frequently one finds the masculine adjective *śāṃbhava* in order to qualify an exalted yogic state. See for example *Candrāvalokana* 2, *Haṭhapradīpikā* 4.7, *Anubhavanivedana* 1, *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* 49.27. The idea has its roots in tantric traditions of Śaivism and refers to a meditative state associated with Śiva.

[247] In rituals the banyan tree (*nyagrodha*) is associated with the *kṣatriya* class (Smith, 1998: 27).

स्नेहपुष्पफलं बीजे विस्तारोऽयं स्वभावतः।
तथासौ निर्मलो नित्यो निर्विकारो निरञ्जनः॥ XXI.5॥

एको ऽनेकः स्वयंभूश्च स्वधाम्ना बहुधा स्थितः।
पञ्चतत्त्वमनोबुद्धिमायाहंकारविक्रियः॥ XXI.6॥

एवं दशविधं विश्वं लोकालोकसुविस्तरम्।
एक एव न चान्योऽस्ति यो जानाति स तत्त्ववित्॥ XXI.7॥

Sources: 1–2 ≈YSv (PT, p. 836): snehapuṣpaphalair vījair vistāro 'yaṃ svabhāvataḥ | tathāsau nirmalo nityo nirvikāro nirañjanaḥ | 3–4 ≈YSv (PT, p. 836): eko 'nekaḥ khayaṃ bhūyān sādhanād bahudhā sthitaḥ | pañcatattvamayo buddhimāyāhaṅkāravikriyaḥ | 5–6 ≈YSv (PT, p. 836): evaṃ bahuvidhaṃ viśvaṃ lokālokasuvistaram | ekam eva na cānvo 'sti yo jānāti sa tattvavit |

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1 **snehapuṣpaphalaṃ** $N_2N_1DK_1PU_2$] snehapuṣpaṃ phalaṃ J, snehapuṣpaṃ phala U_1, snehapuṇyaphalaṃ E, snehe puṣpaphala° LB **bīje** cett.] bīja LB **vistāro** cett.] vistārā N_1D **'yaṃ** $N_2N_1PU_2$E] yasya D, yaḥ sya J, yaḥ U_1, ya LB **svabhāvataḥ** cett.] bhāvataḥ *unm.* DJ, svabhāvatāḥ LB 2 **tathāsau** cett.] tathāpasau *unm.* P, yathāsau B **nirmalo** cett.] nirmalau P 3 **eko** cett.] yeko U_1 **'nekaḥ** em.] nekaḥ cett., neka N_2K_1B, naika U_1, naiko U_2 **svayaṃbhūś ca** cett.] svayaṃbhūtyā U_1 **svadhāmnā** K_1PU_2] svadhāmnāva N_2, svayāṃmnā N_1, svadhā++ṣa D, svabhāvād J, svabhāvā U_1, dhāmnā ca E, svadhābhāva L, dhāmnāya B **sthitaḥ** cett.] sthitāḥ DK_1PL 4 **°buddhi°** ELB] °buddhir cett. **vikriyaḥ** em.] vikriyā $N_2N_1DK_1JU_2$LB, vikriyāḥ U_1PE 5 **daśavidhaṃ viśvaṃ** $N_1DK_1JPU_2$E] daśavidhā viśvaṃ N_2LB, daśavidhaviśvaṃ U_1 **lokālokasuvistaram** em.] lokālokasavistaram N_2DJU_1PELB, lokālokasavistarāṃ N_1K_1, lokāloke savistaraṃ U_2 6 **eka** cett.] ekam U_2 **eva** cett.] yeva U_1

XXI.5 […]The resin, flower [and] fruit are in the seed. This is the extent [of it] by nature. Thus, that [reality] is pure, eternal, unchanging, and immaculate.

XXI.6 [It] is one, [and] not one, self-existing and as a result of its own power it is many things, [as] a modification of five [gross] elements,[248] thinking mind, intellect, illusion and individuation.[249]

XXI.7 Thus, everything is tenfold, extending[250] as far as the Lokāloka[-mountain].[251] There is only one. There is nothing else. One who knows this is a knower of truth.

[248]The term *pañcatattva* refers to the five gross elements. The concept of five gross elements emerging from a supreme god is found in tantric works, cf. e.g. *Śivasvarodaya* 6–8: *nirañjano nirākara eko devo maheśvaraḥ | tasmād ākāśam utpannam ākāśād vāyusambhavaḥ* ‖ 6 ‖ *vayos tejas tataś cāpas tataḥ pṛthvī samudbhavaḥ | etāni pañcatattvāni vistīrṇāni ca pañcadhā* ‖ 7 ‖ *tebhyo brahmāṇḍam utpannaṃ tair eva parivartate | vilīyate ca tatraiva tatraiva ramate punaḥ* ‖ 8 ‖ "Faultless and without a body is the one god, the great supreme ruler. From him, the ether element (*ākāśa*) originated, and from the ether element, the air element came into existence (6). From the air element, the fire element and from the fire element, the water element and from the water element, the earth element. These five elements unfold in a fivefold manner (7). From these five elements, the universe has arisen, evolves and dissolves. [Then] right here, right there [it] enjoys again (8)."

[249]In the tantric traditions of Śaivism tenfold *tattva*-systems existed from a very early period, see Goodall and Isaacson, 2016: 82–85. Rāmacandra, as can be seen in the sources of the edition for this passage, is faithful to his source text. However, the exact origin of this specific arrangement of *tattva*s remains unknown. I discussed the system with Dominic Goodall, who has never encountered it. In Rāmacandra's tenfold system, the one self-existing reality must be counted as the first *tattva*. The term *vikriya* functions as a placeholder for all further modifications of the one self-existing reality. Other *tattva*-systems provide similar concepts such as *ahaṃkāravikrīya* ("transformations of *ahaṃkāra*") which refers to lesser *tattva*s like the *jñānendrīya*s, *karmendrīya*s and *tanmātra*s.

[250]The manuscripts read *savistara*, which is nonsensical in this context. Thus, I emended according to the source text's reading.

[251]Birch suggested that *lokāloka* be understood as the mythical mountain that divides the visible world from the regions of darkness; see Apte (1980: 933).

पृथ्वीवनस्पतिपर्वतेत्यादिस्थावररूपः संसारः। मनुष्यहस्त्यश्वपक्षीत्यादिको जङ्गमरूपः संसारः। अथ च यो दृष्टिविषयः स दृश्य उच्यते। यो दृष्ट्या न वीक्ष्यते स अदृश्य इत्युच्यते। एवं संसारस्य स्वात्मनो भेदं दूरीकृत्य ऐक्येन दर्शनं स एव ज्ञानयोगः। तस्य करणात्कालः शरीरनाशं न करोति॥

Sources: 1–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 836): sthāvarāḥ parvatādyā hi jaṅgamāḥ khecarādayaḥ | jaṅgamasthāvarākāraḥ saṃsāraḥ syāt sa īśvaraḥ | svabhāvalīlayā bhāti śūnye 'sau śūnyabuddhitaḥ | yad dṛṣṭaṃ viṣayaṃ vastu tad dṛśyam iti kathyate | yo dṛṣṭātītaḥ so 'dṛśyas tadā dṛṣṭaṃ hi manyate | svatanūbhedam evan tu saṃsāraṃ duḥkhasaṅkulam | yatnād dūraṃ parityajya jñānayogo bhavet sudhīḥ | jñānasaṃyoga ekas tu ekas tu jñānayogavān | ato hi jñānato 'bhinnaṃ jñeyaṃ jñānāt pṛthak pṛthak | dūrīkṛtyaiva mā pṛthvī bhedavākyena darśanāt | jñānayogī bhaved yena jñānayogas tu caikakaḥ | evaṃ jñānān maheśāni kālajit śivatāṃ vrajet |

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1 **pṛthvī°** cett.] pṛthivī° JU_1 **°vanaspati°** N_2JU_2E] vanaspatī° $N_1DK_1U_1LB$, vanaśpati P **°parvatetyādisthāvara°** N_1K_1] °parvate 'thyādisthāvara° N_2, °parvato tyādisthāṃvara° D, °parvato sādisthāvararūpaḥ J, °parvate iyādisthāvara° U_1, °parvatādisthāvara° γ **rūpaḥ** cett.] rūpa N_2, rūpā LB **saṃsāraḥ** cett.] saṃsāra° U_1E **°hasty aśvapakṣīty ādiko** E] °hastipakṣīty ādiko N_2, °hastī aśvapakṣīty ādiko N_1DK_1J, °hasti asvapakṣīty ādiko U_1, °hasttyaś ca pakṣīty ādiko U_2, °hasteśvapakṣīty ādiko LB 1–2 **jaṅgama°** cett.] jaṃgamaḥ DK_1, jaga° J, jagad° U_1 2 **°rūpaḥ** cett.] rūpaḥ DK_1, rūpā L **saṃsāraḥ** cett.] saṃsāro U_1 **ca** cett.] vā DK_1 **yo** cett.] ya $N_2N_1DK_1$, yaḥ JU_1 **dṛṣṭi°** cett.] ddṛṣṭi° N_1L, dārṣṭi° D, daṣṭi° B **dṛśya** cett.] dṛśyad N_1, dṛṣyā J, dṛṣy° U_1 **dṛṣṭyā** cett.] dyā N_2 3 **ity** cett.] śaty N_2, ty LB **saṃsārasya** cett.] saṃsāra° PU_2L **svātmano** PELB] svātmanaḥ β, svātmanoḥ U_2 **bhedaṃ** cett.] bhedāṃ N_1DK_1, bheda B **°kṛtya** cett.] °kṛtyaṃ JU_2, °kṛty E **aikyena** P] ekena N_2, ekyena N_1DK_1, ekona J, ekānta U_1, ek++ U_2, aikam eva E, aikyona LB **sa eva** E] *om.* cett. 3–4 **jñānayogaḥ** cett.] jñānayogaḥ ‖ cha ‖ J, jñānayoga U_2 4 **tasya** cett.] gatasya U_1 **karaṇāt** cett.] dhyānakaraṇāt JU_1, kāraṇāt PE **kālaḥ** cett.] kāla° U_1 **na** cett.] *om.* $N_2K_1U_2$

The stationary circuit of mundane existence consists of the earth, trees, mountains, etc. The moving circuit of mundane existence consists of humans, elephants, horses, birds, etc. Now, that which is the object of sight is called the visible. That which is not seen by sight is called the invisible. In this way, through the vision of unity, the distinction of one's self from the circuit of mundane existence is to be removed. Only this is Jñānayoga. From the execution of this, time [as death] does not bring about the destruction of the body.[252]

[252] Rāmacandra's prose following XXI.7 picks up the preceding verses' metaphysical nondualism and apparently elaborates his soteriological exposition of Jñānayoga. By distinguishing between the stationary and moving "circuits" of existence (earth, mountains, trees versus humans, animals, etc.) and between the visible and invisible domains, he delineates the full scope of *saṃsāra* as a unified field of experience. The yogin's task is to dissolve the imagined boundary between self and this totality—"through the vision of unity" (*ekadarśana*)—so that perceiver and perceived are no longer opposed. In this realization, all beings and visible and invisible phenomena are apprehended as expressions of one and the same reality, Śaṃbhu. Hence, Jñānayoga is not merely an intellectual affirmation of oneness but a contemplative practice of erasing dualistic perception. The final statement, that "time [as death] does not bring about the destruction of the body," implies liberation from temporal identification: once unity is realised, *kāla* loses its power to destroy, for the knower no longer identifies with the perishable body but with the timeless self.

[XXII. **svabhāvabhedam**]

इदानीं स्वभावभेदं कथ्यते। यथा वटबीजं वटरूपेण परिणमते स तद्दशधा भेदं स्वभावत एव प्राप्नोति। मूलाङ्कुरत्वग्दण्डशाखाकलिकापल्लवपुष्पफलस्नेहा इति दशभेदान् प्राप्नोति। तथा निर्मलो निर्विकारः निरञ्जन एक एतादृश आत्मस्वभावादेव पृथ्व्यापतेजोवाय्वाकाशमनोबुद्धिमायाविकाररूपभेदान् प्राप्नोति। ज्ञानयोगप्रभावादेक एव आत्मा इति निश्चयो भवति।

Sources: 2–6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 836): svabhāvabhedam etat śṛṇu devi prayatnataḥ | yac chrutvā sarvabodhaḥ syāt muktidaḥ siddhivāñchitaḥ | ātmano vā pṛthivyādyāḥ svabhāvaḥ kiñcid ucyate |

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2 **idānīṃ** cett.] idānī B **svabhāva°** cett.] tasya E, svābhāva° LB **°bhedaṃ** N_1DK_1J] °bheda N_2, °bhedāḥ U_1, °bhedaḥ PU_2LB, bhedaḥ E **vaṭa°** cett.] vatha° N_2 **°bījaṃ** cett.] °bīja° U_2, °bījam E, °bījena LB **vaṭarūpeṇa** cett.] rūpeṇa LB **pariṇamate** U_2LB] pariṇataṃ βE, pariṇāte P **sa tad** em.] sa tu N_2, satṛ N_1, sa DU_2, sa ta K_1, sa tat JU_1, sat PE, śata LB **daśadhā** cett.] dṛśadhā P, dasat U_2 **bhedaṃ** cett.] *om.* U_2 3 **svabhāvata** cett.] *om.* U_2, svabhāva LB **eva** cett.] *om.* U_2 **prāpnoti** cett.] prāpnotī U_1LB **mūlāṅkura°** N_2DE] mūlāṃ aṃkura° N_1U_1, mūla āṃkura° K_1, mūla aṃkura° JP, *om.* U_2, mūlaṃ aṃkura° LB **°tvag°** E] °tvak° cett., *om.* U_2 **°daṇḍa°** N_1E] °daṇda° cett. **°śākhā°** cett.] °śākhāṃ $N_2N_1DK_1$ **°kalikā°** cett.] °kilpikā° P, °kilā° L, °kilakāla° B **°pallava°** cett.] °pallavā P, *om.* U_2, °pallavā ‖ LB **°puṣpaphalasnehā** cett.] °puṣpaphalasneha $N_2N_1K_1JU_1$P, puṣpaphalasnehaṃ D, *om.* U_2, vistāro yaṃ svābhāvataḥ LB **iti** cett.] *om.* U_2 3–4 **daśabhedān** PELB] bhedo daśadhā β, *om.* U_2 4 **prāpnoti** cett.] prāpnotīti P, *om.* U_2 **tathā** cett.] yathā U_2E **nirmalo** ELB] nirmalaḥ βPU_2 **nirañjana** E] niraṃjanaḥ cett. **eka** cett.] ekaḥ $N_2N_1K_1JU_1$ **etādṛśa** E] etādṛśaḥ $N_2N_1K_1JU_1$ 4–5 **ātmasvabhāvād** cett.] ātmā svabhāvād E 5 **pṛthvy°** N_1PU_2LB] pṛthvī° N_2D, pṛth° U_1, pṛthivy° E **°āpatejo°** N_1LB] °pate° N_2D, °apatejo° K_1, °aptejo° JU_2E, °akte° U_1, °etetejo° P **°vāyvākāśa°** JE] °jīvīkāśa° N_2D, °vāybākāśa° N_1L, °vākāśa° K_1, °jīvāyuvākāśa° U_1, °vādvyākāśa° PB, °vāyyākāśa° U_2 **°manobuddhi°** $N_1\gamma$] °manobuddhir° $N_2DK_1JU_1$ **°māyā°** cett.] °māyāyā° U_1 **°rūpabhedān** $N_1K_1JU_2$E] °rūpabhedāt N_2DU_1P, °rūpabhedāna LB 5–6 **jñānayogaprabhāvād** U_2E] jñānayogabhavāt β, jñānayogaḥ prabhāvād P, jñānayogaḥ ‖ prabhāvād° LB 6 **eva** cett.] yeva U_1, eka PLB

[XXII. **Distinction of the nature**]

Now, the nature of the self and its distinction[253] is described. Just as the seed of the banyan tree transforms into the shape of the banyan tree—[and] thus attains the tenfold distinction—'root, shoot, bark, branch, twig, bud, the unfolding flower, flower, fruit and resin'—by virtue of its nature, in the same way, the pure, unchanging, immaculate one attains such [a distinction] precisely because of the nature of the self—[namely], the various forms and modifications of earth, water, fire, wind, space, mind, intellect, illusion, [and individuation.][254] As a result of the power of Jñānayoga, the conviction arises that 'the self is only one'.

[253] The term *svabhāvabheda* appears in philosophical systems to signify the division or distinction of essential natures. For a Buddhist example, see Balcerowicz, 2011: 6. In some Nyāya texts, the term is picked up to refer to different essential properties of the self, see Ogawa, 2023: 162. In the *Netratantantra*, the term *bhāvabheda* occurs frequently in a similar sense as in this passage of the *Tattvayogabindu*. For example cf. *Netratantra* 16.20–21: *bhaviṣyanti mahādevi kaliḥ kaṣṭataro yataḥ | tadarthaṃ paramārtho 'yaṃ mayā te prakaṭīkṛtaḥ | paramārthaḥ paratvena mṛtyujit sarvatomukhaḥ | bhāvabhedena yaṣṭav yo mokṣasiddhim abhīpsatā* | Here, however, the context is unphilosophical and specifically intended to signify the phenomenological distinction of the self.

[254] Rāmacandra's tenfold taxonomy of *tattva*s may seem inconsistent at first sight. It is probable, however, that *ahaṃkāra* was lost in the course of the text's transmission given its inclusion in the list of the previous section. Perhaps the discovery of new textual witnesses of the text will solve this problem in the future. None of the tenfold *tattva*-systems known to me correspond exactly to Rāmacandra's system. Taxonomies of *tattva*s such as *Bhagavadgītā* 7.4, in which Kṛṣṇa presents a list of eight divisions of *prakṛti*, are almost identical (*bhūmir āpo 'nalo vāyuḥ khaṃ mano buddhir eva cha | ahankāra itīyaṃ me bhinnā prakṛitir aṣhṭadhā* ‖7.4‖). "Earth, water, fire, air, space, mind, intellect and ego—these are the eight divisions of original nature." In this list we find most of the elements of Rāmacandra's list, except for the term *māyā*. The description of *kuṇḍalinī* in *Yogayājñavalkya* 4.21 incorporates this system. Another system of ten *tattva*s appears in *Uttarasūtra* 1.9–1.13 of *Niśvāsatattvasaṃhitā* where the tenfold nature of Sadāśiva is homologised with the *mantra*. Here the following list is given: *prakṛti*, *puruṣa*, *niyati*, *kāla*, *māyātattva*, *vidyā*, *Īśvara*, *Sadāśiva*, *dehavyāpin* and *Śakti*, see Goodall and Isaacson, 2016: 83–84. There is no similarity between the two tenfold *tattva* systems. However, …

यथैकैकः पृथ्वी क्वचित्कोमलरूपा ॥ क्वचित्मनोहररूपा ॥ क्वचित्परिमलरूपयुक्ता ॥ क्वचित्परिमलरहिता ॥ क्वचित्सुवर्णरूपा ॥ क्वचित्रूप्यरूपा ॥ क्वचिद्रत्नमयी ॥ क्वचित्श्वेश्वेता ॥ क्वचित्कृष्णा ॥ क्वचिद्रक्ता ॥ क्वचित्पीता ॥ क्वचित्कर्बुरा ॥ क्वचि–न्नानाविधफलरूपा ॥ क्वचित्पुष्परूपा ॥ क्वचिदमृतमयी ॥ स्वभावत एव भवति ॥ तथैवात्मा मनुष्यपक्षिहरिणहस्तीविद्याधरगन्धर्वकिन्नरमहापण्डितमहामूर्खरोग्य–रोगीक्रोधीशान्तरूपः स्वभावादेव भवति ॥ ज्ञानयोगाद्विकाररूपरहितो ज्ञायते।

Sources: 1–6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 836–837): ātmaiva pṛthivī dhātrī komalā ca kvacid dṛḍhā | kvacin manoharā sā ca vimalā ca malāmalā | durgandhā ca sugandhā ca nirgandhā gandhamohinī | svarṇarūpā dhāturūpā citrā ratnamayī parā | kvacit śvetā kvacid raktā kvacit pītā ca kṛṣṇalā | ūrvarā ūrvarā sā tu viṣāmṛtamayī sadā | tathā ca devagandharvakinnarādyāḥ khagādayaḥ | sukhasampiṇḍito rogī tathaiva krodhaśāntadhīḥ | aśeṣarūpabalito nānābuddhirataḥ svayam | devatattvaṃ bhūtaśaktyā jīvasaṃjñā bhramātmikā | jñānayogī nirvikāro nistāpa eka īśvaraḥ | ātmaikamūrttimān bhūtvā nirvikalpo nirañjanaḥ | sukhī duḥkhī mohayukto 'nantacetāḥ svabhāvataḥ |

1 **yathaikaikaḥ** em.] yathā ekaṃ ca N_2, yathā ekaiva N_1DK_1J, yathā ekai ca U_1, yathā ekaika PU_2LB, yathaikaiva E **pṛthvī** γ] pṛthivī β **kvacit komala** cett.] *om.* J **°rūpā** γ] °rūpa $N_2N_1DK_1U_1$, *om.* J **kvacit** cett.] *om.* JU_1PE **°hararūpā** B] °harā $N_2N_1DK_1$, *om.* JU_1PE, °hararūpa U_2, °hararūpāḥ L **kvacit** cett.] *om.* JU_1PE **°parimala** cett.] *om.* JU_1PE **°rūpayuktā** LB] °rūpāyuktaḥ N_2, °rūpāyuktā N_1D, °rūpayuta K_1, *om.* JU_1PE 2 **kvacit** cett.] *om.* JU_1P **°parimala** cett.] *om.* JU_1P, °parimalarūpa° E **°rahitā** N_1EL] °rohitā $N_2K_1U_2B$, *om.* DU_1P **kvacit** cett.] *om.* JU_1P **suvarṇarūpā** $N_2K_1U_2EL$] suvarṇarūpa DB, varṇa++pā J, khavarṇakupā U_1, *om.* P **kvacit** cett.] *om.* PLB **rūpyarūpā** $N_1K_1JU_1$] rūpyarūpa N_2D, *om.* PLB, rajatarūpā U_2, raupyarūpā E **ratnamayī** cett.] raktamayīṃ J, ratnamaī PLB 3 **kvacit** cett.] *om.* P, kvacic ca E **śvetā** DJU_2E] śveta $N_2N_1K_1U_1$, *om.* P, śvetarūpā L, śverūpā B **°kṛṣṇā** cett.] °kṛṣṇa N_1, °rakta K_1, *om.* PE **kvacid raktā** U_2ELB] kvacid rakta $N_2N_1DJU_1$, kvacitkṛṣṇa K_1, *om.* P **kvacit pītā** cett.] *om.* P **kvacit karburā** cett.] kvacit karpurā JU_1, *om.* P 3–4 **kvacin** cett.] kvacit JU_2, *om.* P 4 **nānāvidhaphalarūpā** cett.] nānāvidhophalarūpā U_1, *om.* P, nānāvidharūpā E **kvacit** JLB] *om.* N_2P, kvacid $N_1DK_1U_1$, kvacir U_2 **puṣparūpā** N_1D] viṣarūpa K_1, *om.* JU_1P, viśarūpā U_2, viṣarūpā ELB **kvacid** cett.] *om.* JU_1, kvacit U_2 **amṛtamayī** cett.] *om.* JU_1, amṛtarūpamayī E, amṛtamaī LB **svabhāvata** cett.] *om.* JU_1 **eva** cett.] *om.* JU_1 **bhavati** cett.] *om.* JU_1, bhavataḥ LB 5 **tathaivātmā** γ] tathātmā $N_2N_1DK_1U_1$, *om.* J **manuṣya°** cett.] *om.* JU_1 **°pakṣi°** cett.] pakṣi ‖ K_1, *om.* JU_1 **°hariṇa°** cett.] *om.* JU_1, °hariṇā° P **°hastī°** N_1DK_1] hasti cett., *om.* JU_1 **°vidyādhara°** cett.] °vidyādhara ‖ K_1 **°kinnara°** cett.] kiṃnara ‖ K_1 **°paṇḍita°** cett.] paṃḍita ‖ J, piṃḍata B **°mūrkha°** cett.] °mūrva° N_1D, °mūrṣa° K_1U_1, mūrkha ‖ J, °rmūkha° P 5–6 **rogyarogī** em.] °rogī arogī $N_2N_1DJU_1U_2$, °rogī ‖ arogī ‖ K_1, °rogī PLB, °rogyarogi E 6 **°krodhī°** cett.] krodhī K_1, °krodhi° PE, °krodha° LB **°śānta°** cett.] °dhiśānta° LB **°rūpaḥ** cett.] °rūpa β, °rūpāḥ PL **svabhāvād eva** cett.] evaṃ J, evaṃ svabhāvaṃ U_1 **bhavati** cett.] bhati N_1, dharati JU_1, bhavatī LB **°yogād vikāra°** N_1JU_1] °yogadhikāra° cett. **jñāyate** cett.] jñāyate ‖ cha ‖ J, jāyate U_2

Just as the single soil in some places appears soft, in some places beautiful, in some places is endowed with fragrance, in some places without fragrance, in some places [the earth is] gold, in some places silver, in some places [it contains] gems,[255] in some places, appears white, in some places black, in some places red, in some places yellow, in some places appears in variegated colour, in some places like various fruit, in some places like flowers, in some places like a liquid, [and that] only because of its nature.

In the same way, the self also takes the form of a human, a bird, a deer, an elephant, a Vidyādhara, a Gandharva, a centaur, a great scholar or a great fool, a sick or healthy person, an angry or peaceful person, by virtue of its inherent nature. Through Jñānayoga, [the self] is known as being free from changes of form.

since Rājayoga is rooted in ancient Śaivism (see Birch, 2019), and Rāmacandra usually tends to present simplified and transsectarian systems, the choice of a tenfold *tattva*-system could be considered a remnant of these ancient systems.

[255]The description of the soil at this point is not clear. The coloured soil mentioned next suggests soil of golden and silver colours and of the colour of precious stones. However, the parallel formulations in the *Yogasvarodaya* (i.e. *svarṇarūpā dhāturūpā citrā ratnamayī parā* |) instead suggest soil containing the metals or precious stones in question.

यथा फलस्योत्पत्तिस्थानमेकमेव भवति। अथ च फलस्य गतिर्बहुधा दृश्यते। एकं फलं पृथ्वीमध्ये पतति। शुष्कं भवति। एकस्य फलस्य मकरन्दं भ्रमरः पिबति। एकस्य फलस्य मालां कामिनी तुङ्गकुचमण्डलोपरि दधाति। एकं फलं मृतमनुष्योपरि क्षिप्यते। अयं वस्तुनः स्वभावः। तथा एक एवात्मा स्वीयभावादेवाष्टौ भोगान्भुनक्ति। के तेऽष्टौ भोगाः॥

सुवासश्च सुवस्त्रञ्च सुशय्या सुनितंबिनी।
सुस्थाता चान्नपानान्यष्टौ भोगाः सुधिषणम्॥ XXII.1 ॥

Sources: 1–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 837): strīpuṃrūpī mahān so hi parasparavimohitaḥ | amanaskaḥ svīyabhāvāt jñānayogī nirākulaḥ | srakcandanādivāmāsu svabhāvād bhogam icchukaḥ |

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1 **phalasyotpatti** cett.] phalasyautpatti K_1, plakṣasyotpattiḥ E **°sthānam** cett.] °sthāna U_1, sthānam E **ekam** cett.] eva N_2, ekas D, eka K_1, *om.* E **eva** cett.] kam eva N_2, *om.* K_1 **bhavati** cett.] ti U_1, bhavatī B **gatir** cett.] gati $N_2K_1U_1P$ **ekaṃ** cett.] eva N_2, eka° U_2 2 **phalaṃ** cett.] phala° $N_2N_1DK_1$ **pṛthvī°** cett.] pṛthivī° U_1 **śuṣkaṃ** $K_1JU_1U_2L$] śuklaṃ cett. **bhavati** cett.] bhavati ‖ cha ‖ J, bhavatī B **phalasya** cett.] *om.* PL **makarandaṃ** $N_2U_1PU_2EL$] makaraṃda° N_1DK_1, makaraṃdaḥ J, karaṃdaṃ B **bhramaraḥ** cett.] bhramara N_2, bhramaraṃ LB **pibati** cett.] pibaṃti P, pibatī B 3 **phalasya** cett.] phalasyaṃ N_2 **mālāṃ** cett.] mālā° N_2 **kāminī** cett.] kāmibī DJ **tuṅga°** cett.] tuṃ° U_1 **dadhāti** cett.] dadhovati N_2, dadhāvati N_1 **ekaṃ phalaṃ** Jγ] ekaphalaṃ cett. 4 **kṣipyate** cett.] kṣapyate B **eka** cett.] ekam U_2 **evātmā** cett.] eva ātmā U_2 **svīyabhāvād** cett.] svīdhabhāvād K_1, svabhāvād LB **evāṣṭau** cett.] evāstau N_2U_1, evāṣṭa U_2 4–5 **bhogān** cett.] bhogāt N_2U_1, bhogāt K_1 5 **bhunakti** cett.] ābhunakti N_1 **ke te** cett.] *om.* LB **'ṣṭau** cett.] ṣṭe U_1, aṣṭau LB **bhogāḥ** cett.] bhogā U_1U_2, bhogauḥ P 6 **suvāsaś ca** cett.] suvāsac ca B **suvastrañ ca** E] suvaṃśaś ca U_2, *om.* cett. **suśayyā** cett.] suśayyā ca U_1, suyyā *unm.* P, suśayyāḥ LB **sunitaṃbinī** cett.] su ‖ nittaṃbinī J, sunītavinīta U_1, sunitāṃbinīḥ P 7 **susthātā** em.] susthānāś N_2PL, susthātāś N_1DU_1, sudehaṃ U_2, susthānañ E **cānnapānāny** L] cānmanasyā° N_2DK_1, cātmapanasyā° N_1, cānnapānaḥ syād° U_1, cānpanānp° P, sukhasaṃtānaṃ U_2, cānnapānāni E, vānnapānāny B **aṣṭau bhogāḥ sudhiṣaṇam** em.] aṣṭau bhogāḥ sudhiyane N_2, ṣṭau bhogāḥ sudhipaṇa° N_1, °ṣṭau bhogāḥ sudhiṣaṇa° D, °ṣṭau bhogāḥ ‖ sudhiṣaṇa K_1, °ṣṭau bhogāḥ ‖ sudhiṣaṇāṃ J, aṣṭau bhogāḥ sudhiṣaṇāṃ U_1, aṣṭau bhogāś ca dhīmatām PE, abhayādicāṣṭakaṃ U_2, aṣṭau bhogāś cā sudhīmatām LB

Just as the place of origin of the fruit is only one, but the fruit's destiny is seen as manifold—one fruit falls to the ground and dries up; a bee drinks one fruit's juice; a woman places a garland made of one fruit over her voluptuous bosom; one fruit is placed upon a dead person — that is the own nature of the thing. In the same way, the one self enjoys eight enjoyments due to its own nature.[256] What are the eight enjoyments?[257]

XXII.1 A good perfume, fine clothing, a good bed, a beautiful woman and a good charioteer,[258] food, drink, [and a] good dwelling-place. Those are the eight enjoyments.

[256] Rāmacandra demonstrates that it is perfectly natural for an *ātman* to enjoy the eight pleasures. To illustrate this, he uses a random everyday object as an example. With this everyday object, the fruit, different experiences, and actions are naturally produced by different actors, although they all have a single origin—the fruit. In the same way, there is only one self, as Rāmacandra explained earlier, and it naturally manifests as different beings and experiences different things. The phenomenon Rāmacandra wants to address with this example is that it is natural for the one *ātman* to enjoy the eight enjoyments described in the following verse and the prose section on the next page.

[257] The origin of the *aṣṭau bhogāḥ* is uncertain. However, the term is mentioned as one of the results of Rājayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* in which Sundardās takes Rājayoga as that which is commonly known to be *vajrolīmudrā*. Cf. *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.16: *dīsai saṃga pūni muktā | aṣṭa prakāra bhoga kau bhuktā | pāpa puṇya kachu parasai nāṃhīṃ | jaisaiṃ kamala rahai jala māṃhīṃ* ‖ 16 ‖ In the *Mānasollāsa* of King Someśvara, one finds the mention of twenty royal *upabhoga*s, which, however, include all of the eight pleasures in greater detail, cf. Shrigondekar, 1939: 5. This alludes to the possibility of an exceptionally wealthy lifestyle for Rāmacandra's audience mentioned in section I.

[258] Several plausible readings exist for the fifth element among the eight pleasures. The reading *sudeham*, as an outlier, is probably a later correction. Moreover, although *susthānam* ("a good site") would be a simple and plausible solution, the stemma suggests the reading *susthātā* ("a good charioteer"). This word has only survived in an incorrect grammatical form and needs to be corrected. This choice is supported, among other things, by the fact that a total of eight pleasures must be mentioned in this verse, which is only possible if the last word of the fourth *pāda* is read as *sudhiṣaṇam* ("a good dwelling-place"), which makes the reading *susthānam* redundant. Additionally, Rāmacandra himself introduces a horse as one of the eight enjoyments in the following paragraph of the *Tattvayogabindu*. Thus, *susthātā* as an element related to vehicles is plausible.

पट्टसूत्रमयानि वस्त्राणि १॥ पञ्च वा सप्त वा शालिकायुक्तानि हर्म्याणि २॥ अति–विपुला मृदूत्तरछदवती शय्या ३॥ पद्मिनी तारुण्यवती मनोहरा गुणवती तत्रोपवि–ष्टा कान्ता ४॥ साध्वासनम् ५॥ अतिमूल्योऽश्वश्च ६॥ मनोरममन्नम् ७॥ तथाविधं पानम् ८॥ एतेऽष्टौ भोगाः कथिताः। एते दुःखं भजन्ते। भिक्षां याचन्ते च।

Sources: 1–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 837): ātmāvivekam āgamya calac cittaṃ mahākulam | viṣayāndhatamo dṛṣṭvā no vetti paramātmanaḥ | amāyātmā tattvātītaḥ satsandhānavivarjitaḥ | sukhī duḥkhī janmamṛtyuṃ yāti satyaṃ punaḥ punaḥ | vairāgyādidhanaṃ tyaktvā viṣavad duḥkhakṛddhiyaḥ | koṭisūryasamātmeti jñānayogād vimucyate |

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1 **paṭṭa°** $N_2N_1DK_1JE$] pada° U_1P, paṭa° U_2LB **°sūtra°** cett.] °sūtrā° LB **°mayāni** cett.] °yāni N_2N_1D **vastrāṇi** K_1JPEL] vasrāṇi cett. **pañca vā sapta vā** β] paṃcasaptā PE, paṃcasatyā LB **śālikā** em.] tālikā N_2, dṛālikā N_1E, dṛāṃlikā D, ṭṭālikā K_1, dālikā JU_1, dadhikā P, dātikā LB **yuktāni** cett.] saudhāni U_2 **harmyāṇi** β] harmyāṇi teṣu cāsaḥ P, harmyāṇi vāsāya kecit U_2, harmyāṇi teṣu vāsaḥ E, harmyāṇi teṣu vāstu LB 1–2 **ativipulā°** cett.] ativapulā° N_1DK_1J, ativipulāṃ U_1, aṣṭau bhogān āha ‖ U_2 2 **mṛdūttara°** em.] mṛdu | uttara° β, mṛdutara° PELB, sugrahaṃ ‖ U_2 **°chadavatī°** K_1JP] °chandavatī° N_2N_1D, °chadavati° U_1, suvastraṃ ‖ U_2 **°śayyā** cett.] suśayā sustrī U_2 **padminī** cett.] padmanī N_1, *om.* U_2 **tāruṇyavatī** em.] tārūnyavatī N_2LB, tārūṇyavatī N_1K_1PE, tārūrāyavatī D, tāruṇvati J, tārūnyavati U_1, *om.* U_2 **guṇavatī** cett.] guṇavati J 2–3 **tatropaviṣṭā** E] tatropavistā βL, tatopaviṣṭā P, *om.* U_2, tatrāpavistā B 3 **kāntā** PELB] *om.* cett. **sādhvāsanam** J] sādhyāsanaṃ $N_2N_1DK_1U_1$, sādhu āsanaṃ PU_2LB, sādhu āśanam E **atimūlyo 'śvaś ca** em.] amūlyo svaś ca β, atimūlo 'śvaḥ P, suśvaḥ U_2, atimūlyañ ca E, atimūlyo asvaṃ LB **manoramam** cett.] suṣṭu U_2, manoramyam L, manoramyam B 3–4 **vidhaṃ pānam** cett.] vidhapānaṃ N_2LB, vidhayānaṃ U_2 4 **ete** cett.] rāte U_1 **'ṣṭau** γ] aṣṭau β **bhogāḥ** cett.] bhogā N_2N_1, ghogā U_1 **kathitāḥ** U_2E] kathyate $N_2N_1U_1$, kathyante DK_1J, kathitā P, *om.* LB **ete** N_2DU_1] eke N_1K_1JPE, ekaṃ U_2, eka LB **duḥkhaṃ** cett.] duḥkhataṃ N_2, duḥkha P, duḥkhā LB **bhajante** cett.] bhajate N_2JU_1 **bhikṣāṃ** N_2JU_1PE] bhikṣyāṃ N_1DK_1, bhikṣā U_2LB **yācante** cett.] yācate N_2, pācate U_1, yāṃcaṃte P, yāṃcate LB **ca** cett.] kiñca E

[259]1. Clothes made from silk thread;[260] 2. Mansions endowed with five or seven rooms.[261] 3. A very large bed with a soft and lovely blanket;[262] 4. [on which] there is seated a wife belonging to the Padminī-class[263] of women—youthful, beautiful and virtuous;[264] 5. An excellent seat;[265] 6. An exceptionally valuable horse;[266] 7. Appetising food;[267] 8. Similarly [tasty] drinks.[268] The eight enjoyments have been described. They impart suffering. And [they] require begging.[269]

[259]The comparison with the corresponding passage in the source text reveals once again Rāmacandra's positive and anti-ascetic attitude towards wealth and sensual pleasures in his Rājayoga.

[260]Within the twenty *upabhoga*s of the *Mānasollāsa* there is the topic of *Vastropabhoga* ("enjoyment of garments"). Particularly in summer, the king is asked to wear silk or cotton clothes which are thin and charming; cf. Shrigondekar, 1939: 14.

[261]The first *adhyāya* of the third *viṃśati* of the *Mānasollāsa* discusses astrology for finding out auspicious moments while building new houses for princes. The section describes houses with one to four *śālā*s; cf. Shrigondekar, 1939: 6–7.

[262]This corresponds to the *Śayyābhoga* within the *Mānasollāsa*. The section describes seven kinds of beds and eight kinds of bed-steads; cf. Shrigondekar, 1939: 21.

[263]Cf. *Ratirahasya*, Ed. p. 6.

[264]This corresponds to*yoṣidupabhoga* ("enjoyment of young women") within the *Mānasollāsa*. In this chapter, King Someśvara describes the qualifications of women a king should marry. The two most important qualities he gives are beauty and full youth. Out of the four kinds of women: (a) Padminī, (b) Citriṇī, (c) Śaṅkhinī, and (d) Hastinī, he suggests that the latter two kinds are not worth enjoying; cf. Shrigondekar, 1935: 21.

[265]The *āsanopabhoga* ("the enjoyment of seats") within the *Mānasollāsa* describes various kinds of royal seats; cf. Shrigondekar, 1939: 15.

[266]This corresponds to *yānopabhoga* ("enjoyment of vehicles") within the *Mānasollāsa*. In this section, King Someśvara lists nine kinds of vehicles, including horses; cf. Shrigondekar, 1939: 24.

[267]This corresponds to *annabhoga* ("enjoyment of food") within the *Mānasollāsa*. In this section, King Someśvara describes the names of various kinds of delicious food and the instructions for preparing various dishes; cf. Shrigondekar, 1939: 21.

[268]The *pānīyabhoga* ("enjoyment of drinks") section of the *Mānasollāsa* concerns beverages and their consumption; cf. Shrigondekar, 1939: 23.

[269]To the genre connoisseur, the sentence "*bhīkṣāṃ yācante ca* |" initially seems …

यथा सूर्यस्य तेजः ॥ दुग्धस्य घृतम् ॥ अग्नेर्दाहः ॥ विषान्मूर्छा ॥ तिलात्तैलम् ॥ वृक्षाच्छाया ॥ फलात्परिमलः ॥ काष्ठादग्निः ॥ शार्कराद्यिभ्यो मधुरो रसः ॥ हिमानीभ्यः शैत्यम् ॥ इत्यादिपदार्थस्वभाव एव ॥ तथा संसारोऽपि परमेश्वरस्वरूपमध्ये तिष्ठति। परमेश्वरोऽखण्डपरिपूर्णश्च ॥

[XXIII. **bāhyalakṣyam**]

इदानीं बाह्यलक्ष्यं कथ्यते। नासाग्रादारभ्याङ्गुलचतुष्टयप्रमाणं नीलाकारं तेजःपूर्णमाकाशलक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम्।

Sources: 1–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 837): ravī tejo ghṛtaṃ dugdhe tile tailaṃ svabhāvataḥ | śaśam indau kule śākhaṃ kṣāre ca lavaṇaṃ yathā | tathā brahmaṇi saṃsāro hy akhaṇḍaparipūrvake | 6–7 cf. YSv (PT. p. 837): idānīṃ bāhyalakṣāṇi siddhidāni śṛṇu priye | dhāraṇākhyā tu caitāni jñātavyāni viśeṣataḥ | līlayā bhāvayel līnaṃ jyotiḥpūrṇaṃ mahāparam | 6–7 cf. SSP 2.28 (Ed. p. 39): atha bahirlakṣyaṃ kathyate | nāsāgrād bahiraṅgulacatuṣṭaye nīlajyotiḥsaṃkāśaṃ lakṣayet |

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1 **sūryasya** cett.] sūryaś ca U_1 **tejaḥ** cett.] tejāḥ LB **dugdhasya** cett.] dusya N_2, dugdhasy U_1, dugdha° LB **ghṛtam** cett.] ghṛtaḥ PLB **agner** JE] agne cett. **dāhaḥ** em.] dadhi N_2, dahiḥ N_1K_1, dadhiḥ D, dahaṃ J, dārhaṃ U_1, dvāhaḥ PLB, dāhiḥ U_2, jvalanaṃ E **viṣān** cett.] viṣāt JU_1 **tilāt** cett.] tila N_2, tilā U_1, titilāt P 2 **vṛkṣāt** N_1JE] vṛkṣā $N_2DK_1U_2$LB, vrakṣā U_1, vṛkṣāt P **phalāt** cett.] phalā LB **parimalaḥ** cett.] palāt parimalaḥ DK_1, sarimalaḥ LB **kāṣṭhād** cett.] kāṣṭād PU_2, kaṣṭād LB **agniḥ** Jγ] āgniḥ $N_2N_1DK_1U_1$ **śārkarādibhyo** em.] śarkarādibhyo $N_2N_1DK_1JU_1U_2$, śarkvarādibhyo P, arkarādibhyo E, śarkadībhyo LB **rasaḥ** cett.] *om.* LB 2–3 **himānībhyaḥ** cett.] himānitpa N_2, sahimānibhyaḥ LB 3 **śaityam** DK_1JU_1] śaityāś N_2, śaityāṃ N_1, śītaṃ PE, śītyaṃ U_2, śītaḥ LB **ityādipadārthasvabhāva** N_1DK_1JP] atyādipadārtharthasvabhāva N_2, ityādisvabhāvaḥ U_1, ityādipadārthā° U_2, ityādipadārthānāṃ svabhāvaḥ E, ityādiphadārthāḥ svabhāvataḥ L, ityādipadārthāsvabhāvataḥ B **eva** cett.] evā N_1, ravaḥ U_1, *om.* E **tathā** cett.] tathā vā U_1 3–4 **parameśvarasvarūpamadhye** cett.] parameśvararūpamadhye U_1, paremesvara svarūpasya madhye LB 4 **tiṣṭhati** cett.] tiṣṭhaṃti U_2, tiṣṭhatī B **'khaṇḍa°** cett.] yarānda° N_2, 'ṣaṃḍa° N_1DK_1, khaṃḍaḥ JU_1 **°paripūrṇaś ca** cett.] paripūrṇaḥ E 6 **bāhyalakṣyaṃ** K_1P] bāhyalakṣaṇa N_2D, bāhyalakṣaṃ N_1, bāhyalakṣyaḥ JU_1, lakṣaṇaṃ U_2, lakṣyaṃ E, bāhyalakṣa LB **catuṣṭaya°** cett.] catuṣṭayaṃ LB **nīlākāraṃ** cett.] nirākāraṃ N_2, nilākaraṃ PLB **tejaḥ°** cett.] teja° $N_2N_1DK_1$, jaḥ° B 6–7 **pūrṇam** cett.] pūrṇakām U_2 7 **ākāśa°** cett.] ākāśaṃ JU_1PEL **lakṣyaṃ** JU_1PU_2E] lakṣaṇaṃ N_2, lakṣaṃ N_1DK_1LB

Just like the rays of the sun, the ghee of milk, the burning of fire, the stupor from poison, the sesame oil from the sesame seed, the shade from the tree, the sweet odour from a fruit, the fire from a wood log, the sweet taste of sugary things, the cold from piles of snow, etc., is the nature of the thing. In the same way, the circuit of mundane existence is within the highest God's nature. Moreover, the highest God is indivisible and complete.

[XXIII. **The outer focus**]

Now, the outer focus is taught. Beginning at four finger breadths from the tip of the nose, the space element, appearing blue and being full of splendour, shall be made into the focus.

suspiciously strange and suggests a corruption of the text. However, the passage is well preserved in the β and γ-group. The subject of the sentence is undoubtedly the *aṣṭau bhogāḥ*. Nevertheless, this statement is aimed at the practitioner. If one takes the transmission of the manuscripts seriously, the question arises as to who would beg for the eight pleasures specified above. A travelling ascetic or mendicant would ask for food and drink, but certainly not for silk clothes, women, expensive horses, etc. The average householder may aspire to this, but the phrase *yācante* still seems inappropriate and overshoots the mark. Above all, there is no logical answer as to who exactly would be begged for such valuable objects and women. This statement can, therefore, only be aimed at members of the royal court. The only one able to grant such costly requests can be someone extremely rich or a king himself. This observation perfectly suits the initial definition of Rājayoga (cf. I. ll. 1–2, p. 106) in which it is defined as a practice that works even if the practitioner is leading an exuberant wealthy lifestyle.

अथवा नासाग्रादारभ्य षडङ्गुलप्रमाणं पवनतत्त्वं धूम्राकारं लक्ष्यं कर्त्तव्यम्। अथवा नासाग्रादारभ्याष्टाङ्गुलप्रमाणमतिरक्तं तेजोलक्ष्यं कर्त्तव्यम्। अथवा नासाग्रादारभ्य दशाङ्गुलप्रमाणं शुक्लं चञ्चलमुदकं लक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम्। अथवा नासाग्रादारभ्य द्वादशाङ्गुलप्रमाणं पीतवर्णं पृथ्वीतत्त्वं लक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम्। अथवा नासाग्रादारभ्य कोटिसूर्यसमप्रभं तेजःपूर्णमाकाशतत्त्वं लक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम्। आकाशमध्ये आकाशोपरि वा दृष्टिं कृत्वा ध्यानकारणात्सूर्यं विना सूर्यसंबन्धिनीं सहस्रकिरणावलीं पश्यति।

Sources: 1–6 cf. YSv (PT. p. 837): athavā tatra deveśi dhūmrākāraṃ ṣaḍaṅgulam | athavāṣṭāṅgulaṃ raktaṃ nāsikopari lakṣayet | dvādaśāṅgulamānaṃ vā pṛthvītattvan tu pītabham | lakṣayed athavā tatra koṭisūryasamaprabham | tejaḥ puñjaṃ mahākāśaṃ tattad dhyānāc chivo bhavet | ākāśamadhye ākāśoparito dṛṣṭisusthiram | kṛtvā dhyānād vinā sūryaṃ caṇḍasūryan tu paśyati | athavā lakṣam etat tu karttur vahiḥ śivopari | 1–6 cf. SSP 2.28 (Ed. p. 39) athavā nāsāgrād ṣaḍaṅgulam adhovāyutattvaṃ dhūmravarṇaṃ lakṣayet | athavā aṣṭāṅgula āraktaṃ tejas tattvaṃ lakṣayet | athavā daśāṅgule kallolavad āpas tattvaṃ lakṣayet | athavā ākāśamukhaṃ dṛṣṭvā lakṣayat kiraṇākulitaṃ paśyati | evaṃ nirmalīkaraṇam | athavordhvadṛṣṭayāntarālaṃ lakṣayet | jyotir mukhāni paśyati | athavā yatra tatrākāśaṃ lakṣayet | ākāśasadṛśaṃ cittaṃ muktipradaṃ bhavati |

Testimonia: 1–2 ≈*Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 125r ll. 6–7): atha bāhyalakṣyaṃ nirūpyate nāsāgrādārabhyāṃgulacatuṣṭaya 4 pramāṇaṃ pavanatattvaṃ dhūmrākāraṃ lakṣyaṃ karttavyaṃ | athavā nāsāgrād ārabhyāṃguṣṭhāṃgulapramāṇam atiraktaṃ tatvaṃ lakṣyaṃ kartavyaṃ |

1 **nāsāgrād ārabhya** cett.] nāsāgrārabhya N_2, nāsāgrād ābhya N_1DK_1, *om.* L **ṣaḍaṅgula°** cett.] dvadaśaṃgula° U_2, *om.* L, ṣaḍaṃgulaṃ B **pavanatattvaṃ** cett.] *om.* L, +++++ B **dhūmrākāraṃ** cett.] +++++ B **lakṣyaṃ** cett.] lakṣaṇaṃ N_2, lakṣaṃ $N_1DK_1U_2$, *om.* L **karttavyam** cett.] *om.* L **athavā** cett.] atha U_1, *om.* PELB 2 **ārabhyāṣṭāṅgula°** U_1] ārabhyaṃ ṣṭāṃgula° N_2, ārabhyā ṣaḍaṃgula° N_1, ārabhya ṣaḍaṃgula° D, ārabhya aṣṭāgula° K_1, ārabhya ṣṭāṃgula° J, *om.* PELB, ārabhyaṃ ṣṭagula° U_2 **atiraktaṃ** $N_2N_1K_1J$] atirattaṃ D, itiriktaṃ U_1, *om.* PELB, matiraktaṃ U_2 **tejo** cett.] *om.* PELB, teja° U_2 **lakṣyaṃ** JU_1U_2] lakṣaṇaṃ N_2, lakṣaṃ N_1K_1, *om.* PELB **karttavyam** cett.] *om.* PELB 2–3 **athavā nāsāgrād ārabhya daśāṅgulapramāṇaṃ śuklaṃ** cett.] *om.* PELB 3 **cañcalam** cett.] caṃdrākāraṃ U_1, *om.* PELB **udakaṃ** cett.] *om.* PELB **lakṣyaṃ** U_1] lakṣaṇaṃ N_2, lakṣya N_1D, *om.* PELB, lakṣaṃ U_2 **kartavyam** cett.] *om.* PELB 3–4 **dvādaśāṅgulapramāṇaṃ** cett.] dvādaśā aṃgulapramāṇaṃ U_1, tattvaṃ dvādaśāṃgulapramāṇaṃ E 4 **lakṣyaṃ** JU_1PE] lakṣaṇaṃ N_2, lakṣaṃ cett. 5 **°samaprabhaṃ** cett.] °prabhāṃ L **tejaḥpūrṇam** cett.] pūrṇa N_2, tejaḥ | pūrṇaṃ EB **ākāśa°** cett.] akāśa° J **lakṣyaṃ** $N_1DK_1JU_1PE$] lakṣaṇaṃ N_2, lakṣaṃ U_2LB **ākāśamadhye** cett.] *om.* PLB **ākāśopari** cett.] ākāśoparī N_1 **vā** βU_2] *om.* PELB **dṛṣṭiṃ** cett.] *om.* L, dṛṣṭi B 6 **kṛtvā** cett.] ākāśamadhye L, kṛtvā ākāśamadhye B **sūryaṃ** cett.] sūrya N_2U_2 **sūryasaṃbandhinīṃ** em.] sūryasaṃbadhinī J, sūryasaṃbaṃdhīnīṃ P, sūryasambandhinī cett. **sahasrakiraṇāvalīṃ** P] sahasrāṇapi kiraṇāṇi N_2D, sahasrāṇy api kīraṇāṇi $N_1K_1JU_1$, sahasrakiraṇāvaliṃ U_2, sahasrakiraṇapaṅktīḥ E, sahasrakiraṇāvali LB **paśyati** U_2EL] paśyate N_2, paśyatī N_1DK_1B, paśyaṃti JU_1, pati P

Or, beginning at six finger breadths from the tip of the nose, the wind element, in the shape of smoke, shall be made into the focus.

Or, beginning at eight finger breadths from the tip of the nose, the very red fire element shall be made into the focus.

Or, beginning at ten finger breadths from the tip of the nose, the white fickle water element shall be made into the focus.

Or, beginning at twelve finger breadths from the tip of the nose, the yellow-coloured earth element shall be made into the focus.[270]

Or, beginning at the tip of the nose, the space element full of fire shining like ten million suns shall be made the focus. After having fixed the gaze on the space-element or above the space-element, as a result of meditation, he sees the row of thousand rays connected to the sun without the sun.

[270] The first five outer foci, associated with the five elements can also be identified in *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.29–32: *bāhya lakṣa aura puni jāṃnahuṃ | paṃca tatva kī lakṣa su ṭhānahuṃ | agra nāsikā aṃgula cārī | nīla varṇa nabha deṣi bicārī* ‖ 29 ‖ *nāsā agra aṃgula chaha deṣaiṃ | dhūmrahi varṇa vāyu tata peṣai | aṃgula aṣṭa nāsikā āgai | rakta varṇa su vahni tata jāgai* ‖ 30 ‖ *nāsā agra aṃgula daśa tāṃīṃ | śveta varṇa jala deṣi tahāṃīṃ | nāsā agra su aṃgula bārā | pīta varṇa bhū deṣi apārā* ‖ 31 ‖ *bāhya lakṣa aura bahuterī | so jānaiṃ jo pāvai serī | sataguru kṛpā karai jau kabahī | dei batāi chinaka maiṃ sabahī* ‖ 32 ‖ "(29) Contemplate the external focus repeatedly, focusing on the five elements. Four fingers above the tip of the nose contemplate the blue-coloured space-element. (30) Six fingers from the tip of the nose one visualises the smoke-coloured air element. Eight fingers in front of the nose one visualises the red-coloured fire element. (31) Ten fingers from the tip of the nose one visualises the white-coloured water element. Twelve fingers in front of the nose one visualises the earth element with a yellow colour. (32) Many external foci exist, but only a few can attain the ultimate goal. If the true guru shows mercy, everything is revealed within an instant."

अथवा शिरोपर्यूर्ध्वं सप्तदशाङ्गुलप्रमाणं तेजःपुञ्जं लक्ष्यं कर्त्तव्यम्। अथवा दृष्टेरग्रे तप्तस्वर्णवर्णाकारं पृथ्वीतत्त्वं लक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम्। उक्तानांलक्ष्याणां मध्ये यस्य क–स्याप्येकस्य लक्ष्यकरणाद्वलितपलितादि दूरे भवति। अङ्गरोगा विनौषधं दूरे भ–वन्ति। समग्राः शत्रवः स्वप्नेऽपि मित्रतामायान्ति। सहस्रवर्षपर्यन्तमायुर्वर्धते। अपठितं शास्त्रं जिह्वाग्रेणोच्चरति। एतादृशं बहुतरं फलं भवति॥

Sources: 1–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 837): ūrddhvaṃ saptadaśāṅgulyaṃ pramāṇaṃ tejasā prabham | athavā pṛthivītattvaṃ taptakāñcanasannibham | dṛṣṭiragre tu karttavyaṃ lakṣam etad yat ātmanām | uktānāṃ yasya kasyaiva ekaśaḥ karaṇaṃ priye | valīpalitahīnaḥ syād auṣadhena vinā tathā | sarvarogāṇi naśyanti mitravac ca vaśī ripuḥ | jīved varṣasahasran tu sarvalokeṣu pūjitaḥ | jihvāgre prabhaved vidyā vinā śāstrāvalokanāt | 1–2 cf. SSP 2.28 (Ed. p. 40): athavā dṛṣṭyā taptakāñcanasannibhāṃ bhūmiṃ lakṣayet | dṛṣṭiḥ sthirā bhavati | ity anekavidhaṃ bahirlakṣyam |

Testimonia: 2–4 ≈*Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 125r ll. 7–8): uttānāṃ tatvānāṃ madhye yasya kasyāpy ekasya lakṣyasya karaṇād valīpalitādidūre bhavati | auṣadhamṛteṃ-garogāṇā vilayo bhavati | āyur vardhate ca |

1 **athavā** cett.] atha kā N_1, *om.* P **śiropary** em.] śiropari cett., *om.* P, śivopari E, śiroparir B **ūrdhvaṃ** cett.] ūrddhaṃ U_1U_2, *om.* P, vṛddhaṃ E, ūrdhva° L, urdhvam B **saptadaśāṅgu-lapramāṇaṃ** cett.] saptadaśāṃgulaṃ parāṇaṃ N_2, *om.* P, saptadaśāṃgulapramāṇa° U_2 **te-jaḥpuñjaṃ lakṣyaṃ** U_2] tejaḥpuṃjalakṣaṇaṃ N_2, tejā puṃjalakṣaṃ N_1K_1, tejā puṃjalakṣyaṃ D, tejaḥpuṃjakaṃ lakṣyaṃ JU_1, *om.* P, tejaḥpuṃjalakṣyaṃ E, tejaḥpūṃjaṃ lakṣaṃ L, te-jaḥpūṃjaṃ lakṣaṇaṃ B **agre** cett.] ag++ N_1, agne PLB 2 **taptasvarṇavarṇākāraṃ** U_2] taptavarṇākāraṃ β, taptasvarṇavarṇakāraṃ P, tatparaṃ svarṇākāraṃ E, taptasuvarṇavarṇa LB **pṛthvītattvaṃ** βPE] pṛthvīṃ tatvaṃ U_2, pṛthītatvaṃ L, pṛthivītatvaṃ B **lakṣyaṃ** U_1PE] lakṣaṇaṃ N_2, lakṣaṃ $N_1DK_1JU_2$LB **kartavyam** cett.] *om.* P **lakṣyāṇāṃ** E] lakṣāṇā° N_2, lakṣyaṇāṃ N_1U_1, lakṣyaṇaṃ DJ, lakṣyāṇaṃ K_1, lakṣaṇānāṃ P, lakṣāṃ U_2, lakṣaṇaṃ LB 2–3 **kasyāpy** cett.] lasyāpy N_2, kasyāp° D, kasyāpi JU_1LB 3 **ekasya** cett.] elasya N_2, kasya JU_1LB **lakṣya°** cett.] lakṣaṇasya N_2, lakṣasya N_1DK_1J, lakṣyasya U_1, lakṣa° LB **°karaṇād** em.] °karaṇāt cett., karaṇā JU_1 **°palitādi dūre** cett.] °palitā dūre E, °ṃ palitādi dūre LB **bhavati** cett.] bhavanti U_2E, bhavatī B **aṅgarogā** cett.] aṃgirogā P, aṃgarogāḥ E, aṃgirogādi LB **dūre** cett.] dūrī E, dūro LB 3–4 **bhavanti** $N_1DK_1JU_2$E] bhavati N_2U_1PL, bhavatī B 4 **sam-agrāḥ** cett.] samagrā N_2, samagra° U_2 **śatravaḥ** cett.] śatravo L, śatrave B **svapne** cett.] svapin $N_2N_1K_1JU_1$, svacan D **'pi** U_2] evan N_2, eva $N_1DK_1JU_1$, pya PELB **mitratām** PU_2LB] nityaṃ N_2, mityaṃ N_1DK_1, mityevaṃ J, mitevaṃ U_1, mitran E **āyānti** U_2] nāyāti $N_2N_1DK_1J$, naiyati U_1, ayānti PB, nāyāṃti E, ayāṃtī L **°varṣaparyaṃtam** β] °varṣam γ **āyur** γ] āyuṣaṃ $N_2N_1DK_1$, āyuṣyaṃ JU_1 **vardhate** cett.] bhavati E 5 **apaṭhitaṃ** cett.] apathitaṃ $N_2U_1U_2$ **°rati** PU_2EL] °rate β, °ratī B **etādṛśaṃ** cett.] etādṛśyaṃ U_1, mitratām āyāṃti sahasravarṣam āyur varddhate apaṭhitaṃ śāstraṃ jihvāgreṇoccarati etādṛśaṃ P **bahutaraṃ phalaṃ** β] phalaṃ bahutaraṃ γ **bhavati** cett.] bhavati || cha J, phalaṃ bhavati U_2, bhavantī L, bhavatī B

Or, the mass of light situated a distance of seventeen finger-widths above the head shall be made the focus. Or, at the front of the gaze, the earth element appearing in the colour of molten gold shall be made the focus.[271,272,273]

As a result of focusing on any one of the discussed foci, wrinkles, grey hair, etc., become remote. Diseases of the limbs become distant without medical herbs. All enemies become friends even while sleeping.[274] The lifespan increases up to 1000 years. He recites unlearned scripture with the tip of the tongue. Such are the manifold results.

[271] A variant of the practice with minor differences can also be found in *Advayatārakopaniṣad* 6 (Ed. p. 4): *atha bahirlakṣyalakṣaṇam | nāsikāgre caturbhiḥ ṣaḍbhir aṣṭabhiḥ daśabhiḥ dvādaśabhiḥ kramāt aṅgulānte nīladyutiśyāmatvasadṛgraktabhaṅgīsphuratpītavarṇadvayopetaṃ vyoma yadi paśyati sa tu yogī bhavati | caladṛṣṭyā vyomabhāgavīkṣituḥ puruṣasya dṛṣṭyagre jyotirmayūkhā vartante | taddarśanena yogī bhavati | taptakāñcanasaṃkāśajyotir mayūkhā apāṅgānte bhūmau vā paśyati taddṛṣṭiḥ sthirā bhavati | śirṣopari dvādaśāṅgulasamīkṣituḥ amṛtatvaṃ bhavati | yatra kutra sthitasya śirasi vyomajyotir dṛṣṭaṃ cet sa tu yogī bhavati* ‖ 6 ‖ "Now, the characteristics of the outer focus. If one sees a space endowed with two colours, a twinkling yellow breaking into a red which resembles the blackness of profound azure radiance, at [a distance of] four, six, eight, ten and twelve finger breadths, in that order, from the tip of the nose, he becomes a yogin. With the fluctuating gaze of one who looks at the portions of space, luminous rays manifest in front of the observer's field of vision. By seeing that, one becomes a yogin. [Once] he sees luminous rays appearing like molten gold at the corner of his eye or on the ground, his gaze becomes stable. For one who sees [this phenomenon] twelve finger breadths above the head, the state of immortality ensues. If the light of space is seen in the head by one who is situated anywhere, he is a yogin."

[272] Cf. *Śivayogapradīpikā* 4.41cd–47ab for another description of Bāhyalakṣya closely resembling the one in *Advayatārakopaniṣad*.

[273] The *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (manuscripts checked: ORI B220, GOML R3239, MMPP 2244) quotes the Bāhyalakṣya passage from the *Tattvayogabindu* without reference. Yet, Sundaradeva's text appears to be corrupt. Moreover, he selected only some of the techniques presented here; see sources on pp. 174–178.

[274] It is not entirely clear how *svapne 'pi* is meant here. Either it is supposed to emphasise the effortlessness of getting rid of all enemies, as this happens "overnight". Alternatively, it could also be translated as "even in a dream", in the sense that one has got rid of all enemies even in the rather uncontrollable state of dreaming.

[XXIV. **antaralakṣyam**]

इदानीमन्तरलक्ष्यं कथ्यते। मूलकन्दस्थाने ब्रह्मदण्डादुत्पन्ना श्वेतवर्णा ब्रह्मरन्ध्र–
पर्यंतं एका ब्रह्मनाडी वर्तते। ब्रह्मनाडी मध्ये कमलतन्तुसमानाकारा कोटिसूर्य–
विद्युत्समप्रभोर्ध्वं चलति। एतादृश्येका मूर्तिर्वर्तते। तस्या मूर्तेर्ध्यानकारणादणिमा–
द्यष्टसिद्धिः पुरुषस्य समीप आगत्य तिष्ठति।

Sources: 2–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 838): mūlakandotthatalato brahmanāḍīsamudbhavā | śvetavarṇā brahmarandhraparyantam eva tiṣṭhati | eṣā tu brahmarandhrākhyā tanmadhye varttate parā | padmatantusamākārā koṭisūryataḍitprabhā | calaty ūrddhaṃ mahāmūrttir asya dhyānād bhavec chivaḥ | aṇimādyaṣṭasiddhis tu samagreṇa prasīdati | 2–5 cf. SSP 2.26 (Ed. pp. 37–38): tatra tāvad antarlakṣyaṃ kathyate | mūlakandād daṇḍalagnāṃ brahmanāḍīṃ śvetavarṇāṃ brahmarandhraparyantaṃ gatāṃ saṃsmaret | tanmadhye kamalatantunibhāṃ vidyutkoṭiprabhām ūrdhvagāminīṃ tāṃ mūrtiṃ manasā lakṣayet | sarvasiddhipradā bhavati

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Testimonia: 2–5 ≈*Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 125r ll. 8–9 to f. 126v l. 1): athāṃtarlakṣyaṃ nirūpyate | mūlakaṃdasthāne brahmadaṃḍād utpannāśvetavarṇābrahmaraṃdhraparyaṃttaṃ ekābrahmanāḍī vartate | brahmanāḍī madhye kamalataṃtusamānākārakoṭisūryavidyutprabhā tulyā ūrdhva calati | etādṛśī ekā mūrtir vartate | tasya mūrter dhyānakaraṇād aṇimādisiddhayaḥ samīpa upatiṣṭhaṃte |

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2 **idānīm** U_2E] idānīṃ cett. **antaralakṣyaṃ** DK_I] aṃtaralakṣyaṇaṃ N_2U_I, antaralakṣyakaṃ N_I, antaraṃ J, aṃtaraṃ lakṣyaṃ P, ataraṃ lakṣyaṃ U_2, anyataraṃ lakṣyaṃ E, antaralakṣaṃ LB **kathyate** cett.] lakṣyate J, kartavyaṃ LB **mūlakandasthāne** cett.] mūlakaṃ sthāne P **brahmadaṇḍād utpannā** cett.] brahmadaṇḍad ūtpannā N_2, brahmadaṃḍa ityannā N_I, brahmadaṃḍād utpannāḥ J, brahmadaṇād ūtpannaḥ U_I, brahmānaṃḍād utpannā PB, brahmadaṇḍotpannā nāḍī E, brahmānaṃdād utpannā L **°varṇā** cett.] °varṇaṃ K_IJ, °varṇāṃ U_I 2–3 **°randhraparyaṃtaṃ** cett.] °daṇḍaparyantam E 3 **ekā brahmanāḍī** cett.] ekanāḍī L, ekā nāḍī B **brahmanāḍī madhye** cett.] *om.* N_2 **kamalatantusamānākārā** cett.] *om.* N_2, kamalataṃ samānākārā P 4 **°samaprabho°** em.] samaprabhā cett., *om.* N_2, °sabhāprabhā LB **°rdhvaṃ** em.] ūrdhvaṃ cett., *om.* N_2, °rdhvaṃ U_I, urdhvaṃ U_2 **calati** cett.] *om.* N_2 **etādṛśy ekā°** cett.] *om.* N_2U_I, etādṛśī N_IDK$_I$J **mūrtir** cett.] *om.* N_2U_I **vartate** cett.] *om.* N_2U_I **tasyā** cett.] tasyāḥ N_I, *om.* U_I, tan E **mūrter** cett.] *om.* U_I, mūrte B **dhyāna°** cett.] *om.* U_I **°kāraṇād** em.] °karaṇāt cett., °karaṇāc° N_2, *om.* U_I 4–5 **aṇimādyaṣṭasiddhiḥ** DK_IJU_I] *om.* N_2, aṇimādīsiddhiḥ N_I, aṣṭamahāsiddhayo ṇimādyāḥ aṇimāmahimālaghimāgirimādure dīya vā dure stutvā parakāyapraveśitā P, aṣṭamahāsiddhayo aṇimādyāḥ ‖ U_2, aṣṭamahāsiddhayo 'ṇimādayas tasya E, aṣṭamahāsiddhayo aṇimādyāḥ ‖ aṇimāmahimālaghimāgarimā dure vā yadi vā ddure śrutvā parakāyāpraveśitā L, aṣṭamahāsiddhayo ‖ aṇimādyāḥ ‖ aṇimāmahimālaghimāgirimā dure vā yadi vā yadi vā dure śrutvā parakāyāpraveśitā ‖ B 5 **puruṣasya** cett.] *om.* N_2 **samīpa** em.] *om.* N_2, samīpe N_IDK$_I$J, sāmīpe U_I, samīm P, samīpam U_2EL, samīpem B **āgatya** cett.] *om.* N_2, āgamya U_2 **tiṣṭhati** cett.] *om.* N_2, tiṣṭhanti N_IPE

[XXIV. **The inner focus**]

Now, the inner focus is explained. At the location of the root-bulb (*mūlakanda*)[275] there is a single white Brahman-channel,[276] originating from the staff of Brahman[277] and extending up to the aperture of Brahman. The Brahman-channel, being within [the staff of Brahman],[278] having the shape of a stalk of a lotus flower [and] shining like ten million suns goes upwards. One such manifestation exists. As a result of meditation on this manifestation[279] the accomplishment of the eight supernatural powers beginning with 'becoming as small as the smallest particle of matter' etc.[280] exists in proximity of the person.[281]

[275] Various concepts of the location of the *kanda* are found in yogic literature. In the *Yogayājñavalkya* 4.16–27 one reads: *kandasthānāṃ manuṣyāṇāṃ dehamadhyān navāṅgulam | caturaṅgulam utsedham āyāmaś ca tathāvidhaḥ ‖* 16 *‖ aṇḍākṛtivad ākāraṃ bhūṣitaṃ tattvagādhibhiḥ | catuṣpadāṃ tiraścāṃ ca dvijānāṃ tundamadhyame ‖* 17 *‖* "The location of the bulb (*kanda*) of humans is nine finger widths from the waist. [It is] four finger widths in height and has the same [measure in] length. It appears like an egg, and [it is] ornamented with the five elements of creation and sustenance. In quadrupeds, birds and other beings, it is in the centre of the belly." *Haṭhapradīpikā* 3.64cd (*gulphadeśasamīpe ca kandaṃ tatra prapīḍayet*) instructs the yogin to press the *kanda* with the feet in the context of *uḍḍiyāṇabandha*, which could imply that the *kanda* is in the genital region (unless one assumes the very complex and challenging posture termed *kandapīḍāsana*, cf. *Encyclopedia of Traditional Asanas*, pp. 143–144). Sundaradeva, in *Yuktabhavadeva* 7.224 and Bhavadevamiśra in *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 36r) argue that the *kanda* is near the navel. In *Yogacūḍāmaṇyupaniṣad* 14cd the *kanda* is between the penis and the navel (*ūrdhvaṃ meḍhrādadho nābheḥ kande yoniḥ khagāṇḍavat*).

[276] The term *brahmanāḍī* is a synonym for the *suṣumnā*, cf., e.g. *Haṭhapradīpikā* 2.46 and 2.67, *Gorakṣaśataka* 47, *Yogakuṇḍalinyopaniṣad* 37c–38b, *Yogacintāmaṇi* (Ed. pp. 46, 112, 116, 140, 191), *Haṭharatnāvalī* 2.8, 2.25, 2.65, 2.69.

[277] The term *brahmadaṇḍa* in this context refers to the spinal column, which is usually identified with Mt. Meru in tantric texts, cf. Snodgrass, 1988: 360.

[278] Naturally, one would read *brahmanāḍīmadhye* compounded, but this would leave the sentence lacking a subject. Therefore, the only option is to read *brahmanāḍī madhye* separately, referring to the inside of the previously mentioned *brahmadaṇḍa*. Assuming another channel within the *brahmanāḍī* like the *citrānāḍī* in *Śivasaṃhitā* 5.160 would be difficult to prove.

[279] Cf. *Vijñānabhairava* 35.

[280] For a detailed discussion of the yogic *siddhi*s, see Jacobsen, 2017.

[281] Three of the five witnesses of the γ-group add an incomplete list of the eight *siddhi*s …

अथवा ललाटोपर्याकाशमध्ये शुक्लसदृशस्य तेजसो ध्यानकारणाच्छरीरसम्बन्धि-
नः कुष्ठादयो रोगा नश्यन्ति। आयुर्वृद्धिर्भवति। अथवा भ्रुवोर्मध्येऽतिरक्तवर्णस्या-
तिस्थूलस्य तेजसो ध्यानकरणात्सकलानां पार्थिवपुरुषाणां वल्लभो भवति। तं पुरुषं
दृष्ट्वा सर्वेषां दृष्टिः स्थिरा भवति॥

Sources: 1–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 838): lalāṭopari vā dhyātvā candraṃ vā jyotir īśvaram | nāśayet kuṣṭharogādīn mahāyuṣmān śivaḥ paraḥ | bhruvor madhye 'thavā dhyātvā arkantu teja īśvaram | sthiradṛṣṭau rājapūjyo jīvanmuktaḥ śivo yathā | ātmānam ātmarūpaṃ hi dhyātvā yo niṣkriyo bhavet | nirāśīryatatattvo 'yaṃ itaro na nṛpasthitiḥ | 1–4 cf. SSP 2.27 (Ed. p. 38): athavā lalāṭordhve gollāṭamaṇḍape sphurattārākāraṃ lakṣayet |

Testimonia: 1–4 ≈*Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 125v ll. 1–3): athāvā lalāṭopari ākāśamadhye śukladṛśyasya tejaso dhyānakaraṇāc charīrāḥ kuṣṭhādiroga naśyaṃtīti | athavā bhruvor madhye atiraktavarṇasyātisthūlasya tejaso dhyānakaraṇāt kalānāṃ pārthivapuruṣāṇāṃ vallabho bhavati | taṃ puruṣaṃ dṛṣṭvā sarveṣāṃ puruṣāṇāṃ dṛṣṭiḥ sthirā bhavatī |

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1 **lalāṭopary** E] *om.* N_2, lalāṭopari N_1DK_1JPLB, lalāṭoparī U_1U_2 **ākāśamadhye** cett.] *om.* N_2 **śuklasadṛśasya** cett.] *om.* N_2 **tejaso** cett.] *om.* N_2, tejo U_1 **dhyānakaraṇāc** em.] dhyānakāraṇāt cett., *om.* N_2 **śarīra°** LB] śarīra° cett., *om.* N_2 1–2 **°sambandhinaḥ** γ] °saṃbaṃdhi N_2, °sambandhī $N_1DK_1JU_1$ 2 **kuṣṭhādayo** cett.] kuṣṭādayo N_2DK_1J **rogā** cett.] rogāḥ $N_2N_1DK_1JP$ **naśyanti** cett.] naśyaṃtī PB **vṛddhir** cett.] vṛddi N_2 **bhavati** cett.] bhavati ‖ cha ‖ J, bhavatī B **athavā** cett.] *om.* E **bhruvor** cett.] bṛvor U_2 **'tirakta°** cett.] atirakta° U_2, tirikta° E 2–3 **varṇasyātisthūlasya** cett.] varṇasyātī sthalasya U_1, 'tisthūlasyaḥ U_2 3 **tejaso** cett.] tejāso U_2 **dhyānakaraṇāt** cett.] dhyānakāraṇād E, dhyānaṃ karaṇāt B **sakalānāṃ** $N_1JU_1PU_2LB$] sakālānāṃ N_2, sakalānā DK_1, bahulānāṃ E **pārthivapuruṣāṇāṃ** cett.] parthivānāṃ tatpuruṣāṇāṃ ca E **bhavati** cett.] bhavati | jagad vallabho pi bhavati E **taṃ** cett.] asya E 3–4 **puruṣaṃ dṛṣṭvā** $N_1DK_1JU_1$] puruṣaṃ dṛṣṭā N_2, puruṣaṃ PB, puruṣasyāvalokanena E, puruṣa° L 4 **sarveṣāṃ** βE] pratisarveṣāṃ cett. **dṛṣṭiḥ sthirā** JPE] dṛṣṭisthirā cett. **bhavati** cett.] bhavati ‖ cha ‖ J, bhavatī B

Or, as a result of meditation onto the bright light within the space above the forehead, diseases related to the body, skin disease[s], etc., vanish.[282,283] The lifespan increases. Alternatively, as a result of meditation on the very subtle red light in the middle of the eyebrows, he becomes one who is beloved among all royal people.[284] After having seen this person, everybody's gaze becomes fixed [onto him].[285]

(see apparatus). I did not include it in greyscale for two reasons. First, the passage is incomplete and in a very corrupt state. Second, since it is absent U_2 it probably does not belong to the γ-group archetype. The passage *dure vā yadi vādure śrutvā* seems to refer to the supernatural abilities *dūradarśana* and *dūraśravana*. The list does not follow the standard list of eight supernatural powers. After the first four items that are usually considered as primary *siddhi*s, the three manuscripts instead list three of the so-called secondary *siddhi*s, cf. *Bhāgavatapurāṇa* 11.10 and 11.15.2–6. Because of that, it is impossible to determine the missing *siddhi* precisely. However, the passage allows to identify seven *siddhi*s: Aṇimā ("the ability to reduce size to the size of the smallest particle"), Mahimā ("the ability to expand one's body to an infinitely large size"), Laghimā ("the ability to become weightless or lighter than air"), Garimā ("the ability to become heavy or dense"), Dūraśravaṇa ("hearing things far away"), Dūradarśana ("seeing things far away") and Parakāyapraveśitā ("entering the bodies of others").

[282] The *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.27 (Ed. p. 38) includes three techniques of *antarlakṣya* which are unparalleled in Rāmacandra's system: *athavā bhramaraguhāmadhye āraktabhramarākāraṃ lakṣayet | athavā karṇadvayaṃ tarjanībhyāṃ nirodhayet tataḥ śiromadhye dhūṃdhūṃkāraṃ nādaṃ śṛṇoti | athavā cakṣurmadhye nīlajyotirūpaṃ putalyākāraṃ lakṣayed |* "Or, one should focus the form of a very red bee within the *bhrahmaraguhā*. Or, one should close both ears with the index fingers and listen to the *dhūṃ dhūṃ*-sound in the head. Or, one should focus on the form of a doll appearing in blue light within the eyes."

[283] *Śivayogapradīpikā* 4.32–41 describes the main practice of *antarlakṣya* in very similar ways along with two alternatives in 4.40–41 which resemble those in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.27: *athavā karṇayor dvāre tarjanībhyāṃ nirodhayet | śrīhaṭṭamastake nādaṃ ghuṃghuṃkāraṃ śṛṇoti ca ‖* 40 *‖ cakṣurmadhye 'thavā nīlajyotirūpaṃ vilokayet | antarlakṣyam iti jñeyaṃ bahirlakṣyam atha śṛṇu ‖* 41 *‖* "(40) Alternatively, one should block the opening of the ears with the index fingers. At the crown of the head, at the *śrīhaṭṭa*, one hears the sound which makes '*ghuṃ ghuṃ*'. (41) Likewise, one should visualize the form of blue light within the eyes. Thus, it is known as the internal focus. Now listen to the external fixation."

[284] For the translation of *pārthivapuruṣāṇāṃ* cf. the usage of *pārthiva°* in section I, l. 5.

[285] The placement of the ten channels and vital winds after *antaralakṣya* rather than *madhyalakṣya* in both Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya* is puzzling.

[XXV. **nāḍīnāṃ bhedāḥ**]

इदानीं शरीरमध्ये नाडीनां भेदाः कथ्यन्ते। दश मुख्य नाड्यः तन्मध्ये नाडीद्वयमिडापिंगलासंज्ञकं नासाद्वरे तिष्ठति। सुषुम्णा तु तालुमार्गेण ब्रह्मद्वारपर्यन्तं वहति। सरस्वती मुखमध्ये वर्तते। गांधारी हस्तिजिह्वा कर्णयोर्मध्ये वहत्यौ तिष्ठतः। पूषालम्बुषा नेत्रयोर्मध्ये वहत्यौ तिष्ठतः। शङ्खिनी लिङ्गद्वारादारभ्येडामार्गेण ब्रह्मस्थानपर्यंतं तिष्ठति। कुहू मूलद्वारादरभ्य पिङ्गला मर्गेण ब्रह्मस्थानपर्यन्तं तिष्ठति। एतादृषा नाड्यो दशसु द्वारेषु तिष्ठन्ति। अन्या द्विसप्ततिसहस्रपरिमिता नाड्यो लोम्नां मूलेषु सूक्ष्मरूपेण तिष्ठन्ति ॥

Sources: 2–8 cf. SSP 1.66 (Ed. p. 29): atha nāḍīnāṃ daśa dvārāṇi | iḍā piṅgalā ca nāsādvārayor vahataḥ | gāndhārī hastijihvikā ca cakṣurdvārayor vahataḥ | pūṣā yaśasvinī ca karṇadvārayor vahataḥ | alambuṣā ānane vahati | kuhūr gudadvāre vahati | śaṅkhinī liṅgadvāre vahati | suṣumṇā madhyadeśe vahati | sā daṇḍamārgeṇa brahmarandhraparyantaṃ vahati | evaṃ daśanāḍyo daśadvāreṣu vahanti | anyāḥ sarvanāḍyo romakūpeṣu vahanti | 2–8 cf. YSv (PT, p. 838): idānīṃ śṛṇu nāḍīnāṃ bhedaṃ vakṣyāmi siddhidam | meruvāhye iḍānāmnī piṅgalayā samanvitā | suṣumnā bhānumārgeṇa brahmadvārāvadhi sthitā | sarasvatī sugandhā tu gāndhārī hastijihvakā | jñātavyā karṇayor madhye netrayoś ca tathāntimā | pūṣā cālambuṣā ceti mūlasthā kutracit tathā | liṅgadvārād iḍāmārge brahmasthānāvadhi priye | nāḍyantaṃ pratilomeṣu sahasrāṇāṃ dvisaptatiḥ |

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2 **idānīṃ** cett.] idānī N_2LB **nāḍīnāṃ** cett.] nāḍīnām aparo β, nāḍī° LB **bhedāḥ** cett.] bhedaḥ N_1DK_1JU_2LB **kathyante** DK_1PE] kathyate ‖ cha ‖ J, kathyate cett. **mukhya°** cett.] mukhyā° DK_1JPL, mukhye° B **nāḍyaḥ** cett.] nādhyaḥ N_1DK_1, nādhyas J, nāḍyas U_1, nāḍayas L, nāḍyā B **nāḍī°** cett.] *om.* E **°dvayam** N_2N_1E] dvayaṃ cett. 2–3 **iḍā°** E] idā° cett., idānīṃ N_2, idāṃ P 3 **°saṃjñakaṃ** cett.] °saṃjñākaṃ U_1U_2, °saṃjñīkāḥ LB **nāsā°** cett.] nāsānāsā° D **suṣumṇā tu** β] suṣumṇā γ **°mārgeṇa** cett.] °mārge N_2ELB **°dvāra°** cett.] °raṃdhra° PLB **vahati** U_2] vahati tiṣṭhati cett. 4 **sarasvatī** cett.] tisraḥ sarasvati U_2 **vartate** β] tiṣṭhati γ **gāṃdhārī** cett.] gāṃdhādī U_1 **hastijihvākarṇayor** E] hastinījihve N_2N_1DK_1P, hastījihve JLB, harratījihva U_1, hastinī ‖ jihve ‖ U_2 **karṇayor** cett.] °karṇayor U_1, netrayor U_2, karṇa° LB **madhye** cett.] *om.* LB **vahatyau** cett.] *om.* JU_1, vahaṃtyaḥ U_2, vahalyau E, vahatyo LB **tiṣṭhataḥ** cett.] *om.* U_2, tiṣṭhati LB **pūṣā°** cett.] pūṣāṃ N_2N_1DK_1, pūṣo° LB 5 **°laṃbuṣā** em.] alaṃbuṣe N_2N_1DK_1J, °laṃbuse U_1P, °ya śakhinī ‖ U_2, °laṃbusemā E, °ulabuso L, °ḍalabuṣe B **netrayor** cett.] netayor N_2U_1, karṇayor U_2, netra° LB **vahatyau** cett.] vahatyo $N_2N_1U_2$LB, rvahalyā E **tiṣṭhataḥ** cett.] tiṣṭataḥ P, tiṣṭhata ‖ alaṃbuṣā ‖ bh++madhye vaṃhatyo tiṣṭhati ‖ U_2, tiṣṭhaṃti L, tiṣṭhati B **śaṅkhinī** cett.] śaṃkhanī N_1, kuhū U_2 **liṃgadvārād** cett.] liṃgadvārā° U_1 **ārabhye** E] ārabhya cett. **°ḍā°** E] iḍā° cett., iḍānīṃ N_2 6 **tiṣṭhati** cett.] tiṣṭhatīti E **kuhū** conj.] śāṃkhinī U_2, *om.* cett. **mūladvārād-arabhya** U_2] *om.* cett. **piṃgalā°** em.] piṃgala° U_2 **margeṇa brahmasthānaparyaṃtaṃ tiṣṭhati** U_2] *om.* cett. 6–7 **etādṛṣā** P] etā N_2, etādaśa N_1DK_1U_2, etādṛśā J, etādṛśa U_1E, etādṛṣyā LB 7 **nāḍyo** cett.] *om.* N_2 **daśasu dvāreṣu** cett.] daśasv adhāreṣu U_1, daśaśeṣu dvāreṣu U_2, daśa dvāreṣu L **tiṣṭhanti** cett.] tiṣṭhati U_1 **dvisaptatisahasraparimitā** cett.] dvisaptatrisahasraparimitā N_2, dvisaptatisahasraparamitā N_1DK_1, dvisaptatisahaparamitā J, hi daśonā dvisatyati sahasraḥ ‖ 71110 ‖ parimitā U_2, dvisaptatīsahasraparimitā B **nāḍyo** cett.] nāḍyā N_2N_1D, °gryo U_1, nādhyo U_2, nāḍayo E 7–8 **lomnāṃ mūleṣu** cett.] lomnā JU_1PLB 8 **tiṣṭhanti** cett.] tiṣṭati K_1

[XXV. **Division of the channels**]

Now, the divisions of channels within the body are explained. There are ten primary channels.[286] Among them is a pair of channels. [Their] designation is Iḍā and Piṅgalā [and they] exist at the entrance of the nose. The Suṣumṇā flows by the path of the palate to the door of Brahman.[287,288] The Sarasvatī[-channel] exists within the mouth. The two channels, Gāndhārī and Hastijihvā, exist within the two ears. The two channels, Pūṣā and Ālaṃbuṣā, are situated at the centre of the two eyes. Śaṅkhinī stretches from the beginning of the opening of the penis through the Iḍā-channel up to the place of Brahman.[289] Kuhū[290] stretches from the entrance of the root[291] through the Piṅgalā-channel up to the place of Brahman. Such channels are situated at the ten openings. The other channels, numbering 72,000, occur in a subtle form at the roots of the hairs.

[286] The notion of ten primary channels can already be found in early texts of Haṭhayoga, cf., e.g., the *Vivekamārtaṇḍa* 17 (Central Library, Baroda Acc. No. 4110, 1534 Saṃvat): *teṣu nāḍīsahasreṣu dvisaptatir udāhṛtāḥ | pradhānāḥ prāṇavāhinyo bhūyas tatra daśa smṛtāḥ ||* "Of those thousand channels, seventy-two have been spoken of, and among them, ten are considered most important. They are the main pathways of the vital breaths." Also cf. *Gorakṣaśataka (Nowotny)* 34. However, the enumeration of ten main channels in yogic literature also has predecessors, e.g., in Śaivasiddhānta, cf. *Sārdhatriśatikālottara* 10.4–5. Other systems, e.g., *Yogayājñavalkya* IV.26 or *Vasiṣṭhasaṃhitā* 2.21, enumerate fourteen primary channels.

[287] According to *Tāntrikābhidhānakośa 3* (p. 93), the palate is the Śaiva locus of the central *granthi* along the course of the breath through five *granthi*s (heart, throat, palate, eyebrows, nose-tip), cf. *Tantrāloka (b)* 5.111. YSv (PT) alternatively reads *bhānumargeṇa* "by the path of the sun." In several yogic systems, the microcosmic sun is located at the base of the central channel (see *Amṛtasiddhi* 4.1) and ascends upward (see *Amṛtasiddhi* 4.11).

[288] The *brahmadvāra*, synonymous with *brahmarandhra* "aperture of Brahman," denotes the fontanelle through which the yogi's vital principle exits at death, see Mallinson and Singleton, 2017: 438.

[289] The *brahmasthāna*, synonymous with *brahmarandhra*, is here identified with the *sahasrāracakra*, cf. *Dhyānabindopaniṣad* 65.

[290] The list would be incomplete without *kuhū*, attested only in U_2, where it and *śaṅkhinī* are swapped. Neither occurs in YSv (PT), but both and their usual locations appear in SSP 1.66, hence my conjecture. I kept the sentence in greyscale as the omission may be authorial.

[291] The root entrance (*mūladvāra*) here denotes the anus, cf. *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 1.66: *kuhūr gudadvāre vahati*—"Kuhū conducts through the anus."

[XXVI. **śarīramadhye vāyavaḥ**]

इदानीं शरीरमध्ये वायवो दश तिष्ठन्ति। तेषां कार्याणि कथ्यन्ते। प्राणवायुर्हृदय–
मध्ये श्वासोच्छ्वासं करोति। अशनपानेच्छा भवति। गुदमध्येऽपानवायुस्तिष्ठति।
स आकुञ्चनं स्तम्भनं करोति। नाभिमध्ये समानो वर्तते। स समग्रा नाडीः शोषय–
5 ति। तथा नाडीः पोषयति। रुचिमुत्पादयति । अग्निं दीपयति। तालुमध्ये उदान–
वायुस्तिष्ठति। स वायुरन्नं गिलति। पानीयं पिबति। व्यानवायुः सकले शरीरे व–
र्तते। तस्माद्वायोः शरीरं चलति । शोकं आप्नोति विकृते । कूर्मवायुर्नेत्रमध्ये ति–
ष्ठति।

Sources: 2–8 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 838–839): idānīṃ dehamadhyasthāḥ kathyante daśa vāyavaḥ | kāryakāraṇabhāvena kathyante tāni cihnataḥ | prāṇavāyur hṛdi sthitvā śvāsocchvāsaṃ karoti saḥ | asikāntaṃ pītam īśaṃ karoti yogasaṃjñakaḥ | apāno gudadeśasthaḥ karoty ākuñcanaṃ sa tu | stambhanañ ca tathāpānaḥ samāno nābhimaṇḍale | toṣakādipoṣakan tu nāḍīnāṃ rucidāyakaḥ | dīptāgnimadhye 'pi tathā samānākhyā mahāparā | tālumadhye udānas tu aśnāti pibatīti ca | śarīraṃ sakalaṃ vyāpya vyānavāyuḥ pratiṣṭhitaḥ | śarīre cālanaṃ teṣu karoti sthāpayaty api | netramadhye kūrmanāmā … 2–8 cf. SSP 1.67 (Ed. pp. 23–24): atha daśavāyavaḥ | hṛdaye prāṇavāyur ucchvāsaniḥśvāsakārako hakārasakārātmakaś ca | gude tv apānavāyuḥ recakakumbhakapūrakaś ca | nābhau samānavāyuḥ dīpakaḥ pācakaś ca | kaṇṭhe vyānavāyuḥ śoṣaṇāpy āyanakārakaś ca | tālau udānavāyuḥ grasanavamanajalpakārakaś ca | nāgavāyuḥ sarvāṅgavyāpakaḥ mocakaś cālakaś ca | kūrmavāyuḥ cakṣuṣor …

2 **vāyavo** PU_2E] vāyavas β, *om.* LB **daśa** PU_2E] *om.* cett. **tiṣṭhanti** cett.] ṣṭaṃti U_2, *om.* LB **teṣāṃ** cett.] *om.* LB **kāryāṇi** cett.] nāmāni kārmāṇi P, nāmāni kāryāṇi E, *om.* LB **kathyante** cett.] kathyate $N_2U_1U_2$, *om.* LB **°vāyur** PE] °vāyu° βU_2, *om.* LB 2–3 **hṛdayamadhye** cett.] *om.* LB 3 **śvāsocchvāsaṃ** em.] ūrdhvaśvāsapraśvāsaṃ N_2, utsvāsaprasvāsasaṃ N_1, utsvāsaprasvāsaṃ DK_1, utsvāsaprasvāse J, ūdhvasaprasase U_1, śvāsochāsaṃ P, svāsochvāsaṃ U_2, śvāsocchāsaṃ E, śvāsośvareti L, śvāsośvaroti B **karoti** cett.] *om.* LB **aśana°** PU_2ELB] asita° N_2, aśita° N_1DK_1, aśīte J, asīte U_1 **°pānecchā** γ] °pittecha N_2, °piteccha N_1DK_1, pitecha J, pitechā U_1 **'pāna°** em.] *om.* E, apāna° cett. **°vāyus** cett.] °vāyu N_2U_1, °vāyo U_2L, *om.* E, °vāyor B **tiṣṭhati** cett.] *om.* E 4 **sa** cett.] *om.* U_2E **ākuñcanaṃ** cett.] ākuṃcana° N_2, āṃkucana° PU_2LB, *om.* E **stambhanaṃ** cett.] *om.* E **karoti** cett.] *om.* E **°madhye** cett.] °padmamadhye U_2, *om.* E **samāno** cett.] samāno vāyur E, smānā B **sa** cett.] sapta E **samagrā** γ] samāgraṃ β **nāḍīḥ** PE] nādhyaṃ $N_2N_1DK_1$, nāḍīṃ JU_1, nāḍī U_2LB 5 **tathā** cett.] *om.* U_2 **nāḍīḥ** P] nāḍīṃ β, *om.* U_2LB, nāḍī E **poṣayati** em.] pośa iti U_1, ṣoṣayati U_2, °śoṣaṇāt E, pośayatī | tathā poṣayatī B, pośayati cett. **rucim** cett.] kvacit $N_2N_1DK_1$, śucim J, rucir B **agniṃ** em.] āgniṃ $N_2N_1DK_1$J, agnīṃ U_1, vahniṃ PU_2E, vahnī LB **udāna°** cett.] udānāni N_2, udāno DK_1JPU_2E 6 **vāyur** cett.] vāyu P, vāyuḥ E **annaṃ** cett.] ratnaṃ N_1PE **gilati** cett.] śilati N_1, līlati E, galayati L, galayatī B **vyānavāyuḥ** em.] nānāgavāyuḥ D, nāgavāyu° L, nāgavāyuḥ cett. **sakale** cett.] sarva° E, sakala° LB 7 **vāyoḥ** cett.] vāyo P **śarīraṃ** cett.] śarīre LB **calati** β] calayati PU_2, cālayati E, cālayatī L, cālatī B **śokaṃ** U_2ELB] *om.* β, śopham P **āpnoti** γ] *om.* β **vikṛte** em.] *om.* β, vikṛtaḥ PU_2, vivilaḥ E, vikutaḥ L, vi++++++ B **kūrmavāyur** cett.] kūrmo vāyu $N_2N_1DK_1$, kūrmo vāyur J, *om.* U_1, kūrmavāyoḥ LB **netramadhye** cett.] *om.* U_1 7–8 **tiṣṭhati** cett.] *om.* U_1PU_2LB

[XXVI. **The vital winds within the body**]

Now, ten vital winds are situated within the body. Their functions are explained. The Prāṇa vital wind is located within the chest and performs inhalation and exhalation. It brings about the desire for food and drink. Within the anus, the Apāna vital wind is situated. It performs contraction [and] restraining. Within the navel, the Samāna vital wind exists. It induces the absorption of [substances from][292] all the channels. In this way, it causes the channels to be nourished, causes appetite to be generated, and causes the [digestive] fire to be kindled. Within the palate, the Udāna vital wind is situated. This wind swallows food, [and] it drinks liquid. The Vyāna vital wind exists in the entire body.[293] Through that vital wind, the body is set in motion. When it is defective, it leads to pain. The Kūrma vital wind exists within the eyes.

[292] The verbal form *śoṣayati* (causative third person singular indicative present of √śuṣ) means "causes to dry up" or "causes to disappear". In this context, however, a better idiomatic translation would be "causes to absorb", since the Samāna vital wind absorbs the eaten substances in the body and distributes it everywhere, cf. *Yogayājñavalkya* 4.55–57 (Ed. p. 40) and 4.69ab (Ed. p. 42).

[293] I have conjectured *nāgavāyu* to *vyānavāyu* based on the description provided in YSv (PT), as the latter term generally corresponds to the provided function of this vital wind. From a text-critical perspective, however, this choice is difficult and not unambiguous, since according to SSP 1.67 (*nāgavāyuḥ sarvāṅgavyāpakaḥ mocakaś cālakaś ca*), not just Vyāna (as in YSv) but also Nāga pervades the whole body, a concept also attested in *Vasiṣṭhasaṃhitā* 2.49cd and 2.52cd. YSv (PT, pp. 838–839) ascribes the function of belching (*udgāra*) to Nāga (*udgāre nāga ākhyātaḥ ūrdhvavāyuḥ pracālane* |) which supports my conjecture. However, Rāmacandra follows SSP 1.67 (Ed. pp. 23–24) by ascribing the function of belching to Kṛkala, even though Ysv ascribes sneezing (*kṣut*) to Kṛkala. This indicates that he mixed the descriptions of the YSv and SSP, which makes it possible that he followed the SSP in the case of Nāga, too. This leaves us with the other possibility that Vyāna and its description dropped out. However, in the YSv (PT, pp. 838–839), the order of the ten vital winds is as follows: Prāṇa, Apāna, Samāna, Udāna, Vyāna, Kūrma, Nāga, Kṛkara, Devadatta, Dhanañjaya. In the SSP 1.67 (Ed. pp. 23–24): Prāṇa, Apāna, Samāna, Vyāna, Udāna, Nāga, Kūrma, Kṛkara, Devadatta, Dhanañjaya. In both sources, the Vyāna vital wind appears to be within the group of the first five major vital winds. This group of five winds is undoubtedly common across yogic literature, see Mallinson and Singleton, 2017: 187–198. The emergence of Nāga instead of Vyāna in all the witnesses …

निमेषोन्मेषं करोति। कृकलवायोरुद्गारो भवति। देवदत्तवायोर्जृम्भ उत्पद्यते। धनंजयवायोः शब्द उत्पद्यते॥

[XXVII. **madhyalakṣyam**]

इदानीं मध्यलक्ष्यं कथ्यते। श्वेतवर्णं अथवा पीतवर्णं रक्तवर्णं वा धूम्रवर्णं वा नीलवर्णं वाऽग्निशिखासदृशं विद्युत्समानं सूर्यमण्दलसदृश मर्धचन्द्रसदृशं ज्वलदाकाशसमाकारं स्वशरीरपरिमितं तेजो मनोमध्ये लक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम्। एतस्मिल्लक्ष्ये कृते सति मनोमध्ये स्थितस्य मलस्य दाहो भवति। मनसः सत्त्वगुणः प्रकटो भवति। पुरुष आनन्दमयो भूत्वा तिष्ठति॥

Sources: 1–2 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 839): …nimeṣonmeṣakṛdayam | udgāre nāga ākhyātaḥ ūrddhavāyuḥ pracālane | kṛkaraḥ kṣutkaro jñeyo devadatto vijṛmbhaṇe | dhanañjayaḥ saccidākāro mṛtadehaṃ na muñcati | yady api sargakāṇḍe sarvam etad uktaṃ tathāpi kāryakāraṇabhāvajñāpanāya punar nirdiṣṭam iti na punar uktam | 1–2 cf. SSP 1.67 (Ed. pp. 23–24): …unmeṣakārakaś ca | kṛkalaḥ udgārakaḥ kṣutkārakaś ca | devadatto mukhavijṛmbhakaḥ | dhanañjayo nādaghoṣakah | iti daśavāyv avalokanena piṇḍotpattiḥ naranārīrūpam | 4–8 cf. YSv (PT, p. 839): idānīṃ madhyalakṣan tu kathyate siddhikārakam | śvetaṃ raktaṃ tathā pītaṃ dhūmrākāran tu nīlabham | agnijvālāsamānābhā vidyutpuñjasamaprabhā | ādityamaṇḍalākāram athavā candramaṇḍalam | jvaladākāśatulyaṃvā bhāvayed rūpamātmanaḥ | etaj jyotirmayaṃ dehaṃ manomadhye tu lakṣayet | eteṣāñ ca kṛte lakṣe nānāduḥkhaṃ praṇaśyati | manas astu malo yāti mahānando bhavet tataḥ | 4–8 cf. SSP 2.29 (Ed. p. 41): śvetavarṇaṃ vā raktavarṇaṃ vā kṛṣṇavarṇaṃ vā agniśikhākāraṃ vā jyotirūpaṃ vā vidyudākāraṃ sūryamaṇḍalākāraṃ vā arddhacandrākāraṃ vā yatheṣṭasvapiṇḍamātraṃ sthānavarjitaṃ manasā lakṣayet ity anekaviddhaṃ madhyamaṃ lakṣyaṃ |

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1 **nimeṣonmeṣaṃ** cett.] unmeṣaṃ nimeṣaṃ N_2N_I, unmeṣaṃ nimeṣaṃ ca DK_IJ, *om.* U_I **karoti** cett.] *om.* U_I **kṛkalavāyor** N_IDK_I] kṛkaravāyor N_2, kiṃkaravāyor J, *om.* U_I, kṛkalavāyur PLB, puṣkaravāyur U_2, kṛkalakartāvāyur E **udgāro** em.] ūdgāro $N_2N_IK_IJ$, ūdgāto D, *om.* U_I, udhāraṃ PB, udgāraṃ U_2E, uhāraṃ L **bhavati** $N_2N_IDK_IJ$] *om.* U_I, karoti cett. **°vāyor** cett.] °vāyo N_2U_2, °vāyoḥ E **jṛmbha** N_IDK_I] jṛmbho° N_2, jṛmbhā JU_2L, jaṃbhā U_I, jumbhā PB, jṛmbhaṇaṃ E **utpadyate** β] bhavati PU_2E, bhavatī L, bhavaṃtī B 2 **°vāyoḥ** JU_IU_2ELB] °vāyo cett. **śabda** cett.] śabdo° N_2, sabta U_I, śabdāḥ P, śabdaḥ L 4 **idānīṃ** cett.] idānī P **madhyalakṣyaṃ** $N_IDK_IJU_I$] madhyalakṣaṇaṃ N_2B, madhyalakṣaṃ PE, madhye lakṣyaṃ U_2, madhye lakṣaṃ L **°śveta** cett.] sveta° U_I, svata° U_2 **°varṇaṃ** cett.] °varṇā | N_2N_I, °varṇaṃ ‖ D, °varṇāṃ K_I, °varaṃ B **athavā** cett.] atha PLB, aṃtha ca E **°varṇaṃ** cett.] °varṇa N_2 **raktavarṇaṃ** E] raktavarṇa N_2, raktaṃ cett., rakta B **vā** cett.] *om.* N_2 **dhūmravarṇaṃ** em.] dhūmravarṇa N_2, dhūmāra N_I, dhūmākāro D, dhūmākāra K_I, dhūmrākāra JU_I, dhūmrākāraṃ γ **vā** D] *om.* N_2, va N_IK_I, vaṃ J, van U_I, yan γ 5 **'gni°** P] agni° cett. **°samānaṃ** cett.] °samāne L **°maṇḍala°** cett.] °maṇḍalaṃ N_IDK_I **sadṛśam** em.] sadṛśaṃ cett. **ardha°** cett.] ūrdhva° $N_2N_IDK_IJB$, ārdha° U_I 5–6 **jvalad°** cett.] jalad U_I 6 **°ākāśa°** cett.] °ā° JU_I, °ākāraṃ U_2 **°samākāraṃ** cett.] °samānakāraṃ β, samakāraṃ U_2, °samākāra L **°mitaṃ** cett.] °manomittaṃ U_I **°mano°** cett.] *om.* U_I **lakṣyaṃ** cett.] lakṣaṇaṃ N_2, lakṣaṃ U_2LB, tathyaṃ E **etasmil** PU_2L] ekasmin N_2N_IDE, etasmin K_IJU_I **lakṣye** cett.] lakṣaṇo N_2, na lakṣye U_I, lakṣe U_2LB 7 **sati** cett.] satī U_IU_2L **malasya** cett.] *om.* P **manasaḥ** cett.] manaḥ saḥ D **°guṇaḥ** PL] °guṇe N_I, °guṇa° U_2E, °guṇo cett. **prakaṭo** cett.] °prakaśo U_2, °prakāśo E

It performs [the] opening and closing [of the eyes]. Belching arises from the Kṛkala vital wind. Yawning arises from the Devadatta vital wind. Sound arises from the Dhanañjaya vital wind.

[XXVII. **Central focus**]

Now, the central focus is taught. Within the mind, the focus shall be directed onto the light which is white-coloured or yellow-coloured or red-coloured or grey-coloured or blue-coloured, like the flame of fire, like lightning, like the orb of the sun, like a half-moon, appearing like flaming space, [and] of the same size as one's own body.[294] When this focus is practiced, the impurity within the mind is burned away. The *sattva* quality[295] of the mind becomes manifest.[296] The person becomes blissful [and] remains like that.

indicates a corruption of the transmission or a mistake by Rāmacandra. The description of the function of the vital wind in this passage makes it slightly more likely that the term *vyāna* was dropped and replaced with *nāga*. In turn, the original descriptions of the functions of the vital winds were further confused in the course of transmission.

[294] Cf. *Śivayogapradīpikā* 4.47cd–48: *śṛṇuṣva madhyalakṣyaṃ ca kathitaṃ pūrvasūribhiḥ* ‖ 4.47 *śvetādivarṇanavakhaṇḍacandrasaudāminīvahniśikhena bimbāt | jvalannabho vā sthalahīnam ekaṃ vilakṣayet tat khalu madhyalakṣyam* 4.48 ‖ "(47cd) Hear now the central fixation which the ancient sages have taught. (48) One should focus on one [object] devoid of location or the burning space [emerging] from a sphere with flames and lightning shining (*candra*) into [all] nine landmasses (of the continent Jambūdvīpa: Bhārata, Hari, Kimpuruṣa, Ramyaka, Ramaṇa, Kuru, Bhadrāśva, Ketumāla and Ilāvṛta) in the colours of white etc. Truly, this is the central fixation." Despite all similarities, the differences of the techniques are: In the *Śivayogapradīpikā*, the practitioner should direct the mind towards the burning space or that which lacks locality. Conversely, Rāmacandra prescribes fixing one's mind onto the luminous mind, which is equated with the spatial extension of the human body.

[295] For a discussion of the *guṇa*s in the context of Pātañjalayoga, see Bryant, 2009: xlviii–xlix.

[296] The generation of the sattvic quality through the practice of *madhyalakṣ(y)a* also appears in *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.28: *madhya lakṣa mana madhya bicārai | vapu pramāna koi rūpa nihārai | yāte sātvik upajai āī | madhya lakṣa jo sādhai bhāī* ‖ "The central focus directs the mind to reside at its centre, viewing the measure of the body according to its form. It produces the sattvic quality in those who practice it."

[XXVIII. **ākāśabhedāḥ**]

इदानीमाकाशभेदाः कथ्यन्ते। तेषां लक्ष्यानि कथ्यन्ते। आकाशः॥ पराकाशः॥ महाकाशः॥ तत्त्वाकाशः॥ सूर्याकाशः॥ बाह्याभ्यन्तरे निर्मलं निराकारमाकाशलक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम्। ततः परं बाह्याभ्यन्तरे घनान्धकारसदृशपराकाशस्य लक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम्। ततः परं प्रलयकालीनज्वलद्दावानलपूर्णं बाह्याभ्यन्तरे महाकाशं लक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम्। ततः परं बाह्याभ्यंतरे कोटिदीपानां प्रकाशप्राप्तौ यादृशं औज्ज्वल्यं भवति। तादृशं तत्त्वाकाशं लक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम्।

Sources: 2–7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 839): kathyate tu devy adhunākāśaṃ pañcabhir lakṣaṇaiḥ | ākāśan tu mahākāśaṃ parākāśaṃ parāt param | tattvākāśaṃ sūryākāśam ākāśaṃ pañcalakṣaṇam | cf. YSv (PT, p. 839; YK 1.37): ākāśan tu mahākāśaṃ parākāśaṃ parāt param | tattvākāśaṃ sūryakāśam ākāśaṃ pañcalakṣaṇam | sabāhyābhyantare nityaṃ nirākāśantu (*nirākāśas tu* YK 2.38) nirmalam | karttavyaṃ lakṣam ākāśaṃ sādhayet sādhanaṃ vinā | ghanāntarālasadṛśaṃ parākāśaṃ tathaiva ca | koṭikoṭipradīpābhaṃ tattvākāśaṃ smaret tathā | kalpāntāgnisamaṃ (*kālāntāgnisamaṃ* YK 2.39cd) jyotir mahākāśaṃ smaret tathā | 2–7 cf. SSP 2.30 (Ed. p. 42): ākāśaṃ parākāśaṃ mahākāśaṃ tatvākaśaṃ sūryākāśam iti vyomapañcakam | bāhyābhyantare 'tyantaṃ nirmalaṃ nirākāraṃ ākāśaṃ lakṣayet | athavā bāhyābhyantare 'tyantāndhakāranibhaṃ parākāśam avalokayet | bāhyābhyantare kālānalasaṃkāśaṃ mahākāśam avalokayet | bāhyābhyantare nijatatvakharūpaṃ tatvākāśam avalokayet |

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2 **idānīm** PU_2E] idānīṃ cett. **ākāśabhedāḥ** $N_2U_1U_2E$] ākaśabhedāḥ cett. **kathyante** cett.] kathyate N_2U_2L **teṣāṃ** cett.] ṣāṃ U_1, te E, *om.* LB **lakṣyāni** cett.] lakṣaṇāni N_2, *om.* LB **kathyante** cett.] kathyate N_2N_1, ca kathyante P, *om.* ELB **ākāśaḥ** PELB] ākāśa° β **parākāśaḥ** PU_2] parākāśa° N_2DU_1, parākāśa N_1J, parā++++° K_1, paramākāśaḥ ELB 3 **mahākāśaḥ** PU_2EL] mahākāśa° N_2DU_1, mahākāśa N_1B, ++hākāśa° K_1 **tattvakāśaḥ** U_2ELB] tatvākāśa° $N_2DK_1U_1$, tatvākāśa N_1J **sūryākāśaḥ** ELB] sūryakāśaḥ N_2PU_2, sūryakāśa N_1J, sūryakāśa° DK_1U_1 3–4 **nirākāram ākāśa°** E] nirākāraṃ ākāśa° $N_2N_1DJU_1$, nirākāraṃ ā++śaṃ K_1, nirākāram ākāśaṃ PLB, nirākāraṃ mākāśaṃ U_2 4 **°lakṣyaṃ** cett.] °lakṣaṇaṃ N_2 **kartavyam** E], kartavyaṃ cett. **paraṃ** cett.], *om.* U_2 **bāhyābhyantare** cett.], bāhyābhyantarai P **ghanāndha°** cett.], ṣvanandha° E, dha° L, ghanāṃgha° B **°kāra°** cett.], °kāraṃ P **°sadṛśa°** cett.], sadṛśaṃ U_2E, sadṛśaḥ LB **parākāśasya** cett.], parākāśaikyaṃ E, parākāśa° LB **lakṣyaṃ** cett.], lakṣaṇaṃ N_2 5 **paraṃ** cett.], *om.* U_2 **pralayakālīna** cett.], pralayakālīnaḥ LB **°jvalad°** cett.], °jjala° U_1, °jalad° PB **°dāvā°** DE], °vṛ° N_2, °vṛddha° N_1, °dvārā vā K_1, dhaḍvā J, °vaḍa vā° U_1PU_2LB **°nalapūrṇaṃ** cett.], nalapūrṇa $N_2N_1U_2$ **mahākāśaṃ** DK_1JU_1P], mahākāśa° N_2N_1ELB, ghanāṃ dhakārasadṛśaṃ mahākāśasya U_2 **°lakṣyaṃ** cett.], °lakṣaṃ $N_2DK_1U_2LB$ 6 **tataḥ paraṃ bāhyābhyaṃtare koṭidīpānāṃ** cett.], *om.* E **prakāśaprāptau** cett.], prakāśa+++++ K_1, *om.* E **yādṛśaṃ** cett.], ++dṛśam K_1, *om.* E **aujjvalyaṃ** em.], aujvala N_2, aujvalyaṃ $N_1DK_1JPU_2$, aujvalaṃ U_1B, *om.* E, ujvalaṃ L 6–7 **bhavati** cett.], *om.* E 7 **tādṛśaṃ** cett.], *om.* E **tattvākāśaṃ** cett.], *om.* E **lakṣyaṃ** N_1JU_1P], lakṣaṃ $N_2DK_1U_2LB$, *om.* E **kartavyam** cett.], *om.* E

[XXVIII. **Divisions of space**]

Now, the divisions of space are taught.[297] Their foci are taught: Space, beyond space, great space, reality-space, the sun-space. The focus on space shall be visualised as pure and formless internally and externally. After that, the focus on beyond space shall be visualised as dense darkness[298] internally and externally. Then, the focus on the great space shall be visualised as the mass of the burning fire of the time of dissolution internally and externally. Afterwards, the focus on the reality-space should be visualised internally and externally as resembling the splendour produced by the brightness of ten million lights.

[297] The *Advayatārakopaniṣad* 7 (Ed. pp. 4–5) does not separate the practice of Madhyalakṣya from the five spaces. Here, both practices form a unified whole and follow a specific progression: *atha madhyalakṣyalakṣaṇaṃ | prātaś citrādivarṇākhaṇḍasūryacakravat vahnijvālāvalīvat tadvihīnāntarikṣavat paśyati | tadākārākāritayā avatiṣṭhati | tadbhūyodarśanena guṇarahitākāśaṃ bhavati | visphurattārakākāradīpyamānagāḍhatamopamaṃ paramākāśaṃ bhavati | kālānalasamadyotamānaṃ mahākāśaṃ bhavati | sarvotkṛṣṭaparamadyutipradyotamānaṃ tattvākāśaṃ bhavati | koṭisūryaprakāśavaibhavasaṃkāśaṃ sūryākāśaṃ bhavati | evaṃ bāhyābhyantarasthavyomapañcakaṃ tārakalakṣyam | taddarśī vimuktaphalas tādṛgvyomasamāno bhavati | tasmāt tāraka eva lakṣyaṃ amanaskaphalapradaṃ bhavati* ‖ 7 ‖ "Now, he sees the characteristics of the central fixation [which is], like the indivisible orb of the sun, [being] colourful like the variety [of colours of the sun] in the early morning etc., [then] like a row of flames of fire, [and finally] the atmosphere devoid of that. He dwells in a state [in which he is mentally] assuming the form of the apparition of that. By contemplating that, the space (*ākāśa*) without qualities arises. [From that] supreme space (*parākāśa*) resembling absolute dense darkness shining in the form of a sparkling star arises. [From that] the great space (*mahākāśa*) whose shine equals the fire of time arises. [From that] the space of reality (*tattvakāśa*) arises, shining forth with supreme brilliance surpassing everything. [From that] the space of the sun (*sūryākāśa*) arises [which is endowed with] a brilliance as mighty as the brilliance of ten million suns. Thus, the fixations of Tāraka[yoga] consist of five spaces (*vyoma*) situated internally and externally. He who sees them becomes the same as such space [and] becomes one who is freed from the results [of his actions]. Because of that, only Tāraka[yoga] is the central fixation which bestows the fruits of the no-mind state (*amanaska*)."

[298] Instead of extreme brightness as in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* (Ed. p. 29) and *Advayatārakopaniṣad* (Ed. p. 5), Rāmacandra has chosen to promote dense darkness in his *parākāśa*-visualization.

ततः पश्चाद्बाह्याभ्यन्तरे प्रकाशमानसूर्यबिम्बसहितं सूर्याकाशं लक्ष्यं कर्तव्यम्। एतेषां लक्ष्याणां कारणाच्छरीरे रोगसंसर्गो न भवति। तथा वलितं पलितं पुण्यं पापं च न भवति।

नवचक्रं कलाधारं त्रिलक्ष्यं व्योमपञ्चकम्।
समक्रिया न जानाति स योगी नामधारकः ॥ XXVIII.1॥

Sources: 1–3 cf. SSP 2.30 (Ed. p. 42): athavā bāhyābhyantare sūryakoṭisadṛśaṃ sūryākāśam avalokayet | 1–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 839): sūryākāśaṃ tathā koṭisūryavindusamaṃ (°*bimbasamaṃ* YK 2.40d) smaret | sabāhyābhyantare caivam ākāśaṃ (*caiva sākāśaṃ* YK 2.41b) lakṣayet tu yaḥ | śivavad vihared viśve pāpapuṇyavivarjitaḥ | eteṣāñ caiva lakṣeṇa karmadvārā 'ghamāharet (*karmmadvārā na pāharet* YK 2.41d) | 4–5 ≈SSP 2.31 (Ed. p. 43): navacakraṃ kalādhāraṃ trilakṣyaṃ vyomapañcakam | samyag etan na jānāti sa yogī nāmadhārakaḥ | 4–5 = YSv (PT, p. 832) = YK 2.14: navacakraṃ kalādhāraṃ trilakṣaṃ vyomapañcakam | svadehe yo na jānāti sa yogī nāmadhārakaḥ | 4–5 ≈YSv (PT, p. 839): navacakraṃ kalādhāraṃ dvilakṣaṃ vyomapañcakam | samagraṃ yo na jānāti sa yogī nāmadhārakaḥ |

Parallels: 4–5 ≈*Netratantra with Netroddyota* 7.1cd-2: ataḥ paraṃ pravakṣyāmi dhyānaṃ sūkṣmam anuttamam | ṛtucakraṃ svarādhāraṃ trilakṣyaṃ vyomapañcakam ‖ granthidvādaśasaṃyuktaṃ śaktitrayasamanvitam | dhāmatrayapathākrāntaṃ nāḍītrayasamanvitam ‖ 4–5 ≈*Tantrāloka (b)* 19.15: ṣoḍaśādhāraṣaṭcakralakṣyatrayakhapañcakāt | kvacid anyataratrātha prāguktapaśukarmavat | 4–5 ≈*Manthānabhairavatantram Kumārikākhaṇḍaḥ* 25.2ab: ṣaṭcakraṃ ṣoḍaśādhāraṃ trilakṣyaṃ vyomapañcakam | 4–5 ≈*Ūrmikaulārṇavatantra* 2.184: sarvaṃ samadhiyogena kulena hi tad ucyate | ṣaṭcakraṃ ṣoḍaśādhāraṃ trirlakṣaṃ vyomapañcakam ‖ 4–5 ≈*Yogatarańgiṇī* quoted with reference *Nityanāthapaddhati* (Ed. p. 72) = *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* 24.1: ṣaṭcakraṃ ṣoḍaśādhāraṃ dvilakṣyaṃ vyomapañcakam | svadehe ye na jānanti kathaṃ siddhyanti yoginaḥ | 4–5 ≈PT (Ed. p. 172): ṣaṭcakraṃ ṣoḍaśādhāraṃ trilakṣaṃ vyomapañcakam | svadehe yo vijānāti sa guruḥ kathito budhaiḥ | 4–5 ≈*Gorakṣaśataka (Nowotny)* 13 = *Vivekāmartaṇḍa* 6.3: ṣaṭcakraṃ ṣoḍaśādhāraṃ trailokyaṃ vyomapañcakam | svadehe ye na jānanti kathaṃ sidhyanti yoginaḥ | 4–5 ≈*Maṇḍalabrāhmaṇopaniṣat* 3.4.5: navacakraṃ ṣaḍādhāraṃ trilakṣyaṃ vyomapañcakam | samyag etan na jānāti sa yogī nāmato bhavet | 4–5 ≈*Haṭhapradīpikā* 4.61: ṣaṭcakraṃ ṣoḍaśādhāraṃ tridhā lakṣaṃ guṇatrayam | śeṣas tu granthavistāras trikūṭaṃ paramaṃ padam |

1 tataḥ cett.] *om.* LB **paścād** cett.] paścāt $N_2N_1U_1$, *om.* E, paccā LB **bāhyābhyantare** cett.] ābhyaṃtare N_2, bāhyā++++++ K_1 **°māna°** cett.] °māga° P, °mān LB **°sūrya°** cett.] °sūryaṃ P, °yarsū° E **°bimba°** cett.] *om.* E **°sahitaṃ** cett.] °sahita° LB **sūryākāśaṃ** cett.] sūryakāśa° PLB **lakṣyaṃ** cett.] lakṣaṃ N_2JLB **kartavyam** cett.] kartavyaṃ mataḥ LB **2 lakṣyāṇāṃ** cett.] lakṣāṇā N_2, lakṣāṇāṃ JP, lakṣaṃ L, lakṣaṇaṃ B **kāraṇāc** N_2] kāraṇāt E, karaṇāt cett. **charīre** N_2] śarīra° N_1DK_1, śarīre JPU_2LB, °śarīraṃ E **rogāsaṃsargo** cett.] rogāsaṃsargo $N_2U_1U_2$, rohasaṃsarge N_1, rohasaṃsargo D, rogāsaṃsargi E **na** cett.] *om.* E **bhavati** cett.] bhavatī B **valitaṃ palitaṃ** cett.] valī° N_2, valita° PEB **puṇyaṃ** cett.] puṇyāṃ LB **3 ca** cett.] *om.* E **bhavati** cett.] bhati U_1, bhavatī LB **4 navacakraṃ** cett.] navacakra° N_2N_1DK_1, śloka navacakraṃ LB **°lakṣyaṃ** cett.] °lakṣaṃ N_2LB **5 samakriyā** β] svadehe yo γ

After that, the focus on sun-space (*sūryākāśa*) shall be visualized as being accompanied by the shining disc of the sun internally and externally. From executing these foci, contact with diseases does not arise within the body. And, wrinkles, grey hair, sin, and merit do not arise.

XXVIII. 1 One who does not understand the full procedure [consisting of] the nine *cakra*s,[299] sixteen supports,[300] the three foci,[301] and five spaces is merely a yogin by name.[302]

[299] Rāmacandra's ninefold *cakra* system is described in detail in IV–XII, pp. 112–138, and briefly repeated in XXX, p. 194, in a different order for no clear reason.

[300] The sixteen supports of Rāmacandra are the big toe support (*pādāṅguṣṭhādhāra*), root support (*mūlādhāra*), anus support (*gudādhāra*), penis support (*liṅgādhāra*), Udyāna[-support] (*udyāna*), navel support (*nābhyādhāra*), heart-form support (*hṛdayarūpādhāra*), throat support (*kaṇṭhādhāra*), uvula support (*ghaṇṭikādhāra*), palate support (*tālvādhāra*), tongue support (*jihvādhāra*), teeth support (*dantādhāra*), nose support (*nāsikādhāra*), breath support at the root of the nose (*nāsāmūle vāyvādhāra*), centre of the eyebrows support support (*bhrūvormadhyādhāra*) and the eye support (*netrādhāra*). Each one of them is associated with a particular yogic technique. The sixteen supports are presented in *Tattvayogabindu* XXXI.

[301] The three foci called *antar(a)lakṣya*, *bahirlakṣya* (often called *bāhyalakṣya* in the *pañcalakṣya* system of Rāmacandra and others) and *madhyalakṣya* are the predecessors of the five foci found in *Tattvayogabindu*, *Yogasvarodaya* as quoted in *Prāṇatoṣinī* and *Yogakarṇikā* and *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*. The two additional foci are *ūrdhvalakṣya* and *adholakṣya*. A system of three foci is taught in *Tantrāloka (b)*, *Manthānabhairavatantram Kumārikākhaṇḍaḥ*, *Netratantra with Netroddyota*, *Gorakṣaśataka (Nowotny)*, *Śivayogapradīpikā*, *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, *Advayatārakopaniṣad*, *Yogacūḍāmanyupaniṣad*, *Maṇḍalabrāhmaṇopaniṣat*. Structurally, it is surprising that Rāmacandra mentions all five *lakṣya*s in section XIII, then teaches *ūrdhvalakṣya* in section XIV and *adholakṣya* in section XV, and just after the introduction of various other topics, he continues the subject of Lakṣyayoga by teaching *bāhyalakṣya* in section XXIII, *antar(a)lakṣya* in section XXIV and finally *madhyalakṣya* in section XXVIII.

[302] As shown by the sources and testimonia on the previous page, the reception of the variants of this verse and its practices is widespread—from Śaiva Tantras such as *Tantrāloka (b)*, *Manthānabhairavatantram Kumārikākhaṇḍaḥ*, and *Netratantra with Netroddyota*, through early and classical Haṭha- and Rājayoga works (e.g. *Haṭhapradīpikā*), into the post-*Haṭhapradīpikā* era and the late *Yoga Upaniṣads*. Most technical terms appear already in earlier Śaiva Tantras, such as the *Mālinīvijayottaratantra*, which, however, presents a more elaborate but conceptually distinct system of six *lakṣya*s (cf. Vasudeva, 2004: 263–71).

[XXIX. **cakrāṇām anukramaḥ**]

इदानीं चक्राणामनुक्रमः कथ्यते। आधारे ब्रह्मचक्रम् १ ॥ आधारोपरि लिङ्गमूले स्वाधिष्ठानचक्रम् २ ॥ नाभौ मणिपूरकचक्रम् ३ ॥ हृदयेऽनाहतचक्रम् ४ ॥ कण्ठस्थाने विशुद्धिचक्रम् ५ ॥ षष्ठं तालुचक्रम् ६ ॥ भ्रुवोर्मध्ये आज्ञाचक्रम् ७ ॥ ब्रह्मरन्ध्रस्थाने कलाचक्रम्८ ॥ नवममाकाशचक्रम् ९॥ तत्परमशून्यम्॥

Sources: 2–5 cf. SSP 2.1–9 (Ed. p. 29–32): atha piṇḍavicāraḥ kathyate piṇḍe navacakrāṇi | ādhāre brahmacakraṃ tridhāvartaṃ bhagamaṇḍalākāram | tatra mūlakandaḥ | tatra śaktiṃ pāvakākārāṃ dhyāyet | tatraiva kāmarūpapīṭhaṃ sarvakāmaphalapradaṃ bhavati | dvitīyaṃ svādhiṣṭhānacakram | tanmadhye paścimābhimukhaṃ liṅgaṃ pravālāṅkurasadṛśaṃ dhyāyet | tatraivoḍyānapīṭhaṃ jagadākarṣaṇaṃ bhavati | tṛtīyaṃ nābhicakraṃ pañcāvartaṃ sarpavat kuṇḍalākāram | tanmadhye kuṇḍalinīṃ śaktiṃ bālārkakoṭisannibhāṃ dhyāyet | sā madhyā śaktiḥ sarvasiddhidā bhavati | caturthaṃ hṛdayacakram aṣṭadalakamalam adhomukhaṃ | tanmadhye karṇikāyāṃ liṅgākārāṃ jyotīrūpām dhyāyet | saiva haṃsakalā sarvendriyavaśyā bhavati | pañcamaṃ kaṇṭhacakraṃ caturaṅgulam | tatra vāma iḍā candranāḍī | dakṣiṇe piṅgalā sūryanāḍī | tanmadhye suṣumnāṃ dhyāyet | saiva anāhatakalā anāhatasiddhidā bhavati | ṣaṣṭhaṃ tālucakram | tatrāmṛtadhārāpravāhaḥ | ghaṇṭikāliṅgaṃ mūlarandhraṃ rājadantaṃ śaṅkhinīvivaraṃ daśamadvāram | tatra śūnyaṃ dhyāyet | cittalayo bhavati | saptamaṃ bhrūcakraṃ madhyamāṅguṣṭhamatram | tatra jñānanetraṃ dīpaśikhākāraṃ dhyāyet | tatra vāksiddhir bhavati | aṣṭamaṃ brahmarandhraṃ nirvāṇacakraṃ sūcikāgrabhedyam | tatra dhūmaśikhākāraṃ dhyāyet | tatra jālandharapīṭhaṃ mokṣapradaṃ bhavati | navamam ākāśacakraṃ soḍaśadalakamalam ūrdhvamukham | tanmadhye karṇikāyāṃ trikūṭākārāṃ tadūrdhvaśaktiṃ tāṃ paramaśunyāṃ dhyāyet | tatraiva pūrṇagiripīṭhaṃ sarveṣṭasiddhipradaṃ bhavati | iti navacakravicāraḥ ‖

2 anukramaḥ cett.] anukramā N_2DK_I, anukrama N_I, anukramāḥ J **kathyate** U_IPU_2E] kathyaṃte $N_2N_IDK_IJ$, *om.* LB **ādhāre** cett.] ādhāro LB **brahmacakram** ELB] brahmacakraṃ cett. **ādhāropari** γ] *om.* β **liṅgamūle** γ] liṅge β **3 svādhiṣṭhānacakram** $N_2N_IDK_IJPE$] svādhiṣṭhānacakraṃ cett. **maṇipūrakacakram** N_2N_IELB] maṇipūrakacakraṃ $DK_IJU_IPU_2$ **'nāhata°** P] anāhata° U_2ELB, viśuddha° cett. **cakram** ELB] cakraṃ cett. **4 viśuddhicakram** E] anāhatacakraṃ β, viśuddhicakraṃ PB, viśuddhacakraṃ U_2L **ṣaṣṭhaṃ** $N_2N_IDK_IJU_IPEB$] *om.* U_2, ṣaṣṭha° L **tālucakram** N_2N_IE] tālucakraṃ DU_IP, tālucakra U_2, tālucakre LB **°ājñā** cett.] agneja P, āgneya L, ājñāya B **cakram** cett.] cakraṃ DK_IJPLB **5 brahmarandhrasthāne** $N_2N_IDK_IU_IU_2$] *om.* J, brahmasthāne PELB **kalā°** U_2] kāla° $N_2N_IDK_IPELB$, *om.* J, brahma° U_I **cakram** E] cakraṃ $N_2N_IDK_IU_IPU_2LB$, *om.* J **navamam** N_IDK_IJPELB] navama N_2, navamaṃ rattu U_I, *om.* U_2 **ākāśacakram** $N_2N_IDK_IU_IE$] ākāśacakram ‖ cha ‖ J, ākāśacakraṃ PLB, ākāśacakram ūrdhvaṃ U_2 **tat°** cett.] tata N_2, tataḥ P, etat E **°parama°** N_IK_IJ] para° N_2U_I, °paraṃ Dγ **°śūnyam** ELB] °śūnyaṃ $N_2N_IK_IJU_IPU_2$, tatparamaśūnyaṃ D

[XXIX. **Sequence of cakras**]

Now, the sequence of the *cakra*s is taught.[303] At the base,[304] there is the Brahmacakra. Above the base at the root of the penis is the Svādiṣṭhānacakra. At the navel, there is the Maṇipūrakacakra. In the heart [there is] the Anāhatacakra. Situated within the throat is the Viśuddhicakra. The sixth is the Tālucakra. In the centre of the eyebrows is the Ājñācakra. At the aperture of Brahman[305] is the Kalācakra.[306] The ninth is the Ākāśacakra.[307] It is supreme emptiness.

[303] Rāmacandra again describes the *cakra*s, briefly naming them—partly with different terms and locations than before. A detailed ninefold system was already given in IV–XII; this repetition seems redundant. No parallel exists in the *Yogasvarodaya*, and in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* only the positions, not the terminology, mostly coincide. No other ninefold *cakra* system known to me matches this terminology fully. It may thus be Rāmacandra's own synthesis or based on an unknown source. For comparative overviews of nine-, eight-, and sixfold systems, see Powell, 2023: 214. For a tabular overview of the ninefold *cakra* systems and closely related systems with eight and six *cakra*s see Powell, 2023: 214.

[304] In the previous section on *cakra*s Rāmacandra situates the first *cakra*, which he there calls *mūlacakra*, at the beginning (*ādau*) [of supposedly the central channel], which should be at the anus if we assume an ascending order, cf. p. 112.

[305] The fontanelle, through which the vital principle of the yogi exits at death, cf. Mallinson and Singleton, 2017: 438.

[306] The term *kalācakra* ("*cakra* of the digit") for the eighth *cakra* is unprecedented in other texts that teach *cakra* systems. A comparison of the term with the current standard collection of electronic texts in yogic and tantric studies, as well as with collections such as Muktabodha and GRETIL, yielded no hits. Thus, this appears to be an original and previously unknown term for a yogic *cakra*. All other texts that I am aware of designate the eighth *cakra* in a ninefold *cakra* system with different terms: *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* 4359/256.13, *Śivayogapradīpikā* 3.15 and *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.8 call it *nirvāṇacakram* ("*cakra* of absolute extinction"); *Yogasvarodaya* as quoted in *Prāṇatoṣinī* (Ed. p. 833) just calls it *aṣṭamaṃ cakraṃ* ("the eighth *cakra*") and *siddhapuṃsaḥ sthalaṃ* ("place of the accomplished human"); Rāmacandra himself in the previous chapter on *cakra*s in section XI picks this up and calls it *aṣṭamacakraṃ* ("eighth *cakra*") and *siddhapuruṣasya sthānaṃ* ("place of the accomplished person"); *Saubhāgyalakṣmyupaniṣad* also calls it *nirvāṇacakram*, but provides us with yet another unique designation—*parabrahmacakram* ("*cakra* of the supreme Brahman").

[307] The term *ākāśacakra* for the ninth *cakra* in the known ninefold *cakra* systems occurs in *Śivayogapradīpikā* 3.16 and *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.9 only.

[XXX. **ādhāracakrasya bhedāḥ**]

इदानीमाधारचक्रस्य भेदाः कथ्यन्ते। पादयोरङ्गुष्ठे तेजसो लक्ष्यकारणाद्दृष्टिः स्थिरा भवति। द्वितीयो मूलाधारः। पादाङ्गुष्ठस्य मूलेऽपरपादस्य पार्ष्णिः स्थाप्यते। अग्निः प्रबलो भवति। एका पार्ष्णिर्मूलाधारेअ स्थाप्यते। तस्य पादस्याङ्गुष्ठमूलेऽपरस्य पादस्य पार्ष्णिः स्थाप्यते। अग्निर्प्रदीप्यते।

Sources: 2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 839) = YK 2.15: ṣoḍaśādhārabhedan tu śṛṇu devi viśeṣataḥ | cf. SSP 2.10 (Ed. p. 32): atha ṣoḍaśādhārāḥ kathyante | 2–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 839): aṅguṣṭhapādayos tejaḥ salakṣasthiradṛṣṭimān | pādāṅguṣṭhe ya ādhāraḥ prathamo (*prathamaṃ* YK 2.16) yogatattvataḥ | 2–3 cf. SSP 2.10 (Ed. p. 32): tatra prathamaḥ pādāṅguṣṭhādhāraḥ | tatrāgratas tejomayaṃ dhyāyet | dṛṣṭiḥ sthirā bhavati | 3–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 839): dvitīyaṃ pādamūlan tu pādamūlaparaṃ (*pādamūlaṃ paraṃ* YK 2.16) sa vai | pādasya pārṣṇī (*pārṣṇi* YK 2.17a) saṃsthāpya balavān prabhaven muniḥ | pādamūle 'thavā pādāṅguṣṭhamūlaṃ (*pṛṣṭhe pādāṅguṣṭhe* YK 2.17) vidhārayet || 3–5 cf. SSP 2.11 (Ed. p. 33): dvitīyo mūlādhāras taṃ vāmapādapārṣṇinā niṣpīḍya sthātavyam | tatrāgnidīpanaṃ bhavati |

Testimonia: 2 cf. *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 98r ll. 3–4): ity ādhārāḥ ṣodaśayaṃ athoktānāṃ ṣoḍaśādhārāṇāṃ kartavyatām āha | 2–3 ≈*Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 98r l. 4): tatra mūlādhāraḥ 1 pādayor aṃguṣṭhe tejaso lakṣyakaraṇād dṛṣṭiḥ sthirā bhavati 2 ity ādhāracakraṃ | 3–5 ≈*Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 98r ll. 5–7): atha dvitīyādhāraḥ | tatra tatra vāmapādāṃguṣṭasya mūlam aparapādasya pārṣṇis tasmin sthāpyate | tad āgneḥ pradīpanaṃ bhavati | ekaḥ pārṣṇi mūlādhāre dṛḍhaṃ sthāypyate | tasya pādasya mūla aṃguṣṭamūlam aparasya pādasya pārṣṇinā saṃpīḍya ciraṃ sthiraṃ sthīyate tadāgnīm agni dīpyate | iti dvitīyadhāraḥ |

2 **idānīm** N_1PELB] idānī N_2, idānīṃ $DK_1JU_1U_2$ **bhedāḥ** JU_1U_2E] bhedaḥ $N_2N_1DK_1$P, bhedā LB **kathyante** $N_2U_1U_2$LB] kathyate N_1DK_1JP, kathyanta E **aṅguṣṭhe** cett.] aṃguṣṭhai B **tejaso** cett.] tejasaṃ LB **lakṣya°** cett.] lakṣa° N_2, lakṣaṃ LB **°kāraṇād** cett.] °karaṇāt P, kartavyaṃ kāraṇāt LB **dṛṣṭiḥ** cett.] dṛṣṭi° $N_2N_1U_1U_2$ 3 **bhavati** cett.] bhavatī L **mūlādhāraḥ** cett.] mūlādharaḥ U_1, mūlādhare U_2 **'para°** PU_2] apara° $N_2N_1DK_1U_1$, adhara° J, para° E, aparasya LB **pādasya** cett.] pāda° LB **pārṣṇiḥ** cett.] pārṣṇi K_1, dhāraḥ pādāṃduṣṭhasya mūleḥ parapādasya pārṣṇiḥ P **sthāpyate** cett.] sthāyyaṃte U_2, syāpyate LB **agniḥ** N_1] *om.* N_2U_2, agni° DK_1J, agniṃ U_1, tadāgniḥ PELB 4 **prabalo** cett.] *om.* N_2U_2 **bhavati** cett.] *om.* N_2U_2, bhavatī LB **ekā** N_1DK_1PLB] *om.* N_2U_2, ekaḥ JE, ekāṃ U_1 **pārṣṇiḥ** U_1] *om.* N_2U_2, pārṣṇiḥ N_1DK_1J, pārṣṇir ādau PELB **mūlādhāre** cett.] *om.* N_2U_2, mūlādhārai DK_1, mūlādhāraṃ J, mūlādhāra U_1B, mūlādhārā L **sthāpyate** cett.] *om.* N_2U_2 **tasya** cett.] *om.* U_2 **pādasyāṅguṣṭhamūle** cett.] pādasya aṃguṣṭhamūlaṃ $N_1K_1JU_1$, *om.* U_2 **'parasya** P] *om.* U_2, parasya E, aparasya cett. 5 **pādasya** cett.] *om.* JU_1U_2 **pārṣṇiḥ** cett.] pārṇi N_2, pārṣṇi J, pārṣṇo U_1, *om.* U_2 **sthāpyate** cett.] sthāpyaṃ $N_2N_1DK_1$, *om.* U_2 **agnir** N_1DK_1] agni N_2U_1, *om.* J, tadagnīḥ PU_2B, tadagniḥ E, tadāgnīḥ L **pradīpyate** E] dīpate N_2, dāpyate N_1, dīpyate DU_1, akṣipyate J, pradipyate PU_2LB

[XXX. **Divisions of the wheels of support**]

Now, the divisions of the group[308] of supports[309] is taught.

As a result of focusing on a light at the big toes of both feet, the gaze becomes steady.[310]

The root support is the second [one]. The heel of the back-foot is placed at the base of the big toe of the foot.[311] The fire is strengthened. [In other words,] one heel is placed at the root support. The heel of the other foot is placed at the base of the big toe of this foot. The fire is kindled.[312,313]

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[308] I took *cakra* in the sense of "group, crowd, totality", cf. Boethlingk, 1958 (Vol. 2): 209.

[309] The practice of sixteen *ādhāra*s goes back to the yoga traditions of Śaivism and is mentioned in texts such as *Tantrāloka (b)*, *Manthānabhairavatantram Kumārikākhaṇḍaḥ* and *Netratantra with Netroddyota*. The techniques were passed on, copied and recycled across the centuries among the yoga traditions of Haṭha- and Rājayoga. Besides Rāmacandra's text, the other texts which present full lists of the sixteen *ādhāra*s are *Netroddyota*-commentary of Kṣemarāja on *Netratantra* 7.5; *Śāradātilakatantra* 25.24–25; *Śivayogapradīpikā* 3.17–33; *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.10–25; *Yogataraṅgiṇī* 1.13 (Ed. p. 72–73) quotation with reference "*nityanāthapaddhatau*" (maybe another recension of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, see Powell, 2023: 149); *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* 24.10–23 and 40.19; and *Haṭhapradīpikājyotsnā* on *Haṭhapradīpikā*, as well as *Prāṇatoṣinī* (Ed. p. 839–841) quotation with reference "*yogasvarodaye*" and *Yogakarṇikā* quotation with reference "*yogasvarodaye*" 14–36. *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (cf. GOML R3239, f. 201 l. 20 to f. 204 ll. 5–6) directly quotes the *Tattvayogabindu* without reference. Comparing the various lists of *ādhāra*s reveals great variability. Rāmacandra's system draws from the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*. When there are differences in the descriptions of the respective *ādhāra*s among the texts I note them in the annotations without providing a reference again; for the Sanskrit, see the above-provided references.

[310] In all previously mentioned systems, the big toe is the first *ādhāra*. In most texts, the practitioner is instructed to fix the mind onto the big toe—either one shall visualize a light there (as in *Śivayogapradīpikā*) or the light is already present. The *Śāradātilakatantra*, however, instructs to fix *prāṇa* in each *ādhāra* listed. Here, the practice of the *ādhāra*s is subsumed under the *dhāraṇā*-limb of an eight-fold (*aṣṭāṅga*) yoga system.

[311] The base of the big toe of the foot (*pādasyāṅguṣṭhamūla*) is probably the big toe joint of the foot or *articulatio metatarsophalangealis hallucis*.

[312] Rāmacandra combines the techniques presented in YSv and SSP for this *ādhāra*, resulting in a *siddhāsana*-like bodily position.

[313] *Netroddyota*, *Śāradātilakatantra* and *Haṭhapradīpikājyotsnā* give the ankle (*gulpha*) as the second *ādhāra*.

तृतीयं गुदाधारस्थानम् तन्मध्ये संकोचविकासाकुञ्चनकारणात्पवनः स्थिरो भवति। अनु च पुरुषस्य मरणं न भवति। चतुर्थं लिङ्गाधारम्। तन्मध्ये लिङ्गसंकोचनाभ्यासात्पश्चिमदण्डमध्ये वज्रनाडी भवति। तन्मध्ये पुनरभ्यासकरणान्मनःपवनयोः संचारो भवति। तयोः संचारान्मध्ये ग्रन्थित्रयं त्रुट्यति। तत्त्रोटनात्पवनो ब्रह्मकमलमध्ये पूर्णो भूत्वा तिष्ठति। ततो वीर्यस्तम्भो भवति। पुरुषः सदैव युवैव भवति।

Sources: 1–2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 839): tṛtīyan tu gudādhāro (*gudādhāre* YK 2.18) gudasaṅkocanakriyā | vikāsākuñcanaṃ (em. *vikāśā*° PT) tasya sthiravāyau ca mṛtyujit | 1–2 cf. SSP 2.12 (Ed. p. 33): tṛtīyo gudādhāra taṃ vikāsasaṃkocanena nirākuñcayet | apānavāyuḥ sthiro bhavati | 2–6 cf. Ysv (PT, pp. 839–840): liṅgādhāraṃ caturthan tu liṅgasaṅkocanan tu ca | liṅgasaṅkocanābhyāsāt paścimādaṇḍamadhyagaḥ | vajranāḍīti (*vajrānāḍī tu* YK 2.20) tanmadhye punar abhyasyaṃs (*abhyasanan* YK 2.20) tathā | sañcāro vāyumanasor atisañcāra iti (*ratiṃ sañcarati* YK 2.20) tridhā | granthitrayavibhedas (°*bhedan* YK 2.21) tu tadbhedo brahmamārgataḥ | brahmapadmo (°*padme* YK 2.21) vāyupūrṇo (°*pūrṇe* YK 2.21) bhūtvā tiṣṭhati yogirāṭ | vīryastambho bhavet tena sādhayet tu sadā yuvā | mūlādhāre brahmapadme ṣaṭpadme ca tathā tathā | 2–6 cf. SSP 2.13 (Ed. pp. 33–34): caturtho meḍhrādhāraḥ | liṅgasaṃkocanena brahmagranthitrayaṃ bhitvā bhramaraguhāyāṃ viśramya tata ūrdhvamukhe bindustambhanaṃ bhavati| eṣā vajrolī prasiddhā

Testimonia: 1–2 ≈*Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 98r ll. 7–9): atha tṛtīyādhāraḥ tṛtīyaṃ gudādhārasthānaṃ tanmadhye dṛḍhaṃ muhuś ciraṃ saṃkocanavikāsanarūpākuṃcanakaraṇād pānavāyuḥ dvā vāmapādād pārṣṇimūlena gudāsya nipīḍanād apānavāyuḥ sthiro bhavati | cāmaraṃ karoti sādhakaṃ | iti tṛtīyādhāraḥ | 2–6 ≈*Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 98r l. 9 to f. 95v l. 3): atha caturthaṃ liṃgādhāraḥ | tanmadhye liṃgasaṃkocanābhysāt mūlabaṃdhena gudāyā muhuḥ saṃkocane kṛte liṃgasaṃkocanaṃ svayame liṃgasaṃkocanābhyāsat mūlabaṃdhena gudāyā muhuḥ saṃkocane kṛte liṃgasaṃkocanaṃ svayaṃ eva bhavati | paścimadaṃḍamadhye vajranāḍī bhavati tanmadhye punarabhyāsakaraṇān manaḥpavanayoḥ saṃcāro bhavati | tayoḥ saṃcārān madhye graṃthitrayaṃ trudyati | tat troṭaṇāt pavano brahmakamalamadhye pūrṇo bhūtvā tiṣṭhati | tadā vīryastaṃbho bhavati | puruṣa sadaiva yuvā tiṣṭhati | iti caturthādhāraḥ 4

1 tṛtīyaṃ cett.] tṛtīya U_2 **°sthānam** em.] °sthāne B, °sthānaṃ cett. **°vikāsā°** E] °vikāśā° $N_2N_1DK_1JU_1PU_2B$, °vikāśa L **°kuñcana°** cett.] °kuṃcanaṃ N_2DK_1, akuṃcana U_1, ākuṃcana L **pavanaḥ** cett.] pavana° $N_2DK_1JU_1U_2$ **1–2 bhavati** cett.] bhavatī B **2 anu ca** cett.] anū ca N_2N_1, anyac ca E, anucakra° L, anucara° B **na** cett.] *om.* PLB **bhavati** cett.] bhavatī LB **caturthaṃ** cett.] caturtha° DK_1JLB **2–3 °saṃkocanā°** cett.] °sakoṇā° N_2 **3 paścima°** cett.] paścīma° PB, paścama° L **vajra°** cett.] vajrā° DK_1J, vajñā° PLB, prajñā° E **bhavati** cett.] bhavatī LB **°karaṇān** PU_2E] °karaṇāt cett. **manaḥ°** cett.] punaḥ° LB **4 pavanayoḥ** cett.] pavanayo LB **saṃcāro** cett.] saṃcoro DK_1 **bhavati** cett.] bhavatī LB **tayoḥ** cett.] tayo B **saṃcārān** cett.] saṃcārāt DK_1J, saṃccārāt U_1, saṃccārān U_2 **truṭyati** cett.] ti N_2, trudyati U_1, truṭayatī L, truṭyatī B **°tattroṭanāt** N_1] tata troṭanāt N_2D, tat troṭanāt K_1, tatroṭanāt JELB, tatroṭaṇāt U_1, *om.* P, tattroṭaṇāt U_2 **pavano** ELB] *om.* P, pavanaḥ cett. **5 brahmakamalamadhye** cett.] *om.* P, °kamadhye LB **pūrṇo** cett.] *om.* P, pūrṇā LB **bhūtvā tiṣṭhati** cett.] *om.* P **puruṣaḥ** cett.] puruṣa N_2 **sadaiva** cett.] saṃdaivaṃ P **yuvaiva** DK_1JL] yurvaiva N_2, yuve va N_1, yuvaivaṃ U_1, yuve P, vaibhavo U_2, yuvā E, yuvai B **6 bhavati** cett.] prabhavati P, bhavatī B

The third is the place of the anus support.[314] As a result of expansion, contraction and compression, the vital wind becomes stable [on it]. And then, the person does not die.

The fourth is the penis support. As a result of the practice of contracting the penis in the middle of the [support], the adamantine channel (i.e., central channel)[315] arises in the posterior staff (i.e., spine).[316] From the repeated practice, both breath and mind enter it. As a result of the transition of both [breath and mind] the trinity of knots[317] within [the central channel] is pierced. Because of the piercing of those [knots], the breath becomes full in Brahmā's lotus and remains there.[318] As a result of that, the stopping of semen arises.[319] The person becomes youthful forever.[320]

[314] *Netroddyota*, *Śāradātilakatantra* and *Haṭhapradīpikājyotsnā* provide the knee (*jānu*) as the third *ādhāra*.

[315] The adamantine channel (*vajranāḍī*) is another synonym for the central channel. Rāmacandra adapted the term from the *Yogasvarodaya*. *Yogatarańgiṇī* in the commentary on 1.13 uses the term *vajragarbha* ("adamantine womb").

[316] The posterior staff (*paścimadaṇḍa*) is the spine. Cf. *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* 4365.

[317] The trinity of knots are: 1. the knot of Brahmā (*brahmagranthi*) is situated in the lower regions of the body (cf. *Gorakṣayogaśāstra* 23–24); 2. the knot of Viṣṇu (*viṣṇugranthi*) at the level of the heart (cf. *Gorakṣayogaśāstra* 25 and *Gorakṣaśataka* 80); and 3. the knot of Rudra (*rudragranthi*) at the level of the head or between the eyebrows (cf. *Gorakṣayogaśāstra* 25 and *Gorakṣaśataka* 81). Depending on text and tradition, it is either the breath (cf. *Amṛtasiddhi* 13.9–11) or the *kuṇḍalinī* (cf. *Yogabīja* 96–97 and *Gorakṣaśataka* 74–86) that enters the central channel and pierces the knots. *Gorakṣaśataka* 48 states that the entrance to the central channel is blocked by phlegm and that the three knots have arisen from the three *guṇa*s. They obstruct the central passage.

[318] Brahman's lotus refers to the eighth *cakra* in Rāmacandra's system, cf. chapter VIII, p. 134. The same location is expressed in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.13 and *Yogatarańgiṇī* commentary on 1.13 with the term *brahmaraguhā* ("buzzing hive") situated on top of the head (*Jogpradīpyakā* 932; also cf. *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* 4366 and *Gorakhbāṇī* 28.2 and 30.4).

[319] Breath, mind and semen are interconnected. If one of them stops its movement, all stop their movement, cf. *Amṛtasiddhi* 7.19–20 and 23.

[320] Most of the consulted texts situate the fourth *ādhāra* at the penis (*meḍhra*). *Śāradātilakatantra* and *Haṭhapradīpikājyotsnā* place the fourth support at the thighs (*ūru*). *Śivayogapradīpikā* 3.20 and *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.13 additionally associate the practice with the arrest of semen (*bindustambha*). However, *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* calls this *vajrolī*.

पञ्चमं उड्डीयाणं स्वाधिष्ठानम्। तत्र बन्धनान्मलमूत्रयोर्नाशो भवति। षष्ठो नाभ्या–धारः। तत्र प्रणवाभ्यासादनाहतो नादः स्वयमुत्पद्यते। सप्तमो हृदयरूपाधारः। तस्मिन्स्थाने प्राणवायोर्निरोधात्षडपि कमलान्यूर्ध्वमुखानि विकसन्ति। अष्टमः कण्ठाधारः। तत्र जालन्धरो बन्धो दीयते। तस्मिन्सतीडायां पिङ्गलायां पवनः
5 स्थिरो भवति।

Sources: 1 cf. YSv (PT, p. 840): pañcamaṃ jaṭharādhāraṃ tadā bandhayati kramāt | mṛtyunā bhaṅgasiddho 'yaṃ (*mṛtyunā māṅga*° YK 2.23) mṛtyor (*mṛtyur* YK 2.23) eva kṣayaṅkaraḥ | anena paścimād ūrddhaṃ (*ūrdhvaṃ* YK 2.24) vāyuḥ kuryād viśāladhīḥ | bandho 'yaṃ buddhimanasoḥ pañcamādhārakālajit | cf. SSP 2.14 (Ed. p. 34): pañcame oḍīyāṇādhārayor bandhanān malamūtrasaṃkocanaṃ bhavati | *uḍyānā° etc. in various mss. 1–2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 840): nābhyādhāro bhavet ṣaṣṭhas (*ṣaṣṭhaṃ* YK 2.25) tatra prāṇaṃ samabhyaset | svayam utpadyate nādo nādato muktidantataḥ (*muktidaṇḍataḥ* YK 1.25) | 1–2 cf. SSP 2.15 (Ed. p. 34): ṣaṣṭhe nābhyādhāra oṃkāram ekacittenoccārayet | nādalayo bhavati | 2–3 cf. SSP 2.16 (Ed. p. 34): saptame hṛdayādhāre prāṇaṃ nirodhayet | kamalavikāso bhavati | 2–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 840): saptamo hṛdayādhāras tasmin vāyunibandhanāt | ūrddhaktrāṇi (*ūrdhvavaktrāṇi* YK 2.26) padmāni vikasanti mahān bhavet | 3–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 840) = YK 2.27: kaṇṭhādhāro 'ṣṭamas tatra kaṇṭhasaṅkocalakṣaṇaḥ | jālandharākhyo bandhaḥ syāt tasmin sati marud dṛḍhaḥ | 3–5 cf. SSP 2.17 (Ed. p. 34): aṣṭame kaṇṭhādhāre kaṇṭhamūlaṃ cibukena nirodhayet | iḍāpiṅgalayor vāyuḥ sthiro bhavati |

Testimonia: 1 ≈*Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 98v ll. 3–4): athāmamudrāṇāṃ | tatra baṃdhanān malamūtranāśo bhavati | 1–2 ≈*Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244 f. 98v ll. 4–5): atha ṣaṣṭhonābhyādhāraḥ 6 tatra praṇavābhyāse harau samāhitamanaḥ puruṣasya anāhatanādo manaḥ | sthairyaṃ svayam utpadyate | 2–3 ≈*Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244 f. 98v ll. 5–6): atha saptamaṃ hṛdayarūpa ādhāraḥ 7 tasmin yāṇavāyor nirodhā chaṭakamalāni svayam ūrdhamukhaṃ vikasaṃti | 3–5 ≈*Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 203 ll. 5–6): athāṣṭamakaṃṭhādhāraḥ 8 tatra jālaṃdharabaṃdho dīyate tasmin satīḍāpiṃgalāyāṃ pavanaḥ sthiro bhavati |

1 **pañcamaṃ** cett.] paṃcam N_2, paṃcama EB **uḍḍīyāṇaṃ svādhiṣṭhānam** U_2] odyānaṃ N_2, udyānaṃ N_1DK_1, udyāṇāṃ J, uddyānaṃ U_1, uḍḍīyāṇāṃ svādhiṣṭhānaṃ P, udgīryāṇāṃ svādhiṣṭhānaṃ E, uḍḍiyānāṃ svādhiṣṭhānaṃ LB **bandhanān** E] baṃdhanāt $N_2N_1K_1$, vaṃdhanāt D, baṃdhadānāt JU_1, baṃdhadānān P, badhadānān U_2, baṃdha dīyate LB **malamūtrayor** cett.] mūlamūcayor L **bhavati** cett.] bhavatī B 1–2 **nābhyādhāraḥ** cett.] nābhyādhāras JU_1, nābhyādhāre U_2 2 **tatra** cett.] *om.* E **praṇavābhyāsād** Jγ] praṇavābhyāsāt $N_2N_1DK_1$, praṇavābhyāṃsad U_1 **anāhato** cett.] anohato U_2, *om.* E **nādaḥ** cett.] nāraḥ P, *om.* E **svayam** cett.] svayaṃ N_2, *om.* E **utpadyate** cett.] ūtpadyate N_1, *om.* E **saptamo** cett.] *om.* EB **hṛdaya°** cett.] hṛdayā° U_2, *om.* EB **°rūpādhāraḥ** N_2JU_1] °rūpa ādhāraḥ N_1DK_1, °rūpadhāraḥ PL, °dhāraḥ U_2, *om.* EB 3 **prāṇavāyor** cett.] prāṇavāyo B **nirodhāt** γ] nirūṃdhanāt $N_2N_1DU_1$, nirudhanāt K_1J **ṣaḍ api** EB] ṣaḍaṃ pi J, ṣadapi cett. **ūrdhvamukhāni** cett.] ūrdhve mukhaṃ N_2, ūrdhvamukhaṃ N_1DK_1, puttaṣasyordhvamukhaṃ J, ūrusyordha mukhaṃ bhavati U_1 **aṣṭamaḥ** cett.] aṣṭama° N_2, aṣṭamaṃ E, aṣṭame LB 4 **tatra** cett.] tatraḥ DJ **jālandharo** cett.] jālaṃdhara° N_2, jalaṃ LB **dīyate** cett.] dīpyate U_1 **satīḍāyāṃ** PE] satiśadāyāṃ N_2, sati piḍāyā U_2, satīyāṃ LB, sati iḍāyāṃ cett. **pavanaḥ** cett.] pavana° DK_1J 5 **bhavati** cett.] bhavataḥ P, bhavatī LB

The fifth is Uḍḍīyāṇa,[321] that is, Svādhiṣṭhāna. As a result of performing a lock at that place, faeces and urine disappear.[322]

The sixth is the support of the navel. There, from the repeated practice of *praṇava*,[323] the unstruck sound[324] arises by itself.[325]

The seventh is the support in the form of the heart. The six lotuses [become] upward-facing [and] open up as a result of the restraint of the breath in this location.[326]

The eighth is the throat support. There, the Jālandhara lock[327] is performed. When [the lock] is engaged, the breath in the Iḍā [and] Piṅgalā channels becomes firm.[328]

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[321] For a discussion of the term *uḍḍīyāṇa*, see p. 116 n. 148.

[322] *Śivayogapradīpikā*, *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* and *Yogataraṅgiṇī* share the concept of binding at Uḍḍīyāna. *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* instructs to do a pressing (*moṭana*) at the waist (*kaṭau*). *Netroddyota*, along with *Śāradātilakatantra* and *Haṭhapradīpikājyotsnā* situate the fifth *ādhāra* at the anus (*pāyu* or *sīvanī*). The *Yogasvarodaya* situates the fifth *ādhāra* at the belly (*jaṭharādhāra*).

[323] The syllable *oṃ*. See Bryant 2009, pp. 105–109 and Harimoto 2014, pp. 151–163 for a more detailed discussion of the term *praṇava* in the context of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*.

[324] Cf. *Haṭhapradīpikā* 4.17 et seqq.

[325] *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* prescribes reciting *oṃ* at the navel; *Yogataraṅgiṇī* adds meditation on the form of consciousness (*cidrūpa*); and *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* instructs retaining the breath at the navel, causing the sound of *oṃ* to rise into emptiness. In the *Yogasvarodaya*, breath retention at the navel likewise produces spontaneous *nāda*, while the *Śivayogapradīpikā* directs contemplation of Kuṇḍalinī there. The *Netroddyota* identifies the *kanda* as the sixth support.

[326] Rāmacandra's mention of *ṣaḍ api kamalāny* ("six lotuses") seems inconsistent, as he previously (section XXIX) taught a ninefold *cakra* system. In the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, *Yogasvarodaya*, and *Yogataraṅgiṇī*, practice at the seventh *ādhāra* culminates in the blossoming of the heart lotus alone; in the *Haṭhatattvakaumudī*, it is consciousness that blossoms in the heart. The *Śivayogapradīpikā* describes the heart centre as a downward-facing eight-petaled lotus bestowing desires, where one should place the mind in the pericarp (*karṇikā*) as a *liṅga* of light. *Netroddyota* identifies the seventh *ādhāra* as the *nāḍī*, the middle path between navel and heart (*nābhihṛnmadhyamārge tu sarvakāmābhidho mataḥ* |), while *Śāradātilakatantra* and *Haṭhapradīpikājyotsnā* list the navel as the seventh.

[327] This passage shows how Rāmacandra shifts between his two sources. In chapter XI, he places Jālandhara at the *brahmarandhra*; see p. 135 for a discussion.

[328] The *Netroddyota* locates the support in the belly (*jaṭhara*), while the *Śāradātilakatantra* and *Haṭhapradīpikājyotsnā* place the eighth support in the heart. The remaining texts agree in this regard.

नवमो घण्टिकाधारः तत्र जिह्वाग्रं लग्नं भवति। ततोऽमृतकलाया अमृतं स्रव–
ति। तदमृतपानाच्छरीरमध्ये रोगसंचारो न भवति। दशमस्तालवाधारः। तन्मध्ये
चालनं दोहनं च कृत्वा लम्बिकाप्रवेशे सति तालुनि मग्ना जिह्वा तिष्ठति। एकादशो
जिह्वातले जिह्वाधारः। तस्मिन् जिह्वाग्रेण मन्थनं क्रियते। तस्मिन्कृतेऽतिमधुरं पा–
5 नीयं स्रवति। तथा च कवित्वगीतछन्दोनाटकादिविषयज्ञानमुत्पद्यते।

Sources: 1–2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 840): navamo ghaṇṭikādhāras tatra jihvāgram agrataḥ (*jihvāgrataḥ kṛte* YK 2.28) | sampivaty amṛtaṃ tasmād yogajinmṛtyujitparaḥ | 1–2 cf. SSP 2.18 (Ed. p. 35): navame ghaṇṭikādhāre jihvāgraṃ dhārayet | amṛtakalā sravati | 2–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 840): daśamas tālukādhāras tatra jihvāgrataḥ kṛte (hemistich omitted in YK) | calane dohane caiva jihvā jaḍati lambitā (*jāyeta lambitam* YK 2.28cd) | nāsikāprāptajihveyaṃ tālulagnā bhavet tataḥ | 2–3 cf. SSP 2.19 (Ed. p. 35): daśame tālvādhāre tālvantar garbhe lambikāṃ cālanadohanābhyāṃ dīrghīkṛtvā viparītena praveśayet | kāṣṭhībhavati | 3–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 840): ekādaśī (*ekādaśo* YK 2.29) bhavej jihvā talajādhāra īśvari | jihvāgramathane tasmin pānīyaṃ madhuraṃ bhavet | tatpīteṣu kavir gītijyotiś (*gītir* YK 2.29) chandovidāṃ (*chandovidur* YK 2.30) varaḥ | 3–5 cf. SSP 2.20 (Ed. p. 35): ekādaśe atha jihvādhāre tatra jihvāgraṃ dhārayet | sarvaroganāśo bhavati |

Testimonia: 1–2 ≈*Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 98v ll. 6–8): atha navamaṃ ghaṃṭikādhāraḥ 9 tatra jihvāyā agraṃ dataṃ cet tata uparītaḥ amṛtaṃ yat sravati | taj jihvāgreṇa yogī pibati | tadāmṛtapānāc charīramadhye rogāṇāṃ saṃcāro na bhavati | 2–3 ≈*Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 98v l. 8): atha daśamaṃ (*daśamaṃ* GOML R3239] *damaṃ* MMPP 2244) tālvādhāraḥ 10 spaṣṭaṃ | 3–5 ≈*Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 98 ll. 8-9): ekādaśo jihvātale jihvādhāraḥ 11 tasmin jihvāgreṇa mathanaṃ kriyate | tasmin kṛte atimadhuraṃ pānīyaṃ sudhāvat sravati | kavitvagītachaṃdanāṭakādijñānaṃ svayam utpadyate |

1 **navamo** cett.] navo B **ghaṇṭikā°** cett.] ghaṭikā° P, ghaṃṭā° L **°dhāraḥ** cett.] °dhāras U_1 **jihvāgraṃ** cett.] jihvāyāgraṃ DK_1J, juhvāyāṃ U_1 **bhavati** cett.] bhavati ‖ cha ‖ J, bhavati vā U_1, bhavatī B **tato** cett.] tataḥ DK_1JU_1 **'mṛtakalāyā** cett.] amṛtakalāyāḥ DK_1JU_1, mṛtakalāyāḥ U_2, mṛtakalāyāṃ L **amṛtaṃ** cett.] amṛta P, *om.* L 1–2 **sravati** cett.] *om.* L 2 **tadamṛtapānāc** DK_1JP] tadamṛtapānāt $N_2N_1U_1E$, tadamṛtapānā U_2, amṛtapānā L, tadamṛtakalāyāṃ amṛtapānī° B **charīra°** cett.] śarīra° N_2N_1E **na** cett.] *om.* LB **bhavati** cett.] bhavatī B **daśamas** cett.] daśama° N_2N_1, daśamaṃ E, daśamaṃs B **tanmadhye** cett.] staṃnmadhye U_1 3 **cālanaṃ** cett.] cānanaṃ N_1D, vānaṃ E **dohanaṃ** cett.] dohanaṃ chedanaṃ U_2, dollahanaṃ E **kṛtvā** cett.] sva kṛtvā U_1, kratvā LB **lambikā°** cett.] cālaṃbikā° JU_1 **sati** cett.] grati $N_2N_1DK_1$, śe sati P **tāluni magnā** cett.] tālūni magnā N_2, tāluni lagnā JU_1, tālumagnā PLB **jihvā** cett.] *om.* N_2 **tiṣṭhati** cett.] *om.* N_2 **ekādaśo** cett.] *om.* N_2, ekādaśoḥ K_1, ekādaśa J, ekādaśā U_1 4 **jihvātale** cett.] *om.* N_2N_1E **jihvādhāraḥ** cett.] *om.* N_2 **tasmin** cett.] *om.* N_2, tasmin na U_1 **manthanaṃ** cett.] mathanaṃ DK_1JPL **kriyate** cett.] kṛtvā LB **'ti°** cett.] ati° $N_2N_1K_1$, sati° DJLB 5 **sravati** cett.] sravatī B **tathā** cett.] kamin nāsikā phatkāravat ‖ tathā N_2, tadā E **ca** cett.] *om.* LB **kavitva°** cett.] kvacitta° D, kavitvaṃ U_2, kvacitva° LB **°gīta°** $N_2N_1K_1JU_1$] *om.* cett. **°chando°** γ] °chaṃdavacchaṃda° U_1, °chaṃda° cett. **°nāṭakādi°** cett.] °nātikādi° J, °nāḍī° U_1 **°viṣaya°** Dγ] °viṣaye $N_2N_1K_1$, °viṣayaṃ JU_1 **jñānam** cett.] jñānānam U_1 **utpadyate** cett.] utpadyaṃte B

The ninth is the support of the uvula. The tip of the tongue becomes attached to it. As a result of that, the nectar of immortality flows from the immortality digit. From drinking the nectar of immortality, diseases do not spread in the body.[329]

The tenth is the support of the palate. After the moving and milking have been done, [and] after abiding at the entrance with the tongue in the middle of it, the tongue resides inserted within the [cavity above the] palate.[330]

The eleventh is the tongue support at the surface of the tongue. In the middle of that [support], the tip of the tongue is churned.[331] When that has been done, a very sweet liquid oozes out. Moreover, after that, the knowledge of areas like poetry, singing, metrics and dance is generated.[332]

[329] Most texts with the sixteen *ādhāra* system share this concept. Only *Śāradātilakatantra* and *Haṭhapradīpikājyotsnā* situate the ninth support at the neck (*grīva*), and *Netroddyota* at the heart.

[330] The ninth, tenth, eleventh and twelfth supports are all associated with the tongue-related haṭhayogic *khecarīmudrā* and its forerunners. For a detailed account of this *khecarīmudrā*, see Mallinson, 2010. *Netroddyota* places the tenth support at the tortoise channel (*kūrmanāḍī*), whereas *Śāradātilakatantra* and *Haṭhapradīpikājyotsnā* situate it at the throat (*kaṇṭha*).

[331] For a discussion of the term *manthana* in the context of *khecarīmudrā*, see Mallinson, 2010: 207–208, n. 250.

[332] Almost all texts teaching the sixteen *ādhāra*s share the concept of the churning of the tongue with only minor differences: *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* teaches the destruction of all diseases (*sarvaroganāśa*) as the result of this practice, *Yogataraṅgiṇī* calls the practice *jihvādhobhāgādhāra*. The *Netroddyota* alone teaches the throat (*kaṇṭha*) as the eleventh *ādhāra*. Here, it states: *lambhikasya sthitaś cordhve sudhādhāraḥ sudhātmakaḥ* ‖ "Above the place of the uvula is a stream of nectar resembling nectar itself.".

तदुपरि द्वादशो दन्तयोर्मध्ये दन्ताधारः। तस्मिन्स्थाने जिह्वाया अग्रं घटीमात्र-
मर्धगटीमात्रं वा बलात्कारेण स्थाप्यते। तस्मिन्सति साधकस्य समग्रा रोगा न-
श्यन्ति। त्रयोदशो नासिकाधारः। तस्मिल्लक्ष्ये कृते सति मनः स्थिरं भवति।
चतुर्दशो नासामूले वाय्वाधारः तस्मिन्दृष्टेः स्थैर्यकारणात्षष्ठे मासे स्वीयं तेजः प्र-
5 त्यक्षं भवति। तेजसः प्रत्यक्षत्वे पार्थिवं सकलं बन्धनं त्रुट्यति।

Sources: 1–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 840): dantādhāro (*dvandvādhāro* YK 2.31a) dvādaśeti sarvarogakṣayaṅkaraḥ (*sarvarogaḥ* YK 2.31b) | dhārayed dantayor madhye jihvāgrañ ca balād api | dhṛtvārddhaghaṭikāmātraṃ sarvarogan (*sarvarogāṃs* YK 2.32b) tu nāśayet | 1–3 cf. SSP 2.21 (Ed. p. 36): dvādaśe bhrūmadhyādhāre tatra candramaṇḍalaṃ dhyāyet śītalatāṃ yāti | 3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 832): nāsādhāras tato (*tataḥ* YK 2.32b) jñeyo nāsālakṣas trayodaśaḥ (*trayodaśa* YK 2.32d) | manaḥsthirakaro yas tu (*sthiraṃ karoty eva* YK 2.33a) vāyusthirakaro (*vāyuḥ* YK 2.32b) mahān | cf. SSP 2.22 (Ed. p. 36): trayodaśe nāsādhāre tasyāgraṃ lakṣayet manaḥ sthiraṃ bhavati | 4–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 839) = YK 2.33ab–34cd): nāsāpuṭe sthirā dṛṣṭir ādhāro 'yaṃ caturdaśaḥ | kṛte 'smin svīyatejaḥ syāt pratyakṣaṃ ṣaṭtrimāsataḥ | pārthivaṃ truṭati kṣipraṃ pratyakṣaṃ svīyatejasā | 4–5 cf. SSP 2.23 (Ed. p. 36): caturdaśe nāsāmūle kapāṭādhāre dṛṣṭiṃ dhārayet | ṣaṇmāsāj jyotiḥpuñjaṃ paśyati |

Testimonia: 1–3 ≈*Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 98r l. 9 to 99v l. 1): atha tadupari dvādaśo daṃtayor madhye daṃtādhāraḥ 12 tasmin sthāne jihvāyā agraṃ ghaṭīmātraṃ ardhaghaṭīmātraṃ balāt sthāpyate | tasmin sati samagraroganāśo bhavati | ≈*Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 99r l. 1–2): atha trayodaśo nāsikādhāraḥ 13 tasmin lakṣye kṛte sati manaḥ sthiraṃ bhavati | 4–5 ≈*Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 99r ll. 2–3): atha caturdaśo nāsāmūle lalāṭe 'py ādhāraḥ 14 tasmin dṛṣṭeḥ sthairyakaraṇāt ṣaṣṭhe māsi svīyaṃ tejaḥ pratyakṣaṃ bhavati | tejasaḥ prasakṣatve pārthivasaṃkalaṃ baṃdhanaṃ trudyati |

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1 **dvādaśo dantayor madhye** U_1PLB] dvādaśayor madhye N_2N_1D, dvādaśo dantayor madhye K_1, dvādaśavaṃ tayor madhye J, dvādaśor daṃtayo madhye U_2, dvādaśadantayo madhye E **dantādhāraḥ** cett.] dantādhāras J **jihvāyā** cett.] jihvāyāṃ U_1 **agraṃ** cett.] graṃ N_2, agnaṃ LB 1–2 **ghaṭīmātram** cett.] ghaṭīmātraṃ N_2N_1D, ghaṭimātraṃ K_1J 2 **ardhagaṭīmātraṃ** em.] arddhaghaṭimātraṃ $N_2N_1DK_1$J, ārdhaghaṭikāmātraṃ U_1, ārghaghaṭīmātraṃ PU_2, *om.* E, ārddhaghaṭimātraṃ L, ārghaghaṭimātraṃ B **vā** em.] va K_1, *om.* cett. **balātkāreṇa** cett.] bālātkāreṇa U_1PU_2, bālākāreṇa LB **tasmin** cett.] tasmiṃ LB **sati** cett.] *om.* LB 2–3 **naśyanti** cett.] naśyaṃtī B 3 **nāsikādhāraḥ** cett.] nāsikāgrādhāraḥ PE **tasmil lakṣye** em.] tasmin lakṣe $N_2N_1DK_1$, tasmin lakṣye J, tasmiṃ lakṣye U_1PE, tasmil lakṣe U_2, tasmin dṛaṣṭe LB **kṛte sati** cett.] sati kṛte J, *om.* LB **manaḥ sthiraṃ** JPE] manasthiraṃ cett., manaḥ sthiro L, minasthire B 4 **nāsāmūle vāyvādhāraḥ** N_2N_1D] nāsāmūle vāyādhāraḥ K_1, nāsāmūle vā adhāraḥ J, nāsāmūle vādhāraḥ U_1, nāsāmūlādhāro P, nāsāmūlādhāraḥ U_2E, nāso mūlādhāraḥ LB **tasmin** cett.] tasmiṃ na U_1 **dṛṣṭeḥ** cett.] na dṛṣṭeḥ U_1, laṣṭhe U_2, lakṣe kṛte satī L, llakṣe krute satī B **māse** U_1LB] māsi cett., māsaḥ J **svīyaṃ** cett.] svayaṃ N_2U_2LB, svīyan E 5 **pārthivaṃ** cett.] pārthiva N_2 **truṭyati** U_1PU_2] trudyati $N_2N_1DK_1$J, tuṭyati E, truṭayati LB

Above that is the twelfth, the tooth support within the two [top front] teeth.[333] At this place, the tip of the tongue is to be positioned with force for the duration of one *ghaṭi* or half a *ghaṭi*.[334] Abiding therein, all the practitioner's diseases will disappear.[335]

The thirteenth is the support of the nose. When that is set as the focus, the mind becomes stable.[336]

The fourteenth is the support of the vital wind at the bridge of the nose. As a result of stabilising the gaze therein, one's own brilliance becomes apparent within six months. When the brilliance has manifested the entire mundane bond breaks.[337]

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[333] SSP 2.21 (Ed. p. 36) teaches the brows as the twelfth *ādhāra*. Rāmacandra follows the YSv here. Given the other descriptions, it is apparent that Rāmacandra switched between both sources when compiling the section on the sixteen *ādhāra*s.

[334] One *ghaṭi* equals 1/60 of a day (see Sircar, 1966: 114), which is 24 minutes. Half a *ghaṭi* would thus equal 12 minutes.

[335] Most of the texts teach a practice that involves contact between the tongue and the teeth. Rāmacandra and *Yogasvarodaya* teach to push the tongue forcefully against the [upper] teeth. *Śivayogapradīpikā* instructs to rub the tip of the tongue at the upper teeth for half a year, which would cause the practitioner to see an inner light. *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* mixes the two previous ideas. The name of the twelfth *ādhāra* here is *dvijādhāra*, and Sundaradeva also calls it *rājadanta*. The yogin presses the tip of the tongue against this point, and hence, he perceives an inner light within six months. *Yogataraṅgiṇī* surprisingly teaches the same technique as Rāmacandra and not the *bhrūmadhyādhāra* of *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*. *Netroddyota* names the palate as the twelfth support and lets us know that at the root of it is that which is blissful, which is enveloped by the *somakalā*. *Śāradātilakatantra* and *Haṭhapradīpikājyotsnā* list the nose as the twelth support.

[336] The majority of texts teach either the nose, the base of the nose as in *Śivayogapradīpikā* (*ghrāṇamūla*) and *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* (*ghrāṇapada*), or the tip of the nose (*nāsāgra*) as the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* and *Yogataraṅgiṇī*. Whereas *Netroddyota*, *Śāradātilakatantra* and *Haṭhapradīpikājyotsnā* teach the place in between the brows as the thirteenth *ādhāra*.

[337] *Yogasvarodaya* and *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* provide the term *kapāṭādhāra*. *Yogataraṅgiṇī* teaches the base of the nose as the fourteenth *ādhāra*. All other texts teach fixing the mind and the breath at the forehead. *Netroddyota* calls this place at the forehead "a wish-fulfilling jewel with its abode at the crossroads of the four channels" (*cintāmaṇyabhidhānākhyaś catuṣpathanivāsi yat*).

पञ्चदशो भ्रुवोर्मध्याधारः। तस्मिन्दृष्टेः स्थिरीकरणात्कोटिकिरणानि स्फुरन्ति। षोडशो नेत्राधारः। अयमङ्गुल्यग्रेण चाल्यते। तदभ्यासात्पृथ्वीमध्ये यत्किंचित्तेजो वर्तते। तत्सर्वतेजो दृष्टिविषयं भवति। तद्दर्शनात्पुरुषः सर्वज्ञो भवति॥

Sources: 1 cf. YSv (PT, p. 839): pañcadaśo bhruvormadhye sthira (*sthirā* YK 2.35) dṛṣṭis tathā dhruvam | asmin dṛṣṭiḥ sthirā koṭiḥ (*koṭi*° YK 2.35) kiraṇāni sphuranti hi | cf. SSP 2.24 (Ed. pp. 36–37): pañcadaśe lalāṭādhāre tatra jyotiḥpuñjaṃ lakṣayet | tejasvī bhavati | 2–3 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 840–41): netrādhāraḥ ṣoḍaśo 'yam (*aṅgulyagre na* YK 2.36) aṅgulyagreṇa cālayet | pṛthvīmadhye tu yat kiñcid varttate (*sarvajñaḥ prabhavas tena varddhate* YK 2.36) jaṭharānalaḥ | pratyakṣaṃ tad bhavet sarvaṃ tad ābhyāsān na saṃśayaḥ | 2–3 cf. SSP 2.25 (Ed. p. 37): avaśiṣṭe ṣoḍaśe brahmarandhram ākāśacakram | tatra śrīgurucaraṇāmbujayugmaṃ sadāvalokayet | ākāśavat pūrṇo bhavati |

Testimonia: 1 ≈*Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 99r l. 3–4): atha paṃcadaśo bhrūmadhye ajñādhāraḥ 15 asmiṃ dṛṣṭeḥ sthirīkaraṇāt koṭikiraṇāḥ puraḥ sphuraṃti | 2–3 ≈*Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 99r l. 4): atha ṣoḍaśo netrādhāraḥ 16 ayaṃ aṃgulyagreṇa cālyate tadābhyāsāt pṛthivīmadhye yat kiñcit tejo vartate | tat sarvaṃ tejo dṛṣṭiviṣayaṃ bhavati | taddarśanāt puruṣaḥ sarvajño bhavati | iti pūrvoktaṣoḍaśādhārāṇāṃ spaṣṭo 'rthaḥ |

1 **pañcadaśo** cett.] pañcadaśa J **madhyādhāraḥ** P] madhye ādhāraḥ $N_2N_1K_1$, madhye ājñādhāraḥ D, madhye adhāraḥ J, madhye ādhāra U_1, madhyādhāra U_2, madhyādhāras E, madhye dhāraḥ LB **tasmin** cett.] asmin N_1K_1J, smin D, asin U_1 **dṛṣṭeḥ** cett.] na dṛṣṭeḥ U_1, dṛṣṭi° U_2, dṛṣṭe L **kiraṇāni** β] °kiraṇāḥ PE, °kiraṇaḥ U_2, °kiriṇā LB 2 **ṣoḍaśo** cett.] ṣoḍaśaḥ $N_2N_1DK_1$ **netrādhāraḥ** cett.] ne ādhāraḥ J, netrā LB **ayam** γ] ayaṃ β **aṅgulyagreṇa** cett.] aṃgugreṇa N_2, agulyagreṇa N_1DK_1 **pṛthvī°** cett.] pṛthivī° U_2LB **tejo** cett.] tejaḥ N_2N_1D, *om.* JU_1 3 **vartate** cett.] vatate U_1 **tatsarvatejo** $N_2N_1DK_1$] tatsarvaṃ tejo JU_1PELB, tatsarvaṃ tajaso U_2 **dṛṣṭi°** cett.] dṛṣṭī° U_1 **bhavati** cett.] bhavatī B **taddarśanāt** cett.] taddarśanaḥ J, tatdarśaḥ U_1, tadarśanāt P **bhavati** cett.] bhavatī B

The fifteenth support is situated in the middle of the eyebrows. As a result of stabilising the gaze therein, ten million rays of light sparkle.[338]

The sixteenth is the eye support. It is caused to be rubbed with the fingertips. As a result of that practice, some light arises from the earth[-element].[339] That entire light becomes the object of vision. As a result of seeing that, the person becomes omniscient.[340]

[338] *Śivayogapradīpikā* teaches gazing above the brows, which quickly brings about the appearance of light. *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* calls it the "support of the forehead" (*lalāṭādhāra*), in which the practitioner shall visualize a cluster of light. *Yogataraṅgiṇī* teaches the centre of the brows. By concentrating on this point, a direct vision of many-rayed light occurs, and one's mind will merge into the sun-sky (*etasya dṛḍhābhyāse sūryākāśo līyate* |). *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* calls it the "support of ether" (*vyomādhāra*) and explains that by gazing at it, everything is perceived as light. However, *Netratantra* teaches the *brahmarandhra* as the fifteenth support. *Netroddyota* declares it as the "support of the fourth state" (*turyādhāra*). *Śāradātilakatantra* and *Haṭhapradīpikājyotsnā* also teach the top of the head (*mūrdhan*) as the fifteenth.

[339] Perhaps, *tejas* arises from *pṛthvī*, because its origin is unknown and in Śaiva Tantras the earth as the bottom *tattva* contains the entire *brahmāṇḍa*, cf. *Tāntrikābhidhānakośa 3*, 2013: 501.

[340] Rāmacandra's description of *netrādhāra* is very similar to *Yogataraṅgiṇī*, which also instructs the yogin to rub the eyes with the fingers in order to generate the perception of a light. Other texts have some noteworthy differences: *Śivayogapradīpikā* teaches to fix [the gaze] above the eyes. Due to that, the yogin sees a mass of light at the corner of his eyes. *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* teaches to meditate upon the eyes. By seeing a mass of light at the corner of the eyes, one soon becomes like Śiva. *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* teaches to visualize the pair of lotus feet of the revered teacher (*śrīgurucaraṇāmbujayugmaṃ*) at the *brahmarandhra* in which the *ākāśacakra* is situated. The *Haṭhapradīpikājyotsnā*, too, lists the *brahmarandhra*. *Śāradātilakatantra* and *Netratantra* teach the *dvādaśānta* as the sixteenth support. *Tāntrikābhidhānakośa 3*, p. 210. *Netroddyota* explains: *nāḍyādhāraḥ paraḥ sūkṣmo ghanavyāptiprabodhakaḥ* ‖ "The support of the [central?] channel is the highest subtle one which awakens complete pervasion."

[XXXI. **aṣṭāṅgayogasya vicāraḥ**]

इदानीमष्टाङ्गयोगस्य विचारः कथ्यते। यमनियमासन प्राणायामप्रत्याहारध्यान–धारणासमाधिरिति एतेषां लक्षणानि कथ्यन्ते। शान्तिः॥ षण्णामिन्द्रियाणां जयः॥ आहारः स्वल्पः॥ निद्राजयः॥ शैत्यजयः॥ उष्णजयः॥ एते यमाः॥ नियमाः खलु मनः चापलभावान्निवार्य स्थैर्ये स्थाप्यते॥ एकान्ते सेवनम्॥ प्राणिमात्रे समा बुद्धिः॥ औदासीन्यं॥ कस्यापि वस्तुन इच्छा न कर्तव्या॥ यथालाभसंतोषः॥ पर–मेश्वरनाम न विस्मरणीयम्॥ मनोमध्ये दैन्यं न कर्तव्यम्॥ इति नियमाः॥

Sources: 2–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 841): idānīṃ yogam aṣṭāṅgaṃ śṛṇu lakṣaṇasaṃyutam | 2–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 841) = YK 5.29–30ab: yamaś ca niyamaś caiva cāsanaṃ prāṇasaṃyamaḥ | pratyāhāro dhāraṇā ca samādhiś ca viśeṣataḥ | aṣṭāṅgayoga ebhis tu caiteṣāṃ lakṣaṇaṃ śṛṇu | 2–3 cf. SSP 2.32 (Ed. pp. 43–44): yamaniyamāsanaprāṇāyāmapratyāhāradhāraṇādhyānasamādhayaḥ 'ṣṭāṅgāni | 3–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 842): śāntiḥ santoṣa āhāro nidrālpā (*nidrālpaṃ* YK 5.30) manaso damaḥ | śūnyāntaḥkaraṇañ ceti (°*karaṇaś ceti* YK 5.31) yamā iti prakīrttitāḥ | 3–4 cf. SSP 2.32 (Ed. p. 44): tatra yama iti upaśamaḥ sarvendriyajayaḥ āhāranidrāśītavātātapajayaś caivaṃ śanaiḥ śanaiḥ sādhayet | 4–7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 841): cāpalyan tu dūre tyaktvā manaḥ sthairyyaṃ vidhāya ca | ekatra melanaṃ nityaṃ prāṇāmātre na sā matiḥ (*sāmabhiḥ* YK 5.32c) | sadodāsīnabhāvas tu sarvatrecchāvivarjanam (°*vivarjitaḥ* YK 5.32d)| yathālābhena santuṣṭaḥ parameśvaramānasaḥ | mānadānaparityāga ete tu niyamā iti | 4–7 cf. SSP 2.33 (PT, p. 44): niyama iti manovṛttināṃ niyamanam | iti ekāntavāso niḥsaṅgatā audāsīnyaṃ yathāprāptisaṃtuṣṭir vairāgyaṃ gurucaraṇāvarūḍhatvam iti niyamalakṣaṇam |

2 **idānīm** cett.] idānīṃ $N_2U_1U_2$ **°yogasya** cett.] °yoga° E **vicāraḥ** cett.] vicāra U_2 **kathyate** cett.] kathyate ‖ cha ‖ J **yamaniyamāsana°** cett.] yama nimāsana° K_1, yama ‖ niyama ‖ āsana ‖ J **prāṇāyāmapratyāhāra°** cett.] prāṇāyāma ‖ pratyāhāra | J 2–3 **°dhyānadhāraṇāsamādhir iti** PU_2E] °dhyānadhāraṇāsamādhiyaḥ N_2N_1, °dhyānadhāraṇāsamādhi DK_1U_1, dhyāna ‖ dhāraṇā ‖ samādhi ‖ J, °dhāraṇādhyānasamādhir iti LB 3 **kathyante** cett.] kathyate U_1 **śāntiḥ** Jγ] śānti° $N_2N_1DK_1U_1$ **ṣaṇṇām** JU_1E] °ṣaṇṇāṃ $N_2N_1DK_1L$, ṣaṇāṃ PB, °śaṇa U_2 **indriyāṇāṃ** cett.] iṃdriṇāṃ B 4 **āhāraḥ svalpaḥ** U_2] ahāraḥ svalpāḥ N_2, svalpāḥ N_1, āhāraḥ svalpāḥ DK_1, āhāraḥ sajayaḥ JU_1, ahāraḥ svalpaḥ PB, svalpāhāraḥ E, ahāraḥ‖ svalpaḥ ‖ L **nidrājayaḥ** cett.] nidrāyā jayaḥ JB, nidrāyāḥ jayaḥ U_2L **śaityajayaḥ** cett.] śītyajayaḥ N_1, śītoṣṇajayaḥ E **uṣṇajayaḥ** cett.] auṣṇājayaḥ U_1, uṣṇājayaḥ U_2B, *om.* E **ete** cett.] ya te LB **yamāḥ** cett.] yamāniyamāḥ P, yamaḥ LB **niyamāḥ** K_1E] niyamaḥ $N_2N_1DJU_1U_2$, *om.* PLB 5 **khalu** cett.] khalū $N_2U_1U_2$ **manaḥ** $N_2DK_1JU_1$] *om.* cett. **cāpala°** ELB] capala° β, cāpalā° PU_2 **nivārya** cett.] nivārye DK_1, nivāraya U_1, nirvārya PLB **sthairye** cett.] *om.* DK_1U_2LB **ekānte sevanam** N_1E] ekāṃtasevanam N_2, ekāṃtasevanaṃ $DK_1JU_1PU_2$, ekāṃtasevānāṃ LB 5–6 **samā buddhiḥ** cett.] samā buddhi U_1U_2 6 **audāsīnyaṃ** E] udāsīnya $N_2N_1DK_1$, udāsīnyāṃ JU_1U_2, udāsīnyam PLB **vastuna** PU_2E] vastunaḥ βLB **kartavyā** cett.] karttavyaṃ U_1U_2 6–7 **parameśvaranāma** cett.] parameśvaraḥ nāma U_1U_2 7 **na** cett.] *om.* $N_2N_1DK_1$J **vismaraṇīyam** N_1E] vismanīyam N_2, vismaraṇīyaṃ DK_1JU_1PLB, vismaraṇaṃ U_2 **manomadhye** cett.] mano na J, mano U_1, yaṃ mano madhye U_2 **na** βU_2] *om.* PELB **iti niyamāḥ** PE] *om.* β, iti niyamaḥ U_2LB

[XXXI. **Reflection of Aṣṭāṅgayoga**]

Now, the reflection of Aṣṭāṅgayoga[341] is explained: observances, restrictions, posture, breath control, withdrawal of the senses, meditation, concentration[342] and absorption. Their characteristics are taught.

Peace, mastery of the six senses,[343] little food, the conquest of sleep, the conquest of cold, [and] the conquest of heat.[344] These are the observances.

Now, the restrictions: the mind is to be restrained from the unsteady state [and] caused to be grounded in tranquillity, dwelling in a lonely place, maintaining equanimity towards all kinds of living beings, indifference, one shall not desire any object, contentment with whatever is obtained, never forgetting the name of the highest lord, [and] one shall not indulge in self-pity. These are the restrictions.

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[341] Given the extensive list of fifteen yogas presented at the beginning of this text does not contain *aṣṭāṅgayoga*, one wonders why this type of yoga suddenly appears and why it was not included within the list of methods of Rājayoga. Suffice it to say that he followed the structure of his main source text. A comparative analysis of the integration of Aṣṭāṅgayoga into the early modern complex yoga taxonomies can be found on p. 467.

[342] The reversed order of the sixth (*dhāraṇā*) and seventh (*dhyāna*) limb of the "classical" Pātañjalayoga model is striking (cf. *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* 2.29). Rāmacandra's main source text, the *Yogasvarodaya*, names *aṣṭāṅgayoga* but does not list *dhyāna* in the respective verse (cf. sources). The critical edition of the Lonavla Yoga Institute of *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* mentions two manuscripts (J_1 and J_2) with Rāmacandra's order. According to Vasudeva, 2004: 380–381, this reversed order frequently appears in yoga texts structured in *ṣaḍaṅga* or even *pañcāṅga* systems. It is found in *Jayākhyasaṃhitā* and *Maitrāyaṇīyopaniṣad*. Furthermore, it is present in the Śaiva *Rauravatantra*, *Kiraṇatantra*, *Mataṅgatantra*, as well as in Buddhist Tantras like the *Guhyasamājatantra* and *Kālacakratantra*. *Vāyupurāṇa* teaches this "reversed" order in its *pañcāṅga* schema. Powell, 2023: 168 mentions that he has not found an Aṣṭāṅgayoga system with *dhyāna* and *dhāraṇā* reversed outside of the *Śivayogapradīpikā* 2.1–9. Some witnesses of *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, *Tattvayogabindu* and implicitly the *Yogasvarodaya* as quoted in *Prāṇatoṣinī* and *Yogakarṇikā* can be added to this group. It appears that the source for this concept goes back to the Vīraśaiva milieu of the fifteenth century. For a useful table of the texts, including the reversed order, see Powell, 2023: 166.

[343] The sixth sense is the mental faculty (*manas* or *citta*), cf. White, 2021: 18.

[344] Rāmacandra presents a unique mix of his two primary sources: *Yogasvarodaya* lists peace (*śānti*), contentment (*santoṣa*), little sleep (*nidrālpa*), taming of the mind (*manaso dama*) and …

आसनस्य लक्षणं बहुग्रन्थेषु निरूपितमस्ति। तेनात्र न निरूप्यते। प्राणायामस्तु सुकुमारेण साधितुं न शक्यते। अतस्तस्य नाममात्रं कथ्यते। प्रत्याहारः कथ्यते। मनः संसारान्निवृत्यात्मनि स्थाप्यते। मनोमध्ये ये विकारा उत्पद्यन्ते। तेऽपि निवारणीयाः। अनेकचमत्कारिणी बुद्धिरुत्पद्यते। सा गोप्या। ध्यानं च बहुतरं प्रागुक्तं तेनात्र नोच्यते॥

Sources: 1 cf. YSv (PT, p. 841): āsanāni ca tāvanti yāvanto jīvajantavaḥ | SSP 2.34 (Ed. p. 44): āsanam iti svasvarūpe samāsannatā | svastikāsanaṃ padmāsanaṃ siddhāsanam eteṣāṃ madhye yatheṣṭam ekaṃ vidhāya sāvadhānena sthātavyam ity āsanalakṣaṇam | 1–2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 841): prāṇāyāmas tridhā ceti bahudhā prathamaṃ śṛṇu | āsane prāṇasaṃyāme na śaktāḥ sukumārakāḥ | mahāpuṇyaprabhāveṇa śakyate tu mahātmanā | 1–2 cf. SSP 2.45 (Ed. p. 45): prāṇāyāma iti prāṇasya sthiratā | recakapūrakakumbhakasaṅghaṭṭakaraṇāni catvāri prāṇāyāmalakṣaṇāni | 2–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 841) = YK 7.6–7: kṛtvā kalevaraṃ śuddhaṃ kuryād yatnair mahātmanā | mano nivārya saṃsāre viṣayeṣu tathaiva ca | manovikārān sarvāṃś ca tyaktvā śūnyamayo bhavet | pratyāhāro bhavaty eṣu sarvanindācamatkṛtaḥ | 2–4 cf. SSP 2.36 (Ed. p. 45): pratyāhāra iti caitanyaturaṅgānāṃ pratyāharaṇaṃ vikāragrasanaṃ utpannavikārasyāpi nivṛttir nirbhātīti pratyāhāralakṣaṇām | 4–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 841) = YK 7.8: dhyānan tu dvividhaṃ proktaṃ sthūlasūkṣmavibhedataḥ | sthūlaṃ mantramayaṃ viddhi sūkṣman tu mantravarjjitam | 4–5 cf. SSP 2.38 (Ed. p. 46): atha dhyānam | asti kaścana paramādvaitasya bhāvaḥ | sa evātmeti yathā yad yat sphurati tattatsvarūpam eveti bhāvayet | sarvabhūteṣu samadṛṣṭiś ca | iti dhyānalakṣaṇam |

1 **āsanasya lakṣaṇaṃ** β] āsanalakṣaṇaṃ PEL, āsanalakṣaṇaṃ tu U_2, āsanaṃ lakṣaṇāṃ B **bahugrantheṣu** U_2] bahūgraṃthe β, bahuṣu graṃtheṣu PE, bahūgrantheṣu LB **nirūpitam** PU_2E] nirūpitam | $N_2N_1DK_1J$, nirūpitam tan U_1, nirūpyam LB **asti** γ] *om.* K_1, ataḥ cett. **tenātra** γ] atrāyaṃ $N_2N_1K_1$, atratyaṃ D, atra JU_1 **na** U_1PE] *om.* cett. 2 **sukumāreṇa** PE] kūmāreṇa puruṣeṇa $N_2N_1DU_1$, sukumāreṇa puruṣeṇa K_1J, kūmāreṇa U_2, kumāreṇa LB **atas tasya** U_1PE] ata tasya N_2, ataḥ tasya N_1DK_1J, atā tasya U_2, ataḥ LB **nāmamātraṃ** N_1PU_2E] nāmamātre $N_2DK_1JU_1$, nāma LB **kathyate** γ] kathitaṃ $N_2N_1DJU_1$, kathitāṃ K_1 **kathyate** cett.] pratyato E 3 **nivṛtyātmani** em.] nivṛtya ātmani $N_2N_1DK_1J$, nivṛtyātmanī U_1PU_2LB, nivartyātmani E **sthāpyate** cett.] *om.* N_2 **vikārā** cett.] *om.* N_2, vikārāḥ DK_1, vikāraḥ P **utpadyante** cett.] *om.* N_2 **te 'pi** cett.] *om.* N_2 3–4 **nivāraṇīyāḥ** cett.] vāraṇīyāḥ N_2, nivāraṇīyaḥ U_1U_2, nivāraṇīyā LB 4 **anekacamatkāriṇī** cett.] anekacamatkārakarakāraṇī N_2N_1, anekacamatkārakāraṇī DK_1J **buddhir** cett.] buddhi $N_2N_1DK_1$ **utpadyate** cett.] utpadyate DU_2EB, utpadyataraṃ P **sā gopyā** U_2LB] sāṃgopyāḥ $N_2N_1DK_1J$, sā gaupyā U_1, *om.* P, sāṃgopāṃgaṃ E **dhyānaṃ** cett.] *om.* P **ca** cett.] *om.* JU_1PU_2 **bahutaraṃ** cett.] *om.* P **prāg** γ] *om.* β **uktaṃ** $DK_1JU_1U_2$] uktam | E, uktam cett. 5 **tenātra** cett.] tena atra $N_1DK_1JU_1$ **nocyate** cett.] na ucyate U_1

The characteristic of posture has been discussed in many works. For that reason, it is not discussed here.

Young persons cannot practise breath control. That is why it is just mentioned by name.[345]

Withdrawal of the senses is taught. The mind is supposed to be turned away from cyclic existence and caused to abide in the self. The changes that arise within the mind should also be restrained. An intellect that is capable of creating many wonders arises. This is to be kept secret.

Meditation has been taught many times before [in this text]. Because of that, it is not discussed here.[346]

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emptiness of the inner organ (*śūnyāntaḥkaraṇa*). *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* lists: tranquillity (*upaśama*), mastery of all senses (*sarvendriyajaya*), and conquest of food, sleep, cold, wind, heat (*ahāranidrāśītavātātapajaya*).

[345] It is crucial to note here that *Yogasvarodaya* states that young persons are not qualified to practice posture and breath control, but that, by the power of great merit a great soul becomes capable, cf. *Yogakarṇikā* quoted with reference *yogasvarodaye* 7.2 (*āsane prāṇasaṃyāme na śaktāḥ sukumārakāḥ | mahāpuṇyaprabhāveṇa śakyate tu mahātmanā |*). Right after that statement, the text continues to present detailed instructions for eight *kumbhaka*s, cf. *Yogakarṇikā* quoted with reference *yogasvarodaye* 7.3–10, 7.23–24 and 7.68–72. The whole extent of *Yogasvarodaya*'s teaching on *prāṇāyāma* cannot be determined since it is absent in the quotes of *Prāṇatoṣinī* and is just partially quoted in *Yogakarṇikā*. It seems that Rāmacandra, who previously strictly followed the structure of the *Yogasvarodaya*, consciously decided to exclude these teachings for the reason he gives here. Therefore, he probably directly alludes to part of his audience: *sukumāra*s, young persons, or, considering all previous allusions to a wealthy and royal lifestyle, young courtiers and princes.

[346] Rāmacandra perhaps refers to the teaching of the nine *cakra*s and other sections of the text in which meditation is mentioned. The same schema is already found in the *dhyāna* descriptions of *Śivayogapradīpika* 3.4–33, cf. Powell, 2023: 165, 212–215. He might also hint at the various methods he subsumes under Lakṣayoga. Most likely, Rāmacandra consciously decided to skip a description of *samādhi*, since *Prāṇatoṣinī* quoted with reference *Yogasvarodaye* (Ed. p. 841) defines *samādhi* as follows: *samādhir niścalā buddhiḥ śvāsocchvāsādivarjitaḥ |* "Samādhi is the immovable intellect devoid of inhalation, exhalation, etc.". If, indeed, one purpose of Rāmacandra's text was to teach Rājayoga to young courtiers or princes, surely children would not be taught that the highest level of yoga is accomplished by stopping breathing altogether.

[XXXII. **piṇḍabrahmāṇḍayor aikyam**]

इदानीं पिण्डब्रह्माण्डयोरैक्यमस्ति। तस्मात्ब्रह्माण्डमध्ये ये पदार्थास्तेऽपि पिण्ड–मध्ये सन्ति। ते कथ्यन्ते। पादयोरङ्गुष्ठतले तलं वर्तते। तदुपरि तलातलं वर्तते। गुल्फयोर्महातलं वर्तते। जङ्घामध्ये सुतलं वर्तते। जान्वोर्मध्ये वितलं वर्तते। ऊ–
5 र्वोर्मध्येऽतलं वर्तते॥

Sources: 2–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 841): piṇḍabrahmāṇḍayor aikyaṃ śṛṇv idānīṃ prayatnataḥ | brahmāṇḍe santi ye cāṇḍāḥ piṇḍamadhye 'pi te sthitāḥ | 2–3 cf. SSP 3.1 (Ed. p. 28): piṇḍa-madhye carācaraṃ yo jānāti sa yogī piṇḍasaṃvittir bhavati| 3–5 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 841–842): talaṃ pādāṅguṣṭhatale tasyopari talātalam | mahātalaṃ gulphayor madhye gulphopari rasā-talam | sutalaṃ jaṅghayor madhye vitalaṃ jānumadhyakam | ūrvor madhye 'talaṃ proktaṃ saptapātālam īritam | talaṃ talātalañ ceti mahātalarasātalam | saptapātālam etat tu sutalaṃ vitalātalam | 3–5 cf. SSP 3.1–2 (Ed. pp. 48–49): kūrmaṅ pādatale vasati | pātālaṃ pādāṅguṣṭhe | talātalam aṅguṣṭhāgre | mahātalaṃ pādapṛṣṭhe | rasātalaṃ gulphe | sutalaṃ jaṅghāyāṃ | vitalaṃ jānvoḥ | atalam ūrvoḥ |

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2 **piṇḍa°** cett.] piḍa° N_1DK_1 **brahmāṇḍayor** JPELB] °brahmāḍayoḥ $N_2N_1DK_1$, brahmāḍayor U_1U_2 **aikyam** cett.] ekam N_2, ekyam B **asti** cett.] asti ‖ cha ‖ J **tasmāt** cett.] tasmānte N_2, tasmā B **padārthās** cett.] padārthā N_2U_1, padārthāḥ N_1DK_1 **te 'pi** cett.] sarve pi U_1, te PLB, tanmadhye U_2 3 **santi** cett.] sati U_2B, santīti E, saṃ° L **te** $N_2N_1DK_1$] *om.* cett. **kathyante** cett.] kathyate U_1PB **pādayor** cett.] pādayos PL, pādayo° U_2, padas E, pādayas B **aṅguṣṭatale** em.] aṃguṣṭale $N_2N_1DK_1$J, aṃguṣṭatale U_1, tele P, °ṃguṣṭatale U_2, tale E, tālas LB **talaṃ** cett.] talaṃ ca U_1, mūlaṃ rasātalāt U_2 **tadupari** J] tādupari $N_2N_1DK_1$, taduparī U_1, pādopari γ **vartate** cett.] vartate | pādopari talaṃ vartate P 4 **gulphayor** γ] gulpho β **mahātalaṃ** γ] parimahātalaṃ β **jaṅghā°** cett.] *om.* P, jaghā° U_2 **sutalaṃ** cett.] *om.* P, stuta-laṃ B **vartate** U_2ELB] *om.* cett. **jānvormadhye** DK_1JU_1] jānvomadhye N_2N_1, jānumadhye PU_2E, jānubhyāṃ LB **vartate** ELB] *om.* cett. 5 **'talaṃ** E] atalaṃ cett. **vartate** ELB] *om.* cett.

[XXXII. **Identity of the universe and the body**]

Now, there is the identity of the universe and the body.[347] Because of that, the objects that exist in the universe are also in the body. They are taught.

Tala exists at the base of the big toe[s] of the feet. On top of the feet exists Talātala. Mahātala exists at the ankles.[348] Sutala exists within the lower leg. Vitala exists within the knees. Atala exists within the two thighs.[349]

[347] The concept of the body as a microcosmic manifestation of a macrocosmic universe is a common feature in yogic literature, see Mallinson and Singleton, 2017: 174–178.

[348] A description of *rasātala* is missing in the *Tattvayogabindu*. Either this item in the enumeration was lost in transmission or we must assume an authorial mistake. A phrase like "*gulphopari rasātalaṃ vartate |*" would be expected at this point of the text. Both source texts Rāmacandra used describe *rasātala* right after the description of *mahātala*.

[349] Hindu cosmography, as described in various *Purāṇa*s, the *Atharvaveda*, etc., assumes fourteen worlds (*loka*s), seven higher ones (*vyāhṛti*s) and seven lower ones (*pātāla*s). The higher *loka*s (1–7) are described as the heavens, populated by mortals, celestial or divine beings, gods and higher gods, and full of truth. The lower *loka*s (8–14), which are here mapped onto the human body, constitute the different "hells" and are the abode of the *nāga*s or serpents and demons, cf. Haag, 2011: 503–504. According to Patañjali in his *bhāṣya* on *Yogasūtra* 3.26, the beings residing in their respective *loka*s experience the fruit of their *karma*. Residence in those abodes, however, is never eternal but lasts until the particular individual's *karma* has been exhausted and has borne its due fruit (Bryant, 2009: 353). A well-known depiction that shows the mapping of the *loka*s onto the body is Viṣṇu Viśvarūpa, India, Rajasthan, Jaipur, ca. 1800–1820 in the Victoria and Albert Museum, see p. 490. Directly related to the *Tattvayogabindu* is the depiction of a Siddha's body that shows the equivalence of the self and the universe in the manuscript of *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* located in Mehragarh Museum Jodhpur, see p. 491.

[XXXIII. **piṇḍamadhye lokatrayam**]

इदानीं पिण्डमध्ये लोकत्रयं कथ्यते। मूलाधारे भूर्लोकः। लिङ्गाग्रे भुवर्लोकः। लिङ्गमूले स्वर्लोकः॥

[XXXIV. **uparitanaṃ lokacatuṣkam**]

इदानीमुपरितनं लोकचतुष्कं कथ्यते। पृष्ठदण्डाङ्कुरे महर्लोकः। दण्डछिद्रमध्ये जनलोकः। तद्दण्डनालीमध्येतपोलोकः। दण्डकमलमध्ये सत्यलोकः॥

Sources: 2–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 842): idānīṃ piṇḍamadhye tu saptalokaṃ śṛṇu priye | mūlādhāre tu bhūrloko liṅgāgre tu bhuvas tataḥ | svarloko liṅgamūle tu merumūle mahas tathā | 2–3 cf. SSP 3.3 (Ed. p. 49): bhūrloko guhyasthāne bhuvarloko liṅgasthāne svarlokaṃ nābhisthāne evaṃ lokatraye indro devatā piṇḍamadhye sarvendriyaniyāmakaḥ sa evendraḥ | 5–6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 842): merucchidre janaloko merunāḍyāṃ tapas tathā | kamale marttyalokas tu iti lokaḥ pṛthak pṛthak | bhūrbhuvaḥsvarmahaś ceti janaś caiva tapas tathā | saptamaḥ satyalokas tu saptaloka iti smṛtaḥ | saptalokais tu pātālair bhuvanāni caturdaśa | 5–6 cf. SSP 3.4 (Ed. p. 49): daṇḍāṅkure maharlokaḥ daṇḍakuhare janolokaḥ | daṇḍanāle tapolokaḥ | mūlakamale satyalokaḥ |

2 **idānīṃ** cett.] idānīṃ upari tataṃ lokaṃ U_1 **piṇḍamadhye** cett.] śarīramadhye E, piṃḍopari L, piḍopiri B **liṅgāgre** cett.] liṃgamūle N_2N_1 **bhuvarlokaḥ** $DK_1JU_1PU_2E$] *om.* N_2N_1, bhuvarloka° LB 2–3 **liṅgamūle** $N_2N_1JU_1PU_2$] liṅgamadhye DK_1LB 3 **svarlokaḥ** cett.] svargalokaḥ N_2, svaravarlokaḥ U_1 5 **idānīm** PELB] idānīṃ βU_2 **uparitanaṃ** cett.] uparijanaṃ N_2N_1, uparitanu° PB, uparitana° U_2L **lokacatuṣkaṃ** cett.] lokaṃ catuṣkaṃ U_1, lokacatuṣka E, lokaḥ catuṣṭayaṃ LB **pṛṣṭhadaṇḍāṅkure** cett.] pṛṣṭhadaṃḍākūle N_2, pṛṣṭhadaṃḍākūre P, daṃḍaṣṭaṭheṃkure L, daṃḍaṣṭaṭheṃskure B **maharlokaḥ** cett.] maharlokā B **daṇḍachidra°** cett.] daṃḍasthita° U_1, daṃḍaschidra° P, uchidra° U_2 5–6 **janalokaḥ** cett.] janaloka LB 6 **taddaṇḍa°** cett.] daṇḍa° U_2 **°nālīmadhye** em.] °nālī N_2N_1, °nālamadhye DJ, °nālimadhye K_1PU_2, °nāḍīmadhye U_1E, °tālikāmadhye L, °nālikāmadhye B **tapolokaḥ** cett.] polokaḥ B **daṇḍakamalamadhye** cett.] daṇḍamalamadhye U_1E

Notes: 6 **taddaṇḍanāḍīmadhye …**: After section XXXIV up until section XLVIII, approximately 25% of the entire text disappears in two important witnesses of the β-group. The two Nepalese manuscripts N_1 and N_2 exhibit a substantial lacuna, which suggests their close affiliation. They must both be derived from the same exemplar or from each other. The omissions of the text of N_1 and N_2 will not be documented in the apparatus until after their respective *lacunae* to prevent an unnecessarily inflated critical apparatus with entries for every omitted word. The reader will be informed in this register of the apparatus once their evidence resumes.

[XXXIII. **Triad of worlds**]

Now, the triad of worlds within the body is taught.[350] The earth realm (*bhūrloka*) is situated at the root support (*mūlādhāra*). The atmosphere (*bhuvarloka*) is at the tip of the penis. Heaven (*svarloka*) is at the base of the penis.

[XXXIV. **Upper tetrad of worlds**]

Now, the upper tetrad of worlds is taught. The world of greatness (*maharloka*) is located at the sprout of the staff of the back. The world of men (*janaloka*) is within the opening of the spine.[351] In the centre of the tube of that spine is the world of ascetic heat (*tapoloka*). Within the lotus of the spine is the world of truth (*satyaloka*).[352]

[350] The earliest conception of the equation of the cosmos with the body is found in *Ṛgveda* 10,90. This concept becomes linked with yogic practice in subsequent Hindu traditions. According to the *Bhagavadgītā* and the *Kūrma Purāṇa*, the deities Viṣṇu and Śiva are described as engaging in the practice of yoga. During this practice, they assimilate all external aspects by either encompassing the entire universe within their cosmic bodies or by engulfing everything, see White, 2011:88. For a detailed exposition of the Purāṇic concept of the universe in Patañjali's yoga, see the commentaries on *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* 3.25, e.g., Mukerji, 1983:297–304 or Bryant, 2009:353–356. The idea of situating the universe into the yogic body is carried forward into the traditions of Haṭha- and Rājayoga and becomes a substantial constituent of their worldview, cf. *Amṛtasiddhi* 15–19. For a collection of references to the yogic body, see Mallinson and Singleton 2017: 171–227.

[351] The localisation of the upper tetrad of worlds occurs along the spine, which is imagined as a lotus. While the *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* locate *maharloka* at the sprout (°*aṅkūre*) of the spine, in the *Yogasvarodaya* we read about the root (°*mūle*) of the spine. The next world *janaloka* is at the opening (°*chidra*°) of the spine. In the context of the comparison of the spine to a lotus, this must be the rhizome of the lotus because the tube of the stem grows from it. I want to thank Mallinson for this hint. This rhizome is likely the root-bulb mentioned in *Tattvayogabindu* III, from which the central channel emerges. The *satyaloka* within the lotus of the spine may be the lotus of the eighth or ninth *cakra* (section XI–XII).

[352] For extensive accounts of Hindu cosmography and the inhabitants of the various spheres of the cosmos, see Kirfel's study of Purāṇic cosmography, *Bhāgavatapurāṇa* 5.16–26, and, more generally, Kirfel's *Das Purāṇa Pañcalakṣaṇa*.

[XXXV. **catvāro lokasvāminaḥ**]

अथ ब्रह्माण्डमध्ये चत्वारो लोकस्वामिनः। तेऽपि पिण्डमध्ये वर्तन्ते। शरीरमध्ये द्वे कुक्षौ॥ द्वे शक्तिन्योः॥ वक्षःस्थले॥ कण्ठमूले॥ कण्ठमध्ये॥ लंबिकाया मूले॥ तालुद्वारे॥ तालुमध्ये॥ ललाटे॥

Sources: 2–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 842): atha brahmāṇḍamadhyasthāś catvāro lokapālakāḥ | piṇḍamadhye tu tān jñātvā sarvasiddhīśvaro bhavet | indro brahmā viṣṇur īśaś catvāraś cātmadevatāḥ | mūlādhāre catuṣpatre gajārūḍho mahān iti | sṛṣṭikarttā ca tatraiva svādhiṣṭhāne mahān hariḥ | maṇipūre śūlapāṇir aṣṭasiddhīśvaro mahān | tāludvāre tālumadhye lalāṭe vakṣakaṇṭhake | 2–4 cf. SSP 3.4–5 (Ed. pp. 50–52): evaṃ lokacatuṣṭaye brahmā devatā | piṇḍamadhye anekamānābhimānasvarūpī tiṣṭhati | viṣṇulokaḥ kukṣau tiṣṭhati | tatra viṣṇur devatā | piṇḍamadhye 'nekavyāpārakārako bhavati | hṛdaye rudralokaḥ | tatra rudro devatā | piṇḍamadhya ugrasvarūpī tiṣṭhati | vakṣaḥsthala īśvaralokaḥ tatreśvaro devatā | piṇḍamadhye tṛptisvarūpī tiṣṭhati | kaṇṭhamūle sadāśivalokaḥ tatra sadāśivo devatā piṇḍamadhye saumyarūpī tiṣṭhati | kaṇṭhamadhye nīlakaṇṭhalokaḥ tatra nīlakaṇṭho devatā | piṇḍamadhye 'bhayasvarūpī tiṣṭhati | tāludvāre śivalokaḥ | tatra śivo devatā | piṇḍamadhye 'nupamasvarūpī tiṣṭhati | lambikāmūle bhairavalokaḥ | tatra bhairavo devatā | piṇḍamadhye sarvottamasvarūpī tiṣṭhati | tatrābhyantare mahāsiddhalokaḥ | tatra mahāsiddhadevatā | piṇḍamadhye prabodhasvarūpī tiṣṭhati | lalāṭamadhye 'nādilokaḥ | lalāṭamadhye 'nādilokaḥ | tatrānādir devatā | piṇḍamadhya ānandaparāhantāsvarūpī tiṣṭhati |

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2 **catvāro** DK_1JU_1] caturdaśa° cett. **lokasvāminaḥ** DK_1J] lokāḥ svāminaḥ U_1, °lokāsthānāni PLB, °lokāḥ stānāni U_2, °lokāni sthānāni E **te 'pi** DK_1JU_1] tānyapi cett. **piṇḍamadhye** DK_1JU_1] piḍe P, piṇḍe U_2ELB **vartante** E] vartate cett. 3 **dve kukṣau** em.] dvau kukṣīnau DK_1J, dvau kukṣīṇau U_1, dvau kukṣī PU_2E, dvau kukṣau LB **dve śaktinyoḥ** Sellmer conj.] vartate DK_1JU_1, dve sakṭhinī PB, dve sakthinī U_2EL **vakṣaḥsthale** em.] vakṣasthale DK_1JU_1, vakṣaḥschalaṃ P, vakṣassthalaṃ U_2, vakṣaḥ sthalaṃ EB **kaṇṭhamūle** U_2L] kaṃṭhasya mūle DK_1JU_1, kaṃṭhamūlaṃ PEB **kaṇṭhamadhye** DK_1JU_1] kaṃṭhamadhyaḥ PU_2, kaṃṭhamadhyaṃ EL, kamardhye B **laṃbikāyā mūle** DK_1JU_1] laṃbikāmūlaṃ γ 4 **tāludvāre** DK_1JU_1] tāludvāraṃ γ **tālumadhye** DK_1JU_1] tālumadhyaṃ γ **lalāṭe** DK_1JU_1] lalāṭamadhyaṃ PU_2LB, lalāṭamadhye E

[XXXV. **Lords of the world**]

Now, there are four lords (1–4) of the worlds in the universe.[353] They also exist in the body. [Other deities and worlds exist within the body][354] two in the belly (5–6), two in the thighs (7–8), at the location of the chest (9), at the pit of the throat (10), in the centre of the throat (11), at the root of the uvula (12), at the entrance of the palate (13), at the forehead (14),...[355]

[353]Only the reading of D, J, *K1* and U_1 (β-group) is plausible and *lectio dificilior*. The source text confirms this; the *Yogasvarodaya* introduces the *lokapālakāḥ*, which Rāmacandra renders as *lokasvāminaḥ*. In the γ-group, the subject was not understood and rewritten in an attempt to fix the passage.

[354]I decided to add the words in the square brackets to derive the most probable sense of the list of locations based on the source texts.

[355]Rāmacandra greatly simplifies his source texts at this point. The parallel passages in the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* provide much more detail. The background of what Rāmacandra wants to express lies somewhere between the two sources available to him (see sources in the first layer of the *apparatus criticus*). I translate the respective passage in the *Prāṇatoṣinī* quoted with reference *Yogasvarodaye* (Ed. p. 842) as follows: "There are now four world world guardians amid the external universe. Having recognised these within the body, the supreme ruler (of the body?) may be fully successful. Indra, Brahmā, Viṣṇu, and Īśa are the deities of the body (*ātman*). (1) In the four-petalled Mūlādhāra-[cakra] is the great one who is seated on an elephant (Indra). (2) There at Svādiṣṭhāna is the Creator, the great Hari (Viṣṇu). (3) In the Maṇipūra is the one with the trident in hand, the great lord of the eight supernatural powers (Śiva). (4) at the gate of the palate, (5) amid the palate, (6) on the forehead, (7) in the chest and (8) throat, (9) at the junction in the skull, and at (10) the uvula, (11) as well as at the opening of Brahman and (20) at the nine *cakra*s, upper *cakra* and (21) at the triple peak. They are in the 21 worlds and must be realised in detail." The passage of *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 3.4–5 reveals further details of the physical locations listed by Rāmacandra: "Thus, Brahmā is the deity within the fourfold world. He resides in the body in various forms of self-esteem and pride. The world of Viṣṇu is situated in the belly (*kukṣau*). Viṣṇu is the deity there. In the body, he manifests as the performer of various forms of activity. In the heart is the world of Rudra. Rudra is the deity there. Within the body, he resides in the form of strength. In the location of the chest (*vakṣaḥsthale*) is the world of Īśvara. Īśvara is the deity there. Within the body, he exists in the form of contentment. At the root of the throat (*kaṇṭhamūle*) is the world of Sadāśiva. Sadāśiva is the deity there. Within the body, he exists in the form of being...

शृङ्गाटिकायाम्॥ कपालमध्ये॥ कमलिनीमध्ये॥ ब्रह्मरन्ध्रे॥ ऊर्ध्वकमलिन्यां त्रिकूटस्थाने॥ एवमेकविंशस्थानेष्वेकविंशतिब्रह्माण्डानि वसन्ति॥

[XXXVI. **saptadvīpāni piṇḍamadhye**]

इदानीं सप्तद्वीपानि पिण्डमध्ये कथ्यन्ते। मज्जामध्ये जम्बुद्वीपः॥ अस्थिमध्ये शाकद्वीपः॥ शिरोमध्ये शाल्मलिद्वीपः॥ मांसमध्ये कुशद्वीपः॥ त्वचामध्ये क्रौञ्चद्वीपः॥ शरीरस्य लोममध्ये गोमयद्वीपः॥ नखमध्ये श्वेतद्वीपः॥ एतानि द्वीपानि गुप्तानि देहमध्ये तिष्ठन्ति॥

Sources: 1–2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 842): śṛṅgāṭikā kapāle ca lambikā brahmarandhrake | navacakram ūrddhvacakrañ ca trikūṭety ekaviṃśatiḥ | brahmāṇḍāni vasantīti jñātavyāni prayatnataḥ | 1–2 cf. SSP 3.4–5 (Ed. pp. 52–53): śṛṅgāṭe kulalokaḥ | tatra kuleśvaro devatā | piṇḍamadhya ānandasvarūpī tiṣṭhati | śaṅkhamadhye nalinīsthāne 'kuleśalokaḥ | tatra akuleśvaro devatā | piṇḍamadhye nirabhimānāvasthā tiṣṭhati | brahmarandhre parabrahmalokaḥ | tatra parabrahma devatā | piṇḍamadhye paripūrṇadaśā tiṣṭhati | ūrdhvakamale parāparalokaḥ | tatra parameśvaro devatā | piṇḍamadhye parāparabhāvas tiṣṭhati | trikūṭasthāne śaktilokaḥ | tatra parāśaktir devatā | piṇḍamadhye 'sti vāvasthā sarvāsāṃ sarvakartṛtvāvasthā tiṣṭhati | evaṃ piṇḍamadhye saptapātālasahitaikaviṃśatibrahmāṇḍasthānavicāraḥ | 4–7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 842): sapta dvīpāni kathyante 'dhunā tāni śṛṇu priye | jambūdvīpas tu majjāyāṃ śākadvīpas tu madhyamaḥ | śālmadvīpaḥ śiromadhye māṃsamadhye kuśas tathā | tvaci krauñco lomamadhye gomayadvīpa īritaḥ | nakhamadhye tathā śvetaḥ saptadvīpā vasundharā | jambūḥ śākas tathā śālmaḥ kuśaḥ krauñcaś ca gomayaḥ | śvetaḥ sapteti khaṇḍāni saptakhaṇḍair vasundharā | guptāny etāni rūpāṇi dehamadhye sthirāṇi ca | 4–7 cf. SSP 3.7 (Ed. p. 54): majjāyāṃ jambūdvīpaḥ | asthiṣu śākadvīpaḥ | śirāsu sūkṣmadvīpaḥ | tvakṣu krauñcadvīpaḥ | romasu gomayadvīpaḥ | nakheṣu śvetadvīpaḥ | māṃse plakṣadvīpaḥ | evaṃ saptadvīpāḥ |

1 **śṛṅgāṭikāyām** DJU$_1$] śṛgāṭikāyāṃ K$_1$, śṛṃgāṭikā γ **kapālamadhye** em.] karālamadhye L, kapolamadhye cett. **kamalinīmadhye** cett.] kamalinīmadhyaṃ LB **brahmarandhre** DK$_1$JU$_1$] brahmaraṃdhraṃ PU$_2$LB, brahmaraṃdhra° E 1–2 **ūrdhvakamalinyāṃ trikūṭasthāne** Birch em.] ūrdhvakamalinyaḥ ‖ trikūṭasthāne ‖ saptapātāle DJ, ūrdhvakamalinyāḥ ‖ trikūṭasthāne | saptapātāle K$_1$, urdhvakamalinyaḥ trikūṭasthāne U$_1$, ūrdhvaṃ kamalīnyā trikūṭasthānam PL, urdhvakamalinyās trikūṭasthānam U$_2$, kamalinyas trikūṭasthānam E, kamalīnyāṃ strikūṭasthānam B 2 **evam** DK$_1$JPU$_2$E] *om.* U$_1$, ekam LB **ekaviṃśasthāneṣv** P] ekaviṃśatisthāne DK$_1$JE, *om.* U$_1$, ekaviṃśasthān U$_2$, ekaṃ viṃśasthāneṣv L, ekaṃ viṃśasthānek° B **ekaviṃśatibrahmāṇḍāni** DK$_1$U$_1$E] ekaviṃśatibrahmāḍāni J, ekaviṃśabrahmāni P, ekaviṃśabrahmāṇḍāni U$_2$, ekaviṃśabrahmāḍānī LB **vasanti** cett.] vasaṃtī LB 4 **idānīṃ** DK$_1$JU$_1$PU$_2$EL] idānī B **saptadvīpāni** DK$_1$JU$_1$PU$_2$EL] satyadvīpāni B **kathyante** DK$_1$JU$_1$PU$_2$E] kathyate LB **jambu** cett.] jaṃbū P **asthi°** DK$_1$JE] asti° U$_1$U$_2$LB, asthī° P 4–5 **śākadvīpaḥ** cett.] śāktidvīpaḥ JU$_1$, śākaladvīpaḥ LB 5 **śiromadhye** cett.] śirāmadhye PEB, śarīramadhye L **śālmalidvīpaḥ** cett.] śālmalīdvīpaḥ U$_2$, śākadvīpaḥ L, śākaladvīpaḥ B 6 **lomamadhye** cett.] lomadhye U$_1$U$_2$ **gomayadvīpaḥ** DK$_1$JU$_1$] gomedadvīpaḥ cett. **nakha°** cett.] naṣa° K$_1$, tarava° U$_1$L **śvetadvīpaḥ** DK$_1$JU$_1$] puṣkaradvīpaḥ cett. **dvīpāni** cett.] rūpaṇi DK$_1$JU$_1$ 7 **guptāni** PU$_2$LB] gupta° DK$_1$JU$_1$, *om.* E **dehamadhye** Birch conj.] °madhye DK$_1$JU$_1$, madhye PU$_2$ELB

at the junction (15), in the middle of the skull (16), at the centre of the lotus pond (17), at the aperture of Brahman (18), and at the place of the three peaks above the lotus (19–21). Thus, the 21 worlds reside in 21 locations.

[XXXVI. **Seven continents within the body**]

Now, the seven continents within the body[356] are taught.[357]
(1) Within the marrow is the continent [called] Jambu. (2) Within the bones is the continent [called] Śāka. (3) In the head is the continent [called] Śālmali. (4) In the flesh is the continent [called] Kuśa. (5) Within the skin is the continent [called] Krauñca. (6) Within the body hair is the continent [called] Gomaya. (7) In the nails is the continent [called] Śveta. These hidden continents are situated within the body.[358]

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beneficial. In the centre of the throat (*kaṇṭhamadhye*) is the world of Nīlakaṇṭha. Nīlakaṇṭha is the deity there. In the body, he exists in the form of fearlessness. At the entrance of the uvula (*tāludvāre*) is the world of Śiva. There, Śiva is the deity. Within the body, he exists in his matchless form. At the root of the uvula (*lambikāmūle*) is the world of Bhairava. There, Bhairava is the deity. In the body, he exists in the most excellent form. Therein is the world of Mahāsiddha. Mahāsiddha is the deity there. In the body, he exists in the form of awakening. Within the forehead (*lalāṭamadhye*) is the world of Anādi. Anādi is the deity there. Within the body, he is situated in the form of the blissful supreme destroyer. At the crossroads of the three paths (*śṛṅgāṭe*) is the world of the Kula. There, the Kuleśvara is the deity. Within the body, he resides in the form of bliss. Within the temple (*śaṅkhamadhye*) at the location of Nalinī is the World of Akuleśa. There, Akuleśvara is the deity. Within the body, he resides in the state of being free from pride, at the aperture of Brahman (*brahmarandhre*), the world of Parabrahman. There, Parabrahman is the deity. Within the body, he resides in a state of completeness. At the upper lotus (*ūrdhvakamale*) is the world of Parāpara. There, Parameśvara is the deity. Within the body, he exists as the state of Parāpara. At the place of the three peaks (*trikūṭasthāne*) is the world of Śakti. There, Parāśakti is the deity. Within the body, she exists in the existential state for all and the all-creative state. Thus, that is the examination of the locations of the external universe consisting of 21 worlds and seven hells within the body." It is fascinating that he refrains from mentioning the various deities, which once again underlines Rāmacandra's secularizing and simplifying agenda he follows in his text.

[356] *Haṭharatnāvalī* 4.39 identifies the seven continents with the seven *dhātu*s.

[357] The world of earth (*bhūrloka*) consists of seven continents and seven oceans.

[358] The diagnostic conjecture "*dehamadhye*" is based on the reading of *Yogasvarodaya*.

[XXXVII. **piṇḍamadhye saptasamudrāḥ**]

इदानीं पिण्डमध्ये सप्तसमुद्राः कथ्यन्ते। प्रस्वेदमध्ये क्षारसमुद्रः॥ ललाटमध्ये क्षीरसमुद्रः॥ वसामध्ये मधुसमुद्रः॥ कफमध्ये दधिसमुद्रः॥ मेदोमध्ये घृतसमुद्रः॥ रक्तमध्ये इक्षुसमुद्रः॥ वीर्यमध्येऽमृतसमुद्रः॥ पादमध्ये कूर्मस्थानम्॥

Sources: 2–4 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 842–843): samudrāḥ sapta kathyante piṇḍamadhye vyavasthitāḥ | lavaṇekṣusurāsarpirdadhidugdhajalāntakāḥ | lavaṇaṃ svedamadhye tu ikṣūrakte madhu tvaci | sarpir medo vasāmadhye dadhi kṣīraṃ lalāṭake | vīryamadhye 'mṛto jñeyaḥ pāde kūrmaḥ sthito mahān | 2–4 cf. SSP 3.8 (Ed. p. 29): mūrte kṣārasamudraḥ | śukre 'mṛtasamudraḥ | lālāyāṃ kṣīrasamudraḥ | kaphe dadhisamudraḥ | medasi ghṛtasamudraḥ | vasāyāṃ madhusamudraḥ | rakte ikṣusamudraḥ | evaṃ saptasamudrāḥ ||

2 **saptasamudrāḥ** cett.] samudrāḥ LB **kathyante** cett.] kathyete D, kathyate B **prasvedamadhye** cett.] svedamadhye U_1 **kṣārasamudraḥ** cett.] kṣārasasamudra DK_1, kṣārasasamudraḥ JU_1, kṣārasāgaraḥ U_2, sārasasamudraḥ L **lalāṭamadhye** cett.] lālāmadhye P 3 **kṣīrasamudraḥ** cett.] kṣīraḥ samudraḥ E **vasāmadhye** cett.] vīryamadhye svāduḥ samudraḥ ‖ majjāmadhye U_2, vāṅmadhye E **madhusamudraḥ** PE] *om.* DK_1JU_1, madhusamūdraḥ U_2, madyasamudraḥ L, madasamudraḥ B **kaphamadhye** cett.] *om.* DK_1JU_1 **medo°** PEB] meda° cett. 4 **raktamadhye** PU_2] vasāmadhye madhusamudraḥ ‖ raktamadhye DK_1U_1, npāmadhye madhusamudraḥ ‖ raktamadhye J, rasamadhye E, *om.* LB **ikṣusamudraḥ** cett.] ikṣurasamudraḥ U_1U_2, ikṣurasasamudraḥ PE **vīryamadhye** cett.] *om.* U_2 **'mṛtasamudraḥ** JU_1] amṛtasamudraḥ DK_1, svādudakasamudraḥ P, *om.* U_2, svādusamudraḥ E, svādukasamudraḥ LB **pādamadhye** cett.] pādam tale DK_1, *om.* U_2, karmasthāna pādamadhye L, karmasthāna pādasamadhye B **kūrmasthānam** cett.] *om.* U_2LB

[XXXVII. **Seven oceans within the body**]

Now, the seven oceans within the body are taught.[359] (1) Within the sweat is the salt ocean. (2) Within the forehead is the milk ocean. (3) Within the marrow is the honey ocean. (4) In the phlegm is the sour milk ocean. (5) In the fat is the ghee ocean. (6) Within the blood is the sugarcane ocean. (7) Within the semen is the ocean of the nectar of immortality. Situated at the feet is the place of the turtle.[360]

[359] Rāmacandra, who bases his descriptions of the seven oceans on the YSv (PT, pp. 842–843) (cf. sources on the previous page) changed the order of oceans slightly. The respective passage can be translated as follows: "The seven oceans are taught to be situated within the body, each containing respectively salt (*lavaṇa*), sugar (*ikṣu*), wine (*surā*), butter (*sarpir*), sour milk (*dadhi*), milk (*dugdha*) and water (*jala*). (1) Salt is within the sweat, (2) sugar in the blood, (3) wine in the skin, (4) ghee in the fat, (5-6) sour milk and milk in the forehead. (7) The nectar of immortality is known to be situated within the semen. A great turtle* (*the earth imagined as a tortoise floating on water) is situated at their feet."

[360] The earth consisting of seven islands with Mount Meru in its centre represented as a tortoise floating on waters of the seven oceans, cf. *Mārkaṇḍeyapurāṇa* 58, *Bhāgavatapurāṇa* 5.16–26 and Bryant, 2009: 354.

[XXXVIII. **navadvāramadhye navakhaṇḍāni**]

इदानीं नवद्वारमध्ये नवखण्डानि कथ्यन्ते। भरतखण्डः ॥ काश्मीरखण्डः ॥ स्त्री–मण्डलखण्डः ॥ द्विजखण्डः ॥ एकपादखण्डः ॥ राक्षसखण्डः ॥ गान्धारखण्डः ॥ कैवर्त्तखण्डः ॥ गर्भखण्डः ॥

Sources: 2–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 843): idānīn tu navadvāre navakhaṇḍāni saṃśṛṇu | pāyvādau bhāratam khaṇḍam kāśmīram trikamaṇḍalam | dvijakhaṇḍam ekapādam khaṇḍam vakṣye samaṇḍalam | kaivarttam garttagāndhāram navakhaṇḍam iti sthitam | 2–4 cf. SSP 3.9 (Ed. p. 55): navakhaṇḍāḥ nava dvāreṣu vasanti| bhāratakhaṇḍaḥ kāśmīrakhaṇḍaḥ karparakhaṇḍaḥ śrīkhaṇḍaḥ śaṅkhakhaṇḍaḥ ekapādakhaṇḍaḥ gāndhārakhaṇḍaḥ kaivartakhaṇḍaḥ mahāmerukhaṇḍaḥ evaṃ navakhaṇḍāḥ |

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2 **navadvāramadhye** DK_IJU_I] navadvāreṣu PU_2E, *om.* LB **navakhaṇḍāni** PU_2LB] navakhaṃḍāḥ DK_IJU_I, *om.* E **kathyante** cett.] kathyate U_I, *om.* E **bharatakhaṇḍaḥ** DK_IJU_I] mukhe bharatakhaṃḍaḥ PLB, pādamadhye kūrmasthānaṃ ‖ mukhaṃ bhāratakhaṃḍaṃ U_2, *om.* E **kāśmīrakhaṇḍaḥ** DK_IJU_I] nāsikayoḥ kinarakhaṃḍe 3 P, nāsikayoḥ ‖ kinnara ‖ harikhaṃḍa U_2, nāsikayoḥ kinnarakhaṃḍanaraharikhaṃḍauḥ E, nāsikayor madhye kināraṣiṃhakhaṃḍā L, nāsikayor madhye kināraharikhaṃḍā B 2–3 **strīmaṇḍalakhaṇḍaḥ** DK_IJU_I] *om.* cett. 3 **dvijakhaṇḍaḥ** DK_IJU_I] netrayoḥ ketumāla bhadrāśve 4 P, netrayoḥ ‖ ketumāla ‖ bhadraśve U_2, netrayoḥ ketumāla bhadrāśvau E, netrayo ketumāla bhadrāsve LB **ekapādakhaṇḍaḥ** DK_IJ] yekapādakhaṃḍaḥ U_I, *om.* cett. **rākṣasakhaṇḍaḥ** DK_IJU_I] karṇayor hiraṇmayaramyakakhaṃḍaḥ 5 P, karṇayoḥ ‖ hiraṇmaya ‖ ramyakakaṃḍe U_2, karṇayoḥ hiraṇmayakhaṃḍa ramyakakhaṃḍau E, karṇayor hiraṇyamayaramyakhaṃḍaḥ LB **gāndhārakhaṇḍaḥ** DK_IJ] gaṃdhārakhaṇḍaḥ U_I, gude kurukhaṃḍaḥ 6 P, gudekurukhaṃḍaṃ U_2, gude kurukhaṃḍaḥ E, gude kurukhaṃḍāḥ LB 4 **kaivarttakhaṇḍaḥ** DK_IJU_I] liṃge ilāvṛtaḥ 7 P, liṃge ulāvṛtaṃ U_2, liṃge ilāvṛtakhaṇḍaḥ E, ilāvṛtaṃ LB **garbhakhaṇḍaḥ** DK_IU_I] garbhakhaṇḍaḥ ‖ cha ‖ J, evaṃ navakhaṃḍāḥ U_2, *om.* cett.

[XXXVIII. **Nine regions within the nine doors**]

Now, the nine continents[361] within the nine doors[362] are taught: Bharata (1), Kāśmīra (2), Strīmaṇḍala (3), Dvija (4), Ekapāda (5), Rākṣasa (6), Gāndhāra (7), Kaivartta (8) [and] Garbha (9).[363]

[361] The island of Jambudvīpa consists of nine continents.

[362] The nine doors (*navadvāra*) refer to the nine orifices of the body: mouth, nostrils, eyes, ears, anus and genitals.

[363] There is a clear divergence between the two main groups of manuscripts. I have edited according to the β-group, as its readings of the ***khaṇḍa***s are much closer to the source texts. The names of the doors are absent in the β-group and were likely also absent in Rāmacandra's original—perhaps because they were incomplete in the *Yogasvarodaya* or, more plausibly, because they were considered common knowledge. A diligent scribe of the γ-group, however, must have been dissatisfied with the original nomenclature and with the apparent omission of the names of the nine doors in his exemplar, and therefore felt compelled to rewrite the passage. Consequently, the γ-group transmits this section with an alternative nomenclature for the nine regions and includes the full set of names of the nine doors. The names of the nine doors are partially preserved in the *Prāṇatoṣinī* and entirely absent from the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*. The γ-group locates (1) the Bharatakhaṇḍa within the mouth, (2–3) the Kinnara- and Harikhaṇḍa in the two nostrils, (4–5) the Ketumāla- and Bhadrāśva[-khaṇḍa] in the eyes, (6–7) the Hiraṇyamaya- and Ramyaka[-khaṇḍa] in the ears, (8) the Kurukhaṇḍa at the anus, and (9) the Ilāvṛta[-khaṇḍa] at the genitals. This system, together with a detailed and elaborate description, is presented in *Parākhyatantra* 5.61–93.

[XXXIX. **piṇḍamadhye 'ṣṭakulaparvatāḥ**]

इदानीं पिण्डमध्येऽष्टकुलपर्वताः कथ्यन्ते। मेरुदण्डमध्ये मेरुपर्वतः॥ ब्रह्मकपाट–मध्ये कैलासपर्वतः॥ पृष्ठमध्ये हिमाचलः॥ वामस्कन्धे मलयाचलः॥ दक्षिण–स्कन्धे मन्दराचलः॥ दक्षिणकर्णे विन्ध्याचलः॥ वामकर्णे मैनाकः॥ ललाटमध्ये श्रीशैलः। अपरे पर्वता हस्तयोः पादयोरङ्गुलीनां मध्ये वर्तन्ते॥

Sources: 2–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 843): idānīṃ parvatāś cāṣṭau kathyante śṛṇu yatnataḥ | merudaṇḍe sumerus tu pīṭhamadhye himālayaḥ | vāmaskandhe tathā dakṣe malayo mandarācalaḥ | vindhyas tu dakṣiṇe karṇe vāme maināka īśvari | lalāṭe madhyadeśe tu śrīśailaḥ parameśvari | tathā brahmakapāṭasthaḥ kailāsaḥ parvato mahān | sumerur himavān vindhyo malayo mandaras tathā | śrīśailo mainākaś ceti kailāso 'ṣṭau ca parvatāḥ | apare parvatāḥ sarve aṅgulīmadhyavāsinaḥ | 2–5 cf. SSP 3.10 (Ed. p. 56): meruparvato merudaṇḍe vasati | kailāso brahmakapāṭe vasati | himālayaḥ pṛṣṭhe | malayo vāmakandhare | mandaro dakṣiṇakandhare | vindhyo dakṣiṇakarṇe | maināko vāmakarṇe | śrīparvato lalāṭe | evam aṣṭa kulaparvatāḥ | anye upaparvatāḥ sarvāṅgulişu vasanti |

2 **idānīṃ** DK_IJU_I] idānīm cett. **piṇḍamadhye** DK_IJU_I] *om.* cett. **'ṣṭakulaparvatāḥ** em.] aṣṭakulaparvatāḥ DK_IJU_IP, aṣṭakulaparvatā U_2, aṣṭamakulaparvatāḥ ELB **meruparvataḥ** em.] merumparvataḥ DK_IJU_I, merumaṃdaraḥ cett. 3 **kailāsaparvataḥ** DK_IJU_I] kailāsaḥ cett. **pṛṣṭhamadhye** U_2E] paiṭimadhye D, paiṭhimadhye K_I, paiṭhamadhye JU_I, pṛṣṭhaṃ madhye P, pṛthvīmadhye LB **himācalaḥ** cett.] himācalaḥ ‖ parvataḥ D, himācalaparvataḥ JU_I **vāmaskandhe** cett.] vāmaskandhye K_I 3–4 **dakṣiṇaskandhe** cett.] dakṣaṇaskaṃdhe DK_IU_I 4 **mandarācalaḥ** cett.] maṃdirācalaḥ K_I **dakṣiṇakarṇe** cett.] dakṣaṇakarṇe DU_I 5 **śrīśailaḥ** cett.] śrīśailāsaḥ B **parvatā** em.] parvatāḥ DK_IJU_I, śailā PLB, śailāḥ U_2E **aṅgulīnāṃ** DK_IPU_2E] aṃgulībhyāṃ JU_I, aṃguli° LB **madhye** DK_IJU_I] mūleṣu cett. **vartante** PU_2E] vartatte DK_I, vartaṃtte ‖ cha ‖ J, parvate U_I, vartate LB

[XXXIX. **Eight major mountains within the body**]

Now, the eight major mountains[364] within the body are taught.[365] (1) Within the spine is Mount Meru.[366] (2) Within the door of Brahman is Mount Kailāsa.[367] (3) Within the back is the Himālaya.[368] (4) Within the left shoulder the mountains of Malaya.[369] (5) Within the right shoulder Mount Mandara.[370] (6) In the right ear, the Vindhya mountain.[371] (7) the Maināka[-mountain][372] is in the left ear. (8) Within the forehead Śrīśaila.[373] Other mountains exist within the fingers of the hands [and] toes of the feet.

[364] The eight major mountains of Jambudvīpa.

[365] *Haṭharatnāvalī* 4.38ab situates all major mountains within the bones of the spine: *vīṇādaṇḍamayo merur asthīni kulaparvatāḥ* | "The bones of Mount Meru resembling the neck of a *vīṇā* are the major mountains." A related idea is expressed within *Yogavāsiṣṭha* 73.59cd: *jambūdvīpe mahāmeruṃ kulaparvatasaṃkulam* ‖ 59 ‖. "In the continent of Jambudvīpa, there is the great Mount Meru, filled with the major mountains."

[366] Mount Meru is considered to be situated at the universe's centre. According to *Amṛtasiddhi* 2.1, the central channel (*suṣumṇā*, madhyamā, etc.) is situated within Mount Meru.

[367] Cf. *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* 31.1–7. Here, Sundaradeva situates Mount Kailāsa at the centre of the thousand-petalled lotus. Furthermore, he identifies Mount Kailāsa as the abode of Śiva, having the nature of the form of *bindu*, etc.

[368] In the *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (ORI B 220, f. 10r) the Himālaya is supposed to be visualised in the context of *cikitsā* for *doṣa*s arising in the yogin who does not heed the rules of proper time and place in yoga practice. If the practitioner is shaking, he shall visualize the Himālaya (*nāgendra*) in his heart.

[369] The term *malayācala* usually refers to the mountain range on the west of Malabar (see Boethlingk, 1858: 37).

[370] In the *samudramanthana* episode of the *Viṣṇupurāṇa* (Ed. p. 75) Mount Mandara was used as a churning rod to churn the ocean of milk.

[371] In *Bodhasāra* 12.1.6 the immobility of the mind through the practice of yoga is compared to the great Mount Vindhya (*niścalatvaṃ prajāyeta vindhyasyeva mahāgireḥ* ‖6‖).

[372] See *Puranic encyclopaedia*, p. 468 for references.

[373] The mountain has been associated with yoga practice, cf. *Yogatārāvalī* 28.

[XL. **śarīre navanāḍyaḥ**]

इदानीं शरीरे नवनाड्यस्तिष्ठन्ति। तन्मध्ये नवानां नदीनां स्थानानि वर्तन्ते। गङ्गा॥ यमुना॥ वितस्ता॥ चन्द्रभागा॥ सरस्वती॥ विपाशा॥ शतरुद्रा॥ इरावती॥ नर्मदा॥ अपरा नद्योपनदिनिर्झराः स्रोतांसि तटाकानि वापीकूपा द्विसप्ततिसहस्रनाडीनां मध्ये तिष्ठन्ति॥

Sources: 2–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 843): śarīre navanāḍīsthā narmadā ca maheśvari | iḍāyāṃ yamunā devi piṅgalāyāṃ sarasvatī | suṣumnāyāṃ vahed gaṅgā cānyonyāsu ca nāḍiṣu | gaṅgā sarasvatī godā narmadā yamunā tathā | kāverī candrabhāgā ca vitastā ca iḍāvatī | dvisaptatisahasreṣu nadīnadaparisravaḥ | 2–5 cf. SSP 3.11–12 (Ed. p. 57): pīnasā yamunā gaṅgā candrabhāgā sarasvatī | vipāsā śatarudrā ca śrīrātriś caiva narmadā | evaṃ navanadyo navanāḍīṣu vasanti | anyā upanadyaḥ kulyopakulyā dvisaptatisahasranāḍīsu vasanti |

2 **śarīre** cett.] śarīramadhye U_2E **navanāḍyas** U_2E] ṇavānāḍyas DK_1J, ṇavānaḍyaḥ U_1, navanaḍyas PB, navanaḍyaḥ L **tiṣṭhanti** cett.] tiṣṭhati DK_1JU_2, stiṣṭhaṃti U_1 **navānāṃ nadīnāṃ** cett.] navanadīnāṃ E **vartante** cett.] vartaṃte ‖ cha ‖ J, nivartaṃte U_2, vartate B 3 **yamunā** cett.] jamunā J **sarasvatī** cett.] sarasvati L **vipāśā** cett.] vaipaśā DK_1JU_1 **śatarudrā** J] śata hṛdā DU_1, śatarūdrā K_1, śātahṛdā P, śātadrumā U_2, śatahradā E, śatat hṛda L, śāśatahṛdā B **irāvatī** DK_1E] airāvatī J, airāvati U_1, irāvati PLB, *om.* U_2 4 **narmadā** cett.] narmadā ‖ gallakī ‖ J, narmadā gaṃḍakī U_1 **aparā** cett.] *om.* J **nadyopanadinirjharāḥ srotāṃsi** em.] nadyopanadīnair bhurasrota° D, nadyopanadī ‖ nair jarasrota K_1, nadyopanadīnair jñanasrota J, nadyūpanadīnair bhurasrota° U_1, nadyo nadānirjārā srotāṃsī P, nadyo nadānirjñārāsrotāsī U_2, nadyo nadāni srotāṃsi E, nadyo nadānirjñārāsty etāṃsi L, nadyo nadānirjñārāsty etāṃsī B **taṭākāni** E] taṭāka DK_1J, taḍaga U_1, taṭānī PB, taṭhānī U_2, taṭāni L **vāpīkūpā** cett.] vāpikupāḥ DK_1J **dvisaptati°** cett.] dvisaptatī° PB, disaptati E 4–5 **sahasranāḍīnāṃ** cett.] sahasranāḍī° JU_1E, sahasranāḍīnā B 5 **tiṣṭhanti** cett.] tiṣṭhati K_1J, tiṣṭhaṃṭī U_1

[XL. **Nine rivers within the body**]

Now, within the body, nine rivers[374] are situated. Within it, the courses of the nine rivers exist. Gaṅgā, Yamunā, Vitastā,[375] Candrabhāgā,[376] Sarasvatī,[377] Vipāśā,[378] Śatarudrā,[379] Irāvatī[380] and Narmadā.[381] Other rivers, tributaries, waterfalls, streams, lakes, ponds, and wells. are within the 72,000 channels.[382]

[374] The main microcosmic rivers of the yogic body are frequently associated with the main channels, cf., for example, *Haṭhapradīpikā* 3.108.

[375] The Jhelum river that originates in Kashmir and flows through present-day Pakistan, cf. Slaje, 2014: 325 and Geldner, 1907: 160.

[376] This is the Chenab River, cf. Coomaraswamy and Kristnayya Duggirala 2017. The river begins at the confluence of the Candrā and Bhāgā rivers near Tandi in the upper Himalayas in the Lahaul and Spiti districts of Himachal Pradesh. The river flows through the Jammu region in the south of the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir and the plains of Punjab, where the Jhelum and the Rāvī flow into it.

[377] Name of an important river in Vedic times, cf. Wilke and Moebus, 2011: 310.

[378] The present-day river Beas in the Punjab, cf. Geldner, 1907: 162.

[379] The Sutlej River, the longest of the rivers that flows through the Punjab.

[380] The Rāvī river of the Punjab, cf. Monier-Williams, 1899: 168.

[381] The Narmada River flows from east to west in India, rises in the Amarkantak hills in the state of Madhya Pradesh, crosses the central highlands, flows through the states of Maharashtra and Gujarat and finally flows into the Gulf of Khambhat in the Arabian Sea.

[382] The comparison of the river lists in *Tattvayogabindu*, *Yogasvarodaya*, and *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* may provide clues to their regions of composition due to notable differences. I thank Mallinson for drawing my attention to this point. The three lists follow the order given in the texts:

Tattvayogabindu: Gaṅgā, Yamunā, Vitastā (mod. Jhelum), Candrabhāgā (mod. Cenab), Sarasvatī, Vipāśā (mod. Beas), Śatarudrā (mod. Sutlej), Irāvatī (mod. Rāvī), Narmadā.

Yogasvarodaya: Yamunā, Sarasvatī, Gaṅgā, Godā, Narmadā, Kāverī, Candrabhāgā, Vitastā, Iḍāvatī.

Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati: Pīnasā, Yamunā, Gaṅgā, Candrabhāgā, Sarasvatī, Vipāsā, Śatarudrā, Śrīrātrī, Narmadā.

While the *Tattvayogabindu* lists only North Indian rivers (esp. Kashmir and Punjab), the *Yogasvarodaya* also includes Godā (Godāvarī) and Kāverī from the South, suggesting a South Indian provenance, supported by its closeness to the *Śivayogapradīpikā*. The *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* replaces Vitastā with Pināsā and Irāvatī with Śrīrātrī, possibly corruptions, as the Lonavla Edition offers no better variants.

[XLI. **saptaviṃśatinakṣatrāṇi …**]

सप्तविंशतिनक्षत्राणि द्विसप्ततिकोष्ठकान्त्राभ्यन्तरे वसन्ति। द्वादश राशयः॥ मेषः॥ वृषः॥ मिथुनः॥ कर्कः॥ सिंहः॥ कन्या॥ तुला॥ वृश्चिकः॥ धनुः॥ मकरः॥ कुम्भः॥ मीनः॥ नवग्रहाः॥ आदित्या॥ सोमः॥ मङ्गलः॥ बुधः॥ बृहस्पतिः॥ शुक्रः॥ शनिः॥ राहुः॥ केतुः॥ पञ्चदश तिथयोऽत्र मध्ये वसन्ति।

Sources: 2–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 843): itas tato dehamadhye ṛkṣaś ca saptaviṃśatiḥ | yogāś ca rāśayaś caiva grahāś ca tithayas tathā | 2–5 cf. SSP 3.13 (Ed. p. 57): saptaviṃśatir nakṣatrāṇi | dvādaśa rāśayaḥ | navagrahāḥ | nava lakṣa tārāḥ | pañcadaśa tithayaḥ | ete 'ntarvalaye dvisaptatisahasrakoṣṭheṣu vasanti |

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2 **dvisaptatikoṣṭhakāntrābhyantare** P] dvisaptatikoṣṭhakāś cāntrābhyantare DK_1, dvisaptatikoṣṭhakāś cātrābhyantare J, dvisaptatikoṣṭākāś cāntrābhyantare U_1, dvisaptatikoṣṭhakāntarābhyantare U_2, dvisaptatikoṣṭhakābhyantare E, dvisaptatīkoṣṭākāntrābhyāntare L, dvisaptatīkoṣṭhākāntrābhyāntare B **vasanti** cett.] vasati JU_1 **rāśayaḥ** cett.] meṣādy dvādaśarāśayaḥ ‖ J, rāśayāḥ B **meṣaḥ** E] meṣa ‖ K_1U_2, meṣa° cett., *om.* J 3 **vṛṣaḥ** E] vṛṣī° K_1, *om.* J, vṛṣabha ‖ U_2, °vṛṣabha° B, °vṛṣa° cett. **mithunaḥ** E] °mithuna ‖ K_1, *om.* J, °mithūnaḥ P, mithuna ‖ U_2, °mithūna° B, °mithuna° cett. **karkaḥ** E] karka° K_1, *om.* J, karka° P, karka ‖ U_2, °karka° cett. **siṃhaḥ** E] °siṃha ‖ K_1, *om.* J, siṃha ‖ U_2, °siṃha° cett. **kanyā** E] kanyā ‖ K_1U_2, *om.* J, °kanyā° cett. **tulā** E] tūlā ‖ K_1, *om.* J, tula ‖ U_2, °tūla° cett. **vṛścikaḥ** em.] vṛścika ‖ K_1U_2, *om.* J, vṛściko E, °vṛścika° cett. **dhanuḥ** em.] dhana ‖ K_1U_2, *om.* J, dhanur E, °dhana° cett. **makaraḥ** em.] makara ‖ K_1U_2, *om.* J, makara° E, °makara° cett. 4 **kumbhaḥ** em.] kumbha ‖ K_1U_2, *om.* J, °kumbha° cett. **mīnaḥ** em.] mīna ‖ K_1U_2, *om.* J, °mīnāḥ E, °mīnaḥ LB, °mīna cett. **navagrahāḥ** cett.] navagrahā K_1, ādityādinavagrahāḥ J, navagrahaḥ P **ādityā** em.] āditya° cett., *om.* J, ravi ‖ U_2 **somaḥ** em.] °soma° cett., °soma | DK_1, *om.* J, candra ‖ U_2 **maṅgalaḥ** em.] maṅgala | DK_1, *om.* J, maṅgala ‖ U_2, °maṅgala° cett. **budhaḥ** em.] budha | D, budha ‖ K_1U_2, *om.* J, °budha° cett. **bṛhaspatiḥ** em.] bṛhaspati | DK_1, *om.* J, °bṛhaspatiḥ P, vṛhasyati ‖ U_2, °guru° E, °bṛhaspati° cett. 5 **śukraḥ** em.] śukra° D, śukra ‖ K_1U_2, *om.* J, °śukra° cett. **śaniḥ** em.] śani ‖ K_1, *om.* J, °śaniḥ P, śanī ‖ U_2, °śani° cett. **rāhuḥ** P] rāhu ‖ K_1U_2, *om.* J, °rāhu° cett. **ketuḥ** U_1PU_2] ketu K_1, *om.* J, °ketu cett., ketavaḥ E **pañcadaśa tithayo** cett.] pañcadaśatithyoḥ ‖ J, padaśa tithayo U_2, pañcadaśa tithayaḥ ‖ L, pañcadaśa tithiḥ ‖ B **'tra** DK_1PU_2E] atra JLB, ātra U_1 **vasanti** cett.] tiṣṭhanti U_2

[XLI. **Twenty-seven constellations …**]

Twenty-seven constellations[383] are located inside the intestines in the seventy-two vessels.[384]

The twelve zodiacal signs (*rāśi*): Aries, Taurus, Gemini, Cancer, Leo, Virgo, Libra, Scorpio, Sagittarius, Capricorn, Aquarius, and Pisces.[385]

The nine planets are: Sun, Moon, Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus, Saturn, Rāhu and Ketu.[386]

The fifteen lunar days reside here within [the body].

[383] In *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* 45.34–35, one of the results of yoga is the perception of heavenly gardens, the stars, the moon, etc.: *mano layaṃ yadā yāti bhrūmadhye yogato nṛṇām | jihvāmūle 'mṛtasrāvo bhrūmadhye cātmadarśanam ‖* 34 *‖ kampanaṃ tathā mūrdhni manasaivātmadarśanam | devodyānāni ramyāṇi nakṣatrāṇi ca candramāḥ ‖ ṛṣayaḥ siddhagandharvāḥ prakāśaṃ yānti yoginām ‖*

[384] The *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* reads *dvisaptatisahasrakoṣṭheṣu*, which denotes 72,000, as opposed to Rāmacandra's 72. However, none of the witnesses of the *Tattvayogabindu* preserves this reading. The number 72,000 appears more convincing since *Vivekamārtaṇḍa* 16 states that the *kanda*, located between the navel and the penis, is the origin of the 72,000 channels. This number cannot be coincidental, suggesting that this passage might be corrupted.

[385] Twelve zodiac signs are mentioned in the *Vasiṣṭhasaṃhitā* in 5.30–31. They appear in a larger discussion of the nature of the self, the relation of the self with time and the cycles of breath in the body (5.4–29). From 5.32–33, the text discusses the twelve zodiac signs and their influence on various aspects of human life.

[386] A detailed analysis of the *navagraha*s can be found in Kropf, 2005. For an explanation of the concept of Rāhu and Ketu, see Kropf 2005: 142.

यथा समुद्रमध्ये लहरी वर्तते। तथा शरीरमध्य ऊर्मिनाम लहरी भवति॥ तथो–
र्मैश्चलनाच्छरीरे चलनं भवति। धावनं भवति। तन्मध्ये समग्रं तारामण्डलं
वर्तते। त्रयस्त्रिंशत्कोटयो देवता बाहुरोममध्ये वसन्ति। पृष्ठिरोममध्ये षडशीतिस–
हस्रदिव्यतपस्विनः। पीठोपपीठान्यूर्ध्वपृष्ठोपरि यानि रोमाणि तन्मध्ये वसन्ति।

Sources: 1–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 843): laharīṣu mīnamanī cāvāhanaṃ sthāpanaṃ tathā | sarvāṅgeṣu ca deveśi samagraṃ ṛkṣamaṇḍalam | trayastriṃśatkoṭay astu nivasanti ca devatāḥ | sarvāṅgeṣu ca deveśi samagraṃ ṛkṣamaṇḍalam | 1–3 cf. SSP 3.13 (Ed. pp. 57–58): anekatārā-maṇḍalaṃ ūrmipuñje vasati | trayastriṃśatkoṭidevatā bāhuromakūpeṣu vasanti | 3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 843): trayastriṃśatkoṭay astu nivasanti ca devatāḥ | cf. SSP 3.13 (Ed. p. 58): trayas-triṃśatkoṭidevatā bāhuromakūpeṣu vasanti | 3–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 843): tathā pīṭhāni sarvāṇi dehamadhye sthitāni ca | 3–4 cf. SSP 3.13 (Ed. p. 58): anekapīṭhopapīṭhakā romakūpeṣu vasanti |

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1 **yathā** cett.] pīṭhasya romamadhye yathā U_1 **samudramadhye** cett.] *om.* P **laharī** cett.] *om.* P, laharā B **tathā** cett.] *om.* P **°madhya** em.] madhye cett. **ūrmi°** K_1] ūrmī° DJ, urmi° U_1, urmmī° PU_2LB, kūrmmī° E **bhavati** cett.] bhavanti U_2 1–2 **tathā urmeś** em.] tasyāḥ urmyaḥ D, tasyāḥ ‖ urmyaḥ K_1, tasyā ūrmyaś J, tathā urmeś U_1, ūrmyaś calāś P, ūrmiyaś calāḥ ‖ U_2, ūrmyaś calās E, *om.* L, ūrmmīś calāś B 2 **calanāc charīre** em.] calācharīre DK_1J, calanāśarīre U_1, cataḥ śarīre P, tataḥ śarīra° U_2, tataḥ E, *om.* L, cataḥ ‖ śarire B **dhāvanaṃ bhavati** DK_1JU_1] dhāvanaṃ ca cett., *om.* E **samagraṃ** cett.] samagra° U_1U_2, samagrāṃ B 3 **trayastriṃśatkoṭayo** LB] trayastriśatkoṭyo D, trayastriṃśatkoṭyo K_1JP, trayaḥ striśatakoṭī U_1, trayaḥ triṃśatkoṭyo U_2, trayastriṃśatkoṭi° E **devatā** DK_1JU_1] devatāḥ | cett. **vasanti** cett.] vasantī DJU_1 **pṛṣṭhiromamadhye** em.] pīṭhasya romamadhye DK_1J, pṛṣṭīromamad-hye U_1LB, pṛṣṭaromamadhye PU_2, *om.* E **ṣaḍaśīti°** $DK_1JU_1U_2$] ṣaḍaśī° P, *om.* E, ṣaḍaśatī° LB 3–4 **°sahasra°** cett.] *om.* E 4 **divya** cett.] *om.* E **°tapasvinaḥ** PU_2LB] °tapasvino DK_1JU_1, *om.* E **pīṭhopapīṭhāny** conj.] pīṭhamahāpīṭhau DK_1JU_1, pīṭhopapīṭhe PL, pīṭhopapīṭho° U_2, *om.* E, mīṣṭhopapīṭher B **ūrdhvapṛṣṭhopari** em.] ūrddhvatuṣṭopari DK_1J, urdhvapṛṣṭhopari U_1, dvavoṣṭopari P, °rdhvapari U_2, *om.* E, dvaiṣṭhipari L, dvaiṣṭhopari B **yāni** DJU_1PU_2B] yoni K_1, *om.* E, yā L **romāṇi** $DJPU_2$LB] romaṇi K_1, romāni U_1, *om.* E **tanmadhye** cett.] *om.* E **vasanti** cett.] santi JU_1, *om.* E

Just as the wave resides in the ocean, so does the wave called Ūrmi[387] exists in the body. Thus, from the fluctuation of Ūrmi, movement arises in the body, [and] flowing arises. Within her, the totality of stars exists.

Thirty-three crores of divinities reside within the hairs of the arms.

Within the hairs of the back, there are 86,000 (*ṣaḍaśītisahasra*) heavenly ascetics. Seats [of power] and secondary seats [of power][388] reside within the hairs[389] which are on the upper part of the back.

[387] Rāmacandra's concept of *ūrmi* is remarkable. The term *ūrmi* is present in one of his source texts. The SSP 3.13 reads: *anekatārāmaṇḍalaṃ ūrmipuñje vasati* | "The totality of stars resides in the mass of the wave(s)." It appears that both mentions of *ūrmi* could derive from historically much earlier statements of the Kashmiri Śaiva exegetes in which *ūrmi* is a synonym for *spandaśakti*. In his commentary to *Spandakārikā* 1.1 Kṣemarāja writes: *sā caiṣā spandaśaktir garbhīkṛtānantasargasaṃhāraikaghanāhantācamatkārānandarūpā niḥśeṣaśuddhāśuddharūpāmātṛmeyasaṃkocavikāsābhāsanasatattvā sarvopaniṣadupāsyā yugapad evonmeṣanimeṣamayī || tathā hi śivādeḥ kṣityantasyāśeṣasya tattvagrāmasya prāksṛṣṭasya saṃhartṛrūpā yā nimeṣabhūr asāv evodbhaviṣyaddaśāpekṣayā sraṣṭurūponmeṣabhūmis tathā viśvanimeṣabhūś cidghanatonmeṣasārā cidghanatānimajjanabhūmir api viśvonmeṣarūpā || yad āgamaḥ | lelihānā sadā devī sadā pūrṇā ca bhāsate || **ūrmir** eṣā vibodhābdheḥ śaktir icchātmikā prabhoḥ || iti ||*. For Kṣemarāja *ūrmi* is the *spandaśakti*, the goddess (*devī*) and thus the *icchāśakti* of lord Śiva. *Ūrmi* is the force that sets in motion the creation and dissolution of the universe.

[388] The conjecture to *pīṭhopapīṭhāni* is based on the reading of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, which reads *anekapīṭhopapīṭhakā* (cf. sources). The manuscripts of the *Tattvayogabindu* offer two main readings. The β-group preserves the reading *pīṭhamahāpīṭhau*, whose dual form does not align with the final verb *vasanti* preserved in all manuscripts. The γ-group retains variants of *pīṭhopapīṭha* with inconsistent case endings. Given that this is the reading of the source text, I preferred the γ-variant over the β-variant. Consequently, I corrected the case ending to the grammatically appropriate nominative plural.

[389] In the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, the macrocosmic elements are in the pores of the skin (*romakūpa*). However, Rāmacandra seems to take a different view by consistently locating the macrocosmic elements within the body hair (*roma*).

हृदयरोममध्ये तक्षकमहानागः ॥ कर्कोटकः ॥ शङ्खः ॥ पुलकः ॥ वासुकिः ॥ अनन्तः ॥ शेषः ॥ एते नागा वसन्ति। उदररोममध्येऽपरे नागा वसन्ति। गणगन्धर्वकिन्नरकिंपुरुषाप्सरोविद्याधरगुह्यकाः। शरीरमध्ये मर्मस्थानेऽनेकतीर्थावली वसन्ति। अश्रुपातमध्ये मेघमण्डलं वसति। अनन्ताः सिद्धयो बुद्धयाः
5 प्रकाशमध्ये वर्तन्ते। चन्द्रसूर्यौ द्वयोर्नेत्रयोर्मध्ये वर्तते। अनेकवनस्पतिगुल्मलतातृणानि जङ्घारोममध्ये वसन्ति।

Sources: 1–2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 843): hṛdaye vyomamadhye tu anantādyās tu vāsukiḥ | udare vyomamadhye tu pare nāgā vasanti hi | 1–2 cf. SSP 3.13 (Ed. p. 58): kulanāgā vakṣasi vasanti | 2–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 843): udare vyomamadhye tu 'pare nāgā vasanti hi | gandharvakinnarāḥ śūrā vidyādharāpsarādayaḥ | anekatīrthavarṇāś ca guhyakāś ca vasanti hi | 2–3 cf. SSP 3.13 (Ed. p. 58): gandharvakinnarakiṃpuruṣā apsarasāṃ gaṇā udare vasanti | 3–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 843): anantasiddhayo buddhyā prakāśo varttate hṛdi | meghasya maṇḍalaṃ jñeyam aśrupāte tathaiva ca | 3–5 cf. SSP 3.13 (Ed. p. 59, in mss. B_1, W, P_1, P_3): anekatīrthāni marmasthāne vasanti | anantasiddhā matiprakaśe vasanti | 5–6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 843): candrārkau netrayormadhye jaṅghā lomasu sākṣiṇaḥ | tṛṇagulmādikañcāpi viśvarūpaṃ smaret tataḥ | 5–6 cf. SSP 3.13 (Ed. p. 59): candrasūryau netradvaye vasataḥ | anekavṛkṣalaṭāgulmatṛṇāni jaṅghāromakasthāne vasanti |

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1 **hṛdayaromamadhye** cett.] *om.* LB **takṣakamahānāgaḥ** DK_1J] takṣamā nāgaḥ U_1, takṣakamahānāga P, takṣakaḥ mahānāgaḥ U_2E, *om.* LB **karkoṭakaḥ** DK_1PU_2] karkoṭaḥ JU_1, *om.* ELB **śaṅkhaḥ** cett.] śaṃkha K_1, *om.* LB **pulakaḥ** P] pulika DK_1, pulikaḥ JU_1, kulakaḥ U_2, takṣakaḥ E, *om.* LB **vāsukiḥ** PU_2E] vāsukī DK_1JU_1, *om.* LB 1–2 **anantaḥ** P] ānanta DK_1U_2, anaṃta J, ānaṃta˚ U_1, ananta˚ E, *om.* LB 2 **śeṣaḥ** JU_2] śeṣā DK_1, ˚śoṣa U_1, śoṣa P, ˚śeṣaḥ E, *om.* LB **ete** cett.] *om.* LB **nāgā** cett.] nāga E, *om.* LB **vasanti** cett.] vasaṃti ‖ cha ‖ J, *om.* LB **˚madhye** cett.] ˚madhye | D **'pare** JU_1] apare cett. 3 **gaṇa˚** DK_1JU_1] guṇa˚ PELB, gaṃdha˚ U_2 **˚kinnarakiṃpuruṣāpsaro˚** J] ˚kiṃnarakiṃpuruṣa ‖ apsaro D, ˚kiṃnarakiṃpuruṣa ‖ apsaro ‖ K_1, ˚kinnarapuruṣāpsaro˚ U_1, ˚kinarā P, ˚kinnarāpsaro˚ U_2E, ˚kinnarābharo˚ LB **˚vidyādhara˚** ELB] ˚vidyādhāra | D, vidyādhāra | K_1, ˚vidyādhāra JU_1, *om.* P, ˚vidyādhāra U_2 **˚guhyakāḥ** ELB] guhyaka DK_1, ˚guhyaka JU_1, *om.* P, ˚guhyakaḥ U_2 **śarīramadhye** cett.] śarīmadhye D, madhye P **marmasthāne** JU_1] karmasthāne DK_1, *om.* cett. 3–4 **'nekatīrthāvalī** PU_2] nenekatīrthavallī DK_1, naikatīrthavallī JU_1, anekatīrthāni E, anekatīrthāvalī LB 4 **vasanti** cett.] vasaṃtī U_1LB, vasatī U_2 **meghamaṇḍalaṃ** cett.] meghamaṃḍala B **vasati** PU_2E] vasaṃti DK_1JU_1, vasatī L, vasaṃtī B **anantāḥ** DK_1JPE] anaṃtā U_1U_2LB **buddhayāḥ** em.] buddhayaś ca cett., buddhayac ca B 5 **vartante** K_1JPU_2E] vartate DU_1LB **˚sūryau** cett.] ˚sūryo DLB **dvayor** DPE] dvayaur K_1, *om.* JU_1, dvayo U_2L, dvayā˚ B **netrayor** DK_1E] netradvaya˚ JU_1, netreyor P, netrayoḥ U_2, netrayo B **madhye** cett.] ˚madhye ‖ J, *om.* U_1 **vartate** DK_1PLB] vasaṃti ‖ cha ‖ J, vasaṃti U_1, pravartate U_2, varttete E 5–6 **anekavanaspatigulmalatātṛṇāni** PELB] anaikavanaspatigulmatṛṇāni D, anekavanaspatigulmatṛṇāni K_1J, anekavanaspatīgulmalatāni U_1, anekavana | spatigulmalatātṛṇāni U_2 6 **˚roma˚** cett.] ˚rora˚ LB **˚madhye** cett.] ˚sthāne DK_1J **vasanti** cett.] varttaṃte DK_1, vasati JU_2

Within the hairs of the chest: the great Nāga Takṣaka, Karkoṭaka, Śaṅkha, Pulaka, Vāsuki, Ānanta and Śeṣa. These Nāgas reside [there].[390]

Within the abdominal hair reside other snakes, [as well as] Gaṇas, Gandharvas, Centaurs, Dwarves, Apsaras, Vidyādharas, and Guhyakas.

Many series of pilgrimage sites are located at vulnerable places within the body. Within the falling tears resides the totality of clouds. Infinite supernatural powers exist within the light of the intellect (*buddhi*).[391]

The sun and the moon are situated within the two eyes.

Many trees, bushes, creepers and grasses live within the hairs of the legs.[392]

[390] Notably, none of the known sources contains the names of the snake demons.

[391] The original reading suggested by the manuscript transmission is: *anantāḥ siddhayo buddhayaś ca prakāśamadhye vartante* | "Infinite supernatural powers and *buddhi*s exist within the light." While a plural of *buddhi* appears in other Sanskrit texts, its meaning in this context is rather ambiguous. Furthermore, the source text suggests a more coherent reading. Emending *buddhi* to the genitive singular form *buddhayāḥ*, supported by the formulation *matiprakāśe* in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* (cf. sources), resolves nearly all issues within the sentence. Without this emendation, the reference to light in the *Tattvayogabindu* would remain undefined and, therefore, nonsensical in this context, as there is no unspecified *prakāśa* within the body. Additionally, this adjustment avoids the problematic plural form of *buddhi*. The only remaining issue is the *ca*, which likely entered the text during an early stage of transmission once *buddhayāḥ* became *buddhayaḥ*.

[392] Rāmacandra does not explain why he teaches the microcosmic equivalents of the macrocosmic world within the yogic body. Other texts state possible reasons. For example, immediately after the verses on the various contents of the yogic body *Śivasaṃhitā* 2.5 states: *jānāti yaḥ sarvam idaṃ sa yogī nātra saṃśayaḥ* | "One who knows all this is a yogi, in this, there is no doubt." SSP 3.1 explains: *piṇḍamadhye carācaraṃ yo jānāti sa yogī piṇḍasaṃvittir bhavati* ‖ 1 ‖ "He who knows the movable and immovable within the body is a yogi who has the realization of the body."

पुरुषस्य नृत्यदर्शनात्। गीतश्रवणात्। वल्लभवस्तुनो दर्शनात्। य आनन्द उत्पद्यते सः स्वर्गलोकः कथ्यते। रोगपीडादुर्जनेभ्यः पुरुषस्य यद्दुःखमुत्पद्यते। तद्बहुतरं नरकं कथ्यते। अथ च यत्कर्मकरणात्सर्वेषां लोकानां स्वमनसि च शुभं न। भरते। तत्कर्म बन्धनमित्युच्यते। अथ च यत्कर्मकरणान्मनोमध्ये शङ्का न भवति
5 तत्कर्म मुक्तिकारणम्॥

Sources: 1–3 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 843–844): samagradarśanān muktaḥ svargabhogañ ca matsukham | tad etac cintayā yāti rogaśokavivarjitaḥ | 1–3 cf. SSP 3.14 (Ed. pp. 59–60): yat sukhaṃ tat svargaḥ | yad duḥkhaṃ tan narakaḥ | yat karma tad bandhanaṃ | yo nirvikalpaḥ sā muktiḥ | svasvarūpajñānadaśāyāṃ nidrādau svātmajāgaraḥ śāntir bhavati | evaṃ sarvadeheṣu viśvarūpaḥ parameśvaraḥ paramātmā 'khaṇḍasvabhāvena ghaṭe ghaṭe cit svarūpī tiṣṭhati | 3–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 844): yat karmā karmaṇā śaṅkā manomadhye bhaved vahiḥ | tatkarmakaraṇaṃ muktir ity āha bhagavān śivaḥ |

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1 **puruṣasya** cett.] puruṣasya vādya J, puruṣasyāvādya U_1 **nṛtyadarśanāt** PE] nṛtyadarśanād DK_1, nṛtyot° J, nṛtyod° U_1, darśanāt ‖ U_2, nityadarśanāt LB **gītaśravaṇāt** cett.] gītaśravaṇād U_1 **darśanāt** cett.] darśanād U_1 **ya** JP] yaḥ DK_1ELB, yā U_1, *om.* U_2 2 **saḥ** E] sa $DK_1JU_1U_2$, *om.* PLB **svargalokaḥ** PELB] bahurānaṃdaḥ svarga+++laḥ D, bahurānaṃdaḥ svargaphalaḥ K_1U_1, bahurānaṃdaḥ ‖ cha ‖ svargaphalaḥ J, svargaloka U_2 **kathyate** cett.] kathyaṃte J **°pīḍā°** DK_1J] °pīḍa° U_1, °pīḍato PB, °pīḍāto U_2, °pīḍito E, °pīḍano L **durjanebhyaḥ** cett.] durjanebhya PLB **yad duḥkham** em.] duḥkhaṃ DK_1, duḥkham JU_1, yaduḥkham P, duḥkha U_2, yat duḥkham E, yad duḥkhaṃ L, yat duḥkha B 2–3 **tad bahutaraṃ** cett.] tat bahutaraṃ DK_1, bahutaraṃ JU_1 3 **narakaṃ** cett.] nakaṃ D **kathyate** $DK_1U_1PU_2ELB$] kathyaṃte J **atha ca yat karmakaraṇāt sarveṣāṃ lokānāṃ svamanasi ca śubhaṃ na** J] atha ca yatkarmakaraṇāt sarveṣāṃ lokānāṃ svamanasī ca śubhaṃ na U_1, *om.* cett. 4 **bharate** U_1] bhāsate J, *om.* cett. **tat karma bandhanam ity ucyate** JU_1] *om.* cett. **yatkarmakaraṇān** PU_2] yatkarmakaraṇāt cett. **manomadhye** cett.] manobudhye LB **śaṅkā** cett.] śakā U_2 **bhavati** cett.] bhaviti DK_1, bhavaṃti U_2 5 **muktikāraṇam** U_1PE] muktikāraṇaṃ DU_2, muktikāraṇāṃ K_1, muktikāraṇaṃ ‖ cha ‖ J, kamuktikāraṇam LB

The bliss that arises in a person as a result of seeing dance, listening to songs, [and] viewing beloved objects, that [bliss] is called heaven. The suffering that arises in a person from illness and mistreatment by wicked people, that great [suffering] is called hell. Moreover, an action that does not bring goodness to all people and one's mind, that action is said to be bondage.[393] And furthermore, the action that, when performed, does not cause doubt in the mind, that action is the cause of liberation.[394]

[393] This sentence is only preserved in J and U_1. The manuscripts N_1 and N_2 have a *lacunae* here and manuscripts D and K_1 of the β-group omit the sentence. The sentence significantly improves the meaning of the entire paragraph. Therefore, it is likely that the sentence belongs to the original text. This error in the other witnesses can easily be explained here as a haplography of the following sentence, as they begin similarly. A similar statement is found in Rāmacandra's source text, the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* (cf. sources).

[394] Structurally, lacking any introductory statement, these sentences at first sight do not convincingly align with the context of the yogic body's contents. However, the structure is consistently preserved across all witnesses. Furthermore, this sequence corresponds to the presentation of contents in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, as well as the *Yogasvarodaya* (cf. sources). Both source texts conclude the chapter with information about the contents of the yogic body. Rāmacandra's formulations are a synthesis of the two source texts. Gharote and Pai (Ed. p. 60, cf. sources) note the following regarding the corresponding passage in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*: "Thus, the Supreme Lord of universal nature exists in every manifestation in the form of *cit*. Heaven and hell are not two worlds which the souls visit after leaving the body, but only mental states of happiness or sorrow."

[XLII. **rājayogāc charīre cihnāni**]

इदानीं राजयोगाच्छरीरयेतादृशानि चिह्नानि भवन्ति। तानि कथ्यन्ते। सकलरोगनाशः। सकलपृथ्वीं पश्यति। तदनन्तरं तत्त्वविषयं ज्ञानमुत्पद्यते। समग्रां भाषां जानाति। ततः पुरुषस्य देहो वज्रमयो भवति। सर्पदंशे सति मरणं न भवति। ततः पुरुषस्य बुभुक्षापिपासानिद्रोष्णताशीतबाधां न कुर्वन्ति। वाक्सिद्धिर्भवति। विद्युत्पाते शरीरे काचिद्धानिर्न भवति। तदनन्तरं पवनयोगी पुरुषो भवति। समग्रां पृथ्वीं दृष्ट्या पश्यति। अणिमाद्यष्टसिद्धिर्भवति।

Sources: 3–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 844): yasya darśanamātreṇa rogaśokavivarjitaḥ | paramānandacittaḥ syāt tapasvī caiva kīrttitaḥ | saptadvīpā bhaved dṛṣṭā tattvajñānaṃ tato bhavet | sarvabhāvaṃ vijānīyād vajradeho bhavet tathā | sarpadaṣṭe viṣaṃ na syāt kṣudhā nidrā tṛṣā tathā | 5–6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 844): uṣṇatā śītatā ceti vāksiddhiḥ syān na saṃśayaḥ | vidyutpāte 'pi dehasya kvacid hānir na jāyate | 6–7 cf. YS (PT, p. 844): tato 'sau vāyuyogī syād dṛṣṭvā pṛthvīkulānvitaḥ | aṇimādyaṣṭasiddhiḥ syān …

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2 **idānīṃ** cett.] idānī PU_2B **rājayogāc charīray** em.] rājayogāc charīre DJEL, rājayogā ‖ charīre K_I, rājayogācharīre U_I, rogayogācharīre P, rājayogāśarīre U_2, rājayogāc charīre ‖ B **etādṛśāni** cett.] yādṛśāni E 2–3 **sakalaroganāśaḥ** cett.] sakalarogaḥ ‖ J, sakalarogaḥ nāśaḥ U_I 3 **sakalapṛthvīṃ** cett.] sakalāṃ pṛthvīṃ P **paśyati** cett.] paśyatī DK_IB **tad anantaraṃ** cett.] tad aṃtaraṃ P, tad anaṃtara° U_2 **tattvaviṣayaṃ** DK_IJU_I] *om.* cett. 3–4 **samagrāṃ bhāṣāṃ** DK_IJU_IP] samagrā bhāṣā U_2E, samagra bhāṣā L, samagrā bhāṣa B 4 **°daṃśe** cett.] °daṃśo P, °daṃśena E, °daṃśema B **sati** K_IJ] satī DU_I, *om.* cett. **na** cett.] *om.* L **bhavati** cett.] vati U_2, bhavatī B 5 **tataḥ** DK_IPU_2E] *om.* JU_I, tat° LB **puruṣasya** cett.] *om.* JU_I **bubhukṣā** DK_IU_2E] *om.* JU_I, bunnukṣā P, babhukṣā LB **pipāsānidroṣṇatā°** L] pipāsānidrā ‖ uṣṇatā ‖ DK_I, *om.* JU_I, pipāsānidrolmatā P, pipāsānidroṣṭṇatā° U_2, pipāsānidrollatā EB **°śīta°** U_2LB] śīta nā DK_I, *om.* JU_I, śītatā P, śītoṣṇatā E **kurvanti** cett.] kuroti D, karoti K_I, *om.* JU_I **vāksiddhir** cett.] vāk ‖ siddhir K_I, *om.* JU_I **bhavati** cett.] *om.* JU_I, bhavatī B 6 **śarīre** DK_IJU_I] *om.* cett. **kācid hānir na** U_2] na kiṃcid glānir D, na kiṃcid vānir K_I, kvacid dhvanir J, kvācid glānir na U_I, *om.* P, kācid bādhāpi E, kācid glānir na LB **°yogī** K_IU_I] °yopī DJ, °rūpī PU_2, °rūṣī E, °rūpi LB **puruṣo** cett.] puruṣī E 7 **pṛthvīṃ** cett.] pṛthvī B **dṛṣṭyā** DK_IPE] dṛṣṭvā JU_IU_2, dṛṣṭā LB **aṇimādyaṣṭasiddhir** cett.] aṇimādyāṣṭasiddhir U_ILB, aṇimāmahimāgarimāladhimā tathā U_2 **bhavati** cett.] prātikāmyamīśatvaṃ ‖ viśītvaṃ ‖ ity āṣṭasiddhayaḥ ‖ U_2

[XLII. **Signs in the body as a result of Rājayoga**]

Now, such signs manifest in the body as a result of Rājayoga.[395] They are described. The eradication of all diseases occurs. He sees the entire world. Subsequently, knowledge concerning the principles arises. He understands all languages. Then, the person's body becomes as hard as a diamond. After being bitten by a snake, death does not occur. Then, the troubles of hunger, thirst, sleep, heat and cold do not afflict the person. Perfection of speech arises. When struck by lightning, there is no damage whatsoever to the body. Subsequently, the person becomes a yogin of the wind.[396] He sees the entire earth with [his] gaze. The eight supernatural powers beginning with "becoming infinitely small" etc. (*aṇimādi*) arise.

[395] The repeated mention of the effects of Rājayoga seems redundant since the topic has been covered extensively already in section XVI–XVII. Nevertheless, these specific results have not been mentioned so far. In the descriptions of previous chapters, the unhinderedness, equanimity and bliss resulting from Rājayoga were emphasised. Here, the focus shifts to physical results such as health, strength, supernatural abilities or resilience.

[396] Rāmacandra employs *pavanayogī* as a synonym for *vāyuyogī* of his source text *Yogasvarodaya*. The following sentences suggest that the *pavanayogī* is so-called because the yogin can move freely through space, like the wind. That reminds us of *Amanaska* 1.65: *dvādaśāhalayenāpi bhūcaratvaṃ hi sidhyati | nimiṣārdhapramāṇena paryaṭaty eva bhūtalam* ‖ 65 ‖ Birch (213: 243) translates: "By means of absorption for a period of twelve days, the state of moving across the earth is achieved. Within half the time [it takes to] blink an eyelid, [the yogin can] travel [anywhere] around the world." An e-text search for *pavanayogī* yielded no hits, in contrast to *vāyuyogī*. However, the term seems to be mostly associated with *prāṇāyāma* in other texts, as in the case of *Rudrayāmalatantra* 61.177: *pavaneśaś cānilasthā paramātmā nirantaraḥ* (em.] *ninântarā*) *vāyupūrakakārī ca vāyukumbhakavadhinī* ‖ 175 ‖ *vāyucchidrakaro vātā vāyunirgamamudrikā | kumbhakastho recakasthā pūrakasthātipūriṇī* ‖ 176 ‖ *vāyvākāśādhārarūpī vāyusañcārakāriṇī | vāyusiddhikaro dātrī vāyuyogī ca vāyugā* ‖ 177 ‖ " (175) The lord of the breath, residing in breath is the supreme self, not interrupted anywhere. She is one who performs the inhalation of the breath and the one who executes the retention of the breath. (176) He is one who pierces with the breath, he is the blower; she is the one who seals the outflow of the breath. He abides in retention, she abides in exhalation, in inhalation, and in intensified inhalation. (177) She is the one who has the form of a support of space and breath, the one who sets the breath in motion. He is the one who accomplishes the breath, the giver and the yogin of the wind; and she the one who moves the wind."

श्रीपद्मश्च महापद्मः शङ्खो मकरकच्छपौ।
मुकुन्दकुन्दनीलाश्च खर्वश्च निधयो नव॥ XLII.1॥

महापद्माद्या नव निधयः समीप आगच्छन्ति। आकाशमध्ये दशसु दिक्षु गमना–गमनबलं भवति। यत्र लोके गमनेच्छा भवति। तत्र लोके गच्छति। आज्ञा सर्वत्र स्फुरति। परमेश्वरं समीपे पश्यति। करणे हरणे सामर्थ्यं भवति॥

Sources: 5–7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 844): …mahāpadmodayas tathā | āgacchanti samīpe ca nidhayo nātra saṃśayaḥ | yatrecchā gamanaṃ tatra svarge marttye rasātale | sphuraty ājñākhyaḥ sarvatra samīpe parameśvaraḥ | kāraṇe hāraṇe śakto rakṣaṇe 'pi ca pārvati | ātmamadhye mano nityaṃ nirjane nivaset sudhīḥ | kṛtvātmamanasor aikyaṃ prāpnoti paramaṃ padam |

Parallels: 1–3 ≈*Amarakośa* I.I.165–I.I.166: mahāpadmaś ca padmaś ca śaṅkho makarakacchapau | mukundakundanīlāś ca kharvaś ca nidhayo nava ‖

2 **śrīpadmaś ca mahāpadmaḥ** P] *om.* DK_1JU_1EL, padmaś ca mahāpadmaś ca U_2, śrīpadmaś ca mahāpadmaṃ B **śaṅkho** U_2LB] *om.* DK_1JU_1E, saṃkho P **makarakacchapau** em.] *om.* DK_1JU_1E, makarakachapa° P, makarakacchapaḥ U_2LB 3 **mukundakundanīlāś ca** em.] *om.* DK_1JU_1E, kuṃdonukuṃdanīlaś ca P, mukuṃdo kuṃdaś ca nīlaś ca *unm.* U_2, kuṃdonukuṃdoś ca nīlaś ca LB **kharvaś ca nidhayo nava** em.] *om.* DK_1JU_1E, vijñeyā nidhayo nava P, vajrayo navanidhi U_2, vajrayonī cidātmakā L, vajrayonī cīdātmakā B 5 **mahāpadmādyā** DK_1JU_1PE] etādṛśaṃ U_2, mahāpadmājñā LB **nava nidhayaḥ** em.] nidhyayaḥ D, nava nidhayayaḥ K_1, nava nidhayaya J, nava nidhapa U_1, nava nidhaya P, *om.* U_2, nava nidhyayaḥ E, nanidhyayaḥ ‖ L, navinidhyayaḥ ‖ B **samīpa** E] samīpe cett. **āgacchanti** cett.] āgacchati U_2, āgacchatī ‖ nava nidhayaḥ samīpa āgacchanti | B **ākāśamadhye** cett.] ākāśa° JU_1 **daśasu** cett.] °daśa U_2 **dikṣu** cett.] dikṣumadhye DK_1JU_1 5–6 **gamanāgamanabalaṃ** cett.] gamanāgamane bhavataḥ balaṃ E, gamanāgamanavallabhaṃ LB 6 **bhavati** cett.] bhavatī D **yatra** cett.] *om.* E **loke** cett.] *om.* E **gamanecchā** cett.] *om.* E **bhavati** cett.] bhavatī U_1, *om.* E **tatra** cett.] yatra U_1B, *om.* E **loke** cett.] *om.* E **gacchati** cett.] *om.* E **ājñā** cett.] ajñā PU_2LB **sarvatra** cett.] *om.* E 7 **sphurati** cett.] *om.* E **paśyati** cett.] paśyaṃti U_2, paśyaṃtī B **karaṇe** cett.] karaṇaṃ D, karaṇa° K_1 **haraṇe** cett.] taraṇe U_2 **sāmarthyaṃ** cett.] ++++marthyaṃ D, ca sāmarthyaṃ JU_1

XLII.1 1. Śrīpadma ("glorious lotus"), and 2. Mahāpadma ("great lotus"), 3. Śaṃkha ("conch"), 4. Makara ("crocodile"), and 5. Kacchapa ("turtle"), 6. Mukunda ("gem"), 7. Kunda ("jasmine"), and 8. Nīla ("sapphire"), as well as 9. Kharva ("[another type of] gem") are the nine treasures.[397]

The nine treasures, beginning with the Mahāpadma, are near at hand. The power to move in all ten directions through space arises. Wherever one desires to go in the world, one goes there. Unlimited authority manifests everywhere. One sees the Supreme Lord nearby. The capability to create and destroy arises.

[397] The verse is absent in the β-group and therefore greyscaled. A redactor or scribe must have added this verse. The verse might stem from the *Amarakośa*. The nine treasures traditionally belong to the god Kubera, the lord of the riches, the wealthiest god. I emended the edition according to the standard list. The nine treasures that a virtuous emperor possesses are also mentioned in *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.21: *jākaiṃ saba baiṭhe hī sūjñai | asa sabahiṃna kī bhāṣā būjñai | sakala siddhi ājñā mahiṃ jākai | navanidhi sadā rahaiṃ ḍhiṃga tākai* ‖ 21 ‖ Here, the *navanidhi*s are one of the results of Rājayoga (Rājayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* is *vajrolīmudrā*). Furthermore, they are mentioned in *Jogpradīpyakā* 601 (*nāṭika chaṃda sahajahī pāvai aṣṭasidha navanidha cali āvai | prāṇāyāma ādi vasi hoī dasavai dvāra pahautai soī* ‖ 601 ‖) in the context of the *mahābandhamudrā*. In addition, the *navanidhi*s occur in the *vajrolī-section* of the *Jog Manjarī*: *jākauṃ saba dehī ko sūjhai aura sakala jīva kī bhāṣā būjhai | sarva siddhi āgyā maiṃ jākai navanidhi rahai sadā ḍhiṃga tākai |*

[XLIII. **gurubhakteḥ phalam**]

इदं गुरुभक्तेः फलम्। आत्ममध्ये मनसो विश्रामकरणमिच्छता पुरुषेण सद्गुरोः सेवां कृत्वा सावधानं मनः करणीयम्। अभ्यासबलात्परमप्राप्तिः। तेन स्वस्य मनसः समरसं कर्तव्यम्। चन्द्रसूर्यौ यावत्पिण्डो निश्चलो भवति। श्लोकः॥

सम्यक्स्वभावकिरणोदयचिद्विलासे।
व्यक्ते स्वशान्तिमहतां स्वयमेव याति।
ग्रस्ते स्ववेगनिचये पदपिण्डमैक्यम्।
सत्यं भवेत्समरसं गुरुवत्सलानाम्॥ XLIV.1॥

Sources: 2–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 844): candraḥ sūryaḥ sthiro yāvat tāvad dehasthitis tathā | tāvad ekaṃ samābhāṣya prāpnoti ca sadāgatiḥ | sa bhavet kavitā dhīrā niścalā śāntir eva ca | gurupādaprasādena tad aikyaṃ yāti siddhibhāk | 4–8 ≈SSP 5.79 (Ed. p. 105): saṃvitkriyā vikaraṇodayacidvilāsaviśrāntim eva bhajatāṃ svayam eva bhāti | graste svaveganicaye padapiṇḍam aikyaṃ satyaṃ bhavet samarasaṃ guruvatsalānām |

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2 **gurubhakteḥ** cett.] gurubhaktaiḥ P **phalam** cett.] phalaṃ bhavati U_2 **viśrāmakaraṇam** cett.] viśrāme karaṇam U_2, viśrāmaṃ karaṇam L, viśrāmaṃ karaṃṇaṃm B **icchatā** cett.] icchati J, icchatāṃ LB **sadguroḥ** cett.] sadguruḥ DU_1 3 **kṛtvā** cett.] kṛ++ D, kṛtvā ‖ U_2 **sāvadhānaṃ** cett.] māvadhānaṃ U_2 **karaṇīyam** cett.] kṛtvā karaṇīyaṃ L, kṛtvā karaṇīyam B **abhyāsabalāt** cett.] abhyāsabalāt ‖ L **paramaprāptiḥ** cett.] paramapadaprāptiḥ U_2 **tena** cett.] tena saha DK_1JU_1 3–4 **svasya manasaḥ** PU_2LB] svasya manaḥ DK_1, svasya J, svascha manaḥ U_1, svaśiṣyamanasaḥ E 4 **samarasaṃ** L] samarasyaṃ DK_1PU_2, samasyaṃ J, *om.* U_1B, svāsthyaṃ E **kartavyam** cett.] *om.* B **candrasūryau yāvat** K_1U_1PE] caṃdrasūryau yāvit D, caṃdrasūryo yāvat J, caṃdrasūryavat U_2, caṃdrasūryayāt L, *om.* B **piṇḍo** PU_2L] piṇḍe DE, piṃḍau U_1, *om.* B **niścalo** JU_1PU_2L] niścalau DK_1E, *om.* B **bhavati** cett.] bhavatiḥ D, bhavataḥ E, *om.* B **ślokaḥ** DK_1U_2] śloka JU_1L, *om.* PEB 5 **samyak°** cett.] samyagaḥ *unm.* U_1, *om.* B **svabhāvakiraṇodaya°** cett.] svabhāsakiraṇodaya J, karaṇotdṛdi U_2, *om.* B **cidvilāse** em.] cidvilāsam DK_1J, cidvilāsaṃ U_1, cidvilāsa PU_2EL, samarad vilāsa ‖ *unm.* B 6 **vyakte** Hanneder conj.] °grastaṃ DK_1JPU_2ELB, grastasamagraṃ *unm.* U_1 **svaśānti°** cett.] saśāṃti U_1 **mahatāṃ** U_1] avatāṃ DK_1J, manasā PLB, bhavatāṃ U_2, samatāṃ E **svayam** cett.] svam B **yāti** cett.] yāmi P, śāṃti LB 7 **graste** cett.] grāme U_2 **svaveganicaye** cett.] svavegaṃ nicaye DK_1, svavegaṃ niścayed J, svaveganiścaye U_1, sveraṃganicaye U_2 **padapiṇḍam aikyam** cett.] padapiḍam aikyaṃ D, yada piṃḍam aikyaṃ U_2 8 **satyaṃ** cett.] satāṃ L, sataṃ B **guruvatsalānām** em.] guruvatsalānāṃ DK_1JPU_2, guruvatchalānāṃ U_1, guruvatsalāṃ ca E, guruvatsalābhaṃ LB

[XLIII. **Result of devotion towards the teacher**]

This is the reward for devotion to the teacher. An attentive mind should be cultivated by the person desiring to bring about peace of mind within the self after having frequented the teacher. As a result of the power of practice, one attains the supreme [state]. By that, he shall cultivate the uniform taste of his own mind.[398] The body becomes unchangeable for as long as the moon and sun exist. [There is a] verse:

XLIII. 1 [399]When the play of consciousness,[400] the manifestation of the rays of one's intrinsic nature, becomes clear, one arrives at the vastness of peace of the self. When all one's agitations are devoured, the body and [supreme] place[401] truly become one uniform taste for those who are affectionate to the teacher.

[398]In the *Haṭhapradīpikā* 4.70 (= *Vivekamārtaṇḍa* 163; ≈*Yuktabhavadeva* 11.30; ≈*Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* f. 117v), the word *samarasatvam* is used to gloss the state called *samādhi*: *yadā saṃkṣīyate prāṇo mānasaṃ ca vilīyate | tadā samarasatvaṃ yat samādhiḥ so 'bhidhīyate* ‖ When the breath is destroyed and the mind dissolves, all experience is the same (*samarasatva*). That is called *samādhi*." In this context, *samarasa*, which literally means "same taste," indicates equanimity and mental silence.

[399]The metre is Vasantatilaka.

[400]The accusative forms transmitted by the manuscripts in *pāda* ab are perplexing. Ideally, one would anticipate a locative absolute construction as observed in *pāda* c, i.e., *°cidvilāse | graste*. The conversion of accusatives into locatives is a satisfactory solution. Hanneder contends that it is highly implausible for *cidvilāsa* to be an entity that can be devoured. The agitation *nicaya* is antithetical to *cidvilāsa*. The repetition of variants of *grasta* is suspect, as it does not harmonise with *pāda* b. Therefore, *grastaṃ* is probably a dittograph of *graste*. Hence, I adapted the conjecture "*vyakte*", proposed by Hanneder in *pāda* c to yield a coherent verse.

[401]Within the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, *piṇḍa* and *pada* refer to the body and the [supreme] place. The *piṇḍa* is discussed in SSP's chapters two and three. This conclusion is drawn from the fact that throughout these chapters, various elements are located within the body (*piṇḍa*), such as the nine *cakra*s and sixteen *ādhāra*s or the fourteen worlds. The term *pada* is a shorthand for *paramapada*, the supreme place, as shown in *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 5.1: *atha piṇḍapadayoḥ samarasakaraṇaṃ kathyate | mahāsiddhayogī pūrvoktakrameṇa parapiṇḍādisvapiṇḍāntaṃ jñātvā paramapade samarasaṃ kuryāt* ‖1‖ "Now, the process of achieving the uniform taste of the body and the [supreme] place is taught. As it was taught gradually before, after …

[XLIV. **avadhūtapuruṣasya lakṣaṇam**]

इदानीमवधूतपुरुषस्य लक्षणं कथ्यते।

यस्य हस्ते धैर्यदण्डः खर्परं शून्यमानसम्।
योगैश्वर्येण संपन्नः सोऽवधूत उदाहृतः॥ XLIV.1॥

भेदाभेदौ यस्य भिक्षाभरणं जागरं तथा।
एतादृशोऽपि पुरुषः सोऽवधूत उदाहृतः॥ XLIV.2॥

आत्मा ह्यकारो विज्ञेयो वकारो भववासना।
धूतस्तत्कम्पनं प्रोक्तं सोऽवधूतो निगद्यते॥ XLIV.3॥

Sources: 3–4 ≈SSP 6.10 (Ed. p. 111): yasya dhairyamayo daṇḍaḥ parākāśaṃ ca kharparaṃ | yogapaṭṭaṃ nijāśaktiḥ so 'vadhūto 'bhidhīyate | 5–6 ≈SSP 6.11 (Ed. p. 111) : bhedābhedau svayaṃ bhikṣāṃ kṛtvā sāsvādane rataḥ | jaraṇaṃ tanmayībhāvaḥ so 'vadhūto 'bhidhīyate |

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2 **lakṣaṇaṃ** cett.] lakṣaṇam DK_1JU_1LB **kathyate** cett.] āha LB 3 **haste** cett.] hastai U_2 **kharparaṃ** cett.] kharaparaṃ DU_1, kharpara° J **śūnyamānasam** D]śūnyamāna K_1, śūnyanāmakaṃ JU_1, śūnyam āsanam PU_2E, śubhāsanam L, śunyabhāsanam B 4 **yogaiśvaryeṇa** cett.] yogaiśvarye *unm.* L, yogaiśvaryai *unm.* B **saṃpannaḥ** cett.] saṃpanna P, sapannaḥ U_2 **so 'vadhūta** cett.] so vadhūtam LB **udāhṛtaḥ** cett.] udāhṛtaṃ LB 5 **bhedābhedau** cett.] bhedābhedo U_2 **bhikṣābharaṇaṃ** cett.] bhikṣābhakṣaṇaṃ DK_1JU_1, bhīkṣābharaṇaṃ U_2 **jāgaraṃ** P] jāraṇaṃ DK_1JU_1ELB, jīraṇaṃ U_2 6 **etādṛśo 'pi** cett.] tādṛśopi *unm.* LB **so 'vadhūta** cett.] so vadhūtam LB 7 **ātmā** DK_1JPE] ātmai U_1, ā+++ U_2, ātmār L, ātmāt B **hy akāro** cett.] dyukāro LB **vijñeyo** cett.] vijñoyau B **vakāro** cett.] vikāro LB 8 **dhūtas** cett.] dhūtasa *unm.* D, dhūtaṃ E **tatkaṃpanaṃ** cett.] saṃtāpanaṃ E **so 'vadhūto** cett.] so vadhūta PLB **nigadyate** cett.] nirucyate JU_1

[XLIV. **Characteristics of an Avadhūta person**]

Now, the characteristics of an Avadhūta-person are taught.[402]

XLIV. 1 He who has the staff of courage[403] in [his] hand, whose begging bowl is mind of emptiness, he who is endowed with the power of yoga is called an Avadhūta.

XLIV. 2 He, whose alms are "difference and non-difference,"[404] whose ornament is vigilance,[405] only such a person is called an Avadhūta.

XLIV.3 The letter *a* is, in fact, to be known as the self and the letter *va* as mental residues of [mundane] existence; *dhūta* is said to be the shaking off of those [mental residues]; he is called an Avadhūta.[406]

…having realised the beginning with the universal body and ending with the own body, the great Siddhayogin should merge into the supreme place." According to *Tattvayogabindu* XLIX, the *paramaṃ padaṃ* is a synonym for *paraṃ tattvam*, the "supreme reality". Thus, here, the phrase *padapiṇḍam aikyam* must be considered to refer to the goal of yogic endeavour, which is the state of Rājayoga. The concept perhaps derives from *Kubjikāmatatantra* 11.48.

[402] According to Kanamarlapudi (2023), the semantic range of the term *avadhūta* has shifted considerably from the original concept of the antinomian ascetic across texts over the centuries. The Avadhūta was integrated into the Brahmanical *āśrama* system, its unconventional traits and unorthodox practice were tamed, and the Avadhūta was thereby elevated to a legitimate and finally even to the highest class of *saṃnyāsa āśrama*. In Kanamarlapudi's words, the Avadhūta became a sanitised *saṃnyāsin*, see Kanamarlapudi, 2023: 18.

[403] The term *dhairya* can have royal connotations (see Boethlingk, 1858: 167) and could be translated as "courage of a prince".

[404] The *bhedābheda*-Vedānta schools hold the belief that the individual self is both distinct and inseparable from the ultimate reality, Brahman, bridging the gap between Advaita's monistic view of complete identity and Dvaita's dualistic perspective of absolute distinction. See Nicholson, 2023 for a discussion of the concept of *bhedābheda*.

[405] Only manuscript P preserves the reading *jāgaram*, which is the reading of the source text and according to Brunner (1963: 134) means vigilance in Śaiva traditions. Here, the word is attested in neuter form. The other manuscripts present the following variants: *jāraṇaṃ*, and *jīraṇaṃ*. These alternatives make less sense. Another possibility would be to understand *jāgaram* = *jagaram* (n.) as "armour".

[406] The origin of this verse, the next verse, and the subsequent prose passage remains uncertain.

अकारार्थो जीवभूतो वकारार्थोऽथ वासना।
एतद्वयं यो जानति सोऽवधूत उदाहृतः॥ XLIV.4॥

यः पुरुषो द्वितीयं न पश्यति केवलं स्वस्वरूपं पश्यति सोऽवधूतः। अथवा यस्य मनश्चञ्चलभावं न दधाति सोऽवधूतः कथ्यते। यन्न दृश्यते तदव्यक्तमित्युच्यते। तदव्यक्तं प्रत्यक्षेण पश्यति। यत्किंचित्पश्यति तत्सर्वं ग्रसति। मुक्तमिति ज्ञायते। सोऽवधूतः कथ्यते।

अवधूततनुः सोमो निराकारपदे स्थितः।
सर्वेषां दर्शनानां च स्वस्वरूपं प्रकाशते॥ XLIV.5॥

Sources: 7–8 ≈SSP 6.32 (Ed. p. 118): avadhūtatanur yogī nirākārapade sthitaḥ | sarveṣāṃ darśanānāṃ ca svasvarūpaṃ prakāśate |

1 **vakārārtho** cett.] vikārādirsthor *unm.* LB **'tha** cett.] ya U_1U_2B 2 **etad dvayaṃ** P] etad dūyaṃ E, etad vayaṃ cett. **yo jānati** em.] jīyate yaḥ DK_1J, jīryate yaḥ U_1, yaṃ jayati yaḥ P, jayati yaḥ U_2, japaṃ kuryāt E, yaḥ jānati LB **udāhṛtaḥ** cett.] udārataḥ U_1, udādhṛtaḥ L, udādhṛttā B 3 **dvitīyaṃ** U_2E] dvitiyaṃ DK_1JU_1LB, dvitīya P **paśyati** cett.] paśyati ‖ U_2, paśyaṃtī B **svasvarūpaṃ** cett.] svasvarūpa K_1 **paśyati** cett.] tiṣṭhati DK_1JU_1 **°vā** cett.] °cā DJU_1, °ca K_1 4 **manaś** cett.] manaḥ DK_1JU_1 **cañcala°** cett.] cacala° K_1, caṃcalī U_2, caṃcalaṃ LB **bhāvaṃ** cett.] bhāve JU_1, bhāva B **so 'vadhūtaḥ** cett.] so vadhūtaḥ | LB **kathyate** cett.] *om.* LB **yan na** U_1PE] yanma DK_1, yatra J, *om.* U_2, athavā kasyase panna LB **dṛśyate** cett.] *om.* U_2, iśyate B **tad** cett.] °d LB 5 **tad avyaktaṃ** cett.] tad avyakta° DJU_1 **paśyati** cett.] paśyatī U_1, yasyati LB **yatkiṃcit** cett.] yatkiṃcid PELB **paśyati** cett.] dṛśyate PU_2L, ṛśyate EB **tatsarvaṃ** cett.] tatatsarvaṃ P, tatsarva L **grasati** JP] grasatī DK_1U_1, grasaṃti U_2, grastāti E, gasati LB **muktam** cett.] muktim U_2 **jñāyate** cett.] jñāyate ‖ U_2, jñānaṃ paśyati | E 6 **so 'vadhūtaḥ** cett.] 'śauvadhūtaḥ K_1, sāvadhūtaḥ B **kathyate** cett.] kathyataḥ K_1, kathyaṃte U_2 7 **avadhūta°** cett.] āvadhūta U_1 **°tanuḥ** JU_1EB] tanu DK_1PL, ++++ U_2 **somo** cett.] samo J, somā L **sthitaḥ** cett.] sthita U_1B, sthiraḥ P 8 **darśanānāṃ** cett.] darpaṇānāṃ U_2 **prakāśate** PLB] prakāśyate cett.

XLIV. 4 The meaning of the letter *a* is the embodied soul, the meaning of the letter *va* then mental residues. He who knows this pair is declared to be an Avadhūta.

The person who does not see a second [person][407] but only sees [other people as] his own essential nature alone is an Avadhūta. Or, he whose mind does not assume the unsteady state is said to be an Avadhūta. What is not seen, it is said, is the unmanifest. He sees the unmanifest by means of direct perception. Whatever he sees, all of that he devours.[408] He is known to be liberated. He is said to be an Avadhūta.

XLIV.5 The body of the Avadhūta is Soma,[409] existing in a formless state. It shines forth as the essence of all philosophical views.

[407] For *dvitīyaṃ* in the sense of "second person" or "another person", see *Kāśīkhaṇḍa* 4.41.7 and *Aṣṭāvakragītā* 18.16.

[408] The verb *grasati* conveys that all experiences are assimilated into the Avadhūta's *svasvarūpa*.

[409] Rāmancandra has substituted the word *yogin* of his source text with *soma*. *Soma* can have various meanings, with a common translation being the "moon". The moon's radiance is often associated with the juice of the Soma plant, interpreted as *amṛta*, the "nectar of immortality", or sometimes as *kṣīra*, "milk", akin to the Ambrosia of Greek mythology (see Gonda, 1960). In several yoga texts, the body becomes filled with nectar and subsequently perfected through yoga practice, as seen in *Gorakṣayogaśāstra* 28ab: *tataḥ kṣīramayo dehaḥ piṇḍasiddho bhaved dhruvaṃ*. Chapter three of the *Maitreyopaniṣat* describes Maitreya's personal mystical experience in the supreme yogic state. In 3.3ab, he experiences himself as *soma*: *vijñāno 'smi viśeṣo 'smi somo 'smi sakalo 'smy aham* | The *Vivekamārtāṇḍa* (6 chapters) 2.58–73 explains that *soma*, the moon is considered the king of the Brahmins because, even after waning, it begins to wax again, thus embodying its immortal nature: *dhīro vidvān ko na nīcatvam uccair āpatkālaṃ prāpya yāti prayogāt | kṣīṇo dhatte vastrānanto 'pekṣāṃ somo 'smākaṃ brāhmaṇānāṃ tu rājā ‖ 55 ‖ dehasthairyaṃ bheṣajaiḥ samprayuktaṃ prāyaḥ puṃsāṃ yad bhavet sā durāśā | kṣīṇāṅgaḥ syād oṣadhīśo 'pi yasmāt | somo 'smākaṃ brāhmaṇānāṃ tu rājā ‖ 73 ‖*. In his *Haṭhapradīpikājyotsnā* 3.126, Brahmānanda compares the significance of Rājayoga as the king of Yogas for all other yoga practices with the moon as the king of the Brahmins: *pakṣāntare rājño nṛpasya yogo rājayogo rājasambandhas taṃ vinā pṛthvī bhūmir na rājate | śāstāraṃ vinā bhūmau nānopadravasambhavāt | rājā candraḥ | somo 'smākaṃ brāhmaṇānāṃ rājā iti śruteḥ | tasya yogaṃ sambandhaṃ vinā niśā rātrir na …*

सत्यमेकमजं नित्यमनन्तमक्षयं ध्रुवम्।
ज्ञात्वा यस्तं वदेद्धीमान् सत्यवादी स कथ्यते॥ XLIV.6॥

यत्किञ्चिदैक्येन पश्यति स एकः। †तस्य मनो जानाति नाशो न तादृशां पदार्थं ज्ञात्वा काले चेष्टा भवति†स सत्यवादी कथ्यते।

प्रसरं भासते शक्तिः संकोचं भासतेऽपि च।
तयोः संयोगकर्ता यः स भवेत् सत्ययोगभाक्॥ XLIV.7॥

विश्वातीतात्तया विश्वमेकमेव विराजते।
संयोगेन सदा यस्य सिद्धयोगी स गद्यते॥ XLIV.8॥

Sources: 1–2 cf. SSP 6.60 (Ed. p. 128): satyam ekam ajaṃ nityam anantaṃ cākṣayaṃ dhruvam | jñātvā yas tu vaded dhīraḥ satyavādī sa kathyate | 5–6 ≈SSP 6.64 (Ed. p. 129): prasaraṃ bhāsate śaktiḥ saṃkocaṃ bhāsate śivaḥ | tayor yogasya kartā yaḥ sa bhavet siddhayogiraṭ | 7–8 ≈SSP 6.65 (Ed. p. 130): viśvātītaṃ yathā viśvam ekam eva virājate | saṃyogena sadā yas tu siddhayogī bhavet tu saḥ ‖

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1 **ekam** cett.] ekām DK_IJU_I **ajaṃ** cett.] ja *unm.* D **nityam** PELB] nityaṃ cett. **anantam** K_IPELB] manaṃ tam DU_IU_2, manaṃ hy J 2 **jñātvā** cett.] jñātvāt DL **yas taṃ** em.] hy ++++ D, hy sva K_I, hy asta J, hy astaṃ U_I, hy evaṃ γ **vaded** cett.] vadet U_2 **satyavādī** cett.] *om.* L **sa** cett.] *om.* U_2 3 **yatkiṃcid** cett.] *om.* U_2, yatkiṃcin E, yatkiṃ LB **aikyena** DK_IJ] aikena U_I, yena P, *om.* U_2, na E, kena LB **paśyati** cett.] paśyatī U_I, *om.* U_2, paśyaṃti LB **sa** cett.] sa sa D, *om.* U_2 **ekaḥ** cett.] *om.* U_2, eko E **tasya** cett.] *om.* U_2, hy evaṃ E **mano** cett.] manaso PELB, *om.* U_2 **jānāti** JL] jātitā D, jātinā K_I, jnānaṃti U_I, na jānāti P, *om.* U_2, vijānāti E, jānātir B **nāśo na** DK_I] tādṛśo J, tādṛśot U_I, na nāśo na PLB, *om.* U_2, nāśā na E **tādṛśāṃ** cett.] tādṛśaṃ JPELB, *om.* U_2 **padārthaṃ** cett.] padārtha P, *om.* U_2 4 **jñātvā** cett.] *om.* U_2, jñā LB **kāle** cett.] kāla° DU_I, *om.* U_2 **ceṣṭā** cett.] *om.* U_2 **bhavati** cett.] *om.* U_2 **sa satyavādī kathyate** cett.] *om.* U_2 5 **prasaraṃ** conj.] vasare DK_IJU_I, vāsare PU_2L, vāsvare E, vāsvre B **bhāsate** conj.] bhāsvare DK_IPU_2EB, bhāskare JU_IL **śaktiḥ** cett.] śaktiḥ | DU_2, *om.* LB **saṃkocaṃ** conj.] saṃkoco $DK_IU_IPU_2$E, saṃkoce J, *om.* LB **bhāsate** conj.] bhāsvare cett., bhāskare U_I, *om.* LB 6 **tayoḥ** cett.] *om.* U_ILB **saṃyogakartā yaḥ** cett.] saṃyogaḥ karttā yaḥ L, sayogaḥ kartavyaḥ B **sa bhavet** cett.] saṃvit svabhāvāt U_I, bhavat B 7 **viśvātītāt tayā** em.] viśvātīta ttayā DK_I, viśvāvāso viśvātīta tayā *unm.* J, viśvāso viśvātita tayā *unm.* U_I, viśvānīta tayā PE, viśvātita tayā U_2, visvātitā tayā LB **virājate** cett.] evādhirājate J 8 **saṃyogena** DK_I] saṃyogo na cett. **gadyate** cett.] kathyate JU_IP

XLIV.6 Having known the one truth which is unborn, eternal, infinite, imperishable [and] changeless, the wise man who proclaims it is said to be a speaker of truth.

Whatever he sees united, he is one [with it]. †...†,[410] he is called a speaker of truth.

XLIV.7 Śakti shines forth as expansion and as contraction.[411] He who unites the two experiences true yoga.[412]

XLIV.8 Through that the universe shines forth as only one, as a result of being beyond the universe. One who is always united with it is said to be a perfected yogin.

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rājate | rājayogaṃ vinā nṛpasambandhaṃ vinā mudrā rājabhiḥ patreṣu kriyamāṇaś cihnaviśeṣaḥ |vicitrāpi | pṛthvīpakṣe ratnādijanakatvena vilakṣaṇāpi niśāpakṣe grahanakṣatrādibhir vicitrāpi mudrāpakṣe rekhābhir vicitrāpi na rājate |

[410] Rāmacandra appears to elucidate the preceding verse or add relevant information in his prose interjections. As the transmission lacks convincing meaning, I have marked the passage with cruxes.

[411] Rāmacandra has borrowed the verse from the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* and redacted it. The transmission of the manuscripts introduces *bhāskara* ("sun") instead of the source text's *bhāsate*, and *vāsara* ("day") instead of *prasara*. As this makes little sense even with much imagination, I emend the text according to the source. However, the editorial change from *śivaḥ* to *'pi ca* should be retained as this aligns with Rāmacandra's previous redactions of his source texts, where he strives not to mention specific deities by name. In this passage, he also seems to consider SSP 4.19: *sarvaśaktiprasarasaṅkocābhyāṃ jagatsṛṣṭiḥ saṃhṛtiś ca bhavaty eva na sandehaḥ |* "There is no doubt that the creation and destruction of the world result from the expansion and contraction of Sarvaśakti." This teaching appears to be associated with *Kubjikāmatatantra* 11.40–43.

[412] Satyayoga is discussed on p. 477 and Siddhayoga on p. 436.

सर्वासां निजवृत्तीनां विस्मृतिं भजते तु यः।
स भवेत्सिद्धसिद्धान्ते सिद्धयोगी स गद्यते॥ XLIV.9॥

उदासीनः सदा शान्तो महानन्दमयोऽपि च।
यो भवेत् सिद्धयोगेन सिद्धयोगी स कथ्यते॥ XLIV.10॥

[XLV. **kamalānāṃ saṃketam adbhutam**]

अधुना कमलानां तु शृणु संकेतमद्भुतम्।
अनेकाकारभेदोत्थं किं स्वरूपं तु निर्मलम्।
कमलं तेन विख्यातं त्रिविधं तत्त्वदेहकम्॥ XLV.1॥

Sources: 1–2 ≈SSP 6.66 (Ed. p. 130): sarvāsāṃ nijavṛttīnāṃ prasṛtir bhajate layam | sa bhavet siddhasiddhānte siddhayogī mahābalaḥ | 3–4 ≈SSP 6.67 (Ed. p. 130): udāsīnaḥ sadā śāntaḥ svastho 'ntarnijabhāsakaḥ | mahānandamayo dhīraḥ sa bhavet siddhayogirāṭ | 6–8 cf. YSv (PT, p. 844): adhunā kamalānān tu śṛṇu saṅketam adbhutam | anekākārabhedotthaṃ kaṃ svarūpan tu nirmalam | kamalaṃ tena vikhyātaṃ trividhaṃ tattvadehakam |

1 **nijavṛttīnāṃ** cett.] bījavṛtīnāṃ LB **vismṛtiṃ** $K_1JU_1U_2$] vismṛtī PB, vismṛtīr E, vismṛtīṃ L 2 **siddhānte** cett.] siddhasiddhānto E 3 **udāsīnaḥ** cett.] udāsīna K_1U_1, *om.* L **sadā śānto** cett.] *om.* L **mahānandamayo** K_1JU_1B] brahmānandamayo PE, mahānaṃdamayā U_2, *om.* L **'pi ca** cett.] *om.* L 4 **yo bhavet siddhayogena siddhayogī sa kathyate** cett.] *om.* L 6 **śṛṇu** cett.] nuṣre P 7 **anekākārabhedotthaṃ** U_2E] anekākārabhedocchaṃ K_1PB, anekakārabhedotthaṃ JU_1, anekakārabhedātthaṃ L **kiṃ** LB] kaṃ K_1JPE, sva° U_1, kaḥ U_2 **svarūpaṃ tu nirmalam** conj.] svarūpātmakaṃ malaṃ K_1JPLB, sva svarūpātmakaṃ malaṃ U_1, svarūpātmakaṃ paraṃ U_2, svarūpātmakaṃ malam E 8 **trividhaṃ** cett.] vividhaṃ P **tattvadehakam** em.] tena dehagaṃ K_1JU_1, tatra dahagaṃ U_2, tatra dehagaṃ ELB

Notes: 1 **sarvāsāṃ …**: From the first word of verse XLIV.9 up to the middle of section L a larger lacuna starts in D. The omissions will not be recorded to avoid the inflation of the critical apparatus. The reader will be notified once the evidence from D resumes.

XLIV.9 He who forgets all inherent fluctuations [of the mind],[413] he is called a perfected yogin according to the doctrine of the Siddhas.

XLIV.10 One who is always indifferent, peaceful and immersed in great bliss by means of Siddhayoga is said to be a perfected yogin.

[XLV. **The wonderful esoteric teaching of the lotus flowers**]

XLV.1 Now, listen to the wonderful esoteric teaching of the lotus flowers. What [is it that] arises as manifold differentiations of form, but [its] own true form is pure?[414] [It is] the lotus, for it is known as the threefold body of [supreme] reality.[415]

[413] *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* (cf. sources) glosses the description with *laya* instead of *vismṛti* in order to simplify the terminology: "[When] the flow of all one's fluctuations [of the mind] assumes [the state of] absorption, one is called a mighty Siddhayogin according to the doctrine of the Siddhas." In *Haṭhapradīpikā* 4.25*25 (4.34 in the Vulgate of the *Haṭhapradīpikā*) *laya* is defined as *viṣayavismṛti*: *apunarvāsanotthānāl layo viṣayavismṛtiḥ* |

[414] I decided to emend according to the source text and read *svarūpaṃ tu nirmalam*, since the readings *svarūpātmakaṃ malam* or *svasvarūpātmakaṃ malaṃ* would render the true form and the lotus as impure, which would be nonsensical—as the true form in the preceding sections is always presented as intrinsically pure, and the lotus is a symbol of purity. The scribe of U_2 attempted to preserve the reading and emended *malam* to *param*. Considering the source text's reading *svarūpaṃ tu nirmalam*, we can see that *malam* resulted from *nirmalam*. This reading provides a much better sense. In the case of the last *pāda*, the manuscript's reading of *tattra dehagam* or *tena dehagam* is a corruption of the source text's reading *tattvadehakam*.

[415] This verse introduces the following sections which present three lotuses in the body. The first one is the four-petalled lotus of the *mūlādhāra*. The second one is the twelve-petalled lotus of the heart. The third lotus has eight petals and is situated within the twelve-petalled lotus of the heart.

[XLVI. **ādhārakamalam**]

अथाधःकमलं कथ्यते। आधारकमलमस्य कमलमिति संज्ञा कस्मात्।एकमात्मा स्वरूपं स आत्मनमनेकरूपं पश्यति। तद्दर्शनं कमलमिति कथ्यते। तस्मात्क–मलमिति संज्ञा। अस्याधारः कमलस्य दलचतुष्टयं भवति। प्रथमदलं सत्त्वगुणस्य। द्वितीयं राजोगुणस्य। तृतीयं तमोगुणस्य। चतुर्थं दले मनस्तिष्ठति। एतद्दलचतुष्टयसंगादात्मा साध्वसाधु करोति। तस्मिन्कमले निश्चलीकृते सति पुरुषस्य समीपे मरणं न गच्छति॥

Sources: 2–7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 844): tatrādhāraś catuṣpatre sattvarajastamodayaḥ | etad bhā-vasthitaś cātmā sādhvasādhukaro bhavet | asmin sati sthire citte yamo vandīva gacchati |

2 **athādhaḥ** cett.] *om.* E, athādha° LB **kamalaṃ** cett.] kamakamalaṃ K_1, *om.* E **kathyate** cett.] *om.* E **ādhārakamalam** cett.] adhārakamalam E, ārakamalaṃ B **saṃjñā** cett.] kaṃ E **kasmāt** cett.] kasmāt ‖ K_1U_2E **ekam** U_2] ka K_1, kaḥ JU_1, kam PE, kām L, *om.* B 2–3 **ātmā svarūpaṃ** K_1JPU_2L] ātmā U_1E, svarūpaṃ B 3 **sa ātmanam** em.] sa ātmanaṃ cett., tasmāt kamalam E **anekarūpaṃ** K_1JPU_2] anekarūpaṃ svarūpaṃ U_1, *om.* E, anarūpaṃ LB **paśyati** cett.] paśyate U_1, *om.* E **tad darśanaṃ** U_2] tadṛśanaṃ K_1JU_1P, *om.* E, tadṛśa LB **kamalam** em.] kamala K_1JU_1, mala P, malaṃ U_2, *om.* E, na LB **iti kathyate** K_1JU_1] ity ucyate PU_2LB, *om.* E **tasmāt** cett.] *om.* E 3–4 **kamalam** cett.] kamala K_1JU_1, *om.* E 4 **iti** U_1PU_2LB] *om.* E **saṃjñā** cett.] *om.* E, saṃjñāṃ L **asyādhāraḥ** PELB] asyādhāra° $K_1U_1U_2$, asyādhārasya J **ka-malasya** cett.] kamala° JE **dalacatuṣṭayaṃ** $K_1JU_1U_2$] *om.* P, catuṣṭayaṃ E, dalaṃ catuṣṭayaṃ LB **bhavati** cett.] *om.* P, bhavatī LB **prathamadalaṃ** K_1JU_1] *om.* P, prathamaṃ U_2ELB 5 **sattvaguṇasya** cett.] *om.* P, satyaguṇasya L **rājoguṇasya** JU_2L] rajoguṇa K_1U_1, rājayogasya P, rājayogaya E, rājoguṇaḥ B **tṛtīyaṃ** cett.] tṛtīye K_1 **tamoguṇasya** $K_1U_1PU_2$] tamoguṇaṃ J, tamoguṇaḥ EL, tamoguṇa B **caturthe** cett.] caturthaṃ J, caturtho E, *om.* B **dale manas** K_1U_2EL] dalaṃ manas J, dalaṃ manaḥ U_1, dalam enas P, *om.* B **tiṣṭhati** cett.] stiṣṭhati U_1, *om.* B 6 **etad** cett.] etac K_1JU_1, *om.* B **dala** cett.] *om.* K_1JU_1B **catuṣṭaya°** $K_1JU_1PU_2$] catuṣṭayaṃ EL, *om.* B **saṃgād** K_1JU_1P] saṃyogād U_2, ca saṃgād E, saṃjñāgid L, *om.* B **ātmā** cett.] ātma K_1JU_1, *om.* B **sādhvasādhu** K_1JU_2] sādhvasādhū U_1, sāvadhvasādhu P, sādhu EL, *om.* B **karoti** cett.] *om.* B **tasmin** cett.] *om.* U_1 **kamale** cett.] *om.* U_1 **niścalī** K_1JPU_2E] *om.* U_1, niccalī LB **kṛte** cett.] *om.* U_1 **sati** cett.] *om.* U_1 7 **puruṣasya** cett.] *om.* U_1 **samīpe** cett.] *om.* U_1 **maraṇaṃ** cett.] *om.* U_1 **na gacchati** cett.] nāgacchati K_1U_2, nāgacchati ‖ cha ‖ J, *om.* U_1

[XLVI. **Lotus of support**]

Now, the lower lotus is explained. Why is the technical designation of this lotus the "support lotus"? The self, a single essential form, perceives itself in many forms. This perception is referred to as the lotus. Therefore, it is given the technical designation of "lotus." Its "support" is the tetrad of the petals of the lotus. The first petal consists of the *sattva*-quality. The second consists of the *rajas*-quality. The third consists of *tamas*-quality. In the fourth petal is the mind.[416] As a result of the connection of the four petals, the self acts [in] good and bad [ways]. When the lotus is made motionless, death does not come near the person.[417]

[416] The image that the author presumably wants to convey here is the following: The lotus plant grows from a single root base and develops many lotus flowers in different colours and sizes with harmoniously arranged petals. The lotus thus stands for diversity that emerges from a common source, or for the diversity of the manifest that is based on unity. At the same time, the lotus grows out of the mud but remains untouched by it. It is a symbol of the purity and immaculateness of the one Self amidst the multiplicity of the world. In addition, the lotus has a clear geometry — the leaves are arranged symmetrically around the centre. Each lotus flower is connected to the one Self, and the petals represent the individualised Self's view of the multiplicity of the world, which consists of the three *guṇa*s and is perceived via *manas* through the senses (contained in the petals of the upper two lotuses which are presented in the following section).

[417] In *Tattvayogabindu* IV (p. 112) the *mūlādhāra* is associated with the same four petals. Thus, we must assume that the lower lotus is situated at the beginning of the central channel. Alternatively, as manuscript U_2 declares in its additional material that the *ādhāracakra* is at the anus. The main difference, however, is that this time, the location is described as a *kamala* and not as a *cakra*. Interestingly, the passage implies an unspecified yogic practice. In order to delay death, the unspecified practice instructs to cause stillness within the *kamala*. Is this the same as the meditation technique in the context of the first *cakra*? Probably, since the source text for this passage reads: *asmin sati sthire citte yamo vandīva gacchati* | "When the mind is in this [the lotus], death itself [respectfully] withdraws – like a court herald [who bows and leaves the king's presence.]"

[XLVII. **hṛdayakamalasya bhedaḥ**]

इदानीं हृदयकमलस्य भेदः कथ्यते। द्वादशदलानि सिद्धपुरुषाः कथयन्ति। तथा द्विषण्णां दलानामष्टदलं मध्ये एकं कठिनं भवति। तदष्टदलं कमलं हृदये तिष्ठति। ते उभे हृदये तिष्ठतः। प्रथमे दले शब्दस्तिष्ठति। द्वितीये दले स्पर्शस्तितिष्ठति। तृतीये दले रूपं तिष्ठति। चतुर्थे दले रसस्तिष्ठति। पञ्चमे दले गन्धस्तिष्ठति। षष्ठे दले चित्तं तिष्ठति। सप्तमे दले बुद्धिस्तिष्ठति। अष्टमे दलेऽहंकारस्तिष्ठति। एतदष्टदलमध्ये समग्रपृथिव्याकारो वर्तते।

Sources: 2–7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 844): anāhato dvitīyaṃ yatkathyate śṛṇu śraddhayā | anāhate mahāpīṭhe caturasrasamanvitam | varttate 'ṣṭadalaṃ padmam adhovaktran tu satpuram | sparśaśabdarūparasagandhā buddhir manas tathā | ahaṅkāraḥ kramād ete tatrāṣṭadalasaṃsthitāḥ |

2 **hṛdayakamalasya bhedaḥ** PLB] hṛdayakamalasya dvitīyo bhedaḥ K_1U_1, hṛdayakamalasya dvitīyo bhedāḥ J, hṛdayakamalasya bhedāḥ U_2, hṛyakamalabhedāḥ E **kathyate** cett.] kathyaṃte JE **dvādaśadalāni** cett.] dvādaśakalāni J **siddhapuruṣāḥ** cett.] siddhāḥ puruṣāḥ U_2 **kathayanti** PE] kathyaṃte K_1U_1LB, kathayaṃtī JU_2 **tathā** PU_2LB] tathāpi K_1JU_1, *om.* E 3 **dviṣaṇṇām** Sellmer em.] varṇaṃ K_1J, varṇa° U_1, dviṣaṇāṃ PU_2, anuparṇa° E, dviṣaṇā LB **dalānām** $K_1U_1PU_2$E] ++nāṃ J, dalanā LB **aṣṭadalaṃ** conj.] aṣṭadalāṃ ‖ K_1, maṣṭadalānāṃ J, aṣṭadalā U_1, aṣṭadalānāṃ PU_2E **madhye** PU_2] *om.* K_1JU_1, madhya ELB **ekaṃ** cett.] eva U_1 **kaṭhinaṃ** K_1E] kaṭhiṇaṃ JPU_2LB, kaṭitaṃ U_1 **tadaṣṭadalaṃ** cett.] tataḥ aṣṭadalaṃ K_1J, tata aṣṭadalaṃ U_1 3–4 **te ubhe** K_1JU_1PL] te ubha U_2B, te ubhaye E 4 **hṛdaye** cett.] pi K_1U_1, api J **tiṣṭhataḥ** cett.] kathyate K_1JU_1 **prathame dale** JU_1E] prathamadale K_1PLB, prathamadala° U_2 **śabdas** cett.] śabdaḥ U_1, °śabdaṃ U_2 **tiṣṭhati** cett.] stiṣṭhati U_1, tiṣṭhanti E **dvitīye dale** K_1U_1P] dvitīye dala° J, dvitīyadale cett. **sparśas** cett.] sparśaḥ K_1U_1E, sparśa B **tiṣṭhati** cett.] *om.* E 4–5 **tṛtīye dale** K_1E] tritīye dala° J, tritīyadale U_1PU_2, tritiyadale LB 5 **rūpaṃ** cett.] rūpas J, rūpaḥ U_1 **caturthe dale** PE] caturthadale K_1JU_1LB, caturthadala° U_2 **rasas** cett.] rasaḥ U_1 **pañcame dale** $K_1JU_1U_2$E] pañcamadale cett. **gaṅdhas** cett.] gaṃdhaḥ U_1, gaṃdha PB, gandhaṃ E **tiṣṭhati** cett.] stiṣṭhati U_1 **ṣaṣṭhe dale** em.] saṣṭhe dale $K_1JU_1U_2$, saṣṭhadale PLB, paṣṭhadale E 5–6 **cittaṃ** PU_2E] citta J, cittaḥ U_1, ciṃtta L, ciṃta B 6 **tiṣṭhati** cett.] stiṣṭhati U_1 **saptame dale** $K_1JU_1U_2$E] saptamadale cett. **buddhis** cett.] budhiḥ U_1 **aṣṭame dale** $K_1JU_1PU_2$E] aṣṭamadale LB **'haṃkāras** K_1JPE] ahaṃkāraḥ U_1U_2, ahaṃkāras LB **etad aṣṭadalamadhye** cett.] eta dalamadhye K_1, etat tatadalamadhye U_1, etad aṣṭadale madhye P 7 **samagraprthivyākāro** PU_2LB] samagryā pṛthvākāro K_1U_1, samagryā pṛthivyākāro J, pṛthivyākāro E

Notes: 2–3 **tathā dviṣāṇṇām …kaṭhiṇaṃ bhavati**: The next twenty-one sentences of XLVII are transposed in E. In order to preserve important readings, I collated the evidence of E according to the structure of all other witnesses.

[XLVII. **Division of the heart lotus**]

Now, the division of the heart lotus is taught. The accomplished persons teach twelve petals [of it]. So, too, in the middle of the twelve petals, there is one solid eight-petalled [lotus].[418] This eight-petalled lotus is situated in the heart. They are both situated in the heart.[419]

Sound resides in the first petal. Touch resides in the second petal. Form resides in the third petal. Taste resides in the fourth petal. Smell resides in the fifth petal. The mental faculty (*citta*) is situated in the sixth petal. The intellect resides in the seventh petal. The principle of individuation resides in the eighth petal. The form of the entire earth exists within the eight petals.[420]

[418] Rāmacandra introduces the concept of an eight-petalled lotus within the twelve-petalled lotus in the heart as early as section VII on p. 120. The phrase *ekaṃ kaṭhinaṃ bhavati* is peculiar. However, since this second lotus within the lotus faces downwards initially and is turned upwards to bloom through meditation, it seems logical that the author wants the reader to understand that before the lotus flower blooms, its petals are closed, forming a firm or hard unit. Therefore, it seems plausible to interpret *ekaṃ* as one single eight-petalled lotus bud and *kaṭhinam* literally as hard, describing the property of hardness of a closed lotus bud.

[419] The concept of a distinct space within the lotus of the heart (*hṛdayākāśa*), where the self (*ātman*) resides, traces back to early Upanishadic literature, particularly in *Chāndogya Upaniṣad* 8.1.1–5. The specific notion of a twelve-petalled lotus within an eight-petalled lotus is further developed by non-Saiddhāntika Śaiva exegetes of Kashmir, especially within the Trika tradition, a subdivision of the Śaktitantra division of the Vidyāpīṭha. For a concise discussion on the meditation method focusing on the two heart lotuses, see Bäumer, 2013: 49. Furthermore, this dual lotus concept appears in the *Siddhayogeśvarīmata* chapters 17 and 20. Here, amidst intricate descriptions of possession, rites, and deity worship, an elaborate *maṇḍala* is depicted, featuring a twelve-spoked *cakra* embedded with an eight-petalled lotus. For a visual representation of the *maṇḍala* in *Siddhayogeśvarīmata* 20, see Törzsök, 2022: 117–124.

[420] For the Śaiva exegetes of Kashmir, the heart is the binding force of all conscious experiences. The individual person is a *kula* composed of eight elements: five senses, the ego, the mental faculty and the intellect. These eight are a unified, interrelated *kaula* based on consciousness as their common substratum, see Pandey, 1963: 594–597 and Muller-Ortega, 1989: 59.

अथ च तत्कमलमधोमुखं तिष्ठति। अस्य कमलस्य ध्यानादात्मप्रकाशो भवति। प्रकाशादनन्तरं कमलमूर्ध्वमुखं भवति। तथा सूर्यप्रकाशादनन्तरं तदा कमल–मध्ये कमलं विकसति। तथेदमप्यात्मप्रकाशानन्तरमूर्ध्वमुखं विकसति। तन्मध्ये परमानन्दरूपा भूमिर्भवति। तस्याहं सोऽहं स इति संज्ञा। तस्य मध्ये स्वात्मनो ध्यानाद्दिने दिन आयूर्वर्धयति। रोगा दूरे भवन्ति।

शक्तिस्त्रिशाल्येककृता सम्यक्मुद्रा च खेचरी।
चिदानन्दोदयश्चन्द्रश्चेतना चन्द्रिकान्विता॥ XLVII.1॥

Sources: 1–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 844–845): saparyā pṛthag ākārā varttate tatra niścitam | dhyānād ātmaprakāśo 'sya prakāśaṃ kamalaṃ tataḥ | yathā sūryaprakāśena ūrddhvavaktraṃ prakāśitam | ātmadhyānāt sadā tatra āyur vṛddhir dine dine | 7–8 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845): śaktiprasannatā syāc ca rogaśokavivarjitaḥ | yasya mudrābhyāsaśālī samyak siddhā ca khecarī | cidānandamayaṃ cittaṃ cetanā candrikānvitā |

1 **tatkamalam** em.] tatkamalaṃ K_IJU_I, tatkamalamadhye cett. **adhomukhaṃ** K_IJU_I] mukhaṃ cett. **dhyānād ātmaprakāśo** K_IJU_I] dhyānākāśo PLB, dhyānād ātprakāśo U_2, nādāt prakāśo E 2 **prakāśād** cett.] prakāśā° K_IJE, prakāśāvan L **anantaraṃ** cett.] °naṃtaraṃ K_IE, °naṃbaraṃ J, aṃtaraṃ L, anaṃtara | B **kamalam** cett.] kamalaṃ B **ūrdhvamukhaṃ** cett.] ūdhvamukhaṃ K_I, mūrdhvaṃ mukhaṃ B **bhavati** cett.] vikasaṃti J **tathā** cett.] yathā K_IU_I, *om.* J **sūryaprakāśād anantaraṃ** U_2] sūryaprakāśānaṃtaraṃ K_IU_IPEL, *om.* J, sūryo prakāśānaṃtaraṃ | B 2–3 **tadā kamalamadhye** PLB] tadā K_IU_I, *om.* J, tadā malamadhye U_2, tadā saromadhye E 3 **kamalaṃ** cett.] kamalamadhye K_I, *om.* J **vikasati** cett.] *om.* J, visati P **tathedam** PU_2E] tathā idam K_IU_I, *om.* J, tam LB **apy** U_IE] *om.* J, api cett. **ātmaprakāśānaṃtaram** K_IPU_2] *om.* J, ātmaprakāśānataram U_I, ātmāprakāśānantaram E **ūrdhvamukhaṃ** $K_IU_IU_2EL$] *om.* J, ūrdhvaṃ mukhaṃ P, mūrdhvaṃ mukhaṃ B **vikasati** cett.] *om.* J **tanmadhye** cett.] tanamadhye U_2 4 **°rūpā bhūmir** cett.] °rūpā dhūmir K_I, °rūpo bhūmir L **bhavati** cett.] bhavatī U_I **'haṃ sa** cett.] °dara K_I, °daraṃ J, ham E **tasya** LB] tasyā cett. **svātmano** cett.] svātmanaḥ K_IJU_I 5 **dhyānād** cett.] dhyād U_2B **dina** em.] dine cett. **āyūr** cett.] hy āyur E **vardhayati** LB] varddhate K_IPE, varddhati JU_IU_2 **rogā** cett.] rogo E **dūre** cett.] dūrā L, dūro B **bhavanti** cett.] bhavati EB 7 **śaktis** cett.] śaktiḥ K_I, tathā dviṣaśaktis E **triśālyekakṛtā** conj.] trīpalāṃ kṛtaṃ *unm.* K_I, tripalāṃkataṃ *unm.* J, trīvalī kṛtaṃ *unm.* U_I, tritayalokāṃta° P, tritayalokāntaḥ U_2, tṛtīyalokāṃtaḥ E, tritayo lokāṃta° LB **mudrā** cett.] samudrā E **ca khecarī** K_IJPU_2L] bhavati khecarī *unm.* U_I, khecarī *unm.* E, ca khecari B 8 **cidānandodayaś** K_IJ] cidānaṃdodayaṃś U_I, cidānandādayaś P, cidānaṃdādayaḥ U_2, cidānandādvaya E, cidānaṃdādayoś LB **candraś** K_IJ] caṃdraḥś U_I, caḍriś P, caṃdrāś U_2, candra° E, *om.* LB **cetanā** em.] cetanāṃ K_I, cetanāś J, cetanāś U_I, cadrikā P, cadrikā U_2, caṃdrikā E, caṃḍrīkā L, caḍrikā B **candrikānvitā** em.] caṃdrikānvitaḥ K_I, caṃdrakānvitaḥ J, caṃdrakānvitā U_I, cetanānvitāḥ P, cetanānvitaḥ U_2, veti nāmānvitaḥ E, cetanvitāḥ LB

Notes: 5 **rogā dūre ...**: Evidence of E resumes at this point and resynchronises with the structure of the other witnesses.

Moreover, this lotus is downward facing. As a result of the meditation on that lotus, the light of the self arises. Upon that illumination, the lotus faces upwards without delay. Therefore, immediately after the illumination, which is like [the light of] the sun, the lotus within the lotus blooms. Accordingly, only after the illumination of the self, the upward-facing [lotus] blooms. Within it, the stage of the supreme bliss arises. The technical designation of it is "I am he, he is I". Because of the meditation on one's own self in the middle of it, the lifespan increases day by day. Diseases [remain] far away.

XLVII.1 The Śakti, furnished with the three [moon, sun and fire], that has been completely made into one, is the seal that is Khecarī.[421] The moon has the arising of the bliss of consciousness. Consciousness is endowed with the light of the moon.[422]

[421] In the Haṭha- and Rājayogacorpus *Khecarīmudrā* usually refers either to a physical practice in which the yogin inserts his tongue into the nasopharyngeal cavity, (cf. Mallinson, 2010) or to *śāmbhavīmudrā*, like in *Śivayogapradīpikā* 5.3, *Haṭhapradīpikā* 4.5–7 or *Candrāvalokana* 2, which equate *khecarī* and *śāmbhavī*. Judging by the passage's context, however, neither seems to be the case. Rather, this passage seems to draw on the concept of *khecarīmudrā* of the Kashmiri Śaiva exegetes of the Trika division. Cf. *Parātrīśikāvivaraṇa* verse 1 with Abhinavagupta's commentary. Here, Abhinavagupta equates Khecarī with Śakti as Rāmacandra does in our verse, cf. Singh, Lakshman-Joo, and Bäumer, 2005: 7. Muller-Ortega (1989: 142–146) explains in this regard, that *khecarīmudrā* is "the ability of consciousness to freely move (*carati*) about in the space (*kha*) of the heart".

[422] The problem with this verse lies in *pāda* a. The best representative of the β-group available for this passage, manuscript U_1, reads *śaktis trīvalī kṛtaṃ*, and is much closer to the reading of the source text than all other readings of the γ-group manuscripts. The source text reads *yasya mudrābhyāsaśālī*. However, the reading of U_1 is unmetrical. It seems that *°valī* in manuscript U_1 is a corruption of *°śālī* from the source text. Therefore, an important intermediate step here would be to first reconstruct *śaktis triśālī kṛtaṃ*, which is still unmetrical. The missing syllable can be derived as follows. The Śakti mentioned in our half-verse, according to the previously reconstructed intermediate step, is equipped with three. According to the following verses XLVII.2–4, the only mentioned triad is the triad consisting of moon, sun, and fire. It is therefore plausible that the adjective *triśālī* assumes the gender of Śakti and is understood as "equipped with [the] three", and that these three are the triad mentioned in …

परमात्मा महासूर्यरश्मिपुञ्जः प्रकाशकः।
प्रकाशानन्दयोरैक्यं प्रकर्तव्यं निरन्तरम्॥ XLVII.2॥

स्वयमग्निर्महाज्योतिराभाति परमं पदम्।
सदोदितमनश्चन्द्रः सूर्योदयमिवेक्षते॥ XLVII.3॥

तेन ग्रस्तो मनश्चन्द्रः सोऽपि लीनः स्वयंपदे।
पद्मेव महानग्निर्येन ग्रस्तं कलामयम्।
एवं चन्द्रार्कवह्नीनां सङ्केतः परमार्थतः॥ XLVII.4॥

Sources: 1–2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845): paramātmā mahāsūryaḥ sūrya ekaḥ prakāśakaḥ | prakāśānandayor aikyaṃ karttavyañ ca nirantaram | dīptas tathā mahājyotīr avirbhāti paraṃ padam | sadoditaṃ manaḥsūryaṃ candrajyotir ivekṣate | 3–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845): paramātmā mahāsūryaḥ sūrya ekaḥ prakāśakaḥ | prakāśānandayor aikyaṃ karttavyañ ca nirantaram | dīptas tathā mahājyotīr avirbhāti paraṃ padam | sadoditaṃ manaḥsūryaṃ candrajyotir ivekṣate |

1 **paramātmā mahāsūryaraśmipuñjaḥ** K_IJU_I] paramātmā sahāsūryaraśmipuṃja° P, paramātmā mahāsūryaraśmipuṃja° U_2LB, paramātmanā saharaśmipuṃja° E **prakāśakaḥ** cett.] prakāśaḥ E 3 **agnir** cett.] agni° K_IJ, manasi E **mahājyotir** cett.] mahājyotiś U_I **ābhāti** cett.] abhāti K_IU_I **paramaṃ padam** cett.] paraṃmapadaṃ U_2, paramapadam B 4 **sadoditamanaś** K_IELB] sadoditaṃ manaś JPU_2, sadoditamanaḥś U_I **candraḥ** cett.] candraṃ K_IJ, cadraḥ B **sūryodayam** E] sūryodaye K_IJU_I, sūryodaya PU_2LB **ivekṣate** cett.] ca lakṣyate K_IJU_I, avekṣate E 5 **grasto** cett.] graste $K_IJU_IU_2$ **manaś** cett.] manaḥ | B **candraḥ** cett.] ścaṃdraḥ B **līnaḥ** P] linaḥ K_IJ, linaṃ U_IL, lipyaḥ U_2E, lina B **svayaṃpade** cett.] syayaṃpade B 6 **padam** cett.] m P **mahānagnir** cett.] mahānagni K_I, mahānagniḥ L **yena** cett.] yame E, sūrya° LB **kalāmayam** cett.] kalāmayaḥ JU_I 7 **candrārkavahnīnāṃ** cett.] caṃdrārkṣavahīnāṃ K_I, caṃdrārkavatāṃ U_I, caṃdrārkavavahnīnāṃ L, caṃdrārkvavahnīnāṃ B **saṅketaḥ** cett.] saṃketanaṃ LB **paramārthataḥ** cett.] paramārthataḥ vā U_I

XLVII.2 The supreme self is a mass of rays like a great sun, [and] it is an illuminator. Light and bliss should be united continuously.

XLVII.3 One's own fire, the great light illumines the supreme place. The moon, being the mind that constantly arises, perceives as though it were the rising of the sun.

XLVII.4 [423]Because of that, the moon, which is the mind, is devoured. Moreover, it dissolves into its own place. That very place is the great fire, by which [the moon] consisting of its digits is devoured. Thus, the esoteric teaching of the moon, sun and fire according to its highest meaning.[424]

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the subsequent verses. The only verb of the half-verse, the past passive participle *kṛtam*, which stands in the masculine or neuter, has no referent in this half-verse but is surrounded by feminine nouns, suggesting an emendation to the feminine gender. This leads us to the next step of reconstruction, namely to *śaktis triśālī kṛtā*. In the following verses, *paramātman* stands as *cetanā* for the sun, *svayam agniḥ* for the own fire which could be interpreted as the individual self, and the moon is equated with the *manas*. By uniting the *prakāśa* of the fire with the *ānanda* of the *manas*, i.e., the moon, the moon is ultimately consumed by the fire. The sun and the fire are intrinsically connected. Thus, the three become one. It seems to me that Rāmacandra wants to express in *pāda* a that Śakti, which is furnished with three, should be made into one. A distant variant of this half-verse from the source text is found in a quotation by Jayaratha *ad Tantrāloka* 32.63, introduced with *yad āgamaḥ*: *ekaṃ sṛṣṭimayaṃ bījam ekā mudrā ca khecarī* | "There is one seed [syllable], which contains creation, one *mudrā*, *khecarī*". Based on the context of the passage and the formulation from *Tantrāloka* 32.63, I propose as the final step of the verse reconstruction the now metrical conjecture (*bha-vipulā*) to *śaktis triśālyekakṛtā*. This could explain the readings of the γ-group, which are based on similar orthography: शक्तिस्त्रिशाल्येककृता looks very similar to शक्तिस्तृतीयलोकान्तः .

[423]The source text of verse XLVII.4 has not yet been identified.

[424]These verses seem to explain the preceding meditation on the lotus of the heart in an esoteric way. Abhinavagupta describes a largely similar practice in his *Tantrāloka* 5.19b–25a: *tatra dhyānamayaṃ tāvad anuttaram ihocyate | yaḥ prakāśaḥ svatantro 'yaṃ citsvabhāvo hṛdi sthitaḥ | sarvatattvamayaḥ proktam etac ca triśiromate | kadaṃlīsaṃpuṭākāraṃ saṃbāhyābhyantarāntaram īkṣate hṛdayāntaḥstaṃ tatpuṣpam iva tattvavit somasūryāgnisaṃghaṭṭaṃ tatra dhyāyed ananyadhīḥ taddhyānāraṇisaṃkṣobhān mahābhairavahavyabhuk hṛdayākhye mahākuṇḍe jāvalan sphīttāṃ vrajet | tasya śaktimataḥ sphītaśakter bhairavatejasaḥ mātṛmānaprameyākhyaṃ dhāmabhedena bhāvayet | vahnyarkasomaśaktīnāṃ tad eva tritayaṃ bhavet | parā parāparā ceyam aparā ca sadoditā | …*

[XLVIII. **yogasiddher anantaraṃ jñānam**]

इदानीं योगसिद्धेरनन्तरमेतादृशं ज्ञानमुत्पद्यते।

यदा नास्ति स्वयं कर्त्ता कारणं न कुलाकुलम्।
अव्यक्तं च परं तत्त्वमनामा विद्यते तदा॥ XLVIII.1॥

अनामैकः कश्चित्पुरुषो वर्तते। अनाम्नश्च परावरः। परावरा त्परं पदम्। परम–पदात्परमं शून्यम्। शून्यान्निरञ्जनम्। अनाम्नः पञ्चगुणाः। अनुत्पन्नत्वम्॥ अख–ण्डत्वम॥ अचलत्वं॥ अनुपमत्वम्॥ अनन्यत्वम् चेति। परावरस्य पञ्चगुणाः। निश्चलत्वम्॥ निर्मलत्वम्॥ परिपूर्णत्वम्॥ व्यापकत्वं॥ अकलत्वं चेति।

Sources: 3–4 = SSP 1.4 (Ed. p. 2): yadā nāsti svayaṃ kartā kāraṇaṃ na kulākulam | avyaktaṃ ca paraṃ brahma anāmā vidyate tadā ‖ 3–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845): tanmadhye nābhikarteti karaṇaṃ nā kulākulam | avyaktan tu paraṃ tattvam anityaṃ varttate sadā | 5–6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845): eko nāma pumān asti tasmāt tasmāt paraṃ padam | tasmāt tu paramaṃ śūnyaṃ tasmāt syāt tu nirañjanam | 6–7 cf. SSP 4.9 (Ed. p. 65): ananyatvād akhaṇḍatvād advayatvād anāśrayāt | nirdhāmatvād anāmatvād akulaṃ syān niruttaram ‖

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2 **yogasiddher** cett.] yogasiddhar U_1L, yogasiddhe P, yo yogasiddhar B **anantaram** em.] anantaraṃ $K_1JU_1U_2$EL, naranaṃtaraṃ P, anaṃtaraṃ | B **etādṛśaṃ** cett.] etādṛśa U_1 **jñā-nam** cett.] jñānaṃ L 3 **yadā** cett.] padā K_1U_1 **kāraṇaṃ** cett.] kāraṇaṃ ‖ U_2 4 **ca** em.] na cett. **paraṃ** cett.] para° LB **tattvam** K_1JPU_2E] *om.* LB **anāma** γ] manāmā JU_1 5 **anā-maikaḥ** em.] anāmay eka° K_1U_1, anāma eka° JLB, anāmā ekaḥ PU_2E **kaścitpuruṣo** cett.] °puruṣo LB **anāmnaś ca** cett.] anāmnaḥ K_1P, anāthaḥ JU_1 **parāvaraḥ** PU_2E] parāvaraś ca K_1JU_1, parāvarā° LB **parāvarāt** cett.] parāt paraḥ E **paraṃ padam** $K_1U_1U_2$EL] paramaṃ padaṃ J, paramapadaṃ P, paraṃ pada B 6 **paramaṃ śūnyam** U_1U_2] paramaśūnyaṃ K_1JPB, paraṃ śūnyaṃ E, paramaśūnya L **śūnyān nirañjanam** U_2E] śūnyā niraṃjanaḥ K_1U_1P, śūnyān niraṃjanaḥ J, śūnyā niraṃjanaṃ LB **anāmnaḥ** cett.] amnaḥ B **pañcaguṇāḥ** cett.] paṃcaguṇās E **anutpannatvam** cett.] teṣv anutattvam E 6–7 **akhaṇḍatvama** cett.] aṣaṃ-tatvaṃ K_1 7 **acalatvaṃ** K_1J] ācalatvam U_1, *om.* cett. **anupamatvam** cett.] avayavatvam E, *om.* B **ananyatvam** K_1JPE] ananyastvaṃ U_1, ananyatvaṃ nirmalatvaṃ U_2, anatvaṃ LB **ceti** cett.] cetiḥ B **parāvarasya** cett.] *om.* P **pañcaguṇāḥ** cett.] *om.* P, paṃcaguṇā U_2 8 **niścalatvam** cett.] *om.* P **nirmalatvam** cett.] *om.* U_2, niṣkarmatvaṃ E **paripūrṇatvam** cett.] paripūṇatvaṃ P **akalatvaṃ** cett.] *om.* J, prakāśatvaṃ U_1, akalatvaṃ ‖ nirvikāratvaṃ U_2, akalaṃtvaṃ B **ceti** cett.] *om.* JU_1

Notes: 7 **anupamatvam**: After the word *anuparatvam*, E's (printed Edition) previously omitted passage reappears. As all manuscripts share the same order, the editor likely exchanged the folios of E's exemplar. Five later sentences common to all manuscripts are likewise displaced in E, suggesting another folio transposition. Thus, E contains two *lacunae* that reappear later. The reader will be informed once all witnesses resynchronize. All readings of E are recorded in the critical apparatus according to order of all other manuscripts.

[XLVIII. **After the success in yoga, such knowledge arises**]

Now, immediately after the success in yoga, knowledge like this arises:

XLVIII.1 When neither the creator itself, nor the cause, the "Kula and Akula",[425] existed, then the unmanifest,[426] the supreme reality, the nameless one, existed.[427]

The nameless [one] exists alone as an unspecified soul. From the nameless [one], totality arises. From totality, the supreme place arises. From the supreme place, the supreme emptiness arises. From supreme emptiness, the supreme being arises.

The five qualities of the nameless are: Unbornness, indivisibility, immobility, incomparability, [and] no-other-ness.

The five qualities of the totality[428] are immobility, purity, completeness, pervasiveness, [and] partlessness.

Muller-Ortega (1989: 157) translates: "Now as for the Supreme, as it is called here, there is meditation on it. The light, the freedom whose essential nature is consciousness, contains principles, realities, and things within it. This light abides in the Heart. It has been described in this way in the *Triśiro-mata*: The knower of truth sees that reality within the Heart like a flower within which are all external and internal things, a flower shaped like a plantain bloom. He should meditate with undistracted mind on the union there in the Heart of the sun, moon, and fire. From this meditation, as from the agitation of two firesticks, one comes to experience the oblation fire of the great Bhairava, which expands and flames violently in the great firepit known as the Heart. Having arrived at the effulgence of Bhairava, which is the possessor of the powers and full of the powers, one should contemplate its identity with the abode of the knowing subject, the means of knowledge, and the known object. That triad is the very same triad as the triad of powers of fire, sun, and moon, as well as that of the always arising powers of Parā, Parāparā and Aparā."

[425] In this context, the term *kulākula* is a determinative compound, in the sense of "the unevolved cosmic totality", cf. *Tāntrikābhidhānakośa 3*, 2004: 129. Also cf. *Gorakṣasiddhāntasaṃgraha* 16.39: *srṣṭimārgakramāyātaṃ śivaśaktikulākulam | saṃhārakramaṣaṭkaṃ tu kulaśaktyāś ca dakṣiṇam ||*

[426] See *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* 4271.

[427] As in *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* this verse marks the beginning of a longer description of cosmography. Rāmacandra follows the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* but reduces, reorganises, simplifies and modifies the contents.

[428] The five qualities of *parāvara* do not occur in the sources and seem to be authorial.

परमपदस्य पञ्चगुणाः। नित्यम्॥ निजम्॥ निरन्तरम्॥ निराकारम्॥ निर्निकेत–
नम् चेति। शून्यस्य पञ्चगुणाः। लीनता॥ पूर्णता॥ मूर्छा॥ उन्मनीभावः॥ अल–
सत्वं चेति। निरञ्जनस्य पञ्चगुणाः। सत्यः॥ सहजः॥ स्वभावः॥ सत्ता॥ स्वरू–
पता चेति॥

[XLIX. **piṇḍotpattiḥ**]

इदानीं पिण्डोत्पत्तिः कथ्यते। अनादितः परमात्मा। परमात्मनः परमानन्दः। प–
रमानन्दात्प्रबोधः। प्रबोधाच्चिदुदयः। चिदुदयात्प्रकाशः।

Sources: 1–2 cf. SSP 1.17 (Ed. p. 7): niṣkalatvam aṇutaratvam acalatvam asaṃkhyatvam anādhāratvam iti pañcaguṇaṃ paramapadam | 1–2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845): nirākāratvanityatvanijatvañ ca nirañjanam | nirṇiketanatā ceti tatpadasyeti tadguṇāḥ | 2–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845): līnatā śīrṇatā mūrcchātoyamaṇḍalatā iti | guṇāḥ pañca samākhyātāḥ śūnyasya paramasya vai | 2–3 cf. SSP 1.18 (Ed. pp. 7-8): līnatā pūrṇatā unmanī lolatā mūrcchatā iti pañcaguṇaṃ śūnyam | 3–4 cf. SSP 1.19 (Ed. p. 8): satyatvaṃ sahajatvaṃ samarasatvaṃ sāvadhānatvaṃ sarvagatvam iti pañcaguṇaṃ nirañjanam | 3–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845): svabhāvaṃ sahajaṃ satyaṃ śāntiḥ śāntisvarūpataḥ | iti | nirañjanaguṇāḥ pañca etaj jñānī maheśvaraḥ | 6–7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845): vidyotpattis tadānīn tu kathyate śṛṇu yatnataḥ | ānandaparamātmeti paramānanda ekataḥ | prabodhaparamānandacittotpattiprabodhavān | cidudayāt prakāśaś ca eṣāṃ pañca tathaiva ca | avināśyo 'kṣayo 'bhedo 'dāhyo hyakhādya eva ca | ete pañca guṇāḥ proktā anādo nādavairiṇā | 6–7 cf. SSP 1.22 (Ed. p. 9): anādyāt paramānandaḥ | paramānandāt prabodhaḥ | prabodhāc cidudayaḥ | cidudayāt prakāśaḥ | prakāśāt so'hambhāvaḥ |

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1 **nityam** PU_2E] nityā° K_IU_I, nitya° JL, niś++ B **nijam** em.] °nija° K_IU_I, *om.* cett. **nirantaram** PE] niraṃtara K_IJ, °niraṃtara° U_I, nirantarā U_2, °niraṃstaga° L, °++++raṃga° B **nirākāram** ELB] nirākāra K_IJU_I, nirākārā U_2 1–2 **nirniketanam** PU_2] nirnitanāś K_I, nimittaketanā J, nimilaketanā U_I, nirniketanaṃ niścalatvam E, nirviketunaṃ L, nirniketunaṃ B 2 **ceti** cett.] *om.* JU_I **śūnyasya** JU_2ELB] ti anyasya N_2, ti anasya N_I, śūnyaḥsya K_IU_I, śunyasya P **pañcaguṇāḥ** cett.] paṃcaguṇā JU_I **līnatā** cett.] līnatāḥ LB **pūrṇatā** cett.] ++rṇatā K_I, ghūrṇatā JU_2E **mūrchā** cett.] murchā PLB **unmanībhāvaḥ** PU_2EL] unmanībhāva $N_2N_IK_IJU_I$, unmabhāvaḥ B 2–3 **alasatvaṃ** cett.] ālasyatvaṃ LB 3 **ceti** cett.] *om.* JU_I **pañcaguṇāḥ** cett.] paṃcaguṇaḥ U_2 **satyaḥ** PLB] satya βU_2, satyā E **sahajaḥ** em.] sahaja β, sahaḥ P, saha U_2LB, saha° E **svabhāvaḥ** PLB] svabhāva° βU_2, bhāvā E **sattā** cett.] satta° P, sata° LB 3–4 **svarūpatā** cett.] svarūpatāḥ P, svarūpatā samatā E 4 **ceti** U_2E]‖ cha J, *om.* cett. 6 **piṇḍotpattiḥ** cett.] piṃḍotpatti N_2JU_I, piṃḍotpattiṃ LB **paramātmā** cett.] paramātmānaḥ K_I 7 **prabodhaḥ** cett.] *om.* J **prabodhāc** cett.] *om.* U_I, prabodhā U_2 **cidudayaḥ** JPU_2E] ciddayaḥ N_2N_I, *om.* K_I, cittayaḥ U_I, cidudaya° LB **cidudayāt** K_IJU_2EL] cidudayacidudayāt N_2, ciddayacidudayāt N_I, citta° U_I, vidudayāt P, viduyāt B

Notes: 2 **śūnyasya pañcaguṇāḥ**: The substantial lacunae in N1 and N2 noted above (cf. their beginning in section XXXV on p. 214) end here, and both witnesses resume.

The five qualities of the supreme place are permanence, immanence, constancy, formlessness, [and] placelessness.

The five qualities of emptiness are dissolution, completeness, swooning, the state without mind, [and] inactivity.

The five qualities of the supreme being are truth, innateness, self-existence, beingness, [and] the state of one's own form.[429]

[XLIX. **Origin of the body**]

Now, the origin of the body[430] is taught. From beginninglessness,[431] the supreme self arises. From the supreme self, supreme bliss arises. From supreme bliss, awakening arises. From awakening, the manifestation of consciousness arises. From the manifestation of spirit, light arises.

[429] In the doctrine of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* the *paraṃ tattvaṃ* has a will, a force which is called *nijā śakti* (SSP 1.5). Here, from *nijā śakti*'s proximity *parāśakti* arises, from her vibration *aparāśakti* arises (SSP 1.6). From *aparāśakti*'s sense of I-ness (*ahaṃtārtha*) the *sukṣmāśakti* arises. From her nature of sensitivity (*vedanaśīla*) *kuṇḍalinīśakti* arises (SSP 1.7). From those five *śakti*s, the *piṇḍaḥ paraḥ śivaḥ* arises (SSP 1.14). The *piṇḍaḥ paraḥ śivaḥ* has five forms, which, according to SSP 1.15, are *aparam param*, *paramapada*, *śūnya*, *nirañjana*, and *paramātman*. The pentad makes up the *anādyapiṇḍa* (SSP 1.21). Rāmacandra entirely skips the part with the five *śakti*s of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*'s doctrine and instead provides the reader with something close to the five forms of *piṇḍaḥ paraḥ śivaḥ*: *anāman*, *parāvara*, *paramapada*, *śūnya* and *nirañjana* respectively. The five qualities Rāmacandra assigns to each item of his pentad are, to the greatest extent, inspired by mixing the individual qualities of the five *śakti*s and the five forms of *piṇḍaḥ paraḥ śivaḥ*, combined with a strong influence of the *Yogasvarodaya*.

[430] Here, *piṇḍa* refers to both a cosmic and individual body.

[431] The generation of the cosmic body starts with the primordial generation of the supreme self (*paramātman*), which arises from *anādi* ("that which is without beginning"). This *anādi* is used as a synonym for *paraṃ tattvam* ("the supreme reality").

तत्र परमात्मनः पञ्चगुणाः। अक्षयः॥ अभेद्यः॥ अच्छेद्यः॥ अदाह्यः॥ अविनाशी॥ परमानन्दस्य पञ्चगुणाः। स्फुरणः॥ किरणः॥ विस्फुरणः॥ अहंता॥ हर्षवत्त्वम्॥ प्रबोधस्य पञ्चगुणाः। लयः॥ उल्लासः॥ विभासः॥ विचारः॥ प्रभा॥ चिदुदयस्य पञ्चगुणाः। कर्तृत्वम्॥ ज्ञातृत्वम्॥ अभ्यासत्वम्॥ कलनत्वम्॥ सर्वज्ञत्वम्॥ प्रकाशस्य पञ्चगुणाः। सकलः॥ निष्कलः॥ संबोधनम्॥ समता॥ विश्रान्तिः॥

Sources: 1–2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845): kiraṇasphūrttivisphūrttiharṣavat paramātmanā | te tu pañca prakāreṇa guṇāḥ pañca prakīrttitāḥ | 1–2 cf. SSP 1.20 (Ed. p. 8): akṣayyatvam abhedyatvam achedyatvam adāhyatvam avināśitvam iti pañcaguṇaḥ paramātmā | 2–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845): kiraṇasphūrttivisphūrttiharṣavat paramātmanā | tetu pañca prakāreṇa guṇāḥ pañca prakīrttitāḥ | 2–3 cf. SSP 1.23 (Ed. p. 9): spando harṣa utsāho nispando nityasukhatvam iti pañcaguṇaḥ paramānandaḥ | 3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845): vicāraś ca prabhollāsā vibhāvaś ca layas tathā | prabodhasya guṇāḥ pañca kīrttyante tena hetunā | cf. SSP 1.24 (Ed. p. 9): udayaḥ ullāso 'vabhāso vikāsaḥ prabhā iti pañcaguṇaḥ prabodhaḥ | 4–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 845): abhyāsakartṛkamanāḥ sarvatattvaprabhā tathā | cidudayasya pañceti guṇā jñeyā viśeṣataḥ | 4–5 cf. SSP 1.25 (Ed. p. 10): sadbhāvo vicāraḥ kartṛtvaṃ jñātṛtvaṃ svatantratvaṃ iti pañcaguṇaś cidudayaḥ | 5–6 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 845–846): bodhanaṃ samayatvañ ca vismṛtiḥ sakalaprabhā | prakāśasya guṇāḥ pañcacaite jñānakarāḥ śubhāḥ | 5–6 cf. SSP 1.26 (Ed. p. 10): nirvikāratvaṃ niṣkalaṅkatvaṃ nirvikalpatvaṃ samatā vibhrāntir iti pañcaguṇaḥ prakāśaḥ |

1 **akṣayaḥ** cett.] akṣayya J, akṣayyaḥ avadyha U_1 **acchedyaḥ** cett.] *om.* U_1P, avināśī LB **adāhyaḥ** cett.] adahyaḥ J, ādṛṣya U_1, aṣṭadyaḥ P 1–2 **avināśī** cett.] avināsī K_1U_1, avināsaḥ U_2, *om.* LB 2 **pañcaguṇāḥ** cett.] paṃcaguṇā P **sphuraṇaḥ** JU_1PE] sphuraṇa cett. **kiraṇaḥ** JU_1PE] kiraṇā L, kiraṇa cett. **visphuraṇaḥ** PE] visphura N_2K_1L, visphuriṇa N_1B, visphuraḥ JU_1, visphuraṇa U_2 2–3 **harṣavattvam** cett.] harṣavatvaṃ ‖ cha ‖ J, dhairyatva U_1, harṣavārttvaṃ U_2 3 **prabodhasya** cett.] bodhasya U_1 **layaḥ** PU_2E] laya $N_2N_1K_1$JL, *om.* U_1, layā B **ullāsaḥ** U_2E] ullāsā cett. **vibhāsaḥ** U_2E] vibhāsā cett. **vicāraḥ** cett.] vicāra $N_2K_1JU_1$L **prabhā** cett.] *om.* N_2N_1, samādhi U_1, abhā B 4 **cidudayasya** cett.] cidudapasya K_1, cidudadayasya JL, udadayasya U_1, vihṛdayasya B **pañcaguṇāḥ** cett.] paṃcaguṇā PU_2 **kartṛtvam** cett.] katṛtvaṃ K_1JU_1, kartṛtve P, akartutvaṃ L, katutvaṃ B **jñātṛtva** cett.] jñātvaṃ N_2, jñānatvaṃ JU_1 **abhyāsatvam** cett.] +++++satvaṃ N_2, ātmāsatvaṃ K_1, abhāsatvaṃ U_2 **kalanatvam** U_2LB] kalanātvaṃ N_2K_1, kalanaṃtvaṃ N_1P, kalana J, kalyana° U_1, kalatvaṃ E 4–5 **sarvajñatvam** cett.] sarvaśatvaṃ U_1, saṃvajñatvaṃ LB 5 **pañcaguṇāḥ** cett.] guṇāḥ E **sakalaḥ** E] sakalā $K_1U_1U_2$, sakala cett. **niṣkalaḥ** E] nikala N_2N_1, nikaṃla K_1, niṣkala J, *om.* U_1, niṣkvalā P, tidvasā U_2, niṣkvala LB **saṃbodhanam** U_2] saṃbodhanā P, sarvaiḥ saha E, saṃbodhana cett. **samatā** cett.] samaṃtā N_2 5–6 **viśrāntiḥ** PU_2E] viśrāṃti ‖ cha ‖ J, viśrāṃti cett.

Notes: 4 **cidudayasya …**: Here, a major *lacuna* begins in E. Readings reappear later owing to conflation and are recorded according to the structure of the *ceteri* manuscripts.

In this case, the supreme self has five qualities: imperishable, indivisible, uncuttable, unburnable, [and] indestructible.

The five qualities of the supreme bliss are vibration, beam of light, quivering, I-ness, [and] joyful excitement.

The five qualities of awakening are absorption, joy, light, reflection, [and] radiance.

The five qualities of manifestation of spirit are agency, knowership, the state of practising, causality, [and] omniscience.

The five qualities of light are being with parts, being without parts, recognition, uniformity, [and] cessation.[432]

[432] In *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 1.22–28 the author's pentad consists of *paramānanda*, *prabodha*, *cidudaya*, *prakāśa* and *so 'haṃbhāva*. They cause the creation of the *ādyapiṇḍa*. The *ādyapiṇḍa*, in turn, is the cause for the great elements to emerge.

तत एतादृशं ज्ञानमुत्पद्यते। आद्यः। आद्यादात्मा। आत्मन आकाशः। आकाशा–
त्पवनः। पवनात्तेजः। तेजसो जलम्। जलात्पृथ्वी। तत्रात्मनः पञ्चगुणाः। अ–
ग्राह्यः॥ अनन्तः॥ अवाच्यः॥ अगोचरः॥ अप्रमेयश्च॥ आकाशस्य पञ्चगुणाः।
प्रवेशः॥ निष्क्रमणम्॥ छिद्रम्॥ शब्दाधारः॥ भ्रान्तिनिलयत्वम्॥ महावायोः प–
5 ञ्चगुणाः। चलनम्॥ शोषः॥ संचारः॥ स्पर्शः॥ धूम्रवर्णता॥ तेजसः पञ्चगुणाः।
दहनम्॥ ज्वालारूपम्॥ उष्णता॥ रक्तवर्णः॥ प्रकाशः॥

Sources: 1–2 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 845-846): etaj jñāne tataś caiṣāṃ jñānam utpadyate mahat | ākāśāt pavano vāyos tejas tejasa eva ca | jalaṃ jalāt tathā pṛthvī eṣāṃ pañcaguṇās tathā | 2–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): agocarād vayānantagrāhyam eṣāṃ tathātmanaḥ | 3–4 cf. SSP 1.30 (Ed. p. 12): avakāśaḥ acchidratvam aspṛśatvaṃ nīlavarṇatvaṃ śabdatvam iti pañcaguṇo mahākāśaḥ | 4–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): sañcāraś cālanaṃ śeṣe pañcadhūmrābhamambare | 4–5 cf. SSP 1.31 (Ed. p. 12): sañcāraḥ sañcālanaṃ sparśanaṃ śoṣaṇaṃ dhūmaravarṇatvaṃ iti pañcaguṇo mahāvāyuḥ | 5–6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): uṣṇaprakāśaraktābhajvālādāhas tu tejasā | 5–6 cf. SSP 1.32 (Ed. p. 12): dāhakatvaṃ pācakatvaṃ uṣṇatvaṃ prakāśatvaṃ raktavarṇatvam iti pañcaguṇaṃ mahātejaḥ |

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1 **tata** $N_2N_IK_IE$] tataḥ JU_IU_2, tat PLB **etādṛśaṃ** cett.] etādṛśyaṃ U_2, etādraśaṃ LB **jñānam** cett.] *om.* E **ādyaḥ** cett.] adya N_2, *om.* U_I **ādyād** K_IJ] ādhyād N_2N_IP, *om.* U_IE, ādhyā U_2, ādhyāt LB **ātmā** cett.] *om.* U_ILB, dātmā U_2 **ātmana** N_2PE] ātmanaḥ $N_IK_IJU_IU_2$, manaḥ L, manaṃ B **ākāśaḥ** cett.] ākāśa N_2 1–2 **ākāśāt** cett.] ākāśād PU_2 2 **pavanaḥ** $N_IK_IJU_I$] pa+++ N_2, vayuḥ PU_2L, vāyuḥ E, vayoḥ B **pavanāt** $N_2N_IK_IJU_I$] vāyos γ **tejaso** cett.] tejaḥ K_I, tejas J, tejaḥ sa U_I, tejasor U_2 **jalam** γ] *om.* N_2N_I, otadakā K_I, udakam JU_I **jalāt** γ] udakāt $N_2K_IJU_I$, °dakāt N_I **pṛthvī** cett.] pṛthivī P **tatrātmanaḥ** N_2] tatra ātmanaḥ $N_IK_IJU_I$, ātrātmanaḥ P, ātmanaḥ U_2, atrātmanaḥ E, ādyātmanaḥ LB **pañcaguṇāḥ** cett.] paṃcaguṇaḥ U_2 2–3 **agrāhyaḥ** cett.] agrāhya N_2L, *om.* B 3 **avācyaḥ** cett.] avācya N_2, avācyā U_2, *om.* B **agocaraḥ** cett.] *om.* B **aprameyaś ca** cett.] *om.* B **ākāśasya** cett.] ākāśa° L, *om.* B **pañcaguṇāḥ** cett.] *om.* B 4 **praveśaḥ** cett.] praveśa° U_2 **niṣkramaṇam** E] niśkramāṇaṃ N_2N_IPB, nikrumāṇaṃ K_I, nikrumāṇaṃ J, nikrumāṇaḥ U_I, niśkraṇaṃ U_2, niśrumāṇaṃ L **śabdādhāraḥ** U_2E] śabdadhāraḥ N_2N_IP, śabdadhāra K_I, śabdādhāraṃ J, śabdadhāraṃ U_ILB **bhrāntinilayatvam** cett.] bhrāti nilayatvaṃ K_I, bhrāṃtḥ ‖ nilayatvaṃ J, bhrāṃte nijatvaṃ U_I **mahāvāyoḥ** cett.] mahāvāyo K_I, mahāvāyor JU_I 4–5 **pañcaguṇāḥ** cett.] guṇāḥ JU_I 5 **calanam** cett.] calana N_2, pracālanā U_I, *om.* B **śoṣaḥ** cett.] śoṣaṇaṃ U_2, śeṣa° E, *om.* B **saṃcāraḥ** cett.] *om.* B **sparśaḥ** cett.] *om.* U_IB, sparśa L **dhūmravarṇatā** cett.] nirodhanaṃ ‖ prasaraṇaṃ ‖ cha ‖ J, nirodhanaṃ prasaraṇaṃ vaḥ U_I, *om.* B **tejasaḥ** cett.] *om.* U_IB **pañcaguṇāḥ** cett.] guṇāḥ J, *om.* U_IB, paṃcaguṇaḥ U_2 6 **dahanam** cett.] pravāha K_I, dahanaḥ J, *om.* U_I **jvālārūpam** cett.] śithilatā K_I, jvālā ‖ rūpaṃ JU_2, *om.* U_I **uṣṇatā** cett.] drava K_I, *om.* U_I, uṣṭṇatā U_2 **raktavarṇaḥ** N_2L] rakto | varṇaḥ N_I, madhurarasatā K_I, raktavarṇaṃ J, *om.* U_I, rakto varṇāḥ P, raktavarṇāḥ U_2, rakto varṇaḥ E, rakto varṇaḥ B **prakāśaḥ** conj.] śvetavarṇatā K_I, *om.* cett.

From that[433] knowledge like this is generated.

There is a beginning. From the beginning[434] self arises. From self, space arises. From space, wind arises. From wind, fire arises. From fire, water arises. From water, earth arises.

In this regard, the self[435] has five qualities: untouchable, infinite, inexpressible, unattainable, [and] immeasurable.

The five qualities of space are penetrating, disappearing, containing holes, medium of sound, [and] container of movement.

The five qualities of the great wind are moving, drying, passing, tangible, [and] smoky.

The five qualities of fire are burning, flamelike, heating, red-coloured [and] bright.[436]

[433] *tatas* seems to refer to the relationships and dependencies of the cosmography described above.

[434] Rāmacandra previously described the qualities and interrelationships of the beginninglessness (*anāditaḥ*) which brings forth the supreme self (*paramātman*). His realm of beginninglessness signifies a realm before any physical existence. Here, he turns to the beginning (*ādhyaḥ*). The beginning brings forth the [indididual] self and marks the moment of the generation of physical existence itself. Interestingly, the way he presents it implies that physical existence (the elements and so forth) is a result of the self (*ātman*).

[435] The concept of the merging of the self with the five great elements as seen in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* and adopted by Rāmacandra is paralleled as early as the *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* 4278: *tena sṛṣṭaṃ svaśaktyedaṃ trailokyaṃ sacarācaram | pañcabhiḥ saha saṃbhūya pañcabhūtamayātmakaiḥ ||* "Created by his own power, the three worlds with all living and non-living beings, along with the five elements, merged with the Self consisting of the five elements."

[436] Since all witnesses preserve only four qualities of light but five are required, I conjectured the fifth, namely *prakāśa* following the *Yogasvarodaya*.

आपसः पञ्चगुणाः। प्रवाहः॥ शिथिलता॥ द्रवः॥ मधुररसता॥ श्वेतवर्णः॥ पृथिव्याः पञ्चगुणाः। स्थूलता॥ साकारता॥ कठिनता॥ गन्धवत्ता॥ पीतवर्णता॥

[L. **śarīramadhye pañca mahābhūtāni**]

इदानीं शरीरमध्ये पञ्च महाभूतानि कथ्यते। तेषां गुणाः कथ्यन्ते। तत्र पृथिव्याः
5 पञ्चगुणाः। अस्थि॥ मांसम्॥ नाडी॥ लोमानि॥ त्वक्॥

Sources: 1 cf. SSP 1.33 (Ed. p. 12): pravāhaḥ āpyāyanaṃ dravo rasaḥ śvetavarṇatvam iti pañcaguṇaṃ mahāsalilam | cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): prakāśād eva śaithilyam adhutā śvetataj jale | 2 cf. SSP 1.34 (Ed. p. 13): sthūlatā nānākāratā kāṭhinyaṃ gandhaḥ pītavarṇatvam iti pañcaguṇā mahāpṛthvī | cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): sthūlasākārakāṭhinyagandhaṃ pātamṛdau tathā | cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): mahābhūtāni pañceti dehamadhye 'dhunā śṛṇu | mahābhūtāni pañceti pṛthvī tejo marut khakam | 4–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): eteṣāñ ca tathā pañcaguṇasthānaṃ śṛṇu priye | asthi māṃsaṃ loma nāḍī tvak ceti pṛthivīguṇāḥ | 4–5 cf. SSP 1.37 (Ed. p. 14): asthimāṃsatvaṅnāḍīromāṇīti pañcaguṇā bhūmiḥ |

Parallels: 4 cf. *Amaraughaśāsana* 11: ayaṃ prakṛtibhedaḥ pṛthvī āpaḥ tejaḥ vāyuḥ ākāśaś ca iti śarīre pañcaguṇāḥ mahābhūtāni bhavanti tatraiva tāni pañcavidhāni bhavanti 4–5 cf. *Amaraughaśāsana* 12: asthi māṃsaṃ tvak nāḍī romāṇi iti pañcaguṇā pṛthivī ‖

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1 **āpasaḥ** em.] āpo N_2N_IJ, *om.* K_IU_I, apāṃ PU_2E, apa° LB **pañcaguṇāḥ** cett.] *om.* K_IU_I **pravāhaḥ** cett.] pravāha N_2N_I, *om.* K_IU_I, pravāha° P **śithilatā** cett.] *om.* K_IU_I, śithatā B **dravaḥ** cett.] drava N_2N_IJ, *om.* K_IU_I **madhurarasatā** N_IJ] °madhura | rasatā N_2, *om.* K_IU_I, madhurasatā PL, madhuratā U_2E, madhuradatā B **śvetavarṇaḥ** U_2E] śvetavarṇtā N_2N_IJ, *om.* K_IU_I, śvetavarṇāḥ PLB 1–2 **pṛthivyāḥ** U_2E] pṛthivyā $N_2N_IK_IJU_I$, *om.* PLB 2 **pañcaguṇāḥ** U_2E] guṇāpaṃca $N_2N_IK_I$, guṇāḥ JU_I, *om.* PLB **sthūlatā** K_IU_2E] syūlatā N_2, sthulatā N_I, sthalatā JU_I, *om.* PLB **sākāratā** cett.] *om.* PU_2LB **kaṭhinatā** E] kathinatā N_2N_IJ, kaṭinatā K_I, kaṭhiṇatā U_IU_2, *om.* PLB **gandhavattā** K_IE] *om.* N_2PLB, gaṃdhavatta N_I, gaṃdhavettā JU_I **pītavarṇatā** U_2E] pītavarṇaḥ $N_2N_IK_I$, pītavarṇā JU_I, *om.* PLB 4 **idānīṃ** cett.] *om.* DPELB, atha U_2 **śarīramadhye** $N_2N_IK_IE$] *om.* DPLB, śrīramadhye JU_I, śarīrasya madhye U_2 **pañcamahābhūtāni** cett.] *om.* DPLB, paṃca paṃcamahābhūtāni J, pañca āpaguṇaḥ mahāsveravarṇa U_I **kathyate** $N_2N_IK_I$] kathyaṃte J, *om.* cett. **teṣāṃ** cett.] teṣā N_2, *om.* DPLB, tāvāt U_I **guṇāḥ** cett.] *om.* DU_IPLB **kathyante** JU_2E] kathyate $N_2N_IK_I$, *om.* DU_IPLB **tatra** $N_2N_IK_IJU_2E$] *om.* cett. **pṛthivyāḥ** P] pṛthivyā N_2N_IE, pṛthivyā K_IJ, *om.* U_I, pṛthvyā U_2, pṛthvīyā LB 5 **pañcaguṇāḥ** em.] guṇāḥ $N_2N_IK_IJU_2E$, *om.* U_I, paṃcaguṇāḥ kathyaṃte PL, paṃcaguṇāḥ | athyate | B **asthi** cett.] *om.* U_I, asti U_2 **māṃsam** P] māṃsā K_I, māṃsa cett., *om.* U_I **nāḍī** cett.] *om.* U_I **lomāni** cett.] lomani K_I, *om.* U_I, tvak LB **tvak** N_2N_IJ] tvakā K_I, *om.* U_I, vākṛt P, tvakḥ U_2, vāk E, lomāni LB

Notes: 4 **śarīramadhye**: At this point of the text E resynchronises with the textual structure of all other witnesses.

The five qualities of water[437] are flowing, looseness, fluidity, pleasant taste, [and] transparent colour.

The five qualities of earth are grossness, form, hardness, smelliness [and] yellowness.[438]

[L. **Five great elements within the body**]

Now, the five great elements situated within the body are taught. Their qualities are taught.[439]

Among them, the five qualities of the earth-element are bone, flesh, channels, hair, [and] skin.

[437] I emended to the required genitive singular.

[438] The five great cosmic elements have five qualities each. The following section describes how they manifest within the body.

[439] Following his exposition of the macrocosmic properties of the five great elements, Rāmacandra proceeds to delineate their microcosmic counterparts, each defined by its own pentadic set of qualities.

तत्रोदकगुणाः। लाला॥ मूत्रम्॥ शुक्रम्॥ रक्तम्॥ प्रस्वेदः॥ तेजसो गुणाः। क्षुधा॥ तृषा॥ निद्रा॥ ग्लानिः॥ आलस्यम्॥ वायोर्गुणाः। धावनम्॥ मज्जनम्॥ निरोधनम्॥ प्रसारणम्॥ आकुञ्चनं चेति॥ आकाशस्य गुणाः। रागः॥ द्वेषः॥ भयम्॥ लज्जा॥ मोहः॥

[LI. **pañcaprakārā antaḥkaraṇasya**]

तदनन्तरमेतादृश्येका बुद्धिरुत्पद्यते। मनो बुद्धिरहंकारश्चित्तं चैतन्यं चेति। एते पञ्चप्रकारा अन्तःकरणस्य।

Sources: 1 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): kṣudhā tṛṣṇālasya nidrā glāniś ca pañca vāriṇaḥ | cf. SSP 1.38 (Ed. p. 14): lālā mūtraṃ śukraṃ śoṇitaṃ sveda iti pañcaguṇā āpaḥ | 1–2 cf. SSP 1.39 (Ed. p. 14): kṣudhā tṛṣā nidrā kāntir ālasyam iti pañcaguṇaṃ tejaḥ | 1–2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): kṣudhā tṛṣṇālasya nidrā glāniś ca pañca vāriṇaḥ | 2–3 cf. SSP 1.40 (Ed. p. 14): dhāvanaṃ plavanaṃ prasāraṇaṃ ākuñcanaṃ nirodhanam iti pañcaguṇo vayuḥ | 2–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): rogo lajjā bhayodvegau dhāraṇā ca marudguṇāḥ | 3–4 cf. SSP 1.41 (Ed. pp. 14–15): rāgo dveṣo bhayaṃ lajjā moha iti pañcaguṇa ākaśaḥ | 6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): etaj jñānenaiva teṣāṃ buddhir utpadyate śubhā | yadyapi sargakāṇḍe pṛthvyāder guṇā uktās tathāpy etaj jñānenety anena kāryakāraṇabhāvadarśanāya punar ucyante | 6–7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): mano buddhir ahaṅkāraś cittaṃ caitanyam eva ca | ete pañcaprakārāś ca antaḥkaraṇasambhavāḥ | 6–7 cf. SSP 1.42 (Ed. p. 15): mano buddhir ahaṅkāraś cittaṃ caitanyam ity antaḥkaraṇapañcakam |

Parallels: 1 cf. *Amaraughaśāsana* 13: lālāmūtrāsruniḥsvedaprasvedāḥ iti pañcaguṇā āpaḥ ‖ 1–2 cf. *Amaraughaśāsana* 14: kṣudhā tṛṣṇā nidrā ālasyaṃ kāntiś ca iti pañcaguṇaṃ tejaḥ ‖ 2–3 cf. *Amaraughaśāsana* 15: dhāvanaṃ valganam ākuñcanaṃ prasāraṇaṃ nirodhaś ceti pañcaguṇo vāyuḥ ‖ 3–4 cf. *Amaraughaśāsana* 16: rāgo dveṣo lajjā bhayaṃ mohaś ceti pañcaguṇa ākāśaḥ iti pañcaguṇālaṅkṛtāni pañcatattvāni ‖

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1 **tatrodakaguṇāḥ** cett.] netrodakaguṇāḥ N_2, netrodake guṇāḥ N_1, tatrodakasya guṇāḥ J, *om.* U_1, tatrodakaguṇaḥ U_2 **lālā** cett.] lalā K_1U_2, lāla° LB **mūtram** $N_2K_1U_2E$] mutraṃ N_1U_1, mutra J, °muvaṃ P, °mutra° LB **śukram** cett.] śuklaṃ E **raktam** cett.] *om.* N_2, vaktraṃ K_1 **prasvedaḥ** cett.] svedaḥ U_1 **guṇāḥ** cett.] guṇaḥ U_2 2 **kṣudhā** cett.] kṣudhāṃ B **glāniḥ** PE] glāni cett. **ālasyam** cett.] ālasya K_1U_1 **vāyor** cett.] vāyo N_2U_2B, vāyu U_1 **guṇāḥ** cett.] guṇā U_1 **majjanam** cett.] majana N_2, mano° U_1 3 **nirodhanam** cett.] virodhana N_2, rodhanaṃ JU_1 **prasāraṇam** cett.] praśaraṇāṃ N_2 **ākuñcanaṃ** cett.] ākūrcana N_2 **ceti** cett.] *om.* U_2 **guṇāḥ** cett.] guṇaḥ K_1U_1 **rāgaḥ** U_2] rāga° cett. **dveṣaḥ** PU_2] dveṣau N_2, °dveṣo N_1, °dveṣau K_1JU_1E, dveṣ° LB 4 **mohaḥ** $N_1K_1JPU_2E$] moha N_2LB, mohā U_1 6 **etādṛśy** PU_2] etādṛśī N_2, etādṛśā N_1, etādaśī K_1JU_1L, ekādaśī E, metādaśī B **ekā** cett.] kā E, *om.* LB **buddhir** cett.] buddher P **buddhir** cett.] buddhy E **ahaṃkāraś** cett.] ahaṃkāra N_2N_1, ahaṃkāraḥ ‖ U_2, ahaṃkārāś E, ahaṃkāra | ś B **caitanyaṃ** γ] *om.* β 6–7 **pañcaprakārā** E] paṃcāprakārā N_2, paṃcāpiprakārā $N_1K_1JU_1$P, paṃcaprakāraḥ U_2, paṃcāpiprakārāḥ L, paṃcāpiprakāra | B 7 **antaḥkaraṇasya** cett.] aṃtakaraṇasya N_2, aṃtaḥkarṇasya K_1, aṃtaḥkaraṇasya ‖ cha ‖ J, aṃtaḥkarṇva U_1, aṃtaḥkarṇsya LB

In this case, the five qualities of the water element are saliva, urine, semen, blood, [and] sweat.

The qualities of the fire-element are hunger, thirst, sleep, exhaustion, [and] sloth.

The qualities of the wind-element are abrasion, immersion, cessation, expansion, [and] contraction.

The qualities of the space-element are [440] passion, aversion, fear, shame and confusion.[441]

[LI. **Five modes of the internal organ**]

Then, immediately following that, such a unique insight[442] arises: the mind, the intellect, the ego, the mental faculty, and consciousness.[443] These are the five modes of the internal organ.

[440] The *Yogasvarodaya* (PT) does not include the five qualities of *ākāśa*.

[441] The earliest formulation of these specific pentads that explain the manifestation of the five elements in the human body can be at least traced back to the beginning of the sixteenth century, more precisely the *Amaraughaśāsana*, whose oldest extant manuscript is dated to 1525 CE and according to Mallinson (2011: 16) is perhaps the oldest Nath work on Haṭhayoga.

[442] In this case I translated *buddhi* as insight, since *buddhi* as a *tattva* would unlikely arise from the previously mentioned five great elements. In addition, it is dealt with immediately afterwards in the context of the internal organ. Hence, it seems probable that it must refer to the specific knowledge that arises from the accomplishment of yoga, as mentioned in section XLVIII.

[443] Apart from the *Tattvayogabindu*, this particular pentad appears only in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* and the *Yogasvarodaya*. I have not been able to trace it further back in the textual record. Since both sources are associated with the Nāth milieu, it is conceivable that this pentadic scheme formed part of the process of consolidating a distinct sectarian identity for the Nāth Sampradāya. Notably, *citta*—which in several earlier, related traditions subsumes *buddhi*, *ahaṃkāra*, and *manas* (cf. *Śārṅgadharapaddhati*: 4275), and is regarded as being opposed or perceived by consciousness (*caitanya*)—here becomes a constituent element of the internal organ (*antaḥkaraṇa*) itself.

मनसः पञ्चगुणाः। संकल्पः॥ विकल्पः॥ मूर्खत्वम्॥ जडता॥ मननं चेति॥बुद्धेः पञ्चगुणाः। विवेकः॥ वैराग्यम्॥ शान्तिः॥ सन्तोषः॥ क्षमा चेति॥ अहंकारस्य पञ्चगुणाः। अहम्॥ मम॥ एतस्य दुःखम्॥ एतस्य सुखम्॥ स्वतन्त्रता॥ चित्तस्य पञ्चगुणाः। वृत्तिः॥ धृतिः॥ स्मृतिः॥ त्यागः॥ मतिः॥ चैतन्यस्य पञ्चगुणाः। हर्षः॥ विमर्शः॥ धैर्यम्॥ चिन्तनम्॥ निस्पृहत्वम्॥

Sources: 1 cf. SSP 1.43 (Ed. p. 15): saṃkalpo vikalpo mūrcchā jaḍatā mananam iti pañcaguṇaṃ manaḥ | 1–2 cf. SSP 1.44 (Ed. p. 15): viveko vairāgyaṃ śāntiḥ santoṣaḥ kṣameti pañcaguṇā buddhiḥ | 1–2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): mananāmananaṃ jñeyaṃ buddhy ādipañca pañca tu | vivekaśāntisantoṣakṣamāvairāgyateti ca | ete pañcaguṇā buddher ahaṅkāraguṇān śṛṇu | 3 cf. SSP 1.45 (Ed. pp. 15–16): abhimānaṃ madīyaṃ mama sukhaṃ mama duḥkhaṃ mamedam iti pañcaguṇo 'haṅkāraḥ | cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): ahambhāvamahañcādiyugāntaṃ hiṃsanaṃ tathā | 3–4 cf. SSP 1.46 (Ed. p. 16): matir dhṛtiḥ smṛtis tyāgaḥ svīkāra iti pañcaguṇaṃ cittam | 3–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): vṛttiḥ smṛtir matis tyājyaṃ nirāśaṃ caitikā guṇāḥ | 4–5 cf. SSP 1.47 (Ed. p. 16): vimarśaḥ śīlanaṃ dhairyaṃ cintanaṃ nispṛhatvam iti pañcaguṇaṃ caitanyam | 4–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): niḥspṛhatā dveṣatā dhairyaṃ vimarṣacintanaṃ tathā |

1 **pañcaguṇāḥ** cett.] ye ca guṇāḥ E **saṃkalpaḥ** N_2K_1] sakalpa L, saṃkalpa cett. **vikalpaḥ** N_1K_1J] vikalpa cett. **mūrkhatvam** N_2J] mūrṣatvaṃ $N_1K_1U_1$, mūrkhatvā E, mūrkhatva cett. **jaḍatā** cett.] lasatā E **ceti** cett.] ceti ete paṃcāpiprakārā aṃtaḥkaraṇasya ma N_1, ceti ‖ cha J, ceti vā U_1 **buddheḥ** N_1K_1JPEL] buddhe B, *om.* cett. 2 **pañcaguṇāḥ** N_1K_1JPELB] *om.* cett. **vivekaḥ** $N_2N_1K_1P$] viveka JU_1LB, viveko U_2E **vairāgyam** JU_2E] vairāgya cett. **śāntiḥ** cett.] śānti J **santoṣaḥ** cett.] santoṣa N_2J, santoṣāḥ U_2 **ceti** cett.] vā U_1 3 **pañcaguṇāḥ** cett.] paṃcaguṇaḥ U_2 **aham** cett.] *om.* U_1PLB **mama** cett.] mamā K_1, samā U_1, *om.* PLB **etasya** cett.] *om.* PLB **duḥkham** cett.] *om.* U_1PLB **etasya sukham** conj.] *om.* cett. **svatantratā** cett.] svataṃtratāḥ DU_2, svasvataṃtratā U_1, *om.* PLB **cittasya** cett.] *om.* PLB 4 **pañcaguṇāḥ** cett.] guṇāḥ J, naḥ U_1, *om.* PLB **vṛttiḥ** J] vṛddhiḥ U_1, *om.* cett. **dhṛtiḥ** cett.] *om.* U_1, dhṛti° LB **smṛtiḥ** cett.] *om.* U_1, °smṛti° LB **tyāgaḥ** $N_2N_1JU_1$] tyāgaṃ DK_1, rāgadveṣa° P, rāgaḥ ‖ dveṣaḥ U_2, rāgadveṣau E, °rāgadveṣa° L, rāgadveṣam B **matiḥ** cett.] mati D, bhīti L, iti B **caitanyasya** cett.] caitanya U_2 **pañcaguṇāḥ** U_2E] guṇāḥ paṃca N_2N_1, guṇāḥ cett. 5 **harṣaḥ** cett.] harṣa° N_2LB, ārṣaṃ E **vimarśaḥ** cett.] °vimarśa° N_2LB, vimar++ P, vimarṣaḥ U_2 **dhairyam** cett.] dhairya J **cintanam** cett.] citanaṃ K_1, cetanā U_1, cetanaṃ U_2 **nispṛhatvam** cett.] *om.* J

Notes: 2 **santoṣāḥ ‖ kṣamā ceti**: The *lacuna* in D ends here, and collation resumes.

The five qualities of the mind are intentional thought, discursive thought, foolishness, dullness, and reflection.

The five qualities of the intellect are differentiation, equanimity, peace, contentment, and patience.

The five qualities of the ego are[444] [the sense of] I, [the sense of] mine, its suffering, its happiness, [and] self-determination.[445]

The five qualities of the mental faculty are fluctuation, will, memory, renunciation, [and] understanding.[446]

The five qualities of consciousness are excitement, reflection, understanding, thinking, [and] desirelessness.

[444] All five qualities of *ahaṃkāra* are omitted in B, L and P. All three manuscripts list the qualities of *citta* instead.

[445] Rāmacandra follows neither exactly the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* nor exactly the *Yogasvarodaya* in this pentad. Based on the two source texts, the following missing qualities come into question: *abhimānaṃ* ("pride"), *hiṃsanaṃ* ("violence"), or *mama sukhaṃ* ("my happiness"). I decided to conjecture the missing fifth quality to *sukham etasya* to contrast *duḥkham etasya* based on the reading of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*.

[446] Given the β-group's close correspondence with the source text *Yogasvarodaya*, the *rāgadveṣau* reading of the γ-group appears to be a scribal correction intended to restore the set of five qualities of *citta* lost in an intermittent exemplar. Only J within the β-group preserves the complete and presumably original list.

[LII. **kulapañcakasya bhedāḥ**]

तदनन्तरं कुलपञ्चकस्य भेदाः कथ्यन्ते॥ सत्त्वम्॥ रजः॥ तमः॥ कालः॥ जीवनम्॥ तत्र सत्त्वस्य गुणाः। दया॥ धर्मः॥ कृपा॥ भक्तिः॥ श्रद्धा चेति॥ रजसो गुणाः। त्यागः॥ भोगः॥ शृङ्गारः॥ स्वार्थः॥ वस्तुसङ्ग्रहः॥ तमसो गुणाः। विवादः॥ कलहः॥ शोकः॥ बन्धः॥ वञ्चनम्॥ तदनन्तरं कालस्य गुणाः। कलना॥ कल्पना॥ भ्रान्तिः॥ प्रमादः॥ उन्मादः॥ जीवस्य गुणाः। जाग्रदवस्था॥ स्वप्नावस्था॥ सुषुप्तावस्था॥ तुरीयावस्था॥ तुरीयातीतावस्था॥

Sources: 2–3 cf. SSP 1.48 (Ed. p. 16): sattvaṃ rajas tamaḥ kālo jīva iti kulapañcakam | 3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): citter guṇās trayo jīvaguṇān śṛṇu maheśvari | āsthā śraddhā kṛpā bhaktiḥ satyaṃ sattvaguṇā iti | cf. SSP 1.49 (Ed. p. 16): dayā dharmaḥ kriyā bhaktiḥ śraddheti pañcaguṇaṃ sattvam | 3–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): tyāgo bhogaś ca śraddhā ca sārthavastuspṛhā tathā | raso pañcaguṇāḥ caite tāmasasya guṇān śṛṇu | 3–4 cf. SSP 1.50 (Ed. p. 17): dānaṃ bhogaḥ śṛṅgāro vastugrahaṇaṃ svārthasaṃgrahaṇam iti pañcaguṇaṃ rajaḥ | 4–5 cf. SSP 1.51 (Ed. p. 17): vivādaḥ kalahaḥ śoko baṃdho vañcanam iti pañcaguṇaṃ tamaḥ | 4–5 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): pramodaḥ svādakalahau vivādo bhrāntivarddhanam | vañcanañ ca tathā śokas tāmasasya guṇā ime | 5–6 cf. SSP 1.52: kalanā kalpanā bhrāntiḥ pramādo 'nartha iti pañcaguṇaḥ kālaḥ | 6–7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 846): svapnajāgratsuṣuptāni caitanyaṃ jīvakā guṇāḥ | etādṛśi sati tattvaṃ caitanyāt tad bhaved iti | 6–7 SSP 1.53 (Ed. p. 18): jāgrat svapnaḥ suṣuptis turyaṃ tūryātītam iti pañcāvasthāguṇo jīvaḥ |

2 **tad anantaraṃ** *β*] aṃtaḥ paraṃ U_2, ataḥ paraṃ cett. **bhedāḥ** cett.] bhedā U_2B **kathyante** cett.] kathyate N_2 **sattvam** cett.] satva $N_2N_1K_1JU_1$ **rajaḥ** cett.] raja $N_2N_1JU_1$, rājaḥ K_1, rajas LB **tamaḥ** cett.] tama N_2JU_1 **kālaḥ** cett.] kāla N_2JU_1L, kā B 2–3 **jīvanam** cett.] jīvanam ‖ cha ‖ J, jīvanaṃ vā U_1 3 **tatra** cett.] tatrasya B **sattvasya** cett.] sattva ELB **guṇāḥ** cett.] guṇāḥ kathyaṃte J **dayā** cett.] dayāḥ LB **dharmaḥ** DPU_2E] dharma cett. **bhaktiḥ** cett.] bhakti N_2LB **ceti** cett.] ‖ cha J, *om.* U_1 **rajaso** cett.] rajo U_2 4 **tyāgaḥ** cett.] tyāga N_2 **bhogaḥ** cett.] bhoga N_2, *om.* JU_1, bheda P **svārthaḥ** cett.] svārtha N_2U_1LB **vastusaṅgrahaḥ** cett.] vasusaṃgrahaḥ K_1, vastusaṃgrahaś ceti E, vastunāṃ saṃgrahaḥ L, vastunā saṃgrahaḥ B **tamaso** cett.] tamo N_2U_2L **guṇāḥ** cett.] guṇaḥ U_1U_2 4–5 **vivādaḥ** cett.] vivāda N_2, viṣādaḥ U_2 5 **kalahaḥ** PU_2E] kalahaṃ N_2N_1DK_1, kalaha JU_1LB **śokaḥ** cett.] śoka N_2JU_1B, śokaiḥ L **bandhaḥ** cett.] vidha vā N_2, baṃdha JU_1LB **vañcanam** cett.] vaṃcanaṃ smṛtaṃ N_2, vaṃcanā JU_1, caṃcalaṃ ceti U_2 **tad anantaraṃ** *β*] *om.* *γ* **kālasya** cett.] kāraṇasya D, kāranasya K_1, kāla° U_1 **kalanā** cett.] *om.* N_2 6 **kalpanā** cett.] *om.* N_2, kalpaḥ P, kalmaṣaṃ E **bhrāntiḥ** cett.] *om.* N_2, bhrāṃti° U_1B **pramādaḥ** cett.] *om.* N_2, prasādaḥ PE **unmādaḥ** cett.] *om.* N_2, unmādaś ceti U_2 **jīvasya** cett.] *om.* N_2 **guṇāḥ** cett.] *om.* N_2, guṇa D, guṇaḥ U_2 **jāgradavasthā** cett.] jāgradavadasthā N_2, jāgravadasthā N_1, jāgṛdavasthā U_1, jāgravadasthāḥ B 7 **suṣuptāvasthā** cett.] suṣumṇāvasthā N_2, suṣupti° L, suṣupta° B **turīyāvasthā** cett.] turīyāvayāvasthā D, turīyāvasthā ‖ cha ‖ J, turyāvasthā U_1LB **turīyātītāvasthā** cett.] *om.* J, turiyātītāvasthā ‖ kaivalyā U_1, turiyā | tītāvasthā B

[LII. **Divisions of the pentad of the kula**]

Immediately afterwards, the divisions of the pentad of the *kula*[447,448] are taught: *sattva*, *rajas*, *tamas*, time and the embodied soul.

In the case of *sattva*, the qualities are compassion, religious duty, pity, devotion and confidence.

The qualities of *rajas* are renunciation, enjoyment, sexuality, self-interest, [and] accumulation of possessions.

The qualities of *tamas* are conflict, struggle, grief, bondage, [and] cheating.

Furthermore, the qualities of time are effecting, arranging, moving around, negligence [and] mental disorder.

The qualities of the embodied soul are the state of waking, the state of sleep, the state of deep sleep, the state of liberation [and the] state beyond liberation.[449]

[447] According to Pandey (1963: 594–597), the term *kula* has about twenty-two different meanings in various texts. Muller-Ortega explains that the basic meaning of the term from which all other meanings derive is "group". The core concept is that when the absolute reality of Śiva becomes manifest, the various manifestations of reality come together as a unified whole because of the inherent presence of Śiva's underlying unity. The manifest reality is called *kula* whereas Śiva is called *akula*. In this regard, Muller-Ortega (1989: 59) writes: "Similarly, each smaller unit of manifest reality—a universe, a world, a family, an individual person (a body)—can be termed a *kula* because it is a conglomeration of disparate objects, beings, and organs held together by an overarching unity." In the present case, the term *kula* probably refers to an individual person (a body) since the living soul, including its five states, is listed.

[448] The term *kulapañcaka* can be traced back to the *Ūrmikaulārṇavatantra* 2.227 and *Sarvadurgatipariśodhanatantra*, Ed. p. 224.

[449] See *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* 4491–4504.

[LIII. **ekaṃ jñānam**]

तदनन्तरमेतादृशमेकं ज्ञानमुत्पद्यते। इच्छा॥ क्रिया॥ माया॥ प्रकृतिः॥ वाचा॥ इच्छयाः पञ्चगुणाः। उन्मादः॥ वासना॥ वाञ्छा॥ चैत्तम्॥ चेष्टा॥ क्रियायाः पञ्चगुणाः। स्मरणम्॥ उद्यमः॥ उद्वेगः॥ कार्यनिश्चयः॥ सत्कुलाचारत्वम्॥ मा–
5 यायाः पञ्चगुणाः। मदः॥ मात्सर्यः॥ दम्भः॥ कीर्तिः॥ असत्यभावः॥ प्रकृतेः प–ञ्चगुणाः। आशा॥ तृष्णा॥ स्पृहा॥ काङ्क्षा॥ मिथ्यात्वं॥ वाचाया पञ्चगुणाः। परा॥ पश्यन्ती॥ मध्यमा॥ वैखरी॥ मातृका॥

Sources: 2 cf. SSP 1.54 (Ed. p. 18): icchā kriyā māyā prakṛtir vāg iti vyaktaśaktipañcakam | cf. YSv (PT, p. 847): prakṛtīcchā kriyā māyā vacaḥ pañca guṇā iti | 3 cf. SSP 1.55 (Ed. p. 18): unmādo vāsanā vāñchā cintā ceṣṭeti pañcaguṇecchā | cf. YSv (PT, p. 847): āśātṛṣṇāspṛhākāṅkṣāmithyāntaṃ prakṛter iti | unmādo vāsanā vāñchā cekṣitā ca guṇāḥ priye | 3–4 cf. SSP 1.56 (Ed. p. 18): smaraṇam udyogaḥ kāryaṃ niścayaḥ svakulācāra iti pañcaguṇā kriyā | 3–4 cf. YSv (PT, p. 847): śaraṇaṃ satkulācāraḥ kāryaniścaya ucyate | 5 cf. SSP 1.57 (Ed. p. 18): mado mātsaryaṃ dambhaḥ kṛtrimatvam asatyam iti pañcaguṇā māyā | 5–6 cf. SSP 1.58 (Ed. p. 19): āśā tṛṣṇā spṛhā kāṅkṣā mithyeti pañcaguṇā prakṛtiḥ | 6–7 cf. SSP 1.59 (Ed. p. 19): parā paśyantī madhyamā vaikharī mātṛketi pañcaguṇā vāk | iti vyaktiśaktipañcaviṃśatiguṇāḥ |

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2 **etādṛśam** cett.] etādṛśaṃ K_1U_1, etādṛśom U_2 **ekaṃ** cett.] eka N_2PE **icchā** cett.] icchāyāḥ N_1, *om.* E **kriyā** cett.] *om.* N_1E, kriyāḥ K_1 **māyā** cett.] *om.* E **prakṛtiḥ** cett.] prakṛti° U_1, prakṛtī P, *om.* E **vācā** K_1J] vāca $N_2N_1DU_1$, vācāḥ PB, bhāvaḥ U_2, *om.* E, vācyaḥ L 3 **icchayāḥ** cett.] icchayā N_2, ichāyā PLB **unmādaḥ** conj.] unmanya K_1J, unmaya P, unmanyaṃ U_2, unmany cett., unmayā B **vāsanā** cett.] *om.* U_1, vāsanāḥ U_2, avasthā E, avāsanā L **vāñchā** cett.] *om.* U_1, vāṃcha PLB **caittam** N_2N_1J] caita D, caītaṃ K_1, *om.* U_1, vittaṃ P, cittaḥ U_2, cittaṃ EL, krittaṃ B **ceṣṭā** cett.] *om.* U_1, ceṣṭa PL, ceṣṭāḥ U_2, veṣṭanam vibhramaḥ E, ccoṣṭhā B **kriyāyāḥ** cett.] kriyāyā N_2LB, kriyā J, *om.* U_1 4 **pañcaguṇāḥ** cett.] guṇāḥ J, *om.* U_1 **smaraṇam** cett.] *om.* U_1 **udyama** cett.] udyama N_2, *om.* U_1 **udvegaḥ** cett.] udvega N_2PLB, *om.* U_1 **kāryaniścayaḥ** cett.] kārya | niścayaḥ N_1, *om.* U_1 **satkulācāratvam** cett.] sakulācāratvaṃ ‖ cha ‖ J, *om.* U_1 4–5 **māyāyāḥ** U_2EB] māyāyā N_2N_1DJL, māyā° K_1, *om.* U_1, māyāyāṃ P 5 **pañcaguṇāḥ** ELB] guṇāḥ cett., guṇā D, *om.* U_1 **madaḥ** cett.] mada N_2JE, *om.* U_1 **mātsaryaḥ** N_1D] mātsarya N_2LB, matsaryaḥ K_1, māścaryaḥ J, *om.* U_1, mātsaryaṃ PU_2, mātsaryādayaḥ E **dambhaḥ** cett.] daṃbha N_2J, *om.* U_1, raṃbhaḥ LB **kīrtiḥ** cett.] kīrtiś ca $N_2N_1DK_1$J, *om.* U_1 **asatyabhāvaḥ** cett.] *om.* U_1, asatyabhāvāḥ E **prakṛteḥ** E] prakṛter K_1JPU_2, prakṛte cett., *om.* U_1 5–6 **pañcaguṇāḥ** E] guṇāḥ cett., *om.* U_1 6 **āśā** cett.] *om.* U_1 **tṛṣṇā** cett.] tṛṣā K_1, *om.* U_1 **spṛhā** cett.] spṛśā K_1, *om.* U_1 **kāṅkṣā** cett.] kākṣā D, *om.* U_1, bhikṣā P **mithyātvaṃ** cett.] *om.* U_1 **vācāyā** cett.] vācā D, *om.* U_1, vācaḥ U_2 **pañcaguṇāḥ** ELB] guṇāḥ $N_2N_1DK_1$JP, *om.* U_1, pañcaguṇaḥ U_2 **parā** cett.] *om.* U_1 7 **paśyantī** cett.] paśyanti $N_2N_1U_2$LB **madhyamā** cett.] *om.* U_1 **vaikharī** cett.] vaiṣarī K_1 **mātṛkā** cett.] mātṛkāḥ U_2

[LIII. **Unique knowledge**]

Immediately after that, unique knowledge like this is generated: will, action, illusion, nature, [and] speech.[450]

The five qualities of will are intense passion, mental residue, wish, mental state, [and] acting.

The five qualities of activity are memory, effort, agitation, determination of action, [and] adherence to the conduct of the noble lineage.

The qualities of illusion are intoxication, envy, fraud, fame, [and] the state of untruth.

The five qualities of nature are hope, thirst, desire, striving [and] infatuation.

The five qualities of speech are Parā, Paśyantī, Madhyamā, Vaikharī[451] [and] Mātṛkā.[452]

[450] The *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 1.54 associates the five concluding qualities on this page with the higher category of *vyaktaśakti*, each comprising five sub-qualities, amounting to twenty-five in total. Rāmacandra, however, does not employ the term *vyaktaśakti*, nor is it attested in any of the *Tattvayogabindu*'s witnesses examined thus far. It appears that, in this instance, Rāmacandra followed the *Yogasvarodaya* as his model, a text which likewise neither refers to *vyaktaśakti* nor explicitly identifies the referent of these five qualities. Given that Rāmacandra drew upon both works, his omission of a reference element remains a point of interpretive interest.

[451] Parā, Paśyantī, Madhyamā, Vaikharī are the well-known successive phases of sound transformation in Sanskrit. These phases represent the progression of sound from its eternal source to audible speech. Parā is the highest eternal sound or word in which all concepts and words potentially rest. In the additional material of U_2, Parā is associated with the fifth *cakra* at the throat (see p. 126.). Next, Paśyantī is the phase of speech reaching the heart associated with the fourth *cakra* in the heart (see p. 120). Then, Madhyamā is the intermediate stage of speech, characterised by thought or contemplation residing in the mind and intellect. In U_2, it is linked to the *cakra* at the navel (see p. 118). Finally, Vaikharī is the daily spoken language characterised by comprehensible speech. Unlike the first three stages, Vaikharī is audible to others and represents the full transformation of sound from subtle to gross form. U_2 associates Vaikharī with the *svādhiṣṭānacakra* at the gender (see p. 116).

[452] The fifty or fifty-one letters including vowels as well as consonants of the Devanāgarī alphabet associated with the power of the Divine Mother herself, cf. Aryan, 1980: 24–28.

[LIV. **karma kāmaḥ candraḥ sūryaḥ agniḥ**]

तदनन्तरमेतादृशं ज्ञानमुत्पद्यते। कर्म॥ कामः॥ चन्द्रः॥ सूर्यः॥ अग्निः॥ एत–
त्पञ्चकं प्रत्यक्षं कर्तव्यम्। तत्र कर्मणः पञ्चगुणाः। शुभम्॥ अशुभम्॥ यशः॥ अ–
पकीर्तिः॥ इष्टफलसाधनम्॥ कामस्य गुणाः। रतिः॥ प्रीतिः॥ क्रीडा॥ कामना॥
अनुरता॥

[LV. **candrasya ṣoḍaśakalāḥ**]

इदानीं चन्द्रस्य षोदशकलाः कथ्यन्ते। उल्लोला॥ कल्लोलिनी॥ उच्चलन्ती॥ उ–
न्मादिनी॥ तरङ्गिणी॥ पोषयन्ती॥ लम्पटा॥ लहरी॥ लोला॥ लेलिहाना॥ प्रस
रन्ती॥ प्रवृत्तिः॥ स्रवन्ती॥ प्रवाहा॥ सौम्या॥ प्रसन्ना॥ चन्द्रस्य सप्तदशी कला
वर्तते। तस्या नाम निवृत्तिः साऽमृतकला कथ्यते॥

Sources: 2–3 cf. SSP 1.60 (Ed. p. 19): karmaḥ kāmaś candraḥ sūryo 'gnir iti pratyakṣakaraṇa-pañcakam 3–4 cf. SSP 1.61 (Ed. p. 19): śubham aśubhaṃ yaśo 'pakīrtir adṛṣṭaphalasādhanam iti pañcaguṇaṃ karma | 4–5 cf. SSP 1.62 (Ed. p. 20): ratiḥ prītiḥ krīḍā kāmanā 'turateti pañcaguṇaḥ kāmaḥ | 7–10 cf. SSP 1.63 (Ed. p. 20): ullolā kallolinī uccalantī unmādinī taraṃgiṇī śoṣiṇī alampaṭā pravṛttiḥ laharī lolā lelihānā prasarantī pravāhā saumyā prasannā plavantī | evaṃ candrasya ṣoḍaśa kalāḥ | saptadaśī kalā nivṛttiḥ | sā 'mṛtakalā |

2 **utpadyate** cett.] utpādyate N_2N_1DJ **karma** cett.] karmaḥ U_2, kāraḥ E **kāmaḥ** cett.] kāma $N_2K_1JU_1PLB$ **candraḥ** $N_1DK_1U_2E$] candra cett. **sūryaḥ** cett.] sūrya N_2JU_1 **agniḥ** K_1JU_2E] agni N_2, agnī U_1, āgniḥ cett. 3 **kartavyam** cett.] karttavyāṃ K_1 **karmaṇaḥ** cett.] karmaṇa° N_2, karnaṇaḥ K_1U_1, karmaṇā PB, karmaṇāṃ L **pañcaguṇāḥ** cett.] *om.* K_1 **śubham** cett.] śubha DU_1, *om.* E **aśubham** cett.] °aśubha° U_1, *om.* PE **yaśaḥ** cett.] yasa N_2, *om.* E 3–4 **apakīrtiḥ** cett.] apakīrtti N_2, āvakīrtiḥ U_1, *om.* E 4 **iṣṭaphalasādhanam** cett.] *om.* E **kāmasya** cett.] kāmaḥsya U_2 **ratiḥ** cett.] rati° N_2JU_1 **prītiḥ** cett.] prīti *β* **kāmanā** cett.] kāmana K_1, kāmanāḥ P, kāminy L, kāminā B 5 **anuratā** N_1DJ] anurajā N_2, ānuratā K_1U_1, anurattutā P, anuraktā U_2, anustutā EB, anuraktatā L 7 **ṣodaśakalāḥ** N_2K_1] śodaśakalāḥ N_1DJU_1, ṣoḍaśakalāḥ PEB, saptadaśakalā U_2, ṣoḍaśa L **kathyante** cett.] vartaṃte ‖ tasyānāmāni ‖ ṣoḍaśakalā kathyaṃte ‖ U_2, kathyate LB **ullolā** em.] hallolā $N_2N_1DK_1JU_1P$, hallolāḥ U_2, dallolā E, hullātvā L, dullālā B **kallolinī** cett.] kalloli N_2, kallolini K_1U_1L **uccalantī** em.] udyalinī J, uchalanī U_1, uścalinī PE, ucchṛlinī U_2, uchaṃlini L, ucaṃlini B, *om.* cett. 7–8 **unmādinī** cett.] unmādani U_1, unmādanī L 8 **poṣayantī** PE] poṣayanti $N_2N_1DK_1J$, poṣayanī U_1, poṣayati U_2, poṣāyaṃtī LB **lampaṭā** $K_1JU_1PU_2E$] lapaḍā N_2N_1D, lapaṭāḥ L, lapaṃṭāḥ B **laharī** cett.] lahari L **lolā** cett.] lolāḥ U_2 **lelihānā** cett.] lelihanā K_1, lelihānāḥ U_2, lelihā LB 8–9 **prasarantī** cett.] prasaraṃti JU_1U_2 9 **pravṛttiḥ** cett.] prakṛtī L, pravṛttī B **sravantī** cett.] sravatī K_1, sravaṃti U_2, plavantī E **pravāhā** cett.] pravaṃtī śvāḥ U_1, pravāhāḥ U_2, mavāhā LB **saumyā** cett.] saumya U_1, saumyāḥ U_2, somyā LB **prasannā** cett.] prasannāḥ U_2 **saptadaśī** cett.] saptadṛśī U_2, saptadaśamī EB **kalā** cett.] kālā K_1, kā U_1 10 **tasyā** cett.] *om.* J, tasya P, tasyāḥ U_2 **nāma** cett.] *om.* J, nāmāni ‖ U_2 **nivṛttiḥ** U_1] naivṛttiḥ N_2N_1, naivṛttaiḥ DK_1, *om.* J, nivṛtti PELB, vṛttiḥ U_2 **sā 'mṛtakalā** $N_2N_1DK_1$] *om.* J, sā mṛta U_1, sametākalā PEB, sametaḥ ‖ kalāḥ ‖ U_2, sametakalā L **kathyate** cett.] *om.* J, kathyante U_2

[LIV. **Action, desire, moon, sun and fire**]

Immediately after that, knowledge like this is generated: action, desire, moon, sun, and fire. The direct perception of this pentad shall be done.[453] Among those, the five qualities of action are auspicious, inauspicious, honour, dishonour [and] bringing about the desired result.

The qualities of desire are lust, satisfaction, play, sexual desire, [and] falling in love.

[LV. **Sixteen digits of the moon**]

Now, the sixteen digits[454] of the moon are taught. 1. Ullolā, 2. Kallolinī, 3. Uccalantī, 4. Unmādinī, 5. Taraṅginī, 6. Poṣayantī, 7. Laṃpaṭā, 8. Laharī, 9. Lolā, 10. Lelihānā, 11. Prasarantī, 12. Pravṛttiḥ, 13. Sravantī, 14. Pravāhā, 15. Saumyā, 16. Prasannā. A seventeenth digit of the moon exists. Her name is Nivṛtti ("inactivity"), [and] she is taught to be the Amṛtakalā ("digit of the nectar of immortality").

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[453] In contrast to the initial statements introducing the sections dealing with metaphysics and the yogic body (XLVIII–LV) in which the topics are presented as a mere result of the accomplishment of yoga, here, the reader is suddenly instructed to perceive the pentad directly. That raises the question of whether the purpose of the whole metaphysics and yogic body sections is always taught merely as information or if, indeed, all pentads are supposed to be perceived or visualised. The latter option is advocated by *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 1.65, which concludes the section of the *kalās* of sun, moon and fire in a similar way: *iti pratyakṣakaraṇaguṇakalāsamūhaḥ* ‖ "This is the group of qualities and *kalā*s of direct perception." As mentioned, various teachings of the *Tattvayogabindu* and its two source texts have various parallels with the *Netratantra with Netroddyota*. In the *Netratantra with Netroddyota* 7.4–5, all contents of the yogic body are the objects of meditation. The meditation bestows knowledge of the body, a requirement through which the yogin nourishes or enlivens his own body and that of others (*nāḍivṛṇḍaiḥ samākrāntaṃ malinaṃ vyādhibhir vṛtaṃ | sūkṣmadhyānāmṛtenaiva pareṇaivoditena tu* ‖4‖ *āpyāyaṃ kurute yogī ātmano vā parasya ca | divyadehaḥ sa bhavati sarvavyādhivivarjitaḥ* ‖5‖). That is the condition for attaining or becoming a divine body. Furthermore, cf. Srivatsa, 2019: 44, 152–153, 166–167.

[454] The term *kalā* carries the primary meaning of "digit," specifically indicating "a sixteenth digit of the moon". This concept is found in various texts (cf., e.g. *Bṛhadāraṇyakopaniṣat* 1.5.14 or *Amṛtasiddhi* 3.1–4), and it is associated with the moon's waxing and waning, where each day it gains or loses one *kalā*. Some tantric texts (cf. *Tantrāloka (b)* 3.137), add a seventeenth …

[LVI. **sūryasya dvādaśakalāḥ**]

इदानीं सूर्यस्य द्वादशकलाः कथ्यन्ते। तापिनी॥ ग्रासिका॥ उग्रा॥ आकुञ्चिनी॥ शोषिणी॥ प्रबोधिनी॥ घस्मरा॥ आकर्षयन्ती॥ तुष्टिवर्धिनी॥ ऊर्मिरेखा॥ किरणवती॥ प्रभूतवती॥ सूर्यस्य त्रयोदशी कला विद्यते। तस्याः संज्ञा निजकला स्वप्रकाशा च॥

[LVII. **agnisaṃbandhinyo daśakalāḥ**]

इदानीमग्निसंबन्धिन्यो दशकलाः कथ्यन्ते। दीपिका॥ राजिका॥ ज्वलनी॥ विस्फुलिङ्गिनी॥ प्रचण्डा॥ पाचिका॥ रौद्री॥ दाहिका॥ रावणी॥ शिखावती॥ अग्नेरेकादशी निजकला ज्योतिः संज्ञा वर्तते॥

Sources: 2–5 cf. SSP 1.64 (Ed. p. 20): tāpinī grāsikā ugrā ākuñcinī śoṣiṇī prabodhinī smarā ākarṣiṇī tuṣṭivardhinī urmirekhā kiraṇavatī prabhāvatīti dvādaśa kalāḥ sūryasya | trayodaśī svaprakāśatā nijakalā | 7–9 cf. SSP 1.65 (Ed. p. 21): dīpikā rājikā jvalanī visphuliṃginī pracaṇḍā pācikā raudrī dāhikā rāgiṇī śikhāvatī ity agner daśa kalāḥ | ekādaśī kalā jyotiḥ |

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2 **dvādaśakalāḥ** JPU$_2$] dvādaśakalā N$_2$N$_1$DK$_1$U$_1$LB, kalāḥ E **kathyante** cett.] kathyate N$_2$K$_1$LB **tāpinī** em.] tapanī N$_2$N$_1$DK$_1$JU$_2$E, tapani U$_1$, tāpanī P, tāpani LB **grāsikā** em.] grāsakā cett., grāsaka PLB **ākuñcinī** em.] ākuṃcanī β, ākocanī PLB, akocanī U$_2$E 3 **śoṣiṇī** P] śoṣaṇī cett. **prabodhinī** cett.] prabodhanī LB **ghasmarā** cett.] ghasmara N$_2$ **ākarṣayantī** cett.] ākarṣayaṃti U$_1$, ākarṣayatī U$_2$, ākarṣiṇī E **tuṣṭivardhinī** PE] tuṣṭivarddhanī β, tuṣṭiḥ varddhanī U$_2$, tuṣṭivardhanī LB **ūrmirekhā** cett.] ūrmireṣā K$_1$, kurmmīrekhā P, ūrmī ‖ rekhā U$_2$, kūrmīreṣā E 3–4 **kiraṇavatī** U$_2$E] kiraṇāvatī N$_2$N$_1$DK$_1$JP, kīrṇavatī U$_1$, kīrṇāvatī LB 4 **prabhūtavatī** PU$_2$] prabhutavatī N$_2$N$_1$DK$_1$JU$_1$, prabhavati EB, prabhutavati L **tasyāḥ** DK$_1$JU$_1$] tasyā U$_2$, tasya cett. **saṃjñā** β] nāma PEL, nāmāni U$_2$, nāmaḥ B **nijakalā** cett.] nijakalāṃ N$_2$N$_1$DK$_1$ 7 **idānīm** cett.] idānīṃ U$_2$ **agnisaṃbandhinyo** PE] agnīsaṃbaṃdhinī N$_2$N$_1$DK$_1$J, agnīsaṃbaṃdhinīṃ U$_1$, agnisaṃbaṃdhinī U$_2$, agnīsaṃbaṃdhini LB **daśakalāḥ** cett.] daśakalā N$_2$LB, dvādaśakalāḥ J, dvādaśakalā U$_1$ **dīpikā** cett.] dīpikār U$_1$ **rājikā** em.] jārakā N$_2$N$_1$DK$_1$J, jakā U$_1$, *om.* cett. **jvalanī** em.] jvālāviḥ U$_1$, jvālā cett. 8 **pācikā** E] pācakā N$_2$N$_1$DK$_1$J, pāvakā cett. **dāhikā** E] dāhakā N$_2$N$_1$DK$_1$JPU$_2$, dāhaka U$_1$LB **rāvaṇī** K$_1$PU$_2$ELB] rāvaṇi N$_2$N$_1$DJU$_1$ 8–9 **agner** cett.] ajñer K$_1$, agne U$_1$LB 9 **ekādaśī** DJPU$_2$E] ekādaśi cett. **jyotiḥ** cett.] jyoti° K$_1$J **saṃjñā** cett.] saṃjñakā N$_2$N$_1$D, °saṃjñakā K$_1$, °saṃjñakā ‖ cha ‖ J **vartate** cett.] *om.* N$_2$N$_1$DK$_1$J

[LVI. **Twelve digits of the sun**]

Now, the twelve digits of the sun are taught. 1. Tāpinī, 2. Grāsikā, 3. Ugrā, 4. Ākuñcinī, 5. Śoṣiṇī, 6. Prabodhinī, 7. Ghasmarā, 8. Ākarṣayantī, 9. Tuṣṭivardhinī, 10. Ūrmirekhā, 11. Kiraṇavatī, 12. Prabhūtavatī.[455] The thirteenth digit of the sun is to be known. Her technical designation is Nijakalā ("the inherent digit") and Svaprakāśā ("self-luminous").

[LVII. **Ten digits related to fire**]

Now, the ten digits, which are related to the fire, are taught. 1. Dīpikā, 2. Rājikā, 3. Jvalanī, 4. Visphuliṅginī, 5. Pracaṇḍā, 6. Pācikā, 7. Raudrī, 8. Dāhikā, 9. Rāvaṇī,[456] 10. Śikhāvatī. Jyotis ("light") is the technical designation for the eleventh inherent digit of fire.

kalā, often called *amṛtakalā* or *amākalā* (cf. *Tantrāloka (b)* 3.141 [Jayaratha ad 5.63–64]; *Parātriśikāvivaraṇa* 35; *Matsyendrasaṃhitā* 25.57 (e-text provided by Csaba Kiss [08.02.2007]); *Ṣaṭcakranirūpaṇa* 47) which exists eternally, even during the moon's darkest phase. The early association of the moon with *soma* and *amṛta* in Indian traditions (see Gonda particularly chapters II. "Soma, Amṛta and the Moon" [1965: 38–70] and IV. "The number sixteen" [1965: 115–130]) resulted in the idea that all of the moon's *kalā*s contain *amṛta*, cf. particularly chapter II. of the *Khecarīvidyā* 2010. Those ideas were carried into Rājayoga literature like in *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 1.63 and the *Tattvayogabindu*. Moreover, the term *kalā* is used to describe the divisions of the sun and fire, cf. e.g. *Kulārṇavatantra* 6.37–40; *Amṛtasiddhi* 4.1–12 and 5.1–4; *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 1.64–65; *Gorakṣyogaśāstra* 9; *Gorakhbāṇī* 89. In the *Tattvayogabindu*, the twelve *kalā*s of the sun represent the various qualities and aspects of the sun's influence. Perhaps the number twelve additionally reflects the twelve signs of the zodiac or the twelve months in a year. The ten *kalā*s of the fire in the *Tattvayogabindu* represent the various qualities and aspects of the fire's influence.

[455] The best manuscripts of both main branches of the stemma clearly support the variants of *ākarṣayantī* and *prabhūtavatī* for the eighth and twelfth *kalā*s of *sūrya*. For this reason, I was compelled to discard the readings of the source text, which also occurs in our transmission, but was, given the specific manuscripts that transmit it, in all likelihood introduced at a later stage.

[456] Here, too, the stemmatic evidence clearly supports the reading *rāvaṇī* which is distinct from that of the source text (*rāgiṇī*).

[LVIII. **yogasya māhātmyam**]

इदानीं योगस्य माहात्म्यं कथ्यते। गुरोरनुग्रहात्॥ शास्त्रस्य पठनात्॥ आचार–करणात्॥ वेदान्तरहस्यश्रवणात्॥ ध्यानकरणात्॥ लयसाधनात्॥ उपवासक–रणात्॥ चतुरशीत्यासन साधनात्॥ वैराग्यस्योत्पत्तेः॥ वैराग्यकरणात्॥ हठयो–
5 गस्य करणात्॥ इडापिङ्गलयोः पवनधारणात्॥ महामुद्रादिदशमुद्रासाधनात्॥ मौनकरणात्॥ वनवासात्॥ बहुतरक्लेशकरणात्॥ बहुतरकालं यन्त्रमन्त्रादिसाध–नात्॥ तपःकरणात्॥ बहुतरार्थादानात्॥ तीर्थसेवाकरणात्॥ आश्रमाचारपाल–नात्॥ संन्यासग्रहणात्॥ षड्दर्शनग्रहणात्॥ शिरोमुण्डनात्॥ अन्योपायकरणात्॥ योगतत्त्वं न प्राप्यते। स तु योगो गुरुसेवया प्राप्यते।

Sources: 2–9 cf. YSv (PT, p. 847–848): idānīṃ yogamāhātmyaṃ kathyate yad bhavet tataḥ | guror anugrahāc chāstrapāṭhād ācāratas tathā | vedāntārtharahasyārthasarva-jñānādupāsanāt | āsanād dhāraṇād dhyānāl layaṣaṭkarmasādhanāt | āsanāc caturaśītivairā-gyatyāgasambhavāt | haṭhayogād varauṣadhyāt mudrāsādhanamānataḥ | vanavāsād bahuk-leśāt tathā mantrādisādhanāt |bahudānatapastīrthasevanād dānaśikṣaṇāt | sandhyātrayagra-heṇātha ṣaḍadarśagrahaṇāt tathā | śiromuṇḍagato nyāsād yogatattvañ ca vidyate | 2–9 cf. SSP 5.55–58 (Ed. pp. 97–98): samyaksvabhāvavijñānāt kramābhyāsān na cāsanāt | na vairāgyān na nairāśyān nāhārat prāṇadhāraṇāt ‖55‖ na mudrādhāraṇad yogān na mānakarmasamāśrayāt| na virakter vṛthāyāsān na kāyakleśadhāraṇāt ‖56‖ na japān na tapodhyānān na yajñāt tīrtha-sevanāt | na devārcanāśrayād bhaktyā nāśramāṇāñ ca pālanāt ‖57‖ na ṣaḍdarśanakeśādid-hāraṇān na ca muṇḍānāt | nānantopāyayatnebhyaḥ prāpyate paramaṃ padam‖58‖

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2 **idānīṃ** cett.] idānī B **yogasya** cett.] yasya U_1 **māhātmyaṃ** cett.] māhātmya N_2, māhāt-maṃ LB **kathyate** cett.] kathyaṃte JU_2 **guror** cett.] guru LB **anugrahāt** cett.] agrahāt L **śāstrasya paṭhanāt** cett.] śāstrapāṭhanāt J 2–3 **ācārakaraṇāt** cett.] ācārakathanāt U_2 3 **dhyānakaraṇāt** cett.] *om.* P **layasādhanāt** β] *om.* γ 3–4 **upavāsakaraṇāt** cett.] *om.* P 4 **caturaśītyāsana°** PU_2] caturaśīti āsana° β, caturaśītyāsane E, caturāśītyāsana° LB **vairāgyasyotpatteḥ** N_2U_2EL] vairāgyotpatteḥ N_1D, vairāgyotpattair J, vairāgyotpatte U_1, vairāgyasyotpattaḥ P, vairāgyasyotpatte B **vairāgya°** cett.] nairāśya PL, nairāśye E, nairāśa° B **haṭha°** cett.] haṭa° U_1LB 4–5 **°yogasya** cett.] yoga° $N_2N_1DK_1J$ 5 **piṅgalayoḥ** cett.] °piṃgalayāḥ $N_2K_1JU_1$ **pavanadhāraṇāt** PE] pavanādhāraṇāt N_2, pāvanādhāraṇāt N_1D, pavanadharaṇāt K_1U_1, pāvansādhanāt J, pavanādhānākaraṇāt U_2, pāvanāpāvadhyā-nakaraṇāt L, *om.* B **mahāmudrādidaśamudrāsādhanāt** cett.] mahāmudrādidaśamudrādi daśamūdrasādhanāt D, mahāmudrāsādhanāt U_1 6 **maunakaraṇāt** cett.] maunakaraṇād N_2 **vanavāsāt** cett.] vane vāsāta° N_2, vane vāsāt $N_1DK_1JU_1$ **bahutarakālaṃ** cett.] bahutarakāla° U_1U_2L, bahukāla° EB **yantramantrādi°** cett.] yaṃtrayaṃtrādi° N_2N_1D, maṃtrādi° K_1, maṃ-trayaṃtra° J, maṃtrayaṃtrādi° U_1L 7 **tapaḥ** PU_2E] tapa° cett. **bahutarārthādānāt** cett.] bahutarakleśakaraṇāt bahutarakaraṇāt bahutatārthadānāt P, bahutarārpaṇadānāt E **tīrtha-sevākaraṇāt** N_2DJ] tīrthasevokaraṇāt N_1, tīthaṃ sevākaraṇāt K_1, niyamakaraṇāt U_1, *om.* cett. **āśramācāra°** cett.] āśramāra° K_1, āśramācyāra° U_1 8 **ṣaḍdarśana°** K_1U_1ELB] ṣaṭdarśana° cett. **śiromuṇḍanāt** cett.] siromaṃḍanāt N_2J, *om.* P **anyopāyakaraṇāt** cett.] *om.* P 9 **sa tu yogo** cett.] *om.* P, sa tu yogaḥ E **gurusevayā** cett.] *om.* P **prāpyate** cett.] prāpyate śrī N_1, prāpyate ‖ cha ‖ J, *om.* P

[LVIII. **Majesty of yoga**]

Now, the majesty of yoga is taught. As a result of the grace of the teacher, studying the teaching, execution of good conduct, hearing the secret of Vedānta, meditation, dissolution, fasting, practising 84 postures, generating indifference, cultivating indifference, doing Haṭhayoga, holding the breath of the Iḍā- and Piṅgalā-channels, practising the ten seals [like] the great-seal etc., observing silence, dwelling in the forest, causing excessive distress, practising Mantra and Yantra, etc. for a long time, doing austerities, giving many donations, frequenting places of pilgrimage, observing the conduct [proper] to the stages of life, adhering to renunciation, grasping the six philosophies, shaving the head, doing other methods, the reality of yoga[457] is not attained. But this [reality of] yoga is truly attained by serving the teacher.[458]

[457] This is the only mention of the compound *yogatattva* in the entire text. The formulation makes the prominent position of *gurusevā* in Rāmacandra's doctrinal system unmistakably clear. According to Rāmacandra, the techniques and metaphysical views presented earlier in the text and all other yoga practices are incapable of bringing about the reality (*tattva*) of yoga. In Rāmacandra's opinion, *gurusevā* is the means *par excellence* to achieve the goals of yoga.

[458] This specific type of presentation under the keyword *yogamāhātmyam* or *yogasya māhātmyam* is found not only in the *Tattvayogabindu* and its source texts, but also in several other Rājayoga texts. That is not entirely surprising, as the sublimity, superiority or majesty of Rājayoga, which is always suggested, is fundamentally contained in the association with this term. Comparable formulations can already be found in *Amanaska* 2.5: *rājayogasya māhātmyaṃ ko vā jānāti tattvataḥ | jñānāt siddhir muktir iti guror jñānaṃ ca labhyate* ‖ Birch translates: "Who, indeed, truly knows the majesty of Rājayoga? Since [both] power and liberation arise from knowledge, knowledge [should be] obtained from the guru." The proximity becomes even more apparent in *Amanaska* 1.3–5. Here, Birch translates: "In the Cakras, such as Mūlādhāra, in the pathways [of vitality], such as Suṣumnā, and in the vital airs, such as Prāṇa, the highest reality is not located. Some are devoted to Mantra Yoga, some are confused by meditation, and some are tormented by forceful [practices]. They do not know what causes one to cross over [to liberation]. Not by studying the doctrines of scriptural exegesis, logic, planets and mathematics, nor by the Vedas, Upaniṣads, Dharmaśāstras [and the like]; not even by lexicons nor metre, grammar, poetry, nor rhetoric; the sage's attainment of the highest reality is gained only from the oral teachings of his own guru." (*ādhārādiṣu cakreṣu suṣumnādiṣu nāḍiṣu | prāṇādiṣu samīreṣu paraṃ tattvaṃ na tiṣṭhati* ‖ 3 ‖ *mantrayogaratāḥ ke cit ke cid dhyānavimohitāḥ | haṭhena ke cit kliśyanti naiva jānanti tārakam* ‖ 4 ‖ *na mīmāṃsātarkagrahagaṇitasiddhāntapaṭhanair …*

गुरुदृक्पातपात्राणां दृढानां सत्यवादिनाम्।
कथनाद्दृष्टिपाताद्वा सांनिध्यादवलोकनात्॥ LVIII.1॥

प्रसादात्सद्गुरोः सम्यक्प्राप्यते परमं पदम्।
अत एव वचः प्रोक्तं न गुरोरधिकं परं॥ LVIII.2॥

वाङ्मात्राद्वाथ दृक्पाताद्यः करोति शमं क्षणात्।
प्रस्फुटभ्रान्तिहृत्तोषं स्वच्छं वन्दे गुरुं परम्॥ LVIII.3॥

Sources: 1–2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 848): gurupādodakaṃ śiṣṭasevinā satyavādinā | kanyāstrādidṛṣṭipātaharṣagativivarttanāt | 1–2 ≈ SSP 5.60–61ab (Ed. pp. 98–99): gurudṛkpātanāt prāyo dṛḍhānāṃ satyavādināṃ sā sthitir jāyate | kathanāc chaktipātād vā yad vā pādāvalokanāt | 3–4 ≈ YSv (PT, p. 848): prasādāt sadguroḥ samyak prāpnoti paramaṃ padam | na guror adhikaṃ tattvaṃ yat tasmāt paramaṃ padam | 3–4 ≈ SSP 5.61cd–62ab (Ed. p. 99): prasādāt svaguroḥ samyak prāpyate paramaṃ padaṃ ‖61‖ ata eva śivenoktam na guror adhikaṃ na guror adhikaṃ na guror adhikaṃ | 5–6 ≈ SSP 5.64 (Ed. p. 100): vāṅmātrād vātha dṛkpātāt yaḥ karoti ca tatkṣaṇāt | prasphuṭaṃ śāmbhavaṃ vedhaṃ svasaṃvedyaṃ paraṃ padam |

1 **gurudṛkpātapātrāṇāṃ** $N_2N_1JPU_2$] gurudṛkpātapātrāṇo D, gurudṛkpātrāṇāṃ K_1, gurudakpātrāṇāṃ U_1, gurukṛpātaḥ pātrāṇāṃ E, gurudṛkpāt patrāṇāṃ L, gurudṛk | pāt | patrāṇāṃ B **dṛḍhānāṃ** cett.] dṛḍānāṃ K_1, *om.* L **satyavādinām** cett.] satyavāridinām *unm.* U_1 2 **kathanād** cett.] kathanā K_1U_2, upayā° U_1 **dṛṣṭipātād** cett.] viṣapānād L, viṣapātād B **sāṃnidhyād** PU_2E] sānidhyād N_2N_1D, sānidhyāty K_1U_1, sānnidhyād J, sānnitdhy L, sānidhyāt B **avalokanāt** K_1JU_1PEL] dhyavalokanāt N_2N_1, dyavalokanāt D, dhyāvalokanāt U_2, dyavatrokanāt B 3 **prasādāt sadguroḥ** cett.] prasādāsya guroḥ P, sadguruprasādāt E, prasāt sadguroḥ B **prāpyate paramaṃ padaṃ** cett.] paramaṃ padaṃ pāpyate E 4 **ata eva** cett.] ata evaṃ E **paraṃ** cett.] param E 5 **vātha** cett.] bodha E **dṛkpātād** cett.] dṛkpītād B **śamaṃ** cett.] śasaṃ N_2, samaṃ JU_2 6 **prasphuṭa°** em.] prasphaṭa° N_2, prasphaṭat N_1, prasphuṭat DK_1J, prasphuṭad PU_2E, prasphaṭad LB **°bhrānti°** cett.] °bhāti° LB **hṛttoṣaṃ** K_1PE] haddoṣaṃ N_2, hatddoṣaṃ N_1, hṛddoṣaṃ DJ, ++++ṣaṃ U_2, hatoṣaṃ LB **svacchaṃ** cett.] tvacchaṃ N_2 **vande** γ] veda° N_2DK_1J, vade N_1 **guruṃ** γ] °karaṃ N_2K_1, karaṃ N_1, °kakaraṃ *unm.* DJ **paraṃ** cett.] parāṃ N_1

Notes: 1 **vāṅmātrād**: This point marks the beginning of a larger *lacuna* U_1. Omissions will not be recorded. The reader will be informed once the evidence of U_1 resumes.

LVIII.1 Those worthy ones upon whom the teacher's gaze falls, who are firm and truthful, because of either the [teachers'] stories, the falling of the teacher's gaze, or his proximity, or because of viewing [the teacher], …

LVIII.2 By the grace of the true teacher, they completely attain the supreme state. Therefore, it is said that nothing is greater than the teacher's words.

LVIII.3 I venerate the supreme, pure teacher, whose contentment removes my obvious errors, and who instantly brings [me] equanimity by his mere words and the fall of his gaze [on me].

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na vedair vedāntaiḥ smṛtibhir abhidhānair api na ca | na cāpi cchandovyākaraṇakavitālaṅkṛtimayair munes tattvāvāptir nijagurumukhād eva vihitā ‖ 5 ‖). Sundaradeva's *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* 2.1–12 also teaches a *yogamāhātmyam*. In comparison, however, with an interesting twist. While in Rāmacandra's formulations, all the techniques mentioned for achieving *yogatattva* except *gurusevā* are eclipsed, Sundaradeva raises various techniques in his explanations that can only be learnt by a competent *guru*, such as *mudrā*s, *āsana*s, *kumbhaka*s etc. as a basic prerequisite for achieving the state of yoga, see, e.g. *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* 2.1: *atha yogamāhātmyam | yāvan mudrābhyasanamamalaṃ sampradāyānna yātaṃ yāvat pīṭhān yatha gadaharāṇyuccakairno jitāni* ‖ *yāvat kumbho nijagurumukhān nopalabdho na dīrghas tāvad yogo na bhavati kalau lolacittasya sūraiḥ* ‖ 1 ‖ For Sundaradeva, the main focus is on mastering the breath. In a very similar way, the breath is also emphasised within the *yogamāhātmya* section of the first verses of the *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (Ms. No. 2244 f. 2r–2v). In addition, the necessity of detaching the mind from attachment to sense objects and continuous yoga practice, etc., is highlighted here. The term is also mentioned in Agastya's *Rājayoga* (f. 1r) but without the reference to *gurusevā* or the negation of other practices. Thus, in Rājayoga texts, the term *yogamāhatmya* is used either to explain the superiority of the respective core practices of Rājayoga with or without a comparison of inferior or ineffective means.

सम्यगानन्दजननः सद्गुरुः सोऽभिधीयते।
निमेषार्द्धं च पादं वा यद्वाक्यादवलोकनात्॥।
स्वात्मा स्थिरत्वम्आयाति तस्मै श्रीगुरवे नमः॥ LVIII.4॥

नानाविकल्पविश्रान्ति कथनात्कुरुते तु यः।
सद्गुरुः स तु विज्ञेयो न तु विप्रियजल्पकः॥ LVIII.5॥

अत एव परमपदप्राप्त्यर्थं सद्गुरुः सर्वदा वन्द्यः। यः पुरुषः सत्यवादी भवति। निरन्तरं गुरुसेवा रतो भवति। यस्य मनसि पापं न भवति। स्वाचाररतो स्नानादिशीलो भवति। कापट्यं न भवति यस्य वंशपरंपरा ज्ञायते। एतादृशस्य सद्गुरोः संगतिः कर्तव्या तेन। पुरुषस्य मनः शान्तिं प्राप्नोति।

Sources: 1–3 ≈ SSP 5.64cd–5.65 (Ed. p. 100–101): samyag ānandajanakaḥ sadguruḥ so 'bhidhīyate | nimiṣārdhārdhapātād vā yad vā pādāvalokanāt | svātmānaṃ sthiram ādhatte tasmai śrīgurave namaḥ | 1–3 cf. YSv (PT, p. 848): nimeṣārddhena tasyaiva ājñāpālanato bhavet | mahānandaśataprāptis tasmai śrīgurave namaḥ | 4–6 ≈ SSP 5.66cd (Ed. pp. 101): nānāvikalpaviśrāntiṃ kathayā kurute tu yaḥ | sadguruḥ sa tu vijñeyo na tu mithyāviḍambakaḥ| 4–6 ≈ YSv (PT, p. 848): nānāvikalpavibhrāntināśañ ca kurute tu yaḥ | sadguruḥ sa tu vijñeyo na tu vairaprakalpakaḥ | 7–8 cf. SSP 5.67 (Ed. p. 101): ata eva paramapadaprāpty arthaṃ sa sadguruḥ sadā vandanīyaḥ | 7–8 cf. YSv (PT, p. 848): ata eva maheśāni sadguruḥ śiva āditaḥ | satyavādī ca sacchīlo gurubhakto dṛḍhavrataḥ | 8–9 cf. YSv (PT, p. 848): svalpācāraratātmā yo dānādiśīlasaṃyutaḥ | kāpaṭyalobhavinyāsau mahāvaṃśasamudbhavaḥ | 9–10 cf. YSv (PT, p. 848): īdṛśaḥ sadgurus tasya saṅgatau yatnavān bhavet | tad eva manasaḥ śāntiṃ prāpnoti paramaṃ padam |

1 °**jananaḥ** γ] jananaṃ $N_2N_1DK_1J$ 2 **nimeṣārddhaṃ** cett.] nimiṣārddhaṃ N_2K_1P, nimeṣārddhā LB **ca** β] vā γ **pādaṃ vā** β] tatpādaṃ PU_2E, tatpāda LB 3 **āyāti** cett.] yāyāti J **śrīgurave** cett.] śrīguru namo *unm.* U_2, śrīgurubho L 4 **nānāvikalpaviśrāntiṃ** N_1U_2] nānāvikalpaviśrāṃti N_2K_1LB, nānāvikalpaṃ viśrāṃtiṃ D, nānāvaikalpaviśrāṃti J, nānāvikalpaḥ viśrāṃtiḥ P, nānāviplavaviśrāntiḥ E **kathanāt** cett.] kathanāt | B **tu yaḥ** PU_2LB] tataḥ E, tu saḥ cett. 5 **vijñeyo** cett.] vijño *unm.* LB **na tu** cett.] nnu LB **vipriyajalpakaḥ** cett.] me priyajalpaka J, vai priyajalpakaḥ E, viprāyajalākaḥ LB 7 **paramapadaprāpty** cett.] paramapadasya prāpty PE **sarvadā vandyaḥ** cett.] sevyaḥ sarvadā PU_2E, sevyasarvadā LB 7–8 **nirantaraṃ** cett.] niraṃtara° P 8 **gurusevā** cett.] gusevā° U_2 **rato** cett.] tatparo E, taro B **bhavati** cett.] bhava D **pāpaṃ** cett.] pāpa U_2B **svācāra°** γ] svasyācāra° cett. °**rato** cett.] rataḥ PE, °taḥ ‖ U_2, ratāḥ LB 9 **na bhavati** PU_2EL] nāsti $N_2N_1DK_1J$, bhavati B **vaṃśaparaṃparā** cett.] parāparaṃ parā DK_1 **sadguroḥ** cett.] guroḥ U_2 **saṃgatiḥ** cett.] saṃgati N_2P, saṃgatī LB 10 **kartavyā** γ] karttavyāḥ N_2K_1J, kattavyāḥ N_1D **tena** E] *om.* cett. **manaḥ** cett.] mano U_2 **śāntiṃ** cett.] śāṃti LB

LVIII.4 The true teacher is said to be the one who generates complete bliss. Homage to the glorious teacher, because of whose words, a slight glance of [whose] feet and from seeing [whom], my self becomes steady.

LVIII.5 One who brings about the end of [my] various discursive thoughts through his teachings should be known as the true teacher and not an unpleasant blowhard.

Hence, the true teacher is always to be praised in order to attain the supreme place. The person who is a speaker of truth is constantly engaged in serving the teacher. In whose mind there is no evil, he is devoted to good customs, [and] practices [such as] ceremonial bathing, etc. He who knows his noble lineage, he is not deceitful.[459] He shall associate with a true teacher of such a kind. The mind of the person attains peace.

[459] In the light of my hypothesis of Rāmacandra addressing an audience of *kṣatriya*s I translate *vaṃśa* here as "noble lineage".

अथ च यस्य मनोमध्ये स्थिर आनन्द उत्पद्यते। सोऽपि सद्गुरुः कथ्यते। अथ च घटिकामात्रं घटिकार्धं घटिकाचतुर्थांशो वा यस्य पार्श्वमुपविष्टे सत्यतादृषो भावो मनोमध्य उत्पद्यते। गत्वा वनमध्ये स्थीयते गृहं त्यज्यते सोऽपि सद्गुरुः कथ्यते। कस्यापि दुःखं न दीयते। प्राणिमात्रेण सह मैत्री क्रीयते कस्यापि दोषं न प्रकाश्यते सोऽपि सद्गुरुः कथ्यते।

अज्ञानाकुलशीलानां यतीनां ब्रह्मचारिणाम्।
उपदेशं न गृह्णीयादन्यथा नरकं ध्रुवम्॥ LVIII.6॥

यस्य वचसि मनसि धृते सति। स्वात्मनः परमेश्वरस्यैक्यं भवति। एतादृशो मनो–मध्ये निश्चयो भवति। तं सद्गुरुं जानीयात्। विकल्प एतादृशो यथा समुद्रमध्ये महत्तर कल्लोलाडम्बरः प्रपञ्चवासना एतादृशी यथोदकमध्ये महत्तरङ्गाः। तादृ–शात्संसारार्णवाद्यो नावा परं पारं प्रापयति। स सद्गुरुः कथ्यते।

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1 **yasya** cett.] *om.* U_2 **sthira** cett.] sthīrā° N_2, sira P, sīraḥ LB **ca** cett.] *om.* U_2E **2** **ghaṭikāmā-traṃ** em.] ghaṭimātra° N_2, ghaṭī++++mo N_1, ghaṭīṃ mātraṃ D, ghaṭī K_1, ghaṭīmātraṃ J, *om.* γ **ghaṭikārdhaṃ** cett.] °ghaṃṭikārddhaṃ N_2, ghaṭikā U_2, *om.* E **ghaṭikā°** N_2U_2L] ghaṭikāyāḥ N_1DK_1, ghaṭikāyāś J, ghaṃṭikā° PB **caturthāṃśo** JPU_2B] caturtho daṃśo N_2, caturtho ḍaṃśo N_1K_1, caturtho aṃśo D, *om.* E, caturthaṃśo L **vā yasya pārśvam upaviṣṭe** cett.] *om.* E **satyatādṛṣo** cett.] satyetādṛśo N_1DK_1JL, *om.* E **bhāvo** cett.] ++++ N_2, bhavo K_1, *om.* E **3** **manomadhya** PLB] manomadhye cett., *om.* E **utpadyate** cett.] *om.* E, upapadyate LB **gatvā vanamadhye sthīyate gṛhaṃ tyajyate** cett.] *om.* E **so 'pi sadguruḥ kathyate** cett.] *om.* $N_2N_1DK_1$JE **4** **prāṇimātreṇa** cett.] prāṇimātre U_2 **krīyate** cett.] yate N_2 **doṣaṃ** N_2E] doṣo N_1DK_1JPU_2L, doṣau B **prakāśyate** N_2P] prākāśyate N_1DK_1J, kathayati E, prākāśate LB **5** **so** γ] yena so β **6** **ajñānā°** em.] ajñāta° N_2K_1JPU_2E, ajñāna° N_1DLB **7** **upadeśaṃ** cett.] upadeśo PU_2 **gṛṇhīyād** PEL] gṛhītyāsthā | B, gṛhnīyāt cett. **anyathā** cett.] yadānyathā *unm.* B **narakaṃ** cett.] narake J, na narakaṃ *unm.* B **9** **vacasi** cett.] cavi U_2 **manasi** cett.] *om.* U_2 **parameśvarasyaikyaṃ** cett.] parameśvarasyaikaṃ N_2, parameśvarasakyaṃ LB **10** **jānīyāt** cett.] vijānīyāt E **vikalpa** cett.] *om.* J **etādṛśo** cett.] etādṛśaṃ N_2 **11** **mahattara°** cett.] mihattara D, *om.* J, mahattaraṃ E **°ḍambaraḥ** cett.] °ḍambaraṃ PU_2E, °ḍambara° LB **prapañca°** cett.] prapaca U_2 **etādṛśī** cett.] tādṛśī E **mahattaraṅgāḥ** E] mahattarī U_2, mahattarati cett. **11–12** **tādṛśāt** cett.] tādṛśasya E **12** **saṃsārārṇavād** PU_2L] saṃsārāt arṇavād $N_2N_1DK_1$, saṃsāraṛṇavād J, saṃsārārṇavavād B **yo** cett.] yaḥ E, yau LB **nāvā** DK_1JPU_2LB] nāvaraṃ N_2N_1, svavākyanāvā E **paraṃ pāraṃ** JE] *om.* N_2N_1, paraṃ DK_1PLB, pāraṃ pāraṃ U_2 **sa** cett.] *om.* DK_1J

Furthermore, he, in whose mind steady bliss arises, only he is called a true teacher. Thus, a state characterised by seeing the truth arises in the mind of whom is seated at the side [of a true teacher] for merely a *ghaṭikā*[460], half a *ghaṭikā*[461], or a quarter [of a *ghaṭikā*]. Having gone forth, he who dwells in the forest [and] abandons his home is called the true teacher. He is called a true teacher who does not induce suffering to others, [who] bestows friendliness towards living beings, [who] will not expose anyone's badness.

LVIII.6 One should not accept the teaching of celibate ascetics, whose nature is confused by ignorance; otherwise, hell is inevitable.[462]

For one who is steadfast in mind and speech, unity arises between the supreme lord and the own self. Conviction of such a kind arises within the mind. One should know a true teacher. Such discursive thinking is like the roar of mighty waves within the ocean [and] such manifold mental residues are like great waves within the water, one who causes [the disciple] to reach the farther shore of such an ocean of Saṃsāra with a boat is called the true teacher.

[460] One *ghaṭikā* equals 1/60 of a day (cf. Sircar, 1966: 114). A day has 1440 minutes (24 hours x 60 minutes), so 1/60 of a day corresponds to 24 minutes.

[461] 12 minutes.

[462] I could not locate a source for this verse. The verse is possibly authorial.

यस्य पुरुषस्य मनोऽखण्डे परमपदे लीनं भवति। यः पुरुषः स्वीयं कूलं त्रिविधा–त्तापान्निवर्त्य परममुक्तिपदे रक्षति। एतादृशं पुरुषं श्रवणाद्दर्शनात्समग्रविघ्ना नश्य–न्ति। दिने दिने कल्याणं भवति। निष्कलङ्का बुद्धिरुत्पद्यते॥

[LIX. **yogaśāstrarahasyam**]

इदं योगशास्त्ररहस्यं समग्रशास्त्रमध्ये। यस्य मनो यथान्धकारस्य मध्ये दीपस्य तेजः प्रविशति। तथा शास्त्रमध्ये तस्य मनः प्रविशति। यस्य राज्ञो मनोमध्ये कपटं नास्ति। यस्मिन्दृष्टे देशकस्य त्रासो न भवति। तस्य मनः शुद्धं भवति।

Sources: 5–7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 847): idaṃ yogarahasyañ ca na vācyaṃ mūrkhasannidhau ‖ yogadeśas tu tatraiva ‖ utpātarahite deśe kaṇṭakādivivarjite | abhyasyate sadā yogaḥ samaḥ syāt sukhaduḥkhayoḥ | surājani samāśritya karttavyo nirupadrave | deśe tu sarvaśasyāḍhye lobhamohavivarjite |

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1 **mano** cett.] manaḥ LB **'khaṇḍe** cett.] akhaṃḍe LB **paramapade** E] paramada° N_2, parapada° N_1DK_1, parapade JU_2, pade PLB **līnaṃ** cett.] °lita N_2, °līna N_1 **bhavati** cett.] bhavatī B **puruṣaḥ** cett.] puruṣa N_2U_2 **svīyaṃ kūlaṃ** $N_2N_1DK_1$] svīyaṃ kulaṃ JPU_2, svakulaṃ E, sviyaṃ kulaṃ L, svikulaṃ B 1–2 **trividhāt** cett.] trividha° U_2L, trividhaṃ | B 2 **tāpān** cett.] tapān P **nivṛtya** cett.] nivṛtya J **paramamuktipade** N_1DK_1JP] paramamamuktipade N_2, paramamuktipakṣe U_2, parame muktipade E, paramuktipade LB **etādṛśaṃ** cett.] etādṛśa | N_1, etādṛśa DK_1U_2, etādṛśā PLB, etādṛśasya E **puruṣaṃ** β] puruṣasya γ **śravaṇād** cett.] śravaṇāt JLB, śravaṇā P, śravaṇāt ‖ U_2 **darśanāt** cett.] darśanāt | B **°vighnā** cett.] °vighnāṃ J, °viśvaś ca vaśāṃ U_1, vighna U_2 2–3 **naśyanti** cett.] bhavati U_1, na naśyaṃti L, na naśyaṃtī B 3 **dine dine** cett.] dine U_1 **kalyāṇaṃ** cett.] kalyāṇāṃ K_1U_1 **bhavati** cett.] bhavatīr U_1 **niṣkalaṅkā** cett.] niṣkalaṃ N_2N_1, niṣkalaṃko U_2 5 **yogaśāstrarahasyaṃ** N_1JU_2LB] yogaśāstrarahasya N_2D, yogaśāstreṣu rahasyaṃ K_1U_1, yogaśāstrasya rahasyaṃ PE **samagraśāstramadhye** cett.] samastaśāstraprame E, samastaśāstramadhye LB **yasya** cett.] *om.* N_2U_2 **mano** em.] *om.* N_2, mana cett., manaḥ JU_1PU_2E **yathāndhakārasya** cett.] *om.* N_2, yathāṃdhakāras N_1, yathāṃdhakāra° D **madhye** cett.] *om.* N_2 **dīpasya** cett.] *om.* N_2, dīpa° E 6 **tejaḥ** cett.] *om.* N_2 **praviśati** N_1DK_1JPE] *om.* N_2, praviśyati U_1LB, vipraśati U_2 **tathā** cett.] *om.* N_2, yathā U_2 **śāstramadhye** cett.] *om.* N_2U_1LB **tasya manaḥ** $N_2N_1DK_1$] manaḥ JP, *om.* U_1LB, mano U_2E **praviśati** cett.] *om.* U_1LB **yasya** cett.] *om.* U_1 **manomadhye** cett.] madhye E, madhye manasi LB **kapaṭaṃ** cett.] kalaho E 7 **deśakasya** $N_2N_1DK_1$] daśakasya J, darśakasya U_1, deśikasya PU_2LB, deśika° E **tasya** cett.] yasya JU_1

Notes: 2 **etādṛśaṃ**: Textual evidence of U_1 resumes from this word onwards.

That person's mind that has dissolved into the undivided supreme state and who has turned his lineage away from the threefold miseries[463] and protects [them] in the state of supreme liberation, all obstacles disappear because of listening to and seeing that person. Day by day, prosperity arises. A flawless intellect arises.

[LIX. **Esoteric yoga doctrine in all of the scriptures**]

This is the esoteric yoga doctrine in all of the scripturess. [The king] whose mind enters into the teaching just as the light of a lamp enters into the midst of darkness; the king in whose mind there is no deceit and, when he is seen [by his subjects] there is no fear of a ruler, [he is one who] has a purified mind.

[463] The threefold misery consists of: 1. *adhyātmika* ("internal"), which refers to any physical and mental misery caused by diseases; 2. *adhibhautika* ("external"), which refers to any misery caused by external living beings or objects; and 3. *adhidaivika*, which refers to any misery caused by the gods or comes from heaven, such as cold, heat, storm, drought, etc. For a more detailed account, see *Sāṅkhyakārikā* (2004), especially the respective explanations provided in the *bhāṣya* of Gaudapāda for the first *kārikā*.

यस्य पृथिव्यां कीर्तिर्भवति। यस्य मनोमध्ये सत्पुरुषवचनविश्वासो भवति। यो राजा सदानन्दपूर्णो भवति। यस्य पार्श्वे प्रत्यक्षमनेकं मनोहारिवस्तूनि भवन्ति। एतादृशस्य राज्ञोऽग्रे योगरहस्यं कथनीयम्।

न स्नेहान् न भयाल्लोभान् न मोहान् न धनाद्बलात्।
न मैत्रीभावान् न दानान् न सौन्दर्यान् न सेवनात्॥ LIX.1॥

सामान्यादग्रे योगो न कथनीयः। यः परनिन्दारतो भवति। दुराचारो भवति। भ्रातुर्मित्रस्य च योग्यं वस्तु न ददाति। योऽसत्यं वदति। यो योगिनां मनोमध्ये निन्दां करोति। यस्य मनोमध्ये दया न भवति। यः कलहप्रियो भवति।

Sources: 8–9 cf. YSv (PT, p. 847): stutir nindā na karttavyā sādhunāsatyavādinā ‖ yogānadhikāriṇam āha tatraiva ‖ manomadhye dayā nāsti sadā yaḥ kalahapriyaḥ |

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1 **yasya** cett.] *om.* U_1 **pṛthivyāṃ** PL] pṛthivī N_2N_1D, pṛithīvī K_1U_1, pṛthvī J, pṛthvyāṃ U_2EB **kīrtir** cett.] kīrti K_1U_1, kītīr U_2, vītir E **satpuruṣavacanaviśvāso** cett.] satpuruṣavacanaḥ viśvāso N_2, satpuruṣasya vacanaviśvāso J, vacanaviśvabhyāso U_1, satpuruṣasya vaco viśvāso E 2 **sadānandapūrṇo** cett.] sadānaṃdarūpo E, sānaṃdapūrṇo L **anekaṃ** cett.] anokaṃ K_1, aneka° ELB **manohārivastūni** E] manohārivastu cett. **bhavanti** em.] tiṣṭhaṃti E, bhavati cett. 3 **rājño** cett.] rājña E **'gre** *β*] ye PU_2B, idaṃ E, yad L **yogarahasyaṃ** cett.] thogarahasyaṃ B **kathanīyam** PE] karttavyaṃ $N_2N_1K_1JU_1$, karttavya D, kathyate U_2, kathyanīyaṃ L, kathyaniyaṃ B 4 **na** cett.] ni LB **snehān** PU_2E] śnehān cett. **na** $K_1JU_1PU_2$E] a° N_2N_1D, nā° LB **bhayāl** cett.] bhayān U_1E **lobhān** cett.] ++bhān N_2N_1, +++++ P, lo++ *unm.* U_2 **na** cett.] *om.* P **mohān** cett.] *om.* P **dhanād** cett.] *om.* P, na dhanād L **balāt** cett.] *om.* P, balān E, balāta L 5 **na** cett.] na maitrī na *unm.* J, *om.* P **maitrībhāvān** cett.] maitrībhāva N_2, maitrī++++ D, +++++bhāvān P **na** $N_1K_1JU_1$] nā N_2, no PU_2LB, nau E **dānān** N_2PU_2] dāsān N_1JU_1, dānat K_1, dāryān E, dānāt LB **na** cett.] *om.* D **saundaryān** cett.] saudaryān N_2P, sauṃdayan L **na** cett.] ni L **sevanāt** cett.] sevatā U_1 7 **sāmānyād agre** cett.] sāmānyāgre U_1ELB **kathanīyaḥ** cett.] kanīyaḥ N_2, kathanīyaṃ L, kathaniyaṃ B **yaḥ** cett.] *om.* U_1 **paranindā** cett.] parato J, paraniṃdāṃ U_1LB **rato** cett.] *om.* JLB **bhavati** cett.] karoti LB **durācāro bhavati** PE] dūrācāro bhavati $N_2N_1K_1JU_1U_2$, *om.* LB 8 **bhrātur** K_1PU_2] bhrātu° N_2N_1J, bhrātṛr U_1, dur° EB, *om.* L **mitrasya** cett.] mitraṃ U_1, maitryānyasya EB, *om.* L **ca yogyaṃ** N_2JU_1] ca yogyaṃ ca N_1, ca yogya K_1, yogyaṃ PU_2, *om.* ELB **vastu na dadāti** cett.] *om.* L **yo** PU_2] so $N_2N_1K_1JU_1$, ya E, *om.* LB **'satyaṃ** cett.] saṃtyaṃ K_1, asatyaṃ E, *om.* LB **vadati** cett.] *om.* LB **yo** PE] *om.* cett. **yogināṃ** cett.] yoginā $N_2N_1K_1$, yoga° E, *om.* LB **manomadhye** cett.] *om.* ELB 9 **nindāṃ** cett.] niṃdā J, ni° U_1, *om.* LB **karoti** cett.] *om.* LB **yaḥ** cett.] *om.* N_2, yaṃ J, yasya PU_2LB **kalahapriyo** cett.] *om.* N_2, kalahaḥ priyo U_2, kalahaṃ priyo LB **bhavati** cett.] *om.* N_2, na bhavati LB

Notes: 5 **maitrī**: A *lacuna* in D starts here. The omissions are not recorded. The reader will be informed when D resumes.

[The king] who has fame on earth; in whose mind there is trust in the speech of good people; who is a king always filled with bliss; at whose side there is an abundance of enchanting objects visible [to all], in the presence of such a king the secret of yoga shall be explained.[464]

LIX.1 Not because of affection, fear, greed, delusion, wealth, strength, friendship, donations, beauty, not because of service [shall the secret of yoga be explained.][465]

Yoga shall not be taught in the presence of common [people]. He, who is devoted to criticising others, who is misbehaving, who does not give a useful thing, which benefits friend and brother, who speaks falsely, who blames yogis in his mind, in whose mind compassion does not arise, who delights in quarrel, ...

[464] The decision for the γ-group reading *kathanīyam*, and against the reading of the β-group, which reads *kartavyam*, is based on the following observations: Rāmacandra aims to emphasize the contrast between a suitable and an unsuitable king for his *yogaśāstrarahasya*. In the sentence following verse LIX.1, Rāmacandra states: *sāmānyād agre yogo na kathanīyaḥ* | Here, not only the γ-group but also the β-group of manuscripts read the gerundive of √*kath*. The core of Rāmacandra's explanation in this section of the *yogaśāstrarahasya* is the ideal practice for the monarch. The Sahajayoga Rāmacandra teaches in this chapter enables the king, despite being an "enjoyer of the earth," to achieve soteriological completion without the deprivations typical for ascetics. The king can fulfil his duties without even needing practice. Thus, the concluding statement in the last sentence is: *iti cakravartināmakathanam* | "This is the explanation for those named *cakravartin*." In all manuscripts, we again find a word formed from √*kath*. Although the reading of the β-group works, the reading of the γ-group appears to be the original, especially since *kartavyam* could be a scribal error that crept into the transmission early on. This is because *kartavyam* is a word Rāmacandra uses very frequently, and like *kathanīyam*, it begins with *ka* and ends with *yam*. Thus, a scribe who is tired or whose concentration has waned towards the end of copying the text could easily make this mistake.

[465] So far, I have not been able to identify the source of this verse. Perhaps this verse stems from Rāmacandra's own hand.

स्वकार्यकरणेऽसावधानो भवति। गुरोः कार्यकरण आदरो न भवति। एतादृशस्या–
ग्रे न योगः क्रियते न पठ्यते।

शृण्वन् गीतादिकान् शब्दान् पश्यन् रूपं मनोहरम्।
o जिघ्रन् गन्धांश्च सुरभीन् स्पृशन् स्पर्शं मृडुप्रियम्।
5 स्वादान् मनोरमान् खादन् भ्राम्यन् देशान् मनोरमान्॥ LIX.2॥

भाषमाणः सुमधुरं रममाणः स्वलीलया।
भावाभावविनिर्मुक्तः सर्वग्राहविवर्जितः॥ LIX.3॥

सदानन्दमयो योगी सदाभ्यासी सदा भवेत्।
विरुद्धे दुःखदेशे च विरूपेऽतिभयानके॥ LIX.4॥

Sources: 1–2 cf. YSv (PT, p. 847): svakāryalobhane śīlo gurukāryaparāṅmukhaḥ | etasmai ca na dātavyaṃ vaktavyaṃ tasya sannidhau | 6–7 cf. YSv (PT, p. 847): nañ ubhayatra sambadhyate na vaktavyam ity arthaḥ | yogādhikāriṇo 'pi tatraiva ‖ bhāvābhāvavinirmuktaḥ sarvagrahavivarjitaḥ | 7 ≈*Amanaska* 1.12ab: bhāvābhāvavinirmuktaṃ vināśotpattivarjitam | 8–9 cf. YSv (PT, p. 847): sadānandamayo yogī sadābhyāsī sadā bhavet | viruddhe duḥkhadeśe ca virūpe 'tibhayānake |

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1 **svakāryakaraṇe** U_1PU_2E] svakāryyākaraṇā N_2, svakāryākaraṇe N_1L, svakāryakaraṇo K_1, sakāryākaraṇe J, svakāryākaraṇeṃ B **'sāvadhāno** $N_2N_1K_1U_1PU_2ELB$] sādhāno J **guroḥ** cett.] guro N_2U_2B **kāryakaraṇa** em.] kāryakaraṇe cett., kārye karaṇe B **ādaro na** $N_2N_1K_1JU_1$] nādṛto PU_2, na dattacitto E, anādare no L, anādarano B 1–2 **etādṛśasyāgre** cett.] etādṛśasya agre U_1 2 **yogaḥ** cett.] *om.* $N_2N_1U_1$ **paṭhyate** $K_1U_1PU_2E$] padyaṃte N_2N_1, paṭyate J, paṭhayate LB 3 **śṛṇvan** cett.] śuśvana *unm.* N_2 **gītādikān** cett.] prītādikān E **śabdān** cett.] śabdāt | N_2 **paśyan** cett.] paśyat U_1 4 **jighran** cett.] jighraṃ $N_2K_1JU_1$, jāgrat E **gandhāṃś ca** JP] gaṃdhāṃ N_2N_1, gaṃdhāṃ śu K_1, nāṃdhaś ca U_1, spṛśan gaṃdhan *unm.* U_2, *om.* E, agachan *unm.* LB **surabhīn** $K_1JU_1U_2$] śusurabhīn N_2N_1, surabhin PL, sphuran E, sphurabhi B **spṛśan** PU_2E] spṛśyan $N_2N_1K_1$, spṛśyān J, *om.* U_1, spṛśaṃ LB **sparśaṃ** $K_1JU_1PU_2$] asyaṃ N_2, asya N_1, sparśa° E, *om.* cett. **mṛdupriyam** cett.] śarmṛdupriyaṃ N_2, mṛdupriyāṃ ‖ K_1, mṛdu ‖ priyaṃ U_2 5 **manoramān** cett.] manomān N_2N_1, manoman K_1, manorathān LB **khādan** P] *om.* N_2U_2E, svādan N_1J, svādān K_1, khādaṃta° U_1, khādavan LB **bhrāmyan** cett.] bhrāmya na N_2, bhrāmyena N_1, bhrāman LB **deśān** cett.] veṣān J, tveṣāṃn U_1 6 **bhāṣamāṇaḥ** PU_2E] bhāṣamāṇasya $N_2N_1K_1U_1$, bhāṣamāṇa J, bhakṣamāṇaḥ L, bhakṣamāṇa B **sumadhuraṃ** PU_2] madhuraṃ $N_2N_1K_1U_1$, samadhuraṃ J, *om.* E, samadhura° L, samaghura° B **ramamāṇaḥ** cett.] rasamānaḥ N_2N_1, °ramamāṇaṃ L, °ramāṇa *unm.* B 7 **bhāvābhāvavinirmuktaḥ** cett.] bhāvābhāvavinirmukto E, bhāvāvinir muktaḥ LB 8 **sadānandamayo** cett.] *om.* U_2, sadāmayo *unm.* LB **yogī** cett.] *om.* U_2, yo yogī *unm.* L **sadābhyāsī** cett.] sadābhyāso K_1U_1, *om.* U_2 **sadā bhavet** cett.] *om.* U_2 9 **viruddhe** cett.] viruddha° PE, *om.* U_2 **duḥkhadeśe ca** em.] duḥkhade deśe $N_2N_1K_1JU_1PE$, *om.* U_2, duḥkhadeśe L, duḥkhe deśe B **virūpe** N_2K_1PE] śovirūpe N_1JLB, vivarūpe U_1, *om.* U_2 **'tibhayānake** $N_2N_1K_1PE$] te bhayānake J, bhayānake U_1LB, *om.* U_2

…who is inattentive towards his own obligations, [and] who has no regard for fulfilling his obligations to his teacher. In the presence of someone like this, yoga is neither done nor taught.[466]

LIX.2 While hearing the sounds of music, and the like, while seeing [things with] charming forms, while smelling pleasant scents, while touching [things with a] soft and pleasant touch, while eating [dishes with] delicious tastes, while roaming around beautiful places, …

LIX.3 …while speaking very gently and delighting in his own play,[467] he is free from existence and non-existence and clinging to the world.

LIX.4 He is always a yogin, always engaged in practice, and full of permanent bliss, even in a land of suffering, unpleasant, odious and extremely terrible.

[466] Rāmacandra contrasts a good king with a bad king. In both formulations, the usage of *agre* suggests that this yoga was meant to be disseminated in a king's court.

[467] I was unable to identify any known source for verse LIX.2 and the first half of LIX.3; these may therefore be original compositions by the author. The stylistic features of the verses lend some support to this assumption.

इष्टाद्यनिष्टं संस्पर्शे रसे च लवणादिके।
पूत्यादावपि गन्धे च कण्टकोष्मादिवर्जिते॥ LIX.5॥

सर्वदैव सदाभ्यासः समः स्यात्सुखदुःखयोः।
एवंभूतस्य कर्माणि सङ्कल्परहितानि च॥ LIX.6॥

गच्छन्नृणां च संस्पर्शात्पापं कुर्वन्न लिप्यते।
उत्पन्नतत्त्वबोधस्य ह्युदासीनस्य सर्वदा॥ LIX.7॥

Sources: 1–4 ≈ YSv (PT, p. 847): etad aniṣṭasaṃsparśe nyūnādhike balādhike | evaṃbhūtasya karmāṇi saṅkalparahitāni ca | 1–4 ≈ YSv (PT, p. 847): utpātarahite deśe kaṇṭakādivivarjite | abhyasyate sadā yogaḥ samaḥ syāt sukhaduḥkhayoḥ | 5–6 ≈YSv (PT, p. 847): evaṃ gacchan svapan paśyan pāpapuṇyair na lipyate | utpannatattvabodhaḥ syāt sadā śīlasya sarvadā | 5–6 ≈*Amanaska* 2.36: utpannatattvabodhasya hy udāsīnasya sarvadā | sadābhyāsaratasyaitan naikatrāpy upayujyate ‖

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1 **iṣṭādy aniṣṭaṃ saṃsparśe** N_2] iṣṭādhaniṣṭaṃ saṃsparśe P, iṣṭādyaniṣṭasaṃsparśe cett., *om.* U_2 **rase** cett.] rasaṃ N_2, *om.* U_2 **lavaṇādike** cett.] lavaṇādiko N_2, *om.* U_2 2 **pūtyādāv api** N_2N_1JL] pūjādāv api K_1U_1, pratyādāv api PEB, *om.* U_2 **gandhe** cett.] gaṃdhaṃ N_2, *om.* U_2 **ca** cett.] *om.* U_2 **kaṇṭakoṣmādivarjite** N_1K_1J] kaṇṭakeṣmādivarjjite N_2, kuṃṭakoṣmādivarjite U_1, kaṃṭakoṣyādivivarjjite P, *om.* U_2, kaṃkoṣṇādivivarjayet E, kaṃṭakoṣmādivarji L, kaṭakoṣmādivarji B 3 **sarvadaiva** cett.] sarvadeva N_1U_1LB, sarvadaivaṃ U_2 **sadābhyāsaḥ** K_1PU_2E] sadābhyāsāḥ $N_2N_1U_1$LB, sadābhyā J **samaḥ syāt** cett.] mana syāt N_2, sama syāt N_1K_1J, sama syā U_1, samaḥ sya | t L 4 **bhūtasya** N_2K_1J] bhūta° U_1, yogasya cett. 5 **gacchan** cett.] gacha U_1 **saṃsparśāt** cett.] saṃsparśot N_1B **pāpaṃ** cett.] pāpaḥ P, tapaḥ E 6 °**bodhasya** cett.] °bodha syād K_1U_1, °bodhaḥ syād J **hy udāsīnasya** E] udāsīnasya cett.

LIX.5 [As for example] in relation to contact with unfavourable [things] such as [something] desired and so forth, [or] in relation to taste, such as salt and so forth, [or] in relation to odour, such as that of rot and so forth, and [in relation to a place] without thorns, heat and so forth,[468] …

LIX.6 …the [yogin] practises yoga frequently and is equanimous to pleasure and pain. In this way, the actions of one who is thus are free of volition.

LIX.7 [Although] walking among men, and as a result of mutual contact [naturally] committing sin, [the yogin] is untainted.[469] [When the yogin's] awakening has taken place [and when he has become one] who is always indifferent, …

[468] An examination of the source text used by Rāmacandra for these verses reveals particular difficulties with verse LIX.5. Here the author seems to have confused two distinct sections of his source, the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*, by merging descriptions of the *yogadeśa* with those of the *yogādhikārin*. Given the negative aspects presented by Rāmacandra earlier (in LIX.4cd), verse LIX.5d, with its formulation *kaṇṭakoṣmādivarjite* ("a place free from thorns, heat, etc."), seems entirely out of place—but only at first glance. The textual transmission, however, is unambiguous. Furthermore, Rāmacandra states in the following verse (LIX.6) that the yogin is indifferent to pleasure and pain, which makes it conceivable that the preceding verse presents both positive and negative examples of the conditions that affect the yogin. Although Rāmacandra mentions the negative circumstance of foul odours etc. in LIX.5c, he refers shortly before to the taste of salt and the like, which is more likely to be regarded as positive. While salt water might be a possible negative interpretation here, the fact that even fruit juices in India are salted to enhance flavour suggests that the mention of salt in the context of taste should be read more positively. Consequently, LIX.5d should ultimately be accepted as a legitimate reading.

[469] The *kṣatradharma* requires the warrior and ruling caste to perform actions that could be categorised as sinful. For example, killing in a war or the use of force may be necessary to maintain order. If the *kṣatriya* has attained liberation through Rājayoga, he is immune to the karmic consequences.

तदा दृष्टिविशेषः स्याद्विविधान्यासनानि च।
अन्तःकरणजा भवा योगिनो नोपयोगिनः॥ LIX.8॥

सर्वदा सहजस्थस्य निष्कलाध्यात्मवेदिनः।
यत्यत्प्रयत्ननिष्पाद्यं तत्तत्सर्वम् न कारणं॥ LIX.9॥

5

विलासिनीनां मनोहारिगीतश्रवणात्॥ अतिसुन्दरकामिनीनां रूपदर्शनात्॥ कस्तूरीकर्पूरगन्धग्रहणात्॥ मनःशीतलकार्यतिकोमलपरवस्तुनः स्पर्शकारणात्॥ अतिमाधुर्यं चित्ते करोति।

Sources: 1–2 ≈YSv (PT, p. 847): pare dṛṣṭivilaṃ na syād vividhāni mṛtāni ca | antaḥkaraṇam etasya yogino niṣkriyaṃ [niṣkalā?] tu sa | 1–2 ≈*Amanaska* 2.37: tadā dṛṣtiviśeṣāś ca vividhāny āsanāni ca | antaḥkaraṇabhāvāś ca yogino nopayoginaḥ ‖ 3–4 ≈YSv (PT, p. 847): sarvadā sahajas tasya niṣkalādhyātmavādinaḥ | yadā prayatnaniṣpādyaṃ grāhyaṃ sarvam akāraṇam |

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1 **dṛṣṭiviśeṣaḥ** cett.] dṛṣṭir viśeṣa U_1, dṛṣṭiviśeṣa PLB **vividhāny** $N_2K_1U_2E$] vidhāny *unm.* cett. 2 **antaḥkaraṇajā** cett.] aṃtaṣkaraṇajo K_1, aṃtaṣkaraṇayā J, aṃtaḥkaraṇayo U_1 **bhavā** N_2N_1] bhāvā $K_1JU_1PU_2ELB$ **nopayoginaḥ** cett.] nopi yoginaḥ U_2L 3 **sarvadā** cett.] sarva° E, sarvadya LB **sahajasthasya** cett.] mahajarasya U_1, rājapadasthasya E, sahajasya B **°vedinaḥ** JPU_2E] °vedina N_2N_1, °cedina K_1, °vedanā U_1, °vedinā LB 4 **prayatnaniṣpādyaṃ** $N_2N_1U_2$] aprayatna niḥpādyaṃ K_1, prayatnaniḥpādya JLB, aprayatra niṣyayiṃ U_1, prayatnaniḥpārdhaṃ P, prayatnaniḥpāyaṃ E **tat tat sarvam** $N_2N_1K_1PE$] tattaḥ svadharma° J, tat sarvam U_1U_2B, tat sarvem L **na kāraṇaṃ** N_2] akāraṇaṃ N_1, akāraṇāṃ K_1U_1, °kāraṇaṃ J, akāraṇam PE, kāraṇa *unm.* U_2, ikāraṇāt L, akāraṇāt B 6 **vilāsinīnāṃ** cett.] vilāsa ‖ nīnāṃ K_1, vilāsinīnīnāṃ J **manohārigītaśravaṇāt** $N_2N_1K_1U_1$] manoharijītaśravaṇāt J, manohārigānaśravaṇāt γ **atisundarakāminīnāṃ** cett.] atisuṃdaraṃ kāmināṃ P, atisauṃdaryakāminīnāṃ E, atisauṃdarakāmininīnāṃ L, atisauṃdarakāmininīnāṃ B **rūpadarśanāt** cett.] rūpaṃ darśanāt J 6–7 **kastūrī°** cett.] kasturī° N_2J, kastūri° K_1U_1 7 **karpūragandha°** N_2] karpūragaṃdhayār gaṃdha° N_1, karpūra gaṃdhayārgadhya° K_1, karpūrayor gaṃdha° JPEB, karpuro gaṃdha° U_1, karpūrayo gaṃdha° U_2, karpūragandhayor L **śītalakāry** em.] śītalakārī N_2N_1, sītalakārī K_1, sīlakārī JU_1, śaityakāri cett. **atikomalaparavastunaḥ** $N_2N_1K_1JU_1$] komalavastunaḥ γ **sparśakāraṇāt** PU_2E] sparśakaraṇāt $N_2N_1K_1JU_1$, saṃsparśakaṃ L, saṃsparśakāṃ B 8 **atimādhuryaṃ** cett.] atidhūryaṃ N_2 **citte** cett.] cittaṃ N_2, cikrī U_2

LIX.8 then the specific gazing point, the various postures[470] and the states produced from the internal organ[471] are useless to the yogin.

LIX.9 For the knower of the undivided supreme self, who is always in the natural state, whatever is brought about with effort, all of that is entirely groundless.

Because of listening to the lovely songs of charming women, looking at the beauty of very lovely women, smelling the fragrance of camphor and musk, touching objects that make the mind relax and that are extremely soft and superb, [because of all these things] he experiences exquisite beauty in the mind.

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[470] Postures (*āsana*s) are not discussed in Rāmacandra's text. Together with this passage, however, they are mentioned thrice (cf. p. 208 l. 6 and p. 280 l. 2) and given these three statements, one might assume that the audience of this text practised them, but other works were consulted.

[471] Birch (2013: 368, n. 52) wrote a long endnote on the compound *antaḥkaraṇabhāvā* that occurs in *Amanaska* 2.37c which is a possible source of this verse in Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu*. I briefly summarize the endnote and complement my findings: Even though the Nepalese commentator of the *Amanaska* interprets it as the "intention of the heart" (*antaḥkaraṇakā manasuvā pani*) Birch, who has not found the compound in other texts back in 2013 proposes the more plausible explanation that *antaḥkaraṇabhāva* refers to the eight mental states characterizing the higher faculty of discernment (*buddhibhāva*). These eight states, as outlined in *Sāṅkhyakārikā* 23, include religious merit (*dharma*), gnosis (*jñāna*), dispassion (*virāga*), and power (*aiśvarya*) as positive aspects, while their opposites (*adharma, ajñāna, avirāga*, and *anaiśvarya*) form the negative states (*adhyavasāyo buddhir dharmo jñānaṃ virāga aiśvaryam | sāttvikam etad rūpaṃ tāmasam asmād viparyastam*). According to Birch's research, this division of *buddhi* is adopted by Śaiva traditions, such as *Mālinīvijayottaratantra* 1.30cd. The eightfold *buddhi* in the *Mālinīvijayottaratantra* has been noted in Vasudeva, 2004: 353, n. 8. The concept of the *buddhibhāva*s is also present in other contexts, like the hierarchical system of religions in the *Svacchandatantra* (11.179–182). In this scheme, deluded individuals are influenced by dark *buddhibhāva*s. The specific formulation of Rāmacandra with the phrase *antaḥkaraṇajā bhāvā* however, I was able to locate within *Bodhasāra* 17.5: *mano buddhir ahaṅkāraś cittaṃ ceti catuṣṭayam | antaḥkaraṇajā bhāvā ātmā śuddho nirañjanaḥ* ‖ 17.15 ‖ "The quadruplet — mind, intellect, ego, and consciousness — are states produced by the inner organ. The self, however, is pure and untainted." This fourfold scheme is very close to the fivefold version taught by Rāmacandra …

तादृशः स्वादनात्॥ ॥ अनेकदेशानां साध्वसाधुस्थानदर्शनात्॥ मैत्रेण सह कोमल–
वचनात्॥ शत्रुणा सह काठिन्यवचनात्॥ यस्य मनसि हर्षो वा द्वेषो न भवति। स पु
रुष ईश्वरोपदेशको ज्ञेयः। स्वलीलया वदति चलति च। भावाभावयोश्चित्तमुदा–
सीनं भवति। कस्यांचिद्वार्त्तायां हठं न करोति। यस्य मनः सहजानन्दे मग्नं भवति।
तेन पुरुषेण दृष्टिः स्थिरा कर्त्तव्या। आसनं दृढं कर्त्तव्यम्। पवनः स्थिरः कर्त्तव्यः।
एतादृशः कश्चिन्नियमः सिद्धस्य नोक्तः। मनःपवनाभ्यां यदा सहजानन्दः स्वस्व–
रूपेण प्रकाश्यते। स सहजयोगः कथ्यते राजयोगमध्ये।
इति चक्रवर्तिनामकथनम्॥
इति श्रीपरमरहस्यम्।

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1 **tādṛśaḥ** PELB] tādṛśā cett. **svādanāt** cett.] svadanāt J **anekadeśānāṃ** cett.] anekadaśāmāṃ J **sādhvasādhusthānadarśanāt** cett.] sādhvasādhūsthānadarśanāt K_1, sādhūsthānadarśanāt U_1 **maitreṇa** cett.] mitreṇa E **komala°** cett.] kommala J 2 **°vacanāt** cett.] vacat K_1 **śatruṇā** JPEL] śatruṇāṃ $N_2N_1U_2$, śatrūṇāṃ K_1, śatṛṇā U_1 **kāṭhinya°** $K_1U_1U_2$L] kavinya° N_2, kaṭhinya° N_1B, kāṭhiṇya° J, kaṃvinya° P, kaṭhina° E **vacanāt** cett.] vacanād N_2, vacanān N_1 **manasi** cett.] manasī $K_1U_1U_2$, mana L **na** cett.] vā na K_1JU_1, *om.* L 2–3 **sa puruṣa** cett.] pururṣo U_2 3 **īśvaropadeśako** cett.] īśvaropadeśiko E, īśvaropade ko L **svalīlayā** cett.] svalīyayā $N_2N_1K_1$ **calati ca** N_2N_1DK$_1$JU_1L] calati va P, calatī ca U_2, calati E 3–4 **udāsīnaṃ** cett.] udāsīna L 4 **haṭhaṃ** cett.] haṭaṃ U_1L, harṣaviṣādaṃ E **manaḥ** cett.] mana° N_2 **sahajānande** cett.] sahajānaṃda° JU_1, sahajānaṃ daṃde U_2, sahajānaṃdam L **magnaṃ** cett.] °saṃjñaṃ JU_1, añjaṃ L 5 **puruṣeṇa** cett.] svapuruṣeṇa D, bhya puruṣeṇa P **dṛṣṭiḥ** cett.] dṛṣṭi° U_1 **karttavyā** JPU_2EL] karttavyaṃ N_2N_1DK$_1$, karttavyaḥ U_1 **āsanaṃ** cett.] āsana° U_1 **pavanaḥ sthiraḥ** cett.] pavanasthiraḥ K_1, *om.* L **karttavyaḥ** cett.] karttavyaṃ N_2, *om.* L 6 **kaścin niyamaḥ** cett.] kaści nīyamaḥ K_1U_1, kaściniyamaḥ J, kaścin nīyamaḥ U_2 **manaḥpavanābhyāṃ** cett.] manapavanābhyāṃ L **sahajānandaḥ** cett.] sahajānaṃda° EL 6–7 **svasvarūpeṇa** cett.] svarūpeṇa J 7 **prakāśyate** cett.] prakāśate U_1 **sahajayogaḥ** cett.] sahajo yogya N_2, sahajayoga N_1D, sahajo yoga K_1J, sahayogaḥ U_1 **rājayogamadhye** cett.] te madhye PE, rājayogasya madhye U_2 8 **cakravarti°** N_1PU_2EL] cakravarttī N_2DK$_1$J, cakravaktya U_1 **°nāma°** β] *om.* γ **°kathanaṃ** cett.] kathanaṃ ‖ cha ‖ J, °madhye iti cakravartye nāma madhye kathanaṃ U_1, kathyate U_2L 9 **śrī°** cett.] *om.* DK$_1U_1$LV **°paramarahasyam** em.] °paramarahasye N_2, °paramarahasyāṃ N_1DK$_1$JU_1, °paramahaṃsasaṃhitāyāṃ haṃsyāṃ V

Notes: 2 **vacanāt**: The evidence of manuscript B stops here. The last folio of the manuscript is missing. **dveṣo na bhavati**: Here the *lacuna* in witness D concludes, and the transmission of its text continues.

Despite enjoying such things, seeing good and bad places of many countries, speaking sweetly with friends, and speaking harshly to enemies, joyful excitement and hatred do not arise in his mind. This person is known as a teacher who conveys the instruction of the Lord (*īśvara*). For his own amusement, he speaks and moves. The mind is equanimous in both existence and non-existence. He, whose mind is immersed in inherent bliss, does not commit violence in any business.

By that person, the gaze shall be stabilised; the posture shall be stabilised; [and] the breath shall be stabilised. No such discipline is prescribed for the accomplished [person].[472] When by means of mind and breath, the natural bliss appears through its own true nature, it is called Sahajayoga ("natural yoga") in [this system of] Rajayoga.

This is the explanation for those named *cakravartin* ("Universal Ruler").

This is the venerable supreme secret.[473]

in his metaphysics section on p. 268 in which *consciousness* (*caitanya*) is added as a fifth item. The verses of chapter 17 provide information about further resulting states and their differentiations. The states born of the inner organ originally derive from the qualities (*guṇa*s) of original matter (*prakṛti*) (17.4). The four states of the inner organs produce more differentiated states (*bhāvāḥ*)—*manas*, viz., "will and indecision" (*saṃkalpa* and *vikalpa*) (17.6); *buddhi*, viz., "ascertainment" (*niścaya*) (17.7); *ahaṃkāra*, viz., "knowing, doing, experiencing, the sense of agency, and the concepts of being the doer or the enjoyer, as well as notions of injury and harm" (*jñatvakartṛtvabhoktṛtvavadhyaghātakatādayaḥ*) (17.8) of the *citta*, viz., "memory of past experiences and recognition" (*smṛtiḥ pūrvānubhūtasya pratyabhijñā*) (17.9). For the whole account of further divisions of the *bhāva*s see *Bodhasāra* 17.1–51.

[472] With this statement, Rāmacandra repeats the message of verse LIX.7. Once the highest state of yoga is reached, yoga practice becomes unnecessary.

[473] Rāmacandra's treatise concludes with these emphatic statements, clearly asserting that Sahajayoga is a form of yoga intended for kings or aspiring monarchs. For a king who rules and enjoys the amenities of his position, Sahajayoga is the appropriate yoga practice. As a *kṣatriya*, he can maintain the soteriological state of salvation through Sahajayoga while continuing to fulfill his caste duties without continuous practice. Beyond this passage, the term *cakravartin* is absent in the Haṭha- and Rājayoga literature known to me. However, there are notable occurrences of the term in yogic literature, such as Hemacandra's *Hemacandra's Yogaśāstra* 4.19–21: *dhanahīnaḥ śatam ekaṃ sahasraṃ śatavān api | sahasrādhipatir lakṣaṃ koṭiṃ …*

इति श्रीरामचन्द्रविरचितोऽयं तत्त्वयोगबिन्दुः समाप्तः ॥

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1 **iti śrīrāmacandraviracito 'yaṃ** Birch em.] śrīrāmacandraviracitāyāṃ β, rāmacaṃdraparamahaṃsaviracitas PU_2, śrīsarvaguṇasampannapaṃḍitasukhānandamiśrasūrisūnupaṇḍitajvālāprasādamiśrakṛtabhāṣāṭīkāsahito E, rājamacaṃdraparahaṃsaviracites L **tattvayogabinduḥ** J] tatvayogabindu N_2N_1D, tatvayodabiṃda K_1, tatvayogaviduḥ U_1, tatvabiṃduyoga PU_2L, rājayoge binduyogaḥ E, tattvayogavicāraḥ V **samāptaḥ** cett.] samāptam N_2L, saṃpūrṇaṃ K_1, vicāraḥ V

Notes: 1 **iti śrīparamarahasyam | śrīrāmacandraviracito 'yaṃ tatvayogabinduḥ samāptaḥ**: For the final rubrics and colophons of all consulted manuscripts, see p.26.

Thus, the *Tattvayogabindu* ("The Essence of Yoga and Reality")[474] composed by Śrī Rāmacandra, is concluded.

lakṣeśvaro 'pi ca ‖4.19‖ *koṭīśvaro narendratvaṃ narendraś cakravartitām | cakravartī ca devatvaṃ devo 'pīndratvam icchati* ‖4.20‖ *indratve 'pi hi saṃprāpte yadīcchā na nivartate | mūle laghīyāṃs tallobhaḥ śarāva iva vardhate* ‖4.21‖ Qvarnström (Ed. p. 80) translates "One who is poor [desires] a hundred [rupees]; one who has a hundred [desires] a thousand; one who has a thousand [desires] one hundred thousand, and one who has one hundred thousand [desires] ten million [rupees]. One who rules ten million [people] wishes to be a king of men, a king of men [desires to be a] world-emperor, a world-emperor a god, [and] a god wishes even to be a king of gods. [But] even when one has become the king of gods, [one's] desire does not end [there]. Initially, such greed is rather small, [but over time], it increases [and increases] like a [begging-]bowl, [which at the root is shallow, but which expands more and more from the centre to the edge]." A *cakravartin* is, therefore, a ruler who reigns over the kings of the earth. The next higher rank would be that of a god. Thus, the *cakravartin* represents the highest possible secular status that a human being can achieve in terms of power and prosperity. The text further suggests that a king aspires to rise to the rank of a *cakravartin*. Rāmacandra deliberately employs this term to address his target audience. An extensive discussion of Sahajayoga can be found at the end of the comparative analysis of the complex early modern yoga taxonomies on p. 478.

[474] For a discussion of the title, see p. 47. For the reconstruction of the archetypal final rubric, see p. 54.

Chapter 3

Comparative Analysis of the Complex Early Modern Yoga Taxonomies

The similarities between the yoga taxonomies of Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu* and his source text, the *Yogasvarodaya*, as well as those set out by Nārāyaṇatīrtha in his *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* and Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, all of which emerged during the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries, were first observed and briefly discussed by Birch (2014).[475] I call this specific literary phenomenon the "complex early modern yoga taxonomies of the medieval yogas" or simply "complex yoga taxonomies". Table 2 provides an overview of the four known complex yoga taxonomies.[476,477]

No.	*Tattvayogabindu*	*Yogasvarodaya*	*Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*	*Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*
1.	*kriyāyoga*	*kriyāyoga*	*kriyāyoga*	***bhaktiyoga***
2.	*jñānayoga*	*jñānayoga*	*caryāyoga*	*mantrayoga*
3.	*caryāyoga*	*karmayoga*	*karmayoga*	*layayoga*
4.	*haṭhayoga*	*haṭhayoga*	*haṭhayoga*	*carcāyoga*
5.	*karmayoga*	*dhyānayoga*	*mantrayoga*	***haṭhayoga***
6.	*layayoga*	*mantrayoga*	*jñānayoga*	*rājayoga*
7.	*dhyānayoga*	*urayoga*	*advaitayoga*	*lakṣayoga*
8.	*mantrayoga*	*vāsanāyoga*	*lakṣyayoga*	*aṣṭāṅgayoga*
9.	*lakṣyayoga*	-	*brahmayoga*	***sāṃkhyayoga***
10.	*vāsanāyoga*	-	*śivayoga*	*jñānayoga*
11.	*śivayoga*	-	*siddhiyoga*	*brahmayoga*
12.	*brahmayoga*	-	*vāsanāyoga*	*advaitayoga*
13.	*advaitayoga*	-	*layayoga*	-
14.	*siddhayoga*	-	*dhyānayoga*	-
15.	*rājayoga*	- [*rājayoga*]	*premabhaktiyoga*	-
16.	-	-	[*rājayoga*]	-

Table 2: The four complex yoga taxonomies

The phenomenon of complex yoga taxonomies raises various questions.

[475] See Birch, 2014: 415–416.

[476] In the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* column of Table 2, boldface marks the three superordinate yoga categories—*bhaktiyoga*, *haṭhayoga*, and *sāṃkhyayoga*—under each of which the three immediately following yoga categories are subsumed.

[477] Square brackets in Table 2 indicate a yoga category that is implied rather than explicitly included in the enumerated taxonomy.

1. How are the individual yoga categories used and classified in the four texts?
2. Do the four texts use and understand the individual yogas in the same way, or are there differences?
3. Furthermore, what conclusions can be drawn from the preceding question with regard to each individual yoga category and the context of each text?
4. Is there a direct historical connection between all the texts with complex yoga taxonomies, or did they all arise independently?
5. How can the phenomenon of "complex early modern yoga taxonomies of the medieval yogas" be situated within the broader context of the history of yoga?
6. Is it possible to explain why they emerged?

To answer, or at least address, these questions, the complex yoga taxonomies and their individual yoga categories are examined comparatively. The results will be linked with the recent findings of yoga research.

This chapter will conduct an empirical comparative analysis grounded in the hermeneutics of difference.[478] It first historicises the objects of comparison—the early modern yoga texts *Tattvayogabindu*, *Yogasvarodaya*, *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, and *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*—by placing them in their specific historical and religious contexts. It then uses the empirically derived con-

[478]The term "hermeneutics of difference" should be understood in the context of the German concept "Differenzhermeneutik" as employed by the cultural studies-oriented Heidelberg School of Religious Studies. Here, Differenzhermeneutik refers to an interpretative method, particularly in the comparative study of religions, that seeks to understand and analyse the diversity and distinctiveness of religious expressions. This approach emphasises the context, cultural background, and differences that shape a religious phenomenon. Instead of searching for universal principles, the focus is on the differences between various religious traditions and practices. Religious phenomena are examined within their specific cultural, historical, and social contexts, thus revealing the particular conditions and circumstances, as well as the internal logic and significance in their emic context, as viewed from an etic perspective. This etic perspective is critically reflected upon, so that the biases and assumptions of the researcher are taken into account. Researchers are encouraged to become aware of their own cultural and religious perspectives and to reflect on their impact on the understanding process.

cept of "complex early modern yoga taxonomies of the medieval yogas"[479] as the basis for the comparison. The comparison aims to capture the structural and functional similarities and differences between the complex yoga taxonomies and the individual yoga taxa, while taking into account the distinctive characteristics of the texts. The results derived from this will be applied to the questions mentioned above.

The comparison will broaden and clarify our understanding of the respective spectrum of meanings of the individual yoga categories in the discursive field of the authors of the texts containing the taxonomies. Furthermore, the comparison documents the discursive network[480] in which various yoga categories were used in the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries. Additionally, contrasting the single yoga categories used across traditions will sharpen our understanding of the categories themselves, since the use of multiple perspectives can reveal aspects that were previously obscured. Individual yoga categories that do not appear in the list of the *Tattvayogabindu* but are listed in the other texts with complex taxonomies will also be covered and outlined. In addition, yoga categories that do not appear in any of the analysed lists but are nevertheless mentioned in the texts will also be covered. Thus, this comparative study will display the overall picture of all yoga categories used during the period under consideration in an encyclopaedic fashion and will serve as a comprehensive reference for scholars. However, it is essential to emphasise that the comparison of yoga categories is limited to those texts that contain the complex yoga taxonomies. Although the analysis and comparison of the yoga categories can be extended to other yoga texts, locations, and periods where necessary or useful, for example, to provide the required context, the restriction on the complex yoga taxonomies is generally

[479] The metalinguistic conceptualisation of this phenomenon, which appears in these texts, serves to delineate a specific religious-historical phenomenon observed in the 16th and 17th centuries on the Indian subcontinent in certain yoga texts written in Sanskrit and Brajbhāṣā from different traditions. In this comparative study, it serves as the *tertium comparationis*. "Complex" refers to a double-digit number of different yoga categories in an early modern yoga text, compared to the more widespread, less complex medieval yoga taxonomies that describe a single-digit number of yogas. The *Yogasvarodaya* is included here because it explicitly announces a total of fifteen yogas, although the extant quotations preserve the names of only eight of them.

[480] Spoiler alert: There are astonishing differences!

maintained to prevent this complex endeavour from going *ad absurdum*.[481] Ultimately, the comparative analysis of the texts, their authors, and their multiple yoga categories will help to formulate a new, concise hypothesis as to why and under what circumstances the complex yoga taxonomies emerged across traditions, and whether or not they emerged independently of each other.

In striving to avoid the issues highlighted by Jonathan Z. Smith in his influential essay on the theory of comparative religious studies, entitled *In Comparison a Magic Dwells* (1982),[482] this work fundamentally follows the approach and methodology of Barbara A. Holdrege. Her comparative model, presented in her essay *Comparative Religion with a Difference* (1994), effectively addresses the problems in comparative work identified by Smith.[483] This study follows her method, with modifications tailored to the present comparison, in three phases of analysis.[484] These phases are:

1. The historical-religious[485] contextualisation and content characterisation. Holdrege's first step, the "Historical Interpretation," is adjusted to suit the present topic. In this first step, the comparative objects, i.e., the individual texts, are embedded in their historical and religious contexts, providing an overview of their principal contents. The primary

[481] The historical tracing and analysis of developments in the reception history of the yoga categories presented in the complex taxonomies can be used to generate valuable insights, as I have demonstrated by the example of the development of the early modern forms of Kriyāyoga into the modern forms of Kriyāyoga, beginning with the lineage of Paramahaṃsa Yogānanda; see p. 326 et seqq. Unfortunately, this example made me realise that it is beyond this work's scope to extend this analysis to the history of the reception of each yoga category and term throughout the entire history of yoga, particularly the transition from the early modern to the modern period. Fortunately, other scholars have already done great work in the last decade. A groundbreaking example of the history of Rājayoga is Birch (2014), "Rājayoga: Reincarnations of the King of All Yogas". Even single yogic techniques can be extremely complex. For an outstanding article on the history of the haṭhayogic *vajrolīmudrā* see for example Mallinson (2018), "Yoga and Sex: What is the Purpose of Vajrolīmudrā?"

[482] Smith, 1982.

[483] Holdrege, 1994: 804–805.

[484] See ibid. 1994: 806–812.

[485] Holdrege's original historical-cultural contextualisation and content characterisation is adapted to the needs of this comparison's specific setting, as this study deals with texts from the same culture but belonging to different religious traditions within that culture. The specific tradition from which each text emerges is highly relevant to providing the necessary context of each complex yoga taxonomy.

focus is on the individual taxa of the yoga taxonomies in the four texts. The concepts and constellations of ideas necessary for an adequate description and an immanent understanding of the yoga category in each text are considered here. This is achieved by analysing each yoga in each text separately.

2. The comparative analysis. Here, the differences and similarities of the "complex early modern yoga taxonomies of the medieval yogas" for each taxon will be highlighted. Within this framework, the constitutive concepts of each text and their tradition, which form the basis for each complex yoga taxonomy, are contrasted.
3. The interpretation of the results. In this final step, the results are applied to the questions posed in the introduction. The significance of the differences and similarities is examined and reflected upon in the context of the introductory questions. That is initially done at the level of individual yogas and finally at the overarching level, considering the results of the comparative analysis phase of all individual yogas.

In summary, this means the following: After describing and contextualising the four texts, the three analysis phases will be conducted for each yoga category mentioned in these texts. The comparative analysis will follow the structure of the individual yogas (the taxa) outlined in the *Tattvayogabindu*. Each yoga will initially be analysed in its context. The order is based on the order of the list in the *Tattvayogabindu*. That is phase one. The resulting descriptions of the individual yogas will then be compared. Some yogas only appear in the taxonomies of *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya* but are not explicitly dealt with in the text. At these points, reference is made to this fact, and the analysis is continued based on the explanations of the other taxonomies that describe these yogas. Some yogas only occur in one[486] or two texts. They will be described, too, and compared if more than one text contains them. The third analysis phase is conducted for each yoga category, which has more than one occurrence in the four texts. This part of the com-

[486] In this case, a comparison is impossible. However, they are nonetheless described for an encyclopedic overview.

parison will allow us to answer questions 1–3 above. In a concluding step—an overarching third phase of analysis—the overall results of the analysis of the individual yoga categories are summarised, interpreted, and applied to the remaining questions of this comparative study (4–6 mentioned above).

3.1 Contextualising the four texts with complex yoga taxonomies

This section describes the four texts that contain the four known complex yoga taxonomies. The focus is on characterising the historical and religious backgrounds of the texts and their authors. In addition, an overview of the contents will be presented, together with other information relevant to the comparison. Finally, the role of the complex yoga taxonomies within each respective text will be highlighted. The analysis of the individual yogas in each text, which follows this section, is always conducted within the specific religious, historical, and social context of the respective text.

3.1.1 *Tattvayogabindu*

The *Tattvayogabindu* has already been extensively contextualised in the introduction of the present work. In the previous chapter it was critically edited for the first time.[487] It has been established that the *Tattvayogabindu* was composed before 1591 CE[488] and that it was most likely written somewhere in northern India. Much about the author remains unknown. Rāmacandra's composition reflects the Śaiva orientation of his source texts, but also the religious universalism of Advaita Vedānta. As outlined in the chapter *Rāmacandra's audience*,[489] the *Tattvayogabindu* was certainly aimed at householders of the affluent segments of the population. On the basis of numerous internal textual statements, it is plausible that Rāmacandra's *yogaśāstra* was composed at an unidentified royal court for the instruction of aristocrats. If this is true, we must assume that Rāmacandra was employed as a yoga

[487] For a more detailed discussion of the *Tattvayogabindu*, see p. 3.
[488] The dating of the *Tattvayogabindu* is discussed on p. 6.
[489] See p. 12 et seqq.

teacher at the royal court. At the very beginning of the text, a complete list of fifteen yogas, presented as methods of Rājayoga, is provided.[490] Rāmacandra places Rājayoga at the top of the taxonomy to highlight its overarching position, presenting Rājayoga as a universal category encompassing all other yoga methods. Rāmacandra presents the following taxonomy: 1. Kriyāyoga, 2. Jñānayoga, 3. Caryāyoga, 4. Haṭhayoga, 5. Karmayoga, 6. Layayoga, 7. Dhyānayoga, 8. Mantrayoga, 9. Lakṣyayoga, 10. Vāsanāyoga, 11. Śivayoga, 12. Brahmayoga, 13. Advaitayoga, 14. Siddhayoga, and 15. Rājayoga itself.

e

3.1.2 *Yogasvarodaya*

The *Yogasvarodaya* is a Sanskrit yoga text of the Rājayoga genre with a distinct Śaiva orientation, which was possibly written in central or south India.[491] As the *Yogasvarodaya* was the primary source for the compilation of Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu*, the *terminus ante quem* for this work can also be set at 1591 CE. No manuscript of this text has yet been identified. We know of its existence only from quotations in other texts. These primarily include the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*, which cites 304 verses and a half verse from the *Yogasvarodaya* with reference (*yogasvarodaye*).[492] The *Yogakarṇikā* cites a total of 134 verses with reference (*yogasvarodaye*) and at least four additional verses without reference.[493] The *Śabdakalpadruma* (Ed. p. 501) quotes seven verses of the *Yogasvarodaya* with reference (*iti yogasvarodayaḥ*), which form its entry for the term *haṭhayoga*. There are numerous correspondences between the verses from the *Yogasvarodaya* quoted in the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* and the *Yogakarṇikā*. It is noteworthy, however, that many verses attributed to the *Yogasvarodaya* in the

[490] See p. 106 and especially table 2 on p. 305 for an overview.

[491] The *Yogasvarodaya* mentions the rivers Godāvarī and Kāverī. I discuss the role of the rivers of the *Tattvayogabindu*, *Yogasvarodaya*, and *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* on p. 227, n. 382.

[492] Cf. *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*, Ed. pp. 831–848.

[493] The four verses without reference are found in *Yogakarṇikā* 1.210–213 (these overlap with the quotations of the *Yogasvarodaya* in the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*. However, it appears to me that at least 1.209–216 must belong to the *Yogasvarodaya*. In this chapter, many verses are not attributed to any text. That is noteworthy since the author Nath Aghorānanda consistently attributes his chosen verses in all other chapters. Additional verses from the *Yogasvarodaya* might precede 1.209.

Yogakarṇikā containing practical instructions for *kumbhaka*s or purification techniques (*karma*s) are not found in the quotations of the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*. These same verses are also absent in the *Tattvayogabindu*.[494] The texts that quote the *Yogasvarodaya* provide good evidence that it circulated in north-eastern India.[495]

The *Yogasvarodaya* was probably addressed to non-celibate householders.[496] However, some quotations of the *Yogasvarodaya*, particularly one in the *Yogakarṇikā*, suggests that the *Yogasvarodaya* might also have had committed ascetic practitioners among its readers.[497]

Large parts of both the content and structure are similar to those of the *Tattvayogabindu*, except for the few passages where Rāmacandra exclusively

[494]This suggests the existence of different recensions of the *Yogasvarodaya*—one shorter version without practical instructions for physical techniques and another including them. If this is the case, Rāmacandra used the former as the template for the *Tattvayogabindu*.

[495]The *Prāṇatoṣinī* was written near Calcutta, see Shāstri (1905). The origin of the *Yogakarṇikā* is unknown. The only available printed edition of the *Yogakarṇikā* by Nath Sharma (2004) is based on a manuscript presumably from Benares, see Nath Sharma 2004: vi. Radhakanta Deva (1784–1867) compiled the *Śabdakalpadruma* in Calcutta. Thus, northeastern India was a significant area for the circulation of the *Yogasvarodaya*.

[496]Cf. Mallinson, 2018: 201.

[497]Based on an understanding of *śaktināḍī* as a "powerful channel" or "mighty intestine", the inclusion of the practice described here may have been too extreme for householders and could only be aimed at an enthusiastic ascetic audience. That technique is called *nāḍīkṣālanam* and described in the *Yogakarṇikā* with reference to *yogasvarodaye*. *Yogakarṇikā* 4.73–77 (Ed. pp. 58–59; ≈*Gheraṇḍasaṃhitā* 1.21–24; ≈*Haṭhayogasaṃhitā* 2.11–15) reads: *nāḍīkṣālanam | kākīmudrāṃ sādhayitvā pūrayed udaraṃ marut* (*marutodaram Haṭhayogasaṃhitā* 2.11) *| dhārayed ardhaṃ yāmāntaṃ cālayed ardhavartmanā* ‖ 73 ‖ *nābhilagnajale sthitvā śaktināḍīṃ visarjayet | karābhyāṃ kṣālayen nāḍīṃ yāvan malavisarjanam* ‖ 74 ‖ *tāvat prakṣālya nāḍīṃ ca udare veśayet punaḥ* ‖ 75 ‖ *idaṃ prakṣālanaṃ gopyaṃ devānām api durlabham* ‖ 76 ‖ *kevalaṃ dhautimātreṇa devadeho bhaved dhruvam | yāmārddhaṃ dhāraṇāśaktiṃ yāvan no dhārayen naraḥ | bahiṣkṛtaṃ mahādhautaṃ tāvan naiva ca kārayet* ‖ 77 ‖ "(73) Having cultivated the crow-seal, fill the stomach with air, hold it for an hour and a half, then move by the midway [path]. (74) Standing in water up to the navel, draw out the mighty intestine *śaktināḍī*. Wash out the intestine with both hands until all dirt is gone. (75) Having thoroughly washed the intestine, return it to the stomach. (76) This cleansing is so secret that even gods find it difficult to obtain. (77) By this cleansing alone, one certainly achieves the divine body. As long as a man is not able to hold the breath for an hour and a half, he should not perform the externalised great wash (*mahādhauta*)." Further research revealed that this interpretation of *śaktināḍī* is common among Indian scholars, as it is also found in Rodriguez and Ram (1992: 46–47) and additionally in Sahai (1972: 123). This is reinforced by a reading in *Haṭhayogasaṃhitā* 2.11, which reads *gudavartmanā* instead of *ardhavartmanā* in the context of the preliminary practice called Kākīmudrā.

relies on the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*.[498] Furthermore, only the quotations in the *Yogakarṇikā* attest that the *Yogasvarodaya* also taught various physical practices not present in the quotations of the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*: a detailed description of the *ṣaṭkarma*s (4.40–49, 4.67–80), *kevalakumbhaka* and *pratyāhāra* (6.23–34), instructions for *kumbhaka* (7.1–10, 7.23–28, 7.67–72), and instructions on *khecarīmudrā* (8.136–141). Thus, we can assume that these descriptions were much more numerous in the original *Yogasvarodaya*.

The *Yogasvarodaya* presents the fifteen yogas at the very beginning of the text. The fifteen yogas are understood, just like in the *Tattvayogabindu*, as equivalent methods of Rājayoga. Of the fifteen yogas announced, only eight methods of Rājayoga are named in this introduction according to the quotation from the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*. *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* (Ed. p. 831) reads:

> *atha rājayogaḥ || yogasvarodaye |*
> *īśvara uvāca |*
> *rājayogaṃ pravakṣyāmi śṛṇu sarvatra siddhidam |*
> *guhyād guhyataraṃ devi nānādharmaṃ parāt param ||*
> *rājayogena deveśi nṛpapūjyo bhaven naraḥ |*
> *rājayogī cirāyuś ca aṣṭaiśvaryamayo bhavet ||*
> *pañcadaśaprakāro'yaṃ rājayogaḥ ||*
> *kriyāyogo jñānayogaḥ karmayogo haṭhas tathā |*
> *dhyānayogo mantrayoga urayogaś ca vāsanā |*
> *rājaty etad brahmavaśīva ebhiś ca pañcadaśadhā |*
>
> Now Rājayoga; [as described] in the *Yogasvarodaya*. God said: "I will teach Rājayoga, listen! In every case, it bestows completion. [It is] more secret than secret, oh Goddess, [its] nature is manifold, [and it is] higher than the highest. By means of Rājayoga, O Goddess, the person is to be praised like a king. The Rājayogin may have a long life, and he may be equipped with the eight [supernatural] powers. This Rājayoga has fifteen varieties: Kriyāyoga, Jñānayoga, Karmayoga, Haṭha[yoga], Dhyānayoga, Mantrayoga,

[498] In particular, this concerns *Tattvayogabindu* XLIII on the topic of *avadhūtapuruṣa*, as well as individual passages of cosmogony, such as sections XLVIII, LIII, LIV, LV, LVI, and LVII.

> Urayoga[499] and Vāsanā[yoga]. By [means of] these fifteen [yogas], this [person] who is resting in Brahman shines [like a king]."

Not all of the eight yogas mentioned in the introduction are explained in the course of the text. The yogas treated in the text are: Kriyāyoga, Jñānayoga, Lakṣyayoga, which was not mentioned in the introductory verses, Rājayoga, Haṭhayoga, another form of Jñānayoga, and Aṣṭāṅgayoga, which was also not mentioned in the introduction. Since there is still no complete transmission of the *Yogasvarodaya*, it remains uncertain whether the text ever contained a more comprehensive description of these yogas.

3.1.3 *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

The *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* is an important commentary on Patañjali's *Yogasūtra*. Nārāyaṇatīrtha, a Telugu Brahmin born in Kaza in the Guntur district,[500] was a devotee of Kṛṣṇa, a *saṃnyāsin*, a renowned intellectual[501] and a prolific author.[502] Ko suggested that Nārāyaṇatīrtha flourished between 1600 and 1699.[503] Birch was able to further narrow down this period to 1659–1690.[504] Nārāyaṇatīrtha spent a considerable amount of time in Benares, though the exact period of his stay is currently unclear.[505]

As Birch (2014: 414) noted, in his *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Nārāyaṇatīrtha was probably the first author to integrate the teachings of Haṭhayoga into Pātañjalayoga.[506] At the beginning of his commentary (1.1), he enumerates

[499] The term is discussed on p. 450, n. 916.

[500] Ko, 1993: 43.

[501] Later authors like Brahmānanda considered Nārāyaṇatīrtha an authority in the field of yoga, as evidenced by his citation in the *Haṭhapradīpikājyotsnā* (Ed. p. 6).

[502] Nārāyaṇatīrtha composed several commentaries on the *Yogasūtra* and other works in different literary genres. See Penna, 2004: 20–21.

[503] Ko, 1993: 56.

[504] Birch, 2024: 55.

[505] See especially Penna, 2004: 24. A comprehensive study on the life and works of Nārāyaṇatīrtha can be found in Endo Ko's "The Works and Flourishing Period of Nārāyaṇatīrtha, the Author of the Yogasiddhāntacandrikā" (1993). All excerpts of the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* used in this study are based on the following edition: *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (of Nārāyaṇatīrtha). Ed. by Vimalā, Karnāṭak. Chowkhambā Sanskrit Series, No 108. Varanasi: Chowkhambā Sanskrit Series Office, 2000.

[506] The *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* is also the first text in the commentary tradition of Pātañjalayoga to document a proliferation of *āsanas*. In his commentary on *Yogasūtra* 2.46,

fifteen different yogas, which he locates throughout his commentary, particularly in the first two chapters of the *Yogasūtra*. These yogas are as follows: Kriyāyoga, Caryāyoga, Karmayoga, Haṭhayoga, Mantrayoga, Jñānayoga, Advaitayoga, Lakṣyayoga, Brahmayoga, Śivayoga, Siddhiyoga, Vāsanāyoga, Layayoga, Dhyānayoga, and Premabhaktiyoga. Nārāyaṇatīrtha conceptualises all fifteen yogas as valid methods for achieving the overarching goal of Pātañjalayoga, namely *asaṃprajñātasamādhi*, which he equates with Rājayoga in his commentary on 1.20.[507]

3.1.4 *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

Sant Sundardās (1596–1689) was a prominent 17th-century poet and scholar who, as a follower of the Dādūpanth, a religious group named after its founder Dādū, was deeply rooted in the Vaiṣṇava bhakti tradition.[508] Born in the Būsar line of the Khandelval merchant caste (*Vaiśya*), Sundardās met Dādū at a young age, probably shortly before 1600, and became his disciple.[509]

Together with other Dādūpanthīs, he studied from the age of eleven in Benares under the initial guidance of Jagjīvandās, a Brahmin disciple of Dādū, who maintained an ashram near Sundardās's birthplace in Dausa. During this period, he mastered Sanskrit, poetry (*kāvya*), and the prevailing knowledge systems of his time. Sundardās is recognised as the best-educated Dādūpanthī of his era.

After completing his education, Sundardās moved to Fatehpur in Rajasthan. He was known as a Sant poet and wrote numerous works,[510] and his scholarly activities extended to various disciplines.

Nārāyaṇatīrtha lists and describes a total of 38 *āsanas*. A detailed discussion of Haṭhayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* can be found on p. 359 et seqq.

[507] See p. 453 for the passages and a detailed discussion of Rājayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*.

[508] For a comprehensive account of Dādū and the Dādūpanth (1544–1603), see Horstmann and Rajpurohit, 2023: 71–77.

[509] Horstmann and Rajpurohit, 2023: 86.

[510] A selection of Sundardās's works has been translated by Horstmann and Rajpurohit in the book *In the Shrine of the Heart: Sants of Rajasthan from the Sixteenth and Seventeenth Centuries*, 2023: 151–182.

Sundardās preserved most of his works by copying them into a single manuscript in 1685 CE, just a few years before he died in 1689. This manuscript, known as the *Granthāvalī*, comprises three volumes, with the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* in the second volume. This collection contains 38 texts of varying lengths dealing with topics such as *jñāna*, yoga, and the *guru*.[511]

The *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, written in *Brajbhāṣā*, is a seminal historical document that systematically categorises twelve different yogas. Sundardās's text aims to present yoga as a cohesive, progressive system and reflects his comprehensive understanding of the discipline, which has undoubtedly influenced many contemporary Sants.

The yoga system in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* is divided into three main categories comprising twelve different yogas. Each tetrad consists of four yogas, including the main category, which Sundardās also presents as an individual yoga. The first main category is Bhaktiyoga (2.1–51), including Bhaktiyoga (2.1–15), Mantrayoga (2.16–27), Layayoga (2.28–39), and Carcāyoga (2.40–51). The second category is Haṭhayoga (3.1–52), consisting of Haṭhayoga (3.1–12), Rājayoga (3.13–24), Lakṣayoga (3.25–36), and Aṣṭāṅgayoga (3.37–52). The last category is Sāṃkhyayoga (4.1–50), which includes Sāṃkhyayoga (4.1–12), Jñānayoga (4.13–24), Brahmayoga (4.25–30) and Advaitayoga (4.31–50). Each yoga is assigned approximately the same number of verses, with each main category receiving about fifty stanzas.

Sundardās's system emphasises the interconnectedness and complementarity of these yogas, which all converge towards his ultimate goal of Advaitayoga, his system's final limb (*aṅga*).

Sundardās also describes practices that he rejects (1.12–49). He emphasises his disdain for the six philosophical schools (1.11). In other verses, he shows a strong anti-ritualistic attitude and mocks ritual practices, ascetic performances, Jain rites and quacks. He criticises groups such as the *kāpālika*s, *pāśupata*s and other ascetics and denounces their extreme behaviour.[512]

[511] Burger, 2014: 685.

[512] For example, Sundardās writes in *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 1.34: *kecit kaṃda mūla khani khāhīṃ, ekāeka rahaiṃ bana māhīṃ kecit kāsāyadika pahiraiṃ, japahiṃ jāpa paiṭhahiṃ jala gaharaiṃ‖* "Some dig up roots and bulbs and eat them, and live alone in the forest. Others wear saffron robes, recite mantras and sit in deep water." Similarly, in *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 1.40, he

He never explains the practices of the latter groups as yogas but as doctrines (*mata*s).

Sundardās recognises and distances himself from what he considers heretical and glorifies the teachings of his master, Dādū. His devotion to the *guru* is evident in his writings, which are imbued with personal devotion.

remarks: *kecit meghāḍambara baiṭhaiṃ, śīta kāla jalasāī paiṭhaiṃ | kecit dhūma pāna kari bhūlaiṃ, auṃdhe hoi bṛccha sauṃ jhūlaiṃ ||* "Some are staying outside all the time, in the cold season they lie in the water. Some breathe smoke [and] digress, [some are] swinging upside down from trees."

3.2 Comparison of the individual yoga categories

We have observed that although the complex yoga taxonomies are situated in very different texts and religious contexts, they show remarkable similarities. A striking number of the yoga categories covered in these texts overlap. Furthermore, it became clear that all the texts containing the complex yoga taxonomies date from the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries CE. As previously announced, the individual yoga categories of the four yoga taxonomies will be compared in the following sections. This comparison will elucidate the spectrum of meanings of the individual yoga categories, expanding our understanding of the discursive web of negotiations across the traditions that propagated and practised these yogas from the 16th to 17th centuries. Contrasting the individual yoga categories across traditions will sharpen our understanding of the categories themselves.

3.3 Kriyāyoga

Kriyāyoga, "the yoga of action", is the first method of Rājayoga within the list of fifteen yogas presented by Rāmacandra and his source text *Yogasvarodaya*. Remarkably, Nārāyaṇatīrtha also places Kriyāyoga first in his list of fifteen yogas in his *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*. Sundardās, on the other hand, omits Kriyāyoga altogether.

3.3.1 Kriyāyoga in the *Tattvayogabindu*

Since Rāmacandra refers to all fifteen yogas as variants of Rājayoga in his initial definition of yoga, and no explicit hierarchy is recognisable from his formulations in the text, all variants of Rājayoga appear to have been regarded by him as equally effective. All yogas aim towards the same goal: long-term durability of the body (*bahutarakālaṃ śarīrasthitiḥ*). The position of Kriyāyoga does not in itself provide any information about its efficacy or the assignment of practitioners of differing abilities to a particular type of

yoga, as was the case, for example, in the widespread fourfold taxonomies.[513] Implicit hierarchical features are nevertheless present—although all yoga types are a type of Rājayoga, Rāmacandra nonetheless places Rājayoga in the final and topmost position of his taxonomy. The only apparent reason why Rāmacandra specifies Kriyāyoga as the first yoga seems to be that his primary source text, whose content structure he largely follows, specifies this type of yoga as the first.

Mental waves to be cultivated	**Mental waves to be reduced**
Patience (*kṣamā*)	Envy (*matsārya*)
Discrimination (*viveka*)	Selfishness (*mamatā*)
Equanimity (*vairāgya*)	Cheating (*māyā*)
Peace (*śānti*)	Violence (*hiṃsā*)
Contentment (*santoṣa*)	Intoxication (*madā*)
Desirelessness (*niṣpṛha*)	Pride (*garvita*)
	Lust (*kāma*)
	Anger (*krodha*)
	Fear (*bhaya*)
	Shame (*lajjā*)
	Greed (*lobha*)
	Error (*moha*)
	Impurity (*aśuci*)
	Attachment and aversion (*rāgadveśau*)
	Disgust and laziness (*ghṛṇālasyā*)
	Error (*bhrānti*)
	Deceit (*daṃbha*)
	Envy (repeatedly) (*akṣamā*)
	Confusion (*bhrama*)

Table 3: Mental waves of Rāmacandra's Kriyāyoga

The *Tattvayogabindu*'s section on Kriyāyoga is brief. Rāmacandra quotes four verses from the *Yogasvarodaya* without attribution, followed by a prose summary. Kriyāyoga is defined as "liberation through [mental] action" (*kriyā-*

[513] According to *Amaraughaprabodha* 18–24, Mantrayoga is best suited for the weak, Layayoga for the average, Haṭhayoga for the talented and Rājayoga for the exceptionally talented practitioner. In *Dattātreyayogaśāstra* 14, one finds the statement that the lowest practitioner should perform Mantrayoga, which is then also referred to as the lowest yoga. *Śivasaṃhitā* 12–28 expands this fourfold scheme of yogas and practitioners with a temporal dimension. The weak practitioner needs twelve years to succeed with Mantrayoga, the average practitioner needs eight years with Laya, the able practitioner six years with Haṭha and the exceptional practitioner three years with Rājayoga.

muktir ayaṃ yogaḥ), emphasising *mukti* over worldly goals, with the practitioner also attaining "success in one's own body" (*svapiṇḍe siddhidāyakaḥ*). Its method involves restraining mental waves before action, reducing negative and cultivating positive waves.

The practitioner who does this is a *kriyāyogī*. Table 3 details which waves to cultivate or reduce.

3.3.2 Kriyāyoga in the *Yogasvarodaya*

A closer examination of the Kriyāyoga section in the *Yogasvarodaya* reveals Rāmacandra's reductive treatment, since he omits significant aspects of the *Yogasvarodaya*'s original conception of Kriyāyoga.

> *dhyānapūjādānayajñajapahomādikāḥ kriyāḥ* |
> *kriyāmuktimayo yogaḥ svapiṇḍe siddhidāyakaḥ* ‖ 1 ‖
>
> The actions are meditation, ritual worship, donation, recitation, fire sacrifice, and so forth. The yoga made of liberation through action[s] bestows success in one's own body.
>
> *yat karomīti saṅkalpaṃ kāryārambhe manaḥ sadā* |
> *tat sāṅgācaraṇaṃ kurvan kriyāyogarato bhavet* ‖ 2 ‖
>
> When, at the beginning of an action, the mind forms the definite intention "I am acting" and carries it out together with its auxiliaries, one becomes devoted to Kriyāyoga.
>
> *kṣamāvivekavairāgyaśāntisantoṣanispṛhāḥ* |
> *etad yuktiyuto yo 'sau kriyāyogo nigadyate* ‖ 3 ‖
>
> Patience, discrimination, equanimity, peace, contentment, desirelessness: The one endowed with these means is said to be a Kriyāyogī.
>
> *mātsaryaṃ mamatā māyā hiṃsā ca madagarvitā* |
> *kāmaḥ krodho bhayaṃ lajjā lobho mohas tathāśuciḥ* ‖ 4 ‖

---

2 **svapiṇḍe siddhidāyakaḥ** TYB] sapiṇḍisiddhidāyakaḥ PT, sapiṇḍisiddhidāyakaḥ YK

Envy, selfishness, cheating, violence, intoxication and pride, lust, anger, fear, shame, greed, error, and impurity.

rāgadveṣau ghṛṇālasyaśrāntidambhakṣamābhramāḥ |
yasyaitāni na vidyante kriyāyogī sa ucyate ‖ 5 ‖

Attachment and aversion, disgust and laziness, error, deceit, envy [and] confusion: Whoever does not experience these is called a Kriyāyogī.

sa eva muktaḥ sa jñānī caṇḍināśena īśvaraḥ |
kriyāmuktikaro yo 'sau rājayogaḥ sa muktidaḥ ‖ 6 ‖ (om. YK)

He alone, the wise one, the lord, through the destruction of gruesome [behaviour] who performs the liberation through action[s] is liberated. This Rājayoga is the bestower of liberation.

yāvan mano layaṃ yāti kṛṣṇe svātmani cinmaye |
bhaved iṣṭamanā mantrī japahomau samabhyaset ‖ 7 ‖[514] (om. YSv)

Until the mind enters absorption into Kṛṣṇa, in one's own self, which is consciousness, the mantra practitioner (*mantrin*) should practise recitation and fire sacrifice with a valid mind.

vidite paratattve tu samastair niyamair alam |
tālavṛntena kiṃ kāryaṃ labdhe malayamārute ‖ 8 ‖[515] (om. YSv)

When the highest principle has been realised, enough with all the *niyama*s. Why should one wave the palm frond when the wind from the Himalayas has already reached?

tāvat karmāṇi kurvanti yāvaj jñānaṃ na vidyate |
jñāne jāte pareśāni karmākarma na vidyate ‖ 9 ‖ (om. YSv)

Actions are performed as long as knowledge is lacking. When knowledge ensues, oh, Supreme Goddess, neither action nor non-action is known.

[514] 7ab ≈*Rudrayamalam uttaratantram* 38.58cd.
[515] ≈*Kulārṇavatantra* 9.28 & *Yuktabhavadeva* 1.80.

These verses[516] stem from the only two currently available sources of the *Yogasvarodaya*, namely the quotations from the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*[517] and the *Yogakarṇikā*.[518] The quotations of both texts essentially correspond, but the last verses of the passage differ. It cannot be ruled out that the last three verses of the *Yogakarṇikā* in particular come from a different source and were not present within the *Yogasvarodaya*. However, their content is so closely interwoven with the preceding verses that this scenario can be considered unlikely.

The main difference from the Kriyāyoga that Rāmacandra constructed from these verses is the definition, at the very beginning of the passage, of the actions (*kriyāḥ*) that predominantly constitute Kriyāyoga, namely (1) meditation, (2) ritual worship of God, (3) offerings, (4) recitation and (5) fire sacrifice, etc. Furthermore, while Rāmacandra declares the elements mentioned in the table 3 as waves (*kallola*) of the mind which are either required to be cultivated or reduced before any action is executed, the same elements are conceptualised in the *Yogasvarodaya* as the intentions (*saṅkalpa*) preceding the previously defined actions (*kriyā*s), which are to be cultivated.

In the three verses concluding this section, which are preserved only in the *Yogakarṇikā*, the practitioner is referred to as *mantrin* and should perform recitation and fire offerings until entering absorption (*laya*).

A possible historical link, particularly against this Vaiṣṇava background, is the model of Kriyāyoga as found in the *Uddhavagīta*[519] which forms part of the well-known *Bhāgavatapurāṇa*.[520] Here, in chapter XXII.1–55 Kṛṣṇa describes a Vaiṣṇava form of Kriyāyoga in response to a request by his disciple Uddhava. The practice entails a very complex and devotional ceremonial

[516] The numbering used here was introduced by me for practical reasons and does not correspond to the original numbering of the verses in the citations of the source texts. The *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* does not number the verses at all. The verses can be found in the printed edition of the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* on p. 831. The verses here are in the *Yogakarṇikā* with the numbering 1.209–216 and can be found in the edition on p. 17.

[517] A considerable part of the *Yogasvarodaya* is quoted with reference "*yogasvarodaye*".

[518] Normally the *Yogakarṇikā* quotes its sources. This passage is one of the few exceptional cases in which the verses have been taken from the *Yogasvarodaya* without citing the source. However, this passage ends after verse 1.216 with "*iti yogasaṅketāḥ |*".

[519] See e.g., Dāsa, 2007.

[520] See e.g., Shastri and Tagare, 1950.

veneration of the deity through offerings such as flowers and food, accompanied by the recitation of prescribed mantras, meditation, and the ritual consecration of the deity, among other rites. According to the text, this type of yoga is the most beneficial for women and the working class (22.4) and is considered a means for liberation from the fetters of *karma* (22.5). The Kriyāyoga described here is presented as being in accordance with both the Vedas and the Tantras, encompassing both enjoyment (*bhukti*) and liberation (*mukti*), and is said to bestow perfection in both this life and the next, by the Lord's grace (22.49).

Furthermore, this concept of Kriyāyoga in the *Yogasvarodaya* might be related to the ritual domain designated as *kriyā* in Śaiva tantric traditions. Śaiva Siddhānta scriptures are commonly associated with the four domains of *jñāna*, *kriyā*, *yoga*, and *caryā*. This conceptual tetrad should not, however, be confused with a fixed four-*pāda* textual structure. As Goodall has shown, such a fourfold textual division is attested only in a limited number of works and may in individual cases represent a secondary organisation of the textual material.[521]

The occurrence of Jñānayoga, Kriyāyoga, and Caryāyoga as separate categories within the fifteenfold yoga taxonomy nevertheless invites comparison with this familiar Śaiva tetrad. The parallel is therefore more safely located at the level of the four domains of Śaiva teaching and practice than at the level of a fixed four-*pāda* textual structure. In particular, the *kriyā*s mentioned at the beginning of the *Yogasvarodaya*—meditation, ritual veneration, donation, recitation, fire sacrifice, and so forth—show clear affinities with the ritual sphere conventionally designated by *kriyā* in Śaiva scriptures, which includes initiation (*dīkṣā*), ritual worship, mantra practice, and related procedures. *Prāṇāyāma*, meditation, *mudrā*s, *maṇḍala*s, and *mantra*s may also occur within this ritual context.[522] The other component, however, namely the cultivation or reduction of particular mental configurations preceding action (*saṅkalpa*)

[521] See Goodall, 1998: lviii–lxv.

[522] A number of Śaiva Tantras have now been translated, either completely or in substantial part. These include the *Svāyambhuvasūtrasaṅgraha*, *Ajitamahātantra*, *Kiraṇatantra*, *Rauravāgama*, *Niśvāsatattvasaṃhitā*, *Mṛgendrāgama*, and the *Śatika-Kālottara*. Several of these works have been translated completely, although only one is a Tantra divided into *pāda*s; on the problems surrounding this fourfold textual division, see Goodall, 1998: lviii–lxv. The first half of the

or mental waves (*kallola*), has not yet been located in the Śaiva sources examined. It may instead reflect a simplified adaptation of the Pātañjala model of Kriyāyoga.

3.3.3 Kriyāyoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

In his commentary on the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*, entitled the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Nārāyaṇatīrtha presents Kriyāyoga as the first of his fifteen yogas, which he locates in Pātañjalayoga.[523] The term Kriyāyoga occurs in *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* 2.1. According to the introduction to this *sūtra*, in the *bhāṣya*-part of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*, Kriyāyoga is the means by which someone with a distracted mind can also attain yoga (*vyutthitacitto 'pi yogayuktaḥ*). In *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* 2.1, Kriyāyoga is defined as follows:

> *tapaḥsvādhyāyeśvarapraṇidhānāni kriyāyogaḥ* |
>
> Kriyāyoga consists of austerity, self-study, and devotion to the supreme lord.

Kriyāyoga, or "yoga of action", is an action-oriented method of yoga consisting of three elements: austerity (*tapas*), which, according to the *bhāṣya*, should be practised both mentally and physically; the repetition of *mantra*s or the study of sacred literature (*svādhyāya*); and devotion to the supreme lord (*īśvarapraṇidhāna*). According to *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* 2.2, these three elements of Kriyāyoga should lead the practitioner to attain *samādhi* by reducing the so-called *kleśa*s. This explanatory model is picked up by Nārāyaṇatīrtha.[524] The five *kleśa*s consist of ignorance (*avidyā*), self-centredness (*asmitā*), attachment (*rāga*), aversion (*dveṣa*) and fear of death (*abhiniveśa*). None of the three main components of Patañjali's Kriyāyoga is mentioned in the *Tattvayogabindu* or the *Yogasvarodaya*. Nevertheless, a practice similar to the reduction of

Mṛgendra was translated into French by Hulin (1980); Bhatt's 1962 publication provides the Sanskrit edition.

[523] For an earlier brief discussion of Kriyāyoga in Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* see Penna, 2004: 62–66.

[524] Vimala, 2000: 71.

the *kleśa*s can also be found here. Although the specific fear of death (*abhiniveśa*) is not mentioned, the more general term for fear (*bhaya*) is cited.[525] The Kriyāyoga of the *Tattvayogabindu* could therefore perhaps be regarded as a simplified variant of the Pātañjalean model, which is concerned primarily with reducing negative waves of the mind, comparable to the reduction of *kleśa*s, while also adding the cultivation of positive mental waves. In both systems, Kriyāyoga is a means for liberation.[526]

3.3.4 Kriyāyoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Kriyāyoga within the complex yoga taxonomies reveals two distinct models. One is Nārāyaṇatīrtha's model, which draws directly on the Kriyāyoga of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*. The other, attested in sixteenth-century texts such as the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Tattvayogabindu*, appears to combine elements derived from Śaiva ritual traditions with a concern for the cultivation and reduction of mental configurations that is loosely comparable to the Pātañjala model.

The specifically defined *kriyā*s of the *Yogasvarodaya* show clear affinities with the ritual domain conventionally designated as *kriyā* in Śaiva traditions, while the cultivation and reduction of mental configurations before action may reflect a simplified adaptation of the Kriyāyoga of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*. The occurrence of Kriyāyoga, Caryāyoga, and Jñānayoga within the fifteenfold taxonomy is also suggestive when compared with the familiar Śaiva categories of *kriyā*, *caryā*, *jñāna*, and *yoga*. This correspondence need not presuppose dependence on a fixed four-*pāda* textual structure, but it strengthens the possibility that the taxonomy developed within an intellectual environment in which Śaiva classifications of religious knowledge and practice were familiar.

[525] The details of Nārāyaṇatīrtha's understanding of Kriyāyoga have already been discussed by Penna (2004: 62–66) and will therefore not be covered here again.

[526] The Kriyāyoga of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* will not be dealt with in detail here, as this has already been done in countless academic and informal publications. For the *sūtra*s related to Kriyāyoga and Patañjali's autocommentary in Sanskrit with English translation, see Mukerji, 1983: 113 et seqq. For a clear and accessible overview, see Bryant, 2009: 170 et seqq.

Nārāyaṇatīrtha, as a proponent of Pātañjalayoga, therefore seems unlikely to have originated the fifteenfold taxonomy. Rather, he appears to have incorporated an already circulating classification into the framework of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*, presenting the various forms of yoga current in his intellectual milieu as aspects of the authoritative Pātañjala system.

3.3.5 Excursus: Popularisation of a new Kriyāyoga in a global context

[527]The comparatively unusual treatments of Kriyāyoga, which are found only in sixteenth-century yoga literature[528] in *Yogasvarodaya* and Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu*, which deviate from the Pātañjala model, albeit not entirely, and, as shown, show clear influences of tantric origin, can provisionally be regarded as marginal phenomena or as a relatively short-lived intellectual trend. The briefly touched upon model of the *Uddhavagītā*, which describes a Kriyāyoga method for *mukti* and *bhukti* through ritual worship of God, is also comparatively rare in the literature. The overwhelming majority of the Sanskrit yoga texts written in the second millennium CE, as in the case of Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, are based on the model of Kriyāyoga propagated in the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* and the commentary literature. Accordingly, it was above all the publication of the *Yogasūtra* in the West, beginning with the translation by Henry Thomas Colebrooke in 1805,[529] which helped ensure that the concept of Kriyāyoga presented there also dominated the understanding of the term in academic and informal discourse in the West for a long time.

[527]This excursus was included primarily out of personal research interest and is irrelevant to the comparative analysis conducted here. One can safely ignore this section if one is not interested in this topic. Since Paramahaṃsa Yogānanda's *Autobiography of a Yogi* was one of the first books I read on the subject of yoga, I became curious about how exactly Yogānanda's Kriyāyoga should be situated historically and whether there is a historical connection between the early modern forms of Kriyāyoga and the modern forms of Kriyāyoga.

[528]The terminus *ante quem* for the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Tattvayogabindu* is 1591 CE, see p. 6 for the details.

[529]See David Gordon White. *The Yoga Sutra of Patanjali: A Biography*. Lives of Great Religious Books. New Jersey: Princeton University Press, 2014 for a detailed discussion.

The Western discourse only changed with the global success and popularity of Paramahaṃsa Yogānanda (1893–1952) and the *Self Realisation Fellowship* he founded in 1920, which, when compared with the earlier models of Kriyāyoga outlined above, spread an innovative yoga practice under the generic term Kriyāyoga. The influence of Yogānanda and others significantly changed and expanded the range of meanings of the term Kriyāyoga. In addition to various books published by Yogānanda, it was above all the book *Autobiography of a Yogi*, Yogānanda's own autobiography, published in 1946, which paved the way for Yogānanda's success. To this day, this work is considered a classic in popular yoga literature, has been in print for over seventy years and has been translated into more than 50 languages.[530] It retains a significant global following even now. Yogānanda, his books, his followers and the numerous books written by his followers have popularised this new form of Kriyāyoga beyond the Indian subcontinent. The designation Kriyāyoga as an overarching term for the practice system can already be documented in the tradition of Lāhiṛī Mahāśaya (1828–1895). Particularly important in this respect is Chatterjee's *Purana Purusha: Yogiraj Sri Shama Churn Lahiree: A Complete Biography*, a family-based biography compiled with access to twenty-six diaries written by Lāhiṛī Mahāśaya himself as well as family records and oral testimony preserved by his descendants and disciples.[531]

One of Yogānanda's contemporaries was Svāmī Śivānanda Sarasvatī (1887–1963), who likewise propagated a new form of Kriyāyoga. Although

[530] See Official Yogānanda Website. https://web.archive.org/web/20240323081653/https://yogananda.org/autobiography-of-a-yogi. Website saved with the Way Back Machine of archive.org on 23.03.2024. Self Realization Fellowship.

[531] Chatterjee's *Purana Purusha: Yogiraj Sri Shama Churn Lahiree: A Complete Biography* is not a critical or academic biography in the modern historiographical sense, but an explicitly devotional work produced within the Lāhiṛī Kriyāyoga tradition. Its hagiographical framing is pervasive: Lāhiṛī Mahāśaya is repeatedly presented as a divine manifestation, and supernatural events are treated as historical realities. Its evidentiary value therefore varies considerably according to the type of material cited. Of particular importance are passages based on Lāhiṛī Mahāśaya's twenty-six diaries, letters and other family records; other sections depend on oral family and disciple traditions and must be treated with corresponding caution. Satya Charan Lahiri, Lāhiṛī Mahāśaya's grandson, states that he supplied Chatterjee with the twenty-six diaries, other records and books, as well as information remembered from his father, mother, grandmother, aunts and older disciples. See Chatterjee, 2007: 10–11, 18–19.

his Kriyāyoga was initially based mainly on the Pātañjalayoga model, it was expanded under the same umbrella term with Haṭhayoga practices and possibly influenced by Yogānanda's model. This expansion and integration of new practices under the umbrella term Kriyāyoga was continued by his students, particularly Svāmī Satyānanda Sarasvatī (1923–2009), the founder of the famous *Bihar School of Yoga* (since 1962).

The resulting popularity of Kriyāyoga generated a global wave of interest and inspired others, who in turn developed similar but sometimes differently nuanced Kriyāyoga systems. One example is S. A. A. Ramaiah, who founded the *Kriya Babaji Yoga Sangam* in 1952. In this case, too, there is a global following.[532]

It was the actors mentioned above, above all Yogānanda, who drove the global popularisation of this new form of Kriyāyoga so that their concepts are at least as well known in recent public discourse, if not better known, than the Kriyāyoga of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*.

These new forms of Kriyāyoga, which can only be traced from the mid-nineteenth century, are, as will be shown, a reservoir of innovative combinations and further developments of numerous practices already codified in yoga texts in the medieval to pre-colonial period, which were integrated into seemingly coherent practice systems by actors such as Yogānanda, Śivānanda, Ramaiah, etc. The statements made by their traditions about the historicity of their yoga practice utilise established narratives to provide this form of Kriyāyoga with a sense of tradition and historical legitimacy.[533]

[532] Kriya Babaji Yoga Sangam Website. https://web.archive.org/web/20240320214547/https : / / kriyababajiyogasangam . org/. Website saved with the Way Back Machine of archive.org on 20.03.2024. Kriya Babaji Yoga Sangam

[533] For example, tracing yoga traditions back to a legendary founding figure, the master's stay in the Himalayas, lost writings that suddenly reappear and legitimise the yoga practices can also be found in similar forms in other traditions. For example, in the lineage of T. Krishnamacharya. See Singleton and Goldberg, 2013: 81–121.

3.3.6 The Kriyāyogas of the lineages of Paramahaṃsa Yogānanda, Svāmī Śivānanda Sarasvatī and Ramaiah

So what constitutes these new forms of Kriyāyoga? To answer this question, recent publications on this topic were consulted.[534] The following is a brief outline of the main features of the Yogānanda, Śivānanda and Ramaiah models of Kriyāyoga without claiming to be exhaustive. To my knowledge, a comprehensive and complete historical study of Kriyāyoga has not yet been carried out and cannot be done within this framework. This discussion is intended only as an outline and a first approach to the topic in order to differentiate between the models circulating in public discourse on the one hand and, on the other, to formulate a hypothesis on the transition from the older models to the newer models, as these are very close in time.

3.3.6.1 Definitions

The publications consulted contain various creative etymologies and explanations of the term Kriyāyoga. Harihārananda, a Kriyāyoga teacher authorised by Yogānanda[535] himself explains in his book *Kriya Yoga* (1989):

> 'Kriya Yoga' are Sanskrit words, a combination of two root words. One is Kriya and the other is yoga. In the word Kriya there are two syllables: kri and ya. Kri means to pursue your work in daily life and ya means to be ever aware of the invisible God who is abiding in you and is directing and accomplishing work through you. ...The second word, 'yoga,' literally means union of the visible body with the invisible body. This union is always present in everyone.[536]

[534] This list is certainly not exhaustive. Nevertheless, I have consulted a wide range of these publications available to me. 1. For the Yogānanda model: Yogānanda's *Autobiography of a Yogi* (1949); Lowenstein and Lett's *Kriya Yoga for Self-Discovery* (2021); Satyananda's *A Systematic Course in the Ancient Tantric Techniques of Yoga and Kriya* (1981); Harihārananda's *Kriya Yoga* (1989); Kriyananda's *The Kriya Yoga Upanishad and the Mystical Upanishads* (1993) and Sturgess's *The Supreme Art and Science of Rāja and Kriyā Yoga* (2015). 2. For the Śivānanda model: Sivananda's *Tantra Yoga, Nada Yoga and Kriya Yoga* (1955) and Nityānanda Giri's *Kriyāyoga: The science of Life-force* (2013). 3. For the Ramaiah model: Govindan's *Babaji* (2010).

[535] Harihārananda, 1989: 16.

[536] See Harihārananda, 1989: 83.

Another etymology of the term *kriyā* can be found in the book *Kriya Yoga for Self-Discovery* (2021):

> …kri meaning "work" and ya meaning "soul" or "breath" = The Work to be done with the Soul's breath.[537]

The most complex explanation of the term can be found in the book *Kriyāyoga: The science of Life-force* of Nityānanda Giri, who also situates himself in the Yogānanda tradition:

> The word *kriyā* is composed of the letters *k*, *r*, *i*, *y*, and *ā*. The letter *-k* (or *ka*), *ka-kāra*, represents the Lord, *Īśvara*. The Transcendental Lord, *Parama Śiva*, when he manifests Himself in the suble [sic] world and makes Himself ready for creation He becomes *Īśvara*. The letter-*r* (or *ra*), *ra-kāra*, represents fire, light and manifestation. Creation is not seen by us with the ether and air elements since these are subtle elements. We are able to see manifestation from the fire element onwards. The letter *-i*, *i-kāra*, represents energy or *śakti*. So *kri* is the activating power of the Lord manifested in creation. The activating power is called *prāṇa* or vital force. The letter *-y* (or *ya*), *ya-kāra*, represents the air element and the letter *-ā*, *ā-kāra*, represents form. For the manifestations to take a form, *ākāra*, the Lord acts with the air element. With the ether element there is no form. The air element or gaseous state is the first created form although we only see the forms from the fire element onwards. Through the action of air the whole universe is manifested. This is the action of the Life-force, *prāṇakarma*, of the Lord. The word *kriyā* normally means action, but this is the action of god. We are made with the same principle God is. Our identification with the physical body makes us separate from God and this is the state of ignorance. We have to eradicate this ignorance by the action of God, i.e., the action of the breath, *prāṇakarma*. Our mind is the result of ignorance

[537] Lowenstein and Lett, 2021: 91.

> and is responsible for the wrong identification. Breath-practice, *prāṇakarma*, absorbs the mind into the vital force. This action of God reverses the process and leads us from body to God. This is why it is so necessary to perform that action. That is our spiritual practice. Then that action, *kriyā*, becomes yoga.[538]

Satyananda Sarasvati, an important proponent of the Śivānanda model, defines Kriyāyoga in his book *A Systematic Course in the Ancient Tantric Techniques of Yoga and Kriya* (1981) as follows:

> The Sanskrit word *kriya* means 'action' or 'movement'. *Kriya Yoga* is so called because it is a system where one intentionally rotates one's attention along fixed pathways. This movement of awareness is done, however with control. Also kriya yoga is so called because one moves the body into specific mudras, bandhas and asanas according to a fixed scheme of practice. The word *kriya* is often translated as meaning 'practical'. This is indeed a good definition, for kriya yoga is indeed practical. It is concerned solely with practice, without the slightest philosophical speculation. The system is designed to bring results, not merely to talk about them. Sometimes the word *kriya* is translated as 'preliminary'. This too is a good definition, for kriya yoga is a preliminary practice that leads first to dharana and then eventually to the transcendental state of dhyana (meditation) and yoga (union). It is a technique which has been designed to lead to that state of being which is beyond all techniques. Finally, the word *kriya* is used to describe each individual practice. Thus the process of kriya yoga consists of a number of kriyas each being done one after the other in a fixed sequence.[539]

In the book *Babaji* (2010), Govindan, a student of Ramaiah, offers a simple explanation of the term:

[538] Nityānanda Giri, 2013: 2–3.
[539] Satyananda, 1981: 699.

> Kriyā is an activity performed with mindfulness.[540]

As different as the concepts presented here may seem, they share an emphasis on consciously performed actions or practices that connect people with God or are intended to bring about a transcendent state, a state of yoga. In his definition, Nityānanda defines the central action (*kriyā*) that should lead to a connection with God, namely breathing practice (*prāṇakarma*). Satyānanda associates the term with other practices, such as directing attention, *mudrā*s, *bandha*s and *āsana*s.

Further definitions can be found in the consulted texts. However, these are sufficient for present purposes, as they illustrate the basic idea of the new models of Kriyāyoga on the one hand and show the fundamental diversity and openness of the model, which permeates all areas of these new forms of Kriyāyoga, on the other.

3.3.6.2 Histories of the new forms of Kriyāyoga from an emic perspective

Nityānanda Giri, who places himself in the lineage of Yogānanda, explains that Kriyāyoga is an eternal tradition that stands at the beginning of human history. He explains that this is why many of the scriptures, such as the *Śivasūtra*, the *Āgama*s and the writings of the Siddhas, teach the techniques and principles of Kriyāyoga in many different ways. Moreover, remnants of this primal Kriyāyoga can be found in almost all philosophies, be it Buddhism, Jainism, Sāṃkhya, Vaiśeṣika, Nyāya, Mīmāṃsā or Vedānta.[541]

Satyānanda (1981: 699), the founder of the *Bihar School of Yoga*, explains that there is no history of Kriyāyoga and that its origins and development have been lost. Furthermore, the Kriyāyoga system was so secret that there is not even a myth to explain its origin. Next, he describes that parts of the Kriyāyoga taught by him are contained in the texts of Haṭhayoga, such as *āsana*s, *mudrā*s and *bandha*s, but that these are not "integrated together". Satyānanda speculates that Kriyāyoga must have been known in China, as

[540] Govindan, 2010: 214.
[541] Nityānanda Giri, 2013: 2-7.

he sees strong parallels to practices in *Tai Chi Chuan*. He clearly distances himself from the Kriyāyoga of the *Yogasūtra*, which has nothing to do with the Kriyāyoga of his book *A Systematic Course in the Ancient Tantric Techniques of Yoga and Kriya* and serves solely as a preparation for Rājayoga. However, the only definite historical claim he is prepared to make is the following:

> Of history, all we will say is that kriya yoga was passed on by Swami Sivananda of Rishikesh.[542]

Surprisingly, this same Śivānanda of Rishikesh in his book *Tantra Yoga, Nada Yoga and Kriya Yoga* (1955) explicitly traces the Kriyāyoga he taught back to *Yogasūtra* 2.1. Śivānanda uses the Kriyāyoga of the *Yogasūtra* as the overarching framework of his teaching, which also integrates *ṣaṭkarma* and breathing exercises from Haṭhayoga into it.[543]

It is important to emphasise that Satyānanda recognises that the traditional lineage of Yogānanda practises the same Kriyāyoga he teaches. However, he explicitly distances himself from their narrative:

> Of course, there are various other groups of people in India who have practiced and taught kriya yoga. For example, Swami Yogananda, Yukteshwar Giri, Lahiri Mahasaya, Mahatma Gandhi and so forth practiced kriya yoga. In fact, a thriving organization still propagates it throughout the world. They also do not know the origin of kriya yoga, but they say that it was reintroduced by the great yogi Babaji as the ideal practice for sincere seekers of wisdom in the present Kali Yuga (Dark Age).[544]

This narrative is by far the most widespread explanation of the origins of the new Kriyāyoga and is adopted not only in the tradition of Yogānanda, but also in the tradition of Ramaiah. In his book *Babaji* (2010: 31–64), Govindan, a disciple of Ramaiah, has compiled this narrative in detail, which I shall summarise briefly here.

[542] Satyananda, 1981: 699.
[543] See Sivananda, 1982: 168–182.
[544] Satyananda, 1981: 699.

Mahāvātara Bābājī, who according to Govindan is considered an incarnation of the Buddha, was born in 203 CE in Parangipetta in Tamil Nadu under the name *Najaraj* into a Brahmin family, joined a group of wandering Saṃnyāsins at a young age and studied the holy scriptures. His path soon led him to Śrī Laṅka in Katirkāma (now Kataragama), where he became a disciple of Siddha Boganathar and was initiated by him into various *kriyā*s such as *dhyāna*, *āsana*, *mantra* and *bhaktiyoga*. Bhoganathar later sent Bābājī to another teacher, namely Siddha Agastya in Courtallam in the Pothihai hills of Tamil Nadu, located in today's Tinneveley district. He learnt the particularly important *kriyā* called *kuṇḍalinīprāṇāyāma* from him. Agastya then sent Bābājī to Badrinath in the Himalayas, where he practised for many months and finally attained *samādhi*. After attaining enlightenment and immortality at the tender age of 16, Bābājī set himself the task of helping suffering humanity in its search for God-realisation. As an immortal, Bābājī initiated great personalities such as Śaṅkarācārya (788–820) and Kabīr (1440–1518) into the techniques of Kriyāyoga over the centuries. Finally, according to this version of the narrative, in 1861 he initiated Lāhiṛī Mahāśaya (1828–1895) into Kriyāyoga and gave him the task of passing it on to serious seekers.

At this point, Govindan quotes the autobiography of Yogānanda,[545] which states that Bābājī explained to Lāhiṛī Mahāśaya that Kṛṣṇa had once passed on Kriyāyoga to Arjuna and that not only Patañjali knew it, but also Jesus Christ, who in turn had passed it on to John, Paul and other disciples. Among Lāhiṛī Mahāśaya's 100 disciples was Śrī Yukteśvar (1855–1936), to whom Bābājī is also said to have appeared three times. On one of these occasions, Bābājī decided that he should send his disciple Yogānanda (1893–1952) to America to spread Kriyāyoga, which he did, gaining global fame and founding the *Self Realisation Fellowship* in 1920, which is still very active today. A different account preserved within Lāhiṛī Mahāśaya's family tradition presents a significantly different chronology and a less elaborated version of the encounter. According to *Purana Purusha: Yogiraj Sri Shama Churn Lahiree: A Complete Biography*, Lāhiṛī Mahāśaya received his transfer order to Ranikhet only on 23 November 1868 and shortly thereafter encountered a Saṃnyāsin in the moun-

[545] Yogānanda, 1949: 244.

tains who subsequently initiated him into Kriyāyoga. The account states that Lāhiṛī later addressed this guru as Bābājī, a designation subsequently adopted by his disciples.[546] The same biography furthermore observes that Lāhiṛī's diaries contain no record of a subsequent encounter with Bābājī in a physical form; later meetings are instead described as experiences occurring through *sādhanā*. It also records that a Saṃnyāsin belonging to Bābājī's circle occasionally came to Lāhiṛī to collect money received from initiations.[547]

3.3.6.3 The practice of the new Kriyāyoga

In the following, the practices of the new Kriyāyoga are presented in outline based on the publications mentioned and consulted above.[548] The words of Harihārananda (1989: 144) provide a particularly apt first impression of this complex phenomenon:

> Kriya Yoga is the essence and synthesis of all yoga techniques taught in the world.

Importantly, this integrative structure can already be observed in the Kriyāyoga attributed to Lāhiṛī Mahāśaya himself. *Purana Purusha: Yogiraj Sri Shama Churn Lahiree: A Complete Biography* describes the first stage of his Kriyāyoga as consisting of five practices: *tālavya*, *prāṇāyāma*, *nābhikriyā*, *yonimudrā* and *mahāmudrā*. These constitute the first of six successive stages, while *oṃkāra-kriyā* forms part of the second through sixth stages.[549] The same source thus provides evidence that the integration of techniques belonging to different earlier yogic repertoires under the designation Kriyāyoga was already attributed to the system of Lāhiṛī Mahāśaya within the family tradition, rather than being presented merely as a development of later twentieth-century Kriyāyoga traditions.

[546] Chatterjee, 2007: 29–32.

[547] Chatterjee, 2007: 90–91.

[548] A comprehensive presentation and comparative analysis of the practices in the various traditions of the new Kriyāyoga would be too far-reaching for this chapter. The most detailed written practice instructions that I have consulted can be found for the Śivānanda/Satyānanda model in Satyananda, 1981: 697–952, and for the Yogānanda model in Nityānanda Giri, 2013: 249–340.

[549] Chatterjee, 2007: 84–85.

Satyananda (1981: 703) explains that each Kriyā consists of a certain number of subordinate techniques. These always consist of a combination of the following six tools: *āsana*, *mudrā*, *bandha*, *mantra*, *prāṇāyāma* and, as he calls it, "psychic passage awareness". This last point includes a group of exercises mainly involving "circulating awareness through the *cakra*s in an ascending and descending way" or similar. A single Kriyā is an exercise unit comprising individual exercises from the six categories mentioned. However, these are not arbitrary but are integrated into a specific, and, as the protagonists of this tradition say "scientific way" in order to induce the process of concentration (*dhāraṇā*), meditation (*dhyāna*) and meditative absorption (*samādhi*). The main distinguishing feature from other yoga systems is the innovative and specific combination of the individual techniques into a practical and particularly effective sequence of exercises, referred to here as "Kriyā".

In every model the individual exercises are drawn from the vast body of yoga literature but primarily from the exercises taught in the medieval to pre-colonial texts of the Haṭha- and Rājayoga genre. This always takes place against the background of tantric and medieval concepts of the yogic body, such as *cakra*, *nāḍī* and *vāyu* systems. A common feature of the new Kriyāyoga literature is the use of scientific explanatory models that are used as a means of legitimisation. For example, certain *nāḍī*s are located in schematic sketches of the brain[550], or positive effects of Kriyāyoga practice are legitimised with evolutionary biology theories, such as the polyvagal theory.[551]

Govindan (2010: 216–225) distinguishes a total of seven main categories of Kriyāyoga. The first category he mentions is *Kriya Hatha Yoga*. According to him, this is the starting point for every student of Kriya Yoga. This includes eighteen basic relaxation postures (*āsana*s), muscle blocks (*bandha*s), certain gestures (*mudrā*s) and the sun salutation (*sūryanamaskāra*) defined by Bābājī.

The second main category is what Govindan calls *Kriya Kundalini Pranayama*. According to him, this practice is the art and science of mastering the breath and is considered to be the most essential and effective tool in Bābājī's Kriyāyoga. This is not only meant to awaken the *kuṇḍaliṇī* but

[550] Nityānanda Giri, 2013: 215.
[551] Lowenstein and Lett, 2021: 188.

with regular practice, the student awakens all *cakra*s and the associated levels of consciousness, which is supposed to ultimately lead to the breathless state of *samādhi* and self-realisation.

The third main category is *Kriya Dhyana Yoga*, which is intended to include meditation techniques that are not explained in detail but are supposed to awaken the mind's hidden faculties.

The fourth main category is *Kriya Mantra Yoga*. This involves the recitation or murmuring (*japa*) of mantras discovered by the Siddhas. The recitation of mantras must take place with faith, love and concentration.

Govindan specifies the fifth category as *Kriya Bhakti Yoga*, the yoga of love and devotion. In Govindan's words, this is the "turbojet" of self-realisation. This type of Kriyāyoga includes devotional love, chanting, ritual worship and pilgrimages to holy places.

Furthermore, *Kriya Karma Yoga* is presented as the sixth category. In this case he refers to *Bhagavadgītā* (2.47 et seqq.) and thus defines this subtype as selfless service that is performed consciously. All actions are supposed to be performed without the expectation of receiving anything in return, free from anger, selfishness, greed and personal desires. Thus, the practitioner is meant to examine his motivation before every action and is always supposed to act without selfish motives.

The seventh and final category is *Kriya Tantra Yoga*. According to this, the followers of Kriyāyoga, just like the Siddhas, lead a family life. This subtype of Kriyāyoga involves retaining the energy normally wasted during sexual activity and transporting it to the higher *cakra*s. The partner is supposed to be loved as an embodiment of the divine.

A similar system is taught by Lowenstein and Lett. This initially includes a total of twelve *āsana*s and the modern exercise set known as the five Tibetans (or Five Tibetan Rites), as well as typical *prāṇāyāma* techniques, *ujjāyī*, *kapālabhātī*, various *bandha* techniques such as *uḍḍīyānabandha* or *mahābandha*, various *mudrā* techniques such as *mahāmudrā*, *śāmbhavīmudrā*, *yonimudrā*, or the so-called *Kriya Breath*. *Kriya Breath* is referred to as *kevalakumbhaka*.

In addition, classical gymnastic exercises are also added.[552] In addition to the *āsana*s of Haṭhayoga, Lowenstein and Lett also recommends *Tai Chi*, *Qigong*, physiotherapy or a personal trainer to stay fit. Now and then, a biblical quotation is used. For example, in the case of the *Third Eye Gazing* practice, he quotes Matthew (6.22). Furthermore, Lowenstein and Lett emphasises the practice of *Hong Sau* as an important element of the practice.[553] For Nityānanda Giri, *Hong Sau*, or in this case the indologically correct transliteration *haṃsa*, is also referred to by him as *Haṃsa Sādhanā*,[554] "the very foundation" of Kriyāyoga.

As indicated at the beginning of this section, it is clear that the term Kriyāyoga has given rise to a proliferation of different yoga techniques from earlier yoga traditions, which are integrated into innovative exercise systems and whose historical legitimacy is asserted in different ways. Depending on the lineage and the teacher, individual characteristics and different explanatory models exist.[555]

One last exemplary publication is *The Kriya Yoga Upanishad and the Mystical Upanishads* (1993) by Kriyananda. This book offers translations of ten well-known *Yoga Upaniṣads* and one *Kriya Yoga Upanishad*.[556] The translator

[552] Lowenstein and Lett, 2021: 118–124. Gymnastic exercises can also be found in Sturgess, 2015: 447–458.

[553] The spelling "Hong Sau is retained here as the emic English form used in the modern Kriyāyoga literature. It corresponds to the Sanskrit mantra conventionally transliterated as *haṃsa*; the contrast between the two forms is therefore terminological and orthographic rather than doctrinal.

[554] The *ajapājapa*, recitation of the non-recitation of the *haṃsa* mantra.

[555] In these books, one repeatedly comes across pseudo-scientific explanatory models and encounters occasional parallels drawn to other religions, such as Christianity, Buddhism, or esoteric traditions to emphasise the effectiveness and importance of certain practices and views. Particularly in the more recent publications, it can be seen that, depending on the author, typically individual expressions of the ideal type of postmodern spirituality and religiosity are expressed, which Bochinger, Engelbrecht, and Gebhardt have labelled "*spiritueller Wanderer*", see Bochinger, Engelbrecht, and Gebhardt, 2009: 33–49.

[556] The non-diacriticised English forms used here, such as *Kriya Yoga Upanishad* and *Kriya Kundalini*, reproduce the emic titles and terminology of the modern source and are therefore retained as such. Sanskrit technical terms used analytically elsewhere in this study continue to follow the usual Indological transliteration.

claims that the name of the author of this Sanskrit Yoga Upaniṣad was lost in the course of history. His book has no bibliography, nor are the sources of the translations mentioned. Further searches for a verifiable source text of the *Kriya Yoga Upanishad* have remained unsuccessful. The *Kriya Yoga Upanishad* is found neither in the known publications and translations of the *Yoga Upaniṣads*,[557] nor in publications of previously unpublished Upaniṣads.[558] Searching through various catalogues of Sanskrit manuscripts was also unsuccessful.[559] Furthermore, it is striking that the *Kriya Yoga Upanishad* is not mentioned in any other publications on Kriyāyoga consulted. For the time being, therefore, the possibility must be considered that Kriyananda is not only the translator of the *Kriya Yoga Upanishad* but also the secret author. Perhaps he wrote this supposedly ancient source text in order to legitimise his own Kriyāyoga doctrine.

Goswami Kriyananda learnt Kriyāyoga from his teacher Shelly Trimmer, who, according to the official website of the *Temple of Kriya Yoga*[560] founded by Kriyananda, was a guru, yogi, kabbalist and direct disciple of Yogānanda. Kriyananda studied philosophy for four years at the University of Illinois and then embarked on a business career. Whether Kriyananda had the qualifications necessary to translate a Sanskrit source text remains to be seen. Possibly, he was a gifted autodidact.

[557] See *Yoga Upaniṣads* (1938).

[558] Cf. *Unpublished Upanishads* (1938).

[559] In *Descriptive Catalogue of Yoga Manuscripts (Updated)* (2005: 50), two manuscripts with the title *Kriyāyoga* (AGJ 665/1 and TSM 6716) are listed, which, unfortunately, I was unable to consult. Neither manuscript is dated. AGJ 665/1 (Ganganath Jha Kendriya Sanskrit Vidyapitha, Allahabad) is a Devanāgarī manuscript on paper, and TSM 6716 (Sanskrit Mss. at the Tanjore Palace) is a Telugu manuscript on palm leaf. The author of the latter is named Venkaṭayogin. I suspect these manuscripts are probably later works that were created in the 18th century at the earliest. For now, however, no definitive statement can be made on this. However, their consultation could shed further light on the historical development of Kriyāyoga.

[560] Biography of Goswami Kriyananda. Temple of Kriya Yoga Website. https://web.archive.org/web/20240319134009/https://templeofkriyayoga.org/goswami-kriyananda/. Website saved with the Way Back Machine of archive.org on 19.03.2024. Temple of Kriyayoga.

In the *Kriya Yoga Upanishad*, the disciple Sanskriti[561] asks the guru Dattatreya[562] to teach him the doctrine of Kriyāyoga. The latter agrees and explains Kriyāyoga in a total of ten chapters. The framework is formed by the eight-limbed yoga system presented in 1.5, similar to the eight limbs of the Pātañjala scheme. The first chapter (1.6–25) presents the *Ten Spiritual Restraints*. Dattatreya explains the *Ten Spiritual Observances* in the second chapter (2.1–16). Chapter three, *The Nine Postures* (3.1–13), deals with nine *āsana*s with six sitting postures, one standing posture and one complex posture. The fourth chapter (4.1–63) discusses what Kriyananda calls *Mystical Anatomy*. Here, six *cakra*s named after the planets (i.e. the *mūlādhāracakra* is called the "Saturn mass-energy converter *cakra*"), fourteen primary *nāḍī*s and *Kriya Kundalini*, which covers the 'divine creative channel' with its mouth, are taught. The fifth chapter (5.1–14) is entitled *Inner Purification* and contains *prāṇāyāma* techniques such as *sūryabhedana* and *candrabhedana*. Chapter six (6.1–39), entitled *Breath Control*, instructs another breathing exercise in combination with meditation on the three *akṣara*s that constitute the sacred syllable *auṃ*. During the inhalation (*pūraka*), the yogi is supposed to meditate on *a*, during the breath retention on *u* and during the exhalation on *ṃ*. In addition, the breathing technique *śītalī* (6.25) and a technique called *yonimudrā* (6.33–34) are presented. Chapter seven (7.1–10) is about *Withdrawal of the Senses*. The practitioner is instructed to let the breath move through the body in a specific order. The eighth chapter (8.1–9) is entitled *Concentration*. Here, the yogin is meant to inhale and hold the breath at specific bodily locations (not the *cakra*s), which are associated with the five elements and the syllables *ya, ra, va, la* and *ha*, as well as specific deities. The even shorter ninth chapter, *Meditation* (9.1–6), basically only states that the practice of concentration leads to meditation after a while. The tenth chapter, *Samadhi* (10.1–12), then describes the

[561] In the *Dattātreyayogaśāstra* Dattātreya teaches the so-called Sāṃkṛti. The contents of the *Kriya Yoga Upanishad* resemble those of the Dattātreyayogaśāstra and Yogatattvopaniṣad but are not the same. The author of this Upaniṣad may have used these two texts as a source of inspiration.

[562] The spelling *Dattatreya* is retained here because it reproduces the spelling used in the source.

final state of yoga, which is defined as the "deep conscious trance in which the yogi experiences Absolute Wisdom".

3.3.6.4 From early modern to modern models of Kriyāyoga

The *Yogasvarodaya* and Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu* were written before 1591 CE. Nārāyaṇatīrtha must have lived between 1600 and 1690 CE., and accordingly his *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* was also written in this timeframe. Sant Sundardās, the author of the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* lived from 1596 to 1689 CE. Interestingly, Nārāyaṇatīrtha and Sundardās lived in Benares.[563] The earliest quotations of the *Tattvayogabindu* are found in Sundaradeva's *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā*, who also must have lived in Benares before 1659 CE. Text-internal evidence strongly suggests that Rāmacandra, too, is to be located in northern India.[564] Thus, we can safely assume that the complex taxonomies of twelve to fifteen yogas were part of the local discourse of 16th to 17th-century Benares. Lāhiṛī Mahāśaya, the person to whom the new forms of Kriyāyoga seem to go back, lived more than a century later, from 1828 to 1895 CE. Interestingly, Lāhiṛī Mahāśaya is also said to have spent much of his life in Benares. It is, of course, utterly unclear whether Lāhiṛī Mahāśaya ever read any of the works mentioned above. His intellectual background certainly made such encounters possible. According to Chatterjee, Lāhiṛī attended an English-medium branch of the Government Sanskrit College in Benares and studied Sanskrit, the Vedas, the Upaniṣads and other scriptural texts under a Maharashtrian paṇḍita named Nagvaṭṭa.[565] The same source attributes to him yogic interpretations of twenty-six scriptures, including several Upaniṣads, the *Tantrasāra* and, importantly, the *Pātañjalayogasūtra*.[566] It is likely that the local discourse regarding the religious-spiritual marketplace within Benares did not change abruptly. Lāhiṛī Mahāśaya's status as a householder was not merely incidental to his biography but became a programmatic fea-

[563] See Burger, 2014: 684 for dating and location of Sundardās and Penna, 2004: 24 for dating and location of Nārāyaṇatīrtha.

[564] The detailed discussion of the place of origin of the *Tattvayogabindu* is found on p. 227, n. 382.

[565] Chatterjee, 2007: 26.

[566] Chatterjee, 2007: 42.

ture of the tradition associated with him. Chatterjee explicitly presents his ideal as combining family life and independent employment with sustained yogic practice and states that he adapted the rigorous techniques of earlier yoga to make *sādhanā* practicable for ordinary householders.[567] No sectarian affiliations are known, so the full range of the religious-spiritual marketplace of his time was open to him. He was able to combine them freely. As can be seen from the yoga texts examined in this book, there was no shortage of distinct yoga categories in Benares between the 16th and 19th centuries CE. Although these were still labelled differently, it is plausible that at least some practitioners combined elements from them in practice. Moreover, given the plethora of yoga practices from different traditions and texts presented in the previous chapter, the integrative character of the modern Kriyāyoga systems can now be documented more clearly in sources associated with the tradition of Lāhiṛī Mahāśaya himself. As noted above, Chatterjee presents his Kriyāyoga as a graded system combining *tālavya*, *prāṇāyāma*, *nābhikriyā*, *yonimudrā*, *mahāmudrā* and *oṃkāra-kriyā*.[568] Elsewhere, the same source explicitly characterises the requisite yogic discipline as an assemblage of Rājayoga, Haṭhayoga and Layayoga.[569] Thus, although the precise historical processes by which this system developed remain obscure, the synthesis of techniques conventionally associated with different yoga traditions appears to have been an important feature of the Kriyāyoga system attributed to Lāhiṛī Mahāśaya within his tradition.

The precise origin of the designation Kriyāyoga within this lineage cannot presently be established. Significantly, Chatterjee does not present the term as a coinage of Lāhiṛī Mahāśaya himself: in its account of his initiation, the Saṃnyāsin whom Lāhiṛī subsequently addressed as Bābājī is already said to have initiated him into Kriyāyoga.[570] This account cannot in itself establish the historical antiquity of the designation, but it cautions against interpreting the choice of the term as a demonstrably strategic decision made by Lāhiṛī himself.

[567] Chatterjee, 2007: 66–67.
[568] Chatterjee, 2007: 84–85.
[569] Chatterjee, 2007: 13.
[570] Chatterjee, 2007: 31–32.

It nevertheless remains strikingly well suited to the integrative character of the system that became associated with him. The Lāhiṛī tradition itself explicitly connects its Kriyāyoga with the *Pātañjalayogasūtra*: Chatterjee cites *Pātañjalayogasūtra* 2.1–2 in its discussion of Kriyāyoga while simultaneously describing a practice system that extends considerably beyond Patañjali's *tapas*, *svādhyāya* and *īśvarapraṇidhāna*.[571] The designation could thus provide a recognised śāstric point of reference while remaining sufficiently broad to accommodate a variety of physical and non-physical practices associated with Haṭha-, Rāja-, Laya- and tantric yoga traditions.

It remains impossible to determine whether Lāhiṛī Mahāśaya knew the *Yogasvarodaya*, *Tattvayogabindu* or *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, and no direct textual dependence on these works can presently be demonstrated. Nevertheless, the parallels are historically suggestive. These earlier works likewise place Kriyāyoga within broader classificatory systems and integrate practices drawn from a range of contemporary yogic traditions. Such continuities need not presuppose direct textual transmission; they may instead reflect longer-lived patterns of yogic synthesis within the intellectual and practical environment of northern India and, particularly, Benares.

As Birch (2020: 471–472) demonstrated in his article "*Haṭhayoga's Floruit on the Eve of Colonialism*", the popularity of medieval and early modern Haṭhayoga practices reached an unprecedented peak across India during this period. The integration of diverse yogic techniques into a comparatively open, practice-oriented system therefore accords well with this broader historical context. It can also be understood against the background of the "*identifikatorischer Habitus*" described by Axel Michaels (1998: 19–27) and Paul Hacker's (1979) concept of "Inklusivismus".[572] Whether such processes oper-

[571] Chatterjee, 2007: 114.

[572] "Inklusivismus" refers to the inclination of a religion or religious tradition to integrate other religious doctrines and practices into its own system and to view them as partial aspects of its own truth. The idea is not to see other religions as fundamentally false or opposing, but to integrate them into one's own worldview and recognise them as partially true. In the context of Hinduism, "Inklusivismus" means that different religious concepts, deities and rituals of other traditions are regarded as acceptable and valid expressions of one's own beliefs. This stance allows a variety of beliefs and practices to be harmonised and seen as complementary paths to the same ultimate truth.

ated consciously or unconsciously in Lāhiṛī Mahāśaya's case must remain open. What can be stated more securely is that the religious and intellectual environment of nineteenth-century Benares provided ample possibilities for the combination and reinterpretation of practices belonging to different yoga traditions.

3.4 Jñānayoga

JÑĀNAYOGA,[573] the "Yoga of gnosis", is the second method of Rājayoga in Rāmacandra's list of the fifteen yogas as well as in his source text, the *Yogasvarodaya*. In Nārāyaṇatīrtha's list of the fifteen yogas presented within the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Jñānayoga takes sixth place. In the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* Sundardās presents Jñānayoga as a form of Sāṃkhyayoga. Here, it is the second of the four types of Sāṃkhyayoga, alongside Brahmayoga and Advaitayoga.

3.4.1 Jñānayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu*

Jñānayoga occupies the second place in Rāmacandra's taxonomy of the fifteen yogas but is not described according to this order in his text.[574] The description is given from section XXI–XXII. The overarching goal of Rāmacandra's Jñānayoga is the long-term durability of the body (*bahutarakālaṃ śarīrasthitiḥ*) already mentioned in the introduction (section I), which is expressed here again in different words: "From the execution of this [Jñānayoga], time does not bring about the destruction of the body." (*tasya kāraṇāt kālaḥ śarīranāśaṃ na karoti*). Simultaneously, Rāmacandra's Jñānayoga leads to the attainment of the "reality of Śambhu" (*śāṃbhavī sattā*).[575] This Jñānayoga can be practised in two ways. The first method (XXI.1) arises through the application of "non-dualistic thinking" (*avikalpatayā yuktyā*), and the second method (XXI.2) arises "through the realisation that the entire world consists

[573] See section XXI and XXII on pp. 160–175

[574] The description of Jñānayoga is preceded by Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga and Mantrayoga (III–XII), Lakṣyayoga (XIII–XV), Rājayoga (XVI–XVII), Caryāyoga (XVIII) and Haṭhayoga (XIX–XX).

[575] This refers to the highest reality and the state of Rājayoga, see p. 161.

of all knowledge" (…*sarvajñānamayaṃ jagat | ya evaṃ vetti bodhena* …). The first method is only briefly mentioned, whereas the text discusses the second method in detail. The method consists of viewing the world as a unity that is enlightened by the highest self (*viśvātman*). If one perceives this unity, one finds oneself in the "reality of Śaṃbhu". However, this supreme reality is not immediately apparent since it does not show itself as the desired unity but as a tenfold multiplicity (XXI.4ab). He compares this relationship to a seed from which a whole tree with its parts grows (XXI.4–XXI.5). The seed stands for the invisible unity of world and self. The tree, with its various parts, stands for the multiplicity of the visible world. The fundamental unity of the world is like the seed from which a whole tree has grown. The original seed is no longer visible and is not perceived. However, what is perceived is a world consisting of a multiplicity. In the case of the seed, what is perceived is a tree with its branches, leaves, etc.; in the case of the world, it is a set of ten basic principles (*tattva*s): the one [the primordial source of being, the *viśvātmā*] as modifications (*vikriyā*) of five [great] elements (*pañcatattva*), thinking mind (*manas*), intellect (*buddhi*), illusion (*māya*) and individuation (*ahaṃkāra*).[576] Jñānayoga is supposed to produce the realisation of this oneness (XXI.7). In order to realise this, the practitioner is supposed to apply the view of unity (*aikyena darśanam*) to recognise the identity between the visible world of multiplicity[577], and the invisible self of the universe (*viśvātmā*). Through Jñānayoga, the practitioner then realises that the self is one with the world[578] and that the changing forms of the world's material appearance are empty.[579]

3.4.2 Jñānayoga in the *Yogasvarodaya*

If we assume a correct transmission of the *Yogasvarodaya* in the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*, then the text, in fact, describes two different types of Jñānayoga.

[576] For a discussion of the tenfold *tattva* system, see n. on p. 169

[577] This is also referred to by Rāmacandra as *saṃsāra* (XXI ll. 7–9).

[578] *Tattvayogabindu* XXII 166 l. 5: *jñānayogaprabhāvād eka eva ātmā iti niścayo bhavati* | "Because of the power of Jñānayoga, there arises the conviction that the self is truly one."

[579] *Tattvayogabindu* XXII p.168 l. 3: *jñānayogād vikārarūparahito jñāyate* | "Through Jñānayoga he realises the emptiness of the mutability of form."

The Jñānayoga of the first passage[580] contains a description of the major components of the yogic body which the yogin is supposed to know. Gaining knowledge about the body is the aim of this Jñānayoga.[581] In particular, the knowledge of the three primary channels (*nāḍī*s),[582] as well as a system with a total of nine *cakra*s is mandatory. These elements are described in detail. The introduction to this first form of Jñānayoga mentions other things the yogin should know, such as the three targets [for fixing the mind] (*lakṣya*s),[583] sixteen containers [for holding mind and often breath in the context of this type of yogic practice] (*ādhāra*s) and the five [meditative] spaces (*vyoman*s) through which the yogin progresses on the path to the highest state of yoga.

This first form of Jñānayoga in the *Yogasvarodaya*, like much of its content and its overall structure, is adopted by Rāmacandra in his *Tattvayogabindu*. Surprisingly, Rāmacandra presents the first form of Jñānayoga under a different name for unknown reasons.[584] Instead of Jñānayoga, Rāmacandra calls it Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga and Mantrayoga. We can only speculate as to why Rāmacandra made this change. Perhaps Rāmacandra did not want to teach two different forms of Jñānayoga, or he was convinced that Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga and Mantrayoga were the more appropriate terms for this type of yoga. There is also the possibility that Rāmacandra knew Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, because Nārāyaṇatīrtha classifies Jñānayoga as a form of Mantrayoga, as will be shown in the next subsection. However, apart from similarities between the complex yoga taxonomies, there are no other significant overlaps or direct citations. A detailed dis-

[580] *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*, Ed. p. 831–833.

[581] *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*, Ed. p. 831: *jñānayogam pravakṣyāmi tajjñānī śivatāṃ vrajet | paṭhanāt smaraṇād vyānān maṇḍanāt brahmasādhakaḥ | tadbhedasyaikasandhānam aṣṭaiśvaryamayo bhavet | tritīrthaṃ yatra nāḍī ca tripuṇyaṃ parameśvari | svadehe yo na jānāti sa yogī nāmadhārakaḥ | navacakraṃ kalādhāraṃ trilakṣaṃ vyomapañcakam | svadehe yo na jānāti sa yogī nāmadhārakaḥ |*

[582] The left lunar channel (*iḍā*), the right solar channel (*piṅgalā*) and the central channel (*suṣumṇā*).

[583] In the sections on Lakṣyayoga in the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Tattvayogabindu* five targets (*lakṣya*s) are described in total. This is one of many inconsistencies in the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Yogattvabindu*.

[584] Perhaps, the designation *jñānayoga* in this context is a result of textual corruption, as the second Jñānayoga presented later in the text accords much more closely with the designation. However, without further textual evidence, this remains unproven.

cussion of Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga and Mantrayoga in Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu* can be found on p. 436.

The second type of Jñānayoga of the *Yogasvarodaya*[585] is largely identical with Rāmacandra's Jñānayoga. Rāmacandra borrows most of the verses verbatim from the *Yogasvarodaya*. There are minor details that Rāmacandra modifies, but they do not change the overall concept and aim of this type of Jñānayoga. For this reason, the description will not be repeated here. The passage is reproduced in its entirety in the first layer of the critical apparatus in section XXI on p. 160 of the critical edition of the *Tattvayogabindu* and can be consulted there.

3.4.3 Jñānayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

Nārāyaṇatīrtha situates his Jñānayoga [586] in relation to *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*'s *sūtra* 1.28, which says:

> *tajjapas tadarthabhāvanam* ‖ 28 ‖
>
> It's muttering; manifesting its meaning.

This is the last *sūtra* of an extensive section (1.23–28) in the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*,[587] which is entirely devoted to one of the means of attaining *samādhi*, namely *īśvarapraṇidhāna*, devotion to Īśvara, the Supreme Lord.

Īśvara is most aptly represented by the sacred syllable *oṃ*. The above *sūtra* instructs the quiet murmuring of this syllable while contemplating its meaning (*tadarthabhāvanam*) as a practical method of *īśvarapraṇidhāna* to attain the highest state of yoga, which is called Rājayoga or *asaṃprajñātasamādhi*.

In this *sūtra*, Nārāyaṇatīrtha takes *japa* ("muttering") to denote Mantrayoga, while *arthabhāvanā* ("manifesting its meaning") is linked to

[585] *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*, Ed. p. 835–837.

[586] For an earlier brief discussion of Jñānayoga in Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* see Penna, 2004: 76.

[587] An entire monograph entitled *God, Reason, and Yoga: A Critical Edition and Translation of the Commentary Ascribed to Śaṅkara on Pātañjalayogaśāstra 1.23—28* is dedicated to this section by Harimoto (2014). It provides an edition, translation and detailed discussion of this critical passage in the *Pātañjalayogaśāstravivaraṇa*.

Jñānayoga, understood as the cultivation of discriminative knowledge (see previous paragraph). He further extends the interpretation by associating the same *sūtra* with Advaitayoga, which is grounded in the non-dualistic realization of the identity of the individual and the supreme self. The *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 46) reads:

> *kiñ ca japa ity anena mantrayogaḥ arthabhāvanam ity anena viveka-jñānābhyāsarūpo jñānayogaḥ abhedabhāvarūpo 'dvaitayogaś ca saṃgṛhītaḥ* |
>
> Furthermore, by [the term] *japa* the practice of Mantrayoga [is indicated]; by [the term] *arthabhavana*, the cultivation of discriminative knowledge [is meant], which is the form of practice [called] Jñānayoga, [and] Advaitayoga is understood to be the form of cultivating non-differentiation.

Nārāyaṇatīrtha, thus, offers two alternatives about the specific performance of the contemplation. Either, while quietly murmuring the *praṇava* syllable, which symbolises Īśvara and his qualities, the mind shall be focused on the distinction between consciousness (*puruṣa*) and primordial nature (*prakṛti*) including its effects (*tatkārya*).[588] This is Nārāyaṇatīrtha's Jñānayoga. Alternatively, one is supposed to reflect on the non-difference between the highest self (*paramātman*) and the individual self (*jīva*).[589] This is Nārāyaṇatīrtha's Advaitayoga.

3.4.4 Jñānayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

The Jñānayoga of Dādūpanthī Sundardās (*Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 4.13–24) is strikingly similar to the Jñānayoga of Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu* and

[588] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 45): *tasya praṇavasya japaḥ vidhivad uccāraṇaṃ, tadarthasya praṇavārthasya acintyaiśvaryaśaktiyuktasya paramātmano bhāvanaṃ prakṛtitatkāryapuruṣebhyo vivekenānusaṃdhānam* ..."The low-voice muttering of *praṇava* [and] pronunciation according to the rules [along with] the contemplation of the meaning of that *praṇava*, [being associated with] the Supreme Self endowed with inconceivable power and supremacy, is the fixation of the attention with discernment from the individual self and nature with its effects."

[589] Ibid. (Ed. p. 45): *athavā tadarthasya paramātmanaḥ pūrṇasya bhāvanaṃ jīvābhedena punaḥ punaś cetasi niveśanam* | "Alternatively, its meaning is the repeated memorization in the mind of the non-distinction between the individual self and the total supreme self."

the *Yogasvarodaya*. Jñānayoga is the first subcategory of Sāṃkhyayoga.[590] Brahmayoga[591] and Advaitayoga[592] follow it. While Sundardās introduces Sāṃkhyayoga to teach how to distinguish the self (*ātman*) from the not-self (*anātman*) by differentiating twenty-four *tattva*s of the world, Jñānayoga goes a step further and conveys the gnosis (*jñāna*) that the world and the self nevertheless form an inseparable unity. As a result of this gnosis, Brahmayoga arises. Brahmayoga is a specific form of contemplation or state in which the yogin experiences himself as one with the Absolute and the entire universe within himself. Finally, this sequence culminates in Advaitayoga, by which the practitioner finally overcomes the state of duality and conceptualisation. Jñānayoga is the second step of the four-stage Sāṃkhyayoga.

This Jñānayoga emphasises the recognition of the unity of the self and the universe.[593] According to Sundardās, the self is the cause, and the whole universe is the effect.[594] To illustrate the relationship of cause and effect between self and universe, Sundardās presents the same metaphor of the seed and the tree as Rāmacandra in *Tattvayogabindu* XXI.4–5.[595] The rest of the section consists of different comparisons, which are supposed to illustrate the non-difference between the self and the whole or the universe.[596]

[590] Sundardās' Sāṃkhyayoga is discussed on p. 474.

[591] Sundardās' Brahmayoga is discussed on p. 428.

[592] Sundardās' Advaitayoga is discussed on p. 432.

[593] See Burger (2014: 702) for an earlier brief discussion of Sundardās's Jñānayoga in French.

[594] *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 4.13: *jñāna yoga aba esaiṃ jānaiṃ | kāraṇa aru kāraya pahicānaiṃ | kāraṇa ātama āhi akhāṃḍā | kāraya bhayau sakala brahmaṇḍā* ‖ 13 ‖ "Now understand Jñānayoga. Recognise the cause and effect. The cause is the indivisible soul. The effect is the whole universe."

[595] *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 4.14: *jyauṃ aṃkuru teṃ taru vistārā | bahuta bhāṃti kari nikasī ḍārā | śāṣā patra aura pharaphulā | yauṃ ātamā viśva kau mūlā* ‖ 14 ‖ "Just as the tree [grows] out of the seed, bringing forth countless branches, leaves, fruits and flowers, in the same way the self is the root of the universe."

[596] For example *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 4.20: *jyauṃ kuñcana ke bhūṣana nānā | bhinna bhinna kari nāṃva baṣaṇā | gāre sarba eka hi huvā | yaiṃ ātamā biśva nahiṃ juvā* ‖ 20 ‖ "Just like various ornaments made of gold, are worn with different names and forms. However, in essence, all become one in the melting pot. In the same way, the self is not separate from the universe."

3.4.5 Jñānayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Jñānayoga within the intricate and multifaceted texts of the early modern yoga taxonomies identifies four distinct models of Jñānayoga. These models circulated at least among the yoga traditions that were present in the North Indian subcontinent during the 16th and 17th centuries CE.

1. The dominant model is the application of non-dualistic thinking, leading to the perception of the unity of self and world, found in the *Tattvayogabindu*, *Yogasvarodaya*, and *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*. The first two classify Jñānayoga under Rājayoga, while the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* places it under Sāṃkhyayoga.
2. By contrast, Nārāyaṇatīrtha's Yogasiddhāntacandrikā treats Jñānayoga as a form of Mantrayoga, involving *praṇavajapa* and contemplation of the distinction between *puruṣa* and *prakṛti* (and its effects).
3. The *Tattvayogabindu* briefly mentions a second model, defining Jñānayoga as contemplation on the world as consisting of all knowledge, though without further detail.
4. The *Yogasvarodaya* presents another type: Jñānayoga as knowledge of the yogic body—its three channels and paradigms (*lakṣya*s, *ādhāra*s, *cakra*s, and *vyoman*s).

3.5 Caryāyoga

Caryāyoga, "the Yoga of conduct" occupies third place among Rāmacandra's methods of Rājayoga. However, it is entirely absent from the extant transmission of the *Yogasvarodaya*. Nevertheless, Caryāyoga is mentioned as the second method in Nārāyaṇatīrtha's fifteen yogas. It is absent in Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*. Yet, Sundardās describes a yoga with the near-homophonous name Carcāyoga. Sundardās's Carcāyoga is considered the fourth and final method of his Bhaktiyoga after Mantrayoga and Layayoga.

3.5.1 Caryāyoga in the *Tattvayogabindu*

Rāmacandra keeps the section on Caryāyoga (section XVIII) extremely short, with only eight prose sentences. After characterising the self as "formless, permanent, immovable and indivisible," Rāmacandra states that by stabilising the mind in such a self, the self does not come into contact with sin and merit. When the mind is absorbed into the formless [self], this is Caryāyoga. That is all that Rāmacandra has to say on this subject. The brevity of the passage and the fact that the testimony of the *Yogasvarodaya* does not contain this form of yoga, but Rāmacandra clearly constructs its description on the basis of a passage on Rājayoga in the *Yogasvarodaya*,[597] suggests that Rāmacandra did not understand Caryāyoga and merely wanted to do justice to his taxonomy mentioned at the beginning of his text.[598] It is puzzling why this particular yoga with this particular description bears the name Caryāyoga. The apparent association of the first four yogas in Rāmacandra's and *Yogasvarodaya*'s list with the four *pāda*s of some Śaiva Āgamas (*kriyā-*, *jñāna-*, *caryā-* and *yogapāda*) does not offer a convincing solution in this case, as *caryā°* in this context has nothing to do with the original ritual discipline or day-to-day conduct of the śaivite practices, as would be the case in the *caryāpāda*s of the Śaiva Āgamas. It seems, therefore, unlikely that any yoga practitioners at the time practised Caryāyoga in the form described by Rāmacandra.

3.5.2 Caryāyoga in the *Yogasvarodaya*

The term Caryāyoga does not appear in the sources of the *Yogasvarodaya*, namely the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* and *Yogakarṇikā*. Thus, the term is absent from its yoga taxonomy.[599] Although the verses postulate a total of fifteen yogas, only eight are mentioned. Whether Caryāyoga is one of the seven unnamed ones is unclear. However, its presence in the taxonomies of the *Tattvayo-*

[597] Cf. *Tattvayogabindu* XVIII, p. 154

[598] One could argue that Rāmacandra may not have done so, since not all fifteen yogas announced at the beginning are described in the course of his text anyway. I suspect that this may nevertheless have been his original intention but that Rāmacandra discarded this intention while writing his text, perhaps due to inconsistencies in his source text.

[599] *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*, Ed. p. 831.

gabindu[600] and the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*[601] would support this possibility. For this reason, Caryāyoga was possibly a member of the *Yogasvarodaya*'s fifteen-fold yoga taxonomy. The original appearance and structure of the *Yogasvarodaya* remain conjectural. While it almost appears that the entirety of the *Yogasvarodaya* has been preserved in the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*, the *Yogakarṇikā* includes several verses attributed to the *Yogasvarodaya* not found in the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*.[602] Hence, it is plausible that the text was more extensive and may have included a transmission of Caryāyoga.

The *Yogakarṇikā* provides detailed descriptions of daily ritual conduct for the yoga practitioner under the heading *dinacaryā* ("daily conduct") in verses 1.23–61. It is notable that for a significant portion of the first chapter (1.1–168), the source(s) of the verses are not indicated, which is surprising given that the remainder of the first chapter and all other chapters of the text primarily consist of compilations of verses from other texts on typical yogic topics quoted with reference. Thus, throughout the *Yogakarṇikā*, larger sections of the *Yogasvarodaya* are repeatedly, though not always, quoted with attribution. Is it possible that Nāth Aghorānanda, the compiler of the *Yogakarṇikā*, also drew on verses from the *Yogasvarodaya* here?

In the second part of the first chapter of the *Yogakarṇikā* (verses 1.169–280), 37 verses (1.244–280) are quoted from the *Yogasvarodaya* with reference, alongside at least four verses (1.210–213) of the *Yogasvarodaya* without reference.[603]

The possibility of further verses from the *Yogasvarodaya* within the first 168 verses of the *Yogakarṇikā* cannot be resolved definitively without a close examination of manuscripts of the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Yogakarṇikā*. However, one plausible scenario is that the original Caryāyoga within the taxonomy of the fifteen yogas of the *Yogasvarodaya* resembled the content of the *dinacaryā* section of the *Yogakarṇikā*. This section delineates daily ritual ablutions,

[600] *Tattvayogabindu* I. ll. 1–4.

[601] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Ed. p. 2.

[602] It is striking that Rāmacandra's rewriting of his source texts is based almost exclusively on the verses of the *Yogasvarodaya* quoted by the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*. Is it possible that this was the very recension that Rāmacandra used for his *Tattvayogabindu*? Or, was he even the creator of this very recension found in the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*?

[603] The verses lacking attribution were identified as originating from the *Yogasvarodaya* due to their presence in the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī*.

mantra recitation, visualisation, and meditation (1.23–36), as well as other ritual acts such as dressing, applying sectarian markings (*tilaka*), including tying the hair into a knot (1.38), offerings, and the devotional performance of prostrations in front of one's own *iṣṭadevatā* (1.39–61). Since these acts form part of a daily yogic routine, presenting them as a yogic discipline would seem natural.[604]

[604] As discussed in more detail on p. 415, the *Śivayogapradīpikā* contains numerous similarities in content with the *Tattvayogabindu*, the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*. With ten yogas described in total, the *Śivayogapradīpikā* even comes very close to the numbers of yogas within the late medieval yoga taxonomies. These parallels strongly suggest a close connection in terms of reception history. There may not be a direct connection, but all these texts likely drew on the same intertextual network when compiling their own texts. In his dissertation on the *Śivayogapradīpikā*, Powell (2023: 115) presents excerpts from a translation of a Kannada commentary on the *Śivayogapradīpikā* (*ṭike*) by the commentator Basavārādhya. Basavārādhya precedes his commentary with the following praise of the author of the *Śivayogapradīpikā*:

> "The *ācārya* called Cennasadāśivayogisadāśivayogīśvara, who was skilled in the *jñāna*, *kriyā*, *caryā* and *yoga* [*pāda*s] of the Śivāgamas, which are the means of personal liberation, who had the intellect capable of grasping the Veda and Vedānta, who was not caught up in the confusion of the many Śāstras such as the Sāṃkhya and Pātañjala, who was accomplished in the eternal true yoga, who could visualise the many worlds such as *bindu* and *nāda* in the middle of his body (*piṇḍa*), who was an expert in *mantra*, whose mind was absorbed in *laya*, who was devoted to *haṭha*, who was worthy of worship in Rājayoga, who was an expert practitioner and who was knowledgeable in many branches of learning such as Tāraka and the teachings on Brahman (*brahmopadeśa*), engaging in creating the Yogaśāstra called the *Śivayogapradīpikā* in order to illuminate the inner soul of those desirous of liberation."

This eulogy not only suggests the great variety of different yoga teachings of the *Śivayogapradīpikā*, but also confirms that authors such as Cennasadāśivayogin were familiar with Śaiva Āgamic traditions within this intertextual network, which also influenced the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Tattvayogabindu*. This strengthens the possibility that the first three yogas in the fifteenfold taxonomy were shaped by the familiar Śaiva categories of *jñāna*, *kriyā*, and *caryā*, without necessarily presupposing dependence on a fixed four-*pāda* textual structure. It also supports the hypothesis that the original Caryāyoga referred to a form of yoga that included day-to-day ritual conduct.

3.5.3 Caryāyoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

In his *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*[605], Nārāyaṇatīrtha presents Caryāyoga[606] in the context of Yogasūtra 1.33:[607]

> *tasya cittasyāsūyādimalavato yogāsambhavāt tannirāsopāyaṃ caryāyogam āha—maitrīkaruṇāmuditopekṣāṇāṃ sukhaduḥkhapuṇyāpuṇyaviṣayāṇāṃ bhāvanātaś cittaprasādanam* ‖ 33 ‖
>
> Because Yoga is impossible for that mind which possesses defilements such as envy, [the text] said the means of eliminating that is Caryāyoga —
> Calming of the mind arises through the cultivation of friendliness, compassion, joy and equanimity in circumstances of happiness, suffering, virtue and vice.

Caryāyoga consists in cultivating kindness towards those in fortunate circumstances to prevent jealousy. Towards those who are in sorrowful circumstances, compassion is supposed to be cultivated to prevent ill-will. Towards those who act virtuously, one is supposed to cultivate joy to prevent aversion; and towards those who act unvirtuously, one is supposed to cultivate equanimity to prevent anger.[608]

Through this practice of Caryāyoga, which gradually purifies the mind, the sattvic nature of the mind is brought forth. This leads to a clear and serene mind.[609]

Since the word *caryā°* in this context refers to purposeful behaviour designed to give rise to the sattvic nature of the mind, the Caryāyoga of the

[605] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Ed. pp. 2, 52–53, 100–101, 150.

[606] For an earlier brief discussion of Caryāyoga in Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* see Penna, 2004: 66–67.

[607] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Ed. p. 52.

[608] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 52): *tathā ca sukhiteṣu maitrīṃ sauhārdam īrṣyākāluṣyanivarttakaṃ, duḥkhiṣu karuṇāṃ dayāmasūyākāluṣyanivarttikāṃ, puṇyavṛttiṣu harṣaṃ dveṣanivarttakam, apuṇyaśabditapāpiṣu upekṣām amarṣakāluṣyanivarttikāṃ bhāvayet* |

[609] Ibid. (Ed. pp. 52–53): *tad evaṃ caryāyogena cittamalanirāsakena mukhyādiṣu yathākramamuktabhāvanārūpeṇa sāttviko dharmo jāyate | tena ca śuklena dharmeṇa cittaṃ prasannaṃ bhavati | prasāde ca sthitipadaṃ labhate | etac ca puṣkalaṃ viraktasyaiva sambhavatīti mukhyacaryāyogo vairāgyameveti saṃkṣepaḥ* ‖ 33 ‖

Yogasiddhāntacandrikā can be meaningfully translated as "Yoga of [beneficial] behaviour".

3.5.4 Carcāyoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

Within *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* (2.40–51), Sundardās describes Carcāyoga as one of the three subtypes of Bhaktiyoga, understood here as devotion towards unmanifest consciousness (*avyakta puruṣa*) in delightful devotion.[610] He extensively describes the unmanifest consciousness (*avyakta puruṣa*) as being formless and eternal and so on (40), as beginningless and endless, and so on (41). Next, Sundardās describes the various layers of creation emanating from *oṃ* (42–45). He says the unmanifest consciousness illuminates every corner of existence (46), being the inner knower of all (47). Then, Sundardās expresses the importance of deep awe towards the infinite, divine, all-knowing and incomprehensible (48–49) unmanifest consciousness.

The entire passage on Carcāyoga is characterised by a discussion and description of the unmanifest consciousness (*avyakta puruṣa*). This aspect is the core of this type of yoga. The unlimited, unmanifest consciousness can only be expressed in limiting words, and yet the practitioner is confronted with the question of how it is supposed to be defined and determined.[611] And this is precisely the practice of Carcāyoga. The term *carcā°* here refers to "discussing" or "putting into words" and emphasising individual details of unmanifest consciousness to generate deep reverence for the cultivation of Bhaktiyoga, the yoga of devotional worship of *avyakta puruṣa*. *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 2.47 illustrates this:

> *carcā karauṃ kahāṃ laga svāmī | tum saba hī ke antarjāmī |*
> *sṛṣṭi kahat kachu anta na āvai | terā pāra kaiṃna dhaiṃ pāvai ‖ 47 ‖*
>
> To what extent can I describe you [in words], O Lord? You are the inner knower of everything. There is no end to describing creation. Your limit cannot be reached by any means.

[610] See Burger (2014: 694–695) for an earlier brief discussion of Sundardās's Carcāyoga in French.

[611] *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 2.41ab: *avyakta puruṣa agama apārā | kaisaiṃ kai kariye nirddhārā |*

Thus, it is clear that no direct conceptual connection exists between the Caryāyogas described above and Carcāyoga. A meaningful explanation for the conspicuous homophony of both terms cannot be offered for the time being. However, the term raises the possibility that Sundardās may have constructed this yoga in response to the term Caryāyoga, which would suggest that he was aware of other complex yoga taxonomies.

3.5.5 Caryāyoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Caryāyoga within the intricate and multifaceted texts of early modern yoga taxonomies reveals two distinct models. Additionally, the initial question regarding any connection between Caryāyogas and Carcāyoga was addressed, and a hypothesis was formulated on the original form of Caryāyoga.

In the *Tattvayogabindu*, Caryāyoga is described as stabilising the mind in the self. This rather banal description was likely an attempt to define Caryāyoga as mentioned in the initial list. It is possible that Rāmacandra formulated this description without having access to a clearly defined model of Caryāyoga, as it seems to be derived from a description of Rājayoga in his source text. At present, there is no evidence that this form of Caryāyoga had any existence outside Rāmacandra's text.

Caryāyoga is absent from the testimony of the *Yogasvarodaya* and is not listed therein. However, the *Yogakarṇikā*, which extensively quotes the *Yogasvarodaya*, provides circumstantial support for the possibility that the original Caryāyoga was closely related to the practices within the *caryāpāda*s of the Śaiva Āgamas, and thus consisted of daily ritual conduct as part of the yogic routine.

Furthermore, the comparison of Caryāyoga with Carcāyoga in Sundardās's work shows that, beyond their assonant similarity, the two are entirely unrelated. In this context, Carcāyoga represents the final method of Bhaktiyoga, which aims to articulate the unmanifest consciousness in order to generate the profound awe necessary for progress on the yogic path, as presented by Sundardās in his *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*.

3.6 Haṭhayoga

HAṬHAYOGA, "the Yoga of force", appears without exception in all complex late medieval yoga taxonomies. In the taxonomies with fifteen yogas of the *Tattvayogabindu*, the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, it occupies the fourth position. In the yoga taxonomy of Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, it is the second main type of Yoga. Here, Haṭhayoga is a category in itself and the superordinate category for the three subsequent Yogas described by Sundardās, namely Rāja, Lakṣa and Aṣṭāṅgayoga which are all considered to be methods of Haṭhayoga.

3.6.1 Haṭhayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*

Both texts consider Haṭhayoga as another method of Rājayoga. In section XIX–XX of the *Tattvayogabindu*, two categories of Haṭhayoga are distinguished. Both are based on the explanations of the *Yogasvarodaya*, differ only slightly in formulation, and can, therefore, be considered together.[612] Both passages in these two texts are characterised by their brevity.

The first type of Haṭhayoga described teaches the control of the breath through exhalation (*recaka*), inhalation (*pūraka*) and breath retention (*kumbhaka*) etc. With the term "etc." (°*ādi*°), the text probably indicates other known practices of *Haṭhayoga*. In addition to other breathing exercises, this could also refer to the other known basic building blocks of Haṭhayoga, which have been associated with Haṭhayoga since Svātmarāma's *Haṭhapradīpikā*: *āsana*, *mudrā* and *nādānusandhāna*. Both texts mention the six actions that purify the body (*ṣaṭkarma*) next. Then Rāmacandra states that when the full breath dwells within the solar channel (*sūryanāḍi*), the mind becomes immobile. Through the immobility of the mind, bliss arises, and the mind is absorbed into emptiness (*śūnya*). The resulting state leads to the delay of the time of death (*kālaḥ samīpe nāgachati*). The naming of the sun channel is striking in this context. The *Yogasvarodaya* is no concrete help here, as it merely speaks

[612] See *Prāṇatoṣinī* (Ed. p. 835) and *Śabdakalpadruma* (Ed. p. 501). These passages contain quotations from the *Yogasvarodaya* of both types of Haṭhayoga. See also *Yogakarṇikā* 12.23–26. Here, verses of the second category of Haṭhayoga are reproduced

of an unspecified *nāḍī*,[613] in which, triggered by the preceding practice, the fullness of breath is established.[614] In most Haṭhayoga texts, the state of "immobility of the mind" characteristic of *samādhi* is linked to the central channel *suṣūmnā*, not to the sun-associated right channel *piṅgalā*. *Samādhi* generally occurs when the breath enters the central channel.[615] Either the term *sūryanāḍi* is to be understood here as an unfortunate synonym,[616] or the text is corrupt.[617] Another possibility would be to assume a practice associated with the *piṅgalā* channel. This could be the best understanding of the term since *sūryanāḍī* is found in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, a text that also served as a model for Rāmacandra. Here, it is explicitly associated with the *piṅgalā* channel.[618]

The second type of Haṭhayoga in *Tattvayogabindu* instructs the yogin to contemplate a non-specific form (*kiṃcidrūpā*) in the colours white, yellow, blue and red equal to the radiance of ten million suns in one's own body from head to toe. This is supposed to burn away all diseases of the body and prolong life. In the *Yogasvarodaya*, there is no mention of an unspecific form. Instead, these colours and the sun's radiance are meant to be contemplated in the area of the tip of the nose.[619] Rāmacandra and the *Yogasvarodaya* describe

[613] Since the YSv mentions no specific *nāḍī*, it is likely that it is the *nāḍī par excellance*, the *suṣūmnā*

[614] Cf. *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 835): *etan nāḍyān tu deveśi vāyupūrṇaṃ pratiṣṭhitam | tato mano niścalaṃ syāt tata ānanda eva hi |*

[615] This is already evident, for example, in the oldest written testimony of the Haṭhyoga genre, the *Amṛtasiddhi* 26.1–2: *yo 'sau siddhimayo vāyur madhyamāpadaniścalaḥ | tadānandamayaṃ cittam ekarūpaṃ nabhaḥsamam ‖* 26.1 *‖ yadānandamayaṃ cittaṃ bāhyakleśāvivarjitam | bhavaduḥkhāni saṃhṛtya samādhir jāyate tadā ‖* 26.2 ‖ Mallinson and Szántó translate: (1) "When Breath is perfected and fixed in the place of the Goddess of the Centre, then consciousness has the nature of bliss, uniform like the sky." (2) "When consciousness has the nature of bliss, free from external afflictions, then, having the sorrows of existence, Samādhi arises." This idea, which can be found in this genre from the 11th century at the latest, subsequently permeates the entire genre.

[616] In the sense of being ambiguous and overlapping with the *piṅgalā* channel.

[617] A conjecture of *sūryanāḍī* to *śūnyanāḍī* would be obvious. In *Jyotsnā* 4.10, Brahmānanda understands "the void" (*śūnya*) as the central channel. In *Haṭhapradīpikā* 3.4, *śūnyapādavī* is a synonym of *suṣumnā*.

[618] *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.5: *pañcamaṃ kaṇṭhacakraṃ caturaṅgulaṃ tatra vāme iḍā candranāḍī dakṣiṇe piṅgalā sūryanāḍī tanmadhye suṣumnāṃ dhyāyet saivānāhatakalā anāhatasiddhir bhavati |*

[619] *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 835): *ākāśe nāsikāgre tu sūryakoṭisamaṃ smaret | śvetaṃ raktaṃ tathā pītaṃ kṛṣṇam ityādirūpataḥ |*

the second type of Haṭhayoga so briefly and vaguely that the reader is denied a clearer picture. It should be noted at this point that the formulation is very reminiscent of Bāhyalakṣya's explanations in section XXIII.[620] Interestingly, in Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, Lakṣ(y)ayoga is a subcategory, i.e. a partial practice, of Haṭhayoga. Is this hinting the source for this differentiation? Further parallels to practices of other texts of Haṭhayoga involving coloured or non-coloured light exist but are still conceptually too distant to convincingly assign Rāmacandra's second type,[621] and thus remain enigmatic for the time being.

3.6.2 Haṭhayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

In the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, the discussion and description of Nārāyaṇatīrtha's Haṭhayoga is spread over several *sūtra*s of the first two chapters, the *samādhipāda* (1.34) and the *sādhanapāda* (2.46–52). The commentary by Nārāyaṇatīrtha is particularly extensive and detailed here.[622]

Initially, Nārāyaṇatīrtha locates Haṭhayoga in the context of *sūtra* 1.34. This *sūtra* is one of several options (1.32–40) that can be applied to overcome the distractions described in *sūtra*s 1.30–31, which hinder the attainment of the final state of yoga (*asaṃprajnātasamādhi*, *nirbījasamādhi*, or *kaivalya*):[623]

> *pracchardanavidhāraṇābhyāṃ vā prāṇasya* ‖ 34 ‖
>
> Or, through exhaling and restraining of the breath.

This method serves to establish a clear mind and is referred to by Nārāyaṇatīrtha as Haṭhayoga. He explains that *pracchardana* denotes the slow outward emptying of the abdominal breath through one nostril in measured quantities.[624] *Vidhāraṇa* is the continuous external retention of

[620] Cf. p. 174.

[621] See p. 175 for the parallel passages.

[622] For an earlier, short discussion of Haṭhayoga in Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* see Penna, 2004: 76.

[623] This final state of yoga is called *rājayoga* by Nārāyaṇatīrtha.

[624] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* 1.34 (Ed. p. 53): *kauṣṭhyasya vāyoḥ pracchardanam, ekataranāsāpuṭena mātrāpramāṇena śanaiḥ śanair bahir niḥsāraṇam* |

exhaled air.[625] Nārāyaṇatīrtha identifies this form of breath retention as *recitakumbhaka*, the first of seven *kumbhaka*s (*saptakumbhaka*), considered particularly praiseworthy due to its minimal restrictions. The group—*recita*, *pūrita*, *śānta*, *pratyāhāra*, *uttara*, *adhāra*, and *sama*—is elaborated later in the second chapter within the discussion of *prāṇāyāma* (2.49–53), where seven of the eight *kumbhaka*s of the *Haṭhapradīpikā* are also addressed.[626]

According to Nārāyaṇatīrtha, mastery of the breath is inseparable from mastery of the mind. Additionally, *prāṇāyāma* has the power to eradicate all sins, which in turn enables the mind to focus and remain steady on a chosen meditative object (*lakṣya*).[627]

Finally, Nārāyaṇatīrtha authenticates the linking of *prāṇāyāma* and Haṭhayoga (*prāṇāyāmasya haṭhayogatvam uktaṃ smṛtau*) with the famous verse of the *Yogabīja* (148cd–149ab), in which the syllable "*ha*" is linked to the sun and the syllable "*ṭha*" to the moon. Thus, he understands the term *haṭha* as the union of sun and moon.[628]

The next section of the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, addressing aspects of Haṭhayoga, appears in the context of the third limb of *aṣṭāṅgayoga*, beginning with *sūtra* 2.46.

> *itaḥ paraṃ sakalarogādinivṛttidvārā haṭhayogasyopāyam āsanam āha—*
> *sthirasukham āsanam* ‖ 46 ‖
>
> Hereafter, posture, being the means of Haṭhayoga, is said to be the gateway to preventing all diseases etc.
> A comfortable and steady position.

[625] Ibid. 1.34 (Ed. p. 53): *vidhāraṇaṃ recitasya vāyor bahir eva sthāpanaṃ kumbhakaṃ* |

[626] Ibid. 1.34 (Ed. p. 53): *tathā cātra pūrakavarjanād recitapūritaśāntapratyāhārottarādhārasamabhedena saptakumbhakeṣu madhye recitakumbhako 'yaṃ prathamābhyāse 'nekaniyamānapekṣatayā praśastaḥ* | *sarvam etad agre prāṇāyāmaprakaraṇe sphuṭībhaviṣyati* |

[627] Ibid. 1.34 (Ed. p. 53): *tad etābhyāṃ prāṇajaye cittajayas tayor avinābhāvāt prāṇāyāmasya sarvapāpanāśakatvāt pāpanivṛttyā ca cittam ekatra lakṣye sthiraṃ bhavati* |

[628] Ibid. 1.34 (Ed. p. 53): *hakāreṇa tu sūryo 'sau ṭhakāreṇendur ucyate* | *sūryācandramasor aikyaṃ haṭha ity abhidhīyate* ‖ The context suggests here, that Nārāyaṇatīrtha associates the sun and moon with the *piṅgalānāḍī* (representing the sun) and *iḍānāḍī* (representing the moon). Their union would then be the inhalation through these channels with a subsequent breath retention.

In his commentary Nārāyaṇatīrtha presents various *āsana*s. Of a total of 84 *āsana*s, he describes 38 in detail. Birch (2018) observed[629] that Nārāyaṇatīrtha's descriptions of the *āsana*s were borrowed from earlier yoga texts, such as the *Haṭhapradīpikā* (which Nārāyaṇatīrtha refers to as *Yogapradīpa*), the *Vasiṣṭhasaṃhitā* and the *Dharmaputrikā*.[630,631] In 2.47–48, Nārāyaṇatīrtha provides further details on the execution of the yoga postures, which will not be elaborated upon here.[632]

Of greater significance for understanding Nārāyaṇatīrtha's Haṭhayoga are 2.49–51. Beyond a detailed discussion of the three basic elements of *prāṇāyāma*—exhalation (*recaka*), inhalation (*pūraka*), and breath retention (*kumbhaka*)—and their specifics in the commentary to 2.49–50, he then addresses *kevalakumbhaka* in 2.51, the fourth aspect of *prāṇāyāma* and the ultimate goal of breath retention.[633,634] This *kevalakumbhaka* is attained through a gradual process, advancing subtly from the practice of ordinary *kumbhaka*, specified as *sahitakumbhaka*.[635] *Kevalakumbhaka* arises only when the bodily channels have been purified through practice and the movements of inhalation and exhalation have completely ceased. It may be aptly translated as "isolated breath retention," since it is independent of inhalation

[629] See Birch, 2018: 105, n. 9.

[630] A list of the 38 of 84 *āsana*s can be found in *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* 2.46 (Ed. p. 107–108): *tac ca padma-siddha-bhadra-vīra-svastika-siṃha-daṇḍa-sopāśraya-paryaṅka-mayūra-kukkuṭa-uttānakukkuṭa-paścimatāna-matsyendrapīṭha-cakra-gomukha-karma-dhanu-mṛgasvastika-arddhacandra-añjalika-pīṭha-vajra-mukta-candra-arddhaprasāritaśava-kapāla-garuḍa-arddhāsana-kamala-krauñcaniṣadana-hastiniṣadana-uṣṭraniṣadanakapiniṣadana-yogāsana-yonyāsana-samasthāna-ādibhedena caturāśītiprakāram | eteṣāṃ lakṣaṇāni yogapradīpādāv uktāni |* The detailed descriptions of the 38 *āsana*s immediately follows on pp. 108–114.

[631] Penna (2004: 207–209) has briefly discussed the *āsana*s of the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*.

[632] A detailed sketch of the *prāṇāyāma*-system of Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* can be found in Penna, 2004: 209–18.

[633] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* 1.34 (Ed. p. 116): *asya ca lakṣaṇaṃ yājñavalkya āha—recakaṃ pūrakaṃ tyaktvā yat sukhaṃ vāyudhāraṇam | prāṇāyāmo 'yam ity uktaḥ sa vai kevalakumbhakaḥ ‖* "Yājñavalkya declares its characteristic as follows—Having abandoned inhalation and exhalation, that comfortable restraint of breath is breath-control. This indeed is indeed taught as 'isolated retention'."

[634] See *Haṭhapradīpikā* 2.72–80 for the *locus classicus* of all descriptions of *kevalakumbhaka*.

[635] This *kumbhaka* is "accompanied" (*sahita*) because, unlike *kevalakumbhaka*, it still involves inhalation and exhalation, cf. *Haṭhapradīpikā* 2.73.

and exhalation.[636] The yogin who masters *kevalakumbhaka* can hold the breath for an indefinite period.[637] Nārāyaṇatīrtha quotes seven of the eight *kumbhaka*s[638] of *Haṭhapradīpikā* (except *plāvanī*, cf. *Haṭhapradīpikā* 2.71).[639] Next, he explains the other seven *kumbhaka*s already mentioned in the commentary to 1.54 but in more detail.[640] Subsequently, the commentary to 2.50 quotes further explanations from various texts, such as *Yogabhāskara*, *Nandipurāṇa* and *Mārkaṇḍeyapurāṇa* on the subject of *prāṇāyāma*. In addition, the four stages (*avasthā*) of yoga practice—*ārambha*, *ghāṭa*, *paricaya* and *niṣpatti* are introduced,[641] as well as, for example, the yogic dietary guidelines and the dwelling of the yogin based on the explanations of the first chapter of *Haṭhapradīpikā*.

Therefore, Nārāyaṇatīrtha's Haṭhayoga consists mainly of two categories listed in the *Haṭhapradīpikā*[642]: *āsana* and *kumbhaka*, both integrated into Pātañjalayoga. The third category, *mudrā*, as well as the *ṣaṭkarma*s, appear not within Haṭhayoga but in the section on Karmayoga—an unexpected placement given that these practices typically distinguish Haṭhayoga from other yoga systems. Nārāyaṇatīrtha acknowledges their connection to Haṭhayoga, yet deliberately treats them under Karmayoga; accordingly, they will be discussed later in that context. The fourth Haṭhayoga category, *nādānusandhāna*, is absent from the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*. Crucially, Nārāyaṇatīrtha states at

[636] Cf. *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* 2.51: *evambhūta ubhayoḥ śvāsapraśvāsayor gativicchedaś caturthaḥ prāṇāyāma ity arthaḥ | etena sahitakumbhakābhyāsa evāsyā 'sādhāraṇam | yadā nāḍīviśuddhiḥ syād yoginas tattvadarśinaḥ | tadā vidhvastadoṣasya bhavet kevalasambhavaḥ ||*

[637] Cf. *Haṭhapradīpikā* 2.76.

[638] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* 2.51, Ed. p. 118–121. The seven *kumbhaka*s mentioned by Nārāyaṇatīrtha are: 1. *sūryabhedana*; 2. *ujjāyī*; 3. *sītkā(ra)*; 4. *śītalī*; 5. *brahmarī*; 6. *mūrchā*; and 7. *bhastrikā*.

[639] Cf. *Haṭhapradīpikā* 2.48–71.

[640] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* 2.51, p. 121: *kumbhaḥ saptavidho jñeyo recitādiprabhedataḥ | recitaṃ pūratiḥ śāntaḥ pratyāhārottaro'dharaḥ || samaś ceti vinirdiṣṭaḥ kumbhakaḥ saptabhedataḥ iti eteṣāṃ lakṣaṇāni cāha— recitasya bahistambho vāyo recitakumbhakaḥ | pūrakeṇa vinā samyag yogo 'yaṃ sukhado nṛṇām || 1 || pūritasyodare rodhaḥ paścādrecakasaṃyutaḥ | nāḍīśuddhikaraḥ samyak proktaḥ pūritakumbhakaḥ || 2 || kāyasyāntarbahir vyāptir yā sa syāc chāntakumbhakaḥ || 3 || sthānayor antare rodhaḥ pratyāhārākhyakumbhakaḥ || 4 || āpūrayet kramād ūrdhvam ūrdhvarodho hṛdādiṣu || 5 || uttaraḥ kumbhakaḥ sa syād adho 'dho mūrddhato 'dharaḥ || 6 || recanāpūraṇe tyaktvā manasā maruto dhṛtiḥ | yā nābhyād pradeśeṣu samaḥ kumbhaḥ prakīrttitaḥ || 7 ||*

[641] See *Amṛtasiddhi viveka* 19,21,29 and 31 for the oldest account of the four stages. Also cf. *Haṭhapradīpikā* 4.16–25.

[642] Cf. *Haṭhapradīpikā* 1.56.

the end of his commentary on *sūtra* 2.28 that Haṭhayoga yields only bodily perfection and does not directly lead to Rājayoga.[643]

3.6.3 Haṭhayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

In the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* (3.1–52), Haṭhayoga is both an individual category (3.1–12) and a superordinate category. In the following, Haṭhayoga is primarily discussed as the individual category. As a superordinate category, it subsumes three other yogas, namely Rājayoga (3.13–24), Lakṣayoga (3.25–36) and Aṣṭāṅgayoga (3.37–52). These subcategories will be only briefly characterised in this section. They are then discussed in detail in the respective section of this comparative analysis according to the order of the list of the fifteen yogas of the *Tattvayogabindu*.[644]

Sundardās traces his Haṭhayoga back to Ādināth, Matsyendra, Gorakṣa, Carpaṭa, Kāṇerī and Cauraṅga.[645]. He specifies the union of sun and moon as its definition.[646] This is followed by describing the ideal environment for yoga practice, short practice instructions and dietary rules (3.2–8). These are closely reminiscent of the explanations in the first chapter of the *Haṭhapradīpikā*.[647] The chapter concludes with the naming of the six actions (*ṣaṭkarma*s). Due to the lack of details in his descriptions, it is hardly comprehensible to perform the practices without a teacher or other instructive texts. Sundardās could not have conceived his chapter on Haṭhayoga as an instruction manual. Instead, his primary aim must have been to characterise it and integrate Haṭhayoga into the overall context of his successive sequence of yogas.

[643] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 98): *etac ca sarvaṃ yogāṅgānuṣṭhānād iti sūtre sūtritam api haṭhayogāṅgatvena dehasiddhamātraphalatvena sākṣād rājayogān aṅgatvāt kaṇṭharaveṇa sūtrakṛtā noktam iti mantavyam iti saṃkṣepaḥ* ‖ 28 ‖

[644] A French description of the Haṭhayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* can be found in Burger, 2014: 701–709.

[645] *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 1.4: *ādinātha matsyeṃdra aru, goraṣa carpaṭa mīna | kāṇerī cauraṃga puni, haṭha su yoga ini kīnā* ‖ 4 ‖

[646] *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.1: *abahi hahūṃ haṭhayoga sunāī | ādinātha ke bandaiṃ pāī | ravi śaśi doū eka milāvai | yāhī teṃ haṭhayoga kahāvai* ‖ 1 ‖

[647] See *Haṭhapradīpikā* 1.57–60.

The ideal environment for Haṭhayoga is in a well-governed country where justice prevails. Here, the yogin is supposed to build a hut (*maṭhikā*) with a small door and no holes. The yogin shall smear the hut with cow dung for this purpose. A small well is dug into the ground next to the hut.[648,649] The yogin is supposed to sit in the hut, devote himself to Haṭhayoga and regulate the breath.[650] Accordingly, for Sundardās, as in all texts with complex yoga taxonomies without exception, breath cultivation is the central element of Haṭhayoga. In the following, he specifies the practice of yoga postures (*āsana*).[651] Furthermore, Sundardās recommends ritual washing and god worship in the morning.[652] The diet is supposed to be regulated.[653] For Sundardās, this means avoiding hot, spicy and sour foods. Specifically mustard, sesame, alcohol, meat, green vegetables, ginger and garlic, shall be avoided, too.[654] A diet of rice, milk,[655] ghee, honey and gourd vegetables is recommenced. Furthermore, pure water is supposed to be ingested.[656] When the haṭhayogin eats in this way, his body is freed from disease.[657]

Verses 3.9–11 mention the six actions (*ṣaṭkarma*s)—*dhauti*, *basti*, *netī*, *trāṭaka*, *naulī* and *kapālabhātī*. They are supposed to to purify the channels,[658] and lead to success.[659] In the last verse of this section, we learn that the power of Haṭhayoga leads to bliss.[660]

[648] Ibid. 3.2–3ab: *prathama sudharma deśa kahuṃ tākai | bhalau rājya kachu deṣala na jākai | tāhāṃ jāī kai maṭhikā karī | alpa dvāra aru chidra su bharaī ‖ 2 ‖ lipta karai cahūṃ ora sugandhā | kūpa sahita maṭha ihīṃ bidhi baṃdhā |*

[649] Cf. *Haṭhapradīpikā* 1.12–13.

[650] *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.3cd: *tāmahiṃ paiṭhi karai abhyāsā | gutu gami haṭha kari jātai svāsā ‖ 3 ‖*

[651] *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.5ab: *haṭhi kari āsana sādhaiṃ bhāī hatha kari nidrā tajatau jāī |*

[652] Ibid. 3.7b: *prāta sanāna upāsana koī |* What this might have looked like is described in great detail within the first chapter of the *Yogakarṇikā*.

[653] Ibid. 3.5c: *haṭha hī kari āhāra ghaṭāvai |*

[654] Ibid. 3.6: *haṭha kari tīkṣaṇa kaṭuka sutyāgai | sarasoṃ tila mada māṃsa na māṃgai | harita śāka kabahū nahiṃ ṣaī | hiṃgu lasanu saba deśa bahāī ‖ 6 ‖*

[655] Ibid. 3.7c: *gohūṃ śāli su karai ahārā |*

[656] Ibid. 3.8ab: *ṣīra ṣāṃḍa ghṛta madhi puni sāṃnī sūṃṭhi paṭola nirmala ati pāṃnī |*

[657] Ibid. 3.8cd: *yahu bhojana su karai haṭha yogī dina dina kāyā hoī nirogī ‖ 8 ‖*

[658] Ibid. 3.9b: *nāḍī śuddha hoṃhi mala ṭalai |*

[659] Ibid. 3.10c: *ye ṣaṭa karma siddhi ke dātā |*

[660] Ibid. 3.12a: *yā haṭha yoga prabhāva teṃ, pragaṭa hoī ānanda |*

As already mentioned at the beginning, Sundardās also subsumes Rājayoga (3.13–24), Lakṣayoga (3.25–36) and Aṣṭāṅgayoga (3.37–52) under the superordinate category Haṭhayoga. Sundardās' Rājayoga practice is that which is commonly known as *vajrolīmudrā*.[661] Lakṣ(y)ayoga, a practice found in all complex late medieval taxonomies, is the fixation of the gaze (*dṛṣṭi*) on differently located foci (focal points or objects) inside or outside the body. With regard to Aṣṭāṅgayoga, Sundardās discusses the generally known eight limbs individually. Similar to Nārāyaṇatīrtha, characteristic practices of Haṭhayoga such as *āsana*s, *kumbhaka*s, *mudrā*s and *bandha*s are assigned to the individual limbs. A detailed comparative discussion of the subcategories takes place in the following chapters.

3.6.4 Haṭhayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Haṭhayoga across the examined yoga taxonomies demonstrates that, while the defining practices of Haṭhayoga are largely agreed upon, the texts differ markedly in how they classify, prioritise, and situate these practices within their broader soteriological systems. In all cases, Haṭhayoga is defined primarily through bodily and respiratory techniques, yet its doctrinal framing varies substantially. The *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya* present a twofold model of Haṭhayoga, comprising *prāṇāyāma* and the *ṣaṭkarma*s on one hand, and contemplation on coloured light on the other, and both ultimately frame Haṭhayoga as a technique in service of Rājayoga. In the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Haṭhayoga is defined chiefly through *prāṇāyāma* and *āsana*, while *ṣaṭkarma* and *mudrā* are reassigned to Karmayoga; for Nārāyaṇatīrtha, Haṭhayoga serves bodily perfection but cannot directly yield Rājayoga. Sundardās reverses this hierarchy, placing Rājayoga within the domain of Haṭhayoga and identifying it with *vajrolīmudrā*. His system integrates *prāṇāyāma*, *āsana* and *ṣaṭkarma* as core elements of Haṭhayoga, while *mudrā* and *bandha* appear under *Aṣṭāṅgayoga*; his twelve yogas function not as alternatives but as interdependent limbs culminating in Advaitayoga.

[661] The verses do not specify the term, but the practice is identical.

Taken together, the variation of implementations across the texts containing complex yoga taxonomies demonstrates the remarkable flexibility of the Haṭhayoga concept in early modern yogic thought. Rather than presenting a fixed or self-contained system, Haṭhayoga emerges as a versatile constellation of techniques—one that can be hierarchised, integrated, subordinated, or expanded according to shifting doctrinal priorities. Its meaning, therefore, resides not merely in its techniques but in how it is positioned relationally within broader yogic frameworks. Haṭhayoga becomes a dynamic category, shaped by its context, negotiable in scope, and continually redefined through its interaction with other forms of yoga.

3.7 Karmayoga

KARMAYOGA, the "Yoga of deeds", is well-known from the *Bhagavadgītā*[662]. The concept of the Karmayoga of the *Bhagavadgītā* is absent in our four complex early modern taxonomies of yogas. Instead, other concepts of Karmayoga emerged. Rāmacandra lists Karmayoga as the fifth method of Rājayoga within the yoga taxonomy of the *Tattvayogabindu*. Karmayoga is the third yoga mentioned in the yoga taxonomy of the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*. The *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* does not mention Karmayoga at all.

3.7.1 Karmayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*

Both texts mention Karmayoga in their taxonomies. However, they do not explicitly describe a Karmayoga in the course of the text, unlike other yoga categories. The absence surprises the reader, as the initial list of fifteen yogas and the subsequent description of Kriyāyoga, as the first entry in the list, is immediately treated first within a separate section of the text. The expectation is reinforced by the subsequent sections that more or less follow the order provided by the initial taxonomy. However, this expected structure fades away as the text progresses. This observation results in at least three

[662] See for example *Bhagavadgītā* 2.47–49, 3.1–7, & 4.20. Here, Karmayoga is a path (*mārga*) to liberation (*mokṣa*) through action (*karma*) without attachment to one's deeds.

possible explanations. Either the list merely served to illustrate the diversity of the different categories of yoga, and it was never the authors' intention to cover all the yogas in the text, or the transmission of the text has fallen victim to corruption. The third possibility is that some yogas are present not explicitly but only implicitly in the text. Regarding the latter possibility, there exists one passage in both texts that could hypothetically cover the Karmayoga aspect of the text.

The passage under consideration belongs to section *Tattvayogabindu* XLI. Like the previous sections, starting with XXXII, this section deals with the microcosmic equivalents of the macrocosm in the yogic body. In particular, it deals with the listing of various macrocosmic contents which are situated in specific bodily locations, such as twenty-seven stars, twelve signs of the zodiac, nine planets, etc. At the very end of this topic, in both texts, the *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya*, a passage appears that speaks of liberation (*mukti*) through a specific action (*karma*). The *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, Ed. pp. 843–844) reads:

samagradarśanān muktaḥ svargabhogañ ca matsukham |
tad etaccintayā yāti rogaśokavivarjitaḥ ||
yat karmakarmaṇā śaṅkā manomadhye bhaved bahiḥ |
tat karmakaraṇaṃ muktir ity āha bhagavān śivaḥ ||

> Freed as a result of complete vision,[663] [there is] heavenly pleasure and my bliss.[664] By contemplating that, one becomes free from sorrow and disease. That action which causes doubt in the mind should be abandoned. Performing such an action leads to liberation, says the exalted Śiva.

Thus, the specific action which leads to liberation is initiated by the complete vision of the contents of the yogic body, resulting in pleasure and bliss.

[663] The formulation *samagradarśanāt* refers back to the previously mentioned microcosmic contents of the macrocosm.

[664] Since Śiva is speaking, *matsukham* must refer to Śiva's bliss.

12 **karma** em.] karmā PT **bahiḥ** em.] vahiḥ PT

One is supposed to contemplate the contents of the yogic body and abandon doubt. It is this very action (*karma*) which leads to liberation *mukti* in the *Yogasvarodaya*. Rāmacandra's reformulations paint a different picture. This passage almost appears out of place since he fails to express the thematic reference—the yogic body—clearly. Rāmacandra seems to miss the point by proclaiming that deeds that lead to nothing good bind man[665] and that deeds that do not produce fear are the cause of liberation. The connection to the yogic body, which also in Rāmacandra's text precedes this formulation is bypassed. The end of *Tattvayogabindu* XLI reads:

> *puruṣasya nṛtyadarśanāt || gītaśravaṇāt || vallabhavastuno darśaṇāt || ya ānanda utpadyate saḥ svargalokaḥ kathyate | rogapīḍādurjanebhyaḥ puruṣasya yad duḥkhaṃ utpadyate | tad bahutaraṃ narakaṃ kathyate | atha ca yatkarmakaraṇāt sarveṣāṃ lokānāṃ svamanasi ca śubhaṃ na bharate tat karma bandhanam ity ucyate | atha ca yatkarmakaraṇān manomadhye śaṅkā na bhavati tatkarma muktikāraṇam |*
>
> The person's bliss that is generated as a result of seeing dance, listening to songs, [and] viewing beloved objects, that [bliss] is called heaven. The person's suffering that arises as a result of the pain caused by disease and wicked people, that great [suffering] is called hell. Moreover, an action that does not bring goodness to all people and one's mind, that action is said to be bondage. And furthermore, the action that, when performed, does not cause doubt in the mind, that action is the cause of liberation.

Thus, even though both texts do not introduce Karmayoga as a separate topic, they at least present a path to liberation through action (*karma*). In the *Yogasvarodaya*, the action (*karma*) is the contemplation of the microcosmic equivalents of the macrocosm within the yogic body without doubts. Whereas in the *Tattvayogabindu*, it is the cultivation of all actions that bring goodness and the renunciation of actions that lead to dread.

[665] Presumably to the cycle of rebirth (*saṃsāra*).

3.7.2 Karmayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

Nārāyaṇatīrtha situates his Karmayoga[666] in the context of his commentary on *sūtra* 2.28:[667]

> *yogāṅgānuṣṭhānād aśuddhikṣaye jñānadīptir āvivekakhyāteḥ* ‖ 28 ‖
>
> As a result of the execution of the limbs of yoga upon the destruction of impurities, the lamp of knowledge arises up to the realisation of discrimination.

This *sūtra* introduces a description of the eight well-known limbs of Pātañjalayoga. Nārāyaṇatīrtha explains that the practice of the eight limbs leads to the realisation of the overarching goal of yoga, the discriminating knowledge of *puruṣa* and *prakṛti*, thereby removing ignorance (*vidyā*) and manifesting liberation. He then presents Karmayoga as an alternative for attaining the lamp of knowledge:[668]

> *athavā yogāṅgānāṃ dhautīvastītyādiṣaṭkarmaṇāṃ mahāmudrādīnāṃ ca anuṣṭhānād dṛḍhābhyāsāj jñānadīptiḥ | jñāyate 'neneti jñānaṃ karaṇavargaḥ | tasya dīptiḥ rogādyanabhighātena tejasvitā dṛḍhatā ca, āvivekakhyāteḥ vivekakhyātiparyantaṃ bhavatīty arthaḥ | rogādinā jñānasya kuṇṭhabhāvas tu prasiddha eva | sa caiteṣv aṅgeṣv anuṣṭhiteṣu rogapratibandhān na bhavatīty arthaḥ | tathā ca karaṇadārḍhyadvārā samādhidārḍhyārthārthakarmayogo 'pi prathamato 'nuṣṭheyo rogabhīruṇeti bhāvaḥ | sa ca karmayogaḥ ṣaṭkarmarūpo mudrārūpaś ceti dvividho nirūpita ākare yathā |`
>
> Alternatively, as a result of executing consistent practice of the limbs of yoga, [particularly] of the six actions like Dhautī, Vastī etc. and the great seal etc., the lamp of knowledge arises. By

[666] See Penna (2004: 67–20) for an earlier discussion of Karmayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*.

[667] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Ed. pp. 92–98.

[668] This differentiation inevitably awakens the association with the differentiation of the eight-fold yoga according to Yajñavalkya and the Haṭhayoga with *mudrā*s etc. of Kapila already stated in *Dattātreyayogaśāstra* 29.

> the [word] "*jñāna* (knowledge)", the group of sense organs is to be understood. Its "*dīpti* (lamp)" becomes brilliant and robust without damage through diseases, etc. The meaning of [the word] "*āvivekakhyāteḥ* (up to the realisation of discrimination)" extends as far as the realisation of discrimination. Through diseases, etc., the state of the inefficiency of the sense organs (*jñāna*) is thus established. Furthermore, the meaning of "after having practised these limbs" is [that] there are no obstacles from diseases. And thus, Karmayoga is the means for acquiring resilience of the sense organs for the steadfastness of *samādhi*, which shall be practised first so that one does not become afraid of disease. And that Karmayoga, having the nature of the six actions and having the nature of the seals is discussed twofold accordingly.

Next, Nārāyaṇatīrtha simply lists the *ṣaṭkarma*s and nine *mudrā*s:

> *dhāutī vastī tathā neti trāṭakaṃ naulikaṃ tathā |*
> *kapālabhātī caitāni ṣaṭ karmāṇi pracakṣate ||*
> *karmaṣaṭkam idaṃ gopyaṃ dehaśodhanakārakam iti |*
> *mahāmudrā mahābandho mahāvedhaś ca khecarī ||*
> *śakticālo mūlabandha uḍḍīyānaṃ tataḥ param |*
> *jālandharābhidho yogo viparītakṛtis tatheti ||*
> *lakṣaṇāni ca tatraivoktāni |*
>
> Dhautī, Vastī, as well as Neti, Trāṭaka and Nauli, and also Kapālabhāti—these six actions are being told. This hexade of action is to be kept secret as it produces the purification of the body. The great seal, the great lock, the great piercing and Khecarī, the stimulation of the goddess, the root lock, Uḍḍīyāṇa [and] thereafter [that] yoga [practice which is] known as Jālandhara as well as the act of inversion. The characteristics are described there [in the following].

Subsequently, Nārāyaṇatirtha presents verses containing instructive descriptions of every practice borrowed from earlier yoga texts.[669] Even though Nārāyaṇatīrtha situates the *ṣaṭkarma*s and *mudrā*s within his Karmayoga, at the very end of the section on Karmayoga he notes that they are part of the practice of Haṭhayoga.[670]

3.7.3 Karmayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Karmayoga within the complex yoga taxonomies contained some surprising findings. Although three texts with complex yoga taxonomies list Karmayoga, only one of them contains a concrete description of a yoga method labelled as such.

Karmayoga is explicitly mentioned in the yoga taxonomies of *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*, but is not introduced in a separate section and dedicated description. Nevertheless, both texts contain passages that describe liberation (*mukti*) through action (*karma*). Thus, even though both texts do not introduce Karmayoga as a separate topic, they at least present a path to liberation through action (*karma*). In the *Yogasvarodaya*, the action (*karma*) is the contemplation of the yogic body without doubt. Whereas in the *Tattvayogabindu*, it is the cultivation of actions (*karma*s) that bring goodness and the renunciation of actions that lead to dread.

In Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, the action (*karma*) of his Karmayoga is the practice of the *ṣaṭkarma*s and nine *mudrā*s. As a highly educated Kṛṣṇa devotee and intellectual, Nārāyaṇatīrtha should have known the Karmayoga of the *Bhagavadgītā* well. However, there is not trace of that at all. His concept of Karmayoga is, therefore, all the more unusual and innovative. Nārāyaṇatīrtha's interpretation thus opens up another possibility for an explanation of the absence of a named description of Karmayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*. If one were willing to consider that Rāmacandra and the unknown author of the *Yogasvarodaya* shared

[669] The section on the *ṣaṭkarma*s is based on *Haṭhapradipikā* 2.24–26, whereas the descriptions of the *mudrā*s are primarily taken from the *Yogacintāmanī*, Ed. p. 132 et seqq.

[670] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 98): *etac ca sarvaṃ yogāṅgānuṣṭhānād iti sūtre sūtritam api haṭhayogāṅgatvena dehasiddhamātraphalatvena sākṣād rājayogān aṅgatvāt kaṇṭharaveṇa sūtrakṛtā noktam iti mantavyam iti saṃkṣepaḥ* ‖ 28 ‖

Nārāyaṇatīrtha's view of Karmayoga, the *ṣaṭkarma*s in both texts would already be covered in their section on Haṭhayoga, which would render repeated description redundant.

3.8 Layayoga

LAYAYOGA, the "Yoga of absorption", was frequently discussed in recent academic discourse primarily due to the increased popularity of academic research on the early texts of Haṭhayoga and the publication of critical editions of those texts.[671]

The Layayoga of *Dattātreyayogaśāstra* (15–26) is a state of mind that one reaches through fifteen million secret methods called *saṃketa*s. From this methodological variety, Dattātreya describes a total of seven, e.g. permanent meditation on the *śūnya*, i.e. day and night while sitting still, moving, sleeping and eating[672], staring at the region between the eyebrows,[673] or fixation of the gaze on the big toe of the right foot.[674]

In the *Amaraugha* (18–19) only one method of Layayoga is mentioned. The method consists of visualising dripping nectar in the body and then meditating on Kāmarūpa, the exact location of which is not specified, on Śiva in the form of a *liṅga* that shines like a jewel.[675]

A text that in terms of content is particularly close to the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya* is the 15th century *Śivayogapradīpikā*.[676] Here, a *layayogin* is someone who has succeeded in dissolving their mind, together with their inner organ and breath, in the object of meditation, or inner resonance.[677]

[671] For example the ERC-funded *Haṭha Yoga Project* (2015–2020), see http://hyp.soas.ac.uk/ (Alternatively: https://web.archive.org/web/20240516171430/http://hyp.soas.ac.uk/; saved on archive.org: 04.10.2023).

[672] *Dattātrayayogaśāstra* 21: *tiṣṭan gacchan svapan bhuñjan dhyāyec chūnyam aharniśam | ayam eko hi saṃketa ādhināthena bhāṣitaḥ* ‖ 21 ‖

[673] Ibid. 23: *bhrūmadhyadṛṣṭimātreṇa paraḥ saṃketa ucyate | līlāvibhūtilepaś ca uttamaḥ parikīrtitaḥ* ‖ 23 ‖

[674] Ibid. 24ab: *svasya dakṣiṇapādasya aṅguṣṭhe laya uttamaḥ |*

[675] *Amaraugha* 18: *kāmarūpe sitaṃ devaṃ liṅgābhaṃ maṇisannibham | dravantaṃ cāmṛtaṃ prekṣya yo dhyāyen nijavigrahe* ‖ 18 ‖

[676] See p. 416 for a discussion.

[677] *Śivayogapradīpikā* 1.6: *yasya cittaṃ nijadhyeye manasā marutā saha | līnaṃ bhavati nāde vā layayogī sa eva hi* ‖ 6 ‖

The term *laya*, in these texts, thus refers to the "dissolution" of the mind through specific methods. In other contexts, the term *laya* is also used as a synonym for *samādhi*. There are even Buddhist and Vedic texts in which the term *laya* has negative connotations and is regarded as an obstacle to meditation or gnosis. However, in the texts of the complex yoga taxonomies, such negative views on different *laya*s are absent.[678]

Layayoga occupies fifth place in the taxonomy of the *Tattvayogabindu*'s methods of Rājayoga but is not listed in the verses on the fifteen yogas of the *Yogasvarodaya*. Ultimately, however, an explicit description of Layayoga is missing in both texts. The omission of a separate section on Layayoga likely results from its thematic overlap with specific teachings of the text. According to Birch (2024: 37, n. 86), the 14th century *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* (4350–4363) contains perhaps the oldest tradition of Layayoga which aims at absorption of the mind into *cakra*s. The section is introduced with the words "*atha layayoga* ‖" and states that Kṛṣṇadvaipāyana and others attained the state called *laya* by performing *laya* over the nine *cakra*s.[679] Just as in the *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, pp. 832–833) and *Tattvayogabindu* (section IV–XII), *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* presents a description of the nine *cakra*s together with instructions and results of the respective meditation on every single *cakra*. Other "classical" methods of Layayoga from earlier texts can also be found scattered in the *Yogasvarodaya* or *Tattvayogabindu*, such as the fixation of the gaze on the big toe[680] or the centre of the eyebrows.[681] Summa summarum, the *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya* actually do include many practices typically associated with Layayoga, but these are not referred to as Layayoga when presented in the text.

In the taxonomy of the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Layayoga occupies the thirteenth place. In Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, Layayoga is presented as one of the methods of Bhaktiyoga.

[678] See Birch (2024: 35–37) for the detailed documentation of the complex reception-historical scope of the term *layayoga* based on evidence from numerous texts of yoga's relevant subgenres.

[679] *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* 4350: *kṛṣṇadvaipāyanādyais tu sādhito layasaṃjñitaḥ | navasv eva hi cakreṣu layaṃ kṛtvā mahātmabhiḥ* ‖4‖

[680] *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 839; YK 2.16) as well as *Tattvayogabindu* section XXX.

[681] *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 839; YK 2.35) and *Tattvayogabindu* section XXX.

3.8.1 Layayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

Nārāyaṇatīrtha places his discussion of Layayoga[682] in the context of his commentary on *sūtra* 1.41:[683]

> *samprajñātasya viṣayaṃ pradarśayan na samprajñātā 'paraparyāyaṃ layayogam āha—kṣīṇavṛtter abhijātasyeva maṇer grahītṛgrahaṇagrāhyeṣu tatsthatadañjanatā samāpattiḥ* ‖ 41 ‖
>
> [In] pointing out the object of [the] *saṃprajñāta*[-type of *samādhi*], [the text] does not state [that the] *saṃprajñāta* is [merely] another designation for Layayoga—[rather,] *samāpatti*, [the state of complete absorption of the mind] of one who is devoid of its mental fluctuations, happens when the mind becomes like a pure crystal that takes the form of the object placed before it, whether it is the knower, the instrument of knowing, or that which is to be known.

After the previous *sūtra*s introduced various objects that can support the mind in meditation, this *sūtra* now continues the analysis of different stages within the state of meditation, regardless of its object.[684] When the *vṛtti*s of the mind fade, the mind becomes more and more like a crystal (*maṇi*). Just as a crystal takes on the colouring (*añjanatā*) of any object placed in front of it, the clear mind focusing on any object also takes on the colouring of that very object.[685] With regard to the objects that serve absorption, here, the *sūtra* specifies the hierarchical sequence of the knower (*grahītṛ*), the instrument of knowledge (*grahaṇa*) and that what is to be known (*grāhya*). For Nārāyaṇatīrtha, the knower is *puruṣa*. The instrument of knowledge is the sense organs, and what is to be known is the object that can be grasped by

[682] For an earlier discussion see Penna, 2004: 85–89.

[683] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Ed. p. 64.

[684] This analysis already began in *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* 1.17.

[685] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* 1.34 (Ed. p. 64): *uparāgeṇa tadākāratāyāṃ dṛṣṭāntam āha—abhijātasyeva maṇer iti | nirmalasya sphaṭikāder yathā japākusumādyuparāgeṇa raktādyākāratā tathety arthaḥ |*

the mind.[686] Depending on which object the mind focuses on, it takes on its colour and nature. The term *samāpatti* refers to the complete identification of the mind with the object of meditation. Nārāyaṇatīrtha then equates the term *samāpatti* with *laya*:[687]

> *teṣu yā tatsthatadañjanatā tatsthena uparāgeṇa tadañjanatā tanmayatā samyak tadākāratā samāpattiḥ samyagāpattir layaḥ samprajñātalakṣaṇo yogo bhavatīty arthaḥ* |
>
> In those [objects] that are [in the] "state of being colored by residing in that", by [the act of] residing in that, [and] by coloration, the state of being colored [arises], [which is] the complete identification of that form; [that] is absorption (*samāpatti*); the complete immersion into [that] state is Laya, which is a yoga characterised as *samprajñāta*. This is the meaning.

For Nārāyaṇatīrtha, Layayoga is therefore a synonym for the state of *samāpatti* and is attributed to the *samprajñāta* form of *samādhi*, in which the consciousness is still focussed on one of the aforementioned objects. *Samprajñātasamādhi* is also known as "*samādhi* with discrimination", as the meditator retains awareness of the distinction between the meditator, the meditation object and the process of meditation itself. It is therefore a *samādhi* in which there is still a minimal remainder of *vṛtti*s, in contrast to the final *asaṃprajñāta* form of *samādhi* in which the last *vṛtti* also expires and final liberation—the state called *kaivalya* ("isolation" [of *puruṣa*]) occurs.[688]

[686] Ibid. 1.34 (Ed. p. 64): *kṣīṇavṛtter iti* | *abhyāsavairāgyābhyām apagamavṛttyantarasya cittasya grahītṛgrahaṇagrāhyeṣu, grahītā puruṣaḥ sthūlasūkṣmabhedena, grahaṇaṃ gṛhyate 'rtho 'nenetīndriyam, evaṃ grāhyaṃ ca grahītṛgrahaṇagrāhyāni* |

[687] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Ed. p. 64.

[688] See *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* 1.17–22 for more detailed explanations of the *samprajñāta* and *asaṃprajñāta* forms of *samādhi*.

3.8.2 Layayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

For Sundardās, Layayoga (2.28–39) is a subcategory of Bhaktiyoga.[689,690] He describes it as a method for the liberation from the cycle of birth and death.[691] Sundardās emphasises that Layayoga is an incomparable method and therefore attaches great importance to it among the yoga methods he presents.[692] Layayoga dispels all illusion,[693] makes one attain the highest state,[694] dispels anger and difficulties,[695] and makes one equal to Brahman.[696] The main emphasis of the practice is the continuous absorption of the mind into a specific goal, which he defines as Rāma[697] or Hari.[698] This absorption is supposed to be continued throughout day and night.[699] To illustrate how exactly this practice is to be carried out, he draws various comparisons. For example, *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* reads 2.35:

> *jaisaiṃ gāu jaṃgala kauṃ dhāvai | pānī pivai ghāsa cari āvai |*
> *citta rahai bacharā kai pāsā | aisī laya lāvai haridāsā ‖* 2.35 ‖
>
> Just as a cow walks towards the forest, drinks water, and grazes, but its mind remains near the calf, in such a way, Haridāsā practices Laya.

Another example is *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 2.36:

> *jyauṃ jananī gṛha kāja karāī | putra piṃghrau pauḍhata bhāī |*
> *ura apnai taiṃ chana na bisārai | aisī laya jana kauṃ nistārai ‖* 36 ‖

[689] A description of Layayoga in French can be found in Burger, 2014: 693–94.
[690] See p. 461 for a discussion of Bhaktiyoga in the complex yoga taxonomies.
[691] *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 2.28c: *laya binu janma marana nahīṃ chūṭai |*
[692] Ibid. 2.29a: *laya samāna nahīṃ aura upāī |*
[693] Ibid. 2.29c: *āvāgamana sakala bhrama bhāgai ‖* 29 ‖
[694] Ibid. 2.30d: *parama sthāna samāvai soī ‖* 30 ‖
[695] Ibid. 2.32cd: *esī laya jo koī lāvai | jonī saṃkaṭa bahuri na āvai ‖* 32 ‖
[696] Ibid. 2.31a: *yaha laya yoga anupa hai karai brahma samāna |*
[697] Ibid. 2.29b: *jo jana rahai rāma laya lāī |*
[698] Ibid. 2.38ab: *sa saṃprakāra hari sauṃ lavai | koī videha parama pada pāvai |*
[699] Ibid. 2.29c: *niśi vāsara esaiṃ lai lāgai |*

> Just as a mother does the housework while her son plays or crawls nearby and never for a moment forgets him in her heart, *laya* liberates the person who practices it.

As illustrated by these comparisons, Sundardās's concept of Layayoga is the continuous absorption or centring of the mind on Rāma or Hari while performing the necessary daily activities. The examples of the cow and the mother emphasise that this is supposed to be done in a way that resembles the tireless love and attention of a mother towards her child.

3.8.3 Layayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Layayoga within the complex yoga taxonomies displays the full range of historical meanings of Layayoga. While the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya* mention Layayoga in their taxonomies, they do not dedicate specific sections to the subject, likely because many of the techniques they teach overlap with practices described in medieval Haṭhayoga texts. In contrast, the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* and *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* propagate differing concepts.

For Nārāyaṇatīrtha, Layayoga is a synonym for the state of *samāpatti* and is attributed to the *samprajñāta* form of *samādhi*. His concept of *laya* closely aligns with those of earlier commentators on the *Yogasūtra*, such as Bhojadeva in his *Rājamārtaṇḍa*,[700] or Vijñānabhikṣu in his *Pātañjalabhāṣyavārttika*,[701] who use *laya* in the sense of *nirodha*, or Śivananda's *Yogacintāmaṇi*,[702] for whom *laya* is equated with *samprajñāta*.

For Sundardās, Layayoga belongs to the Bhaktiyoga branch of yoga. It is the continuous absorption or centring of the mind on Rāma or Hari while performing the necessary daily activities. Remarkably, this concept resembles

[700] *Rājamārtaṇḍa* 1.2: *tāsāṃ nirodho* […] *svakāraṇe layo yoga ity ākhyāyate* | Birch translates: "The cessation of those [mental activities, that is to say,] the dissolution [of them] in their own cause is known as yoga."

[701] *Pātañjalabhāṣyavārttika* 1.2 reads: […] *vṛttayas tāsāṃ nirodhas tāsāṃ layākhyo* […] "Their mental fluctuations are restrained; this restraint is called absorption."

[702] *Yogacintāmaṇi* (Ed. p. 11) reads: *layaḥ samprajñātaḥ*. "Laya is *saṃprajñāta*."

the *saṅketa* described above in *Dattātreyayogaśāstra* 21,[703] which prescribes meditation on *śūnya* day and night while sitting still, moving, sleeping, and eating. Basically, the fixation of the mind on *śūnya* is replaced by Rāma or Hari. A distant historical connection between these practices is plausible, as both texts originate from the Vaiṣṇava milieu. The observed shift in practice reflects the central position *bhakti* among Sants like Sundardās.

3.9 Dhyānayoga

DHYĀNAYOGA, the "Yoga of meditation", occupies the seventh place of the *Tattvayogabindu*'s taxonomy of the fifteen methods of Rājayoga. In the *Yogasvarodaya*, Dhyānayoga is to be found at the fifth position. In both cases, Dhyānayoga as a single subcategory and method of Rājayoga is not discussed explicitly in the remainder of the text. Nevertheless, in the case of Dhyānayoga, the situation in these two texts seems to be similar to the treatment of Layayoga analysed above. Even if not explicitly labelled as Dhyānayoga, both texts inherently contain many specific techniques that could be assigned to this term and are labelled as *dhyāna*s. As will be shown, it seems plausible that Rāmacandra and the author of the *Yogasvarodaya* did not dedicate a separate section to Dhyānayoga, as they might have been aware of the various categorical overlaps and wanted to avoid redundancy.[704]

In the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Dhyānayoga is the fourteenth method of Rājayoga Nārāyaṇatīrtha presents, and as with all other yogas, he locates the method within the framework of the *Yogasūtra*.

Sundardās, in his taxonomy of the three yoga tetrads presented in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, does not list Dhyānayoga at all.

[703] A technique strikingly similar to the *saṅketa* of *Dattātreyayogaśāstra* 21 is the practice of *antarlakṣya* within the *Yogasvarodaya*, cf. *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 824) and *Yogakarṇikā* 2.8–13. The passage is translated and discussed on p. 403.

[704] The avoidance of redundancy must be considered here as a motive for the omission of Dhyānayoga. Text-internal evidence is provided by *Tattvayogabindu* XXXI, p. 210. Here, in the context of a presentation of the eight limbs of Aṣṭāṅgayoga, Rāmacandra writes concerning *dhyāna*: *dhyānaṃ ca bahutaraṃ prāg uktaṃ tenātra nocyate* | "Meditation has been taught many times before. Because of that, it is not discussed here."

Thus, the only explicit description of Dhyānayoga within the texts of the complex yoga taxonomies occurs in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*. For this reason I decided to discuss it first. Interestingly, Nārāyaṇatīrtha's description parallels various *dhyāna*-related contents of the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*.

3.9.1 Dhyānayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

Nārāyaṇatīrtha situates Dhyānayoga in the context of his comparatively extensive commentary on *Yogasūtra* 1.39:[705]

> *dhyānayogam āha—*
> *yathābhimatadhyānād vā* ‖ 39 ‖
>
> [With regard to] Dhyānayoga, it is said—
> Or, as a result of meditation on what one favours.

Below, Nārāyaṇtīrtha's commentary explains the various possibilities of Dhyānayoga:

> *yatheti | kim bahunā, harirāmādirūpaṃ parameśvaraṃ bāhyaṃ candrasūryādijyotir vā yad eveṣṭaṃ tad eva dhyāyet | tasmād api dhyānāl labdhasthitikasya cittasya sādhanāntaraṃ vināpi kevale paramātmani sthitau yogyatā bhavatīty arthaḥ | ayam eva dhyānayoga ukto yogagrantheṣu |*
> *vinā deśādibandhena vṛttir yā 'bhimate sthirā |*
> *dhyānayogo bhaved eva cittacāñcalyanāśakaḥ* ‖
> *ity ādinā |*
>
> [Regarding the term] "yathā". Why [say] more? One should meditate on the supreme lord in the form of Hari, Rāma, etc., or on an external light such as the moon, sun, etc. [or] just onto what is favoured. Because of that, as a result of meditation alone, the stability of the mind is attained without the need for any other means, enabling one to reside in the supreme self. This is the

[705] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Ed. pp. 56–63.

> meaning. This very Dhyānayoga is taught in the texts of yoga; [for example] in quotations such as:
>
> Without being confined by place, etc., the fluctuations of the mind become stable in the preferred [object]. In fact, Dhyānayoga is the destroyer of the fickleness of the mind.[706]

In his commentary, Nārāyaṇatīrtha addresses common objects for meditation that will lead to the reduction of fluctuations in the mind. An important set of meditation objects he presents in the following lines:

> *yad vā yathābhimatānāṃ tīrthadevalokavarṇatattvādīnāṃ yathābhimateṣu svadehādiṣu dhyānād bhāvanāviśeṣān manasaḥ sthitir bhavatīty arthaḥ | tatra yady api brahmavido brahmamayatvādinā sarvam eva tīrthaṃ pratilomakūpaṃ ca tīrthāni bhavantīti tathāpi yuñjānena cittaśuddhyarthaṃ prathamatas tīrthādikam avaśyaṃ bhāvanīyam |*
>
> Or, it means that the stability of the mind arises from a specific contemplation, [viz.] from meditation onto favoured [objects] like, for example, sacred sites, deities, worlds, letters, principles, etc., with regard to favoured locations within one's own body. In that case, it is stated, although the knowers of Brahman assert that because of the pervasiveness of Brahman, everything indeed is a sacred place, and even the pores of the skin become places of pilgrimage. Nevertheless, the yogin (*yuñjāna*) who is aiming at the purification of the mind, must inevitably contemplate sacred places, etc. in the beginning [of practice].

Here, Nārāyaṇatīrtha differentiates an alternative form of Dhyānayoga that is suitable particularly for beginners in meditation practice. Nārāyaṇatīrtha devotes the rest of his commentary on *sūtra* 1.39 to this type of meditation, which is aimed at objects located inside the body. He first specifies *tīrthabhāvanā*,[707] the meditation on sacred places, in which the

[706] I am yet to identify the source of this *śloka*.
[707] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Ed. p. 57–59

practitioner is supposed to meditate on various sacred places of the Indian subcontinent in different body parts. Then, he specifies *devabhāvanā*,[708] the meditation of different deities, which are located in body parts, and *lokabhāvanā*,[709] the meditation on the worlds in the body and *varṇabhāvanā*,[710] the meditation on letters in the body. These letters are visualised in one of six *cakra*s.[711] Finally, Nārāyaṇatīrtha describes *tattvabhāvanā*, the meditation on the principles.[712] The commentary concludes by discussing manipulating air currents through the nostrils for beneficial results, such as in heat or cold exposure, intercourse, travelling, etc.[713]

3.9.2 Dhyānayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*

Dhyānayoga is mentioned in the taxonomies of both texts[714] but is not treated as an individual topic. However, various *dhyāna* practices can be found throughout the texts, as the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*, particularly with regards to the *dhyāna*-related practices share the concepts and even the order in which they occur, they are discussed together in this section.

The first mention of the term *dhyāna* occurs in the context of nine *cakra*s in the sections of *Tattvayogabindu* IV–XII.[715] Rāmacandra and the unknown author of the *Yogasvarodaya* instruct *dhyāna* on the respective *cakra*, or a *mūrti* located within the *cakra*. The scribe-author of manuscript U_2 even adds more precise instructions on the duration of the meditations on the respective *cakra*s. However, as we discover in section III, Rāmacandra attributes this meditation practice to Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga or Mantrayoga and not to Dhyānayoga. The author of the *Yogasvarodaya*, on the other hand, associates the category of Jñānayoga with it.

[708] Ibid. (Ed. p. 59).
[709] Ibid. (Ed. p. 59).
[710] Ibid. (Ed. p. 59).
[711] Ibid. (Ed. p. 59–61).
[712] Ibid. (Ed. p. 61–63).
[713] A summary of the details of this part of Nārāyaṇatīrtha's commentary has already been sufficiently worked out by Penna (2004: 91–97). Thus, it is not necessary to repeat it here.
[714] The various mentions of *dhyāna* in this section follow the sections of the *Tattvayogabindu*. For the Sanskrit and the corresponding passages of the *Yogasvarodaya* see the critical edition of the text starting on p. 106.
[715] ≈*Yogasvarodaya* (PT, pp. 832–833).

Next, we encounter the term *dhyāna* in the description of *adholakṣya* in section XV,[716] in the second subtype of Haṭhayoga in section XX,[717] in the description of *bāhyalakṣya* in section XXIII,[718] as well as within *antaralakṣya* in section XXIV.[719] Another mention can be detected within the list and the eight limbs of Aṣṭāṅgayoga in section XXXI.[720] Here, Rāmacandra states that *dhyāna* will not be discussed in this context, as this has happened many times before. That instance demonstrates Rāmacandra's attitude towards redundancy. His approach towards redundancy possibly extends to his treatment of certain yoga methods that he initially mentions but does not elaborate on in separate sections of his text, unlike his treatment of other yogas. Unlike Rāmacandra, the *Yogasvarodaya* describes *dhyāna* in the context of its short presentation of Aṣṭāṅgayoga. The unknown author mentions two types of *dhyāna*, a gross and subtle form. The gross form is associated with mantras, and the subtle form is without mantras.[721] The text does not provide any further details in this regard.

In *Tattvayogabindu* XXXII–XLI[722] the identity of the external universe with the body is taught. Microcosmic equivalents of various contents, such as the fourteen worlds, mountains and rivers, etc., are located in the body, similar to what we have previously observed in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*. However, Rāmacandra fails to provide a concrete reason for listing these physical equivalents of the external universe in the body. However, this is not true for the parallel passages of the *Yogasvarodaya*. Here, the yogic body is listed not only for purely informal reasons but also for meditation. According to the statements of the *Yogasvarodaya*, contemplation of the contents of the yogic body leads to freedom from sorrow and disease and brings about

[716] ≈ *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 834).
[717] ≈ *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 835).
[718] ≈ *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 837).
[719] ≈ *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 838).
[720] ≈ *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 841).
[721] *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 841 = YK 7.8): *dhyānan tu dvividhaṃ proktaṃ sthūlasūkṣmavibhedataḥ | sthūlaṃ mantramayaṃ viddhi sūkṣman tu mantravarjitam |*
[722] ≈ *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, pp. 841–843).

liberation.[723] That position is also found in *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 3.1, which says:

> *piṇḍamadhye carācaraṃ yo jānāti sa yogī piṇḍasaṃvittir bhavati* ‖ 1 ‖
>
> He who knows the movable and immovable [viz. the whole world] as being in his body, he is a yogin; he has [complete] knowledge of the body.

In section XLVII,[724] in the context of the divisions of the lotus in the heart, Rāmacandra precribes a meditation on the inner eight-petalled heart lotus which is initially downward facing. When the practitioner meditates on it, the light of the self arises, and, caused by the light of meditation, which is compared to sunlight, the inner lotus becomes upward-facing and blooms. This meditation is supposed to lead to the illumination of the self and enhance vitality.

In conclusion, we can state that although Dhyānayoga is not provided with its own section in either text, it is at least implicitly present in both texts and the generic term of meditation (*dhyāna*) is nevertheless a central theme. Due to the numerous overlaps with the previously presented yoga methods, both authors likely omitted a separate description of Dhyānayoga to avoid redundancy.

3.9.3 Dhyānayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Dhyānayoga within the three yoga taxonomies considered here shows that it is consistently situated as a method of Rājayoga. Nārāyaṇatīrtha defines Dhyānayoga as a means to stabilise the mind, distinguishing two groups of meditation techniques: a general group, including meditations on the supreme deity in various forms, light, etc., and a set of practices particularly suited for beginners. The latter comprises *tīrthabhāvanā* ("meditation on microcosmic sacred places"), *devabhāvanā* ("meditation on deities"), *lokabhāvanā* ("meditation on worlds within the

[723] *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, Ed. pp. 843–844). For a translation of the passage, see p. 367.
[724] ≈*Yogasvarodaya* (PT, pp. 844).

microcosm of the body"), *varṇabhāvanā* ("meditation on letters within *cakra*s"), and *tattvabhāvanā* ("meditation on fundamental principles").

Dhyānayoga appears in the taxonomies of both the *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya*, although neither text treats it as a discrete topic. Nevertheless, meditation practices are found throughout both works. They mention various forms of *dhyāna*, including meditation on *cakra*s, *lakṣya*s (focal points), and bodily locations. In its discussion of Aṣṭāṅgayoga, the *Yogasvarodaya* further distinguishes between a gross form of *dhyāna* employing mantras and a subtle form without mantras. Although Dhyānayoga lacks a dedicated section in these texts, it remains pervasive: meditation is one of the central concerns within both, and its omission as an independent chapter likely serves to avoid redundancy, given its integration into most other methods of Rājayoga.

3.10 Mantrayoga

Mantrayoga, the "Yoga of mantra(s)", appears without exception in all complex early modern yoga taxonomies under consideration. Similarly, in earlier basic fourfold yoga taxonomies, Mantrayoga is always one of the four representatives. In the Vaiṣṇava text called *Dattātrayayogaśāstra* (13th century), Mantrayoga, succeeded by Layayoga, Haṭhayoga and Rājayoga, is the first yoga in the scheme. In this text, the four yogas follow a clearly defined hierarchical order. Mantrayoga is considered the method for the lowest yogis, those with low intellect. With a duration of twelve years, the goal of this Mantrayoga, namely supernatural abilities (*siddhi*s), is achieved after a relatively long time. This practice consists of reciting a single mantra after installing the letters of the alphabet on one's body.[725]

The *Amararaugha* (12th century) was composed within a Śaiva milieu and describes the same yogas, albeit in a different order. The scheme begins with Laya- and Haṭha-, followed by Mantra- and Rājayoga. This shows a different form of hierarchy. Here, all yogas are subordinated to Rājayoga only,

[725] *Dattātrayayogaśāstra* 12–14.

although the relatively low status of Mantrayoga is implied as well.[726] The practice of Mantrayoga consists of meditation on the *oṃ* mantra, followed by meditation on a white deity and a mantra beginning with *oṃ* in the heart and then in a *maṇḍala*. After one hundred thousand repetitions and a fire offering (*homa*) after every tenth repetition, this seemingly arduous practice can not only liberate from suffering and death but also ultimately leads to Rājayoga.[727] However, this implicit or explicit hierarchical view which manifested itself within the early medieval texts with basic taxonomies changed a few centuries later in certain discourses. In our complex early modern yoga taxonomies, different perspectives on Mantrayoga dominate.

Mantrayoga occupies the eighth position in the taxonomy of the Rājayoga methods within the *Tattvayogabindu*. It occupies the sixth position in the *Yogasvarodaya*. In both texts, all yogas are considered equally valuable forms of Rājayoga. However, the identification of practices involving mantras is tricky in both texts. As I will argue, the *Tattvayogabindu*, or, at least some of its recipients, might have taught the repetition of *so 'ham* which sometimes is called the *ajapā* mantra.[728] In the available textual evidence of the *Yogasvarodaya*, a description of Mantrayoga is absent. In Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* Mantrayoga is the fifth method for his Pātañjala based model of Rājayoga. His innovation is in directly integrating Mantrayoga with Jñānayoga and Advaitayoga. Among the sequence of yogas in Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* Mantrayoga is considered to be one of the four methods of Bhaktiyoga.

In none of these texts exists an implicit or explicit statement that the practices of Mantrayoga are an inferior form of yoga practice to be performed by remarkably untalented people, or that they would take a comparatively

[726] *Amaraugha* 6: *nityaṃ mantraparo labheta bhavatāṃ naivādhipatyaṃ tathā divyastrīnavasaṅgamo 'py anudinaṃ na dhyāyato labhyate | hastinyas turagāḥ kareṇukarabhāḥ śālyān nadā gopradā jāyante haṭhayoginas tu vaśagā naitat prasādaṃ vinā* ‖ 3 ‖ Birch translates: "One devoted to [reciting] mantras would never obtain śivahood and sovereignty; one meditating every day does not obtain even the first union with divine women, and a *haṭhayogī* cannot control cow elephants, horses, bull elephants, camels, givers of gruel and givers of cows without the serenity of [Rājayoga]."

[727] For an exhaustive discussion of Mantrayoga in the *Amaraugha*, see Birch, 2024: 34–35.

[728] Repetition of *so 'ham* or *ajapā* mantra are e.g. attested in *Yogabīja* 106–107 and *Vivekamārtaṇḍa* 29–31.

long time to achieve the overarching yogic goals. This observation suggests that practices labelled Mantrayoga were regaining popularity despite the disparaging voices of earlier texts.

3.10.1 Mantrayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*

Apart from the mention of Mantrayoga in the initial verses quoted from the *Yogasvarodaya* in the *Prāṇatoṣinī*[729], the quotations we have do not contain a dedicated description of Mantrayoga, similar to the case of Layayoga and Dhyānayoga. However, in the context of the *Yogasvarodaya*'s description of Aṣṭāṅgayoga[730] a practice involving *mantra*s is mentioned in passing. The unknown author distinguishes two types of *dhyāna*—one is said to be gross and the other subtle. The gross type is associated with *mantra*s, while the subtle type is devoid of *mantra*s. The available testimonies of the *Yogasvarodaya* do not provide further details.

In the *Tattvayogabindu*, however, the term Mantrayoga appears again in section III:

> *idānīṃ rājayogasya bhedāḥ kathyante | ke te | ekaḥ siddhakuṇḍalinīyogaḥ mantrayogaḥ amū rājayogau kathyete |*
>
> Now, varieties of Rājayoga are described. Which are these? One is Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga and one is Mantrayoga. These two Rājayogas are described [in the following].

After that, Rāmacandra discusses the three primary channels of the yogic body: Iḍā, Piṅgalā and Suṣumnā. The section concludes with the assertion that the practitioner becomes omniscient once knowledge about the central channel is generated. The subsequent sections (IV–XII) present a system consisting of nine *cakra*s.

This passage is problematic from a text-critical perspective. Rāmacandra is very much orientated towards his textual source, the *Yogasvarodaya*, in terms of structure and content, particularly in the first half of his text.

[729] See *Prāṇatoṣinī* (Ed. p. 831) quoted with reference *yogasvarodaye*.
[730] See *Yogasvarodaya* PT, p. 841.

However, the *Yogasvarodaya* specifies *jñānayoga* instead of *siddhakuṇḍalinīyogaḥ mantrayogaḥ*. As usual, the remainder of the section is very similar in content to the *Yogasvarodaya*. Nevertheless, the manuscripts offer no alternatives for the conspicuous passage, so that the text must be accepted for the time being. Another reason is the seemingly strange sentence construction, which is ultimately unsurprising if one knows the rest of the text and can be accepted. Right after the term *mantrayogaḥ*, the reader would have wished for a *ca* ("and"). Only the manuscript L omits the term *mantrayogaḥ* but preserves the following dual forms, so this is not a solution either.

The first *cakra* named *mūlacakra* is provided with the following introduction:

> *idānīṃ suṣumṇāyāḥ jñānotpattāv upāyāḥ kathyante | ādau caturdalaṃ mūlacakraṃ vartate |*
>
> Now, the means for the genesis of gnosis of the central channel is described. At the beginning [of the central channel] exists the four-petalled root-cakra.

Based on this description which promises the genesis of gnosis, against the background that the *Yogasvarodaya* teaches Jñānayoga here, one is forced to infer that Rāmacandra assigns the sections IV–XII, which describe the nine *cakra*s, to Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga and Mantrayoga. However, almost all manuscripts, with the exception of U_2, do not provide any conclusive evidence for a practice that could be classified as Mantrayoga.

Manuscript U_2 contains detailed additional passages that address this issue and describes a practice that can be identified as Mantrayoga. For each *cakra*, all manuscripts instruct *dhyāna* (meditation) on the respective *cakra*. Manuscript U_2, in addition to various supplementary details, always includes an indication of the duration of the meditation, measured in *ajapājapa*s ("the recitations of the non-recitation").[731] Finally, the additional material in sec-

[731] The *cakra*s additionally receive the same time indication measured in *ghaṭi*s, *pala*s and *akṣara*s. Instructions for the duration of the practice of meditation are in most of the additions of U_2 for each *cakra*, except the seventh *cakra* at the palate and the ninth *cakra* named

tion XI of manuscript U_2 makes it clear that the so-called *ajapā mantra* or *haṃsa mantra* must be meant here:[732]

> *sakāreṇa bahir yāti hakāreṇa viśet punaḥ |*
> *haṃsaḥ so 'haṃ tato mantraṃ jīvo japati sarvadā ||*
>
> With the sound "sa", he exhales. With the sound "ha", he inhales again: "I am he, he is I". Because of that, the embodied soul constantly utters the Mantra.

The *ajapā mantra* ("unmuttered mantra") consists of the two syllables *haṃ* and *saḥ* according to the phonological association with the sound of inhalation and exhalation. Because all living beings inhale and exhale, they recite the *ajapā mantra* continuously day and night. At the same time, *haṃsa*,

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mahāśūnyacakra. For example, manuscript U_2 instructs a total of 600 *ajapājapa*s as the duration of meditation onto the *mūlacakra*. This refers to the duration of the voiceless uttering of the natural *mantra* of the breath: *so 'haṃ* ("he is I")—*haṃ sa* ("I am him"). As in many other yoga texts, the total amount of *ajapājapa* per day is declared to be 21600 (cf. section XI. on p. 134, l. 7). If 21600 *ajapājapa* equals 24 hours, then 600 *ajapājapa* would equal 40 minutes. In the additions of U_2, one finds the same numbers of *ajapājapa* as in the instructions for meditation onto the seven *cakra*-system of Jayatarāma (cf. Maheśānanda, Sharma, Sahay, and Bodhe, 2006: 163 and *Jogpradīpyakā* 889–912). The redactor of the text as found in U_2 applied the system of the durations for seven *cakra*s to the ninefold *cakra* system of Rāmacandra. Next, the duration that was mentioned before as 600 *ajapājapa* is repeated in another scheme by stating "*ghaṭi* 1 *palāni* 40". One *ghaṭi* equals 1/60 of a day (see Sircar, 1966: 114), which is 24 minutes. One *pala* equals 1/60 of a *ghaṭi*, which is 24 seconds (see Boethlingk, 1858: 4). The *Amanaska* in 1.35 (cf. Birch, 2013: 231) uses the same concept. For a more detailed tracing of the usage of the system in yogic and tantric literature, see Birch, 2013: 265, n. 46. In our case, the 24 minutes of the one *ghaṭi* plus the 16 minutes (40x24 seconds) of 40 *pala*s once more sums up to 40 minutes for the instructed duration of meditation onto the first *cakra*. Other systems are less specific. *Kumbhakapaddhati* 208, e.g. states: *ṣaṇṇimeṣo bhavat prāṇaḥ ṣaḍbhiḥ prāṇaiḥ palaṃ smṛtaṃ | palaiḥ ṣaṣṭibhir eva syād ghaṭikākālasammitā ||* "Six winkings are one *prāṇa*, six *prāṇa*s make up one *pala*. Sixty *pala*s equal the time-period of a *ghaṭikā*." According to Birch (2013) the time unit *akṣara* appears in Bhāskara's *Siddhāntaśiromaṇi* (17cd – 18ab of the *Kālamānādhyāya* in the *Madhyamādhikāra*): *gurvakṣaraiḥ khendumitair asus taiḥ | ṣaḍbhiḥ palaṃ tair ghaṭikā khaṣaḍbhiḥ || syād vā ghaṭīṣaṣṭir ahaḥ kharāmair māso dinais tair dvikubhiś ca varṣam |* Birch, 2013: 265, n. 46 translates: "A breath is ten long syllables, and a Pala is six breaths, sixty Palas is one Ghaṭikā, sixty Ghaṭikās is a day, thirty days is a month, and twelve months is a year." If one assumes an *akṣara* to be 1/10 of a breath and 21600 breaths per day, one hour would have 900 breaths, one minute would equal 16 breaths, one breath would equal 4 seconds, and one *akṣara* would be 0,4 seconds or 400 milliseconds.

[732] The earliest mention of the *ajapā mantra* or *haṃsa mantra* in yoga literature is likely found in *Vivekamārtaṇḍa* 28–30.

most often translated as "swan" or "goose" in English, is a famous and ancient metaphor for the soul travelling through the wheel of Brahman or Saṃsāra.[733] Sometimes this mantra is also specified as *ajapāgāyatrī*.[734]

Manuscript U_2 explains that the total daily number of all silent recitations of the *haṃsa mantra* is 21600.[735] The association of the term Mantrayoga with the practice of *haṃsa mantra* is widespread in Sanskrit yoga literature.[736]

From a text-critical perspective, there is ambivalent evidence regarding the authenticity of the passages under discussion. All manuscripts mention Mantrayoga in the above passage. We must, therefore, assume that Mantrayoga was originally and perhaps even deliberately specified here by Rāmacandra, even if, or precisely because, he reads the source text differently. But why?[737]

The fact that only the manuscript U_2 explicitly teaches a Mantrayoga must make one suspicious. This manuscript only contains additional material in the sections IV–XII. The most likely scenario is that the scribe of the manuscript U_2 made these additions to provide the missing explanations

[733] See *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* 1.6 and 3.18.

[734] The *ajapā* can be seen as a yogic appropriation of the Vedic *gāyatrīmantra*, cf. Mallinson and Singleton, 2017: 134.

[735] The number of total breaths is based on the assumption of an average breath duration of four seconds. Each day has 86400 seconds. If one divides this total number by four, one gets the 21600 breaths of the *ajapā mantra*. Birch (2013: 265, n. 46) argues that this assumption comes from *Svacchandatantra* 7.54–55. In addition to the U_2 manuscript of *Tattvayogabindu*, this yogic axiom is widely used in Sanskrit yoga literature. See for example *Amaraughaprabodha* 58, Hemacandra's *Hemacandra's Yogaśāstra* 5.232, *Vivekamārtaṇḍa* 46, *Gheraṇḍasaṃhitā* 5.79, *Dhyānabindūpaniṣad* 62ab–63ab or *Jogpradīpyakā* 913.

[736] See e.g. *Yogabīja* 147; *Śivayogapradīpikā* 2.26–27 and 2.29–32. Powell (2023: 205) explains that in his text "mantra is reframed and interiorised within a *prāṇāyāma* environment, specifically in the form of the *ajapā*, the 'unuttered' mantra"); *Yogacintāmaṇi* (Ed. p. 12); *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* 55.28; and *Yogaśikhopaniṣad* 132.

[737] Mantrayoga, which in the *Tattvayogabindu* III is introduced within the context of an explanation of the channels, followed by a description of the *cakra*s could make sense in this context if we apply a perspective similar to *Śivayogapradīpikā* 2.34: *so 'haṃ kṛtvātmamantraṃ svapadaparapadaṃ vyaktavarṇadvayaṃ tad vyālumped vyañjane dve punar api racayed divyam oṃkāramantram | kṛtvānusvārayuktaṃ sakalamanuvaraṃ brahmanāḍīṃ nayed yaḥ pūrṇānandaḥ sa kuṇḍalyanubhavavikalaḥ karmaṇo muktim eti* || 34 || Powell (2023: 322) translates: "Having made *so 'ham* one's personal mantra—in which the two syllables are expressed as one's self and the Supreme—[the yogin] should take away the two consonants and refashion it as the divine mantra *oṃ*. Having joined it with the nasal sound (*anusvāra*), it is the best of all mantras. He who leads it to the *brahmanāḍī* (i.e. *suṣumṇā*) is full of bliss, [even if] deprived of the experience of Kuṇḍalinī. He attains release from [all] *karma*."

on Mantrayoga.[738] As a γ-group manuscript, U_2 preserves a later stage of transmission than the β-group. Nevertheless, the γ-group remains important for reconstructing the text, as the β-group is relied upon precisely in those sections where its transmission is clearly defective, and U_2 is among the best representatives of the γ-group.[739]

Given these considerations, the supplementary material of U_2 is included in greyscale in the edition rather than in footnotes, both because it resolves textual issues and is of interest for reception history. The stemmatic evidence suggests the scribe likely added this material to specify Mantrayoga, but its originality cannot be entirely ruled out. Overall, the only reasonable conclusion is that Mantrayoga was present in the original text: Rāmacandra probably conceived of it in relation to the *cakra*s, but did not fully incorporate it in his final wording. This conception may have resembled that of U_2 or *Śivayogapradīpikā* 2.34, consistent with other textual inconsistencies Rāmacandra produced.

3.10.2 Mantrayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

Nārāyaṇatīrtha locates Mantrayoga, like Jñānayoga before it, in the context of *Yogasūtra* 1.28.[740] This *sūtra* and the corresponding commentary by Nārāyatīrtha have already been discussed in the section on Jñānayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*[741] and therefore need not be repeated here.[742] Mantrayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* is *japa* ("low-voice muttering") of *praṇava* ("sa-

[738] The connection between Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga and Mantrayoga established in U_2 is found in a similar form in *Śāradātilakatantra* 25.37ab: "The *kuṇḍalī* Śakti abides in the *haṃsaḥ* [and] supports the [individual] Self." (*bibharti kuṇḍalī śaktir ātmānaṃ haṃsaṃ āśritā* |), see Bühnemann 2011: 218, 228.

[739] E.g., it preserves the only possible correct variant of a sentence in III: *bhuktimuktidā śivarūpiṇī suṣumṇānāḍī pravartate | asyā jñānotpattau satyāṃ puruṣaḥ sarvajño bhavati* |

[740] For a discussion of meditation on *praṇava* in the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*, see Maas, 2009: 276–280.

[741] See p. 347 et seqq.

[742] For another discussion of Mantrayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* see Penna, 2004: 71–76.

cred syllable *oṃ*"), which can be performed in two alternative ways, as Jñānayoga[743] or Advaitayoga.[744]

3.10.3 Mantrayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

Sundardās introduces his Mantrayoga (2.16–27) with the question of how the formless and featureless highest reality can be described.[745] For without naming it, one cannot refer to it.[746] A personal surrender, a devotion to the highest reality, is the basic prerequisite for Bhaktiyoga, the superordinate category of Sundardās's Mantrayoga. According to Sundardās, the best, or verbatim, the crown of all names for the highest reality is *rāma*.[747] After several verses of praise of the *rāma mantra* Sundardās explains that the *rāma mantra* has to be learnt from the Guru. At the beginning of Mantrayoga practice, one is supposed to recite the *rāma mantra* with the tongue, i.e. audibly.[748] In the course of the practice, the *rāma mantra* is then supposed to be recited mentally, constantly, day and night, in order to unite the practitioner with the omnipresent supreme reality:

> *++pīchai hiradai maiṃ dhārai | jihvā rahita maṃtra uccārai |*
> *niśa dina mana tāsauṃ raha lāgau | kabahūṃ naiṃka na ṭūṭai dhāgau ‖*
> 24 ‖
> *puni tahāṃ pragaṭa hoī raṃkārā | āpu hi āpu akhaṇḍita dhārā |*
> *tana mana bisari jāī tahāṃ soī | romahi roma rāma dhuni hoī ‖* 25 ‖
>
> (24) Afterwards, retain it [the mantra] in the heart; recite the mantra without the tongue. Night and day, let your mind stay attached to it; may the thread never break.
> (25) Then there, the omnipresent one manifests; an unbroken stream by itself, Body and mind forgotten there, in that state; in every hair, the sound of Rāma resonates.

[743] For a discussion of Jñānayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, see p. 347.
[744] The concept of Advaitayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* is discussed on p. 348.
[745] *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 2.16cd: *jākai kachū rūpa nahiṃ reṣā kauna prakāra jāī so deṣā ‖* 16 ‖
[746] Ibid. 2.17b: *nāma binā nahiṃ lagai piyārā |*
[747] Ibid. 2.19cd: *rāma mantra sabakai siramaurā tāhi na koī pūjata aurā ‖* 19 ‖
[748] Ibid. 2.23cd: *prathama ..vana suni guru kai pāsā puni so rasanā karat abhyāsā ‖* 23 ‖

Thus, Mantrayoga in *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* is a form of Bhaktiyoga that seeks union with the highest reality in the form of devotional recitation of the *rāma mantra*.

3.10.4 Mantrayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Mantrayoga within the four texts of the complex early modern yoga taxonomies reveals a broad range of applied variants of this form of yoga. It reflects the variety of adaption of the practice across different traditions during the 16th and 17th centuries.

Rāmacandra, or at least some of the readers of his *Tattvayogabindu*, understood Mantrayoga as a practice involving meditation on one of the nine *cakra*s while mentally reciting the *ajapā mantra*.

Nārāyaṇatīrtha understands Mantrayoga as *japa* of *oṃ*, which symbolises Īśvara and his qualities. This can either be performed as Jñanayoga—while silently reciting *oṃ*, the mind is focused on the distinction between consciousness (*puruṣa*) and primordial nature (*prakṛti*) including its effects (*tatkārya*). Or, it is performed as Advaitayoga—while silently reciting *oṃ* one is supposed to reflect on the non-difference between the supreme self (*paramātman*) and the individual self (*jīva*).

Finally, Sundardās' Mantrayoga is the devotional recitation of the *rāma mantra*.

We discovered that Mantrayoga has evolved in various forms across different traditions. The practices and the practitioners have undergone significant changes over the centuries, and intriguingly, Mantrayoga has seemingly shed its negative image, which was prevalent in some early Haṭhayoga traditions, and has gained in popularity.

3.11 Lakṣyayoga

LAKṢYAYOGA, the "Yoga of foci", is one of the most voluminous and most important topics[749] in the *Tattvayogabindu*.[750] The concept of this type of yoga has a complex history of reception, and its origins as a category of specific yoga techniques can be traced far back into early Tantric texts.

The yoga practice of *lakṣya*s derives from an ancient Śaiva paradigm. The roots of this paradigm are difficult to reconstruct precisely. In many cases, the *lakṣya*s are taught together with a system of six to nine *cakra*s, sixteen *ādhāra*s and five *vyoma*s, *ākāśa*s or *kha*s. In most texts that take up this paradigm, there is a variant of a verse also contained in the *Tattvayogabindu*, which lists the elements just mentioned as essential components of yoga.[751] Perhaps the oldest datable textual evidence for the practice of yogic *lakṣya*s can be found in *Netratantra* 7.1–2, which was composed between 700–850 CE.[752] Here, the *lakṣya*s are only listed but not explained in detail, so we can assume that this practice is probably even older than the *Netratantra* itself. Kṣemarāja, in his *Netroddyota* commentary, further elaborates on the three *lakṣya*s. Enveloped in enigmatic language, he briefly states in the context of *Netratantra* 7.27:

> *trīṇy antarbahirubhayarūpāṇi lakṣyāṇi lakṣaṇīyāni yatra* |
> *nirāvaraṇarūpatvāt "khamanantaṃ tu janmākhyaṃ"*|
>
> The three foci, internal, external or both, are to be attained, and because they are unobstructed, "The endless void is called the birth."

[749] In the *Śivayogapradīpikā* 1.8, the one who has attained the realisation of Brahman using the (in this case) three *lakṣya*s is called a knower of Rājayoga. In this text, the practice of *lakṣya*s is the primary characteristic practice of Rājayoga. In addition, being free from mental fluctuation through gnosis is specified as the second characteristic practice: *triṣu lakṣyeṣu yo brahmasākṣātkāraṃ gamiṣyati | jñāne vātha manovṛttirahito rājayogavit* ‖ 1.8 ‖

[750] The sections XIII (overview of the five *lakṣya*s), XIV (*adholakṣya*), XV (*ūrdhvalakṣya*), XXIII (*bāhyalakṣya*), XXIV (*antaralakṣya*) and XXVII (*madhyalakṣya*) of the *Tattvayogabindu* deal exclusively with the types of Lakṣyayoga.

[751] See *Tattvayogabindu* section XXVIII.1 for the verse and its variants in other contemporary and earlier texts.

[752] Sanderson, 2004: 243.

After this, the *lakṣya*s are not mentioned explicitly. Yet *Netratantra* 8.39–44 clearly alludes to *lakṣya* techniques: the yogin, already in *samādhi*, is instructed to abandon meditation on various foci. The rejected foci closely parallel the three to five *lakṣya*s found in early modern yoga taxonomies. For example, *Netratantra* 8.42 states:

> *nāntaḥ śarīrasaṃsthāne na bāhye bhāvayet kvacit |*
> *nākāśe bandhayel lakṣyaṃ nādho dṛṣṭiṃ niveśayet ‖* 42 ‖
>
> One should not contemplate any place of the body inside or outside. One should not fix one's attention towards the sky (open space), nor should one direct one's gaze downwards.[753]

The *Mālinīviyajottaratantra* (12.9) and other linked Tantras[754] also contain a system of *lakṣya*s. In the *Mālinīviyajottaratantra*, there are six *lakṣya*s. These six *lakṣya*s are labelled as follows: 1. emptiness (*vyoman*), 2. body (*vigraha*), 3. drop (*bindu*), 4. phoneme (*arṇa*), 5. world (*bhuvana*) and 6. resonance (*dhvani*). According to Vasudeva (2004: 255), *lakṣyabheda* in *Mālinīviyajottaratantra* denotes "the ultimate destination upon which the Yogin must fix his attention". These *lakṣya*s are "different manifestations through which Śiva can be approached". He further states: "To the Yogin engaged in the conquest of realities the *lakṣya*s serve as teleological magnets drawing him towards the sought after rewards". Despite the same basic concept, the *lakṣya*s of the *Mālinīviyajottaratantra* appear very different at the first glance. On closer inspection, however, there are striking parallels with the *lakṣya* systems found in the late medieval texts treated in this chapter. For example, the first *lakṣya* of the *Mālinīviyajottaratantra* 12.10abc is described as follows:

> *bāhyābhyantarabhedena samuccayakṛtena ca trividhaṃ kīrtitaṃ vyoma |*
>
> The void is said to be threefold by the division of external, internal and that arising from accumulation.

[753] Additionally, cf. *Netratantra* 8.44ab.
[754] E.g. *Kiraṇatantra* 2.22–23 and *Dīkṣottara* 2.2–3.

Vasudeva (2004: 263) maintains that this elliptical definition can only be explained on the basis of the teachings on the voids of other Śaiva Tantras but notes that none of the systems he consulted show complete congruence with the position of the *Mālinīviyajottaratantra*. Nevertheless, he cites, for example, the passages from *Dīkṣottara* 3.10c–11 and *Svacchandatantra* 4.289 that are particularly interesting for our context, in which an upper emptiness (*ūrdhvaśūnya*), a lower emptiness (*adhaḥśūnya*) and a middle emptiness (*madhyaśūnya*) are distinguished.

Taken together, the basic features of the late medieval differentiation of the five *lakṣya*s into *ūrdhva-*, *adho-*, *bāhya-*, *antara-*, and *madhyalakṣya* can already be discerned here.[755] This rough overview illustrates that different systems of yogic *lakṣya* practices have been circulating in the Śaiva Tantras for a very long time. Over the centuries, the techniques were passed on, copied and reused in the yoga traditions of Haṭha- and Rājayoga.

In addition to the four texts analysed in this chapter, different forms of *lakṣya* practice can also be found, for example, in *Vivekamārtaṇḍa*, *Śivayogapradīpikā*, (recensions of the *Haṭhapradīpikā*), *Yogasvarodaya*, *Nityanāthapaddhati*, *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, *Yogacūḍāmaṇyupaniṣad*, *Maṇḍalabrāhmaṇopaniṣat*, *Haṭhatattvakaumudī* and *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā*. However, it was not labelled as an independent yoga category until the texts of the complex late medieval yoga taxonomies emerged. In the fifteen-fold yoga taxonomy of the *Tattvayogabindu*, Lakṣyayoga is listed as the ninth method of Rājayoga. The *Yogasvarodaya* does not mention Lakṣyayoga in its introductory verses. The *Yogasvarodaya* dedicates two verses to listing the fifteen yogas. Although the verses announce fifteen yogas, only eight yogas are specified, probably for metrical reasons. Lakṣyayoga is not among the eight yogas mentioned but is dealt with in detail throughout the text. In the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Lakṣyayoga is the eighth yoga method Nārāyaṇatīrtha mentions.[756] Within the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* Sundardās

[755] The *lakṣya*s of the *Mālinīviyajottaratantra* are discussed in detail in Vasudeva, 2004: 253–293.

[756] For an earlier discussion of *Lakṣyayoga* in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, see Penna, 2004: 77–78.

presents Lakṣayoga[757] as one of the four methods of Haṭhayoga alongside Rāja- and Aṣṭāṅgayoga.[758] In contrast to the yoga categories discussed so far, Lakṣyayoga is conceptually largely congruent within the late medieval texts of the complex yoga taxonomies and differs only in a few details.

3.11.1 Lakṣyayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu*, *Yogasvarodaya* and *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

The three texts present Lakṣyayoga as an explicitly simple yoga method right at the beginning of their respective discourses. The descriptions of the texts are very similar in the majority of instances. Thus, a separate analysis of them, as in the previous chapters, would be redundant. The word *lakṣya* means "goal". In the practice of Lakṣyayoga, it refers to goals on which the gaze (*dṛṣṭi*) and the mind are directed, i.e. a "focus" for stabilising the mind on which one constantly meditates. The three texts distinguish five categories from one another, depending on the place to be focussed. The following order[759] is given in the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*: 1. the upper focus (*ūrdhvalakṣya*), 2. the lower focus (*adholakṣya*), 3. the outer focus (*bāhyalakṣya*), 4. the middle focus (*madhyalakṣya*) and 5. the inner focus (*antar(a)lakṣya*).[760,761] Meditation on particular foci produces specific results.

3.11.1.1 Ūrdhvalakṣya

In the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*, the upper focus (*ūrdhvalakṣya*)[762] refers to the fixation of the gaze (*dṛṣṭi*) and the mind (*manas*) on the centre of the sky, or the zenith (*ākāśamadhye*). This results in the unity of the gaze

[757] The terms vary in the literature. The most common term is *lakṣya*, but *lakṣa* or *lakṣana* were also commonly specified.

[758] See Burger (2014: 697–98) for another discussion of Lakṣayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* in French.

[759] The order in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* is not identical, but as follows: 1. *adho lakṣa*, 2. *ūrddha lakṣa*, 3. *madhya lakṣa*, 4. *bāhya lakṣa* and 5. *aṃtar lakṣa*.

[760] Only in *Tattvayogabindu* is this *lakṣya* is designated as *antaralakṣya*. In all other texts, including the *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā*, which quotes the *Tattvayogabindu*, the term *antarlakṣya* is used.

[761] In the *Tattvayogabindu* section XIII, in the *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, Ed. pp. 833–834) and *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.25–36.

[762] *Tattvayogabindu* XV, *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 834) and *Yogakarṇikā* 2.5.

with the splendour of the Supreme God (*parameśvara*). In addition, an object arises in the sky within the practitioner's scope of vision, an object that was previously unseen.[763] The latter effect is cryptic. The source text, the *Yogasvarodaya*, also does not contribute to clarity in this case, as there is no parallel passage. The *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā*[764] quotes this passage literally, without further explanation. The only clue lies in the description of *ūrddha lakṣa* in *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.27. The technique described here is identical. The practitioner shall focus the gaze on the sky day and night. Sundardās explains the effect resulting from the practice in similar terms.[765] In 3.27cd Sundardās states: "Various kinds of splendour manifest, the essence of the Gopīs' object of consideration becomes visible." Due to the striking similarity of the formulations and the fact that Sundardās must have been a contemporary of Rāmacandra, a correlation is probable. Sundardās was a disciple of Dādū Dayāl (1544–1603) and a member of the school named after him, and therefore a Vaiṣṇava, so the phrase "the essence of the object of the Gopīs' consideration" is probably the essence of Krṣṇa. Gopīs are paradigmatic figures of devotion (*bhakti*) to Kṛṣṇa.[766] Since Kṛṣṇa is considered the eighth *avatāra* of Viṣṇu, the essence or being of Kṛṣṇa is probably Viṣṇu, who is sometimes called *puruṣottama* or *parameśvara*. Whether the *adṛṣṭaḥ padārthaḥ* of Rāmacandra derives from the *gopi padāratha* is uncertain, but the parallels to the wording of the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* are striking. Rāmacandra does not seem to favour any sectarian affiliation, and despite the clear Śaiva orientation of the main source text of his compilation, he is remarkably neutral in his formulations. Here, once more, he maintains his neutrality.

[763] *Tattvayogabindu* XIV (Ed. p. 146): *etasya lakṣyasya dṛḍhīkaraṇāt parameśvarasya tejasā saha dṛṣṭer aikyaṃ bhavati | atha cākāśamadhye yaḥ kaścid adṛṣṭaḥ padārtho bhavati | sa sādhakasya dṛṣṭigocare bhavati |*

[764] *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* MMPP MS. No. 2244 f. 124v ll. 1–2.

[765] *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.27: *ūrddha lakṣa karai ihīṃ bhāṃtī | duṣty ākāśa rahai dina rātī | bibidh prakāra hoi ujiyārā | gopi padāratha dīsahiṃ sārā ‖ 27 ‖*

[766] See e.g. *Bhāgavatapurāṇa* 10.29.

3.11.1.2 Adholakṣya

The lower focus (*adholakṣya*) as presented in the *Tattvayogabindu* requires the stabilisation of the gaze (*dṛṣṭi*) at a distance of twelve fingers' breadth from the tip of the nose or on the tip of the nose itself. The technique stabilises the *dṛṣṭi*, the breath and prolongs life.[767,768] Afterwards, the practitioner is supposed to focus inwardly and outwardly on emptiness (*śūnya*), which leads to freedom from the fear of death (*maraṇatrāsa*).[769] Sundaradeva, in his *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā*,[770] quotes the full passage of *Tattvayogabindu*'s *adholakṣya* without attribution. However, the *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* transmits further techniques to the description of *adholakṣya*:[771]

[767] *Yogasvarodaya* (PT): *nāsikopari deveśi dvādaśāṅgulamānataḥ dṛṣṭiḥ sthirā* (*dṛṣṭisthiran* YK 2.5) *tu karttavyā* (*karttavyam* YK 2.5) *adholakṣam idaṃ bhaja* (*bhajet* YK 2. 5) | *athavā* (*tathā ca* YK 2.5) *nāsikāgre tu sthirā dṛṣṭir iyaṃ bhavet* (*śṛṇu* YK 2. 5) *sthirā dṛṣṭiś cirāyuḥ syāt tathāsau* (*yasya bhavet sthirā dṛṣṭiś cirāyuḥ* YK 2. 6) *sthiradṛṣṭimān* |

[768] Rāmacandra, in contrast to *Yogasvarodaya*, notes at this point that both options are taught as techniques of external focus (*bāhyalakṣya*). The difference for Rāmacandra appears to be not only the designation but, above all, the subsequent focussing on *śūnya*.

[769] Rāmacandra reduces and massively changes his source text; see p. 148. Rāmacandra's *adholakṣya* on *śūnya* is attributed to *antarlakṣya* in the *Yogasvarodaya*. For a translation of the passage, see p. 403.

[770] The collation of the passages of the *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* I based on ORI B 220 (f. 239r l. 8 to f. 240r l. 13), GOML R 3239 (f. 258 l. 14 to f. 259 l. 10) and MMPP 2244 (f. 124r ll. 5–9 to f. 125r ll. 1–2).

[771] This passage may represent material composed by Sundaradeva himself, or is derived from an as yet unidentified source.

athavā dṛṣṭir netrayor dvayor netrādhobhāgayor akṣikūṭayos tad adhogallayor ubhayor upari sthirā kartavyā | ekānte vijane dīpam āvarake saṃsthāpya ciraṃ gatvāvalokya stheyam | ghaṭīmātraṃ vā ghaṭikārdhaṃ vā tato dīpam ācchādya bhūmau sarvatrāvalokane sarvaṃ śvetanīlapītasphuliṅgasphuliṅgakaṇānte maṇḍalākārīṇi ceti jyotiścakrāṇi pañca ṣad vā dṛśyante | tataś cāṃdhakāre dṛśyate | dīptimat sarvaṃ svaśarīraṃ dṛśyate | bhāsate sarvo 'pi sapradeśo dīptimān sphuṭo dṛśyate | ekadārḍhye jyotirmayacakrānte parameśvarasya tejomūrtir dṛśyate | puṃsaḥ paramānandotpattir jāyate | svadehavismṛtiś ca saṃbhavati | athavā svanetrayor vartamanīr dakṣahastamadhyamātarjanībhyām akṣikuṭayor adhaḥ kṛtvā akṣivartmanī dṛḍhaṃ cālanī ye ghaṭikārdhaṃ vā ghaṭīmātraṃ tata evaṃ kṛte sādhakasyāgre suśvetajyotiḥ prākāśaḥ prāg bhavatīti |

Alternatively, the gaze should be fixed on the lower parts of both eyes, at the rim of the eye sockets, just above the cheeks. In a lonely place without people, a lamp shall be placed in a darkened [room][and] after some time has passed, one should remain there watching it. After one *ghaṭikā* (24 minutes), or half a *ghaṭikā* (12 minutes)[already], having covered the lamp and then, while looking all around on the ground, five or six circles of light appear, which are shaped like *maṇḍala*s and occur amidst white, blue, and yellow sparks.

1–13 Jo = Jodhpur MS. No. 2244; G = Chennai GOML Ms. No. R 3239; G_{pc} = ibid. *post correctionem*; M = Mysore ORI Ms. No. B 220.

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1 dṛṣṭir Jo] dṛṣṭi $GG_{pc}M$ **dvayor** $GG_{pc}M$] dvayo Jo **netrādhobhāgayor** $GG_{pc}M$] netrā 'dhobhāgayor Jo **1–2 adhogallayor** em.] adhogallayo cett. **2 ubhayor** GG_{pc}] rūpayor CJo, rūpa M **upari** GG_{pc}Jo] pari M **āvarake** Jo] āvake $GG_{pc}M$ **3 ghaṭīmātraṃ** $GG_{pc}M$] ghaṭīmātra J **5 °pīta°** Jo] yoṃta M, yomta GG_{pc} **°kaṇānte** MGG_{pc}] °kaṇāṃ 'te Jo **maṇḍalākārīṇi** em.] maṇḍalākāriṇiś cett. **ceti** $GG_{pc}M$] ceta Jo **6 cāṃdhakāre** GG_{pc}Jo] vāṃdhakāre M **8 ekadārḍhye** em.] ekadārḍye G_{pc}, etadārḍye G **9 saṃbhavati** $GG_{pc}M$] saṃbhavati | athavā svanetrayor vartmanīr dakṣahastamadhyamātarjanībhyām akṣikū dehavismṛtiś ca saṃbhavati | Jo **10 vartamanīr** Jo] vartmanā $GG_{pc}M$ **11 akṣikuṭayor** em.] ākṣikoṭayor M, akṣikūṭakūṭayor GG_{pc}, akṣikūtvā Jo **adhaḥ kṛtvā** $GG_{pc}M$] *om.* Jo **akṣivartmanī** $GG_{pc}M$] akṣivanmanī Jo **12 sādhakasyāgre** em.] sādhyakasyāgre GJoM **suśvetajyotiḥ** GJo] suśvītajyotiḥ M **13 prāg** $GG_{pc}M$] prāgvad Jo

> As a result, one is able to see in the dark. One's entire body is seen as luminous. Also, the entire surrounding area appears radiant [and] becomes clearly visible. When one becomes firmly established in one of the circles of light, the luminous form of the supreme lord is seen. Supreme bliss arises for the person. Forgetting of one's own body occurs.
>
> Alternatively, having placed the thumb and index finger of the right hand below the edge of the eye socket at the eyelids of the own eyes, and steadily causing to move [the fingers] at the eyelids, either for a half *ghaṭikā* (12 minutes) or for a *ghaṭikā* (24 minutes), as a result of having done this, very bright white light becomes visible in front of the practitioner.

Sundardās's *adho lakṣa* is the simple focusing of the gaze on the tip of the nose, which leads to the stabilisation of breath and mind.[772]

3.11.1.3 Bāhyalakṣya

The external focus (*bāhyalaksya*)[773] is the fixation of the gaze (*dṛṣṭi*) on one of the five gross elements at different distances from the tip of the nose or, in one case, directly on the tip of the nose. The texts present the foci as alternatives. The presentation of the three texts follows the same pattern in every case. They list a specific location, followed by an element (in most cases) and a characteristic, such as an associated colour. A table is the best way to illustrate the spread of the various techniques across the texts.

[772] *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 2.26: *prathamahīṃ adho lakṣa kauṃ jānaiṃ | nāśā agra dṛṣṭi sthira ānaiṃ | yātoṃ mana pavanā thira hoī | adho lakṣa jo sādhai koī* ‖ 26 ‖

[773] *Tattvayogabindu* XXIII; *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 837).

Table 4: Foci of Bāhyalakṣya

Location	**Element**	**Characteristic**	***Yogatattva-bindu***	**Yoga-svarodaya**	***Haṭha-saṃketa-candrikā***	***Sarvāṅga-yogapra-dīpikā***
Four finger breadths from the nose	Space	Appearing blue, full of splendour	x[774]	x[775]	x[776]	x
Six finger breadths from the nose	Wind	In the shape of smoke	x	x	-	x
Eight finger breadths from the nose	Fire	Very red	x	x	x	x
Ten finger breadths from the nose	Water	White, fickle	x	-	-	x
Twelve finger breadths from the nose	Earth	Yellow-coloured	x	-	-	x
At the tip of the nose	Space	Full of fire, shining like ten million suns	x	-	-	-
Above the space-element	Space	Connected to the sun without the sun (thousand rays)	x	-	-	-
Seventeen-finger wide distance above the head	Light	Mass of light	x	x	-	-
In front of the gaze	Earth	Appearing in the colour of molten gold	x	x	-	-

[774] A “x”signifies the presence, and a “-” the absense of the focus in the text.
[775] Here, the *Yogasvarodaya* mentions no element.
[776] The *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* provides the wind as the element and the shape of smoke as the characteristic of this focus.

Table 4 shows that the *Tattvayogabindu* contains the greatest variety of foci of the *bāhyalakṣya* category. Sundaradeva does not adopt all the foci in his *Yogasaṃketacandrikā*. However, here, the transmission of this passage appears partially corrupt, since the witnesses mix up the first two foci. The *Yogasvarodaya* only contains five of the nine foci in the table. Thus, it seems natural, that Rāmacandra has added further foci based on the explanations of Bahirlakṣya in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.28 (Ed. 38–40).[777] Sundardās describes the first five foci for the five elements in a perfectly analogous fashion.[778] In the last verse of his explanation of *bāhya lakṣa*, he explains that there are many more *bāhya lakṣa*s, but they must be revealed by the Guru.[779] The effects attributed to the practice of *bāhyalakṣya* are similar throughout the texts. Regardless of the variant practised, the practice promises rejuvenation, improved health, sometimes even an improved social life[780] and a longer life span etc.

3.11.1.4 Antar(a)lakṣya

The inner focus (*antar(a)lakṣya*) is a special case, as there are noticeable deviations between Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya*. Although Rāmacandra continues to follow the *Yogasvarodaya* in terms of structure and content for the description of his *antar(a)lakṣya*, the passages in the *Yogasvarodaya* are not explicitly attributed to *antaralakṣya*, but are evidently assigned to the preceding *bāhyalakṣya*.[781] In addition, Rāmacandra simultaneously uses the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* (2.26–27) as a template for this passage, which attributes largely similar practices to the category of *antar(a)lakṣya*. In the *Yogasvarodaya*, there is a separate description of *antarlakṣya*, the core practice

[777] The *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* teaches only three instead of five Lakṣyas: *antarlakṣya* (2.26–27); *bahirlakṣya* (2.28); and *madhyalakṣya* (2.29).

[778] *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 2.29–31.

[779] Ibid. 2.32: *bāhya lakṣa aur bahuterī so jānaṃ jo pāvai serī | sataguru kṛpā karai jau kabahī | dei batāi chinak maiṃ sabahī* ‖ 32 ‖

[780] *Tattvayogabindu* XXIII: *samagrāḥ śatravaḥ svapne 'pi mitratām ayānti |*

[781] Cf. *Tattvayogabindu* XXIV and *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, pp. 837–38).

of which was already integrated by Rāmacandra in the context of his *adho-lakṣya*.[782] The concept of the *antar lakṣa* of Sundardās is essentially identical.

In the XXIV section of the *Tattvayogabindu*, Rāmacandra specifies a total of three alternative *antar(a)lakṣya*s. As part of the explanations of the first *antar(a)lakṣya*, Rāmacandra first presents a description of the central channel in the yogic body, which is labelled here as *brahmanāḍī*. It originates from the spine (*brahmadaṇḍa*) and passes through the spine from bottom to top. The central channel extends from the root-bulb (*mūlakanda*) to the opening of Brahman (*brahmarandhra*) at the top of the head. It is shaped like the stem of a lotus flower and shines like ten million suns. The practice of *antar(a)lakṣya* consists of meditating on it, which allows the practitioner to acquire supernatural abilities. Just the first of the three techniques appears in the context of *antar lakṣa* in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* of Sundardās, albeit in less detail. According to Sundardās, one is supposed to meditate on the central channel also called *brahmanāḍī*, which brings about the eight supernatural abilities.[783]

Rāmacandra's second technique for the practice of *antaralakṣya* is a meditation on a bright light above the forehead, preventing certain diseases.

His third alternative for the practice of *antaralakṣya* is meditation on the very fine red light in the centre between the eyebrows, which causes the yogin to be loved by everyone in the royal court and ensures that no one can take their eyes off him.[784]

Interestingly, the *antar(a)lakṣya* of the *Yogasvarodaya*,[785] differs greatly from the models in *Tattvayogabindu*, *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, and *Siddhasiddhānta-paddhati*. It is exclusively about meditation on emptiness (*śūnya*):

[782] This is the meditation on emptiness (*śūnya*), cf. *Tattvayogabindu* XV and *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 834).

[783] *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.33: *aṃtar lakṣa ju sunahuṃ prakāśā | brahma nāḍikā karahu abhyāsā | aṣṭa siddhi nava niddhi jahāṃlauṃ | ṭarahiṃ na kabahūṃ jivai jahāṃ lauṃ ‖ 33 ‖*

[784] All three techniques of *antar(a)lakṣya* are also specified in the *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 837–838), but still in the context of *bāhyalakṣya*: *mūlakandotthatalato brahmanāḍīsamudbhavā | śvetavarṇā brahmarandhraparyantam eva tiṣṭhati | eṣā tu brahmarandhrākhyā tanmadhye varttate parā | padmatantusamākārā koṭisūryataḍitprabhā | calaty ūrddhaṃ mahāmūrttir asya dhyānād bhavec chivaḥ | aṇimādy aṣṭasiddhis tu samagreṇa prasīdati | lalāṭopari vā dhyātvā candraṃ vā jyotir īśvaram | nāśayet kuṣṭharogādīn mahāyuṣmān śivaḥ paraḥ | bhruvor madhye 'thavā dhyātvā arkan tu teja iśvaram | sthiradṛṣṭau rājapūjyo jīvanmuktaḥ śivo yathā | ātmānam ātmarūpaṃ hi dhyātvā yo niṣkriyo bhavet | nirāśīryatattvo 'yaṃ itaro na nṛpasthitiḥ |*

[785] *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 824) and *Yogakarṇikā* 2.8–13.

antarlakṣaṃ śṛṇu subhru digvidigādivarjitam |
bāhyābhyantara ākāśaṃ vādhāmantraṃ paraṃ mataṃ ||

Listen to the internal focus, oh lovely-browed [Goddess], being devoid of the major and minor directions, etc. The internal and external space is the magical formula against pain, the supreme view.

calajjāgratsuṣupteṣu bhojaneṣu ca sarvadā |
sarvāvasthāsu deveśi cittaṃ śūnye niyojayet ||

While walking, waking, sleeping and eating at all times [and] in all states, oh Goddess, the mind shall be focussed onto emptiness.

5 *karttā kārayitā śūnyaṃ mūrtimān śūnya īśvaraḥ* |
harṣaśokaghaṭastho 'yaṃ janmamṛtyū labhet svayam ||

The actor and he who causes to act are void; the form-bearer in the void is the supreme lord. Situated in a vessel[786] of joy and sorrow, he himself experiences both birth and death.

ghaṭasthāṃ cintayen mūrtimitaś cintāsvarūpadhṛk |
viṣayaṃ viṣavad dṛṣṭvā tyaktvā jñātvā tu mārutam ||

He shall contemplate [himself as] being situated in a vessel, established as form [and] carrying the nature of thought. Having abandoned sense objects as defective like poison, having realised them as consisting of the Maruts, ...

[786] Obviously, the human body or body of living beings.

1 PT= *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* quotes *Yogavarodaya* with reference *yogasvarodaye*. YK= *Yogakarṇikā* quotes *Yogavarodaya* with reference *yogasvarodaye*.

1 **subhru°** PT] śukra° YK 2 **bāhyābhyantara ākāśaṃ vādhāmantraṃ paraṃ mataṃ** YK] *om.* PT 5 **śūnyaṃ** YK] śunyaḥ PT 7 **ghaṭasthāṃ** YK] ghaṭasthā PT **cintayen** YK] cintyayor PT **mūrtimitaś** YK] mūrtir hata° PT 8 **dṛṣṭvā** YK] duṣṭaṃ PT

saṃjñāśūnyamanā bhūtvā puṇyapāpair na lipyate |
bāhyam ābhyantaraṃ khaṃ yad antarlakṣam iti smṛtam ||

...having become aware of the emptiness of conception, he is not tainted by merits or sin. That which is the inner and outer space is taught as the internal focus.

etaddhyānāt sadā kiñcid duḥkhaṃ na syāc chivo bhavet |
śūnyan tu saccidānandaṃ niḥśabdaṃ brahmaśabditam |
saśabdaṃ jñeyam ākāśam iti bhedadvayan tv iha ||

Because of this meditation, any kind of suffering will no longer arise [and] one would become Śiva. Emptiness is being-consciousness-bliss, [and] called the soundless Brahman; space [on the other hand] is to be understood as with sound. Indeed, this is the twofold distinction in this world.

3.11.1.5 Madhyalakṣya

The concept of the central focus (*madhyalakṣya*) is very similar in all three texts. In the *Tattvayogabindu*,[787] a light is visualised by the mind. The light is supposed to be the size of one's own body. Like a room on fire, this body shall be envisioned as filled with light. The light shall be white, yellow, red, grey or blue. The envisioned light is compared to the light of the sun, lightning or a crescent moon. *Madhyalakṣya* leads to the burning of the impurities of the mind. It also produces the sattvic quality of the mind. The practitioner becomes blissful. Rāmacandra remains very close to his original text regarding the choice of terminology and the content. Thus, there is no significant conceptual difference in comparison with the *madhyalakṣya* of the *Yogasvarodaya*.[788] Sundardās's descriptions in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* are shorter,

[787] See *Tattvayogabindu* XXVII, Ed. p. 188.

[788] Cf. *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 839): *idānīṃ madhyalakṣan tu kathyate siddhikārakam | śvetaṃ raktaṃ tathā pītaṃ dhūmrākāran tu nīlabham | agnijvālāsamānābhā vidyutpuñjasamaprabhā | āditya-*

1 **khaṃ** PT] *om.* YK **yad** em.] yad hi YK, hi PT 4 **ākāśam** PT] ākāśa YK

but equally similar. The mind is supposed to dwell in its centre and focus on the form of the body. The practice brings about the sattvic quality of the mind. However, Sundardās does not specify any visualisation of a light.[789]

3.11.2 Lakṣyayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

Nārāyaṇatīrtha neither divides Lakṣyayoga into five,[790] nor in three subcategories.[791] His explanations are of a more general nature. He locates Lakṣyayoga within the framework of his commentary on *Yogasūtra* 1.35.

> *lakṣyayogasvarūpam upāyāntaram āha—*
> *viṣayavatī vā pravṛttir utpannā manasaḥ sthitinibandhinī* ‖ 35 ‖
>
> It is said [there is] another method having the nature of Lakṣyayoga—Alternatively, activity directed to a sense object is generated, causes the stopping of the mind.

Nārāyaṇatīrtha explains:

> *viṣayavatīti | nāsāgrādau cittasya saṃyamarūpāl lakṣyayogād divyagandhādisākṣātkāro bhavati | seyaṃ viṣayavatī pravṛttir viśvāsam utpādya parameśvarādāv atisūkṣme manasaḥ sthitiṃ sampādayatīty arthaḥ | tathā ca śāstrīyānubhavaviṣaye jāte śraddhayā yogino dhyānādau sthirā bhavatīty ayaṃ lakṣyayogaḥ |*
> *yā hi nāsādideśeṣu dṛṣṭiḥ puṃsāṃ sthirā bhavet |*
> *sa lakṣyayoga ākhyāto yoge śraddhākaraḥ paraḥ ‖*
> *iti smṛter iti* ‖ 35 ‖
>
> [Regarding the term] "*viṣayavatī*". As a result of Lakṣyayoga, which has the nature of concentration of the mind (*saṃyama*)

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maṇḍalākāram athavā candramaṇḍalam | jvaladākāśatulyaṃ vā bhāvayed rūpam ātmanaḥ | etaj jyotirmayaṃ dehaṃ manomadhye tu lakṣayet | eteṣāñ ca kṛte lakṣe nānāduḥkhaṃ praṇaśyati | manasas tu malo yāti mahānando bhavet tataḥ |

[789] *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.28: *madhya lakṣa mana madhya bicārai | vapu pramāna koi rūpa nihārai |yāte sātvik upajai āī | madhya lakṣa jo sādhai bhāī* ‖)

[790] As in the *Tattvayogabindu*, the *Yogasvarodaya* or in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*.

[791] As in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* or the *Śivayogapradīpikā*.

> on the tip of the nose, etc., a direct perception of divine fragrances and other objects occurs. This activity being directed to sense objects, having produced confidence, causes to generate fixedness of the mind in [something] very subtle, in [something like] the supreme Lord, etc. Such is the meaning. And thus, stability in meditation, etc., arises for the yogin after the sense object from the experience of scripture has been produced with confidence. This is Lakṣyayoga.
>
> For indeed, when the gaze of the person becomes steady at places like the tip of the nose, etc.,
> that is called Lakṣyayoga, which in yoga, is considered the supreme faith-inspiring [practice].
>
> Thus, it is remembered.

Nārāyaṇatīrtha is referring to the *bhāṣya*-part of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* concerning *sūtra* 1.35.[792] In the *bhāṣya*, various foci for meditation and specific effects that arise through concentration on the respective point are listed. Concentration on the tip of the nose creates absolute perception of odour. Concentration on the tip of the tongue leads to absolute perception of flavour. Concentration on the palate leads to absolute perception of form. Concentration on the centre of the tongue leads to absolute perception of touch. Concentration on the root of the tongue leads to absolute perception

[792] *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* (Ed. p. 80): *nāsikāgre dhārayato 'sya yā divyagandhasaṃvit sā gandhapravṛttiḥ | jihvāgre rasasaṃvit | tāluni rūpasaṃvit | jihvāmadhye sparśasaṃvit | jihvāmūle śabdasaṃvid ity etā vṛttaya utpannāś cittaṃ sthitau nibadhnanti, saṃśayaṃ vidhamanti, samādhiprajñāyāṃ ca dvārībhavantīti | etena candrādityagrahamaṇipradīparaśmyādiṣu pravṛttir utpannā viṣayavaty eva veditavyā yady api hi tattacchāstrānumānācāryopadeśair avagatam arthatattvaṃ sadbhūtam eva bhavati | eteṣāṃ yathābhūtārthapratipādanasāmarthyāt, tathāpi yāvad ekadeśo 'pi kaścin na svakaraṇasaṃvedyo bhavati tāvat sarvaṃ parokṣam ivāpavargādiṣu sūkṣmeṣv artheṣu na dṛṃ buddhim utpādayati | tasmāc chāstrānumānācācāryopadeśopodbalanārtham evāvaśyaṃ kaścid arthaviśeṣaḥ pratyakṣīkartavyaḥ | tatra tadupadiṣṭārthaikadeśapratyakṣatve sati sarvaṃ sūkṣmaviṣayam api āpavargāc chraddhīyate | etadartham evedaṃ cittaparikarma nirdiśyate | aniyatāsu vṛttiṣu tadviṣayāyāṃ vaśīkārasaṃjñāyām upajātāyāṃ samarthaṃ syāt tasya tasyārthasya pratyakṣīkaraṇāyeti | tathā ca sati śraddhāvīryasmṛtisamādhayo 'syāpratibandhena bhaviṣyantīti |*

of sound. In addition, the *bhāṣya* lists the moon, sun, planets, jewels and lamps as sensory objects for focussing the mind. The resulting heightened perceptions stabilise the mind, remove doubt and are a gateway to *samādhi*. Furthermore, the *bhāṣya* explains that although the true nature of reality can be revealed through scriptures, inferences or instructions from teachers, these must be experienced personally, through one's own senses, so that the experience is not second-hand. Otherwise doubts occur for the practitioner. However, if these heightened perceptions referred to in this *sūtra* are experienced personally, then faith, trust or confidence (*śraddhā*) in the statements of the scriptures etc., the entire yogic endeavour and especially the possibility of the desired liberation is strengthened.

3.11.3 Lakṣyayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Lakṣyayoga across the four early modern yoga taxonomies reveals that these texts are the first to treat Lakṣyayoga as an independent category, even though practices involving *lakṣya*s are considerably older. Earlier sources describe only a threefold scheme (*antar-*, *bahir-* and *madhyalakṣya*), whereas all texts that present Lakṣyayoga as a distinct type adopt the fivefold model (*ūrdhva-*, *adho-*, *bāhya-*, *antara-* and *madhyalakṣya*). Although various texts—such as the *Netratantra*, *Śivayogapradīpikā*, *Maṇḍalabrāhmaṇopaniṣat* and *Advayatārakopaniṣat*—mention three *lakṣya*s, none presents them as a separate yoga. The earliest works to teach Lakṣyayoga as an autonomous yoga category were very likely the *Tattvayogabindu*, and the lost *Yogasvarodaya*. From the *Yogasvarodaya*, the category passed into the *Prāṇatoṣinī*, *Yogakarṇikā* and *Tattvayogabindu*, and from the latter into the *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā*. Nārāyaṇatīrtha's presentation of Lakṣyayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* may be understood as an attempt to integrate this increasingly influential category into the *Yogasūtra*. In a similar vein, and possibly in response to its growing prominence, Sundardās appears to have incorporated Lakṣ(y)ayoga into his *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*. Across the corpus, the conceptual treatment of Lakṣyayoga remains strikingly consistent. Lakṣyayoga thus emerges as a defining category of texts with complex yoga taxonomies.

3.12 Vāsanāyoga

Vāsanāyoga, the "Yoga of mental residues", is in the tenth position of the methods of Rājayoga presented at the beginning of *Tattvayogabindu*. In the *Yogasvarodaya*, it is the eighth method mentioned. However, neither text contains a specific description of Vāsanāyoga. However, the term *vāsanā* appears in several places in the texts. In the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Vāsanāyoga is the twelfth method for Rājayoga Nārāyaṇatīrtha mentions.[793] The *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* does not list Vāsanāyoga. The term *vāsanāyoga* is scarce in the entire yoga literature and only appears in the context of early modern yoga taxonomies. It is not found at all in the early and medieval yoga texts. The compound *vāsanāyoga* appears in a few places in tantric literature but never as an independent yoga category.

However, the term *vāsanā* itself is a technical term frequently used in Indian philosophy, especially in the context of the concept of *karma*. It plays a significant role in yoga and Advaita Vedānta but the term is equally important in Buddhist philosophy. The concept of the term *vāsanā* can be characterised as follows in the yoga philosophy of Pātañjalayoga and Advaita Vedānta, which is congruent with the context of the texts discussed here. *Vāsanā* denotes a certain type of karmic imprint. In the commentary literature of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*, the term and concept of *vāsanā* is closely linked to the term and concept of *saṃskāra*. Both terms are often even used synonymously. However, there is a nuanced difference: A *saṃskāra* is a mental imprint that is left in the mind (*citta*) by every action (*karma*). *Saṃskāra*s trigger thoughts, memories and further actions (*karma*). *Vāsanā*, on the other hand, refers primarily to cumulative inherent imprints (*saṃskāra*s) that exert a subconscious influence on the person's personality and actions, a behavioural tendency caused by past actions. *Vāsanā*s are also those *saṃskāra*s that exert an influence on later rebirths or control the configuration of rebirth.[794] Every action performed by a subject leaves an imprint or trace in the *karma* storage (*karmāśaya*) of the mind (*citta*).

[793] For an earlier discussion of Vāsanāyoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* see Penna, 2004: 82–85.

[794] Cf. Bryant, 2009: 418.

Because the mind in Pātañjalayoga is the main component of the transmigrating subtle body (*sūkṣmaśarīra*), the configuration of the *karma* storage of the mind will determine the nature of future rebirth.[795] Literally, *vāsanā* even means "scent" or, in this context, "scent trail". Metaphorically speaking, the actions leave behind a certain scent within the mental faculty (*citta*). This scent permeates the person and will continue to be felt in future actions for a long time because the accumulation of these habitual tendencies predisposes the person to certain future patterns of thought and behaviour. Thus, I think "mental residues" is a suitable translation. These patterns of thought and behaviour can be activated at any time, for example, triggered by sensory stimuli. In the context of a meditative yoga practice aimed at achieving the state called *samādhi* using concentration, a state characterised by a temporary standstill of mental activity, the *saṃskāra*s and *vāsanā*s in the yogin's mind, when activated by sensory stimuli, would repeatedly lead to newly arising mental activity and thus to distraction from this desired goal.

If these are active, most are considered a hindrance to the ultimate goal of yoga practice and are either to be reduced or at least should be rendered inactive or latent. If the yogin is free from activated *saṃskāra*s and *vāsanā*s through yoga practice, he can not only reach the *samādhi* state, but he will also no longer be reborn. Only then he is able to be freed from the cycle of rebirth (*saṃsāra*). It is important to emphasise that certain *saṃskāra*s and *vāsanā*s are considered positive and work in favour of yoga practice, such as the habit of regular yoga practice (*yogābhyāsa*) itself or good eating habits. However, all *saṃskāra*s and *vāsanā*s must be rendered inactive, for the final goal of the yoga of *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*, the *asaṃprajñātasamādhi*.[796]

Thus, when we encounter the term Vāsanāyoga, we naturally expect a yoga that aims at reducing the *vāsanā*s in order to achieve mental stillness and thereby *mokṣa*.

[795] Cf. *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* 4.7–11.

[796] See *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* 1.18, 1.50–51 and Bryant, 2009: 70–72 on 1.18 and ibid. 2009: 164–68 on 1.50–51 for a summary of the classical commentaries.

3.12.1 The term *vāsanā* in *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*

Just as Dhyānayoga is mentioned in the taxonomies of the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya* without being treated as an independent category, the concept of *dhyāna* can still be inferred from the texts. Likewise, even without a dedicated section on Vāsanāyoga, the usage and conception of *vāsana* can be reconstructed.

In *Tattvayogabindu*, the term plays a role in the etymological word explanation (*nirukti*) of the word *avadhūta*. This *nirukti* is explained in XLIV.3 and XLIV.4:[797]

> *ātmā hy akāro vijñeyo vakāro bhavavāsanā* |
> *dhūtas tatkaṃpanaṃ proktaṃ so 'vadhūta nigadyate* ‖ XLIV.3 ‖
>
> The letter *a* is, in fact, to be known as the self and the letter *va* as mental residues of [mundane] existence; *dhūta* is said to be the shaking off of those [mental residues]; he is called an Avadhūta.
>
> *akārārtho jīvabhūto vakārārtho 'tha vāsanā* |
> *etad dvayaṃ yaḥ jānati so 'vadhūta udāhṛtaḥ* ‖ XLIV.4 ‖
>
> The meaning of the letter *a* is the existence of the embodied soul, the meaning of the letter *va* then mental residues. He who knows this couple is declared to be an Avadhūta.

Accordingly, an Avadhūta is characterised by not only knowing the being of the embodied soul (*jīva*) and the *vāsana*s ("mental residues") produced by action (*karma*), but the Avādhūta is an embodied soul (*jīva*) who has already shaken off all *vāsanā*s and, as the following verses XLIV. 5–10, let us know, has become a perfected yogin (*siddhayogin*) through yoga.

The term *vāsanā* reappears in the context of *Tattvayogabindu* LIII. This section is part of a thematic sequence of sections (XLVIII–LVII) that differentiate metaphysical concepts of cosmogony.

[797] Although most of the verses and passages in *Tattvayogabindu* XLIV are taken from *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, there is no correspondence to the verses XLIV.3–4 in this case. These verses may be authorial. The *Yogasvarodaya* does not thematise the *avadhūta* at all.

That which existed even before the Creator Rāmacandra calls the unmanifest (*avyakta*), nameless (*anāmā*) supreme reality (*paraṃ tattvaṃ*). According to *Tattvayogabindu* XLVIII–LVII, the creation unfolds in pentads, giving rise to five qualities each. In section LIII, Rāmacandra introduces the next pentad. The pentad is based on the explanations of the pentad on *vyaktaśakti* of *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*.[798] The specific pentad consists of will (*icchā*), activity (*kriyā*), illusion (*māyā*), primordial nature (*prakṛti*) and speech (*vācā*). Each pentad has five properties. The will (*icchā*) consists of the five properties—intense passion (*unmāda*), mental residues (*vāsanā*), desire (*vāñchā*), mental state (*caitta*) and behaviour (*ceṣṭā*). The pentad can also be identified in the *Yogasvarodaya*.[799] None of the texts provides additional information on these five qualities.

The last mention of *vāsanā* occurs in section LVIII which is one of the largest sections of the entire text. Therefore, Rāmacandra probably considered this topic particularly important. It bears the title "Majesty of yoga" (*yogasya māhātmyaṃ*) and vehemently emphasises the indispensability of a teacher (*guru*) for the attainment of the reality of yoga (*yogatattva*). However, this should not be just any teacher, but a true teacher (*sadguru*):

> *vikalpa etādṛśo yathā samudramadhye mahattarakallolāḍambaraḥ prapañcavāsanā etādṛśī yathodakamadhye mahattaraṅgāḥ | tādṛśāt saṃsārārṇavād yo nāvā paraṃ pāraṃ prāpayati | sa sadguruḥ kathyate |*
>
> Such discursive thinking is like the roar of mighty waves within the ocean [and] such manifold mental residues (*vāsana*s) are like great waves within the water, one who causes [the disciple] to reach the farther shore of such an ocean of Saṃsāra with a boat is called the true teacher.

In the *Yogasvarodaya*, the term *vāsanā* appears only within a cosmogonic context. In the *Tattvayogabindu*, its three occurrences—in discussions of the *avadhūta*, cosmogony, and the teacher's role—are likewise insufficient to

[798] *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 1.54.
[799] *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 847).

imply a distinct method of Vāsanāyoga. Vāsanāyoga is therefore absent from both texts. Nonetheless, the analysis shows that the reduction of *vāsanā*s constitutes a central motif in Rāmacandra's yoga system.

3.12.2 Vāsanāyoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

The *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* is the only text amongst the texts of the complex late medieval taxonomies that contains a dedicated description of a Vāsanāyoga.

Nārāyaṇatīrtha locates Vāsanāyoga in the framework of his commentary on *Yogasūtra* 1.37 and 1.38[800] and distinguishes two different methods of Vāsanāyoga. Let us first look at the first:

> *avāntaravāsanāyogam āha—- vītarāgaviṣayaṃ vā cittam* ‖ 37 ‖
>
> With regard to [the two different methods of] Vāsanāyoga, it is said—Or, [the mind becomes stable when directed], on a mind without the desire for sense objects.

This *sūtra* presents one among several methods for attaining *samādhi*. In this case, mental stability is achieved by meditating on the mind (*citta*) of someone already free from craving for sense objects—typically one's realised teacher or a renowned master of the past. Crucially, the person's mind must be free of *vāsanā*s. Nārāyaṇatīrtha explains:

> *vīteti | vītarāgaṃ nirvāsanaṃ yat sanakādīnāṃ cittaṃ tadviṣayaṃ tadvibhāvanaparaṃ kuryāt | nirvāsanavāsitam antaḥkaraṇaṃ kuryād iti yāvat | anenātra yogino mumukṣālābhena vāsanāyogo darśitaḥ |*
>
> [Regarding] *vīta* [etc.]—One should make the mind the object [of meditation], [on] that [mind] which is without desire [and] without mental residues, [namely, the mind] of Sanaka and others; one should be intent on contemplating that.

[800] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Ed. p. 55–56.

The most important characteristic of the chosen mind is freedom from *vāsanā*s. The key indicator of having chosen the right mind as the object of meditation is the practitioner's increased desire for liberation (*mokṣa*). In the further course of his commentary on *Yogasūtra* 1.37, Nārāyaṇatīrtha explains that Vāsanāyoga primarily leads to an increase in the sattvic quality of mind. This increase of *sattva*, in turn, increases the efficiency of all other practised yoga methods.[801] The key to this practice is that by meditating on a mind free of *vāsanā*s, one's own *vāsanā*s are naturally extinguished.[802] Let us now turn towards the second method of Vāsanāyoga. Nārāyaṇatīrtha introduces this method as follows:

> *vāsanāyogasyāvāntaraṃ bhedam āha—*
> *svapnanidrājñānālambanaṃ vā* ‖ 38 ‖
>
> With regards to the [other] distinction of Vāsanāyoga, it is said—
> Or, [onto] the support of knowledge from dreams and sleep.

Nārāyaṇatīrtha explains in this regard that during sleep in dreams, some people have a vision of the favoured form of the divine, and others experience happiness through sleep. If this is the case, one can use these experiences as objects of meditation. This method works well because these experiences are based on previous very sattvic *vāsanā*s. Meditating on them, therefore, also increases the sattvic quality in the waking state and thus leads to liberation.[803]

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[801] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 56) regarding *sūtra* 1.37: *uktañ ca smṛtau—sattvāvalambanaṃ yat tad bījaṃ cittaviśodhane | bhavet sa vāsanāyogo yogāntaravivardhakaḥ ‖ iti* ‖ "It is said in the Smṛti: That which supports the sattvic constitution is the primary cause for the purification of the mind, this is the Vāsanāyoga which enhances the other yogas." I have not yet succeeded in identifying the source text of this verse.

[802] Ibid: *tejaḥpratibandhajalaśaityavad iti vinaiva sādhanāntaraṃ yogino mokṣasukhaniṣṭhāsambhavāt | ayaṃ śubho vāsanāyogo viruddhavāsanānivarttaka iti* ‖ 37 ‖ "Just as coolness arises from water when heat is obstructed, thus, without any other means, it is impossible for a yogin to be firmly established in the bliss of liberation. This auspicious Vāsanāyoga is the remover of the suppressed mental residues, so it is said."

[803] Ibid.: *svapne bhagavato yadrūpaṃ priyam ārādhayann eva prabuddha, evaṃ nidrādau yatsukham anubhūyate tad avalambanaṃ tad vibhāvanaparaṃ cittaṃ kuryāt | pūrvavāsanāprāptasattvapradhānam evāntaḥkaraṇaṃ kuryād iti yāvat* ‖ 38 ‖ "With regard to a dream, worshipping the divine in the favoured form, similarly, when one is awake, the mind should make the happiness

3.12.3 Vāsanāyoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The term Vāsanāyoga appears as an independent yoga category only in the early modern yoga taxonomies, apart from Sundardās' *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*. No Haṭha- or Rājayoga text outside this corpus treats it as a distinct method. Although both the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya* list Vāsanāyoga in their taxonomies, neither explains it. Only Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* provides a definition: a practice that refines the mind by diminishing negative *vāsanā*s or cultivating positive ones, functioning as an auxiliary to all other yogas.

Given that Nārāyaṇatīrtha wrote in Benares, while the *Yogasvarodaya*—the source of the North Indian *Tattvayogabindu*—likely has South Indian roots, the unelaborated Vāsanāyoga in both texts is unlikely to reflect his influence. It seems more probable that Rāmacandra omitted a description because none existed in his source text. Whether a recension of the *Yogasvarodaya* once contained such a passage remains uncertain. Considering the importance of *vāsanā* in yoga literature, the missing method was likely similar in intent to Nārāyaṇatīrtha's: reducing negative *vāsanā*s or cultivating beneficial ones.

3.13 Śivayoga

Śivayoga, "the yoga of Śiva" is in the eleventh yoga of Rāmacandra's taxonomy of the fifteen methods of Rājayoga. Rāmacandra does not dedicate a specific section to Śivayoga, nor is the term mentioned again in the course of the text. The two verses mentioning the total number of fifteen yogas in the *Yogasvarodaya* only list eight. Śivayoga is not included in this incomplete list nor introduced as a separate topic in the *Yogasvarodaya*. However, Śivayoga likely was one of the missing seven yogas in the *Yogasvarodaya* for the following reasons. On the one hand, the *Yogasvarodaya* is a yoga text that originates from a Śaiva milieu. On the other hand, all other texts that deal with fifteen yogas also mention Śivayoga. Although the *Tattvayogabindu*

experienced during sleep, etc., the support; that is what should be contemplated. To put it plainly: The mind should indeed cultivate the predominance of purity obtained from previous impressions."

adopts much of the content of the *Yogasvarodaya*, it conceals almost all traces of religious affiliation that were present in its source text. When Rāmacandra speaks of a god, he exclusively uses the neutral term *īśvara*. Śivayoga is not mentioned at all in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*. In the Vaiṣṇava *bhakti* milieu of a sant like Sundardās, a Śivayoga would not have been expected.[804] Once more, the only explicit description of a Śivayoga within the texts of the complex taxonomies is again found exclusively in Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*.[805]

3.13.1 Śivayoga in the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Tattvayogabindu*?

The *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Tattvayogabindu* do not dedicate a separate section to Śivayoga as a subcategory of Rājayoga, as was the case with other subcategories of Rājayoga listed in the taxonomies of the fifteen yogas. Nonetheless, at least Rāmacandra incorporated the term within his list. The question of why Śivayoga is listed at all but then not described raises another question. Namely, what would have been expected in such a description of Śivayoga as a method of Rājayoga? The comparison of the teachings of both texts with those of the *Śivayogapradīpikā*,[806] the first text ever to postulate Śivayoga as a unique system of yoga in relation to other yoga systems,[807] shows striking parallels in content to the texts examined here. There are also clear connections between these texts from the perspective of reception history, as will be shown in this section. These observations, in turn, raise a further question, namely whether the entire yoga system presented in the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Tattvayogabindu* could also be understood as Śivayoga, or instead whether there is a sufficiently big difference to describe Śivayoga separately after its mention in the taxonomy. Notably, Cennasadāśivayogin, the author of the *Śivayogapradīpikā*, equates Śivayoga and Rājayoga in verse 1.13:

[804] See Horstmann and Rajpurohit, 2023: 7.

[805] See Penna (2004: 80–82) for an earlier discussion of Śivayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*.

[806] A critical edition was only recently completed as part of a dissertation by Powell (2023). I want to take this opportunity to thank Dr. Seth Powell for making his work available for consultation before the actual publication.

[807] A textual history of the Sanskrit compound *śivayoga* is presented by Powell, 2023: 48–57.

> In reality, there is no difference between Śivayoga and Rājayoga. Yet for those who worship Śiva [a difference] is thus declared, in order to increase wisdom.[808,809]

The *Yogasārasaṅgraha* contains a similar statement. Rājayoga, Śivayoga, *samādhi* and other terms for the highest soteriological state are equated here.[810]

The *Yogasvarodaya* constitutes a Rājayoga treatise produced in a Śaiva doctrinal environment. For instance, the text states that a yogin, as a knower of Jñānayoga, becomes Śiva,[811] that the yogin becomes equal to Śiva through the practice of Haṭhayoga,[812] or that the yogin, as a result of the practice of *madhyalakṣya*, wanders the world like Śiva, devoid of sin or merit.[813] Furthermore, in the section on *yogamāhātmya*, a true teacher (*sadguru*) is equated with Śiva.[814] Additional references to Śiva can be found throughout the *Yogasvarodaya*. In contrast, while Rāmacandra draws extensively from the *Yogasvarodaya* for the compilation of his text, he largely omits Śaiva terminology from his source to maintain religious neutrality.[815] The parallels in content between our texts and the *Śivayogapradīpikā* are striking, making it pertinent to delineate the fundamental aspects of this similarity in light of the inquiry of this section. The *Śivayogapradīpikā* by Cennasadāśivayogin is dated by Powell to approximately 1400–1450 CE.[816] Thus, we are situated

[808] Translated by Powell, 2023: 315.

[809] *Śivayogapradīpikā* 1.13: *na bhedaḥ śivayogasya rājayogasya tattvataḥ | śivārcināṃ evam ukto buddeḥ pravṛddhaye ‖ 13 ‖*

[810] *Yogasārasaṅgraha*, Ed. p. 60: *rājayogaḥ samādhiś conmanī ca manonmanī | śivayogo layas tatvaṃ śūnyāśūnyaṃ nirañjanam ‖ amanaskaṃ yathā caitannirālambaṃ nirañjanam | jīvanmuktiś ca sahajam ity adir hy ekavācakam ‖*

[811] *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 831): *jñānayogaṃ pravakṣyāmi taj jñānī śivatāṃ vrajet |*

[812] Ibid. (PT, p. 835): *śivatulyo mahātmāsau haṭhayogaprasādataḥ |*

[813] Ibid. (PT, p. 839): *śivavad vihared viśve pāpapuṇyavivarjitaḥ |*

[814] Ibid. (PT, p. 848): *nānāvikalpavibhrāntināśañ ca kurute tu yaḥ | sadguruḥ sa tu vijñeyo na tu vairaprakalpakaḥ | ata eva maheśāni sadguruḥ śiva āditaḥ |*

[815] Only one passage in the *Tattvayogabindu* explicitly reveals the Śaiva origins of its content: In section XXI.3, the highest soteriological state attainable through Jñānayoga is described as *śāmbhavī sattā* ("the reality belonging to Śiva"). Īśvara and Śakti, however, Rāmacandra mentions quite frequently.

[816] Powell 2023: 157.

around two hundred years prior to the composition of the *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya*.

In contrast to the fifteenfold yoga taxonomy of our texts, Cennasadāśivayogin employs the model often used in medieval yoga literature, comprising Mantra, Laya, Haṭha, and Rājayoga, which are considered subcategories of Śivayoga.[817] As mentioned in the above quote from *Śivayogapradīpikā* 1.13, Cennasadāśivayogin equates Śivayoga with Rājayoga, which he further subdivides into three categories: Sāṃkhyayoga, Tārakayoga, and Amanaska Rājayoga.[818] Cennasadāśivayogin also refers to his Sāṃkhyayoga as Jñānayoga.[819] To structure his text and teachings, Cennasadāśivayogin utilises the eight limbs of Aṣṭāṅgayoga.[820] This Aṣṭāṅgayoga, however, is not the standard model of the eight–limbed yoga of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* tradition, but rather a specific model of a group of texts that interchange *dhyāna* and *dhāraṇā*—a phenomenon otherwise only found in *ṣaḍaṅga* or *pañcāṅga* yoga systems.[821] Powell (2023: 168) explains that this interchange of *dhyāna* and *dhāraṇā* in an eight-limbed system is found only in the *Śivayogapradīpikā*. During the work on the critical edition of the *Tattvayogabindu*, especially the inspection of the oldest manuscripts, could show that other texts with eight-limbed systems also conserve this sequence.[822] Moreover, it turned out that this reversed sequence is also found in the transmission of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, which is closely linked to the *Śivayogapradīpikā* and the *Tattvayogabindu*, in the manuscripts J_1 and J_2.[823] The transmission of the *Yogasvarodaya* is problematic: it professes an eight-limbed yoga, yet the verse mentions only *dhāraṇā*, while discussion is devoted to *dhyāna* and *dhāraṇā*

[817] *Śivayogapradīpikā* 1.3–4: *śivatattvavidāṃ śreṣṭha vakṣyāmi śṛṇu te 'dhūna | śivayogaṃ paraṃ guhyam api tvadbhaktigauravāt* ‖ 3 ‖ *mantro layo haṭho rājayogaś ceti caturvidham | tam āhuḥ pūrvamunayaḥ siddhāḥ śaṃbhuprabodhitāḥ* ‖ 4 ‖

[818] Ibid. *Śivayogapradīpikā* 1.10–11: *so 'pi tridhā bhavet sāṅkhyas tārakaś cāmanā iti | pañcaviṃśatitattvānāṃ jñānaṃ tat sāṅkhyaṃ ucyate* ‖ 10 ‖ *bahirmudrāparijñānād yogas tāraka ucyate | antarmudrāparijñānād amanaska itīritaḥ* ‖ 11 ‖

[819] Ibid. 4.31.

[820] Ibid. 2.4–5: *śivayogaḥ sādhakānāṃ sādhyas tatsādhanaṃ haṭhaḥ | tasmād ādau prayoktavyaṃ haṭhayogam imam śṛṇu* ‖ 4 ‖ *aṅgāny aṣṭau haṭhasyāpi bāhyāny abhyantarāṇi ca | yamādihir ato 'ṣṭāṅgair devapūjāṃ samācaret* ‖ 5 ‖

[821] See table 10: *Yogāṅgas with Dhyāna before Dhāraṇā* in Powell (2023: 166) for an overview.

[822] See Section XXXI in the critical edition of the *Tattvayogabindu* on p. 208.

[823] See the edition of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* by Gharote and Pai (2016) in 2.32, Ed. p. 45.

remains unexamined. This discrepancy, however, already betrays a tight historical reception between the four works. Furthermore, the *Śivayogapradīpikā* teaches a great variety of yogas, and thus presents a similar diversity of yoga categories as found in the texts with complex yoga taxonomies. The *Śivayogapradīpikā* includes ten interwoven yoga categories. The entire system is a system called 1. Śivayoga embedded in a system of 2. Aṣṭāṅgayoga. Within this, 3. Mantrayoga, 4. Layayoga, 5. Haṭhayoga, and 6. Rājayoga are situated. The latter is further divided into 7. Sāṅkhyayoga (= 8. Jñānayoga), 9. Tārakayoga, and 10. Amanaska Rājayoga.

In the context of the fourth limb of the eight-limbed framework of the *Śivayogapradīpikā* named *prāṇāyāma*, Cennasadāśivayogin differentiates between three types of *prāṇāyāma*: 1. natural (*prākṛta*), 2. modified (*vaikṛta*), and 3. *kevalakumbhaka*, which unfolds by itself, with or without the practice of the first two variants.[824] The first variant[825] actually refers to the *ajapā mantra*, which is possibly alluded to by Rāmacandra in section III, and explicitly instructed in the context of meditations (*dhyāna*s) on the nine *cakra*s in the manuscript U_2. However, the Mantrayoga of the *Śivayogapradīpikā* is subordinated to *prāṇāyāma*.[826] The second variant of *prāṇāyāma* aligns with that in *Tattvayogabindu* Section XXXI.[827] In the third chapter of the *Śivayogapradīpikā*, which is dedicated to the fifth limb named *dhyāna*, we find detailed descriptions of the nine *cakra*s,[828] and the sixteen *ādhāra*s,[829] central themes also found in the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*. The descriptions of the individual elements of both themes are largely congruent.

Alongside various similarities, there are also significant differences between the texts. For example, both texts include variants of Jñānayoga (*Śivayogapradīpikā* 4.31 refers to Sāṃkhyayoga as Jñānayoga). The *Śivayogapradīpikā*

[824] *Śivayogapradīpikā* 2.22: *prāṇāyāmas tridhā proktaḥ prākṛto vaikṛtas tathā | dvābhyāṃ vinā jṛmbhate 'sau kevalaḥ kumbhakaḥ svayam* ‖ 22 ‖

[825] Ibid. 2.29–34

[826] See Powell, 2023: 205.

[827] Ibid. 22.4: *āgamoktavidhānena recapūrasvabhāvataḥ | yadi prāṇanirodhaḥ syād vaikṛtaḥ sa udīritaḥ* ‖ 24 ‖

[828] Ibid. 3.7–16.

[829] Ibid. 3.17–32.

teaches a system with a total of twenty-five *tattva*s plus *puruṣa*.[830] In contrast, the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Tattvayogabindu* teach a simpler system with only ten *tattva*s.[831] While Cennasadāśivayogin initially defines a great soul (*mahātman*) as a soul that understands the true self (*ātman*) as ontologically distinct from the evolutes of *prakṛti*,[832] he immediately thereafter proclaims the non-duality of *ātman* and *brahman* in the sense of Advaita Vedānta or the *bhedābheda* schools of Vedānta.[833] In contrast, *Yogasvarodaya* and *Tattvayogabindu* teach a radical non-duality, the radical unity of the universal soul, individual soul, and creation,[834] reminiscent of forms of Śuddhādvaita.[835] In the context of Tārakayoga in the fourth chapter of the *Śivayogapradīpikā*,[836] the three *lakṣya*s *antar*, *bāhya*, and *madhyalakṣya* are taught, whereas *Yogasvarodaya* and *Tattvayogabindu* teach five *lakṣya*s. There are additional divergences, but the most significant is that Cennasadāśivayogin's *Śivayogapradīpikā* situates all its teachings within the ritual and devotional framework of the Vīraśaivas.[837] Thus, Cennasadāśivayogin defines Śivayoga in verse 1.15 as:

> Śivayoga is five-fold, indeed: gnosis (*jñāna*) comprised of Śiva, devotion (*bhakti*) to Śiva, meditation (*dhyāna*) comprised of Śiva, Śaiva religious observance (*vrata*), and worship of Śiva (*arcā*).[838]

Despite the clear Śaiva affiliation of the *Yogasvarodaya*, these elements are nowhere to be found. The same applies to the *Tattvayogabindu*. Even the eight-limbed (*aṣṭāṅga*) scheme of the *Śivayogapradīpikā* is regarded as a ritual worship of Śiva (*śivapūjā*)[839] and Powell (2023) concludes that it is precisely

[830] See *Śivayogapradīpikā* 4.19–31. Additionally, the *tattva* system of the *Śivayogapradīpikā* is thoroughly analysed by Powell, 2023: 239–242.

[831] Cf. *Tattvayogabindu* XXXI.6 and *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 836).

[832] *Śivayogapradīpikā* 4.28: *dehatrayaṃ prathitaṣoḍaśadhāvikārān liṅgāni saptadaśadhā navadhā padārthān | ātmānām aṣṭavidhayā prakṛtisvabhāvaṃ jñātvā tad anya iti jīvati yo mahātmā* ‖ 28 ‖

[833] Ibid. 4.29–30: *satyaṃ jñānam anantaṃ yad brahmeti vadati śrutiḥ | muktānandasvarūpaṃ ca nanu tat tvam asi sthiram* ‖ 29 ‖ *naitad ahaṃ naitad ahaṃ ceti yad anyaṃ vibhāvayātmānam | so 'haṃ iti so 'ham iti nanu bhāvaya sarvaṃ tvam ātmānam* ‖ *30* ‖

[834] See *Tattvayogabindu* XXI.7 and *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 836).

[835] See Glasenapp, 1985: 270–272.

[836] Ibid. 4.32–52.

[837] Powell 2023: 8.

[838] *Śivayogapradīpikā* 1.15: *jñānaṃ śivamayaṃ bhaktiḥ śaivī dhyānaṃ śivātmakam | śaivavrataṃ śivārceti śivayogo hi pañcadhā* ‖ 15 ‖ Translation by Powell, 2023: 315.

[839] Ibid. 2.1–5.

this devotional and ritual orientation that renders the yoga system of the *Śivayogapradīpikā* as Śivayoga.

Can we say from this comparative study that the yoga systems of *Yogasvarodaya* and *Tattvayogabindu* implicitly teach Śivayoga? This question cannot be answered definitively. It is a fact that, at the level of doctrinal content, all three texts exhibit numerous commonalities. Content-wise, this question could tentatively be answered in the affirmative. However, the strong Śaiva orientation,[840] as observed in the *Śivayogapradīpikā*, is largely absent in the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Tattvayogabindu*, with both texts effectively subordinating Śivayoga to Rājayoga. The degree of Śaiva orientation in the *Yogasvarodaya* based on the quotations in the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* appears moderate, with ten mentions of the word *śiva*, and it is almost entirely extinguished in the *Tattvayogabindu*. From this perspective, the question posed in this subsection must be answered in the negative. Nevertheless, given the background presented here, the mysterious presence of the category Śivayoga in the fifteenfold taxonomies, which lists Śivayoga as a subcategory of Rājayoga and regrettably does not explicitly explain it, is easily elucidated. Śivayoga and Rājayoga would be essentially synonymous in content, as per the view initially mentioned by Cennasadāśivayogin. The fact that both systems also teach essentially the same practices would render the absence of a dedicated section explicitly explaining Śivayoga superfluous. Thus, it is quite possible that Rāmacandra shared a perspective similar to Cennasadāśivayogin. Furthermore, the striking content similarities, such as the specific sequence of the eight limbs of Aṣṭāṅgayoga, lead to the conclusion that the *Śivayogapradīpikā* and the *Yogasvarodaya*, and thereby also the *Tattvayogabindu*, which also draws upon the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, a text closely related to the *Śivayogapradīpikā*,[841] originate from the same intertextual network. For this reason, I find it highly likely that the concept of Śivayoga, not explicitly described in the *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya*, should broadly align with that of the *Śivayogapradīpikā*.

[840] The word *śiva* is mentioned a total of seventy-nine times in the *Śivayogapradīpikā*.

[841] For a discussion of the relationship between the *Śivayogapradīpikā* and *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, see Powell, 2023: 147–52.

3.13.2 Śivayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

Nārāyaṇatīrtha situates Śivayoga, along with Brahmayoga,[842] in his commentary on *Yogasūtra* 1.36:[843]

> *brahmayogaṃ śivayogañ cāha—-*
> *viśokā vā jyotiṣmatī* ‖ 36 ‖
>
> It is said about Brahmayoga and Śivayoga—
> Or, [steadiness of the mind is gained when it is directed onto that which is] without sorrow [and] luminous.

According to Nārāyaṇatīrtha, Śivayoga consists in fixing the gaze—internally and externally—on the inner light at the brow-centre, a form of saṃyama that dispels sorrow.[844] He further states that Śivayoga, aided by the disciplines of Haṭhayoga, is free from strain and, through the luminous awareness of the witness, stabilises the mind; he identifies it with śāmbhavīmudrā.[845] His explicit appeal to Haṭhayoga indicates that Śivayoga/śāmbhavīmudrā is not an alternative path but a complementary practice, plausibly drawing—like his other Haṭhayoga teachings—on the Haṭhapradīpikā as its source.

Nārāyaṇatīrtha then quotes the *Amanaska*[846] without reference:

> *antarlakṣyā bahirdṛṣṭir nimeṣonmeṣavarjitā* |
> *eṣā hi śāmbhavī mudrā sarvatantreṣu gopitā* ‖
>
> The focus is internal, the gaze external, unblinking: this is the *śāmbhavīmudrā* concealed in all the Tantras.[847]

[842] For a discussion of Brahmayoga, see p. 424.

[843] See Penna (2004: 80–82) for another discussion of Śivayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*.

[844] Yogasiddhāntacandrikā (Ed. p. 55): athavā bhrūmadhyādau jyotirūpe pratyagātmani bahirdṛṣṭibandhena manasaḥ saṃyamād viśokā |

[845] Ibid. (Ed. p. 55): haṭhayogādāv ivāyāsakṛtakleśarahitā jyotiṣmatī sākṣiviṣayā saṃvin manasaḥ sthairyahetur iti śivayogaḥ | ayam eva śāmbhavī mudrety ucyate |

[846] *Amanaska* 2.10; *Haṭhapradīpikā* 4.6.

[847] This is the translation of our critical Edition of the *Haṭhapradīpikā* (2024), which also quotes this verse in 4.6.

Immediately after that, Nārāyaṇatīrtha explains that *śāmbhavīmudrā* can also be mastered through *yogāsana-*, *cāñcarī-*, *bhūcarī-*, *khecarī-*, *agaucarī-* [and] *nirvāṇamudrā*. However, the instructions for these needing to be obtained from a teacher.[848,849] Nārāyaṇatīrtha's association of *śāmbhavīmudrā* and Śivayoga is insightful, as *śāmbhavīmudrā* is the central practice of the Rājayoga of the *Amanaska*,[850] and Cennasadāśivayogin also teaches *śāmbhavīmudrā* as part of his Śivayoga system[851] which establishes yet another conceptual bridge between Rāja- and Śivayoga.

3.13.3 Śivayoga in the complex taxonomies

Given the absence of an explicit account of Śivayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya*, despite its inclusion in their complex yoga taxonomies, a comparative examination of Śivayoga across the four early modern taxonomic texts yields important insights into this category and its reception-history, particularly in relation to the authoritative *Śivayogapradīpikā*. Moreover, Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*—the only one of these texts to offer a detailed treatment—provides a valuable perspective on how a 17th century Brahmin *saṃnyāsin* and learned author in Benares understood the practice termed Śivayoga.

The lack of a concrete description in the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya* makes a comparison with the *Śivayogapradīpikā* particularly instructive, especially since the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* cannot have served as their source. This comparison reveals that the *Yogasvarodaya* and, by extension, the *Tattvayo-*

[848] Ibid.: *sā ca yogāsanacāñcarībhūcarīkhecarya'gaucarīnirvāṇamudrābhiḥ siddhyati | prakāras gurumukhād avagantayaḥ |*

[849] Some of the *mudrā*s mentioned here by Nārāyaṇatīrtha, but not explained, are given more detailed descriptions under the same or similar names in the *Jogpradīpyakā* of Jayatarāma. Jayatarāma teaches a total of twenty-five *mudrā* techniques. For the *cāñcarīmudrā*, which Jayatarāma calls *cācarimudrā*, see verses 688–690. The *bhūcarīmudrā* is described in verses 691–693. For the *agocarīmudrā*, see verses 694–695. A brief description of the techniques in English can be found in the introduction to the Kaivalyadhama edition at Maheśānanda, Sharma, Sahay, and Bodhe, 2006: 132–133. I have not yet been able to identify descriptions of *yogāsanamudrā* and *nirvāṇamudrā* in other texts. For a detailed discussion of *khecarīmudrā* see Mallinson, 2010.

[850] *Amanaska* 2.2–10.

[851] *Śivayogapradīpikā* 5.3.

gabindu participate in the same intertextual network as the *Śivayogapradīpikā*. They share core doctrinal features, such as a system of nine *cakra*s, sixteen *ādhāra*s, a set of three to five *lakṣya*s, and five *vyoma*s. All three texts also present an Aṣṭāṅgayoga in which the classical Pātañjalean sequence is inverted, placing *dhyāna* before *dhāraṇā*. Although the Śaiva orientation is attenuated in the *Yogasvarodaya* and almost entirely absent from the *Tattvayogabindu*, their doctrinal architecture nonetheless remains strikingly similar. This suggests that a separate exposition of Śivayoga within these works would have been redundant, since a Śivayoga matching that of the Śivayogapradīpikā would overlap almost entirely with what these texts already teach.

For Nārāyaṇatīrtha, whose principal aim in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* was to anchor the fifteen yogas circulating in Benares within the *Yogasūtra*, thereby reinforcing the universality and superiority of his own system, Śivayoga is identified with *śāmbhavīmudrā*. He appears to have drawn the practice from the *Haṭhapradīpikā* and seems unaware of independently organised systems bearing the name Śivayoga. His alignment of *śāmbhavīmudrā* with haṭhayogic practice—further supported by his assertion that it may be mastered with the aid of other *mudrā*s—confirms that his conception of Śivayoga is rooted in Haṭhayoga rather than in the older Śaiva Śivayoga traditions represented by the *Śivayogapradīpikā*.

3.14 Brahmayoga

BRAHMAYOGA, the "Yoga of Brahman", is linked to the key Vedāntic term *brahman*. In the early *Upaniṣads* (750–500 BCE), *brahman* denotes the immortal, infinite Absolute—the causeless ground of all being from which everything originates. From this philosophical notion also emerged the anthropomorphic male principal deity Brahmā, with all goddesses and gods, including Brahmā, being aspects of Brahman. A significant concept linked to this is the essential identity of Brahman with the individual self or essence of a person, the Ātman. A paramount goal, especially in early Vedāntic yoga texts, such as the *Kathopaniṣad*,[852] is to realize this identity between

[852] See Haas (2018) for a recent comprehensive study on the *Kathopaniṣad*.

one's microcosmic self and the macrocosmic Brahman, thereby recognising one's essential immortality and achieving liberation (*mokṣa*) from the cycle of rebirth (*saṃsāra*). The preferred means here, and in many other Vedāntic yoga texts, is meditative absorption through reciting the syllable *oṃ*. This syllable is considered the ideal sonic representation of Brahman and thus capable of making the essential unity between the individual self and the transcendent Brahman experientially accessible.[853] Here, originally Vedic ideas are combined with concepts from the Śramaṇa movement's Proto-Sāṃkhyayoga. These concepts and terms, already circulating on the Indian subcontinent in pre-Christian times, exerted significant influence on later yoga traditions so that various core elements and fundamental ideas from that time can still be found in yoga literature centuries, even millennia later. For this reason, these core elements and fundamental ideas also resonate in early modern descriptions of Brahmayoga, the "Yoga of Brahman".

In the taxonomy of the fifteen methods of Rājayoga, Rāmacandra places Brahmayoga in twelfth position. Apart from this mention, no further discussion appears. It is possible that, as with Śivayoga, Brahmayoga in the *Yoga-tattva-bindu* is treated as synonymous with Rājayoga and therefore omitted.[854]

In the *Yogasvarodaya*, the term Brahmayoga does not occur. The two verses that give the total number of fifteen yogas list only eight; Brahmayoga is missing from this partial list and is not introduced elsewhere. Since all other complex yoga taxonomies include Brahmayoga, it is likely among the seven lost yogas of the *Yogasvarodaya*. Nārāyaṇatīrtha places Brahmayoga ninth in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*. In the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, Sundardās groups it under Sāṃkhyayoga together with Jñānayoga and Advaitayoga, making it the eleventh and thus one of the penultimate yogas in his progressive system of twelve. Both Nārāyaṇatīrtha and Sundardās provide detailed accounts of their versions of Brahmayoga.

[853] Cf. *Kathopaniṣad* 2.15–17.

[854] In the introductory verse of the *Yogasvarodaya* (Ed. p. 831) it is said of the fifteen methods of Rājayoga: *rājaty etad brahmaśīva ebhiś ca pañcadaśadhā* ‖ "By these fifteen yogas, this person who abides in Brahman shines [like a king]."

3.14.1 Brahmayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

As with Śivayoga, Nārāyaṇatīrtha discusses Brahmayoga in his commentary on *Yogasūtra* 1.36.[855,856] Here, Brahmayoga entails focusing the mind on a luminous (*jyotṣmatī*), sorrowless (*viśokā*) meditation object—Brahman in the form of *nāda* ("resonance") located in the eight-petalled lotus of the heart. Union of the mind with this *nāda* is said to be free from the distress caused by other yogic efforts and is "luminous" because its object is light, namely the gnosis inherent in the *nāda*, composed of consciousness and bliss. When the practitioner unites the mind with the *nāda*, the mind becomes still.[857] The practice involves a combination of meditation, visualisation, *prāṇāyāma*, and the recitation of the three letters A–U–M forming the mantra *oṃ*:

> *tathā hy ayam atra kramaḥ |*
> *hṛdayādho 'dhomukham aṣṭadalaṃ kamalaṃ recakeṇordhvamukhaṃ vibhāvya, tatra sūryamaṇḍalaṃ dvādaśakalātmakaṃ jāgaritasthānam akāraṃ, tadupari candramaṇḍalaṃ ṣoḍaśakalātmakaṃ svapnasthānam ukāraṃ, tadupari vahnimaṇḍalaṃ daśakalātmakaṃ suṣuptisthānam makāraṃ, tadupari nādākhyaṃ turīyaṃ brahma vibhāvayed iti brahmayogaḥ |*
>
> Thus, indeed this is the respective sequence:
> In the lower [part of] the heart there is an eight-petalled lotus facing downward, by means of *recaka*[*-kumbhaka*?][858] it should be made upward facing, there, one should contemplate the orb of the sun, consisting of twelve digits, the wakeful state [and] the letter A; above that the orb of the moon, consisting of sixteen digits, the dream state [and] and the letter U; above that the orb of fire, consisting of ten digits, the deep sleep state [and] the letter

[855] See p. 422 for the translation of this *sūtra*.

[856] For a discussion of Brahmayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, see Penna, 2004: 89 et seqq.

[857] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 54): *viśoketi ...saṃvin manasaḥ sthitihetur ity arthaḥ*.

[858] Since the yoga technique described here is complex and takes some time, *recaka* likely refers either to a very prolonged exhalation or an exhalation followed by a breath retention (*kumbhaka*) with empty lungs.

> M; above that, that which is known as Nāda, the fourth state, the Brahman. This is Brahmayoga.

The exact execution of the practice is not clearly discernible. Nārāyaṇatīrtha leaves it ambiguous whether the practitioner of Brahmayoga should perform all the individual steps of the visualization during precisely one *recaka*, or if one or even several *recakas* should be performed per individual step of the visualization. The practice could also be interpreted in such a way that a single *recaka* suffices to make the eight-petaled lotus face upward, and the meditation steps are then carried out without further breath technique. Similarly, it could be understood that several *recakas* are practiced until the eight-petaled lotus faces upward, after which the meditation steps are practiced without additional breath techniques. The execution of the meditation is easier to comprehend. The three steps are apparently to be performed in immediate succession to [mentally] recite an elongated *oṃ*, whose concluding M (*makāra*) transitions into the *nāda*, which is associated with Brahman and the fourth state (*turīya*). Subsequently, Nārāyaṇatīrtha specifies this *nāda* by means of a quotation he draws from the *Gītāsāra*:[859]

> *anāhatasya śabdasya tasya śabdasya yo dhvaniḥ |*
> *dhvaner antargataṃ jyotir jyotir antargataṃ manaḥ ||*
> *tan mano vimalaṃ yāti tad viṣṇoḥ paramaṃ padam |*
>
> The tone of that sound is that of the unstruck sound. A light is inside the tone [and] the mind is inside the light. That mind becomes pure. That is the supreme state of Viṣṇu.

Thereafter, Nārāyaṇatīrtha cites the *Haṃsopaniṣad*, which prescribes not the recitation of *oṃ* but that of *haṃsa*, the *ajapā* mantra.[860] It remains unclear whether both recitations are alternatives or whether the *ajapā* follows an

[859] =*Uttaragīta 41cd–42* and *Haṭhapradīpikā* 4.49.

[860] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. pp. 54–55): *haṃsopaniṣadi coktaḥ – haṃsānusaṃdhānaphalabhūto 'nekavidhaḥ saphalaḥ.*

initial recitation of *oṃ*. Concentration on the *nāda* then leads the practitioner through a sequence of ten sounds perceived during contemplation:

> *asyaiva japakoṭyā nādam anubhāvayati yas tasya daśavidha upajāyate | ciṇīti prathamaḥ, ciṇciṇīti dvitīyaḥ ghaṇṭānādas tṛtīyaḥ, śaṅkhanādaś caturthaḥ, pañcamas tantrīnādaḥ, ṣaṣṭhas talanādaḥ, saptamo veṇunādaḥ, aṣṭamo bherīnādo, navamo mṛdaṅganādo, daśamo meghanādaḥ | navamaṃ parityajya daśamam evābhyaset |*
>
> Thus, caused by practicing 10 million repititions (*japa*) of that sound, then types of that [sound] arise: The first sound is *ciṇi*, the second *ciṇciṇi*,[861] the third the sound of a bell, the fourth the sound of a conch, the fifth the sound of strings (*tantrī*), the sixth the sound of [clasping?] palms, the seventh the sound of a flute, the eighth the sound of the *bherī*-drum, the ninth the sound of the *mṛdaṅga*-drum, and tenth the sound of a cloud. Having given up the ninth, he shall practice the tenth only.

When the mind is fixed on *nāda*, according to Nārāyaṇatīrtha, the mind enters a state of absorption, and mental activity dissipates. Sin and merit are burned away. By the nature of pure potency (*maśakti*),[862] Sadāśiva is revealed as the all-encompassing peace of mind.[863]

3.14.2 Brahmayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

Sundardās's Brahmayoga, as described in his *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* (4.25–35),[864] is a form of contemplation,[865] which he presents as difficult.[866]

[861] These terms may be meant onomatopoeically. The sound is reminiscent of the chirping of a bird or the chirping of a cricket.

[862] According to Rodrigues (2023) the term *maśakti* is a synonym of the well-known *citśakti*. For a discussion of the term, see Rodrigues, 2023:55–66.

[863] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 55): *tasmān manovilīne manasi gate saṃkalpavikalpe dagdhapuṇyapāpe sadāśivo maśaktyātmanā sarvatrāvasthitaḥ śāntaḥ prakāśayati | ity ādinā |*

[864] See Burger (2014: 703–704) for her discussion of Brahmayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*.

[865] *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 4.25c: *brahmayoga kā kaṭhina bicārā |*

[866] Ibid. 4.26a: *brahmayoga ati dūrlabha kahiye |*

Without experience, one cannot reach its end.[867] Sundardās describes that only a selfless person attains Brahmayoga, whereas one who indulges in sensory pleasures wanders aimlessly.[868] In *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 4.27 Sundardās writes:

> *brahmayoga soī bhala pāvai | pahile sakala sādhi kari āvai |*
> *brahmayoga saba ūpara soī | brahmayoga bina mukti na hoī* ‖ 27 ‖
>
> That person truly attains Brahmayoga who first masters all practices and then comes to it. Brahmayoga is supreme above all, [and] without Brahmayoga, there is no liberation.

With Brahmayoga, Sundardās initially seems to describe a state that must be attained. As an independent practice, Brahmayoga is an advanced form of yoga, because, as Sundardās explains, all preliminary exercises must have been mastered to practice it. This likely refers to a prolonged yoga practice comprising the previously described yogas, which qualify the practitioner for Brahmayoga. One must have progressed far enough on the yogic path that, as mentioned earlier, selflessness has been achieved and one no longer indulges in sensory pleasures. In verses 4.29–35, Sundardās then describes what can either be interpreted as a mystical form of contemplation or as an introspective experience of mystical unity. This is articulated in the form of a verbalization from the first-person perspective, demonstrated by two of these verses. In *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 4.29 and 4.33, Sundardās writes:

> *saba saṃsāra āpa maiṃ deṣai | pūraṇa āpu jagata mahiṃ peṣai |*
> *āpuhi karatā āpuhi haratā | āpuhi dātā āpuhi bharatā* ‖ 29 ‖
>
> All of existence reveals itself within me, the world is to be seen completely in the self. I am the creator, I am the destroyer. I am the giver, I am the sustainer.

[867] Ibid. 4.25d: *anubhava vinā na pāvai pārā* ‖ 25 ‖

[868] Ibid. 4.26bd: *paracā hoī tabahiṃ tau lahiye | brahmayoga pāvai niḥkāmī |* bhramata su phirai indriyārāmī ‖ 26 ‖

ahaṃ abhedya achedya aleṣā | ahaṃ agādha su akala adeṣā |
ahaṃ sadodita sadā prakāśā | sakṣī ahaṃ sarva mahiṃ vāsā ‖ 33 ‖

I am inseparable, I am unassailable, without stain. I am unfathomable, supremely timeless, and unseen. I am eternally arisen, always luminous. I am the witness, dwelling in all the universe.

In the last verse, Brahmayoga is even equated with Brahman itself:

ahaṃ parama ānandamaya ahaṃ jyoti nija soī |
brahmayoga brahmahi bhayā dubidhyā rahī na koī ‖ 36 ‖

I am supremely filled with bliss, I am the self-luminous light. Brahmayoga is Brahman itself, fear and doubt do not remain anymore.

3.14.3 Brahmayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Brahmayoga within the four texts of the complex early modern yoga taxonomies reveals, on the one hand, the underlying continuities of the Vedāntic concept of Brahman and, on the other hand, exciting developments in the yoga practices associated with the term Brahmayoga in the 16th and 17th centuries.

For Nārāyaṇatīrtha, Brahmayoga is a form of yoga distinguished by a complex technique involving the syllable *oṃ*, associated with Brahman, culminating in absorption into its *nāda*. After the practitioner has performed this practice and passed through various stages of perceiving the *nāda*, Sadāśiva is ultimately revealed as all-encompassing inner peace. Notably, the practice culminates not in the revelation of Brahman but in the revelation of Sadāśiva.

For Sundardās, Brahmayoga is both a state and a practice. It is a state in which the practitioner must have already reached a very advanced level of yoga practice. In the context of his twelve-limbed yoga system, one must first have mastered Bhaktiyoga and Haṭhayoga. Through Bhaktiyoga, one's devotion to Rāma, Sundardās' term for the unmanifest consciousness (*avyakta*

puruṣa), must have become unwavering.[869] Through the diverse practices of Haṭhayoga, body, breath, and mind are cultivated to a degree that allows Brahmayoga to arise. This initially occurs through the overarching category of Sāṃkhyayoga, where duality becomes conscious. In the state and contemplation of Brahmayoga, the practitioner experiences and realises both self and world as a unity, eventually dissolving duality and unity in the non-duality of Advaitayoga, the final stage of his system. It is fascinating to observe how Sundardās attempts to harmonise the philosophical differences of Sāṃkhya, Vedānta, and Advaita Vedānta by merging them into a progressive sequence. His descriptions of Brahmayoga read like a collection of Upaniṣadic statements on the essential identity of Ātman and Brahman.

In light of the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* and the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, despite the absence of specific descriptions of Brahmayoga in the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Tattvayogabindu*, it seems plausible that the undescribed Brahmayoga in these two texts would have incorporated core elements and fundamental ideas of Vedānta. Perhaps the authors understood Brahmayoga, as in the case of Śivayoga, as another synonym for Rājayoga.

3.15 Advaitayoga

Advaitayoga, the "Yoga of non-duality" is a rare term in yoga literature. A search for the term *advaitayoga* in the digitised collections of Sanskrit [yoga] texts yielded an astonishingly low number of results. The compound *advaitayoga* in the sense of a distinct yoga category appears only in the yoga texts of the 16th and 17th centuries. Besides the texts of the complex yoga taxonomies, I found the term only in one other text, namely in the *Haṭhapradīpikā Siddhāntamuktāvalī*,[870] where a total of 48 verses (6.115–162) are dedicated to this yoga.

[869] For an analysis of Bhaktiyoga in Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, see p. 465.

[870] The *Haṭhapradīpikā Siddhāntamuktāvalī* survives in a single manuscript (MMPP Ms. No. 6756) from 1708 CE. The manuscript contains a recension of the *Haṭhapradīpikā* with a total of six chapters and 1553 verses, making it by far the most extensive recension of the *Haṭhapradīpikā*.

In the *Yogasvarodaya*, the term *advaitayoga* is entirely absent in the extant transmission. However, Advaitayoga is present in the three other complex yoga taxonomies.

Advaitayoga is the thirteenth method of Rājayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu*. Beyond this mention, the term *advaitayoga* does not appear in the text, and it is not treated as an independent topic. Similar to the cases of Śivayoga and Brahmayoga, Advaitayoga could be implicitly present in the text, making a separate description redundant for Rāmacandra. Indeed, in the context of Section XXI, there is an explicit reference to applying non-dualistic thinking to achieve Jñānayoga.[871] Rāmacandra states that one who is devoted to non-duality will always attain the reality of Śaṃbhu.[872]

Sundardās presents Advaitayoga as the final non-dual state, viz. the goal in his twelve-limbed sequence of yogas and not as an independent method. For Nārāyaṇatīrtha, Advaitayoga is a specific method of meditative murmuring (*japa*) of the mantra *oṃ* or *praṇava*. Since Advaitayoga has already been covered in the context of the analysis of Jnānayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* on p.347, it need not be repeated here. Therefore, only the determination of Advaitayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* remains to be addressed.

3.15.1 Advaitayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

Sundardās's description of Advaitayoga (4.37–50)[873] follows his description of Brahmayoga. As previously mentioned, this is not a practice but rather the final state of yoga, the description of which begins in verses 4.30–36. While the mystical experience described in the Brahmayoga verses, which can be articulated as an infinite and absolute experience of unity, remains within the realm of the comprehensible, Sundardās uses his formulations to immerse the reader into the ultimate dissolution of the non-duality state, the final

[871] *Tattvayogabindu* XXI.1: *ekam eva jagat paśyed viśvātmā suvibhāsvaram | avikalpatayā yuktyā jñānayogaṃ samācaret ||* "He shall see the world as only one, illumined by the supreme self. By the method of non-dualistic thinking, he shall accomplish Jñānayoga."

[872] Ibid. XXI.3ab: *prāpnoti śāmbhavīṃ sattāṃ sadādvaitaparāyaṇaḥ |*

[873] See Burger (2014: 703–704) for her discussion of Advaitayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*.

step in his progression through the twelve yogas. Subsequently, Advaitayoga is the direct result of the preceding contemplation of Brahmayoga. Through numerous negations, Sundardās attempts to show what lies beyond any form of description or comprehension. This can be illustrated with some examples:

> *aba advaita sunahuṃ ju prakāsā | nāhaṃ nā tvaṃ nāṃ yahu bhāsā | nahiṃ prapaṃca tahāṃ nahīṃ pasārā | na tahāṃ sṛṣṭi na sirajanahārā* ‖ 37 ‖
>
> Now listen to the realisation of non-duality: there is no "I", no "you" and nothing that arises. There is no mundane world, no spaciousness, no creation and no creator.
>
> *na tahāṃ prakṛti puruṣa nahiṃ icchā | na tahāṃ kāla karma nahiṃ vaṃchā | na tahāṃ śūnya aśūnya na mūlā | na tahāṃ sukṣma nahīṃ sathūla* ‖ 38 ‖
>
> There, neither primordial nature nor consciousness exists, there is no desire. There, neither time nor activity nor aspirations exist. There is neither void nor non-void nor root. There, neither subtle nor gross matter exist.
>
> *na tahāṃ bhāva nahīṃ tahāṃ bhaktī | na tahāṃ mokṣa nahīṃ tahāṃ muktī | na tahāṃ jāpya nahīṃ tahāṃ jāpī | na tahāṃ mantra nahīṃ laya thāpī* ‖ 46 ‖
>
> There, neither existance nor devotion exists. There, neither liberation nor salvation exists. There, neither the recitation nor the one who recites exists. There, neither Mantra nor absorption exists.

Various other negations follow, which also negate specific yoga practices:

> *na tahāṃ sādhaka siddha samādhī | na tahāṃ yoga na yuktyārādhī | na tahāṃ mudrā baṃdhana lāgai | na tahāṃ kuṇḍalinī nahīṃ jāgai* ‖ 47 ‖

> There, neither the practitioner nor the accomplished dwelling in *samādhi* exists. There, neither yoga nor the means of worship exists. There, neither seals nor locks apply. There, the Kuṇḍalinī does not awaken.

In conclusion, Sundardās states:

> *jñe jñātā nahiṃ jñāna tahaṃ dhye dhyātā nahiṃ dhyāna | kahanahāra sundara nahīṃ yaha advaita baṣāna* ‖ 50 ‖
>
> There, neither the knower, the known, nor knowledge exists. There, neither the meditator, the meditated upon, nor meditation exists. Sundar says, there is no speaker; this is the abode of non-duality.

Structurally, Advaitayoga, along with Jñānayoga and Brahmayoga, is situated within the overarching category of Sāṃkhyayoga. Sundardās depicts a progression through these four yogas. Sāṃkhyayoga initially teaches the distinction between the Self and the Non-Self, the doctrine of dualism between consciousness and matter from the perspective of the classical Sāṃkhya system. The goal of Sāṃkhyayoga is to recognise this duality as the difference between what is the Self and what is not the Self. Following this is Jñānayoga, which fundamentally shifts the perspective from duality to identification. The aim of Jñānayoga is to recognise the non-difference between the Self (*ātman*), the body, and the world. Only after the practitioner has recognised this fundamental unity can he, through Brahmayoga, perceive the entire world within himself. Ultimately, in the resulting Advaitayoga, the state of duality and conceptual distinctions are transcended, and all opposites dissolve. The practitioner is detached from the world, maintaining equanimity toward all existing phenomena without negating their existence. All the yogas described by Sundardās within the framework of the twelve yogas ultimately aim at this non-dual state. In the state of Advaitayoga, where duality is overcome, no limiting concepts remain, and the practitioner attains the state of final liberation.

3.15.2 Advaitayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Advaitayoga within the four texts of the complex early modern yoga taxonomies sharpens our understanding of this yoga category. While Rāmacandra's Jñānayoga involves the application of non-dualistic thinking, Nārāyaṇatīrtha situates both Jñānayoga and Advaitayoga in his *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* within the context of his commentary on *Yogasūtra* 1.28. For Nārāyaṇatīrtha, both methods are based on the murmuring (*japa*) of the mantra *oṃ* or *praṇava*. This *japa* practice only differs in its accompanying contemplation method. The variant of Jñānayoga involves contemplation focused on the distinction between consciousness (*puruṣa*), primal nature (*prakṛti*), and its effects (*tatkārya*). In contrast, the Advaitayoga variant involves an alternative contemplation focused on the non-difference between the supreme Self (*paramātman*) and the individual self (*jīva*).[874]

In Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, Jñānayoga and Advaitayoga are situated within the same tetrad along with Brahmayoga. All three yogas are forms of Sāṃkhyayoga. However, Sundardās presents Advaitayoga as the final non-dual state of yoga and no longer as a specific method that can be applied to reach this state. If Rāmacandra held a similar perspective, it would be plausible why he did not dedicate a separate section to Advaitayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu*, even though one searches in vain for Advaitayoga in the *Yogasvarodaya*. Thus, only the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* explicitly includes a method of Advaitayoga among the early modern texts with complex taxonomies.

Remarkably, the *Haṭhapradīpikā Siddhāntamuktāvalī* describes Advaitayoga as a practice or method and state. The state is the identity of Ātman and Brahman (6.124, 6.121). The practitioner transcends all dualistic perceptions and realises the omnipresent nature of the Self (6.130, 6.150). As a practice, Advaitayoga involves deep meditation and contemplation, whereby the mind is centred on the Self and unity with Brahman. This is represented by the focus on the inner and outer merging of the Self with the universe (6.120) and the contemplation of *nāda* (6.133).

[874] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 46): *kiñ ca, japa ity anena mantrayogaḥ, arthabhāvanam ity anena vivekajñānā 'bhyāsarūpo jñānayogaḥ, abhedabhāvarūpo 'dvaitayogaś ca saṃgṛhītaḥ |*

3.16 Siddhayoga

SIDDHAYOGA, the "Yoga of the Siddhas," is the fourteenth method of Rājayoga in Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu*. The text distinguishes between two variants of Siddhayoga. In the transmission of the *Yogasvarodaya*, however, it is entirely absent—neither listed nor mentioned elsewhere. Nārāyaṇatīrtha does not describe a Siddhayoga but a Siddhiyoga, which appears as the eleventh yoga in his *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*. Sundardās includes neither Siddhayoga nor Siddhiyoga in his *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*.

3.16.1 Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga and Siddhayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu*

In *Tattvayogabindu* III, a yoga is described that is referred to as Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga ("The Kuṇḍalinīyoga of the Siddhas").[875] The presence of the second element of the compound *°kuṇḍalinī°* is difficult to explain, as *kuṇḍalinī* is neither mentioned in the sections about this yoga nor in the rest of the text. Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga is also mentioned immediately alongside Mantrayoga.[876] In the *Yogasvarodaya*, the corresponding passage in the transmission of the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* (Ed. pp. 831–823) is designated as Jñānayoga. However, the content of both passages is essentially identical. It seems that Rāmacandra

[875] Siddhas, often called masters of yogic and tantric practices, are highly renowned figures who cannot be confined to a single religious tradition or order. These accomplished practitioners appear in medieval Sanskrit and Tibetan texts associated with Haṭhayoga, Śaiva Tantra, and Vajrayāna Buddhism, spanning the Indian subcontinent and the Himalayan regions. For example, the *Haṭhapradīpikā* (1.4–9) is an early fifteenth-century text that provides a famous list of Siddhas. Svātmārāma, the author, refers to a lineage beginning with Ādinātha and Matsyendranātha. However, he lists twenty-nine great adepts (*mahāsiddha*s) who are described as "used the power of Haṭhayoga to smash the rod of death and [so] are roaming the worlds." Although Nātha figures such as Gorakṣa and Caurańgī are included, the list is not exclusive to the Nātha order. It is not a traditional lineage or order of succession. Many of the personalities listed, such as Manthānabhairava, Kākacaṇḍīśvara, and Pūjyapāda, are associated with the alchemical traditions of the Rasāyana Siddhas. Figures such as Virūpākṣa are revered in both the Śaiva and Buddhist traditions. Therefore, Siddhas embody the ideals of Tantra and Haṭhayoga and illustrate the different sectarian roots of these practices; see Powell, 2023: 35–36.

[876] For a discussion of Mantrayoga and the terminological issues arising in this context, see p. 386.

only exchanged the name. Before we address why this yoga is named Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga, we should first characterise its practice.

The section about Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga describes the names and paths of the three main channels of the yogic body: Iḍā, Piṅgalā, and Suṣumnā. Rāmacandra emphasises the importance of the central channel by explaining that the central channel grants both enjoyment and liberation (*bhuktimuktipradā*). He then explains that the practitioner attains omniscience once the knowledge of the central channel arises. This leads into the subsequent sections IV–XII, where a system consisting of nine *cakras* is described.[877] The presentation of the *cakras* is introduced with the statement: "Now, the means for the genesis of gnosis of the central channel are described."[878] Rāmacandra teaches a meditation onto each individual *cakra*, resulting in extravagant outcomes, as table 5 demonstrates.

Table 5: The nine *cakra*s of Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga

Name	Location	Focus of Meditation	Result of the Meditation
1. *mūlacakram*	Beginning of the central channel.	A flame-shaped *mūrti* inside *kāmapīṭha* within the *cakra*.	Spontaneous literary knowledge.
2. *svādhiṣṭhānacakram*	Penis	An extremely red light in its centre.	Enhanced attractiveness.
3. *nābhisthāne padmam*	Navel	In its middle exists a *cakra* with five angles. In the middle of it is a single form.	The body of the person becomes durable.
4. *hṛdayamadhe kamalam*	Heart	The *jīva* within the central receptacle of the eight-petalled lotus inside the twelve-petalled lotus.	Women's obedience.
5. *kaṇṭhasthāne kamalam*	Throat	The *puruṣa* inside the *cakra*.	Freedom from diseases and long life.

Continued on next page

[877] The reception history and genesis of the ninefold *cakra* system have been convincingly presented by Seth Powell, and thus do not need to be repeated here. See Powell, 2023: 215–218.

[878] *Tattvayogabindu* IV: *idāṇīṃ suṣumṇāyāḥ jñānotpattāv upāyāḥ kathyante* |

Table 5: (continued)

Name	Location	Focus of Meditation	Result of the Meditation
6. *ājñācakram*	Middle of the eyebrows.	Blazing, indivisible fire in its middle.	A non-ageing and immortal body.
7. *cakram tālumadhye*	Centre of the palate.	The hidden digit of the moon within the *ghāṇṭikā*.	Immortality and initiating the flow of *amṛta*.
8. *aṣṭamacakra brahmarandhra-sthāne*	Fontanelle on the head.	Smoke-like streak in its centre.	Direct perception of the soul, earth element immunity, omniperception and separation from matter and longevity.
9. *mahāśūnya-cakram* aka. *mahāsiddha-cakram*	Above the previous *cakra*.	The *ūrdhvaśakti* as a unique digit.	Eradication of suffering, immediate manifestation of wishes, equanimity despite material wealth, merit and sin no longer affect the body, realising one's nature and remote viewing.

Why does Rāmacandra specify this form of yoga as *Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga*, even though *kuṇḍalinī* plays no explicit role here? A straightforward explanation could be a corruption in the archetype of the *Tattvayogabindu* from which all surviving manuscripts derive. The term would be entirely unproblematic if Rāmacandra had referred to this yoga simply as Siddhayoga. However, if the transmission is correct and Rāmacandra indeed consciously chose this term, why did he do so?

Sections III–XII of the *Tattvayogabindu* are largely a prose adaptation of the *Yogasvarodaya*. Unlike the *Tattvayogabindu*, however, the term *kuṇḍalī* appears once in the latter, mentioned in connection with the fourth *cakra* in the heart.[879] It is puzzling why Rāmacandra, in his prose adaptation of this passage, did not include the term *kuṇḍalī*. Therefore, another plausible ex-

[879] *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 832): *prāṇavāyoḥ sthalañ cāsya liṅgākāran tu karṇikā | kālikākhyā karṇikeyaṃ asyā madhye tu kuṇḍalī |*.

planation could be a lack of diligence in rephrasing and transforming of the source text.

Additionally, Rāmacandra's sections on the nine *cakra*s shows clear influences from the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*.[880] The *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* locates the *kuṇḍalinī* in the context of the third *cakra* at the navel, a concept that Rāmacandra does not adopt.[881] Moreover, *kuṇḍalinī* is an important central element in the metaphysics of the Nāths.[882] According to Mallinson (2011: 20), the composition of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* marks the moment when the Nāth Sampradāya established a solid sectarian identity. The Nāth Sampradāya traces itself back to the so-called "nine Nāths," a list of Siddhas whose names closely follow early lists of Siddhas.[883] A key yogic technique associated with the Nāth Siddhas is the awakening of the *kuṇḍalinī*, which, as a result of its awakening, ascends through a certain number of *cakras* up the central channel.[884]

In light of the prominence of *kuṇḍalinī* within the traditions underlying the sources Rāmacandra drew upon, the appearance of the term *siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga* in a section that does not mention *kuṇḍalinī* at all is, understandably, unsatisfactory. One hint to understand this phenomenon might be the occurrence of the term Mantrayoga, which Rāmacandra places right next to

[880] This is evident, for example, in the inclusion of the concept of *ūrdhvaśakti* in the context of the ninth *cakra* in Section XII.

[881] *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.3: *tṛtīyaṃ nābhicakraṃ pañcāvartaṃ sarpavat kuṇḍalākāram | tanmadhye kuṇḍalinīṃ śaktiṃ bālārkakoṭisannibhāṃ dhyāyet | sā madhyā śaktiḥ sarvasiddhidā bhavati ||*

[882] See for example *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 1.7, 1.12, 1.14, 2.3, 4.21.

[883] Mallinson, 2011: 5.

[884] *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 6.86: *śaktyākuñcanam agnidīptikaraṇaṃ tv ādhārasaṃpīḍaṇāt sthānāt kuṇḍalinīprabodhanam ataḥ kṛtvā tato mūrdhani || nītvā pūrṇagiriṃ nipātanam adhaḥ kurvanti tasyāś ca ye khaṇḍajñānaratās te nijapadaṃ teṣāṃ hi dūraṃ padam ||* Cf. *Yogataraṅgiṇī* 1.48–49: *kiṃ ca, yena dvāreṇa gantavyaṃ brahmasthānam anāmayam | mukhenācchādya tad dvāraṃ prasuptā parameśvarī || 48 || yena dvāreṇa yena mārgeṇa kṛtvā anāmayaṃ jananamaraṇādiduḥkhacintārahitaṃ brahmasthānam akhaṇḍānandapadaṃ gantavyaṃ tad dvāraṃ mukhenācchādya prasuptā parameśvarī kuṇḍalī śaktiḥ ||48|| prabuddhā vahniyogena manasā marutā saha | sūcīvad guṇam ādāya vrajaty ūrdhvaṃ suṣumnayā || 49 || vahniyogena prāṇapreritānalaśikhāsambandhena kṛtvā prabuddhā tyaktanidrā satī manasā marutā prāṇena ca saha yuktā suṣumṇāyā avadhyā nāḍyā kṛtvā ūrdhvaṃ sahasradalābhimukhaṃ vrajati | dṛṣṭāntam āha—sūcīvad iti yathā sūcī svasaktaṃ guṇam ādāya ūrdhvaṃ paṭasya prati tantvantarālaṃ vrajati tadvad iyam api svakalpitaṣaṭcakraṃ tad adhitiṣṭhati tat tad eva ādisakalaprapañcaṃ saṃhṛtya vrajati || 49 ||*

Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga in *Tattvayogabindu* III. An explicit connection between Kuṇḍalinī and Mantra is established in *Śāradātilakatantra* 25.37ab:

> *bibharti kuṇḍalī śaktir ātmānaṃ haṃsaṃ āśritā* |
>
> The *kuṇḍalī* Śakti abides in the *haṃsah* [and] supports the [individual] Self.[885]

However, only manuscript U_2 introduces the *haṃsaḥ mantra* in the context of *Tattvayogabindu*'s nine *cakra*s. Be it as it may, another hint to unlock the mystery surrounding Rāmacandra's deployment of the term *siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga* is the following. Already in the *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* (1363 CE), the oldest text presenting a ninefold *cakra* system within the framework of Layayoga, the *cakra* system is linked with the concept of *kuṇḍalinī*. *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* 4351–4352 reads:

> *prathamaṃ brahmacakraṃ syāt trir āvartaṃ bhagākṛtiḥ* |
> *apāne mūlakandākhye kāmarūpaṃ ca taj jaguḥ* ‖5‖
>
> The Brahmacakra is the first. [It has] three windings [and] the appearance of the perineum. [Situated] within *apāna* [it is] known as the root-bulb and that is praised as Kāmarūpa.
>
> *tad eva vahnikuṇḍaṃ syāc chaktiḥ kuṇḍalinī tathā* |
> *tāṃ jīvarūpiṇīṃ dhyāyej jyotiṣkāṃ muktihetave* ‖6‖
>
> That [*cakra*] is the firepit and the *śakti* is *kuṇḍalinī*. One should meditate on her as the embodiment of life, as she who is luminous, for the sake of liberation.

Immediately following the presentation of the nine *cakras*, one encounters Śārṅgadhara's section on Rājayoga, which includes two methods. The first method is attributed to Dattātreya. This method involves guiding the breath and mind by contracting the *mūlādhāra* along the posterior path in the back (*paścime daṇḍamārge*) to the end of the Śaṅkhinī channel. After the three

[885] Translated by Bühnemann, 2011: 218.

granthis are pierced and the mind and breath reach the *brahmarakandara*, the sound-born *bindu* dissolves into the void.[886] The second method, however, involves the awakening of *kuṇḍalinī*, which ascends through the *cakras* (in this case, notably only five *cakra*s), uniting as *śakti* with *śiva* in the head, producing nectar that floods the entire body, leading to *samādhi* and transforming the yogin into a Siddha. This is described in *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* 4368–4371:

> *athavā mūlasaṃsthānām udghātais tu prabodhayet* |
> *suptāṃ kuṇḍalinīṃ śaktiṃ bisatantunibhākṛtim* ||
>
> Alternatively, one should awaken the dormant Kuṇḍalinī Śakti, which has a form that resembles a lotus stalk, by striking the place of the *mūla*[*-ādhāra*].
>
> *suṣumṇāntaḥ praveśyaiva pañca cakrāṇi bhedayet* |
> *tataḥ śive śaśāṅkābhe sphurannirmalatejasi* ||
>
> Causing [Kuṇḍalinī Śakti] to enter the interior of the Suṣumṇā, one should pierce the five *cakras*. Then, in the pure, radiant light resembling the moon, in Śiva …
>
> *sahasradalapadmāntaḥsthite śaktiṃ niyojayet* |
> *atha tatsudhayā sarvāṃ sabāhyābhyantarāṃ tanum* ||
>
> who resides in the thousand-petalled lotus, one should join the Śakti. Then, with that nectar, one should flood the entire body inside and out.
>
> *plāvayitvā tato yogī na kiṃcid api cintayet* |
> *tata utpadyate tasya samādhir nistaraṅgitaḥ* |
> *evaṃ nirantarābhyāsād yogī siddhaḥ sa jāyate* ||
>
> Having flooded [the body with that nectar], the yogi should not think of anything. Then arises his unwavering *samādhi*. Thus, as a result of practising constantly, the yogin becomes a Siddha.

[886] *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* 4364–4367.

This passage indicates that the ninefold *cakra* system described by Rāmacandra was originally intrinsically linked with the concept of *kuṇḍalinī* and Siddhahood. This conclusion is confirmed by the *Nāḍīcakra* scroll (ORIS 1334), which, in its system of nine *cakra*s, likewise refers to the third *cakra* as the locus of Kuṇḍalinī.[887] From this perspective, Rāmacandra's designation "Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga" is understandable and could be seen as a remnant of the intrinsic connection of the ninefold *cakra* system with *kuṇḍalinī*.

In *Tattvayogabindu* XLIV, the second, and this time explicit, mention of Siddhayoga is found, including a description of the characteristics that define a Siddhayogin. This passage is not based on the *Yogasvarodaya*, but most of the verses presented here are derived from the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* with some significant editorial changes. Some verses of this passage are possibly even from Rāmacandra's own hand. The entire section revolves around the characteristics of an Avadhūta person (*avadhūtapuruṣa*).[888] In the last three verses of this passage, the Avadhūta is equated with a Siddhayogin, in the sense of a "yogin who has perfected yoga." Through Siddhayoga, one becomes a *siddhayogin*:

> *viśvātītāt tayā viśvam ekam eva virājate* |
> *saṃyogena sadā yasya siddhayogī sa gadyate* || XLIV.8 ||
>
> Through that the universe shines forth as only one, as a result of being beyond the universe. One who is always united with it is said to be a perfected yogin.

[887] *Nāḍīcakra* (ORIS 1334 ll. 155–63) reads: *oṃ tṛtīyaṃ kuṇḍalinīsthānaṃ sindhūravarṇaṃ sarpākāraṃ adhomukhī agnir devatā kuhūriṇī śaktiḥ brahmāṛṣiḥ kūrmakalā udyānabandhakā varuṇamaṇḍala kāmākhyā devī mālāgnir bhāvāmasthāna kāmānavami 2 yoginī mokṣadāyinī jaṭharāgnipraveśe nābhisthāne kuṇḍalinī śaktiḥ raktavarṇā adhomukhī dhūmrakalā jaganmātā yoginām abhiset sadāḥ garbhapuṭam*. It is important to note that the supplementary material concerning the nine *cakra*s preserved in witness U_2 corresponds almost entirely with the content of the *Nāḍīcakra* scroll, apart from the omission of the passage cited above.

[888] A recent discussion of the reception history of the term *avadhūta* can be found in Sravani Kanamarlapudi. "Avadhūta: Examining the Emergence and Institutionalisation of an Antinomian Ascetic". In: *Journal of Hindu Studies* 16 (2023), pp. 241–269.

sarvāsāṃ nijavṛttīnāṃ vismṛtiṃ bhajet tu yaḥ |
sa bhavet siddhasiddhānte siddhayogī sa gadyate ‖ XLIV.9 ‖

He who forgets all inherent fluctuations [of the mind], he is called a perfected yogin according to the doctrine of the Siddhas.

udāsīnaḥ sadā śānto mahānandamayo 'pi ca |
yo bhavet siddhayogena siddhayogī sa kathyate ‖ XLIV.10 ‖

One who is always indifferent, peaceful and immersed in great bliss by means of Siddhayoga[889] is said to be a Siddhayogin.

Thus, a Siddhayogin has realised the unity of the universe, has stilled his mind, and is always indifferent, peaceful, and immersed in great bliss. He has attained all this by means of Siddhayoga. The use of the instrumental *siddhayogena* in this context confirms that the compound *siddhayoga* is a genitive *tatpuruṣa* and not a *karmadhāraya* compound. Unfortunately, there are no clear instructions or explicit descriptive statements that would define the practice of Siddhayoga in this second context. Nonetheless, it is possible to derive them from the previous statements.

Verse XLIV.2, for example, says that the alms of the Avadhūta[890] are "difference and non-difference" (*bhedābheda*). A similar perspective can already be found in the Jñānayoga section XXI. Although the term *bhedābheda* is not here, we can infer that the practice of Siddhayoga should involve the cultivation of this specific philosophical perspective.

In the preceding verse XLIV.3, there is an etymological explanation (*nirukti*) of the term *avadhūta*. The letter *a°* stands for the self (*ātman*), the letter *°va°* stands for the mental impressions (*vāsanā*s), and *°dhūta* is said to be the shaking off of those *vāsanā*s. Thus, an Avadhūta or Siddhayogin

[889] Interestingly, the term *siddhayogena* is not attested in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*.

[890] Originally, the Avadhūta was considered an antinomian ascetic who detached himself from all societal bonds and did as he pleased. Over the centuries, in the words of Kanamarlapudi (2023), he became "sanitised" and more socially acceptable. The Avadhūta was integrated into the Brahmanical *āśrama* system, his unconventional traits and unorthodox practices were tamed, and the Avadhūta was thereby elevated to a legitimate and eventually even the highest class of the *saṃnyāsa āśrama*.

dedicates himself to a yogic practice that ensures the reduction of the *vāsanā*s and strives for self-realisation.

Furthermore, no other statements could specify Siddhayoga's method.

3.16.2 Siddhiyoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

Siddhiyoga, the "Yoga of supernatural powers" in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* denotes an advanced stage of Yogic practice on the path to *samādhi*. This stage is reached when a high degree of mastery over the mind ensues. From this mastery, various supernatural abilities can be acquired through specific practices such as austerity (*tapas*) or meditative exercises (*saṃyama*), which are presented in the second chapter (*sādhanapāda*), but especially in the third chapter (*vibhūtipāda*) of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*. According to Nārāyaṇatīrtha, this stage is conducive to the attainment of *samādhi*.[891] As with all other yogas, Nārāyaṇatīrtha locates Siddhiyoga in the first chapter, specifically within his commentary on *sūtra* 1.40:

> *cittasthitijayasya jñāpakaṃ siddhiyogaṃ samādhy anukūlam āha—*
> *paramāṇuparamamahattvānto 'sya vaśīkāraḥ* ‖ 40 ‖
>
> It is said that Siddhiyoga indicates mastery of the stability of the mind, which is conducive to *samādhi*—His [the yogins] mastery extends from the smallest particle of matter up the greatest extend.

Nārāyaṇatīrtha explains that the control of the yogin encompasses total and unhindered mastery over everything. This mastery is conducive to *samādhi* because it prevents afflictions such as hunger and thirst. It is a significant indicator that the yogin has mastered his mind.[892]

[891] The description of Siddhiyoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* by Penna (2004: 84–85) portrays Siddhiyoga solely as a state that facilitates *samādhi*, but completely overlooks the practical aspect of Siddhiyoga, which is the cultivation of particular supernatural abilities (*siddhi*s).

[892] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 106): *parameti | asya sthiracittasya yoginaḥ paramamahattvāntaḥ paramamahattvaṃ yeṣāṃ viyatpuruṣādināṃ tatparyanto vaśīkāraḥ apratighātaḥ kenāpy apratibandhyatā | saiva kṣutpipāsādi—pīḍāpratibandhadvārā samādhisādhikā cittajayasya ca jñāpiketi bhāvaḥ |*

Towards the end of his commentary on *Yogasūtra* 1.40, Nārāyaṇatīrtha states that this advanced stage of yogic practice can be achieved through various methods and leads to the highest possible firmness (*dṛḍhatā parā*).

> *ayam eva siddhiyogaḥ prāṇaspandanirodhādyair upāyair dṛḍhatā parā |*
> *siddhiyogo bhaved atra yogaḥ siddhikaraḥ paraḥ ‖ ity ādinā ‖ 40 ‖*
>
> This indeed is Siddhiyoga. By means such as the cessation of the movement of breath, supreme firmness arises. Here, Siddhiyoga means the supreme yoga that brings about accomplishment. Thus it is stated.

Next, Nārāyaṇatīrtha links Siddhiyoga with specific supernatural abilities (*siddhi*s) as he illustrates in his commentary on *Yogasūtra* 2.35. Siddhiyoga is exemplified here by the result of the practice of non-violence (*ahiṃsā*).[893] Once the yogin has achieved stability in non-violence through the practice of *pratipakṣabhāvana*,[894] he creates a sphere of non-violence where no enmity exists. This sphere of non-violence even neutralises natural enmities, such as those between the mongoose and the snake, as Nārāyaṇatīrtha informs us.[895] Finally, we encounter Siddhiyoga in Nārāyaṇatīrtha's commentary on *Yogasūtra* 2.43, where Siddhiyoga is explicitly linked with a broader spectrum of attaining supernatural abilities (*siddhis*). In particular, asceticism (*tapas*) is the crucial catalyst for success in Siddhiyoga. It is here that the full scope of the concept of Siddhiyoga becomes comprehensible, as it explicitly builds upon and expands the explanations from *Yogasūtra* 1.40:

> *tapaḥ sādhyāṃ siddhim āha—*
> *kāyendriyasiddhir aśuddhikṣayāt tapasaḥ ‖ 43 ‖*

[893] The supernatural ability resulting from the practice of *ahiṃsā* is the creation of a sphere of non-violence. The yogin who has perfected *ahiṃsā* can no longer suffer any violence. This is, incidentally, the first supernatural ability that manifests for the yogin who practices Pātañjalayoga.

[894] The intentional cultivation of opposing thoughts, e.g., when one feels sorrow or anxiety and then concentrates on positive or pleasurable thoughts.

[895] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 104): *evam ahiṃsāparasya yoginas tatphalabhūtaṃ siddhiyogaṃ darśayati—ahiṃsāpratiṣṭhāyāṃ tatsannidhau vairatyāgaḥ ‖ 35 ‖ ahiṃseti | uktapratipakṣabhāvanenāhiṃsāsthairye sati tatsannidhau ahiṃsāṃ bhāvayataḥ samīpe vairatyāgaḥ | sahajavirodhinaḥ mahinakulādīnām api nirmatsaratayā 'vasthitir bhavatīty arthaḥ ‖ 35 ‖*

Ascetic heat is said to cultivate perfection—
Perfection of the senses and the body manifests as a result of ascetic heat on account of the removal of impurities.

kāyeti | tapasaḥ tapo 'bhyasād, aśuddhikṣayād yatheṣṭagatyādiprati-bandhakapāpamalāder nāśāt, kāyendriyasiddhiḥ kāyendriyāṇām alpatvamahattvadūrārthadarśitvādisāmarthyarūpā siddhir bhavatīty arthaḥ | kāyasyātilāghavena dūradeśagamanādikaṃ dharmav-iśeṣāyattaṃ mahattvenānyair abādhyatvādi ca bhavati | indriyāṇāṃ dūrārthasūkṣmārthavyavahitānekārthagrāhitā bhavatīti yāvat | etena paramāṇuparamamahattvānto 'sya vaśīkāra iti sūtreṇokta—siddhiyogasyātrāntarbhāvo jñātavyaḥ |

[Regarding the term] *kāya* ("body"). Ascetic heat (*tapas*) [arises] from repeated practice of ascetic heat [i.e. austerities, etc.].[896] As a result of the destruction of impurities and other obstructions such as sin and filth, which hinder free movement and the like, perfection of the senses and the body manifests, meaning the ability of the body and senses to become small, large, see distant objects, etc. Through the extreme lightness of the body, there is the ability to travel to distant places, etc. and through other capacities dependent on special qualities, unobstructedness, etc., arises. To be precise, the [ability] of the senses to perceive distant, subtle, covered, and multiple objects arises. This is indicated by the *sūtra* "his control extends from the smallest atom to the greatest magnitude."—It should be understood that Siddhiyoga is included here.

3.16.3 Siddhayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Siddhayoga across the four early modern yoga taxonomies clarifies the term's use as a yoga category in the 16th and 17th cen-

[896] The heat of *tapas* bakes the body and destroys impurities that are mentioned in the following.

turies. The *Tattvayogabindu* mentions Siddhayoga in two forms: *Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga* and Siddhayoga. The former denotes a practice centred on the three channels and meditation on a ninefold *cakra* system associated with the Siddhas, leading the yogin to perfection (*siddha*). Although *kuṇḍalinī* would be expected in this context, it remains unmentioned. The latter term lacks an explicit practice but is clearly linked to the Siddha doctrine (*siddhasiddhānta*), indicating that for Rāmacandra Siddhayoga was the "Yoga of the Siddhas," a usage not unique to him.

Nārāyaṇatīrtha, by contrast, speaks of Siddhiyoga. His alignment of fifteen yogas with the *Yogasūtra* responds to the contemporary prominence of this taxonomy and suggests familiarity with the term Siddhayoga in Rāmacandra's sense. Advocating the superiority of Pātañjalayoga, he sought to subsume all fifteen yogas within it. As the Siddha doctrine of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* could scarcely be integrated into the *Yogasūtra*, he likely adopted the phonologically similar Siddhiyoga to encompass practices leading to supernatural powers (*siddhi*), a central concern of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*.

3.17 Rājayoga

Rājayoga[897] occupies the fifteenth—and thus the final and most elevated—position in Rāmacandra's taxonomy. In the *Yogasvarodaya*, Rājayoga assumes a similarly superior role. In both works, it designates a path comprising several methods, each named as a distinct yoga, all of which culminate in the state of Rājayoga. The term thus functions both as an umbrella category and as the name of an exalted state with specific effects.

Strikingly, neither text explicitly associates Rājayoga with *samādhi*. The term is rare in both: it appears only in the brief accounts of Aṣṭāṅgayoga. The *Tattvayogabindu* merely lists *samādhi* as one of the eight limbs, without explanation; the *Yogasvarodaya* offers only a single sentence. By contrast, in texts from the twelfth to fifteenth centuries Rājayoga is primarily a synonym

[897] An outstanding reconstruction of the reception history of the term is "Rājayoga: Reincarnations of the King of All Yogas" (2014) by Jason Birch. See also Mallinson, 2024: 21–23 on the emergence of the term in early Haṭhayoga sources.

for *samādhi*.[898] The *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya* therefore exemplify the sustained early-modern tendency, visible from the sixteenth century onward, to reinterpret Rājayoga and align it with alternative yogic systems.

A different interpretation is observed in Nārāyaṇatirtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*. Here, Rājayoga is synonymous with *samādhi*, or, to provide the technical term for the final overarching goal of this system *asaṃprajñātasamādhi*, the final state of Pātañjalayoga. Rājayoga is, therefore, only the goal and not a method. However, in Nārāyaṇatīrtha's text, Rājayoga can be achieved through fifteen methods, all of which he situates within his yoga system, aiming to demonstrate its superiority by subordinating various other contemporary yoga methods to Pātañjalayoga.

In stark contrast, Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* attributes Rājayoga differently. Here, Rājayoga, along with Lakṣayoga and Aṣṭāṅgayoga, is considered a subcategory of Haṭhayoga, primarily denoting a specific technique widely known as *vajrolīmudrā*.

Thus, once more, we can observe how the competitive environment of Hinduism's diverse soteriological practices plays out in thematically, spatially, and temporally precisely delimited discourses manifesting in such negotiation processes.

3.17.1 Rājayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu*

Rājayoga is the overarching theme of Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu*. Rāmacandra's text aims to document the method of Rājayoga. That is clearly stated at the very beginning of the treatise.[899] Rāmacandra's Rājayoga encompasses a total of fifteen variants, which are listed as follows: Kriyāyoga, Jñānayoga, Caryāyoga, Haṭhayoga, Karmayoga, Layayoga, Dhyānayoga, Mantrayoga, Lakṣyayoga, Vāsanāyoga, Śivayoga, Brahmayoga, Advaitayoga, Siddhayoga, and Rājayoga itself. However, only Kriyāyoga, Jñānayoga, Caryāyoga, Haṭhayoga, Mantrayoga, Lakṣyayoga, and Siddha[kuṇḍalinī]yoga are explicitly introduced as methods with their own sections. Dhyānayoga, Vāsanāyoga, Karmayoga, and Advaitayoga are at

[898] Birch, 2014: 401.

[899] *Tattvayogabindu* I l. 1: *śrī gaṇeśāya namaḥ ‖ atha rājayogaprakāro likhyate |*

least implicitly present. Śivayoga and Brahmayoga are mentioned initially as methods but are not further elaborated upon in the text. We can, however, infer that Śivayoga[900] and Brahmayoga[901] were regarded as synonyms for Rājayoga, and thus Rāmacandra did not see the need to introduce them as independent categories. The mention of Rājayoga in the list of methods for Rājayoga appears redundant. However, it was probably placed at the end of the list to express its superiority as the "king of yogas,"[902] as there is no separate yoga method named Rājayoga found in the text. However, other terms that might suggest distinctive yoga categories not listed among the initial fifteen methods of Rājayoga are mentioned. These include Aṣṭāṅgayoga,[903] Satyayoga,[904] and Sahajayoga.[905] The reasons for their absence in the initial list are not entirely clear. However, the final statement with regards to Sahajayoga,[906] presented as the final method of Rājayoga, is followed by the statement: "This is the explanation for those named *cakravartin*."[907] This is the final sentence of *Tattvayogabindu*. Sahajayoga must, therefore, be understood as Rājayoga in the sense of "Yoga for royals", "Royal Yoga", or "Yoga for kings", which would plausibly explain the final position of Rājayoga in the taxonomy of Rāmacandra due to its final position.

A distinctive feature of the *Tattvayogabindu* is the result of Rājayoga mentioned directly in the introduction. Here, Rāmacandra speaks of "long-term durability of the body,"[908] which, as Rāmacandra explicitly emphasises, oc-

[900] The Śivayoga of the *Śivayogapradīpikā* closely aligns with the overall content of the *Tattvayogabindu*, suggesting the possibility of synonymous usage.

[901] For instance, Divākara comments on the first verse of the *Bodhasāra*: *rājayogo rājñāṃ nṛpāṇāṃ svasthāne sthitvāpi sādhayituṃ śakyatvāt tatsambandhī yogo jīvabrahmaikyaviṣayakajñānalakṣaṇo* …Birch (2014: 430, n. 51) translates: "Rājayoga is the yoga of kings, because rulers can accomplish it even while remaining in their position (that is, as kings). In this connection, its [main] characteristic is knowledge concerning the union of the individual self with Brahman." The *Tattvayogabindu* occupies a similar position. Here, too, Rājayoga is yoga for kings. Thus, it is possible that Rāmacandra shared this view and considered Brahmayoga synonymous with Rājayoga.

[902] Much in the sense of the *Amanaska* 2.3cd: *rājatvāt yogānāṃ rājayoga iti smṛtaḥ* |

[903] For the discussion of Aṣṭāṅgayoga, see p. 467.

[904] For the discussion of Satyayoga, see p. 477.

[905] For the discussion of Sahajayoga, see p. 478.

[906] *Tattvayogabindu* LIX: *…sa sahajayogaḥ kathyate rājayogamadhye* |

[907] *Tattvayogabindu* LIX: *iti cakravartināmakathanam* |

[908] *Tattvayogabindu* I: *…bahutarakālaṃ śarīrasthitir bhavati* |

curs under special circumstances, namely "even if the practitioner is enjoying manifold royal pleasures and even when there is manifold royal entertainment and spectacle."[909] The name Rājayoga here implies that the practitioner can live like a king and, despite engaging in excessive forms of worldly enjoyment, still experience the positive effects of yoga without renouncing the world and becoming an ascetic. Numerous passages in the text suggest that the Rājayoga of the *Tattvayogabindu* was indeed directly addressed to members of the royal court, aristocracy, young princes (*kumāra*s), and perhaps the king himself. Due to the scope and significance of this topic, it is addressed elsewhere in this work.[910]

Besides the *śarīrasthiti*, various other effects or signs of the Rājayoga methods are explicitly addressed in *Tattvayogabindu* XVI,[911] XVII,[912] and XLII.[913,914] The table 6 lists these effects according to the *Tattvayogabindu*'s sections.

3.17.2 Rājayoga in the *Yogasvarodaya*

Just like in the *Tattvayogabindu*, Rājayoga in the *Yogasvarodaya* has fifteen variants. Of these fifteen, however, only eight yogas are named: Kriyāyoga, Jñānayoga, Karmayoga, Haṭhayoga, Dhyānayoga, Mantrayoga, Urayoga[916] and Vāsanāyoga. The other variants are not named, presumably for metrical reasons. In this case, Rājayoga is again considered both as a fifteenfold

[909] Ibid. I: *…yena rājayogenānekarājyabhogasamaya eva anekapārthivavinodaprekṣaṇasamaya eva …*

[910] See p. 12.

[911] *Tattvayogabindu* XVI: *idānīṃ rājayogayuktasya puruṣasya yac charīracihnaṃ tat kathyate |*

[912] Ibid. XVII: *anyad rājayogasya cihnaṃ kathyate |*

[913] Ibid. XLII: *idānīṃ rājayogāc charīre etādṛśāni cihnāni bhavanti |*

[914] Additionally, the individual methods of Rājayoga most often have their own effects.

[916] The term Urayoga is possibly a corruption of the text. Jason Birch suggested emending to *lakṣyayoga*, as Lakṣyayoga plays a central role in the course of the text. Karen O'Brien-Kop suggested *ūha°* as a possible reading for *ura°*—a term derived from the older meditation framework of Sāṃkhya, which emphasises *ūha* (reflection), *śabda* (speech), and *adhyayana* (study). Oberhammer, for example, discusses this term in his analysis of the *Yuktidīpikā* (commentary on the *Sāṃkhyakārikā*). Unfortunately, the term is not found a second time in the surviving material of the *Yogasvarodaya*. In view of the mention of Sāṃkhyayoga in Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, this possibility cannot be ruled out. Unfortunately, the surviving material of the *Yogasvarodaya* does not support this idea. Sven Sellmer suggested that it may not be a mistake, but an abbreviated form of *uraga°*. Uragayoga translated as "Snake yoga" and could be a synonym for Kuṇḍalinīyoga. However, I could not find this word attested anywhere else.

TYB XVI	TYB XVII	TYB XLII
• He is rich at all times. • He dwells distant from the world. He dwells in the world, having permeated it. • Neither birth nor death exists for him. • Happiness does not exist. • Suffering does not exist. • Descent does not exist. • Moral conduct does not exist. • Abode does not exist. • In the mind of this perfected one, a light appears immediately before him, which is the connection with God. • Neither does he have a caste, nor does he have any sign. • He is without parts, immaculate and uncharacterised. • Whatever wish for the most excellent fruit, affectionate woman, etc. arises, he obtains that very enjoyment. His mind truly does not suffer attachment in this situation.	• Even when there is the attainment of a kingdom, etc., the perception of a reward does not arise. • Even in loss, suffering does not arise within the mind, and neither does desire arise. • Even when whatever object has been obtained, aversion towards any object does not arise; and concerning this object, affection of the mind does not arise. • The mind is equal towards a person who has expertise in sacred scriptures, a friend or an enemy. • An indifferent view arises. • When for him who freely moves across the entire world being furnished with enjoyment and happiness, the pride of the ability to do these things does not arise within the mind; and one does not proclaim the ability to do these things among all his followers—this is also said to be of Rājayoga. • Whether one has new clothes made of silk, or old, worn clothes with holes, whether one is smeared with sandalwood and musk, or smeared with mud—when delight and grief do not reside within the mind, it is that which is Rājayoga. • When the mind is neither bored nor overwhelmed situated in a city, a forest, an uninhabited village, or a village full of people.	• The eradication of all diseases occurs. • He has a vision of the entire earth. • Knowledge of the principles (*tattva*s) arises. • He understands all languages. • The body becomes as strong as a diamond. • Even with the bite of a snake, death does not occur. • Hunger, thirst, drowsiness, and heat do not trouble the person. • Perfection of speech arises. • Fatigue does not occur in the body. • The person assumes the nature of the wind. • He sees the entire earth with a glance. • The eight supernatural powers beginning with "becoming infinitely small" etc. (*aṇimādi*) arise. • The nine treasures (*navanidhi*) approach nearby.[915] • Within the ten cardinal points in space, the power over death and rebirth arises. • Wherever there is a desire to go in the world, one goes there. • Ignorance disappears everywhere. • One sees the supreme Lord nearby. • There is the capability of accomplishing tasks and removing obstacles.

Table 6: The *Tattvayogabindu*'s effects of Rājayoga

method and as a state. All fifteen methods lead to the practitioner dwelling in Brahman. The term here implies both the highest or most superior form of

yoga and the highest yogic state. Rājayoga leads to a long life and the attainment of the eight supernatural powers. In comparison to the *Tattvayogabindu*, which presents Rājayoga as a yoga that can be practiced despite royal sensual pleasures, the introduction in this text merely states that the practitioner is worthy of being revered by kings. The quotation of the *Yogasvarodaya* in the *Prāṇatoṣiṇī* (Ed. p. 831) reads:

atha rājayogaḥ ‖ yogasvarodaye |
īśvara uvāca |
rājayogaṃ pravakṣyāmi śṛṇu sarvatra siddhidam |
guhyād guhyataraṃ devi nānādharmaṃ parāt param ‖
rājayogena deveśi nṛpapūjyo bhaven naraḥ |
rājayogī cirāyuś ca aṣṭaiśvaryamayo bhavet ‖
pañcadaśaprakāro'yaṃ rājayogaḥ ‖
kriyāyogo jñānayogaḥ karmayogo haṭhas tathā |
dhyānayogo mantrayoga urayogaś ca vāsanā |
rājaty etad brahmavāsy ebhiś ca pañcadaśadhā ‖

Now Rājayoga. [As described] in the *Yogasvarodaya*. God said: "I will teach Rājayoga, listen! In every case it bestows completion. [It is] more secret than secret, oh goddess, [its] nature is manifold, [and it is] higher than the highest. By means of Rājayoga, oh goddess, a man becomes [worthy] of being worshipped by kings. The Rājayogin may have a long life and he may be equipped with the eight [supernatural] powers. This Rājayoga has fifteen varieties: Kriyāyoga, Jñānayoga, Karmayoga, Haṭhayoga, Dhyānayoga, Mantrayoga, Urayoga and Vāsanāyoga. By [means of] these fifteen [yogas], that [person] who is resting in Brahman shines [like a king]."

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16 **brahmavāsy** em.] brahmavaśīva *unm.* PT

3.17.3 Rājayoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

In his introduction to the first *sūtra*, Nārāyaṇatīrtha takes Rājayoga as a synonym of *samādhi* ("meditative absorption") and *nididhyāsana* ("profound meditation"). Later on, he equates Rājayoga more specifically with *asaṃprajñātasamādhi* and *nirbījasamādhi*.[917] Thus, the Rājayoga of the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* designates the final state, the goal of the Pātañjalayoga system,[918] and not a method to achieve the state. He provides fifteen different yogas to reach this state. All yoga methods are, in turn, embedded within the eight limbs of Pātañjalayoga. In his commentary, Nārāyaṇatīrtha situates and explains all of them within the *samādhipāda* and *sādhanapāda* of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*. This can best be understood from Nārāyaṇatīrtha's own words:

> *brahmavid āpnoti param | brahmavid brahmaiva bhavati | tam eva viditvā 'timṛtyum eti nānyaḥ panthā vidyate 'yanāya | tarati śokam ātmavit | ity ādiśrutisiddhaparamapuruṣārthasādhanatānandātmasākṣātkārasādhanatayā śravaṇamanananididhyāsanādīni, ātmā vā 're draṣṭavyaḥ śrotavyo mantavyo nididhyāsitavyaḥ | ity ādināmnātāni | tatra nididhyāsanaṃ pradhānam | tatsahakṛtād eva manaso 'laukikā 'bādhitātmagocarapramāsambhavāt, sarvavijñānādirūpaphalasaṃvādāc ca | nididhyāsanañ caikatānatādirūpo rājayogāparaparyāyaḥ samādhiḥ | tatsādhanaṃ tu kriyāyogaḥ, caryāyogaḥ, karmayogo, haṭhayogo, mantrayogo, jñānayogaḥ, advaitayogo, lakṣyayogo, brahmayogaḥ, śivayogaḥ, siddhiyogo, vāsanāyogo, layayogo, dhyānayogaḥ, premabhaktiyogaś ca | tad etat sarvaṃ sāmānyaviśeṣabhāvenāṣṭāṅgayogena kavalīkṛtam iti manasi nidhāya sāṣṭāṅgaṃ saphalaṃ yogaṃ samādhisādhanavibhūtikaivalyārthakaiś caturbhiḥ pādair vyutpādayiṣyan*

[917] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* 1.20 (Ed. p. 25): *tataḥ paravairāgyād asamprajñāta itareṣāṃ pūrvavilakṣaṇānāṃ manuṣyāṇāṃ mumukṣūṇāṃ bhavatīty arthaḥ | ayam eva ca rājayoga ity ucyate | tad uktaṃ smṛtau—samādhis tatra nirbījo rājayogaḥ prakīrttitaḥ | dīpavad rājate yasmād ātmā saccinmayaḥ prabhuḥ ||*

[918] This has previously been noted within the article by Jason Birch (2014: 414–415) on the reception history of yoga named "Rājayoga: Reincarnations of the King of All Yogas". Here, Birch states that the first occurrence of the term "*rājayoga*" in a commentary on the *Yogasūtra* may be Vijñānabhikṣu's *Yogasārasaṃgraha* (16th century). Here, too, Vijñānabhikṣu understood Rājayoga as *samādhi*.

prekṣāvat pravṛttaye viṣayaprayojanādhikārisambandhān darśayan prathamaṃ śāstrasyārambhaṃ pratijānīte bhagavān patañjaliḥ | atha yogānuśāsanam ‖ 1 ‖[919]

Hearing (*śravaṇa*), reflection (*manana*), [and] profound meditation (*nidhidhyāsana*), etc. are transmitted through quotations such as—"Oh, the self, indeed, must be seen, heard, reflected upon, and profoundly meditated upon"—as a means to the blissful realisation and as the means to the supreme goal of human beings, which is established in the sacred scriptures in quotations such as "the knower of Brahman attains the supreme"; "the knower of Brahman is Brahman [itself]"; "having realised that alone, one transcends death; no other path is known for advancing"; [and] "the knower of the self traverses sorrow." Among these, profound meditation is the most essential part. Only because of that, the extraordinary perceptions of the mind arise—as a result of the occurrence of the right idea of the dwelling place of the unobstructed self and, as a result, the information of the fruits of the first appearance of all-encompassing insight. Profound meditation, characterised by being towards unity, is another synonym for Rājayoga or *samādhi*. The means to this include Kriyāyoga, Cāryāyoga, Karmayoga, Haṭhayoga, Mantrayoga, Jñānayoga, Advaitayoga, Lakṣyayoga, Brahmayoga, Śivayoga, Siddhiyoga, Vāsanāyoga, Layayoga, Dhyānayoga, and Premabhaktiyoga. All these are encompassed generally and specifically through the eight-limbed yoga. Keeping this in mind, the yoga with eight limbs which is fruitful, through the chapters regarding the subjects *samādhi* ("meditative absorption"), *sādhana* ("practice"), *vibhūti* (*supernatural powers*) and *kaivalya* (*isolation*) teaching the connections regarding the objective of the topic for its application in a comprehensible manner the venerable Patañjali

[919] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Ed. p. 2.

revealing the most excellent beginning of his treatise states: Now, the teaching of yoga begins.

3.17.4 Rājayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

The Rājayoga of Sundardās (3.13–24) is subsumed along with Lakṣyayoga and Aṣṭāṅgayoga in the tetrad of Haṭhayoga.[920] In contrast to Rāmacandra, who portrays Haṭhayoga as a form of Rājayoga, Sundardās understands Rājayoga as a form of Haṭhayoga. This form exclusively refers to what is generally known as *vajrolīmudrā*.[921]

Although the association of Rājayoga and *vajrolī* might seem surprising in light of the modern understanding of Rājayoga as meditation,[922] or its use in medieval yoga texts (12th–15th centuries CE) as a synonym for *samādhi*,[923] *vajrolīmudrā* was already regarded in early *haṭha* texts, such as the *Dattātreyayogaśāstra*,[924] as a suitable method to achieve Rājayoga. Śrīnivāsayogī goes even further in the *Haṭharatnāvalī*. For him, one can only become a *rājayogī* through the practice of *vajrolī*.[925] According to Mallinson (2018: 205), *vajrolīmudrā* was originally used by ancient ascetic traditions as a technique for the retention and conservation of semen (*bindudhārana*) by reabsorbing the fluids emitted by both sexes during the act through the urethra, thus maintaining the celibacy so crucial to these traditions under all circumstances. Mallinson showed through texts written from the second millennium CE onward that these practices were first made accessible to an audience beyond their ascetic originators, allowing householders to benefit from yoga practice without having to forgo the pleasures of sexual intercourse. Simultaneously, this technique was adapted by tantric Śaiva traditions. They synthesised the originally purely physiological concept of *vajrolīmudrā* with two of their own

[920] For another discussion of Rājayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, see Burger, 2014: 696–697.

[921] In his brilliant article titled "Yoga and Sex: What is the Purpose of Vajrolīmudrā?" (2018), Mallinson determined the history, method, and purpose of *vajrolīmudrā* based on textual, ethnographic, experiential, and anatomical data.

[922] See De Michelis, 2004: 178–180.

[923] Birch 2014: 401.

[924] *Dattātreyayogaśāstra* 183–184.

[925] *Haṭharatnāvalī* 2.104.

concepts: the use of sexual fluids as the ultimate offering in rituals and its internalisation as a visualisation of the united sexual fluids being directed upward through the central channel. As a result, *vajrolīmudrā* was no longer considered merely a physiological method for maintaining celibate efforts but, through this synthesis with tantric ideas, became a method leading to a divine body,[926] the attainment of all supernatural powers (*siddhis*),[927] or the awakening of *kuṇḍalinī*.[928]

Only against this background can the Rājayoga of Dādūpanthī Sundardās be adequately understood, whose practical aspect must be derived from only two verses:[929]

> *rājayoga kīnā śiva rāī | gaurā saṃga anaṃga na jāī |*
> *ghṛta nahiṃ ḍharai agni ke pāsā | rājayoga kā baḍā tamāsā* ‖ 14 ‖
>
> Śiva performed Rājayoga with Gaurī (Parvatī), without being overcome by the god of love (*anaṅga*).[930] Just as clarified butter cannot stay near fire, Rājayoga is a great challenge.
>
> *nāḍīcakra bheda jau pāvai | tau caḍhi biṃda apūṭhau āvai |*
> *karanī kaṭhina āhi ati bhārī | baśabarttanī hoi jau nārī* ‖ 15 ‖
>
> Having pierced the network of channels (*nāḍīcakra*), then the rising semen arrives unbroken. The practice is hard and very difficult, even when the women is under control.

The name *vajrolīmudrā* is not mentioned. However, the practice referred to as Rājayoga in these verses is practically identical to the medieval models of *vajrolīmudrā* described above.[931] Rājayoga consists of a practice involving sexual intercourse between a man and a woman, which leads to not being

[926] *Śivasaṃhitā* 4.87
[927] *Dattātreyayogaśāstra* 175
[928] See *Haṭharatnāvalī* 2.82
[929] *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.14–15.
[930] Anaṅga is another name for Kāma (lit. "desire"), the god of love.
[931] The same conclusion is drawn by Burger (2014: 696) and Mallinson (2018: 195).

overpowered by the god of love, the personification of desire.[932] The yogin is encouraged to make the semen rise after it has pierced the network of channels (*nāḍīcakra*). The entire process is described as extremely difficult, even if the woman cooperates.

The first verse describes Śiva practicing Rājayoga with Pārvatī. Due to subsequent references to *vajrolī*, this implies engaging in sexual intercourse. Despite the physical union with Pārvatī, who symbolises beauty and passion, Śiva was not overpowered by the god of love (*anaṅga*), who represents desire and passion. To illustrate the difficulty of Rājayoga, Sundardās uses the image of clarified butter, which cannot remain near the fire without melting and burning. This image symbolises how something very pure, like ghee, typically cannot withstand the presence of something that could consume or destroy it. This purity, the clarified butter, represents yogic celibacy, while the fire represents the source of desire, namely the woman, Pārvatī. The celibacy of a yogin in this situation is highly threatened, as it is extremely difficult to resist the urge. Unlike anyone else, Śiva can enjoy the sexual act with Pārvatī without being consumed by her flames and without giving up his celibacy. He succeeds in using Rājayoga to pierce the network of channels with the semen[933] and then make it rise within himself. The comparison illustrates the high degree of self-control and difficulty required to practice this form of Rājayoga, as it is natural for desire to arise in the presence of attractive stimuli. Accordingly, the last verse of this chapter states:

> *rājayoga cinha ye jānaiṃ biralā koi* |
> *triyā saṃga mati kījiyahu jo aisā nahīṃ hoi* ‖ 24 ‖
>
> Those who truly understand the characteristic of Rājayoga are rare indeed; he who does not, should shun the company of women.

[932] Mallinson (2018) mentions *Haṭhābhyāsapaddhati* (f. 28r, ll. 6–9), which describes that the yogin can have sex with sixteen women a day without giving up celibacy and without succumbing to passion once the practice of *vajrolī* is well established. For the new critical edition of the *Haṭhābhyāsapaddhati*, see Birch, Singleton, and Mallinson, 2025.

[933] It remains unclear whether this refers to his own semen or a mixture of male and female semen, as in the *Yogaśikhopaniṣad* 1.137cd: *rajaso retaso yogād rājayoga iti smṛtaḥ* | Here, Rājayoga is defined as the union of female generative fluid or menstrual blood (*rajas*) and semen (*retas*).

The other verses describe the one who has mastered Rājayoga. These descriptions are similar to those in the *Tattvayogabindu*. The positive effects of Rājayoga are far-reaching. The practitioner's resilience is increased immeasurably. Neither hunger nor thirst, sleep or laziness, cold and heat, nor old age can affect him (3.19). Fire cannot burn, nor can water drown him; he does not age and becomes immortal with a body as hard as a diamond (3.20). He goes wherever he wants; nothing in the world can stop him, and he can dwell in heaven with the gods or in the netherworld with the demons if he desires (3.21) etc. The *rājayogin* presented here strongly resembles the archetypal Avadhūta, who can do as he pleases. Particularly interesting is the statement that he is liberated (*muktā*) and yet enjoys the eight pleasures, untouched by sin and merit.[934] I could only identify the eight pleasures in the *Tattvayogabindu* (Section XXII) and here. They are listed there and include: 1. Silken clothes, 2. A mansion with five or seven rooms, 3. A large bed with a soft mattress and cover, 4. A woman belonging to the Padminī class of women,[935] 5. A comfortable seat, 6. An exceptionally valuable horse, 7. Appetizing food, and 8. Various drinks. The original idea of *vajrolī*, namely maintaining celibacy despite the enjoyment of sexual intercourse, is further expanded here. As a result of the Rājayoga of Sundardās, the yogin apparently need not renounce anything in the world. That demonstrates the character of the comprehensive syncretistic equation of *vajrolī* and Rājayoga that Sundardās undertakes here. He reduces the practice of Rājayoga to one of the fundamental practices of Haṭhayoga, namely *vajrolī*. This practice allows the yogin to enjoy the world's pleasures without facing the consequences that would affect the overarching goals of yoga. That opens the door for Sundardās to unreservedly transfer the general characteristics of the results of Rājayoga from other traditions to his own model. The very classification of Rājayoga as a subcategory of Haṭhayoga shows that Sundardās certainly did not understand Rājayoga as the king of all yogas as in *Amanaska*,[936] rather the term Rājayoga here implies that the practitioner can live like a king, indulge in

[934] *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.17: *dīsai saṃga pūni muktā | aṣṭa prakāra bhoga kau bhuktā | pāpa punya kachu parasai nāṃhīṃ | jaisaiṃ kamala rahai jala māṃhīṃ* ‖ 16 ‖

[935] See n. 264 on p. 173.

[936] *Amanaska* 2.3cd: *rājatvāt yogānāṃ rājayoga iti smṛtaḥ |*

the associated sensual pleasures, and remain a yogin, without wandering as a possessionless, world-renouncing ascetic seeking liberation. This aligns with his explicit criticism of groups such as the *kāpālikā*s, *paśupata*s and other ascetics, mainly for their extreme behaviour.[937]

3.17.5 Rājayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Rājayoga within the four texts of the complex early modern yoga taxonomies demonstrates the complex cross-traditional negotiation processes of the 16th and 17th centuries. It underscores the prominence of Rājayoga as a universal category in an interplay between continuity and innovation.

The analysis of the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya* shows the use of the term Rājayoga as a superior and at the same time universal category. All yogas listed in these texts are presented as methods of Rājayoga. Here, Rājayoga carries multiple connotations. At the first level, Rājayoga must be understood as the "king of yogas" since it is placed at the top of the lists, as seen in the earlier fourfold taxonomies. At the same time, Rājayoga is a specific state to be attained but can be reached through very different yoga methods. Regarding the desired state, the *Tattvayogabindu* notably departs from the earlier connotations with *samādhi* and shifts the interpretation of this once primarily soteriological state, which still resonates but surprisingly weakly, towards a state that emphasises more worldly concerns. Specifically, one property of Rājayoga is unmistakably highlighted. Despite extensive involvement in sensual pleasures, the practitioner attains all the mental and physical benefits of a yoga practice. That occurs against the backdrop that the *Yogasvarodaya* targets householders and ascetics,[938] and the *Tattvayogabindu* targets wealthier social strata, probably *kṣatriya*s. Therefore, in the latter text, the meaning of "Yoga for kings" is also clearly implied at a second level. The inclusivist schema[939] that emerges in the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*

[937] See p. 316.

[938] The quotations from *Yogasvarodaya* in the *Yogakarṇikā* make it clear that some of the practices attributed to *Yogasvarodaya* – such as *nāḍīkṣālanam* (YK 4.74–77) – were undoubtedly only performed by professional ascetics.

[939] Inclusivist in the sense of Paul Hacker's "Inklusivismus" (1979).

also appears in Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*. In Nārāyaṇatīrtha's text, Rājayoga can be achieved through fifteen yogas or yoga methods, all of which he situates within his own yoga system, aiming to demonstrate its superiority by subordinating all other contemporary yoga methods he knew to Pātañjalayoga. Nārāyaṇatīrtha equates Rājayoga with *asaṃprajñātasamādhi*, the ultimate state of Pātañjalayoga. Thus, Rājayoga is considered solely as the goal and not as a specific method. However, that reflects the discursive power and social esteem Rājayoga had in Nārāyaṇatīrtha's lifetime. Although Nārāyaṇatīrtha undoubtedly considers his Pātañjalayoga as the ultimate and superior yoga system, which is evident in his attempt to incorporate or perhaps more aptly subjugate the fifteen yogas to the *Yogasūtra*, Rājayoga was so significant in his discursive environment that he equated the term Rājayoga, a term that originated from Śaiva traditions, with the final goal, the quintessence of Pātañjalayoga, namely *asaṃprajñātasamādhi*.

Sundardās, as an author with a clear Vaiṣṇava orientation, naturally sought to distinguish himself from other discursive authorities and degrades Rājayoga in his *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* to a method of Haṭhayoga, namely *vajrolīmudrā*, which, according to his descriptions, is not only difficult to master but was also widely considered disreputable and frowned upon.[940] He keeps his descriptions so vague and brief that it is unimaginable that this description could have served as a practical guide. This categorisation could only have served a strategic purpose, namely, similar to the *Tattvayogabindu*, *Yogasvarodaya*, and the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, to strengthen and propagate his own yoga model in contrast to other models, especially those models that place Rājayoga at the top of the hierarchy. Sundardās deliberately knocks Rājayoga off its throne with his model. Through this categorisation, he manages to subtly undermine the authority of Rājayoga without having to ignore it. In comparison to the other texts of the complex yoga taxonomies, his yoga

[940]The fact that participants in the discourse were troubled by *vajrolīmudrā* is shown, for example, in the *Dattātreyayogaśāstra*. The new critical edition by Mallinson (2024) has shown that in the most widely disseminated recension of the text, the section on *vajrolīmudrā* was significantly shortened, likely due to disapproval of these practices. The same phenomenon was observed in the new critical edition of the *Haṭhapradīpikā* (2025). In most recensions of this text, the section on *vajrolīmudrā* was either moved to the end or removed entirely.

taxonomy proceeds more skillfully in terms of eloquence, systematics, and diplomatic finesse.

Taken together, we witness a struggle for interpretive authority, a competitive environment of yoga traditions entangled in discursive processes, where each actor tries to assert themselves.

3.18 Other yogas

Up to this point, the comparison of individual yoga categories has been based on the order set out in *Tattvayogabindu*. Thus, most of the yoga categories used in our texts have already been covered. However, there are still some yogas that need to be addressed. These will be described in the following sections and, if they appear in more than one text, they will be contrasted with each other.

3.19 Bhaktiyoga

Bhaktiyoga, the "Yoga of devotion" is entirely absent in the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*. Nārāyaṇatīrtha, however, places his Premabhaktiyoga at the topmost position in the yoga taxonomy of the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*. For him, this method of yoga is the final and most important element for attaining Rājayoga or *samādhi*.[941] Sundardās, on the other hand, places Bhaktiyoga at the very beginning in his treatise on all limbs of yoga, the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*.[942] In his progressive sequence of twelve yogas, Bhaktiyoga forms the very foundation of his yoga system. In Sundardās's system, Bhaktiyoga is both an individual category and an overarching term of the

[941] For another description of Premabhaktiyoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* see Penna 2004: 97–102. Unlike Penna, Nārāyaṇatīrtha does not mention the four types of *praṇidhāna* merely for informational purposes. Rather, Nārāyaṇatīrtha illustrates the superiority of his concept of Premabhaktiyoga, which encompasses all four methods.

[942] For a discussion of Bhaktiyoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* in French, see Burger, 2014: 690–692.

first tetrad, subsuming the three methods already discussed: Mantrayoga,[943] Layayoga,[944] and Carcāyoga.[945]

3.19.1 Premabhaktiyoga in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*

Nārāyaṇatīrtha introduces Premabhaktiyoga, the "Yoga of devotion with unconditional love", in his commentary on *Yogasūtra* 1.32:

> *tatpratiṣedhārtham ekatattvābhyāsaḥ* ‖ 32 ‖
>
> For the purpose of their repulsion, the practice of concentrating on a single principle [should be performed].

This *sūtra* refers back to the disturbances (*vikṣepa*s) mentioned in *Yogasūtra* 1.30, which lists the obstacles to the stilling of the fluctuations of the mind (*cittavṛttinirodha*). These disturbances are disease (*vyādhi*), incompetence (*sthyāna*), doubt (*saṃśaya*), carelessness (*pramāda*), sloth (*ālasya*), lack of detachment (*avirati*), erroneous conception (*bhrāntidarśana*), not obtaining a base for concentration (*alabdhabhūmikatva*), and instability (*anavasthitatva*).

According to Nārāyaṇatīrtha, the devout worship of Īśvara (*īśvara-praṇidhāna*) is indispensable for the repulsion of the nine disturbances. Nārāyaṇatīrtha asserts that even minimal or incomplete practice of *praṇidhāna* can yield remarkable results. Simply uttering the name of Īśvara destroys accumulated sins. This destruction, along with faith, etc., results in complete devotion, thereby achieving all desired outcomes.[946]

Praṇidhāna can be practiced in four ways: the highest (*paramamukhya*), the most excellent (*mukhya*), the one belonging to the most excellent (*mukhya-jātīya*), and the almost excellent (*mukhyakalpa*).[947] All four methods serve the

[943] See p. 391.

[944] See p. 376.

[945] See p. 355.

[946] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* 1.32 (Ed. pp. 49–50): *yathā 'gnikaṇo 'tisvalpo 'pi tṛṇarāśaṃ jvālayaṃs tenaiva varddhitaḥ pūrṇaḥ sarvāṇi sūcitāni kāryāṇi janayati | tathā bhagavato yathākathañ cinnāmoccāraṇādirūpam api praṇidhānam ajāmilāder iva pāparāśiṃ nāśayat tena nāśenaivādhikaṃ sampādyamānaṃ śraddhādinā pūrṇaṃ bhajanīya icchāsahakṛtaṃ sarvābhilaṣitaṃ sādhayate | tasmāt praṇidhānam evāvaśyakam |*

[947] Ibid. 1.32 (Ed. p. 50): *tac ca caturvidham paramamukhyaṃ, mukhyaṃ mukhyajātīyaṃ, mukhyakalpañ ceti |*

progressive fixation of the mind on Īśvara and are based on the expositions of the *Bhagavadgītā* 12.8–11.

The first type (*paramamukhya*) of devout worship is the loving and continuous fixation of the mind and intellect on Īśvara. This form of *praṇidhāna* is compared to the devotion and love of the Gopīs for Kṛṣṇa. The mind of the Gopī melts upon hearing the multitude of divine qualities and, like molten copper poured into a mold, firmly takes its shape.[948]

The second type (*mukhya*) is also known as the practice of *nididhyāsana*. If the first type is impossible, this form should be adopted initially. It is characterised by repeatedly drawing back the outwardly directed and wandering mind through practice and focusing it on the exalted self within.[949] This variant is intended for practitioners who are unable to maintain the mental constancy required for the first method.

For those who cannot fix their mind on the Supreme God through love or constant repetition, the third type (*mukhyajātīya*) is recommended. That primarily involves devout service to God, such as recitation of God's name, fasting, etc. This service and all actions, good or bad, should be dedicated to the Supreme God without attachment to the results.[950]

The fourth type (*mukhyakalpa*) is finally for those who cannot yet practice the third type, the devout service to God. Here, the practitioner is encouraged to renounce the fruits of all actions and to rest in the self.[951]

In the context of the repeated practice [of concentration] on a single principle to eliminate the nine disturbances of *Yogasūtra* 1.32, Nārāyaṇatīrtha identifies the one principle (*ekatattva*) as the Supreme God, and the practice

[948] Ibid. 1.32 (Ed. p. 50): *tatrādyaṃ gopīnām iva tadguṇagaṇaśravaṇādinā drutacetaso drutatāmarasyeva dṛḍhatadākāratā tadviṣayakavṛttipravāharūpaṃ prema mayy eva mana ādhatsva mayiṃ buddhiṃ niveśaya | ityādinoktam | anena premabhaktiyogo darśitaḥ | sa ca parameśvaracaraṇāravindaviṣayakaikāntikātyantikapremapravāho 'navacchinna ity arthaḥ |*

[949] Ibid. 1.32 (Ed. p. 50): *dvitīyaṃ tadasāmarthye bahiḥpravṛttisvabhāvasya manasaḥ pratyāhāreṇa punaḥ punarbhagavatyātmani niveśanarūpo 'bhyāso nididhyāsanākhyaḥ |* To illustrate this explanation, Nārāyaṇatīrtha quotes *Bhagavadgītā* 12.9: *atha cittaṃ samādhātuṃ na śaknoṣi mayi sthiram | abhyāsayogena tato māṃ icchāptuṃ dhanañjaya || ityādy uktam |*

[950] Ibid. 1.32 (Ed. p. 50): *tṛtīyan tu tadasāmarthye 'pi svabhāvata eva kṛtānām api karmaṇāṃ phalecchāṃ tyaktvā parameśvare paramagurāv arpaṇam sādhu vā 'sādhu vā karma yad yad ācaritaṃ mayā | tatsarvaṃ tvayi saṃnyastaṃ tvatprayuktaḥ karomy aham || iti saṃkalpaviśeṣarūpam |*

[951] Ibid. 1.32 (Ed. p. 50): *athaitad apy aśakto 'si kartuṃ madyogam āśritaḥ | sarvakarmaphalatyāgaṃ tataḥ kuru yatātmavān || ity ādinoktaṃ bhagavadgītādvādaśādhyāye |*

(*abhyāsa*) as Premabhaktiyoga. Premabhaktiyoga, he asserts, is the culmination of all the methods above. Moreover, according to Nārāyaṇatīrtha, Premabhaktiyoga unites both results: the removal of disturbances and the reception of God's grace.[952]

The continuous flow of mental fluctuations (*vṛttipravāha*) generated within the framework of Premabhaktiyoga can be practised either with qualities (*saguṇa*) and distinctions (*savikalpa*), focusing on a specific form of God, such as Vāsudeva mentioned by Nārāyaṇatīrtha, or without qualities (*nirguṇa*) and without distinctions (*nirvikalpa*), focusing on the "one reality free from internal, external, and contradictory distinctions, [a reality having an] unattributed, undivided nature." (*ekaṃ sajātī vijātīyasvagatabhedarahitaṃ tattvam anāropitam akhaṇḍārtha*).[953]

Nārāyaṇatīrtha further emphasises the particular significance of Premabhaktiyoga in his commentary on *Yogasūtra* 2.45. Here, it is *īśvarapraṇidhāna* in the form of *premabhakti*, which leads the yogin to the grace of God, which is required for the perfection of *samādhi*.[954] Thus, the passage clarifies why Nārāyaṇatīrtha positions Premabhaktiyoga at the summit of his yoga system.

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[952] *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* 1.32 (Ed. pp. 50–51): *atra ca praṇidhānaśabdenoktam | tatra nididhyāsanaṃ samānaviṣayatayā sākṣātkārajanakatvasādhanaṃ karmādi yogebhyaś cāntaraṅgam ity abhipretya, arthabhāvanaśabdena pūrvam ādṛtaṃ yady api tathāpy adṛṣṭadvārā kṛpātiśayaphalakād antarāyābhāvaphalakāc ca | tasmāt paramaṃ mukhyaṃ bhaktiyogaṃ sarvopāyaphalabhūtamayam ata eva tadubhayaphalakaṃ premākhyam abhyāsam āha—tatpratiṣedhārthamekatattvābhyāsaḥ ‖ 32 ‖ tatpratiṣedheti | teṣāṃ vikṣepāṇāṃ pratiṣedhārtham anāyāsena nāśārthaṃ ekasmiṃs tattve mukhyabhagati, abhyāsaḥ gopīnām iva tadguṇagaṇaśravaṇādinā dravībhūtasya cetaso mūṣānikṣiptadrutatāmrasyeva dṛḍhatadākāratārūpaprema abhyāsayogayuktena cetasā nānyagāminā | ity ādinā bhagavatsūcitaḥ kārya ityarthaḥ | yadbalād anāyāsena sampannāyāṃ jīvanmuktau vikṣepāḥ praśamam upayānti | na vāsudevabhaktānām aśubhaṃ vidyate kvacit | ity ādismṛteḥ |*

[953] Ibid. 1.32 (Ed. pp. 51–52): *athavā ekaṃ sajātīvijātīyasvagatabhedarahitaṃ tattvam anāropitam akhaṇḍārtha iti yāvat | tasya abhyāsaḥ tad ekam ajaram amṛtam abhayam iti vṛttipravāhaḥ kārya ity arthaḥ |atrātmavyatirekeṇa dvitīyaṃ yo na paśyati | ātmarāmaḥ sa yogīndro brahmībhūto bhaved iha ‖ ātmakrīḍasya satataṃ sadātmamithunasya ca | ātmany eva sutṛptasya yogasiddhir adūrataḥ ‖ abhiyogāt sadābhyāsāt tatraiva ca viniścayāt | punaḥ punaranirvedāt siddhyed yogo na cānyathā ‖ iti skandokteḥ | tasmāt saguṇātmavadākārākāradhārāvāhivṛttipravāhaḥ savikalpo nirguṇagocaro dhārāvāhiko nirvikalpako vā kāryo 'nāyāsena mokṣam icchateti yāvat ‖ 32 ‖*

[954] Ibid. 1.32 (Ed. p. 107): *īśvarapraṇidhānasādhyasiddhim āha—samādhisiddhariśvarapraṇidhānāt ‖ 45 ‖ samādhīti | īśvarapraṇidhānaṃ pūrvaṃ vyākhyātam | samādher uktalakṣaṇasya siddhir apratibandhenānāyāsena tatkṛpayā gurvādidvārā ca dṛḍhā prāptir bhavatīty arthaḥ | etac ca phalaṃ premabhakteḥ svataḥ puruṣārtharūpāyā nāntarīyakaṃ yathā phalārthino vṛkṣādisānnidhyec chāyāṃ gandhādir ity anyatra vistaraḥ ‖ 45 ‖*

3.19.2 Bhaktiyoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

Sundardās specifies Sanaka, Nāradamūnī, Śuka, Dhruva and Prahlāda as important representatives of his Bhaktiyoga.[955] He describes Bhaktiyoga in verses 2.1–15. Initially, Sundardās emphasises the attitude necessary for Bhaktiyoga in verses 2.2–7. One should control the senses. Regardless of where one is situated, one should not become attached to them.[956] Without falling into illusion (*māyā*) and deception, one should remain equanimous towards everything. Gold and women should be banished, and one should not be overwhelmed by desire.[957] Moreover, virtues such as good conduct, contentment, forgiveness, patience, and compassion should be cultivated.[958] Furthermore, one should view all beings as equal, from the king to the insect,[959] and keep the words of the true Guru in the heart, etc. These verses are reminiscent of the elements of *yama*s and *niyama*s from Aṣṭāṅgayoga systems.[960] Furthermore, Sundardās' writes in verse 2.7:

> *sāra grahai kūkasa saba nāṣai | ramitā rāma iṣta sira rāṣai |*
> *āṃna deva kī karai na sevā | pūjai eka niraṃjana devā ‖ 7 ‖*
>
> One should seize the essence and abandon all impurities, keeping the beloved Rama at the forefront of the mind. One should not serve any other gods, but worship only the one pure and formless deity.

Although Sundardās refers to the Divine as Rāma here, he represents the Nirguṇa type of Bhaktiyoga.[961] For Sundardās, Rāma is nothing other than a designation of the unmanifest consciousness (*avyakta puruṣa*).

[955] *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 1.3: *sanakādika nārada mūnī, śuka aru dhruva prahalāda | bhakti yoha so ina kiyau, sadguru kaiṃ ju prasāda ‖ 3 ‖*

[956] Ibid. 2.2cd: *jitendriya aru rahai udāsī | athavā gṛha athavā bana vāsī ‖ 2 ‖*

[957] Ibid. 2.3cd: *māyā moha karai nahiṃ kāhū | rahai sabani sauṃ beparavāhū | kanaka kāminī chāḍai saṃgā | āśā tṛṣnā karai na aṃgā ‖ 3 ‖*

[958] Ibid. 2.4ab: *śīla santoṣa kṣamā ura ghārai | dhīraja sahita dayā pratipārai |*

[959] Ibid. 2.5d: *kīrī kuṃjara sama kari jānaiṃ ‖ 5 ‖*

[960] In fact, in the presentation of his variant of Aṣṭāṅgayoga 3.37–52, Sundardās refrains from giving a concrete description of the *yama*s and *niyama*s. He only specifies them in verse 3.37.

[961] In *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 2.15, Sundardās himself describes this form of Bhakti as without attributes: *yaha so bhakti aliṃganī |*

The ritual worship (*pūjā*) mentioned in 2.7d is used by Sundardās as a metaphor and comparison for the form of Bhaktiyoga he describes in verses 2.9–11. The external *pūjā* is performed internally in Bhaktiyoga. One's discipline is the ritual washing, and one offers the flowers of love and devotion.[962] The lamp (*āratī*) for the worship is knowledge, and the bell (*ghaṇṭā*) is the unstruck sound (*anāhada śabda*) he contemplates, etc. He offers his entire body and mind, becomes humble, and falls at the feet of the Divine.[963] From this, a clear criticism of the ritualistic worship of God can be inferred, which Sundardās already expresses in the first chapter.[964]

The concluding verses illustrate the deep emotional devotion. One never abandons the attitude of the servant, and love grows day by day.[965] This inner attitude of service is compared to the attitude of a faithful wife towards her husband.[966] She serves continuously without interruption. Sundardās calls this form of devotion "incomparable" (*bhakti ananya*).[967]

3.19.3 Bhaktiyoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Bhaktiyoga across the four early modern yoga taxonomies clarifies the status of this category in the seventeenth century. For Sundardās, Bhaktiyoga is the foundational, devotional core of his system, reflecting the centrality of Sant Bhakti, which had spread widely from the fourteenth century onward across Maharashtra, Sindh, Punjab, Haryana, Gujarat, Rajasthan, and the Gangetic plains.[968]

Nārāyaṇatīrtha's placement of Premabhaktiyoga at the summit of the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* taxonomy likely responds to the contemporary prominence of the Bhakti movement and underscores his insistence on the universality and superiority of Pātañjalayoga.

[962] Ibid. 2.9cd: *saṃjama udaka sanāna karāvai | prema prītī ke puṣpa caḍhāvai* ‖ 9 ‖

[963] Ibid. 2.11: *jñāna dīpa āratī utārai | ghaṇṭā anahada śabda vacārai | tana mana sakala samarpana karaī | dīna hoī puni pāyani paraī* ‖ 11 ‖

[964] Ibid. 1.12–49.

[965] Ibid. 2.12cd: *sevaka bhāva kadai nahiṃ caurai | dina dina prīti adhika hī jorai* ‖ 12 ‖

[966] Ibid. 2.13ab: *jyauṃ pratibratā rahai pati pāsā | aisaiṃ svāmī kī ḍhiṃga dāsā |*

[967] Ibid. 2.14cd: *sadā aṣaṇḍita sevā lāvai | soī bhakti ananya kahāvai* ‖ 14 ‖

[968] See Horstmann and Rajpurohit (2023: 3–16) for an introduction to the Sant traditions.

In the *Yogasvarodaya*, the absence of Bhaktiyoga can be explained by the text's probable southern provenance. The references to the rivers Godāvarī and Kāverī suggest a regional context in which the Bhakti movement exerted comparatively less influence.[969]

The absence of Bhaktiyoga in Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu* is partly due to its sources, the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, which do not mention this category. Yet Rāmacandra composed his text in northern India, as indicated by his substitution of the southern rivers with Vipāśā (Beas) and Śatarudrā (Sutlej), regions where Bhakti was widespread. A further explanation is therefore likely: since the *Tattvayogabindu* was intended for elite audiences, Bhaktiyoga—associated with Sant traditions rooted in lower castes and marked by egalitarian, anti-ritualistic critiques of caste—was deemed unsuitable. It is thus understandable that Bhaktiyoga has no place in Rāmacandra's "Yoga for Kings."

3.20 Aṣṭāṅgayoga

Aṣṭāṅgayoga, the "eight-limbed yoga" is invariably incorporated by all four authors who present complex yoga taxonomies in their texts, yet in entirely different manners. Rāmacandra does not mention Aṣṭāṅgayoga within his enumeration of the fifteen methods for Rājayoga but introduces it in a separate section of his text. The author of the *Yogasvarodaya* presents an incomplete enumeration of the fifteen yogas, naming only eight of them, excluding Aṣṭāṅgayoga by name. However, similar to Rāmacandra, he presents Aṣṭāṅgayoga within his text. Unlike the *Tattvayogabindu*, it appears that Aṣṭāṅgayoga in the *Yogasvarodaya* is considered part of the fifteen methods of Rājayoga. Rāmacandra, in compiling his text, which heavily relies on the *Yogasvarodaya*, seems to have inadequately considered this when establishing his variant of the fifteen yogas, which he describes inconsistently and unsystematically throughout the text. Nonetheless, the Aṣṭāṅgayoga of the *Tattvayogabindu* remains part of Rāmacandra's Rājayoga.

[969] On the rivers of the *Yogasvarodaya*, *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, and *Yogasvarodaya*, see p. 227, n. 382.

In contrast, Nārāyaṇatīrtha does not include Aṣṭāṅgayoga among his fifteen methods for achieving Rājayoga. Strictly speaking, Aṣṭāṅgayoga is not one of Nārāyaṇatīrtha's methods for Rājayoga. Nevertheless, he situates his fifteen yogas within the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra*, the *locus classicus* of Aṣṭāṅgayoga, thus allowing Aṣṭāṅgayoga to frame the fifteen yogas in the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*.[970]

Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* presents a starkly different scenario. Here, Aṣṭāṅgayoga is the last of the four methods of Haṭhayoga.

3.20.1 Aṣṭāṅgayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu* and *Yogasvarodaya*

Since Rāmacandra's compilation of his Aṣṭāṅgayoga section largely follows the *Yogasvarodaya*,[971] yet deviates in some interesting places, it is insightful to compare both texts.[972] Both texts begin with an enumeration of the limbs of Aṣṭāṅgayoga. Notably, the *Yogasvarodaya* lists only seven of the eight limbs, omitting *dhyāna*.[973] Intriguingly, subsequent verses describe *dhyāna* but not *dhāraṇā*. The *Tattvayogabindu* lists all eight limbs, but Rāmacandra deviates from the Pātañjalayoga model, presenting *dhyāna* before *dhāraṇā*.[974] However, following his source, Rāmacandra omits subsequent explanations of *dhāraṇā*. He also does not explain *samādhi*. Both texts provide detailed

[970] Due to the absence within Nārāyaṇatīrtha's fifteen yogas and because Aṣṭāṅgayoga of the *Pātañjalayogaśāstra* has been extensively discussed in secondary literature, a renewed discussion is omitted here. Nārāyaṇatīrtha presents the eight limbs in his commentary on *sūtra* 2.29 as follows: *yamaniyamāsanaprāṇāyāmapratyāhāradhāraṇādhyānasamādhayo 'ṣṭāvaṅgāni ‖ 29 ‖ yameti | tatra yamāḥ svata eva saphalatvādatyāvaśyakāḥ | sarvamumukṣujanasevyā ādau, paścāt tatsāpekṣā niyamāḥ | etad ubhayādhīna cittasthairyasāpekṣāṇyāsanāni | tatsāpekṣaḥ prāṇāyāmaḥ | tatsāpekṣaḥ pratyāhāraḥ | tatsāpekṣā dhāraṇā | tatsāpekṣaṃ dhyānam | tatsāpekṣaḥ samādhiḥ savikalpa ity aṣṭau sākṣāt paramparayā vā nirvikalpasya samādher aṅgānīty arthaḥ | aṣṭāṅgamaithune kriyāniṣpatteraṅgino 'ṅgatvavat samādhiḥ savikalpa ity aṣṭau sākṣāt paramparayā vā nirvikalpasya samādher aṅgānīty arthaḥ | aṣṭāṅgamaithune kriyāniṣpatter aṅgino 'ṅgatvavat samādher aṅgino 'ṅgatvaṃ vā bodhyam | tena na ko 'pi doṣaḥ ‖ 29 ‖* In summary, Nārāyaṇatīrtha states that the limbs, beginning with the *yama*s, build upon each other and culminate in *samādhi*, which he also calls Rājayoga at the beginning of his commentary.

[971] Additionally, influences from the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.32–38 can be identified in this passage.

[972] See *Tattvayogabindu* wection XXXI and *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 841).

[973] *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 841): *idānīṃ yogamaṣṭāṅgaṃ śṛṇu lakṣaṇasaṃyutam | yamaś ca niyamaś caiva cāsanaṃ prāṇasaṃyamaḥ | pratyāhāro dhāraṇā ca samādhiś ca viśeṣataḥ |*

[974] See p. 173 n.264 for a discussion and further references on the reversed order of the limbs of Aṣṭāṅgayoga.

lists of six *yama*s and *niyama*s. Variations in the *Tattvayogabindu* reflect the influence of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, as well as Rāmacandra's ideas.[975] For the similarities and differences of the *yama*s see table 7 and for the *niyama*s see table 8. Notably, both texts omit non-violence (*ahiṃsā*) and sexual abstinence (*brahmacarya*).

The *yama*s of the *Tattvayogabindu*	The *yama*s of the *Yogasvarodaya*
• peace (*śāntiḥ*) • conquest of the six senses (*ṣaṇṇāṃ indriyāṇāṃ jayaḥ*) • little food (*āhāraḥ svalpaḥ*) • conquer of sleep (*nidrājayaḥ*) • conquer of cold (*śaityajayaḥ*) • conquer of heat (*uṣṇajayaḥ*)	• peace (*śāntiḥ*) • contentment (*santoṣaḥ*) • appropriate diet (*āhāraḥ*) • minimal sleep (*nidrālpā*) • control of the mind (*manaso damaḥ*) • an empty mental faculty (*śūnyāntaḥkaraṇam*)

Table 7: The *yama*s of the *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya*

The discussion of postures (*āsana*s) in both texts is brief. The *Yogasvarodaya* addresses *āsana* in half a verse, stating that there are as many postures as there are living beings.[976] Rāmacandra explains that the characteristics of postures are discussed in many other treatises. Therefore, he does not cover this topic.[977]

The *Yogasvarodaya* states that breath control (*prāṇāyāma*) is of three types and takes various forms. It asserts that young people are not capable of practising *āsana* and *prāṇāyāma*, but through the great power of spiritual merit (*mahāpuṇyaprabhāva*), the great soul (*mahātmā*) can do so.[978] The author

[975] The *yama*s of *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.32 are: calmness (*upaśamaḥ*), conquest of all senses (*sarvendriyajayaḥ*) and conquest of food, sleep, cold, wind, and heat (*āhāranidrāśītavātātapajayaḥ*). The *niyama*s of the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.33 are: living in solitude (*ekāntavāsa*), detachment (*niḥsaṅgatā*), indifference (*udāsīnyaṃ*), contentment with what is obtained (*yathāprāptisaṃtuṣṭiḥ*), aversion (*vairasyaṃ*), and dedication to the feet of the guru (*gurucaraṇāvarūḍhatvam*).

[976] *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 841): *āsanāni ca tāvanti yāvanto jīvajantavaḥ* | The author of this verse alludes to the numerous animal names of many yoga positions. See e.g. *Encyclopedia of Traditional Asanas* of Gharote, Jha, Devnath, and Sakhalkar (2006).

[977] *Tattvayogabindu* section XXXI: *āsanasya lakṣaṇaṃ bahūgrantheṣu nirūpitam asti | tenātra na nirūpyate |*

[978] *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 841): *prāṇāyāmas tridhā ceti bahudhā prathamaṃ śṛṇu | āsane prāṇasaṃyāme na śaktāḥ sukumārakāḥ | mahāpuṇyaprabhāveṇa śakyate tu mahātmanā |*

The *niyama*s of the *Tattvayogabindu*	The *niyama*s of the *Yogasvarodaya*
• restraining the mind from fickleness and establishing steadiness (*khalu manaḥ cāpalabhāvān nivārya sthairye sthāpyate*) • seeking solitude (*ekānte sevanam*) • equanimity towards all living beings (*prāṇimātre samābuddhiḥ*) • indifference • one shall not desire any object (*udāsīnyaṃ kasyāpi vastuni icchā na kartavyā*) • contentment with whatever is obtained (*yathā lābhasantoṣaḥ*) • never forgetting the name of the Supreme Lord (*parameśvaranāma na vismaraṇīyam*) • not indulging in self-pity (*manomadhye dainyaṃ na karttavyam*)	• discarding fickleness (*cāpalyan tu dūre tyaktvā*) • establishing steadiness of mind (*manaḥsthairyaṃ vidhāya*) • constantly uniting the mind with the breath (*ekatra melanaṃ nityaṃ prāṇamātreṇa sā matiḥ*) • always maintaining a detached attitude (*sadodāsīnabhāva*) • renouncing all desires (*sarvatrecchāvivarjana*) • being satisfied with whatever comes (*yathālābhena santuṣṭaḥ*) • keeping the mind fixed on the Supreme Lord (*parameśvaramānasaḥ*) • giving up pride and oblations (*mānadānaparityāga*)

Table 8: The *niyama*s of the *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya*

explains only the first type of *prāṇāyāma*, which is a standard form of alternate nostril breathing accompanied by visualisation. The *mahātmā* inhales through the left channel (*iḍā*), i.e., the left nostril, meditating on its moonlike appearance. Then he holds his breath (*kumbhaka*) for as long as possible. When his mind is filled with great splendour, and his body with air, and fear of the power of intense trembling arises, he should then exhale very slowly through the right channel (*piṅgalā*), i.e., the right nostril, meditating on its sunlike nature. He should repeat this like a moth repeatedly flying into the fire, which ultimately leads to the purification of the body.[979]

Rāmacandra only mentions that *prāṇāyāma* is unsuitable for young practitioners (*sukūmāra*), thus omitting any explanation of its practice.[980] Taking

[979] *Yogasvarodaya* (PT, p. 841): *iḍāṃ śaśiprabhāṃ dhyātvā mandendunā tu pūrayet | pūrayitvā yathāśakti dhyānayogī tu kumbhayet | mahājyotirmano bhūtvā vāyuḥpūrṇakalevaraḥ | śaktitrāsan tu santrāsya recayed vāyum arhitaḥ | piṅgalām arkavarṇān tu tyajed dhyātvā śanaiḥ śanaiḥ | ayaṃ pataṅgaḥ kāṣṭhāgnipratyāsena punaḥ punaḥ | kṛtvā kalevaraṃ śuddhaṃ kuryād yatnair mahātmanā |*

[980] *Tattvayogabindu* section XXXI: *prāṇāyāmas tu sukumāreṇa sādhituṃ na śakyate | atas tasya nāmamātraṃ kathyate |*

Rāmacandra at his word, this statement may indicate his intended audience. Why would he not describe a single breathing technique in his entire text?[981] Both texts briefly explain the withdrawal of the senses (*pratyāhāra*). In the *Yogasvarodaya*, *pratyāhāra* means withdrawing the mind from the cyclical existence (*saṃsāra*) and from the engagements with sensory objects. After the yogin has thus discarded the states and transformations of the mind, he remains composed of emptiness. Similarly, in the *Tattvayogabindu*, the yogin should turn his mind away from cyclical existence and dwell in the self, thereby restraining the emerging transformations of the mind.

The description of meditation (*dhyāna*) is similarly concise in both texts. The *Yogasvarodaya* mentions two types of meditation: a gross one consisting of *mantra* (*mantramaya*) and a subtle one without *mantra*. Further details are not provided. The *Tattvayogabindu* merely states that meditation has been taught many times before[982] and is therefore not discussed.[983]

In the *Yogasvarodaya*, *samādhi* is the state of the motionless intellect (*buddhi*), free from inhalation and exhalation. Rāmacandra does not mention *samādhi* at all in the *Tattvayogabindu*. At first glance, this seems peculiar, as the reader might expect a commentary on the highest state of yoga. However, if Rāmacandra addresses young practitioners (*sukūmāra*s), it is entirely reasonable why he does not recommend them to cease breathing.

3.20.2 Aṣṭāṅgayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*

For Sundardās, Aṣṭāṅgayoga (3.37–52) is the final method in his four-method system of Haṭhayoga.[984] It supplements the preceding three methods of Haṭhayoga (environment for yoga practice, dietary rules, and *ṣaṭkarma*s), Lakṣayoga (foci for meditation), and Rājayoga (*vajrolīmudrā* for celibacy

[981] For a discussion of the intended audience, see p. 12.

[982] Probably Rāmacandra refers to the descriptions of *dhyāna* in his own text. See p. 381 for the references.

[983] *Tattvayogabindu* section XXXI: *dhyānaṃ ca bahutaraṃ prāg uktaṃ tenātra nocyate |*

[984] Already in the *Śārṅgadharapaddhati* 4372–4375, a six-limbed yoga system, a variant without *yama* and *niyama*, is subordinated to Haṭhayoga: *atha haṭhayogaḥ dvidhā haṭhaḥ syād ekas tu gorakṣādisusādhitaḥ | anyo mṛkaṇḍaputrādyaiḥ sādhito 'niśam udyataiḥ ‖1‖ tatra gorakṣasadṛśaiḥ sādhito yaḥ sa kathyate | dhīrair api hi duḥsādhyaḥ kiṃ punaḥ prākṛtair janaiḥ ‖2‖ āsanaṃ prāṇasaṃrodhaḥ pratyāhāraś ca dhāraṇā | dhyānaṃ samādhir etāni yogāṅgāni smṛtāni ṣaṭ ‖3‖*

preservation), giving the entire *haṭha* practice a framework. It is precisely here, within the context of Aṣṭāṅgayoga that most of the characteristic haṭhayogic practices, namely *āsana*s, *kumbhaka*s, *mudrā*s, and *bandha*s, are introduced. The order of the eight limbs follows the Pātañjalayoga model.

Sundardās first mentions the two initial limbs, observances *yama* and restrictions *niyama*, each with ten different aspects, which he spares himself from listing.[985]

The second limb, the practice of postures (*āsana*), should be performed regularly to purify the body. For Sundardās, the two most important *āsana*s are the accomplished posture (*siddhāsana*) and the lotus posture (*padmāsana*).[986] In the context of breath control (*prāṇāyāma*), Sundardās initially emphasises that these exercises must be learned from a Guru. He then describes the basic form of alternate nostril breathing. That involves inhaling through the left nostril (*iḍā nāḍī*), followed by a retention phase, and then exhaling through the right nostril (*piṅgalā nāḍī*). During the retention phases, one should mentally recite the mantra twelve times. At this point, no further details about the mantra are provided. However, retrospectively, it could be the *rāma mantra* mentioned in Sundardās's Mantrayoga (2.16–27). The retention phases should be doubled and tripled over time and are accordingly named upper (*uttama*), middle (*madhyama*), and lower (*kaniṣṭa*) stages.[987] Additionally, Sundardās mentions the eight breath retentions (*kumbhaka*s) and five types of seals (*mudrā*s), as well as the three locks (*bandha*s). Further differentiations must be provided by the Guru.[988] Sundardās does not offer detailed descriptions of these practices. Regarding the fifth limb, the withdrawal of the senses (*pratyāhāra*), Sundardās is very brief. He defines *pratyāhāra* as controlling the mind so that one never craves the "taste of sensory objects"

[985] *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.37cd: *prathamahiṃ yama aru niyama bicārai | palari ṭeka daśa daśahiṃ prakārai* ‖ 37 ‖ This omission may be due to Sundardās's earlier treatment of many typical elements of *yama* and *niyama*; see p. 465.

[986] Ibid. 3.38: *bahuryau karai su āsana sabahī | nirma śarīra hoi puni tabahī | tāmahiṃ sārabhūta dvai sādhai | siddhāsana padmāsana baṃdhai* ‖ 38 ‖

[987] Ibid. 3.39–40: *prāṇāyāma karai bibhi aisī | sataguru saṃdhi batāvai jaisī | iḍā nāḍi kati pūrai bāī | recaka karai piṃgalā jāī* ‖ 39 ‖ *pūri piṃgalā iḍā nikārai | dvādaśa vāra mantra bidhi dhārai | dviguṇa triguṇa kari prāṇāyāmaṃ | uttama madhyama kaniṣṭa nāmaṃ* ‖ 40 ‖

[988] Ibid. 3.41: *kuṃbhaka aṣṭa bhāṃti ke jānaiṃ | mudrā paṃca prakāra su ṭhānaiṃ | baṃdha tīni nīkī bidhi lāvai | aura bheda sadaguru taiṃ pāvai* ‖ 41 ‖

(*biṣai svāda*). He uses the metaphor of a turtle retracting its limbs into its shell to illustrate *pratyāhāra*.[989]

Sundardās's sixth limb, concentration (*dhāraṇā*), involves focusing on one of the five elements: earth (*pṛthvī*), water (*apa*), fire (*teja*), air (*vāyu*), and ether (*ākāśa*), along with their associated deities, for five *ghaṭikā*s each.[990,991]

Sundardās divides meditation (*dhyāna*), the seventh limb of his Aṣṭāṅgayoga, into two categories: meditation with qualities (*saguṇa*) and meditation without qualities (*nirguṇa*). The former involves meditation on one of six *cakra*s, while the latter pertains to meditation on the formless self.[992]

Verses 3.45–48 describe the system of the six *cakra*s, which is widely spread in medieval Haṭhayoga texts: *ādhāra*, *svādhiṣṭhāna*, *maṇipūra*, *anāhata*, *viśuddha*, and *ājñā*. Sundardās concludes by stating that only through meditation on the six *cakra*s can the realisation of the formless (*nirguṇa*), the second form or stage of meditation, be achieved.[993]

From the *nirguṇa* stage of meditation arises the eighth limb, meditative absorption (*samādhi*). When the fluctuations of the mind and senses are absorbed, in the final stage of Aṣṭāṅgayoga, the individual self (*jīvātman*) and the supreme self (*paramātmā*) merge like salt in water.[994] Sundardās characterises this state as follows:

> *kāla na ṣāi śastra nahiṃ lāgai | yaṃtra maṃtra tā deṣata bhāgai |*
> *śīta uṣna kabahūṃ nahiṃ hoī | parama sāmādhi kahāvai soī* ‖ 51 ‖

[989] Ibid. 3.42: *pratyāhāra pakari mana rāṣai | biṣai svāda kabahūṃ nahiṃ cāṣai | jaisaiṃ kurama sakucai aṃgā | esaiṃ indrī rāṣai saṃgā* ‖ 42 ‖

[990] One *ghaṭikā* equals 1/60 of a day, see Sircar (1966: 114). 1/60 of a day corresponds to 24 minutes. Five *ghaṭikā*s equal exactly two hours.

[991] Ibid. 3.43: *paṃca dhāraṇā tatva prakāśā | pṛthi apa teja vāyu ākāśā | akṣara sahita devatani dhyāvai | paṃca paṃca ghaṭikā laya lāvai* ‖ 43 ‖

[992] Ibid. 3.44: *dhyāna su āhi ubhai ja prakāra | eka saguṇa ika nirguna sārā | saguna su kahiye cakra sthānaṃ | nirguṇa rūpa ātamā dhyānaṃ* ‖ 44 ‖

[993] Ibid. 3.48: *iti ṣaṭa cakra dhyāna jau tānai | tabahiṃ jāī nirguṇa pahacānai | gaganākāra dhyāya saba ṭhairā | prabhā marīcī jala nahiṃ aurā* ‖ 48 ‖

[994] Ibid. 3.49–50: *aba samādhi aisī bidhī karaī | jaisaiṃ laiṃna nīra mahiṃ garaī | mana indrī kī vṛtya samāvai | tākau nāma samādhi kahāvai* ‖ 49 ‖ *jīvātma paramātma doī | sama rasa kari jaba ekai hoī | bisarai āpa kachu nahiṃ jānai | tākau nāma samadhi vaṣānai* ‖ 50 ‖

> Time cannot affect it and no weapon can violate it. *Yantra* and *mantra* flee at the sight of it. It is not affected by cold or heat; this is called the supreme *samādhi*.

3.20.3 Aṣṭāṅgayoga in the complex yoga taxonomies

The comparative analysis of Aṣṭāṅgayoga across the four early modern yoga taxonomies reveals the diverse and nuanced uses of the term in the 16th and 17th century. Despite shared terminology, three distinct models emerge.

Nārāyaṇatīrtha follows the *locus classicus* of Aṣṭāṅgayoga, the Pātañjalayoga system, without alteration, seeking to incorporate the popular yogas of his milieu into this framework.

By contrast, the Aṣṭāṅgayoga of the *Yogasvarodaya* and *Tattvayogabindu* reflects Śaiva milieus, indicated by the reversed order of *dhyāna* and *dhāraṇā* and by distinct readings of *samādhi*. These texts pursue the opposite strategy: rather than integrating other yogas into the Pātañjala model, they subsume Aṣṭāṅgayoga within a Śaiva hierarchy headed by a form of Rājayoga.

Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* likewise embeds Aṣṭāṅgayoga within a sequence of yogas, treating it as a subcategory of Haṭhayoga and subordinating it to Advaitayoga. Nevertheless, he refrains from explicit hierarchisation and instead integrates all yogas into an interlocking system in which each is a part of progression on the yogic path. His limbs of Aṣṭāṅgayoga incorporate characteristic Haṭhayoga practices (*mudrā*, *bandha*) and structure a *cakra* system, reinforcing the impression of a cohesive twelvefold whole.

These models illustrate both cross-traditional competition for interpretive authority and the ongoing negotiation between innovation and tradition. The incorporation of regional and popular practices into established frameworks reflects a dynamic, cross-traditional reshaping of yogic systems in the 16th and 17th century.

3.21 Sāṃkhyayoga

Sāṃkhyayoga, the "Yoga of the enumerative philosophical method" appears only in Sundardās' *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* (4.1–12). All other texts of

the complex early modern yoga taxonomy do not deal with Sāṃkhyayoga.[995] Sundardās specifies Ṛṣabhadeva, Kapilamūni, Dattātreya, Vaśiṣṭha, Aṣṭāvakra, and Jaḍabharata as important representatives of Sāṃkhyayoga.[996] After Bhaktiyoga and Haṭhayoga, Sāṃkhyayoga is the third and final main category in Sundardās's yoga system. Sāṃkhyayoga forms the starting point for the three subsequent yogas associated with it, namely Jñānayoga,[997] Brahmayoga,[998] and Advaitayoga.[999] Before the Yogi recognises unity with the world through Jñānayoga, experiences unity with the universe through Brahmayoga, and ultimately overcomes duality in Advaitayoga, Sāṃkhyayoga primarily serves to create initial awareness of the duality to be transcended by differentiating the self from the non-self.[1000] Compared to classical Sāṃkhya, consciousness (*puruṣa*) here (4.2–3) is referred to as the self (*ātama*) and primordial nature (*prakṛti*) as the non-self (*anātama*):

> *ātama śuddha su nitya prakāśā | ana ātamā deha kā nāśā |*
> *ātama sukṣma vyāpaka mūlā | ana ātamā so paṃca sthūlā ‖ 2 ‖*
>
> The self is pure, eternal and illuminating. The not-self relates to the destructible body. The self is subtle, omnipresent and the fundamental cause, while the non-self is composed of the five gross elements.
>
> *pṛthi apu teja vāyu aru gaganā | ye paṃcauṃ ātama saṃlagnā |*
> *paṃcani maiṃ mila aura bikārā | tini yaha kiyā prapaṃca pasārā ‖ 3 ‖*
>
> Earth, water, fire, air and ether—these five are attached to the self. In these five elements, other transformations occur, and

[995] However, Sāṃkhyayoga also appears in *Śivayogapradīpikā* 4.19–31. Here, it belongs to Rājayoga within the description of *samādhi* and is thus embedded in the basic structure of an Aṣṭāṅgayoga.

[996] *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 1.5: *ṛṣabhadeva aru kapila mūni, dattātreya vaśiṣṭha | aṣṭāvakra ru jaḍabharata, ina kai sāṃkhya sudṛṣṭa ‖ 5 ‖*

[997] For the discussion of Jñānayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, see p. 347.

[998] For the discussion of Brahmayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, see p. 428.

[999] For the discussion of Advaitayoga in the *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, see p. 432.

[1000] *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 4.1: *aba sāṃkhya su yoga hi suni lehū | pīchai hamako doṣa na dehū | ātama ana ātamā bicārā | yāhī teṃ saṃkhya su nirddhārā ‖ 1 ‖*

> these three [self, non-self and transformations] have created the proliferation of the universe.

The non-self consists of the five gross elements: earth (*pṛthi*), water (*apu*), fire (*teja*), air (*vāyu*), and ether (*gāganā*); the five subtle elements: sound (*śabda*), touch (*sparśa*), form (*rūpa*), taste (*rasa*), and smell (*gandhā*); the five senses of perception (*jñānendriya*s): hearing (*śrotra*), touch (*tvak*), sight (*cakṣu*), taste (*jihvā*), and smell (*ghrāṇa*); the five organs of action: speech (*vākya*), grasping (*pāṇi*), moving (*pāda*), excreting (*pāyu*), and reproducing (*upastha*); and the inner organ (*antaḥkaraṇa*) consisting of mind (*mana*), intellect (*buddhi*), consciousness (*citta*), and ego (*ahaṃkāra*).[1001] These comprise twenty-four *tattva*s in total.

Sundardās then elaborates on the inner organ. The thinking mind (*manas*) generates thoughts and doubts. The intellect (*buddhi*) discerns and recognises what is good or bad. Consciousness (*citta*) generates awareness. The ego (*ahaṃkāra*) produces self-awareness and pride.[1002]

Finally, Sundardās distinguishes the subtle transmigratory body (*liṅga śarīra*), composed of the five subtle elements and the inner organ, totalling nine *tattva*s, from the gross body, which is subject to decay and comprises the gross elements, the senses of perception, and the organs of action.[1003]

Sundardās concludes by explaining that these twenty-four elements work together, with the soul (*jīva*) as the driving force behind them. He also refers to the soul as the knower of the field (*kṣetrajña*) or eternally auspicious (*nirantara śīvā*). The soul permeates everything and is omnipresent. It appears to be involved in everything but is ultimately unbound. As the witness, it is distinct from all else, the twenty-four *tattva*s of the non-self. The self and the non-

[1001] Ibid. 4.4–6: *śabda saparśa rūpa rasa gaṃdhā | tanmātṛkā paṃca tana baṃdhā | śrotra tvak cakṣu jihvā ghrāṇaṃ | jñāna su indriya kiyau baṣāṇaṃ ‖ 4 ‖ vākya hi pāṇi pāda aru pāyuḥ | upastha sahita paṃca samajñāyuḥ | karma su indriya ina kau nāmā | tatpara apanai apanai kāmā ‖ 5 ‖ mana uru buddhi citta ahaṃkārā | catuṣṭa antahakaraṇa vicārā | tina kai lakṣaṇa bhinnai bhinnā | mahāpuruṣa samujñāye cinhā ‖ 6 ‖*

[1002] Ibid. 4.7–8ab: *saṃkalpai aru bikalapa karai | mana so lakṣaṇa esau dharai | buddhi su lakṣaṇa bodhahiṃ jāṃnī | kīkai burau leī pahicānī ‖ 7 ‖ caitana lakṣaṇa citta anūpā | ahaṃkāra abhimāna svarūpā |*

[1003] Ibid. 4.8cd: *nau tatvani kau liṃga śarīrā | paṃdraha tatva sthūla gaṃbhīrā ‖ 8 ‖*

self are eternal and not subject to ageing and death. However, the gross body (*deha*) is transient.[1004]

3.22 Satyayoga

SATYAYOGA, the "true Yoga" is a term that appears in the *Tattvayogabindu* in XLIV.7 in the section on *avadhūtapuruṣasya lakṣaṇam*:

> *prasaraṃ bhāsate śaktiḥ saṃkocaṃ bhāsate 'pi ca |*
> *tayoḥ saṃyogakartā yaḥ sa bhavet satyayogabhāk ||*
>
> Śakti shines forth as expansion and as contraction. He who unites those two experiences true yoga.

The term *satyayoga* is not included in the initial taxonomy of the fifteen methods for Rājayoga. Rāmacandra adopted the verse from the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 6.64 and redacted it according to his own agenda and mingled it with *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 4.19.[1005] All manuscripts of the *Tattvayogabindu* read *satyayogabhāk* in the fourth *pāda* of the verse. Here, the source text reads *siddhayogirāṭ*. Rāmacandra might have used the term as a synonym for Siddhayoga[1006] or it might be a typographical error of Siddhayoga. By the definition of this verse, Satyayoga would be a practice in which the practitioner dedicates himself to the union of two aspects of Śakti, here defined as expansion (*prasāra*) and contraction (*saṃkoca*). In the light of the source text, it could be a corruption of the term *siddhayoga°* which could have arisen from the homoioteleutic ending of the preceding verse. Furthermore, no other medieval or premodern yoga texts use the term to designate a distinct type of yoga. For this reason, it seems unlikely that this term is a specific category or method of yoga.

[1004] Ibid. 4.9-12: *ye caubīsa tatva baṃdhānaṃ | bhinna-bhinna karikiyau vaṣānaṃ | saba kau preraka kahiye jīvā | so kṣetajña nirantara śīvā ||* 9 *|| sakala viyāpaka aru sarvagā | dīsai saṃgī āhi asaṃgā | sākṣī rūpa sabani teṃ nyārā | tāhi kachū nahiṃ lipai bikārā ||* 10 *|| yaha ātama ana ātama niranā | sagajñai takauṃ jarā na maraṇā | sāṃkhya su mata yāhī sauṃ kahiye | sataguru binā kahauṃ kyauṃ lahiye ||* 11 *|| sāṃkhya yoga so yaha kahyau, bhinna hi hbinna prakāra | ātama nitya svarūpa hai, deha anitya vicāra ||* 12 *||*

[1005] See p. 246.

[1006] For the discussion of Siddhayoga in the *Tattvayogabindu*, see p. 436.

3.23 Sahajayoga

SAHAJAYOGA, among the texts of the complex yoga taxonomies, is exclusively mentioned in the *Tattvayogabindu*. Generally, in Sanskrit literature, the term is often linked to the "classical" Avadhūta. The archetypal Avadhūta has renounced *saṃsāra* and rejects both worldly and religious activities. He is typically associated with *nirguṇa bhakti*, devotion to the formless Divine, and, rather than complex spiritual disciplines, pursues the sole true and natural practice: the repetition of the Divine name.[1007]

The model of the Avadhūta that emerges in Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu* continues a trend that Kanamarlapudi (2023: 18) calls the "sanitisation" of the Avadhūta. In her study, she describes the term's history and identifies a clear development. Over the centuries, the Avadhūta, the original antinomian ascetic, was gradually integrated into the Brahmanical *āśrama* system. His antinomian behaviour, unconventional traits, and unorthodox practice were tamed, and according to Kanamarlapudi, the Avadhūta became a legitimate and eventually even the highest class of the *saṃnyāsa āśrama*.

An aspect of this development can be observed, for example, in the early history of Haṭhayoga. Mallinson (2011: 17) notes that in the early history of Haṭhayoga attributed to Gorakṣa (11th–13th centuries), "the antinomian external practices of Tantra were internalised and, together with the visualisation techniques of *kuṇḍalinīyoga*, were melted with the physical practices of early Haṭha Yoga, whose original aim was the sublimation of sexual continence into liberation."

Rāmacandra continues this process of sanitisation, reshaping the Avadhūta for royal or courtly adoption. In the *Tattvayogabindu*, the Avadhūta becomes the ideal type of the Rājayoga-practicing *kṣatriya* or king. Rāmacandra cuts off the last threads of the image of Avadhūta that is still connected to the antinomian ascetic.[1008] On the contrary, Rāmacandra's Avadhūta does not scorn worldly activity; rather, he is indifferent to it yet fully involved in it and extremely positive towards worldly pleasures. The natural consequence

[1007] Mallinson, 2011: 15.
[1008] *Tattvayogabindu* XLIV p. 242.

is that Rāmacandra elevates Sahajayoga to the practice *par excellence* for a king.

Rāmacandra defines Sahajayoga, the "natural yoga," at the very end of his work, in section LIX. This passage is presented as the "esoteric yoga doctrine in all of the scriptures," forming the grand climax of the text. This secret is explicitly directed at kings, princes or aristocrats at the royal court.[1009] More specifically, the secret is addressed to a good king characterised by being honest, fearless, reputable, trusting of good people, always blissful, and surrounded by enchanting objects.

Then Rāmacandra explains to whom this secret should explicitly not be revealed: not to those who blame others, criticise, misbehave, do not speak the truth, lack compassion, and enjoy conflict.[1010]

Finally, Rāmacandra reveals the secret. The esoteric yoga teaching evokes the person of one who embodies the highest reality, free from existence and non-existence (*bhāvābhāvavinirmuktaḥ*).[1011] And although this person, viz. the king or a *kṣatriya*, as the enjoyer of the earth, is constantly exposed to worldly pleasures, he is free from all attachments. This person is a yogin made of perpetual bliss (*sadānandamayo yogī*) and dwells in constant equanimity towards happiness and sorrow. The person has realised the indivisible highest self and performs actions without personal desires or attachments.[1012]

While an ordinary person must constantly stabilise the gaze (*dṛṣṭiḥ sthirā kartavyā*), stabilise the sitting posture (*āsanaṃ dṛḍhaṃ kartavyaṃ*), and stabilise

[1009] *Tattvayogabindu* LIX: *yasya rājño manomadhye kapaṭaṃ nāsti | yasmin dṛṣṭe deśakasya trāso na bhavati | yasya manaḥ śuddhaṃ bhavati | yasya pṛthivyāṃ kīrtir bhavati | yasya manomadhye satpuruṣavacanaviśvāso bhavati | yo rājā sadānandapūrṇo bhavati | yasya pārśve pratyakṣam anekaṃ manohārivastūni bhavanti | etādṛśasya rājño 'gre yogarahasyaṃ kathanīyam |*

[1010] Ibid. LIX: *yaḥ paranindā rato bhavati | dūrācāro bhavati | bhrātumitrasya ca yogyaṃ vastu na dadāti | yo satyaṃ na vati | yo yogināṃ manomadhye nindāṃ karoti | yasya manomadhye dayā na bhavati | yaḥ kalahapriyo bhavati | svakāryakaraṇe sāvadhāno bhavati | guroḥ kāryakaraṇe 'nādito bhavati | etādṛśasyāgre na yogaḥ kriyate na paṭhyate |*

[1011] This statement implies a characterisation of the highest reality (*tattva*), which in *Amanaska* 2.62 is described as free from the duality of existence and non-existence: *bhāvābhāvadvayātītaṃ svapnajāgaraṇātigam | mṛtyujīvananirmuktaṃ tattvaṃ tattvavido viduḥ* ‖ 62 ‖ "The knowers of the highest reality know that the highest reality is beyond the duality of existence and non-existence, passes beyond [both] sleep and waking and is free from dying and living." (Translated by Birch, 2013: 318).

[1012] *Tattvayogabindu* LIX. 1–8.

the breath (*pavanaḥ sthiraḥ kartavyaḥ*) to achieve this state, a perfected person no longer needs to adhere to this discipline (*etādṛśaḥ kaścin niyamaḥ siddhasya noktaḥ* |).

> *manaḥpavanābhyāṃ yadā sahajānandaḥ svasvarūpeṇa prakāśyate | sa sahajayogaḥ kathyate rājayogamadhye | iti cakravartināmakathanaṃ |*
>
> When by means of mind and breath, the natural bliss appears through one's own true nature, it is called Sahajayoga ("natural yoga") [in this system] of Rajayoga. This is the explanation for those named *cakravartin* ("Universal Ruler").

That is Rāmacandra's core message of his secret of yoga in all yoga scriptures. It recalls the *rājaguhyam* of the Mokṣopāya, a teaching through which rulers could attain a state free from suffering.[1013] These words conclude Rāmacandra's *Tattvayogabindu*. Thus, Sahajayoga is the ideal yoga for a king. For a king who rules and enjoys the amenities of this position, this is the aspired state, the ultimate. As a *kṣatriya*, he can maintain the soteriological state of salvation through Sahajayoga and continue fulfilling his caste duties without continuous practice. The duties of a ruler sometimes involve "cruel" actions, such as enforcing laws, possibly through war. Additionally, Sahajayoga enables the king, despite being an "enjoyer of the earth," to achieve soteriological completion without the deprivations typical for ascetics.[1014] The term *sahaja°* in this context thus primarily means natural but in the sense of "preserving its original nature" and "not undergoing further change."[1015]

3.24 Conclusion

The comparison of the medieval complex yoga taxonomies in the four texts *Tattvayogabindu*, *Yogasvarodaya*, *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, and *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* reveals a remarkable diversity of a total of twenty-three

[1013] *Mokṣopaya* 2.11.10–17.
[1014] See also Hanneder, 2006: 121.
[1015] *Sanskrit Wörterbuch*, 1858: 99.

different yoga categories. These categories are contextualised and structured differently depending on the text and show significant differences even within overlapping yoga categories in most cases.

1. Kriyāyoga
2. Jñānayoga
3. Caryāyoga
4. Carcāyoga
5. Haṭhayoga
6. Karmayoga
7. Layayoga
8. Dhyānayoga
9. Mantrayoga
10. Lakṣyayoga
11. Vāsanāyoga
12. Śivayoga
13. Brahmayoga
14. Advaitayoga
15. Siddhayoga
16. Siddhakuṇḍalinīyoga
17. Siddhiyoga
18. Aṣṭāṅgayoga
19. Bhaktiyoga
20. Premabhaktiyoga
21. Sāṃkhyayoga
22. Sahajayoga
23. Rājayoga

The degree of difference in the taxonomies and the significantly divergent interpretations of the yoga categories among the texts indicates that the transmission was not a purely textual phenomenon with a linear reception history. Instead, the complex yoga taxonomies were likely part of cross-traditional and overlapping oral discourses. That is supported by the fact that the authors of the texts containing these complex early modern yoga taxonomies come from different religious traditions. Nevertheless, it must be stated clearly that the *Yogasvarodaya* (A) is, at present, the oldest known text to articulate a complex taxonomy of fifteen yogic methods. It constitutes the source text of the *Tattvayogabindu* (B), which likewise presents a fifteenfold taxonomy, and must therefore predate both Nārāyaṇatīrtha's *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (C) and Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* (D). Given that the present investigation establishes only the relative chronology of texts exhibiting complex taxonomies, any reception-historical influence at the purely textual level—if such influence occurred at all—can be assumed to have followed the following simplified pattern: A → B → C ↔ D.

Text	**Dating**
Yogasvarodaya	before 1591 CE
Tattvayogabindu	before 1591 CE and after YSv
Yogasiddhāntacandrikā	1659–1690 CE
Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā	before 1685 CE

Table 9: Chronology of the texts with complex yoga taxonomies.

While Rāmacandra, the author of the *Tattvayogabindu*, promoted a form of religious universalism that is almost profane in character and oriented towards Advaita Vedānta—despite the many Śaiva features of his source texts that naturally entered his own composition—the author of the *Yogasvarodaya* likely emerged from a South Indian Śaiva milieu. Nārāyaṇatīrtha was a renowned *saṃnyāsa* intellectual and prolific author, born a Brahmin and a follower of Kṛṣṇa,[1016] whereas Sant Sundardās was regarded as one

[1016] Ko, 1993: 41.

of the most learned Dādūpanthīs and, in his writings, propagated the Sant belief system as a representative Vaiṣṇava *bhakta*.[1017]

It is noteworthy that two of the authors, namely Sundardās and Nārāyaṇatīrtha, spent a significant part of their lives in Benares. Sundardās lived in Benares between the first decade of the 17th century and around 1625 CE, where he was trained in the dominant knowledge systems of the time, including aesthetics and the tradition of artistic poetry (*kāvya*).[1018] Ko (1993: 56) convincingly narrows the flourishing period of Nārāyaṇatīrtha to 1600–1690 CE. It is generally agreed that Nārāyaṇatīrtha also spent much of his life in Benares, though the exact period is yet to be determined.[1019] It is possible that both authors lived in Benares simultaneously.

Text	**Religious Context**
Yogasvarodaya	Śaiva (Vaiṣṇava influence)
Tattvayogabindu	almost Profane, Advaita Vedānta (Śaiva influence)
Yogasiddhāntacandrikā	Vaiṣṇava, Brāhmaṇa, Pātañjalayoga
Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā	Dādūpanthī, Sant Vaiṣṇava Bhakti

Table 10: Religious context of the texts with complex yoga taxonomies.

The few clues that exist for locating Rāmacandra and the *Tattvayogabindu* first of all narrow the place of its composition to the northern part of India. One of the most compelling reasons for this conclusion is the list of nine rivers in section XL. Compared to Rāmacandra's primary source text, the *Yogasvarodaya*, the *Tattvayogabindu* mentions the rivers Vipāśā (modern Beas) and Śatarudrā (modern Sutlej) instead of the central-southern Indian rivers Godāvārī and Kāverī, indicating a northern context.[1020] Although the *Yogasvarodaya* was likely composed much further south, this work circulated in northeastern India. This observation is based on the fact that it is currently known only through specific citations, namely in the *Prāṇatoṣinī*, written

[1017] Horstmann and Rajpurohit, 2023: 84–87.
[1018] Ibid. p. 86.
[1019] Penna, 2004: 24.
[1020] See n. 382 on p. 227.

near Calcutta,[1021] the *Yogakarṇikā*, whose origin is unknown,[1022] and the *Śabdakalpadruma*, which Radhakanta Deva (1784–1867) also compiled in Calcutta. Thus, it can be inferred that northeastern India was a significant area for the circulation of the *Yogasvarodaya*. Given that Rāmacandra extensively drew from the *Yogasvarodaya* for the compilation of the *Tattvayogabindu*, and since his fifteen yogas were part of an oral and literary discourse centred in Benares, it would be plausible that Rāmacandra also resided in Benares for some time. Finally, this hypothesis is supported by the fact that Sundaradeva lived in Benares[1023] and his citations of the *Tattvayogabindu* in the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* represent the second oldest verifiable testimony of the *Tattvayogabindu*.[1024] Based on the cumulative evidence, the hypothesis of Rāmacandra compiling the *Tattvayogabindu* in northern India can be considered secured. It seems possible that Rāmacandra may have spent some time of his life in the Benares area.

What is certain is that both the *Yogasvarodaya* and the *Tattvayogabindu*, as has been shown,[1025] must have been written before 1591 CE. Thus, all complex early modern yoga taxonomies emerged within a remarkably narrow timeframe—most likely from the middle of the sixteenth century to around 1690 CE—with a significant proportion of these texts produced in the discursive milieu of Benares. Each author and text has individual reasons for addressing or codifying the complex yoga taxonomies. Rāmacandra's text, for instance, appears to have been intended for the education of young princes or potential kings. The taxonomy serves both as an encyclopedia and a way to convey the superiority of Rājayoga, in the sense of a "Yoga for Kings," and its methods through a hierarchical taxonomy. Integrating the fifteenfold yoga taxonomy from the *Yogasvarodaya* is undoubtedly a continuation of an older Śaiva strategy. This strategy aimed to integrate yogas from various traditions into a hierarchical schema, emphasizing a Śaiva interpretation

[1021] Shāstri 1905.

[1022] The only available printed edition of the *Yogakarṇikā* by Nath Sharma (2004) is based on a manuscript presumably from Benares, see Nath Sharma, 2004: vi.

[1023] Birch, 2018: 123.

[1024] See p. 6.

[1025] For the dating of the *Tattvayogabindu* and the *Yogasvarodaya*, see p. 6.

of *samādhi* and liberation in life (*jīvanmukti*).[1026] Fundamentally, this is an extension of the older fourfold taxonomy that subordinated Mantra, Laya, and Haṭhayoga in hierarchical order to Rājayoga.

In the case of the *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Ko (1998: 34–35) suggests that Nārāyaṇatīrtha, in line with Paul Hacker's concept of "inclusivism" (1979), sought to integrate the increasingly popular medieval yogas into his context. Ko sees this as an attempt by Nārāyaṇatīrtha to not only equate the perceived inferior foreign and popular forms of medieval yoga with his form, the Pātañjalayoga model but also to subordinate them to it.

Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* has a less instructional and more informal or encyclopedic character, placing great emphasis on both systematics and aesthetics. However, it also follows a clear agenda much less hierarchical than those taxonomies that place Rājayoga at the top. Instead, Sundardās seeks to find a common thread and establishes an overarching context between the yoga categories he discusses. He creates a harmonious order through a successive and logical sequence, beginning with Bhaktiyoga, with an evident Vaiṣṇava influence, moving through Haṭhayoga, encompassing various body-oriented yogas. His system culminates in philosophically oriented yogas, starting with Sāṃkhyayoga, which creates awareness of duality through the philosophical contemplation of the world's components. This differentiation is then resolved in the experience of unity in Brahmayoga, ultimately leading to the state he considers the *summum bonum*, Advaitayoga.[1027]

This categorical and interpretative diversity reflected in the complex taxonomies suggests a veritable cross-traditional yoga boom in the milieu of the authors considered, marking an unprecedented wave of popularity, particularly for medieval and body-oriented yoga forms like Haṭhayoga, which various traditions and the educated elite increasingly engaged with. At the same time, the comparison of the texts of the yoga taxonomies revealed a genuine struggle for asserting interpretive authority, a contest over the

[1026] The Śaiva subordination of yogas into a Rājayoga model began after the 10th century CE and was first described by Birch, 2019.

[1027] As Burger (2004: 706) observed, Sundardās's three yoga tetrads strongly recall the tripartite division of yogas in the *Bhagavadgītā* with Bhakti, Karma, and Jñāna.

interpretation and classification of yoga categories, and an attempt to highlight one's conception of the best yoga. In our case study, within its clearly defined discursive framework, the previously mentioned popularity at that time permeated many social strata. Yoga and its efficacy were endowed with high soteriological significance to the extent that by the 16th century, yoga could not be absent from the curriculum in the circles of the ruling classes. Furthermore, it becomes evident that the meanings of the various yoga categories were very fluid and were discursively negotiated in lively and dynamic exchange processes. It is therefore not surprising that the phenomenon of early modern complex yoga taxonomies developed in a specific fertile ground. One such fertile ground was sixteenth–seventeenth-century Benares, located in northeastern India.

Benares has always been a centre of knowledge, attracting scholars from near and far for centuries. However, with the onset of Muslim rule in India, many prominent scholars teaching in Benares left the city for fear of religious persecution. By the 16th century, Benares experienced a cultural revival, primarily sparked by the open religious policy of the Mughal Emperor Akbar and his immediate successors, the "Pax Mughalia".[1028] That was a significant

[1028] In 1556, at the age of 13, Akbar ascended the throne of the Mughal Empire, which had been partially reconquered by his father but collapsed immediately after his death under almost hopeless circumstances; see Stietencron, 1989: 53. Following a period of military consolidation of his empire, a divided situation marked by social and religious tensions prevailed in northern India. Hindus, in particular, were humiliated and exploited. Rajasthan, Gujarat, and central India were not part of his empire. Beginning with his marriage to the daughter of the Rajput prince Rājā Bihārī Mal of Amber in 1562, Akbar initiated a policy of pacification. More wives from the princely houses of Rajasthan followed, all of whom retained their religious customs. He issued decrees allowing Hindus to rebuild temples and perform religious practices in public. Overall, Akbar's reign was characterised by a very open religious policy. For instance, he promoted Hindus like Todar Mal and Mān Singh to high political positions for the first time; see ibid., p. 70. Akbar encouraged interfaith dialogue and even created a lodge-like free-thinking order, the Dīn-i-Ilāhī, the "divine faith," aiming to collect the best from all religions and discard anything that was rationally unconvincing to find a common truth; see ibid. p. 62. During this time, numerous previously destroyed Hindu temples were rebuilt in Benares; see ibid., pp. 58–59. Later vassals of the Mughal emperors, especially the later Kachwaha Rajput rulers of Amber, notably under Rāja Man Singh I, constructed numerous temples and *ghāṭ*s in the city; see Hooja, 2006: 493–495. Akbar's immediate successor, Jahāngīr (1605–1627), continued the open religious policy; see Wheeler (1999). It was only during the reign of Shāh Jahān, who ruled the Mughal Empire from 1628–1658 that the government's general attitude became less favourable towards Hindus again from 1632

catalyst for the emerging formation of not just the solidification of religious identities in northern India,[1029] but also a general increasingly pronounced "Hindu" identity, which both took shape during the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries.[1030] Yoga played a crucial role in the development of this new identity. Under the patronage of the Mughal emperors, Benares once again became a melting pot of intellectual and religious exchange, attracting many scholars to resettle there, as evidenced by the examples of Sundardās and Nārāyaṇatīrtha. Concurrently, as Birch (2020: 471–472) demonstrated in his article "Haṭhayoga's Floruit on the Eve of Colonialism", there was a general flourishing of Haṭhayoga literature in both North and South India. From the 16th century onwards, Haṭhayoga literature became increasingly diverse. Authors from various traditions, mainly learned Brahmins, sought to expand Haṭhayoga and integrate other yogas and religions. The beginnings of this development, highlighted by Birch, are discernible here.

Another catalyst that initiated the floruit of Haṭhayoga literature was the acquisition of corporate identities of the four main ascetic orders of North India (Nāths, Daśanāmī saṃnyāsīs, Rāmānandīs, and Udāsīs). By 1600, the Nāth yogīs were reportedly organised into 12 panths, with all their headquarters located in North India.[1031] This acquisition of corporate identities of the ascetic orders strengthened the discursive weight of their views, teachings and texts on the market of religious options in northern India. Thus, other religious traditions were stimulated to deal with those impulses.

Thus, the complex early modern yoga taxonomies of medieval yogas resulted from the convergence of various yogic traditions and associated

onwards. Shāh Jahān ordered a law for the destruction of Hindu temples under construction, as his Islamic theologians sought to prevent the construction and renovation of temples of other religions. However, it remains unclear how strictly this law was enforced and to what extent this religious policy shift after three-quarters of a century of religious dialogue and tolerance affected the population. The impacts were at most marginal. During Shāh Jahān's reign, seven instances of temple destruction are documented; see Eaton. How his rule specifically impacted Benares is unclear but presumably minimal. For example, the then Rāja of Amber, Jai Singh I, who ruled from 1627–1667, was an important military ally, and his father, Man Singh I, had invested large sums in the construction of Hindu temples in Benares. It was only under Aurangzeb (1658–1707) that a distinct of anti-Hindu policy resurged.

[1029] O'Hanlon and Washbrook, 2011.

[1030] Clark, 2006: 188.

[1031] Mallinson, 2011: 17.

religions in melting pots of intellectual and religious exchange during the early blossoming phase of a new, more diversified wave of yoga literature, mainly disseminated through hubs like Benares.[1032] Moreover, they are a literary testament to this process and reflect the discursive negotiations and repositioning of authors from different traditions in response to new yogic impulses affecting them.

[1032] Given the high likelihood that the *Yogasvarodaya* was composed in more southern regions, we can assume that the discourse surrounding complex Yoga taxonomies had another area of dissemination. There is no doubt that South Indian scholars were drawn to Benares. This is evidenced by the authors discussed here: on one hand, Nārāyaṇatīrtha, who was originally from Kaza in the Guntur District of present-day Andhra Pradesh and then spent a significant part of his life in Benares, see Ko, 1993: 43. On the other hand, Sundaradeva, the author of the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā*, also originated from more southern regions before moving to Benares, see Birch, 2018: 123 n. 61.

Appendix

Figures



Figure 1: The *dehasvarūpa* of *ajapāgāyatrī*. The image, reminiscent of a hippogriff, is part of an illustrated Sanskrit manuscript written in the Śāradā script. Preserved as a single large scroll under Acc. No. 1334 at the Oriental Institute in Srinagar (Kashmir), it is entitled *Nāḍīcakra*. The manuscript contains a depiction of the yogic body's *cakra*s, *nāḍī*s and the yogic cosmos. The text surrounding the figure closely corresponds to the additional material found in manuscript U_2 of the *Tattvayogabindu*. The manuscript reads (diplomatic transcription): *oṃ daśame pūrṇagiripīṭhe lalāṭamaṇḍale candro devatā amṛtāśaktiḥ paramātmā ṛṣiḥ dvāviṃśaddalāni amṛtavāsinikalā 4: ambikā 1 lambikā 2 gha(ṃ)ṭkā 3 tālikā 4 dehasvarūpaṃ kākamukhaṃ 1 naranetraṃ 2 gośṛṅgaṃ 3 lalāṭa brahmapara 4 hayagrīvā 5 mayūramuścaṃ haṃsacārītāni 7 sthāna.*



Figure 2: Viṣṇu Viśvarūpa, India, Rajasthan, Jaipur, ca. 1800–1820, Opaque watercolor and gold on paper, 38.5 × 28 cm, Victoria and Albert Museum, London, Given by Mrs. Gerald Clark.



Figure 3: The Equivalence of the Self and the Universe (detail), folio 6 from the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* (Bulaki), India, Rajasthan, Jodhpur, 1824 (Samvat 1881), 122 x 46 cm, RJS 2378, Mehragarh Museum Trust.

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